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1 Kings 1:1–4

1 Kings

1 Kings 1:1–4

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 1:1–4 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:1–4 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:1–4 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The storyteller wants to tell us about the history of the kings of Israel from the end of David's reign of Israel. The storyteller uses the books of 1 and 2 Kings to continue the story of the people of Israel that began in the books of Joshua, Judges, and 1 and 2 Samuel. First, the storyteller tells us about the history of the united kingdom of Israel. Then the storyteller tells us about the divided kingdoms of Israel in the north and Judah in the south. Then the storyteller tells us about the end of the kingdoms of Israel and Judah until the Babylonians destroyed Jerusalem. The storyteller starts his story by telling us about King David. David was king for a long time and was very old. David lived for many years and was still a king when he was very old.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do the leaders of your community or nation do when they get very old? Do the leaders continue to lead, or do they stop and let someone else become the leader? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller shows that David did not have the strength and health to continue to be a strong and powerful king. But it was only David's body that was not working well. David could still think very well.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If possible, talk about leaders who led your people or community even when they were old. What signs of old age did people see and talk about? How did people feel about having a leader who was very old? Pause this audio here.

When David was very old, David got cold very easily and did not get warm when people put covers or blankets over him.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about older people in your community. How do those people stay warm or try to get warm if they feel cold? Pause this audio here.

David's servants talked to David. These servants were more like advisors to David, or officials in David's palace. The servants told David that the servants would look for a young woman. The servants wanted the young woman to be unmarried and a virgin, someone who had not had sexual intercourse with a man. The servants wanted the young woman to come to be with David and to serve David by taking care of David. The servants wanted the young woman to share David's bed and to be in David's arms. We do not know what the servants wanted to happen when the woman was in David's arms. It is possible that the servants just wanted the woman to keep David warm. However, the servants may have wanted to see if David could have more strength and health by having sexual intercourse with a young woman. At the time of David, some people believed that when an older

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man had sexual intercourse with a young woman, the young woman would give the man more strength and make him younger.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about someone in your community who has married or shared their home with someone much younger than themself. What did people say when the person began the relationship? How did people think that the younger person would affect or change the older person? Pause this audio here.

The servants searched all the different parts of Israel for a beautiful young woman. We do not know if the servants searched for the woman or if they got other people to search for the woman. The servants wanted the woman to be physically beautiful. The servants found a woman called Abishag who lived in Shunem. Shunem was a village near Mount Gilboa, south-west of Lake Galilee.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel that shows the city of Jerusalem and the village of Shunem. Pause this audio here.

Abishag left Shunem and went to David in Jerusalem. Abishag served and looked after David. David did not know Abishag, which means David did not have sexual intercourse with Abishag. Abishag was not David's concubine or wife. We do not know if David chose not to have sexual intercourse with Abishag or if David was not able to have sexual intercourse with Abishag. The storyteller uses the information that David did not have sexual intercourse with Abishag as a sign to show us that David was not strong and powerful and was not able to rule Israel well.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:1–4 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: David is very old and his body is not working well so he cannot get warm. David's servants, or advisors, suggest to David that the servants find a young woman to look after David and help keep David warm.

In the second scene: The servants look for a beautiful young woman in all of Israel. The servants find Abishag from Shunem. The servants take Abishag to Jerusalem.

In the third scene: Abishag looks after David but David does not have sexual relations with Abishag.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- David's servants, who are his advisors
- And Abishag from Shunem

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller starts the story at a time when David was very old. David was not just an older man, but David was at a time in his life when David's body was not working well because he was very old.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about someone who is very old? Pause this audio here.

David's body did not work very well, so David could not stay warm. David's body did not work well for some time, and it was a problem that David had more than one time. David's servants noticed that David's body was not working well to keep David warm. The servants were people who worked for and served David to help David lead Israel. These servants were not like the servants who did domestic tasks like cleaning or cooking.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call people who work closely with and help the most important leader in your people group or nation? Pause this audio here.

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The servants used very polite language to talk to David. The servants referred to David as another person in the conversation, even though the servants talked directly to David. The servants used a formal title, “our lord the king,” to refer to David instead of using David’s name.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you change your language when you talk to someone who is very important and you want to show respect? Pause this audio here.

The servants organised a search for a beautiful, young, unmarried woman throughout all of Israel. The servants wanted the woman to be a female servant or helper for David. The woman would help David by lying in David’s bosom. A bosom is the chest of a person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call a young, unmarried woman who has not had sexual intercourse? Pause this audio here.

The servants found Abishag in the village of Shunem and took Abishag to King David in Jerusalem. Just as David was very old, Abishag was very beautiful. Abishag was more beautiful than most beautiful women.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and find Shunem and Jerusalem, if necessary. Pause this audio here.

Abishag took care of David. Abishag also waited on David, which means Abishag did small tasks to help David and served David. David did not know Abishag. This means that David did not have sexual intercourse with Abishag.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Sometimes people use a polite word or phrase to refer to things that people may feel upset or embarrassed to talk about. What words or phrases, if any, would you use in this way to talk about sexual intercourse? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:1–4 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- David’s servants, who are his advisors
- And Abishag from Shunem

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David is very old and his body is not working well so David cannot get warm. David’s servants suggest to David that the servants find a young woman to look after David and help warm David.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

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- I have lived a very long time; or
- I feel cold. Even with extra blankets, I cannot get warm; or
- My body is getting weak but I can still rule Israel.

Ask the person playing David's servants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Maybe a young woman will warm our king and help him to feel younger; or
- We need to do something to help our king; or
- We are worried that David is too old to be king.

Continue the drama.

The servants look for a beautiful young woman in all of Israel. The servants find Abishag from Shunem. The servants take Abishag to Jerusalem.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David's servants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We need to find a very beautiful young woman for our king; or
- The woman must not be married to anybody; or
- Abishag is very beautiful. Abishag must come to be with our king.

Ask the person playing Abishag from Shunem, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honoured that people chose me to look after our king; or
- I am worried to go from my small village to the city of Jerusalem; or
- What will I need to do to serve my king?

Continue the drama.

Abishag looks after David but David does not have sexual relations with Abishag.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Abishag, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I lie in my king's bed and keep my king warm; or
- I am still a virgin; or
- Am I a servant? The king did not make me his concubine or wife.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Abishag is very beautiful and very helpful to me; or
- I like how Abishag looks after me; or
- I have not had sexual relations with Abishag.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:1–4 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King David was very old.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **king**. Look up king in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. For more information on David, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

David could not stay warm even when people put covers or clothes for a bed over David.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **covers**. Pause this audio here.

David's servants, or advisors, decided to look for a young virgin woman to serve David. These men are a special kind of servant who look after the personal needs of a leader and advise the leader.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **servants**. You can use the word for servants, which is also in the Master Glossary. Or, you can use a word that means advisors or people who help a leader make good decisions about the leader's personal life. Pause this audio here.

The servants looked for a young virgin woman throughout Israel. A virgin is a person who is unmarried and has not had sexual intercourse with anyone. You will remember that Israel is the nation of people that Yahweh specially chose.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Israel** and for **virgin**. Israel is in the Master Glossary. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The servants found Abishag in Shunem and brought her to David. Abishag took care of David and waited on or served David.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (967 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 1:5–10

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 1:5–10 and put it in your hearts.

1 Kings 1:5–10

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:5–10 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:5–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You will remember from the previous story that David is very old. David's body is not working very well, and when David's servants gave a beautiful young virgin to David, David did not have sexual relations with her. The storyteller gives us this information to show that David might not be able to rule Israel well and will die soon.

In this story, the storyteller starts to tell us about David's oldest living son, Adonijah. Adonijah, David's fourth son, was very proud and thought that he was the right person to be the next king of Israel. Adonijah boasted that he wanted to be king. Adonijah's mother was Haggith. You will remember from 2 Samuel that David's first son, Amnon, and David's third son, Absalom, are dead. We do not know what happened to Chileab, David's second son, but he probably died as a child. People thought David was very old and not able to rule Israel. Adonijah decided to be the next king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What happens when your most important leader gets old and cannot lead anymore? What happens if the people lose confidence in the leader's ability to lead? Who decides which person will become the most important leader next? Pause this audio here.

Adonijah told people that he wanted to be king. Adonijah decided to make himself look like a king, so Adonijah gathered together chariots and men to look after the horses for the chariots. A chariot is a two-wheeled cart that two horses pull along. A man or two men stand in the chariot to control the horses. A horse has four legs. People ride on horses, and sometimes horses pull carts or other wheeled vehicles along. In David's time, people used chariots in war to attack people, but important people also travelled in chariots during ceremonies and parades.

Stop here and look at a picture of a person driving a chariot as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of a horse as a group. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah also gathered 50 men to run in front of the chariots when Adonijah was in one of the chariots. The 50 men would help to clear a path for the chariots to move along.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How would you know that your most important leader was going past you? What vehicles or animals does the leader ride, and who rides with the leader? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller pauses the action in the story and gives information about Adonijah to help us understand why Adonijah was proud and thought he should be king. The storyteller tells us that David never made Adonijah unhappy by questioning why Adonijah did something. The storyteller is telling us that David did not discipline Adonijah and did not stop Adonijah from doing whatever Adonijah wanted to do. The storyteller also tells us that Adonijah was a very handsome man. People around Adonijah probably gave Adonijah special treatment because he was very handsome. Also, Adonijah was the son born after Absalom. After Absalom died, Adonijah was the next oldest son of David, and people gave Adonijah special treatment as the eldest living son of the king. Adonijah was used to people giving him what he wanted, and Adonijah believed that he should be the next king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about someone you know who believed that people should treat that person differently and better, or give them something special, because they were the oldest child. How

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did the person make their feelings known to people around them? What did the person do to make you notice them? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller returns to the story. Adonijah discussed his desire to become king with some important people in Israel. Joab was the leader of Israel's army, and you will remember that Zeruiah was Joab's mother. You will also remember that Joab did not always follow David's commands. Abiathar was a very important priest in Jerusalem. We do not know why Abiathar supported Adonijah. It is possible that, as David got older, David preferred Zadok the priest and made Abiathar unhappy. Joab and Abiathar decided to support Adonijah and help Adonijah become king.

The storyteller now tells us that a different group of people did not support Adonijah. Zadok was an important priest in Jerusalem and had a good relationship with David. Benaiah was the leader of a special group of fighters, the Kerethites and Pelethites, who protected David. Nathan the prophet was an important advisor to David. You may remember that Nathan gave David's son, Solomon, a special name that means "God loves him," to show David and Israel that Yahweh favored Solomon. We do not know who Shimei and Rei were. Shimei was possibly someone who later became an administrator for Solomon, but he was not the same person as Shimei, son of Gera, who cursed David. David's mighty men were David's special group of guards, or fighting men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when one group of people supported a person to do something, but another group of people did not support the person. Pause this audio here.

Sometime after Adonijah discussed his desire to be king with Joab and Abiathar, Adonijah prepared a special ceremony. Adonijah gathered together some animals to sacrifice. We do not know why Adonijah sacrificed animals, but it was probably part of a ceremony to make Adonijah king of Israel. Adonijah was trying to do everything to make himself look like the king of Israel, even though Yahweh did not choose Adonijah to be the king of Israel. You will remember that a sacrifice is a gift to God and that people often put a sacrifice on a stone platform or flat rock. Usually, a priest would sacrifice the animals, and Adonijah probably asked a priest to sacrifice the animals. Adonijah sacrificed sheep, oxen, including male, female, and young animals, and special male cattle that people had made fat and ready for people to sacrifice. Oxen and cattle are the same type of animal.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sheep as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of oxen or cattle as a group. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah sacrificed the animals on a rock called the Stone of Zoheleth or the Serpent's Stone near the Spring of En Rogel. En Rogel was near Jerusalem, and the Israelites used the spring to mark the border between the lands of Judah and Benjamin. The Israelites thought springs of water were special places. A spring is a place where clean water comes up out of the ground.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Judah and Benjamin in Israel. Find Jerusalem and the Spring of En Rogel. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah invited important people who supported him to the ceremony. The storyteller first tells us that Adonijah invited all of Adonijah's brothers. These brothers had the same father, David, but had different mothers. All Adonijah's brothers at the ceremony were King David's sons. Adonijah also invited special officials who served King David in the land of Judah. We do not know why Adonijah invited the officials from Judah, but you will remember that Adonijah was born in Hebron, in Judah. Judah was the name of one of Jacob's sons, and therefore the name of one of the 12 tribes of Israel. Each tribe had a special territory of land called by the name of the tribe.

Adonijah did not invite other people who were important and supported David, but not Adonijah. Adonijah did not invite Nathan, Benaiah, the mighty men, or Adonijah's brother, Solomon. Solomon was also the son of David but did not have the same mother as Adonijah. You will remember from the end of 1 Chronicles that David has probably already appointed Solomon to be the next king of Israel.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:5–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 1:5–10

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Adonijah told people that Adonijah wanted to be the next king. Adonijah gathered chariots, horsemen, and 50 men together to make himself look like a king.

In the second scene: The storyteller gives us reasons why Adonijah was confident and proud. David never questioned anything Adonijah did. Also, Adonijah was handsome, and Adonijah was David's oldest living son.

In the third scene: Adonijah talked to Joab and Abiathar about Adonijah's desire to become king. Joab and Abiathar supported Adonijah to be king. Zadok, Benaiah, Nathan, Shimei, Rei, and David's mighty men did not support Adonijah to be king.

In the fourth scene: Adonijah prepared a ceremony on the Stone of Zoheleth near the Spring of En Rogel. Adonijah sacrificed animals and invited his brothers and the king's officials from Judah. Adonijah did not invite Nathan, Benaiah, David's mighty men, or Solomon.

The characters in this passage are:

- Adonijah
- The storyteller
- Joab and Abiathar, Adonijah's supporters
- Zadok, Benaiah, Nathan, Shimei, Rei, and David's mighty men
- Adonijah's brothers
- The royal officials from Judah
- And Solomon

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story happened when David was very old, and people were worried that David was not strong enough to be king. The storyteller tells us this story immediately after he tells us that David was very old and that David's body was weak. Adonijah responds to David's old age and weakness and decides that he should be king. Adonijah's mother was Haggith, one of David's wives.

Adonijah raises himself up or puts himself forward. When a person puts themselves forward or makes themselves high, the person thinks that they are very good at doing something, and that other people should see how good that person is. The person might boast or say lots of good things about themselves and be proud. Adonijah tells people that Adonijah will be the next king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How would you describe what Adonijah does to make people know that Adonijah wants to be king? Pause this audio here.

After Adonijah boasts to people and says that he will be the king, Adonijah gets ready chariots, horsemen, and 50 men to run in front of Adonijah's chariot. Adonijah wants to look like an important and rich king when he moves from one place to another.

The storyteller pauses the narrative to give us reasons why Adonijah thinks he should be king and why Adonijah decides to behave like a king. The storyteller tells us that David never made Adonijah unhappy by questioning Adonijah's behaviour or choices. Adonijah always did everything that Adonijah wanted to do. Adonijah was very handsome. A handsome man has a very attractive face and body that people like to look at. Adonijah was more handsome than many handsome people.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have one person in your group tell a story about another person. In the middle of the story, have the person pause and give the group some more information about the character of the person in their story. Then have the person continue to tell the story. How does the additional information about the person's character help you to understand the story? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you say that Adonijah was a very handsome man? Pause this audio here.

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Lastly, the storyteller reminds us that Haggith gave birth to Adonijah after Maacah gave birth to Absalom. Adonijah was David's fourth son and David's oldest living son.

Adonijah conferred with or talked to Joab and Abiathar to find out if Joab and Abiathar would support Adonijah to be king of Israel. Abiathar was a priest, a male descendant of Aaron who served Yahweh by making sacrifices to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you describe a conversation when someone talks to a person or people to find out what they think about an idea or action? Pause this audio here.

Joab and Abiathar decided to support Adonijah to become the new king. The storyteller does not tell us that Adonijah talked to Zadok and the other people, but they all knew that Adonijah wanted to be king. Zadok, Benaiah, Nathan the prophet, Shimei, Rei, and David's mighty men did not support Adonijah, and they did not join Adonijah's group of supporters. You may remember that a prophet was someone who heard directly from Yahweh and gave Yahweh's messages to the Israelites.

Sometime after Joab and Abiathar supported Adonijah to be king, Adonijah decided to sacrifice animals as a gift to Yahweh. Adonijah went to a place called the Stone of Zoheleth. The word Zoheleth is similar to the word that means to crawl and glide in the original language. Some people call it the Serpent's Stone because a snake moves in such a way that it slides and glides over the earth. Some people think that the rock was smooth and easy to slide over. Other people think that the rock was near where the rock slid down a slope.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What will you call the Stone of Zoholeth or the Serpent's Stone in your translation? Pause this audio here.

This stone was near the spring called En Rogel. A spring is a place where water naturally comes up through the ground.

Adonijah wanted important people to see the sacrifices and possibly share the meat as part of a feast to celebrate Adonijah becoming king. Adonijah invited all of the rest of King David's sons. The storyteller calls these sons Adonijah's brothers, but although they all had the same father, they had different mothers than Adonijah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call the relationship between people who have the same father but a different mother to each other? Pause this audio here.

Royal officials from Judah also went to the Stone of Zoheleth. The officials were not part of the royal family, but they worked for David to manage David's kingdom in Judah.

Adonijah did not invite Nathan the prophet, Benaiah, David's mighty men, or Solomon, his brother. Solomon and Adonijah also had different mothers.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:5–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Adonijah
- The storyteller
- Joab and Abiathar, Adonijah's supporters
- Zadok, Benaiah, Nathan, Shimei, Rei, and David's mighty men
- Adonijah's brothers
- The royal officials from Judah
- And Solomon

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

1 Kings 1:5–10

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Adonijah told people that he wanted to be the next king. Adonijah gathered chariots, horsemen, and 50 men together to make Adonijah look like a king.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Adonijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I think that I should be the next king; or
- Look at me! I am rich and powerful and will make a good king; or
- Make way for me! Look at all my men making a way for me to come.

Continue the drama.

The storyteller gives us reasons why Adonijah was confident and proud. David never questioned anything Adonijah did. Also, Adonijah was handsome and was David's oldest living son.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the storyteller, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- David was not a good parent to Adonijah; or
- David should have punished Adonijah when Adonijah did something wrong or was too proud; or
- People always said yes to Adonijah and did what he wanted because of who Adonijah was and what he looked like.

Continue the drama.

Adonijah talked to Joab and Abiathar about Adonijah's desire to become king. Joab and Abiathar supported Adonijah to be king. Zadok, Benaiah, Nathan, Shimei, Rei, and David's mighty men did not support Adonijah to be king.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Adonijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Will you support me to be the next king? or
- I am glad that powerful people like Joab and Abiathar support me and will help me be king; or
- I am disappointed that Zadok and the other people do not support me. I hope that those people are not a problem for me.

Ask the person playing Joab and Abiathar, Adonijah's supporters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is time to have a new and strong king; or
- If Adonijah is king, we will be powerful too; or
- Adonijah is the oldest son of David.

Ask the person playing Zadok, Benaiah, Nathan, Shimei, Rei, and David's mighty men, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh did not choose Adonijah to be king; or
- We are worried that Adonijah thinks that he will be the next king of Israel; or
- We know that Solomon should be the next king.

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Continue the drama.

Adonijah prepared a ceremony on the Stone of Zoheleth near the Spring of En Rogel. Adonijah sacrificed animals and invited his brothers and the king's officials from Judah. Adonijah did not invite Nathan, Benaiah, David's mighty men, or Solomon.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Adonijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This ceremony will make me king of Israel; or
- All of my brothers will call me king of Israel; or
- The officials from Judah will see that I am now king and tell other people.

Ask the person playing Adonijah's brothers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We will show respect to Adonijah because he is older than us; or
- We do not know if Adonijah is king or not.

Ask the person playing the royal officials from Judah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Is Adonijah king? Is David still king? or
- Adonijah is making a great sacrifice to Yahweh; or
- We wonder what will happen now?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:5–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Adonijah put himself forward and wanted to be **king**. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Adonijah got chariots ready.

Stop here and look at a picture of a person driving a chariot as a group, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **chariots**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah got horsemen or charioteers ready. The horsemen or charioteers rode in the chariots and controlled the horses.

Stop here and look at a picture of a horse as a group, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **horsemen**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David never got angry with Adonijah. Some translations say that David never rebuked Adonijah. When a person rebukes someone else, the person tells that person that what they have done is wrong. David did not say anything to or punish Adonijah when Adonijah did or said something wrong.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use to say that David never got angry with or **rebuked** Adonijah. Pause this audio here.

Abiathar was a priest, a descendant of Aaron who served Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **priest**. Look up priest in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Nathan the prophet did not support Adonijah. A prophet is a person who gives messages from God to the people.

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Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **prophet**. Look up prophet in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David's special guard or mighty men did not join Adonijah. The special guard is around 30 brave and special soldiers who served David in David's army. These men were great fighters for David. You may remember these men from 2 Samuel 23:8.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for mighty men, or **special guard**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah sacrificed animals. Adonijah killed and burned animals as a gift to God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sacrifice**. Look up sacrifice in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah sacrificed sheep.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sheep as a group, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sheep**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah sacrificed cattle or oxen. This is the general name for all types of cows or oxen, including male, female, and young animals.

Stop here and look at a picture of oxen as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cattle** or **oxen**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah sacrificed fattened calves. People gave young cows or oxen extra food to make the cows fat and ready for other people to sacrifice the cows.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **fattened calves**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah sacrificed animals at the Stone of Zoheleth or the Serpent's Stone. Zoheleth means to glide, slide, or crawl in the original language.

Stop here and discuss as a group what place name you will use for **Stone of Zoheleth**. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah invited all his brothers. Adonijah's brothers all had the same father but had different mothers.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **brother**, especially in this situation. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah invited the royal officials of Judah, the area of Israel where the tribe of Judah lived. The royal officials were men in Judah who served and worked in Judah for the king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Judah**. For more information about Judah, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller uses the word "servant" for these royal officials, even though they did not do the daily tasks of house cleaning or food preparation. These men served the king by advising him and helping him govern the country.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **royal officials**. If you have already translated this word or phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. If you choose to use the word servant here, refer to the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word
Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 1:5–10

Audio Content
- Hear and Heart (973 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 1:11–27

Hear and Heart
In this step, hear 1 Kings 1:11–27 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:11–27 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage
Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:11–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

1 Kings 1:11–27

Pause this audio here.

This story happens when David is very old, and some people in Israel think Israel needs a new king. You will remember from the earlier story that Adonijah, David's oldest living son, decided to be king. Adonijah organised a special ceremony to make himself the king of Israel. Adonijah invited his brothers and some officials to the ceremony.

In this story, Nathan the prophet hears about Adonijah's ceremony. Nathan goes to talk to Bathsheba, the wife of David and the mother of Solomon. We do not know where Nathan and Bathsheba are when they talk together. Nathan worries about Adonijah becoming king and knows that Nathan and Bathsheba need to take action to stop Adonijah. Nathan asks Bathsheba if Bathsheba knows or has heard from someone that Adonijah has made himself king of Israel. Nathan also says that David does not know that Adonijah made himself king. David did not choose Adonijah to be king of Israel after David. Nathan talks to Bathsheba to make a plan and to advise Bathsheba on how to keep herself and Solomon safe. Nathan knows that Adonijah thinks that Solomon is Adonijah's rival to become king of Israel. At the time of the story, it was common for new kings to kill a rival, someone who might challenge the new king's right to be king.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about a time you met someone and made a plan together to talk to another person about something important. Pause this audio here.

Nathan tells Bathsheba what to do. Nathan wants Bathsheba to go to King David immediately. Nathan wants Bathsheba to be very polite and respectful of David and to remind David that Bathsheba is loyal to David as the king of Israel. Nathan tells Bathsheba to ask if David promised Bathsheba that Solomon would be the next king after David and sit on David's throne. There is no record in the Bible of David promising to Bathsheba that Solomon would be the next king after David. Only someone who is king can sit on David's throne, his special seat. It is very likely that David made the promise to Bathsheba. It is unlikely that Nathan and Bathsheba are pretending that David made the promise. Nathan uses Bathsheba to tell David what Adonijah is doing. Nathan wants Bathsheba to tell David about Adonijah in a way that pretends that David already knows what Adonijah has been doing. Bathsheba does not want to embarrass David by telling David that he does not know what is happening in his kingdom.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Tell a story about a time when you told someone something in a way that was kind and considerate so that the person was not embarrassed to hear the information. Pause this audio here.

Nathan tells Bathsheba that he, Nathan, will also go to David. Nathan will tell David the same things as Bathsheba. Nathan will confirm what Bathsheba said to David so that David believes Bathsheba.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when one person told another person something important, but the person who heard the information needed to hear the information from another person as well to believe what the first person said. Why did they need to hear the information from more than one person? Pause this audio here.

Bathsheba goes from the place where she spoke with Nathan to the king in his room. David is in a room where David sleeps and rests, in the middle of his large house or palace. The storyteller reminds us that, at the time of the story, David is very old and Abishag is looking after the king's personal needs. We do not know if Abishag is with David when Bathsheba talks to David. Bathsheba speaks and acts very respectfully to David. Bathsheba bows lower than she needs to so that David will know that Bathsheba needs to talk about something very important. David knows Bathsheba needs something from David. Bathsheba calls David "lord" and herself "David's servant" to show respect to David. Again, this shows David that Bathsheba needs to talk about something very important.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you meet, greet, and show respect to someone who is very important? Pause this audio here.

Bathsheba reminds David of David's promise to Bathsheba that David spoke to Bathsheba at an earlier time. Bathsheba uses David's own words to Bathsheba to remind David of his promise. Bathsheba wants David to pay attention to the situation in Israel. David is unaware that Adonijah has become king. Bathsheba tells David about Adonijah's special ceremony, where Adonijah sacrificed many animals. Adonijah sacrificed cattle, fattened young cattle, and sheep. Bathsheba tells David that Adonijah invited all of King David's children. Bathsheba

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means David's male children. Adonijah did not invite all of David's sons because Adonijah did not invite Solomon. Bathsheba tells David that Adonijah invited Abiathar the priest and Joab, commander of David's army. Bathsheba is telling David which people support Adonijah. Bathsheba tells David that Adonijah did not invite Solomon. Bathsheba wants David to know that Solomon does not support Adonijah and that Adonijah thinks that Solomon is a rival for being king of Israel. Solomon is loyal to David.

Bathsheba tells David that all the eyes of the people in Israel are watching David. Everyone in Israel is watching and waiting to find out who David will choose to be the next king after David. The next person to sit on David's throne, or special seat of authority, will be the next king.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Tell a story about a time when people were waiting to find out who would be the next most important leader in your community or nation. Pause this audio here.

Bathsheba warns David about the time after David is sleeping with his ancestors or is dead. At the time of David, it was normal for the people to bury the body of a dead king alongside the bodies of other people in that king's family who had died before, so people talked about when someone died as "sleeping with his ancestors."

If David does not say that Solomon will be the next king, Bathsheba and Solomon will be in danger. Adonijah will treat Bathsheba and Solomon as criminals, people who broke the law, because Bathsheba and Solomon do not support Adonijah as king and want Solomon to be king. At the time of David, a king treated people as criminals if they did not support the king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What happens to a person in your country or community who does not support the most important leader and wants to be the most important leader themself? Pause this audio here.

While Bathsheba was speaking with King David, Nathan arrived to speak with David. King David's servants told King David that Nathan wanted to speak with David. We know from later in the story that Bathsheba leaves David's room when Nathan arrives. Nathan uses the same words as Bathsheba to ask David if David has said that Adonijah will be the next king. Nathan tells David that the feast is happening at the same time as Nathan is talking to David. Nathan says that David's sons, the commanders of the army and Abiathar are showing their loyalty to Adonijah by calling Adonijah king and wishing Adonijah a long life as king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your nation show their loyalty to your most important leader? Pause this audio here.

Nathan tells David which people Adonijah did not invite to the ceremony. Nathan wants David to know which people are loyal to David. Nathan asks David if Adonijah is doing what David wants Adonijah to do. Nathan questions whether David has let Adonijah become king without involving his most trusted servants, such as Nathan. Nathan uses questions to tell David what is happening while showing respect to David.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:11–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Nathan tells Bathsheba that Adonijah made himself king and they are in danger. Nathan tells Bathsheba to ask King David if David had promised that Solomon would be king and why Adonijah is ruling. Nathan says he will talk to David, too.

In the second scene: Bathsheba talks to David. Bathsheba bows and asks why Adonijah is king when David promised Solomon would be the next king. Bathsheba tells David about Adonijah's supporters and says Israel is waiting for David to choose the next king. Bathsheba warns David that if he does not choose the next king, Adonijah's supporters will kill Bathsheba and Solomon.

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In the third scene: Nathan comes to speak with David. Nathan bows and asks if David chose Adonijah to be king. Nathan tells David about Adonijah's ceremony and who was there. Nathan also says who was not there. Then Nathan asks if David made Adonijah king without telling Nathan.

The characters in this passage are:

- Nathan the prophet
- Bathsheba, David's wife and Solomon's mother
- King David
- Abishag the Shunammite
- And David's servants

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This passage probably takes place in David's home, the city of David, in Jerusalem, on the same day as the previous story, where Adonijah sacrificed animals with his supporters. Nathan goes to talk to Bathsheba, Solomon's mother. At this time in the story, the storyteller does not use Nathan's formal title of prophet. Nathan asks if Bathsheba has not heard that Adonijah is king, and David does not know. Nathan uses the question to ask why Bathsheba is not trying to stop Adonijah from becoming the next king. If Bathsheba knows, Bathsheba should take action. Nathan is worried that Solomon will not be the next king and that Adonijah will kill Bathsheba and Solomon. Nathan suggests a way for Bathsheba to talk to David. Nathan suggests what Bathsheba should say to David. Nathan wants Bathsheba to be very polite and show lots of respect to David. This will show that Bathsheba is loyal to David. Nathan wants Bathsheba to use questions to find out what David wants to happen. Nathan wants Bathsheba to remind David of David's promise to Bathsheba. David promised Bathsheba that Solomon would be the next king and sit on David's throne. A throne is a special chair that a king or the most important leader sits on to do official business.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If your king or most important leader has a special seat to sit on, what do you call this seat? Pause this audio here.

Nathan wants Bathsheba to ask David why Adonijah is king. Nathan and Bathsheba will use questions to David to suggest that Nathan and Bathsheba might be wrong about Solomon being the next king. Nathan and Bathsheba are sure that Solomon is supposed to be the next king, and that David does not know what is happening. Nathan does not want to embarrass or shame King David. Nathan tells Bathsheba that Nathan will "add his word," or talk to David immediately after Bathsheba and say the same things as Bathsheba. This will help David to know that what Bathsheba said was true.

In the second scene, Bathsheba goes to David's room, where Abishag cares for David. Bathsheba shows a lot of respect to David when Bathsheba goes to see David. Bathsheba bows low to show respect for David. We do not know if Bathsheba bows her body from the waist or if she kneels or lies down in front of David with her face to the floor. Bathsheba does this to show loyalty and great respect for David. David knows that Bathsheba wants something important. Bathsheba calls David "my Lord" and calls herself "David's servant". In this way, Bathsheba uses very polite language to show that this is an important visit and that Bathsheba is loyal to David. Bathsheba says David made a promise to Bathsheba in the name of Yahweh, David's God. Bathsheba wants to remind David that Yahweh, David's God, witnessed David's promise. We do not know if Bathsheba worshipped Yahweh.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Tell a story about a time when you went to talk to someone and reminded the person of something the person said to you at an earlier time. Pay attention to how you talk about what the person said to you at the earlier time. Pause this audio here.

Bathsheba tells David that Adonijah was making lots of animal sacrifices and inviting Adonijah's supporters in order to make himself king. Bathsheba tells David that Adonijah did not invite Solomon and that Solomon is also David's servant. Bathsheba says that all eyes are on David to know who will sit on the throne, to be king after David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about the discussion you had in step two about waiting to find out who will be the next leader. How will you talk about the fact that everyone is watching and waiting to see what a person will do? Pause this audio here.

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Bathsheba warns David about what might happen to Bathsheba and Solomon when David is dead. Bathsheba uses a polite way to talk about David's death when she refers to a time when David is sleeping or lying to rest with his ancestors.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you say that someone royal or very important is dead? Pause this audio here.

If Adonijah is king, Adonijah and his supporters will treat Bathsheba and Solomon as they would treat people who break the law or are guilty because they did something wrong.

Immediately after Bathsheba finishes talking, Nathan arrives. David does not have time to respond to Bathsheba. King David's servants tell King David that Nathan the prophet wants to speak to David. The servants announce Nathan with his title as a prophet, a messenger from God. We do not know when Bathsheba leaves the room but she does not stay in the room when Nathan speaks to David. Nathan enters David's room. Nathan also bows low to David and touches his face to the floor to show respect to David.

Nathan follows his plan and questions if Adonijah is doing what David wants Adonijah to do. Even though Nathan knows that David does not know what has happened, Nathan gives David the opportunity to say it is what David wants. Nathan is helping David to avoid embarrassment. Nathan also tells David some of the same information that Bathsheba has told him about who is there at the feast. Nathan says that Adonijah's supporters are wishing Adonijah a long life as king to show their loyalty to Adonijah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words or phrases do you use to show loyalty to your king or most important leader? Pause this audio here.

Nathan also says that Adonijah did not invite Nathan, Zadok the priest, Benaiah son of Jehoiada, and Solomon. Nathan calls himself and Solomon "David's servants" to show that they are both loyal to David. Nathan asks David if David let Adonijah become king but did not tell his own servants, Nathan and Solomon, who will be the next king. Nathan does not believe that David did this. If David did something as important as naming the next king without involving the people who support David, this would upset and hurt David's supporters, such as Nathan.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:11–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Nathan the prophet
- Bathsheba, David's wife and Solomon's mother
- King David
- Abishag the Shunammite
- And David's servants

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

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Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Nathan tells Bathsheba that Adonijah made himself king and that they are in danger. Nathan tells Bathsheba to ask King David if David promised Solomon would be king and why Adonijah is ruling. Nathan says he will talk to David, too.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Nathan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am really worried. I know that Yahweh wants Solomon to be the next king of Israel; or
- Bathsheba and Solomon are in danger if Adonijah becomes king. We need to work together to stop Adonijah; or
- David needs to know what Adonijah is doing. I know that David wants Solomon to be the next king.

Ask the person playing Bathsheba, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know Adonijah has sacrificed lots of animals and made himself king, but I do not know what I can do; or
- Adonijah will kill my son Solomon when my husband David dies; or
- I am so relieved that Nathan has come to help us talk to David about Adonijah.

Continue the drama.

Bathsheba talks to David. Bathsheba bows and asks why Adonijah is king when David promised Solomon would be the next king. Bathsheba tells David about Adonijah's supporters and says Israel is waiting for David to choose the next king. Bathsheba warns David that if he does not choose the next king, people will kill Bathsheba and Solomon.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Bathsheba, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Years ago, I cared for my husband, but now Abishag looks after him; or
- David is my king as well as my husband, and I love and respect him; or
- Nathan and I know David promised Solomon would be the next king. We need David to understand that the wrong person is trying to be king; or
- I need David to help us because Adonijah will kill Solomon and me if Adonijah is the next king; or
- I need David to tell everyone what David wants.

Ask the person playing Abishag the Shunammite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Something important is happening; or
- Bathsheba is upset and worried; or
- My king is getting so old.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Why is Bathsheba bowing down to me when she knows that she can just come to me? or
- Adonijah is foolish and proud; or
- Adonijah is wrong. Solomon must be the next king of Israel.

Continue the drama.

Nathan comes to speak with David. Nathan bows and asks if David chose Adonijah to be king. Nathan tells David about Adonijah's ceremony and who was there. Nathan also says who was not there. Then Nathan asks if David made Adonijah king without telling Nathan.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David's servants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Something is happening. Nathan the prophet looks worried; or
- Quick! We must announce Nathan to our king; or
- Let Bathsheba pass, because Bathsheba is leaving now.

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Ask the person playing Nathan the prophet, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I must let David know what is happening, but I do not want to embarrass David; or
- Adonijah has some powerful followers, but we have Zadok and Benaiah who support Solomon; or
- What if David does not trust me? Maybe David does want Adonijah to be king and did not talk about it with me; or
- I am loyal to David and will serve him all his life.

Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Now Nathan has arrived! Bathsheba told me the truth, and we have a big problem; or
- I will make it clear to my sons and commanders of my army who I want to be the next king; or
- I am so thankful for my loyal servant, Nathan. Nathan serves me well and has saved my wife Bathsheba and my son Solomon.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:11–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Adonijah has become **king**. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Nathan calls David his lord. A lord is someone who is a master over other people, who has full authority, and who deserves for people to give him respect. When you address someone as “Lord,” you are saying that person has authority over you.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **lord**. Look up lord in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Nathan gives advice to Bathsheba. Nathan tells Bathsheba what Nathan thinks Bathsheba should do.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **advice**. Pause this audio here.

Nathan wants Bathsheba to ask David if he swore to Bathsheba. If somebody swears something, they make a solemn promise or oath to a person or people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **swear**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Look up oath in the Master Glossary for more information about making a strong promise. Pause this audio here.

David swore by **Yahweh**. Yahweh is God’s personal name. In this passage, the storyteller calls God “Yahweh.” Be sure to translate Yahweh in the same way as you have in previous passages, and remember that Yahweh is in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh is David’s God, the God of Israel. God is the general title for the creator God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **God**. Look up God and Israel in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Nathan wants Bathsheba to call herself David’s servant. A servant is a person who does work for someone else. Bathsheba does not work for David but does what David tells her to do because David is the king. Bathsheba calls herself a female servant to show respect to David. Later in the story, Nathan calls himself and Solomon male servants of David.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **servant**. Look up servant in the Master Glossary for more information, and discuss if you need a separate word for female and male servants. If you have

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already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David had promised Bathsheba that Solomon would sit on David's throne. A throne is a special seat for a king.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **throne**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Abishag is attending, or helping, David. Bathsheba bows very low to the king to show respect to the king.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**bowed** very low to show respect." If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Look up bow in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah **sacrificed** cattle, fattened calves, and sheep. Use the same words or phrases for sacrificed, cattle, fattened calves, and sheep as you used in previous passages. For more information on sacrifice, refer to the Master Glossary.

Adonijah invited Abiathar the **priest**. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Adonijah invited Joab, the commander of the army. A commander was a military leader who carried a staff to show he was a leader.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **commander**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

When David is dead, and people have buried David, people will treat Bathsheba and Solomon as criminals or as people who are guilty and who deserve to have Adonijah punish them.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **criminal**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Nathan the **prophet** arrives to speak to David. Use the same word or phrase for prophet as you used in previous passages. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

Nathan also tells David about Adonijah's ceremony and asks David if David wants Adonijah to be the next king of Israel.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 1:11–27

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (978 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 1:28–37

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 1:28–37 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:28–37 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:28–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You will remember from the earlier stories that Adonijah was having a ceremony to become king of Israel. Nathan and Bathsheba knew about Adonijah's ceremony and went to talk to King David. Nathan and Bathsheba wanted David to know about Adonijah's ceremony and the people who supported Adonijah. Nathan and Bathsheba also wanted David to confirm Solomon as the next king of Israel after David. Nathan and Bathsheba told David the names of people who still supported David.

After David heard from Bathsheba and then from Nathan, David responded to what Bathsheba and Nathan told David. First, David asked his servants to bring Bathsheba into David's room. The servants brought Bathsheba to David. This time, Bathsheba stands in front of David to hear what David says to Bathsheba. Bathsheba does not bow down deeply. King David takes an oath. David makes a strong promise to Bathsheba and asks Yahweh to witness David's promise. David is sure that Yahweh is a living God and saves David from enemies and difficulties. Bathsheba can be just as sure that David will keep David's promise. David uses the same words to make his strong promise as David used at other times in his life.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: If possible, listen to your translation of 2 Samuel 4:9 and notice how David makes his oath. Pause this audio here.

David says to Bathsheba that today, David will fulfill the promise David made to Bathsheba some time before. We do not know when David made his promise. Sometime in the past, David promised Bathsheba that Solomon, Bathsheba's son, would be the next king of Israel. David says that David will make Solomon the next king today, and Solomon will sit on David's throne instead of David.

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Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about a promise that someone made to you in the past. As you talk about the promise, share the actual words the person spoke to make the promise. Pause this audio here.

Bathsheba shows David that she is very thankful when she bows down very low to David with her face touching the floor. We do not know if Bathsheba kneels on the floor and bows to place her face on the floor or if she lies down on the floor. Bathsheba speaks a blessing, words of praise, to David. Although Bathsheba says, "May my lord King David live forever," Bathsheba does not expect King David to live forever because he is very old and Bathsheba knows that he will die soon. Bathsheba's words show that Bathsheba is loyal to David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words or phrases would you use to celebrate or show thanks to your most important leader? Pause this audio here.

Bathsheba possibly leaves David after Bathsheba bows to David. After David has finished speaking to Bathsheba, David calls for the men who are loyal to David and support David. David asks his servants to bring the men to David in David's room. Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah son of Jehoiada arrive and enter David's room to speak with David.

David gives instructions to the three men. David wants the three men to make Solomon king of Israel. David talks about himself as the lord or master of the three men. David wants his servants to go with the three men. This time, David's servants are probably David's bodyguard, not the people who look after David in his room or his officials. This could be the same group of men whom Benaiah led as David's bodyguard.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the different groups of people who serve or work for your most important leader. What do those people do? Pause this audio here.

David wants Solomon to ride David's mule. A mule is an animal that is born when a donkey mates with a horse. Mules were special and rare in Israel because Yahweh had told the Israelites not to allow one kind of animal to mate with a different kind of animal. David's mule is a female mule and a special animal for the king to ride on. David wants Solomon to look like a king.

Stop here and look at a picture of a person riding a mule as a group. Pause this audio here.

David wants the men to make Solomon the king at Gihon. Gihon is a spring just outside of Jerusalem. Gihon was an important source of water for Jerusalem, and you will remember that springs were special places for the Israelites. Adonijah had his ceremony next to a different spring. Gihon was on the side of the Kidron Valley. The men and Solomon went down the hill from Jerusalem into the valley next to Gihon.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem and find the spring of Gihon. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What special place do you use to appoint or recognise a new most important leader of your country or people? Pause this audio here.

David wants Zadok and Nathan to anoint Solomon. You may remember that in Israel, a priest anoints a person to symbolise Yahweh's spirit coming on the person. Priests anoint the person whom people believe Yahweh has chosen. A priest anoints a person by pouring or dripping special oil onto the person's head. Zadok and Nathan will anoint Solomon. Zadok is David's most important priest, and Nathan the prophet brings messages to David from Yahweh. This adds authority to Solomon as king. When the priest anoints Solomon, Solomon will be the new king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What rituals or ceremonies do you use to show that someone is the leader of your people? Pause this audio here.

When Zadok and Nathan anoint Solomon as king of Israel, David wants the people at Solomon's ceremony to blow a trumpet or horn to announce that Solomon is king. A person blows a horn to make a loud musical noise. At the time of David, people made horns or trumpets from the horns of a ram, which is a male sheep or goat. People blew horns at battles and important events.

Stop here and look at a picture of a person blowing a ram's horn as a group. Pause this audio here.

David also wants the people at the ceremony to announce that Solomon is king by shouting, "Long live King Solomon." The people use this phrase to celebrate Solomon and show that they are loyal to Solomon. You will

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remember from the earlier passage that Nathan told David that Adonijah's supporters shouted the same phrase at Adonijah's ceremony.

David wants Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah to go with Solomon from Gihon up the hill to the City of David in Jerusalem. David wants Solomon to sit on David's throne to show that Solomon is the king of Israel. You will remember that a throne is a special seat for a king. David wants Solomon to be the new king of Israel and Judah. We do not know why David mentions both Judah and Israel. At the time Solomon became the new king, Israel included all the lands of the tribes of Israel, including Judah. Judah was not a separate kingdom from the rest of Israel.

Benaiah responds to everything David said with strong agreement. At the time of David, a person said "Amen" to agree with someone and say that everything would be done as the person said it would. Benaiah asks for Yahweh's blessing on David's wishes. Benaiah wants Yahweh to bless Solomon like Yahweh blessed David. Benaiah uses the king's throne as a symbol for the king's reign. Benaiah asks Yahweh to make Solomon a greater and more powerful king than King David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words of blessing do you say to each other to wish good things from God for a person?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:28–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: King David asks his servants to bring Bathsheba to him in David's room.

In the second scene: King David promises to fulfill the promise that David made to Bathsheba in the past. David tells Bathsheba that today, Solomon will become the next king. Bathsheba is very thankful to David.

In the third scene: King David asks his servants to bring Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah son of Jehoiada to David in David's room.

In the fourth scene: King David instructs Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah to make Solomon the king of Israel at Gihon. David tells Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah to put Solomon on David's throne in Jerusalem after Zadok makes Solomon king of Israel. Benaiah gives his strong approval to David's plan and asks for Yahweh's blessing on Solomon to make Solomon a greater king than David.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- David's servants
- Bathsheba
- Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet
- And Benaiah, son of Jehoiada

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

We do not know when Nathan left David's room, but Nathan must have left David after Nathan spoke to David and before David asked the servants to bring Bathsheba back to David's room. We do not know how much time passed between David's conversation with Nathan and when David decided to call Bathsheba back to the room. We do not know if Nathan leaves the room before David asks the servants to bring Bathsheba, or if Nathan leaves the room when Bathsheba comes back into the room. All of Bathsheba and Nathan's visits to David's room happen on the same day and at the same time as Adonijah's ceremony to become king. David gives instructions to his servants to bring the different people to David's room.

When Bathsheba arrives in David's room, Bathsheba enters into King David's presence, the place where David is. David speaks to Bathsheba and makes an oath, a strong promise to Bathsheba. David's oath appeals to Yahweh

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as a witness to the oath, states the new promise for that day, and repeats the promise that David had made to Bathsheba before. David promises to complete or fulfill his previous promise on that day. After David speaks his promise to Bathsheba, Bathsheba bows to show loyalty, thankfulness, and respect to David. Also, Bathsheba wishes health and long life to her king to show her thanks and loyalty to David. Then Bathsheba leaves David.

Next, David speaks to his servants to ask his servants to bring Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah to David's rooms. David uses the men's titles to identify the men to his servants. David probably asks his servants to bring the men to him quickly after Bathsheba leaves.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How often and when do you use people's official titles? Pause this audio here.

Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah come to David in David's room. David gives the men orders to make Solomon king of Israel on that day. David wants his bodyguard to go with Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah. David calls his bodyguard "servants" and refers to himself as the lord of the men. You will remember that a lord is a master over other people. David tells the men to go all together with Solomon down to the spring of Gihon. The spring of Gihon is in the Kidron Valley just outside Jerusalem and below the City of David, the part of Jerusalem where David lives.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem and the spring of Gihon in the Kidron Valley, if needed. Pause this audio here.

When the men arrive at the spring of Gihon, David wants Zadok and Nathan to anoint Solomon and announce Solomon as king.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have one person give instructions to the group about some things the group should do later that day. Pay attention to the language the person uses as they give one instruction and then the next instruction. Pause this audio here.

After the men make Solomon king, David wants the men to follow Solomon up to the City of David and to the building which contains David's throne. The City of David is on a hill above the spring of Gihon. David wants people to see Solomon as the new king. David wants the people of Israel to know that David has formally chosen or appointed Solomon as the new king.

Benaiah answers or responds to David's instructions with a strong affirmation or agreement. Benaiah uses the word "amen" to say that people will do the things David has ordered. Benaiah wishes Yahweh to make everything happen. Benaiah uses formal language to talk to David and to show respect to David. Benaiah wants Yahweh to be with Solomon in the same way that Yahweh protected David, Benaiah's lord. Benaiah uses David's throne as a symbol of David's reign and wants Solomon's reign to be even better than David's reign over Israel.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:28–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- David's servants
- Bathsheba
- Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet
- And Benaiah, son of Jehoiada

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

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First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

King David asks his servants to bring Bathsheba to him in David's room.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing king David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I need to talk to Bathsheba again; or
- I am so worried. Solomon must be the next king of Israel; or
- I want Bathsheba to know that I will keep my promise to her.

Ask the person playing David's servants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The king is very worried; or
- Quick! We must bring Bathsheba back here; or
- Something very serious is happening.

Continue the drama.

King David promises to fulfill the promise that David made to Bathsheba in the past. David tells Bathsheba that today, Solomon will become the next king. Bathsheba is very thankful to David.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I love Bathsheba and want her to be safe and happy; or
- I do not want Bathsheba to worry about Solomon; or
- I am glad that Bathsheba knows that I will keep my promise to her.

Ask the person playing Bathsheba, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- My king is faithful and will keep his promise to me; or
- I am so happy that David is strong today and will stop Adonijah; or
- I thank God for my king and wish good things for him.

Continue the drama.

King David asks his servants to bring Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah son of Jehoiada to David in David's room.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I need the men who are faithful to come and help make Solomon king; or
- I need to make Solomon king today; or
- I am worried that people will think Adonijah is king before I can make Solomon king.

Ask the person playing David's servants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- First, King David wanted us to bring Bathsheba and now three very important men! Something important is happening; or
- Quick, find Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah; or
- We feel worried about King David.

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Continue the drama.

King David instructs Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah to make Solomon the king of Israel at Gihon. David tells Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah to put Solomon on David's throne in Jerusalem after Zadok makes Solomon king of Israel. Benaiah gives his strong approval to David's plan and asks for Yahweh's blessing on Solomon to make Solomon a greater king than David.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Now we will make everything right; or
- I am so happy and relieved that these men are faithful to me; or
- I want these men to make Solomon king immediately, and for everyone to see that this is what I want.

Ask the person playing Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Now our king will make everything right; or
- We will anoint Solomon and make him our next king today; or
- Everyone will see that Solomon is the next king of Israel.

Ask the person playing Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yes! Let us do this; or
- I hope Yahweh helps us to do everything David wants us to do; or
- I think Solomon will be a great king with Yahweh's help.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:28–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King David calls for Bathsheba to come back to David. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Bathsheba comes into the king's presence. A person's presence is the place where they are. Bathsheba goes into the place where the king is.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe the king's **presence**, the place where the king is. Pause this audio here.

King David takes an oath and makes a solemn promise to Bathsheba.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **oath**. Look up oath in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David makes a promise to Bathsheba. David says that as sure as **Yahweh**, the **God** of **Israel** lives, David will do what he promised to Bathsheba before. Yahweh is the personal name for God, the almighty, the God of Israel. Be sure to translate Yahweh, God, and Israel in the same way as you have in previous passages, and remember that Yahweh, God, and Israel are in the Master Glossary.

David promises that Solomon, Bathsheba's son, will be the next king. A son is a male child of his parents.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **son**. Look up son in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

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Bathsheba bows down to David, her lord or master, and shows loyalty and great respect for David. Use the same words or phrases for lord or master, and bow down as you used in previous passages. For more information on **bow** and **lord** or master, refer to the Master Glossary.

David asks his attendants to call Zadok the **priest**, Nathan the **prophet**, and Benaiah son of Jehoiada. Use the same words or phrases for priest and prophet as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest and prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

David tells Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah to take their lord's servants with them. David's servants in this case are his bodyguards.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **servants** in this case. The storyteller calls these men servants in the story, but they are probably the bodyguards that Benaiah led. Discuss as a group if you want to call these men servants, bodyguards, or officials. Look up servant in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David wants Solomon to mount or sit on and ride David's mule.

Stop here and look at a picture of a person riding a mule as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **mule**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David wants Zadok and Nathan to anoint Solomon as king. When someone anoints someone else, it means they drip or pour sweet-smelling oil over that person in order to appoint them for a special task.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **anoint**. Look up anoint in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David wants people to blow a horn or trumpet when Solomon becomes king.

Stop here and look at a picture of a person blowing a ram's horn as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **horn**. Look up horn in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David wants Solomon to sit on David's throne and reign in David's place. Use the same word or phrase for throne as you used in previous passages. To reign means to rule a country as a king.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **reign**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David tells Zadok and Nathan that David appointed Solomon the ruler over Israel and **Judah**. Judah is the name of one of the tribes of Israel. Judah is the tribe that David is from. Use the same word for Judah as you have previously, and remember that Judah is in the Master Glossary.

A ruler is a general term for someone who rules over a country. People often use this term for a ruler whom someone appoints.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **ruler**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Benaiah said "Amen" to David. Amen is a word in the original language, and a person says this word as a strong agreement with what another person says.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **amen**. Look up amen in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Benaiah says that Yahweh is the God of his lord, the king.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 1:28–37

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (983 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 1:38–53

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 1:38–53 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:38–53 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:38–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

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Pause this audio here.

In the previous passages, Nathan and Bathsheba told King David that David's son Adonijah was making himself the next king of Israel. David told Bathsheba and the men loyal to David that Solomon would be the next king of Israel. David told Nathan the prophet, Zadok the priest, and Benaiah the leader of David's bodyguard to make Solomon the next king of Israel on that same day. In this passage, the men who are loyal to David make Solomon king of Israel and stop Adonijah. Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah son of Jehoiada leave David's room and join with the Kerethites and Pelethites. The Kerethites and Pelethites were David's personal fighting men. The Kerethites and Pelethites were not Israelites, but they had served David as his special guard for many years. David's supporters go to Solomon and put Solomon on David's mule. You will remember that a mule is a special animal for important people to ride.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man riding a mule as a group. Pause this audio here.

All the men leave the City of David, in Jerusalem on the hill, and go with Solomon down the hill to the spring of Gihon in the Kidron Valley. Solomon rides David's mule.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem and the surrounding area and find Gihon. Pause this audio here.

Zadok takes the special oil from the special tent and carries it to the spring of Gihon to use on Solomon. You may remember that David ordered people to make a special tent to contain the ark of the covenant when David brought the ark to Jerusalem. You will also remember that a person would put special scented olive oil on another person to anoint that person. People kept this oil in a container that people made from animal horn. We do not know what shape the container was. When the men arrive at the spring of Gihon, Zadok the priest anoints Solomon with this special oil.

Stop here and look at a picture of containers that people made from animal horn. Pause this audio here.

When Zadok anoints Solomon, Zadok makes Solomon king of Israel. Some people blow horns or trumpets that people made from rams' horns to make a loud musical noise. You will remember that people blew horns at important events and battles. The people at Gihon use the horns to announce that Solomon is now the king of Israel.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a person blowing a ram's horn trumpet. Pause this audio here.

All the people at the spring of Gihon shout, "Long live King Solomon!" The people use this phrase to celebrate Solomon and show that they are loyal to Solomon.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you celebrate and announce a new most important leader in your nation or people group? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon goes back up the hill from Gihon to Jerusalem and to the City of David. The people at Gihon follow Solomon while they are playing pipes. People make a musical noise with pipes by blowing into the instruments. People make pipes from wood, ivory, or bone. Sometimes people use a reed as a mouthpiece to blow into the pipes or flutes.

Stop here and look at a picture of people playing pipes. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What musical instruments do people in your community use to make music by blowing into them? What kind of noise do these instruments make? Pause this audio here.

The people shout and make happy noises to celebrate King Solomon. The people make a very loud noise so that the people feel like the ground or the earth might shake or break.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about a time when you were with people who made so much noise that you could feel the noise in your body and through your feet from the ground. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah is at the Stone of Zoheleth near the spring of En Rogel with the people Adonijah invited to see him become king of Israel. Adonijah and his guests are finishing the feast, the large meal to celebrate Adonijah as king. Adonijah and his guests hear the people at Gihon and in Jerusalem celebrating their new king with horns. Joab, one of Adonijah's important supporters, asks why the noise from horns is coming from Jerusalem.

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Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem and the surrounding area. Notice how close the spring of En Rogel is to the spring of Gihon and Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

Suddenly, Jonathan, son of Abiathar the priest, arrives at Adonijah's celebration. You may remember that Jonathan was a supporter of David when Absalom wanted to be king. In this story, Jonathan probably supports Adonijah. You will remember that Abiathar also supports Adonijah to be king. We do not know why Jonathan is not already at Adonijah's celebration, but he was in Jerusalem and saw Solomon become king.

Adonijah welcomes Jonathan and calls Jonathan a worthy man. A worthy man is a man who is trustworthy and reliable. Adonijah expects Jonathan to bring good news to Adonijah. Jonathan tells Adonijah that he does not bring good news. Jonathan brings bad news to Adonijah and his supporters. Jonathan shows respect to David and calls King David "our lord," the master of Adonijah and Jonathan. Jonathan tells Adonijah and his supporters that King David made Solomon king on that day. Jonathan tells Adonijah about all the ways King David showed the people that David wanted Solomon to be king. Jonathan tells Adonijah that the people who do not support Adonijah do support Solomon to be king. Jonathan tells Adonijah that Zadok and Nathan anointed Solomon as king at the spring of Gihon. Jonathan tells Adonijah that the people in Jerusalem are making a very loud noise to celebrate King Solomon. Jonathan adds to his story by telling Adonijah that Solomon sat on the royal throne, another sign that Solomon is now king. Jonathan then tells Adonijah that David's royal officials congratulated King David for choosing Solomon. Jonathan tells Adonijah what the officials said to David. The officials prayed for Yahweh to make Solomon more well-known and more praised than David. The officials want Solomon's reign to be even better than David's. Finally, Jonathan tells Adonijah about David's actions and what David said to the royal officials in David's room. David was in bed and bowed his body down to Yahweh. David bowed to show respect and thanks to Yahweh. David was grateful to Yahweh and praised Yahweh, the most powerful heavenly being in Israel. David thanked Yahweh for letting David see Solomon become the next king of Israel.

Jonathan's story worries the people Adonijah invited to his celebration. All the people at Adonijah's celebration did not do what David wanted and did not support Solomon. The people are frightened that the new king, Solomon, will punish them by killing them. Adonijah is frightened and thinks Solomon will punish Adonijah by killing him. Adonijah leaves the Stone of Zoheleth near En Rogel and goes to the altar of burnt offerings or sacrifice. The altar of sacrifice is probably at the tent for the ark of the covenant in Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem and the surrounding area, and find the tent for the ark of the covenant. Pause this audio here.

You may remember from the book of Exodus that Bezalel made the corners of the altar of burnt offerings into shapes like animal horns. People called the shapes "horns," but people made these horns of bronze, not animal horns.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar of burnt offerings as a group. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah goes to the altar to claim safety from Solomon. In Israel, if a person killed another person by accident, the person went to the altar and held the horns to be safe. The person asked the priests not to punish the person for killing someone. In Israel, the king could kill or execute a person for killing another person. If the king executed a person, the king or one of the king's soldiers would kill that person quickly with a sword. Adonijah did not kill anybody, but Adonijah did not want Solomon to kill him with a sword.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sword as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What places, if any, can people go to for safety from punishment in your community or country? Pause this audio here.

People go to Solomon to tell Solomon about Adonijah at the altar. People tell Solomon that Adonijah is frightened of Solomon and is holding onto the horns of the altar. People tell Solomon that Adonijah wants King Solomon to swear or promise not to kill Adonijah with a sword. Adonijah calls himself the servant of Solomon and gives Solomon the title of king. Adonijah knows Solomon has authority over Adonijah and is now the king of Israel.

Solomon decides to wait and see how Adonijah behaves. Solomon gives Adonijah an opportunity to be worthy, to be trustworthy and reliable. If Adonijah behaves well, Solomon will not let even one hair from Adonijah fall to the ground. This means that Solomon will not let anything harm Adonijah.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you said that you would protect someone and not let anything bad happen. Pause this audio here.

Solomon says that if he or his people find evil in Adonijah, then Adonijah will die. Solomon will judge Adonijah by Adonijah's actions. King Solomon sends men to get Adonijah from the altar and bring Adonijah to King Solomon. Adonijah comes to King Solomon and bows to King Solomon to show respect to Solomon. Solomon tells Adonijah to go from where they are to Adonijah's home.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:38–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has eight scenes.

In the first scene: Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, Benaiah son of Jehoiada, the Kerethites, and the Pelethites go with Solomon, who rides on David's mule, from the city of David down to the spring of Gihon.

In the second scene: Zadok anoints Solomon with oil that he takes from the tent where the ark is. People blow horns and shout, "Long live King Solomon!"

In the third scene: Solomon goes back up to the City of David. All the people at the spring of Gihon follow Solomon to the city and play pipes and make a loud and happy noise.

In the fourth scene: Near En Rogel, Adonijah and his supporters hear the loud noise from Jerusalem. Joab wonders why there is a loud noise from Jerusalem. Adonijah welcomes Jonathan. Jonathan tells everyone that David has made Solomon king and that Solomon sits on David's throne. Royal officials are happy, and David thanks Yahweh for allowing David to see Solomon become king. Everyone at Adonijah's celebration is frightened and leaves En Rogel.

In the fifth scene: Adonijah goes from En Rogel to the tent where the ark is and holds onto the horns of the altar.

In the sixth scene: People tell Solomon that Adonijah is frightened and thinks Solomon will kill him. Adonijah wants Solomon to promise not to kill Adonijah for trying to become king. Solomon replies to say that Adonijah needs to show Solomon that he is a worthy man. If Adonijah does the wrong thing again, Solomon will kill Adonijah.

In the seventh scene: King Solomon sends men to the tent where the altar is to bring Adonijah to King Solomon.

In the eighth scene: Adonijah meets with King Solomon, and Solomon tells Adonijah to go home.

The characters in this passage are:

- Zadok the priest
- Nathan the prophet
- Benaiah, son of Jehoiada
- The Kerethites and the Pelethites
- Solomon
- People following Solomon
- Adonijah
- Adonijah's guests
- Joab
- Jonathan, son of Abiathar
- And King Solomon's men

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

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In the last passage, King David gave Nathan the prophet, Zadok the priest, and Benaiah son of Jehoiada instructions to make Solomon the next king. In this passage, Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah son of Jehoiada follow David's instructions. You will notice that the storyteller gives Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah their titles as well as their names.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you refer to Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah in your translation? Are you going to use the titles that show what they do, like priest, prophet, and son of Jehoiada, every time, sometimes, or just at the beginning of the passage? Pause this audio here.

Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah join the Kerethites and Pelethites and go with Solomon to Gihon. All of these people travel with Solomon to guard and protect Solomon.

The storyteller tells us that Zadok uses a container of special oil to anoint Solomon. Zadok collected the container from the tent where the ark of the covenant was, between the time when David told Zadok what to do and when the people went to Gihon to anoint Solomon.

After Zadok anoints Solomon, people at Gihon blow horns to announce that Solomon is now the king. The people at Gihon shout, "Long live King Solomon!" to celebrate Solomon and show support for Solomon. King Solomon and the rest of the people at the spring of Gihon go from Gihon back up to the City of David, which is the part of Jerusalem where David lives. As the group of people goes to Jerusalem, people make a loud musical noise on pipes and celebrate with loud shouts.

Stop here and look at a picture of people playing pipes as a group, if needed. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that the ground shook with the sound. The ground did not actually shake, but the storyteller uses the phrase to help us know that the noise was very loud.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What phrase or saying do you use to help people know that a noise or an event was very loud? Pause this audio here.

At the same time, Adonijah is with the people whom Adonijah invited to celebrate Adonijah as the new king. The people are Adonijah's guests. Everyone is finishing eating a feast, a big and special meal for celebrations.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call a big and special meal that you eat at celebrations or on special days? Pause this audio here.

Joab is with Adonijah and hears the sound of horns. En Rogel is less than one kilometre from Gihon, so Adonijah and his supporters can hear the loud celebrations. People with Solomon are blowing the horns.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about how loud a sound needs to be for the people in one of the places in the story to hear what happened in the other place in the story. How might you describe that type of sound? Pause this audio here.

Joab wants to know why so much noise is coming from the city of Jerusalem. At the same time that Joab speaks, Jonathan arrives. Adonijah welcomes Jonathan. Adonijah calls Jonathan a worthy man, someone who is reliable and trustworthy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call a person who you know is reliable, trustworthy, and honest? Pause this audio here.

Adonijah thinks Jonathan brings good news. Jonathan replies and tells Adonijah that he does not bring good news. Jonathan tells Adonijah and Adonijah's guests that David has made Solomon king. Jonathan calls King David "our lord," the person who is master over Adonijah and Jonathan. Jonathan shows respect to David. Jonathan tells Adonijah all the things that happened to make Solomon king: Solomon rode King David's mule. At Gihon, Zadok and Nathan anointed Solomon to make Solomon king. We do not know why Jonathan says both men anointed Solomon when the storyteller earlier tells us that Zadok anointed Solomon to become king. It is possible that Nathan put oil on Solomon after Zadok or was beside Zadok when Zadok anointed Solomon. After the people made Solomon king at Gihon, the people went up to Jerusalem while they cheered or shouted happily. People are shouting and making a lot of noise in the city. There is so much sound that the sound fills the city, and people can hear it everywhere. Jonathan tells Adonijah that the noise from the city is what Adonijah can hear. Jonathan then adds to his story and tells Adonijah more about Solomon becoming king.

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Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have one person tell the group the first part about an exciting event. Let some people from the group comment on the story, and then have the person tell the group the next exciting part of the event. Pay attention to how the person connects the story together. Pause this audio here.

Jonathan tells Adonijah that Solomon sits on the royal throne, David's special seat. Jonathan also tells Adonijah that David's royal officials went to David to congratulate David. The officials approve of what David has done and are pleased that Solomon is king. Jonathan tells Adonijah what the officials said to David. Jonathan describes the events in Jerusalem to the people at the Stone of Zoheleth. David and the officials are not present in this scene. The officials say that they pray that more people will praise Solomon than the people who have praised David. The officials call Yahweh "your God," the God of David, even though the royal officials also serve Yahweh. The officials pray that Yahweh will make Solomon's throne greater. The officials do not want Solomon's real throne to be bigger in size. Instead, the officials use the throne as a symbol for Solomon's reign. David responds to his royal officials and bows down on his bed. Jonathan tells Adonijah that David prayed to Yahweh to praise Yahweh for letting David see the next king of Israel sit on David's throne.

After Jonathan finishes telling his story, all Adonijah's guests are very worried and get up from the feast and go away from the feast to different places. Adonijah goes to the place where the altar of sacrifice is and holds onto the bronze horns on the corners of the altar. The altar of sacrifice is probably near the tent where the ark of the covenant is, in Jerusalem.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the altar of sacrifice if needed. Pause this audio here.

In the City of David, some people tell Solomon that Adonijah is afraid of King Solomon and is holding onto the altar. The people tell Solomon that Adonijah wants King Solomon to swear or promise not to kill Solomon's servant, Adonijah. We do not know who the people are who talk to Solomon about Adonijah. Solomon hears Adonijah name Solomon king and Adonijah as Solomon's servant. Adonijah is not the personal servant of Solomon, meaning someone who will do hard work around the house. Adonijah means that he will be obedient to Solomon as Adonijah's king and master.

Solomon replies to the people to say that Solomon will not harm or kill Adonijah if Adonijah is worthy. Solomon uses special language to say that Solomon will not harm Adonijah in any way, not even a single hair on his head. However, Solomon will kill Adonijah if Adonijah does something to show Solomon that Adonijah is not worthy or is evil. Solomon uses more special language, "evil found in him," to describe Adonijah being unworthy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about the story that you told in step two when you talked about protecting someone. What phrases did you use to describe when you protected someone and did not let anything bad happen to a person? Pause this audio here.

Solomon sends some of his servants to bring Adonijah from the tent where the altar of sacrifice is. Adonijah comes to Solomon and bows down to Solomon to show respect to Solomon. Solomon tells Adonijah to go to Adonijah's home. We do not think Solomon wants Adonijah to stay in his home all the time, but just wants Adonijah to go away from Solomon at this time.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:38–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has eight scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Zadok the priest
- Nathan the prophet
- Benaiah, son of Jehoiada
- The Kerethites and the Pelethites
- Solomon

1 Kings 1:38–53

- People following Solomon
- Adonijah
- Adonijah's guests
- Joab
- Jonathan, son of Abiathar
- And King Solomon's men

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, Benaiah son of Jehoiada, the Kerethites, and the Pelethites go with Solomon, who rides on David's mule, from the city of David down to the spring of Gihon.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Zadok the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We need to make Solomon our new king as soon as possible; or
- Come on, everybody! We will go to the spring of Gihon to make Solomon our king.

Ask the person playing Nathan, Benaiah, the Pelethites, and the Kerethites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We need to go quickly; or
- This is what Yahweh wants for Israel; or
- We will protect Solomon like we protected King David.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel amazed. I did not expect to become king today; or
- King David honours me. It is very special to ride his mule; or
- Now Adonijah will know that Yahweh wants me to be king of Israel.

Continue the drama.

Zadok anoints Solomon with oil that he takes from the tent where the ark is. People blow horns and shout, "Long live King Solomon!"

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Zadok the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This oil is holy. I am honoured to anoint Solomon as our new king; or
- This is our new king! Tell everyone the good news; or
- We have done it! Solomon is king, not Adonijah.

Ask the person playing Nathan, Benaiah, the Pelethites, and the Kerethites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Blow the horns hard! We want everyone to hear that we have a new king; or
- We are happy to have a new king; or
- We follow King Solomon! We think Solomon will be a wonderful king.

Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel important and special. I am now the king of Israel; or
- I will serve my people and follow Yahweh; or
- Everyone is making an incredible noise.

Continue the drama.

Solomon goes up to the City of David. All the people at the spring of Gihon follow Solomon back up to the city and play pipes and make a loud and happy noise.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Look at all these people celebrating me; or
- I feel overwhelmed and humbled; or
- Now I will go to sit on my father’s throne to show everyone that I am king of Israel.

Ask the person playing the people following Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Solomon looks young and powerful; or
- We are happy to have a new king to look after us and Israel; or
- Make a happy noise! Blow the pipes to celebrate our new king; or
- We are very loud. We can feel the noise around us.

Continue the drama.

Near En Rogel, Adonijah and his supporters hear the loud noise from Jerusalem. Joab wonders why there is a loud noise from Jerusalem. Adonijah welcomes Jonathan. Jonathan tells everyone that David has made Solomon king and that Solomon sits on David’s throne. Royal officials are happy, and David thanked Yahweh for allowing David to see Solomon become king. Everyone at Adonijah’s celebration is frightened and leaves En Rogel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Adonijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- What a noise! What is going on in Jerusalem? or
- Here is Jonathan. Jonathan will tell us why people are celebrating and blowing horns; or
- This is not good news. Nathan, Zadok, and Benaiah were clever and worked quickly. Now everyone knows Solomon is the new king; or
- Lots of important people support Solomon; or
- I am frightened. Solomon will kill me because I tried to become king of Israel.

Ask the person playing Joab, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- What is going on? or
- Everything has gone wrong now; or
- Solomon will be angry with us. I am in danger.

Ask the person playing Jonathan, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Adonijah thought he was the new king, but Solomon is the new king; or
- Everyone needs to know what happened at Gihon and in Jerusalem; or
- Listen to what the royal officials said and what David said. Everyone supports Solomon; or
- I am very worried.

Ask the person playing Adonijah’s guests, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- People are blowing horns in Jerusalem. What is happening? or
- David and Solomon were clever. Adonijah cannot be king now; or
- We are in danger. We are frightened that Solomon will punish us for supporting Adonijah.

Continue the drama.

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Adonijah goes from En Rogel to the tent where the ark is and holds onto the horns of the altar.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Adonijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I need to go somewhere safe where someone will protect me; or
- I will hold onto the altar and ask the priests to keep me safe; or
- I am so frightened. Solomon will want to kill me.

Continue the drama.

People tell Solomon that Adonijah is frightened and thinks Solomon will kill him. Adonijah wants Solomon to promise not to kill Adonijah for trying to become king. Solomon replies to say that Adonijah needs to show Solomon that he is a worthy man. If Adonijah does the wrong thing again, Solomon will kill Adonijah.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon’s men, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Adonijah is right to be frightened. Solomon might kill Adonijah; or
- I wonder what Solomon will do? or
- I feel respect for my new king.

Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am angry, but I will wait and see if Adonijah supports me as king; or
- Maybe I will kill Adonijah if he does not support me; or
- I feel powerful.

Continue the drama.

King Solomon sends men to the tent where the altar of sacrifice is to bring Adonijah to King Solomon.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want Adonijah to come and see me; or
- Adonijah does not need to ask for safety at the altar.

Ask the person playing King Solomon’s men, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We will bring Adonijah to our new king; or
- Adonijah is foolish. Adonijah looks desperate as he holds the horns of the altar.

Continue the drama.

Adonijah meets with King Solomon, and Solomon tells Adonijah to go home.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I think Adonijah is foolish. I will see what Adonijah does now; or
- I feel merciful; or
- I am happy that I am king and Adonijah is not the king; or
- I have had enough of this man. I do not want to see Adonijah anymore.

Ask the person playing Adonijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so frightened. What will Solomon do to me? or
- I am grateful to Solomon. I thought Solomon would kill me; or
- What will I do now?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 1:38–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Zadok the **priest**, Nathan the **prophet**, Benaiah son of Jehoiada, the Kerethites, and the Pelethites go with Solomon, who rides on David's **mule**, from the city of David to Gihon. Use the same words or phrases for priest, prophet, and mule as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest and prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

Zadok took the horn of oil from the tent. The horn of oil was a container that people had made from an animal horn. Special oil for anointing people was inside the container.

Stop here and look at a picture of containers made from animal horn if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **horn of oil**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Zadok took the horn of oil from the tent where David had put the ark of the covenant. This was a special, or holy, tent where Yahweh lived among his people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use to describe this tent in Jerusalem. Some translations say that this was a "holy tent" that was special because Yahweh lived there. Listen to your translation of 2 Samuel 6:17 if possible, and hear how you translated tent in that story. Pause this audio here.

Zadok **anoints** Solomon. People blow **horns** or trumpets made from ram's horns. Use the same words or phrases for anoint and horns as you used in previous passages. For more information on anoint and horns, refer to the Master Glossary.

People at Gihon shout, "Long live **King** Solomon." Use the same phrase for "long live the king" as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

People follow Solomon from Gihon to Jerusalem and play pipes.

Stop here and look at a picture of people playing pipes if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **pipes**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah and Adonijah's guests hear the noise as they finish their feast. A feast is a special meal to celebrate an event.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **feast**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Jonathan calls King David **lord** and says that Solomon sat on the royal **throne**. Use the same words or phrases for lord and throne as you used in previous passages. For more information on lord, refer to the Master Glossary.

Jonathan says that the **royal officials**, or servants, congratulated David. Royal officials are people who serve David and help David to rule Israel. Use the same word or phrase for royal officials as you used in previous passages. If you used the word for servants, remember that servant is in the Master Glossary.

Jonathan tells Adonijah that David **bowed** down to worship **Yahweh**, the **God** of **Israel** and **praised** or **blessed** Yahweh. To praise or bless someone means to say good things about them. Use the same words or phrases for bowed down and Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on bow, Yahweh, God, and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for praise. For more information about praise, refer to praise or bless in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah goes to the tent of the Lord's presence and holds onto the horns of the altar. Bezalel made the corners of the altar of burnt offerings into shapes like animal horns.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar of burnt offerings as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

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Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **horns**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The altar is the altar of sacrifice or burnt offerings, the place where the priests make burnt offerings to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **altar**. Look up altar in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah wants Solomon to **swear an oath** or make a solemn promise to Adonijah that Solomon will not kill Solomon's **servant**, Adonijah. Use the same words or phrases for "swear an oath" and servant as you used in previous passages. For more information on oath and servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Adonijah does not want Solomon to kill Adonijah with a sword.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sword as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sword**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon says that Adonijah will die if Solomon finds evil in Adonijah. Evil is the opposite of good, and a person with evil in them willingly does bad things to hurt other people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **evil**. Look up evil in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon tells Adonijah to go to Adonijah's home. A person's home is the house or shelter where a person lives and rests.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **home**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 1:38–53

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1003 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 2:1–12

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 2:1–12 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:1–12 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, King David made his son, Solomon, king of Israel. Therefore, until David's death, King David and King Solomon were ruling Israel together. This story takes place a short time after King David made Solomon king. The storyteller assumes that we remember the stories about how Joab killed Abner and Amasa, how Barzillai helped David, and how Shimei cursed David. Joab had killed Abner after Abner had made peace with David. Joab had also killed Amasa, after David had made Amasa the commander of his army, because Joab was jealous of Amasa. Shimei had cursed David when David escaped from Absalom, but David had promised not to kill him on his way back to Jerusalem after defeating Absalom. Barzillai and his sons had helped David and brought him food.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about what you remember about how Joab killed Abner and Amasa, as well as how Barzillai and Shimei treated King David in the previous stories in the book of 2 Samuel. Pause this audio here.

When King David knew that his time to die was near, King David spoke his last words to King Solomon. It is not clear how long King David lived after he made Solomon king, but it is likely that King David died a short time after that.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories of a time when someone in your community knew that they would soon die. What last words did they say, and to whom did they speak them? How long did that person live after that? How do people in your culture feel when someone gives their last words? Pause this audio here.

King David told King Solomon that he was about to die, just like everybody else on earth must die. King David commanded King Solomon to be strong and to act like a man or an adult. King David was telling King Solomon to have courage and strength to do what Yahweh said at all times, even when he was scared or in danger. King David commanded King Solomon to pay attention and obey what Yahweh his God required. King David usually

1 Kings 2:1–12

called Yahweh his own God, but this time, King David called Yahweh Solomon's God. King David wanted Solomon to have a true and personal relationship with Yahweh.

King David told Solomon to act like a man by walking in the paths of Yahweh. King David was telling Solomon to live and behave the way Yahweh has commanded in the law of Moses. Yahweh's laws and commands include the specific things Yahweh told the people of Israel to obey, such as the ten commandments and the rules for sacrifices and offerings.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about the laws and commands that you have in your community, and arrange the laws into groups. For example, you can group the laws into laws about religion, customs, ceremony, society, property, and any other groups you can think of. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh had commanded every person who became king of Israel to write down a copy of all the teachings of Moses and to read them regularly. Yahweh said that the king must respect and obey Yahweh by carefully following the words of the law of Moses.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the religious duties and responsibilities of rulers in your community. What laws and commands must your ruler keep? Explain who gave these laws and commands and how you communicate them to each new ruler. Pause this audio here.

King David told Solomon that if Solomon obeyed Yahweh, Solomon would be successful and Yahweh would fulfil his promise to David. Yahweh had promised David that if David's descendants sincerely obeyed Yahweh, Yahweh would make sure that one of David's descendants was always king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when one generation has given the job of leading your community to a younger generation. When, how, and why did they do this? Pause audio here.

After King David told Solomon to stay loyal to God, King David reminded Solomon of what Joab, son of Zeruiah, had done. Joab killed two army commanders of Israel, Abner and Amasa, during a time of peace, not war. Abner had once fought for King Saul against David, but later made peace and joined David. Joab killed Abner to get revenge because Abner had killed Joab's brother. Amasa had led Absalom's army when Absalom rebelled against David. Even though David told his men not to kill Absalom, Joab disobeyed and killed Absalom. Later, David forgave Amasa and made him the new army commander instead of Joab. Joab then tricked Amasa and killed him, too. It is likely that David was not powerful enough to punish Joab when he committed these crimes because David's enemies were trying to kill David at the time. David says that Joab got innocent blood on his belt and on his sandals. It is not clear whether David means he got innocent blood on his own belt and sandals or on Joab's belt and sandals. If David means David's own belt and sandals, David might be saying that Joab made David guilty for the murders because King David was in charge of what the army did. If David means that Joab got the innocent blood on Joab's own belt and sandals, David might be saying that Joab is responsible.

Stop here and look at a picture of sandals together as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell of a time when someone disobeyed their leader or commander and did something wrong or killed someone. Who did the people of your community say was responsible? Pause this audio here.

David told Solomon to use his wisdom to deal with Joab in a clever way. David told Solomon not to let the grey head of Joab go down to the world of the dead in peace. David is saying that Joab should not die peacefully of old age, but that Joab should die violently. Solomon needed a lot of wisdom to punish Joab, the powerful military commander, because it was possible that Joab could lead some of the army in a rebellion against Solomon. It is likely that King David realises that Joab could be dangerous to Solomon's rule and also does not want people to consider David and Solomon to be guilty of murder.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk of people who are as powerful or more powerful than a leader and the challenges the leader has to control those people. Pause this audio here.

David also tells Solomon to deal kindly with the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite because they were loyal to David and met David when he was escaping from Absalom with food and provisions. David tells Solomon to let the sons of Barzillai be among those who eat at Solomon's table. David is asking Solomon to provide or take care of the sons, not necessarily that they should sit at Solomon's table and eat. David had wanted to reward their

1 Kings 2:1–12

father Barzillai by bringing him to Jerusalem where David would provide for Barzillai, but Bazillai was too old and chose to stay at his farm.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about how your leaders reward those people who have been loyal to them, especially in times of rebellion and division. Pause this audio here.

Then King David told Solomon to also remember that Shimei, the son of Gera, had called down curses from heaven on David when David went to Mahanaim. Shimei was from the tribe of Benjamin and a relative of Saul. Shimei lived in Bahurim which was not too far from Jerusalem on the road that went toward the Jordan River, northeast of the Mount of Olives. When David was returning to Jerusalem after David's army defeated Absalom, Shimei met King David, with 1,000 men of Benjamin, at the Jordan River and begged King David to forgive him. King David told Solomon that he had promised Shimei, in the name of Yahweh, that he would not kill him. David told Solomon that Solomon should not consider and treat Shimei as innocent. David told Solomon to be wise and make sure that Shimei did not grow old and die peacefully but violently.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories of a leader who seriously punished someone who had wronged the leader. Focus on stories where the leader had to be clever in the way he punished the person. How did the leader make sure that the people did not think that he was illegally punishing the person? Pause this audio here.

King David slept with his fathers, which means that David died. People buried David in the City of David. People also called Jerusalem the City of David because it was David who captured it in war from the Jebusites. The Israelites buried people in caves or tombs. Often family members shared a tomb. Therefore, when someone died, people said that he "slept with his fathers." This phrase also shows that the person died peacefully.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you bury members of the same family in your community? Pause this audio here.

King David had ruled for seven years in Hebron and 33 years in Jerusalem, a total of 40 years as king of the people of Israel. After David died, Solomon sat on the throne of his father, or became king, and Solomon's kingdom was strong and secure.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: When King David knew that he would soon die, he commanded Solomon to be strong and to obey Yahweh and everything that Yahweh commanded in the law of Moses. King David told Solomon that if Solomon was faithful to obey Yahweh, then Yahweh would be faithful to fulfill the promise he made to King David.

In the second scene: King David told Solomon to remember what Joab, the son of Zeruiah, did to King David. David told Solomon to deal with Joab in a wise way for the way Joab killed Abner, son of Ner, and Amasa, son of Jether.

In the third scene: King David told Solomon to be kind to the sons of Barzillai because they were kind to King David when he was escaping from Absalom.

In the fourth scene: King David told Solomon to remember Shimei, who had cursed King David on the day he went to Mahanaim. Although King David had promised Shimei that he would not kill him, King David told Solomon not to consider Shimei innocent or to let him die a peaceful death.

In the fifth scene: King David died, and people buried David in Jerusalem. King Solomon ruled Israel in the place of his father, David, and Yahweh made Solomon's kingdom very strong.

The characters in this passage are:

1 Kings 2:1–12

- Yahweh
- King David
- King Solomon
- Joab, the son of Zeruiah
- Abner, the son of Ner
- Amasa, the son of Jether
- Barzillai the Gileadite and his sons
- Absalom
- And Shimei, the son of Gera

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, King David knew he was about to die, so he gave his last command to Solomon. King David told Solomon that he was about to go the way of all the earth. Because everyone must die, the people of Israel talked about death as going the way of all the earth.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your community talk about death? How would you say that someone is about to die in a gentle and appropriate way in your language? Pause this audio here.

King David commanded Solomon to be strong and show himself a man, or act like an adult. King David was not telling Solomon to be physically strong. Instead, David wanted Solomon to have courage and strength to follow Yahweh's commands, even when it was difficult to follow Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about someone who did what they believed was right and honest, made tough decisions, and stayed strong in difficult times. What is the difference between that kind of strength and physical strength, and how would you talk about it in your language? Pause this audio here.

King David explained that Solomon would show himself a man if he kept the charge of Yahweh, which means that Solomon should obey Yahweh. King David said that Solomon should walk in the ways of Yahweh. A person who walks in the ways of Yahweh is a person who obeys the will of Yahweh. King David usually called Yahweh his God, but now David calls Yahweh Solomon's God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about people who obey God and do the things that God wants? Pay attention to the words and phrases you use. Pause this audio here.

King David told Solomon to walk in the way of Yahweh by obeying Yahweh's laws and commands. King David used several words to talk about these general laws and commands. First, King David told Solomon to keep Yahweh's statutes, which are often Yahweh's laws or rules about how to perform duties in the temple or any other specific instructions about how to live in Yahweh's society. King David also told Solomon to keep Yahweh's commandments, which are general rules for living. King David told Solomon to keep Yahweh's ordinances, which are the laws that Yahweh gave to the people to help them live together well. King David also told Solomon to keep the testimonies of Yahweh. The two stone tablets that Yahweh wrote the ten commandments on were called the testimony because they were testimony to, or proved, the special relationship that Yahweh had with the people of Israel. The testimonies of Yahweh are, therefore, another way to talk about the ten commandments.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Yahweh's statutes, commandments, ordinances, and testimonies were all ways that Yahweh talked about his laws and commands. When you talk about all of the general rules that your society has about how to live with God and live with each other in peace, what do you call those rules altogether? Pause this audio here.

King David told Solomon to do all that Yahweh had commanded in the law of Moses, so that Solomon would be successful in everything. King David said that if Solomon did so, Yahweh would fulfill his promise to David. David told Solomon what Yahweh had promised to do for David if David's children obeyed Yahweh. If David's descendants followed Yahweh with all their heart and soul, then someone from David's family would always sit on the throne of Israel. You will remember that sitting on the throne represents the rule of a king. A person who walks before Yahweh or obeys Yahweh faithfully is a person who decides to obey with his mind and his intelligence. And when the person walks before Yahweh with a faithful soul, they obey with their emotions.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your community talk about someone who is completely committed to something or someone both physically and emotionally? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, King David told Solomon that Solomon himself knew what Joab did to King David. It is not clear how Solomon knew, but King David makes it clear that Solomon knew for himself what Joab had done. Joab had killed two commanders of the armies of Israel, Abner and Amasa, during peacetime. King David said that Joab did that to King David. It is likely King David means that Joab did these murders to David because as king, David was responsible for the murder of both Abner and Amasa. King David says that Joab avenged the blood of war or blood shed during a war in peacetime. Abner had killed Joab's brother during a war. But Joab killed Abner, to avenge his brother, after Abner had made peace with David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What rules do you have in your community about people who kill during war and people who kill during peacetime? How do you refer to the people who kill other people and to the people who other people kill in war and in peace? Pause this audio here.

Joab had also killed Amasa, the son of Jether. David said Joab got innocent blood around his belt and shoes. It is not clear whether Joab got the innocent blood on David's belt and shoes or on Joab's belt and shoes. But it is most likely that Joab got blood on his own belt and shoes. David might have been complaining that Joab made David appear guilty for these crimes, but David was most likely saying that Joab was the one responsible for their deaths.

Stop here as a group and discuss someone who killed someone else as if they were in a war when they were not. Talk about the special language you have in your language to say that someone is guilty of killing an innocent person. Pause this audio here.

David told Solomon to use his wisdom or clever planning to deal with Joab. David told Solomon not to let Joab's gray head go down to Sheol in peace. In other words, David told Solomon not to let Joab die peacefully in his old age. The Israelites called old people "gray heads" because their hair had turned gray.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about old people? Pay attention to the words and phrases you use. Pause this audio here.

The people of Israel considered Sheol to be a dark place beneath the earth where all the dead people, good or bad, went.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your community speak of the world of the dead? Be careful that the words or phrases you use do not simply mean the grave or cemetery. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, David also told Solomon to be kind to the sons of Barzillai because they had been loyal to David when he fled from Absalom. David told Solomon to make sure that the sons of Barzillai were among those who ate at Solomon's table. This does not necessarily mean that Barzillai's sons were to physically eat at Solomon's table. David was telling Solomon to take care of Barzillai's sons and repay their kindness to David with kindness.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Which words and phrases would you use in your language to talk about someone who a ruler is taking care of? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, David reminded Solomon of Shimei, who cursed David but later begged for forgiveness. King David said that he made an oath or promised in the name of Yahweh that he would not kill Shimei by the sword. But now, King David told Solomon not to treat Shimei as innocent. It is likely that David was saying that the oath he made to Shimei did not include someone other than David killing Shimei by something other than a sword. King David said that Solomon was a wise man and would know how to bring Shimei's gray head down to the grave in blood. David was telling Solomon to make sure that Shimei died a violent death.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you make sure promises in your language? And how do people in your language say that someone died a violent death without being offensive? Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, King David slept with his fathers, or died, and people buried him in Jerusalem, the City of David. King David's fathers include his ancestors, not just his own father.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about famous stories in your culture where the hero of the story dies. How do people describe that the person died a peaceful death? Pause this audio here.

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The storyteller tells us that King David was King of Israel for a total of 40 years. The first seven years David was king over the tribe of Judah. David ruled Judah from Hebron. King David then ruled all of Israel for 33 years from Jerusalem. After David died, Solomon sat on the throne of David his father or became king of Israel in the place of his father. Yahweh firmly established Solomon's kingdom. This is a way to say that Yahweh made Solomon's kingdom strong.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King David
- King Solomon
- Joab, the son of Zeruiah
- Abner, the son of Ner
- Amasa, the son of Jether
- Barzillai the Gileadite and his sons
- Absalom
- And Shimei, the son of Gera

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, King David knew that he would soon die, so David commanded Solomon to be strong and to obey Yahweh and everything that Yahweh commanded in the law of Moses. King David told Solomon that if Solomon was faithful to obey Yahweh, then Yahweh would be faithful to fulfil the promise Yahweh made to King David.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel old and tired. I do not have the strength to live much longer. I am about to die; or
- I am happy with the life I have lived. Yahweh has been good to me and blessed me; or
- I want my son to be successful and to love Yahweh. I am worried about the dangerous people around my son.

Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel sad. It is hard to see my father like this. My heart is sorrowful; or
- I must listen to my father and be strong. I have a big responsibility to rule after my father; or
- I feel worried that I might fail. But I trust Yahweh will be with me.

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Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy and pleased with David. David has been obedient and has ruled my people well; or
- My love for Solomon means that I too feel the sadness that Solomon feels about his father; or
- I love David. I love how careful David is to honor me. I love Solomon and the way he listens to his father. If Solomon obeys me, I will do all that I have promised David. That is my great desire, to bless the house of David.

Continue the drama.

In the second scene, King David told Solomon to remember what Joab, the son of Zeruiah, did to King David. David told Solomon to deal with Joab in a wise way for killing Abner, son of Ner, and Amasa, son of Jether.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, the son of Zeruiah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud and strong. I have made myself a strong leader in Israel. I am untouchable. Even King David could not punish me. I will get even stronger when David dies; or
- I am glad that I killed Abner and Amasa. I do not regret it.

Ask the person playing King David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel angry with Joab; or
- I am worried that Joab will trouble Solomon as he has troubled me. Joab is able to destroy the kingdom or even remove my son from the throne; or
- I hate to be associated with Joab’s crimes. Someone must kill Joab so the people of Israel know that I am not guilty of the murders.

Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am angry with Joab. I can see how dangerous Joab is; or
- I really want to punish Joab for his crimes; or
- I feel confident that I can find a clever way to kill Joab.

Continue the drama.

In the third scene, King David told Solomon to be kind to the sons of Barzillai because they were kind to King David when he was escaping from Absalom.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the sons of Barzillai, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We love King David; or
- The whole nation is very sad that King David is dying; or
- As our father loved King David and was loyal to him, we will love and be loyal to King Solomon.

Ask the person playing King David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I love Barzillai; or
- I very much desire that Barzillai’s sons should be rewarded for the help they gave me; or
- I feel loyal to Barzillai and I want my son to feel the same way.

Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel pleased with Barzillai and his sons; or
- I love Barzillai and his sons because they showed my father love; or
- I want to reward Barzillai and his sons as my father has asked.

Continue the drama.

In the fourth scene, King David told Solomon to remember Shimei who cursed King David on the day he went to Mahanaim. King David told Solomon not to consider Shimei innocent or let him die a peaceful death.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shimei, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

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- I feel good and free. King David promised me not to kill me; or
- I feel safe from danger; or
- I still hate King David because he took Saul's throne and I am not sad that he is dying.

Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to be careful for my son. My enemies are a threat to my son. I am worried; or
- I feel angry with Shimei.

Continue the drama.

In the fifth scene, King David died, and the people buried David in Jerusalem. King Solomon ruled Israel in the place of his father, David, and his kingdom was firmly established.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very sad. I miss my father; or
- I feel very proud of what my father has done. My father has ruled Israel well and has left me a great kingdom.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel pleased with David; or
- I am glad that Solomon is doing all that his father commanded him

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

When **King** David knew that he was about to die, he commanded Solomon to keep the commands of **Yahweh**, his **God**. These commands included the ten commandments and all the requirements of Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases for king, Yahweh, and God as you used in previous passages. For more information on King, Yahweh, or God, refer to the Master Glossary.

King David told Solomon to walk in the paths of Yahweh and to keep Yahweh's statutes, commandments, ordinances, and testimonies as Yahweh gave them in the law of Moses. A statute is a law or rule about how to perform duties in the tabernacle or temple. A statute may also refer to a special required task or instructions for how to live in society. A commandment is a law, a rule, or an instruction. Yahweh gave Moses 10 commandments to give to the people of Israel. These commandments taught the Israelites how to live well together in a good relationship with Yahweh and each other. Ordinances usually refer to the ritual rules that Yahweh gave the people of Israel about offering sacrifices and feast celebrations. Yahweh wrote the ten commandments on two stone tablets. The people of Israel called the stone tablets with the law of Yahweh "the testimony." This law proved that Yahweh and the people of Israel had a covenant, or a special relationship.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **statutes**, **commandments**, **ordinances**, and **testimonies**. If you decide to just use the general terms "laws" and "commands," discuss how you will say that. If you decide to use all four special words for these types of laws, look up statutes, commandments, ordinances or testimonies in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these ideas in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **law** of Moses. This law is the general, special instructions that Yahweh gave to Moses and includes all of these other types of laws. For more information about the law of Moses, refer to the Master Glossary. If you have already translated "law of Moses" in another book of the Bible, use the same words you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh promised David that if David's descendants walked faithfully before Yahweh with all their heart and soul, Yahweh would make sure that one of David's descendants would be on the throne of Israel, or be king of Israel. Use the same word for throne that you have used in previous passages. Someone's descendants are their children, their grandchildren, and all the children in their family for generations.

1 Kings 2:1–12

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **descendants**. For more information, refer to descendants in the Master Glossary. If you have translated this idea in another book of the Bible, use the same word here. Pause this audio here.

Walking faithfully is special language that describes how someone lives their life. A person who walks faithfully is a person who behaves the way Yahweh asks him to behave. That person obeys Yahweh. The heart is a muscle inside our body that keeps our blood flowing, but in the Bible, the heart is special language for the place where a person's thoughts, feelings, and decisions happen. The soul is the total invisible, inner part of a person. This part of a person may live on even after their body dies.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**walk faithfully with all their heart and soul**." Look up "heart" and "soul" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these ideas in another book of the Bible,use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David told Solomon to remember that Joab, the son of Zeruiah, killed or shed the blood of the two **commanders** of Israel, Abner and Amasa. A commander is a military leader who is in charge of soldiers. Commanders in Israel's army led their soldiers in battle. Use the same word or phrase for commander as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **blood**. When someone sheds the blood of someone, they kill that person. The Israelites believed that someone's life was in their blood. For more information about blood, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Joab got blood on his belt around his waist and his sandals on his feet. A belt was a piece of cloth that people tied around their waist to hold their robe in place.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **belt** and for **sandals**. If needed, look at a picture of sandals again. Pause this audio here.

David told Solomon to deal with Joab wisely and not to let his grey head go down to Sheol in peace. Sheol is the word throughout the Old Testament for the place of the dead. People thought that Sheol was under the earth. Therefore, the people talked about going down to Sheol. Sheol includes the ideas of death, the underworld, and a place where people buried dead bodies. It was also a place of darkness and silence, weakness, and no joy. Most ancient cultures had a concept of a place for the dead under the earth.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Sheol**. Look up Sheol in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David told Solomon not to let Joab's gray head go down to Sheol in peace. When people live in peace, they are completely well. Those people have a complete life, and are living in harmony with each other, with nature, and most importantly, with Yahweh. Someone who lives in peace is content. Someone who dies in peace dies from natural causes like old age.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **peace**. Look up peace in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King David also told Solomon to remember that Shimei had cursed King David when David fled from Absalom. To curse someone is the opposite of to bless someone. When you bless someone, you wish that something good will happen to the person you bless. When you curse that person, you wish that something bad will happen to them. People believed that a curse would come true.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **curse**. Look up curse in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King David says that he swore to Shimei by Yahweh or made an **oath** not to kill Shimei with the sword. When people make a promise to each other, they can swear an oath to make the promise more serious. When someone swears an oath, they say that they will absolutely keep their promise. And if that person does not keep their promise, Yahweh should punish them. Use the same word or phrase for "swearing by Yahweh" as you used in previous passages. If you find it helpful, you may refer to oath in the Master Glossary.

David said that Solomon is wise and will not bring Shimei down to the grave in blood. A person who has wisdom understands many things and is able to make good decisions that lead to good results. When a person has certain skills, like the ability to build or to make something beautiful, the Bible also says that this person has wisdom.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wisdom**. Look up wisdom in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

After King David died, King Solomon became king, and Yahweh made Solomon's rule strong. A king's rule is the time and way he rules his people. In this case, Solomon's rule also refers to his authority and right to be king.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **rule**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 2:1–12

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (812 KB)
- Setting the Stage (8.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (9.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (7.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Kings 2:13–25

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 2:13–25 and put it in your hearts.

1 Kings 2:13–25

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:13–25 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:13–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last few stories, King David became old, and David's son Adonijah tried to become the new king. However, Yahweh had chosen David's son Solomon to be the new king. Now David has died, and Solomon is the new king of Israel. In this story, Adonijah asks to marry a woman from David's household. However, Solomon sees that Adonijah wants to cause trouble for Solomon, and so Solomon kills Adonijah.

This story begins when Adonijah visits Bathsheba, Solomon's mother. Remember that in an earlier story, Bathsheba helped Solomon become king instead of Adonijah. So when Adonijah visits, Bathsheba wonders why Adonijah has come. Bathsheba may even be nervous, so she asks if Adonijah comes peacefully, or if Adonijah will cause trouble. Adonijah responds that he comes peacefully and wants to speak with Bathsheba.

Adonijah says that earlier, the people of Israel expected Adonijah to be the next king. In that time, a king's oldest son would usually become the new king. Adonijah was David's oldest living son. However, Adonijah says that things have changed and Yahweh chose Solomon to be king. Now Adonijah just wants to ask Bathsheba for something. Adonijah wants Bathsheba to ask Solomon to allow Adonijah to marry Abishag.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who gives permission for a man to marry a woman? How does a man ask permission? Pause this audio here.

Remember that Abishag is a woman from the Israelite town of Shunem. When King David grew old, Abishag took care of King David. Abishag was not David's wife, but Abishag lay close to King David to keep King David warm. Abishag was a part of David's household and is now probably a part of Solomon's household. Adonijah needs Solomon's permission to marry Abishag. Remember also that Adonijah tried to become king instead of Solomon. So Solomon probably does not like Adonijah. But Adonijah knows that Bathsheba has power as the mother of the king and that Solomon will likely listen to his mother. So Adonijah politely asks Bathsheba to ask Solomon to allow Adonijah to marry Abishag. Bathsheba agrees.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When are some times when, instead of asking someone for something yourself, you would ask another person to ask that person for you? Why would you do this? Tell a story about a time when this happened. Pause this audio here.

Bathsheba goes to Solomon. Normally, a king would stay seated on his throne, or special seat, when someone else entered the room. But to show respect for his mother, Solomon gets up and moves towards Bathsheba when Bathsheba arrives. Solomon even bows to his mother and tells people to bring a throne for his mother to sit on. Bathsheba sits on Solomon's right side. A person's right side was a place of honor. Solomon also responds very respectfully when Bathsheba says she has a request. Solomon is ready to listen to and help his mother!

Stop here and look at a picture of a throne together as a group. In your culture, how do you show respect to your mother? How might a king or a leader treat his mother? Pause this audio here.

However, when Bathsheba asks Solomon to allow Adonijah to marry Abishag, Solomon does not want to. Solomon wonders why Bathsheba would ask this. Solomon knows that Adonijah probably wants to cause trouble for Solomon. When David was alive, Abishag was probably a part of King David's household or harem. In that time, a king would have a harem, or a group of wives, female relatives, female servants, and other women that the

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king was in charge of. When a king died, the new king would take control over the old king's harem. Abishag was probably a part of David's harem and is now a part of Solomon's harem. Adonijah acts like Adonijah has the rights of a new king when Adonijah asks to marry Abishag. This is insulting to Solomon and may show that Adonijah will try again to become king instead of Solomon.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In this time, a king would often marry a woman as a way to gain power. For example, a king might marry the daughter of the king of another nation to form an alliance with that nation. Or, as in this story, a king's son might wish to marry an important woman in the king's household to gain authority in that household. In your culture, how do kings and leaders choose who they will marry? Who can marry members of the king's family or household? How could someone become more powerful or influential because of the person they marry? Pause this audio here.

Solomon says it is like Bathsheba asks Solomon to allow Adonijah to become king! Adonijah is David's oldest son and has tried to become king in the past. If Bathsheba asks for power for Adonijah, then it is like she also asks for power for Abiathar and Joab. Abiathar was a priest, and Joab was the head of the army when David was king. Solomon says this because these two men had supported Adonijah and wished to rule as Adonijah's officials. If Solomon allows Adonijah to marry Abishag, then Solomon might as well give power to Abiathar and Joab, too.

Solomon, however, will not give power to Adonijah or to his followers. Instead, Solomon will order someone to kill Adonijah. Earlier, Solomon allowed Adonijah to live as long as Adonijah did not do anything evil. But now, because of what Adonijah asked for, Adonijah will die. Solomon swears an oath, or a very solemn promise, that this will happen. In this time, when a person swore an oath, that person would often ask God to punish that person if the person did not keep their promise. Solomon says that Adonijah will certainly die today, as certainly as Yahweh lives.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you show that you certainly will do what you promise to do? Pause this audio here.

Solomon knows that Yahweh is the one who gave Solomon full control of Israel, as Solomon's father, David, had. Yahweh promised to David that David's descendants would continue to rule. Yahweh kept that promise and has given Solomon and Solomon's descendants the authority to rule. Since Yahweh chose Solomon and promised these things to Solomon, Adonijah cannot become king. King Solomon orders Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, to kill Adonijah. So Benaiah kills Adonijah. In the next story, King Solomon will make Benaiah the leader of Solomon's army.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:13–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Adonijah visits Bathsheba. Adonijah wants Bathsheba to ask Solomon to allow Adonijah to marry Abishag. Bathsheba agrees.

In the second scene: Bathsheba visits Solomon and asks if Adonijah can marry Abishag. Solomon is surprised that Bathsheba would ask this. Solomon knows Adonijah wants to be king, so Solomon swears that Adonijah will surely die. Solomon orders Benaiah to kill Adonijah.

In the third scene: Benaiah kills Adonijah.

The characters in this passage are:

- Adonijah, Haggith's son
- Bathsheba, Solomon's mother
- The people of Israel
- Yahweh
- Solomon

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- Abishag of Shunem
- Abiathar the priest
- Joab, Zeruiah's son
- David
- And Benaiah, Jehoiada's son

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story begins after Solomon has become king. In the first scene, Adonijah visits Bathsheba. The storyteller reminds us that Haggith is the name of Adonijah's mother, while Bathsheba is Solomon's mother. Bathsheba first asks Adonijah if Adonijah comes peacefully. Adonijah responds that Adonijah comes peacefully and politely asks permission to say something to Bathsheba. Bathsheba says Adonijah may say it.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you ask if someone will act in a peaceful or friendly way? How would you politely ask if you can speak to someone about something? Pause this audio here.

Adonijah then says that Adonijah had the kingdom, or had the right to become the next king. Adonijah emphatically says that Bathsheba knows this! Adonijah exaggerates and says that all the people of Israel looked to Adonijah or expected Adonijah to be king. Remember that a king's oldest son would usually become the new king, so Adonijah probably thought people expected Adonijah, David's oldest son, to be the next king. However, that did not happen. Adonijah says that Yahweh chose Solomon to be king. So now, Adonijah just wants to ask Bathsheba for something. Adonijah politely asks that Bathsheba not say no.

Bathsheba says that Adonijah can ask his question. Adonijah politely asks Bathsheba to ask King Solomon something for Adonijah. Adonijah says that Solomon will not say no to Bathsheba. Adonijah probably says this because Bathsheba is Solomon's mother. Adonijah wants Solomon to allow Adonijah to marry Abishag. Bathsheba agrees to speak to Solomon about this.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Adonijah speaks very politely to Bathsheba and asks permission both to speak and to ask Bathsheba for something. In your language, when you want to ask for something from someone important, how do you speak to that person in a polite and respectful way? How might the important person respond? Discuss how you want to translate Adonijah's polite questions and Bathsheba's responses. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Bathsheba goes to speak to Solomon. Solomon sits on a throne and may be in his palace. When Bathsheba arrives, Solomon stands up and bows to Bathsheba. Then Solomon sits on his throne again. Solomon has someone bring another throne for Bathsheba so that Bathsheba can sit in an honorable place at Solomon's right side.

Bathsheba says that she has a small request for Solomon and asks Solomon not to refuse her. Solomon responds that Bathsheba can ask and that Solomon will not say no. Bathsheba asks Solomon to allow Adonijah to marry Abishag.

However, Solomon does not like this request. Solomon asks Bathsheba why she would ask this. It is not clear if Solomon expects Bathsheba to answer this question or if Solomon wants to show that Solomon is surprised. Solomon says it is like Bathsheba asks for Adonijah to become king, since Adonijah is older than Solomon. Solomon also says it is like Bathsheba asks for power for the priest Abiathar and Joab, the son of Zeruiah, who support Adonijah. Bathsheba does not actually ask for Adonijah to rule with Abiathar and Joab. Solomon means that if Solomon agreed to Adonijah's request, then Solomon would help Adonijah to become king. Then Adonijah would make Abiathar and Joab officials.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When someone asks you something very surprising, how do you show that you are surprised that they would ask this? As an activity, have one person in the group pretend to ask a second person for something important and surprising, like the second person's house. Ask the second person, "How do you feel?" How do you show that this is an unreasonable or crazy request? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Solomon says that when Bathsheba asks for the marriage, it is like Bathsheba also asks for power for Adonijah, Abiathar, and Joab. Solomon means that this marriage would

cause Adonijah, Abiathar, and Joab to become powerful. Discuss how you want to translate Solomon's surprise and response to Bathsheba here. Pause this audio here.

Instead of saying yes to Adonijah's request, Solomon swears by Yahweh, or makes a solemn promise in the name of Yahweh. With this oath, Solomon asks God to punish Solomon if Solomon does not keep his promise. Solomon says that in the same way that it is completely true that Yahweh is alive, people can also be completely sure that Solomon will order that Adonijah will die the same day. Solomon declares that Yahweh is the one who caused Solomon to sit on David's throne. To sit on a throne is a common way to say that a person is a ruler. Yahweh has also established Solomon's dynasty or made a house for Solomon. This house is not an actual building. Solomon's house means Solomon's descendants or family line. So here, this means that Yahweh causes Solomon and Solomon's family to continue to rule. Solomon may mention what Yahweh has done to show that Solomon is right to defend himself as king. Solomon then orders Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, to kill Adonijah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people make solemn promises in your language? How do people ask God or a god to be a part of the promise? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you want to translate Solomon's solemn promise here. First, Solomon asks God to punish Solomon if Solomon does not keep his promise. Then Solomon talks about what Yahweh has done for Solomon. David also makes a solemn oath in a similar way that Solomon does here. You can review how you translated it in 1 Kings 1:29–30. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Benaiah goes to the place where Adonijah is. Benaiah strikes Adonijah, or attacks Adonijah, so that Adonijah dies.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:13–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Adonijah, Haggith's son
- Bathsheba, Solomon's mother
- The people of Israel
- Yahweh
- Solomon
- Abishag of Shunem
- Abiathar the priest
- Joab, Zeruiah's son
- David
- And Benaiah, Jehoiada's son

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

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The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Adonijah, the son of David and Haggith, visited Bathsheba, the mother of Solomon.

Bathsheba asked Adonijah, “Have you come to me in peace?”

Adonijah replied, “Yes, in peace.” Then Adonijah asked, “May I tell you something?”

Bathsheba answered, “Tell me what it is.”

Then Adonijah said, “You know that I had the right to be the king. All the people of Israel hoped that I would become king. But that did not happen. My younger brother is now the king, for this was what Yahweh chose to do. So now, I want to ask you something. Please do not say no.”

Bathsheba said, “You can ask.”

Adonijah said to Bathsheba, “Ask King Solomon something for me. King Solomon will not say no to you. Ask King Solomon to let me marry Abishag from Shunem.”

“All right,” Bathsheba answered. “I will ask King Solomon if you can marry Abishag.”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Adonijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I do not want Bathsheba to think that I will try to become king instead of Solomon. I must be polite to Bathsheba so she will help me; or
- I will pretend to accept that Solomon is king, but I still want to become king and rule! I do not like that Solomon is king instead of me; or
- If I marry Abishag, I will become more important, because Abishag took care of King David; or
- Solomon probably does not trust me because I tried to become king. Solomon will not listen to me, so I will ask Bathsheba to ask for me. Solomon will surely listen to his mother.

Ask the person playing Bathsheba, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am surprised that Adonijah has come to visit. Adonijah tried to become king even though David said my son would be the next king! or
- I know a marriage with Abishag is an important marriage, but if Adonijah marries Abishag, maybe Adonijah will be happy. Then Adonijah will no longer cause trouble for Solomon; or
- I am not sure why Adonijah wants to marry Abishag. I will speak with Solomon about this. I am sure Solomon will know what is best to do.

Continue the drama.

Bathsheba went to tell King Solomon what Adonijah had requested. King Solomon stood up to meet Bathsheba and bowed to her. Then Solomon sat down on his throne again. Solomon had someone bring another throne for his mother so that his mother could sit in honor at Solomon’s right side. Then Bathsheba said to Solomon, “I want to ask you to do a small favor for me. Please do not say no.”

Solomon responded, “Mother, you can ask me. I will not say no.”

Bathsheba said, “Please allow your brother Adonijah to marry Abishag of Shunem.”

But King Solomon responded, “Why do you ask if Adonijah can marry Abishag from Shunem? It is like you ask for Adonijah to become king, since Adonijah is older than I and wants that! Adonijah would rule Israel, and with him would be the priest Abiathar and Joab, the son of Zeruiah!”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that my mother has come to visit me. I love my mother and respect her; or
- I am surprised that my mother, Bathsheba, would ask for something for Adonijah! Maybe she does not know how this marriage would help Adonijah become king; or

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- I am upset that Adonijah causes trouble for me. I am even more upset that Adonijah tried to get my mother to help him.

Ask the person playing Bathsheba, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am pleased that my son shows me respect; or
- I am surprised that my son spoke to me like this! or
- I am embarrassed that Solomon thinks that I would try to help Adonijah.

Continue the drama.

King Solomon made an oath in the name of Yahweh. Solomon said, "May God punish me, yes, punish me very severely if Adonijah does not die because of what Adonijah asked for. I swear this in the name of Yahweh, who certainly lives! Yahweh, who has given me the same full control of the kingdom as my father David had! Yahweh, who, as Yahweh promised, has given me and my family line the authority to rule! I swear that Adonijah will surely die today!"

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Adonijah will continue to cause trouble for me if Adonijah continues to live; or
- Since Yahweh chose me to be king, I must continue to be king. I will stop anyone who tries to cause trouble for me; or
- I am upset that Adonijah has asked for this. If Adonijah had not tried to cause trouble, I would have let Adonijah live in peace.

Continue the drama.

Then King Solomon ordered Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, to kill Adonijah. So Benaiah killed Adonijah.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:13–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Bathsheba asks if Adonijah comes **peacefully**. When people do not fight, they live at peace. Here, Bathsheba wants to know if Adonijah comes to cause trouble or comes in a friendly way. For more information on peace, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for peace as you used in previous passages.

Adonijah talks about the kingdom of Israel, which now belongs to Solomon. A kingdom is the territory or the people that a king rules.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **kingdom**. Look up kingdom in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Adonijah says that all **Israel** expected Adonijah to be king. Israel is the name of the territory where the Israelites lived. Sometimes the word Israel means the Israelites, or the people of Israel, as it does here. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

Solomon is **king** of Israel. A king is someone who rules over a city or a country. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh caused Solomon to be king. The name Yahweh was a very personal name for God. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

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Solomon **bows** to Bathsheba. When a person bows down before someone else, they lower their head or the whole top of their body forward. The person does this to show respect and humility. For more information on bow, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for bow as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of someone bowing. Pause this audio here.

Solomon sits on a **throne** and asks people to bring a throne for Bathsheba. A throne is a special chair that a ruler, a ruler's family members, or an important person would sit on. Use the same word or phrase for throne as you used in previous passages.

Solomon swears an **oath**. An oath is a very serious promise. For more information on oath, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for oath as you used in previous passages.

Solomon asks that **God** punish Solomon if Solomon does not do what Solomon promised. This is a general word for God. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh has made a dynasty or a house for Solomon. The house of Solomon refers not to a building, but to the people who belong to Solomon. Solomon's house means Solomon's descendants or family line. So here, this means that Yahweh caused Solomon's family to continue to rule as king.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **house**. Look up "household" or "house of David" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 2:13–25

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (839 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.4 MB)

- Filling the Gaps (3.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Kings 2:26–35

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 2:26–35 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:26–35 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:26–35 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, we heard that King Solomon ordered Benaiah to kill Adonijah because Adonijah tried to become king. Now King Solomon is making sure that no one who is loyal to Adonijah remains to cause more problems. Abiathar the priest is one of the people who betrayed King Solomon and supported Adonijah. King Solomon orders Abiathar to go back to his home in Anathoth. Anathoth is one of the special cities that Yahweh set aside for the Levites or priests to live in. Anathoth is about five kilometers north of Jerusalem.

Stop here as a group and look at a map that shows the location of Anathoth. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon tells Abiathar that he deserves to die because he betrayed Solomon and supported Adonijah. However, King Solomon recognizes that in the past, Abiathar was a great support to King David and suffered through a lot of difficult times with King David. King Solomon also tells about how, in the past, Abiathar was one of the priests who carried the ark of the Sovereign Yahweh. The ark that the storyteller calls the ark of the Lord, or Adonai, Yahweh, here is the ark of the covenant that you have heard about in previous stories. The ark is a powerful symbol of Yahweh's presence with his people.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of what the ark of Yahweh probably looked like.

Pause this audio here.

Because Abiathar has supported King David in the past, King Solomon does not kill Abiathar. However, King Solomon punishes Abiathar for supporting Adonijah and tells Abiathar he is no longer Yahweh's priest. Abiathar must leave Jerusalem and stay in Anathoth.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell about a time when a person deserved a severe punishment but received a less severe punishment. Why did the person receive the less severe punishment? Pause this audio here.

A long time ago, in a previous story, a prophet in a place called Shiloh prophesied that one day the family of Eli would no longer be a part of the priesthood. Abiathar is from the house, or family, of Eli, and now Abiathar is no longer Yahweh's priest. The prophecy is now fulfilled, or is true.

Joab, the commander of the army, who supported Adonijah, hears the news that Adonijah is dead. Joab also hears that Abiathar is no longer Yahweh's priest and that Solomon has sent Abiathar away to Anathoth. Joab is afraid that Solomon will also punish him because Joab supported Adonijah. Joab had been loyal to David before this, as he did not support Absalom when Absalom tried to become king before David died. But now, Joab has

betrayed David and Solomon by supporting Adonijah. Joab runs into the tent of Yahweh and grabs the horns on two corners of the altar. The tent of Yahweh is where the people keep the ark of Yahweh in Jerusalem at this time. This area is also where the people offer sacrifices or burnt offerings on an altar to Yahweh. In this story, it is not clear whether this is the original tent of meeting we heard about in previous stories. David may have brought this tent to Jerusalem to put the ark of the covenant inside. Therefore, this altar could have been inside a tent, or it could have been outside in the courtyard, as it was when it was near the original tent.

Stop here and look at a picture of the tent of Yahweh as a group. Pause this audio here.

The altar is where people sacrifice animals as burnt offerings to Yahweh. Sometimes, when the priests sacrificed animals as a sin offering for a person who had sinned accidentally, they smeared the blood of the animals on the horns.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of the altar of burnt offerings. Notice the horns on each corner of the altar. Pause this audio here.

Why does Joab grab onto the horns of the altar? The law that Yahweh gave to Moses says that if a person kills another person accidentally, that person can go to the altar and take hold of the horns. Then Yahweh protects that person, and no one can kill that person for the accidental death the person caused.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what is the difference in punishment for someone who kills another person accidentally and someone who kills another person intentionally? Pause this audio here.

Remember, before King David died, he told his son Solomon to punish Joab for the sin of murdering Abner, the commander of Israel's army, and Amasa, the commander of Judah's army. Joab did not kill Abner and Amasa accidentally; Joab killed the two innocent men intentionally. Because of this sin, Joab is not really safe when he goes to the altar and holds onto the horns. Joab is also guilty because he did not support the king that Yahweh chose and anointed, King Solomon.

King Solomon hears that Joab is in the tent at the altar, and then Solomon commands Benaiah to go and kill Joab. Benaiah goes into the tent and tells Joab that the king commands him to come out. But Joab refuses to come out and says that he will stay and die in the tent by the altar. Benaiah goes back and tells King Solomon that Joab refuses to come out and says he will die in the tent.

Why does Benaiah not kill Joab right away? Maybe Benaiah does not feel it is right to kill someone inside the tent of Yahweh, especially someone who is holding onto the horns of the altar. But Solomon gives Benaiah permission to kill Joab inside the tent. Solomon says that this is how Yahweh will repay Joab for the murders of Abner and Amasa. Solomon says only Joab is guilty of the murders, not Solomon's father, David, because David did not know that Joab planned to kill Abner and Amasa. Solomon says that Abner and Amasa were very good men, better than Joab. Solomon says that the blood of the two men Joab killed will "rest on the head of Joab and his descendants forever." When people offer sacrifices to Yahweh, Yahweh requires the guilty person to put their hand on the head of the animal. In this way, the person transfers their own guilt to the animal, and then Yahweh removes the guilt through the sacrifice. Here, Solomon is saying that he wants Joab and his descendants to always keep the guilt. In contrast, Solomon says that Yahweh's peace or good fortune will be on David and his descendants and his kingdom forever.

Benaiah goes back into the tent of Yahweh and kills Joab. The story does not tell how Benaiah kills Joab, but he probably kills Joab with a sword. Then people bury Joab near his home, which is in a large area of open land, in the wilderness of Judah. We know from another story that Joab is from Bethlehem, but the storyteller does not mention that in this story.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Bethlehem and the wilderness of Judah, where Joab's family buries him. Pause this audio here.

After Joab dies, King Solomon makes Benaiah the commander of the army. Solomon also appoints Zadok to replace Abiathar as priest. Remember, Zadok is the priest who anointed King Solomon.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:26–35 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has seven scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon sends Abiathar the priest away from Jerusalem and says that Abiathar can no longer be Yahweh's priest. King Solomon explains why he is not punishing Abiathar with death. King Solomon tells Abiathar the priest to return to his fields, or his home, in Anathoth.

In the second scene: Joab hears that Adonijah is dead and that Solomon has removed Abiathar as Yahweh's priest and sent him to Anathoth. Joab becomes afraid, because he knows that King Solomon will also punish him because he was loyal to Adonijah. The storyteller does remind us, however, that Joab had not been loyal to Absalom when Absalom had tried to overthrow King David. Joab runs to the tent of Yahweh and grabs the horns on the altar of sacrifice.

In the third scene: Someone tells King Solomon that Joab is in the tent of Yahweh, and Solomon tells Benaiah to go and kill Joab.

In the fourth scene: Benaiah goes into the tent of Yahweh and confronts Joab. Joab refuses to come out and says that he will die there, beside the altar.

In the fifth scene: Benaiah returns to King Solomon and reports that Joab refuses to come out of the tent. King Solomon tells Benaiah to go ahead and kill Joab inside the tent. Solomon explains why he must punish Joab. Solomon also explains why it is acceptable to kill Joab, even though Joab is holding the horns of the altar inside the tent of Yahweh.

In the sixth scene: Benaiah follows King Solomon's command, returns to the tent of Yahweh, and strikes Joab down, or kills him with a sword. Then, people bury Joab at his home, out in the wilderness area of Judah.

In the seventh scene: King Solomon appoints Benaiah to be the commander of his army. Also, King Solomon appoints Zadok to be a priest to replace Abiathar.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- A messenger, who tells Solomon about Joab
- Abiathar the priest, who supported Adonijah
- Joab, the commander of the army, who supported Adonijah
- Benaiah, one of David's mighty warriors, who is loyal to Solomon
- And Zadok, a priest loyal to Solomon

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember, in the first scene, Solomon tells Abiathar to go back to Anathoth. We heard earlier that Anathoth is about five kilometers north of Jerusalem. When Solomon removed Abiathar from being priest, he was fulfilling the word, or message, of Yahweh. Yahweh had told Eli many years before at Shiloh that one day he would remove Eli's family from being priests.

If necessary, stop here and, as a group, look at a map to see where Anathoth is in relation to Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Joab runs to the tent of Yahweh. Joab is quickly escaping to a safe place. Joab takes hold of or grabs the horns on the altar of sacrifice, or the bronze altar. This altar was probably in the courtyard of the tabernacle, or the tent that David had brought to Jerusalem for the ark. The phrase "tent of Yahweh" refers to the entire tabernacle, not just the tent that covers the Holy Place and the Most Holy Place. Only priests were allowed to go inside the tent that covered the Holy Place.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of the tabernacle that shows the courtyard, the altar of sacrifice, and the tent that covered the Holy Place and Most Holy Place. Even if this was not the original tent of meeting that Moses constructed, this tent probably looks very similar. Pause this audio here.

Remember, because of the law Yahweh gave to Moses, Joab thinks that grabbing the horns of the altar will protect Joab from punishment. The storyteller gives some background information. He reminds us that Joab supported Adonijah but did not support Absalom.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Consider if you need to mention this fact as two separate ideas, or together in one statement. How will you share this information about Joab's support of Adonijah but not of Absalom? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, we do not know where Solomon is when he hears that Joab has gone to the altar and grabbed the horns. We do not know who tells Solomon about Joab.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller says that Benaniah enters the tent to confront Joab. This probably means that Benaiah goes into the courtyard area of the tabernacle, near the altar of sacrifice or the bronze altar.

In the fifth scene, Solomon explains why it is acceptable for Benaniah to kill Joab while Joab is holding onto the horns of the altar. Joab is guilty of intentionally killing two innocent men—Abner, the commander of Israel's armies, and Amasa, the commander of Judah's armies. Solomon says that Joab killed Abner and Amasa without telling David about it. Solomon says that Abner and Amasa "were better men and more upright than" Joab. Solomon says that "the guilt of their blood" will rest on the head of Joab and his descendants forever. This means that because Joab killed Abner and Amasa, Joab is guilty forever of this crime, and his family after him will also be guilty. It is impossible for Joab to be innocent.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about people who are guilty of committing a crime? How might this person's crime affect the people in their family and future generations? Pause this audio here.

Solomon also says that Yahweh's peace will be "on David and his descendants, his house, and his throne" forever. "House" and "throne" here do not mean an actual physical building or a piece of royal furniture. "House" refers to all of David's current and future family members and the people who live under his authority. "Throne" refers to David's kingdom and all of the kings that come after David, through his bloodline, or family line.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:26–35 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has seven scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- A messenger, who tells Solomon about Joab
- Abiathar the priest, who supported Adonijah
- Joab, the commander of the army, who supported Adonijah
- Benaiah, one of David's mighty warriors, who is loyal to Solomon
- And Zadok, a priest loyal to Solomon

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

1 Kings 2:26–35

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, King Solomon banishes Abiathar the priest and says that Abiathar can no longer serve as Yahweh's priest. King Solomon explains that he is not punishing Abiathar with death because Abiathar helped carry the ark of Yahweh and suffered through difficult times with David. However, Solomon tells Abiathar that he must move out of Jerusalem back to Abiathar's fields at Anathoth.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Abiathar, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wish I had never supported Adonijah! or
- I am so glad King Solomon is letting me live.

Continue the drama.

In the second scene, Joab hears the news that Adonijah has died and that Solomon sent Abiathar away. Joab runs into the tent of Yahweh and grabs the horns of the altar.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The law will protect me. Solomon cannot kill me here! or
- I wonder if Solomon knows I killed Abner and Amasa.

Continue the drama.

In the third scene, someone tells King Solomon that Joab is in the tent of Yahweh, holding the horns of the altar. Solomon orders Benaiah to strike Joab down to kill him.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I remember my father David's dying wish. I want to honor my father. Here is my chance to punish Joab!

Continue the drama.

In the fourth scene, Benaiah tells Joab to come out of the tent. Joab refuses to come out and says he will die there inside the tent.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- If Solomon kills me here in the tent of Yahweh, then he will be guilty of sin himself! I will take my chances.

Continue the drama.

In the fifth scene, Benaiah tells King Solomon that Joab refuses to come out of the tent. King Solomon tells Benaiah to go ahead and kill Joab inside the tent. The king explains that he must punish Joab because he is guilty of killing innocent people, or shedding innocent blood. The king says that Yahweh will repay Joab for the sin he committed when he killed Abner and Amasa.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Benaiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It cannot be right to kill someone inside the tent of Yahweh. I am afraid I will be punished, too!

Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Joab murdered Abner and Amasa intentionally. Therefore, I have a right to kill Joab in the tent of Yahweh.

Continue the drama.

In the sixth scene, Benaiah kills Joab. Joab's family buries him at his own home.

In the seventh scene, King Solomon appoints Benaiah to be the commander of his army. Also, King Solomon appoints Zadok to be a priest to replace Abiathar.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:26–35 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King Solomon orders Abiathar to go back to his fields in Anathoth. This means that Abiathar must go back to his land or property in Anathoth. Throughout this story, the storyteller refers to King Solomon as "the king." For more information about "king," refer to the Master Glossary.

Abiathar is a priest. For more information about "**priest,**" refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **fields** or property that someone owns. Pause this audio here.

Abiathar is from the "house," or household, of Eli, and Solomon mentions that Yahweh's peace will be on David's "house" forever. "House" here does not mean a building that people live in. "House" means descendants, family line, and often other people who belong to them. For more information about "house," refer to "household" and "House of David" in the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**house of Eli**" or "**House of David**." Pause this audio here.

King Solomon tells Abiathar that he deserves to die. This means that King Solomon has the right to put Abiathar to death because Abiathar supported Adonijah and not Solomon.

King Solomon says that Abiathar helped carry the **ark** of Adonai Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for the "ark of Yahweh" that you have used in previous passages. For more information about the ark of the covenant or Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Translate these ideas the same way you did in previous passages.

This is the first time that the storyteller uses the name "Adonai Yahweh" in 1 Kings. The name "Adonai" means Lord, or master. This name for God tells us that God is all-powerful.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Adonai Yahweh** and for "**ark of Adonai Yahweh**." Look up Adonai in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that Solomon fulfilled the **word** of Yahweh about the household of Eli when he removed Abiathar as priest. When Yahweh speaks a word, Yahweh is giving a message to people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for "**word of Yahweh**." See word in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same phrase here. Pause this audio here.

Use the same word or phrase for **the tent of Yahweh** as you used in previous passages. In previous passages, the storyteller just called this a tent, but here the storyteller calls it the tent of Yahweh.

Use the same word for **altar** and **horns of the altar** as you used in previous passages. For more information about altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Solomon talks about **commanders** that Joab killed. Use the same word for army commanders as you used in previous passages.

King Solomon says that the guilt of Abner and Amasa's **blood** will rest on the head of Joab and his **descendants** forever. In other words, Joab and his descendants will always be guilty of murdering Abner and Amasa. Use the same words or phrases for blood and descendants as you have used previously, and refer to blood in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for “his **guilt** will rest on his head.” Although the storyteller does not use the word for “guilt” in this story, you may state that Joab will remain guilty, or that Joab will need punishment because of what he did. For more information about guilt, refer to the Master Glossary. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon calls Amasa and Abner more righteous than Joab. This means that these men acted fairly and obeyed Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **righteous**. For more information about righteousness, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon also says that **peace** will be on David and his descendants and his house and throne forever. Use the same words or phrases for David’s descendants, David’s house, and throne as you have used in previous passages. The meaning of peace here is not the opposite of war, but rather prosperity and being completely well. For more information on peace, refer to the Master Glossary. Translate peace in the same way as you have translated it previously.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 2:26–35

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (884 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Kings 2:36–46

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 2:36–46 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:36–46 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:36–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In 2 Samuel, chapter 16, we heard about a man named Shimei, who was from the family of King Saul. When Shimei saw King David and his army running away from Absalom, Shimei cursed and insulted David, and threw rocks at David and his army. Shimei was angry with David for replacing Saul as king. At that time, King David promised that he would not kill Shimei. However, just before King David died, David instructed his son Solomon to make sure that someone punished Shimei for how he treated David.

Now we see Shimei again. King Solomon sends a message to Shimei to request a meeting. When King Solomon meets with Shimei, Solomon orders Shimei to build a house in Jerusalem and live there. However, Shimei must not go to any other place. Shimei must stay in Jerusalem. We know from the earlier story about Shimei that he lives in a place called Bahurim, a village outside Jerusalem. Bahurim is located on the road that leads from Jerusalem to Jericho.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map that shows Jerusalem, Bahurim, and Jericho. Pause this audio here.

Solomon warns Shimei that if Shimei disobeys and leaves Jerusalem, Shimei will die. Solomon says to Shimei, “Your blood will be on your own head,” or “you will be guilty.” Solomon warns Shimei that he will only have himself to blame if he dies—Solomon will not be guilty of murder.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Share a story about a time when someone broke a promise, and then that person took responsibility for the consequences. Pause this audio here.

Solomon mentions the Kidron Valley. The Kidron Valley is a low-lying area that separates the walled city of Jerusalem from the Mount of Olives. The Kidron Valley goes from north to south and is on the eastern boundary of Jerusalem. If Shimei leaves Jerusalem from the east side, Shimei has to cross the Kidron Valley to go to another place. However, Solomon’s command means that Shimei cannot leave Jerusalem from any direction.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map that shows Jerusalem, the Kidron Valley, and the Mount of Olives. Pause this audio here.

Shimei agrees to do what Solomon says and swears an oath that he will stay in Jerusalem. But after a long time, three years later, two of Shimei’s slaves run away from Shimei’s property. The slaves may have been working on land or property that Shimei owns outside of Jerusalem.

Someone informs Shimei that the two slaves have gone to Gath, which is in Philistine territory. Gath is about 50 kilometers southwest of Jerusalem. The two slaves go to the king of Gath. The king’s name is Achish. Shimei rides his donkey to Gath and searches for his slaves. Shimei finds the slaves and brings them back to Jerusalem with him.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map that shows Jerusalem and Gath. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 2:36–46

Someone tells King Solomon that Shimei left Jerusalem, went to Gath, and came back. Finally, here is Solomon's opportunity to carry out the last wishes of his father, David. King Solomon orders Shimei to come and see Solomon. Solomon reminds Shimei about the oath or promise Shimei made to Yahweh and to Solomon, that he would not leave Jerusalem. Solomon reminds Shimei that he already knows the result of breaking the oath—Shimei will die. Solomon asks Shimei, "Why did you not keep your oath?"

Stop here and discuss: Tell about a time when you or someone you know made an oath or a strong promise, and then did not keep it. What reasons did you or that person give for not keeping the promise? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon reminds Shimei about how he treated David badly long ago, when Shimei cursed and insulted David, and threw rocks at him. Solomon warns Shimei that now Yahweh will punish him for this wrong behavior. Solomon says this to make sure that Shimei understands that the punishment is from Yahweh, not from Solomon. According to King Solomon, Yahweh will bless Solomon, and David's throne will be "secure before Yahweh forever." This means that Solomon believes that David's kingdom will never end.

Once again, Solomon calls Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, to "strike down" a person. Benaiah is the commander of Solomon's army, and he is the man who killed both Adonijah and Joab in the previous stories. Benaiah follows Solomon's order and kills Shimei.

Now that Solomon has removed Adonijah, Joab, Abiathar, and Shimei, Solomon has full control over his kingdom. Solomon has fulfilled the last wishes of his father, David. David had asked Solomon to make sure that he punished both Joab and Shimei.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:36–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon meets with Shimei and tells him to build a house in Jerusalem. King Solomon tells Shimei that Shimei must stay in Jerusalem. If Shimei leaves the city, he will die. Shimei agrees to stay in Jerusalem.

In the second scene: After Shimei has stayed in Jerusalem for about three years, his two slaves run away to Gath. Someone tells Shimei where the two slaves are, that they have gone to Achish, the king of Gath. Shimei leaves Jerusalem and goes to Gath to find and bring back his slaves.

In the third scene: Someone tells King Solomon that Shimei left Jerusalem and came back. King Solomon calls for Shimei to come see him. King Solomon reminds Shimei that he promised not to leave Jerusalem and asks why Shimei broke his promise. King Solomon reminds Shimei of the wrong way he treated David. Solomon orders Benaiah to kill Shimei, and Benaiah obeys.

In the fourth scene: We see that King Solomon's kingdom is now established.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Shimei
- The messenger or messengers who tell Shimei to come and meet with King Solomon
- Shimei's two slaves
- Achish, king of Gath
- The person who tells Shimei that his slaves are in Gath
- The person who tells Solomon that Shimei left Jerusalem
- The messenger or messengers who tell Shimei to come back to meet with King Solomon
- And Benaiah

1 Kings 2:36–46

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, King Solomon orders Shimei to come and see him. King Solomon probably sends messengers or soldiers to Shimei. Then the messengers or soldiers bring Shimei to meet with Solomon. Solomon orders Shimei to build himself a house in Jerusalem, live there, and not go anywhere else. Then Solomon warns Shimei, "The day you leave and cross the Kidron Valley, you can be sure you will die; your blood will be on your own head." When Solomon mentions crossing the Kidron Valley, Solomon just means this as a way to show that someone is leaving Jerusalem. There are other ways to leave Jerusalem that do not go across the Kidron Valley. Solomon means that Shimei will definitely die if Shimei leaves Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Solomon warns Shimei that he will die the "day you leave" Jerusalem. In your language, what is the best way to say this as a strong warning, where there is no doubt that this consequence will happen? Pause this audio here.

Solomon tells Shimei, "Your blood will be on your own head" if Shimei leaves Jerusalem. This means that Shimei will only have himself to blame if he breaks his oath and leaves Jerusalem.

As a group, discuss another question: In your language, how do you say that someone is responsible for what happens if he breaks an oath or a promise? Pause this audio here.

Shimei answers Solomon and says, "What you say is good," which means "I agree with you." Shimei promises to do what Solomon orders, and Shimei humbles himself and says that he is Solomon's servant and calls Solomon "my lord the king."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way in your language to show this whole conversation between Solomon and Shimei? The conversation begins when Solomon tells Shimei to build a house in Jerusalem and not go anywhere else. The conversation ends when Shimei agrees to do what Solomon says. Also, what words of respect do you use to show humility and respect to a person in authority? Pause this audio here.

The scene ends with the information that Shimei stays in Jerusalem for a long time. We know that "a long time" means a few years, because the next part of the story mentions that Shimei leaves Jerusalem "three years later."

The second scene happens three years later. This means what happens next happens about three years after Shimei swore to Solomon that he would not go outside of Jerusalem. Shimei learns that two of his slaves have run away to Achish, the king of Gath. It is not clear if the slaves ran away from Shimei's house in Jerusalem or from Shimei's property in the village of Bahurim. When Shimei hears that the slaves ran away, he rides his donkey to King Achish in Gath and looks for his slaves. The city of Gath is about 50 kilometers southwest of Jerusalem. After Shimei finds the slaves, he brings the slaves back to Jerusalem with him.

In the third scene, after Shimei is back home in Jerusalem with his slaves, someone tells King Solomon that Shimei left Jerusalem, went to Gath, and came back. Solomon again sends messengers or soldiers to get Shimei and bring Shimei to meet with Solomon. King Solomon reminds Shimei of his oath to Yahweh that he would not leave Jerusalem. Solomon also reminds Shimei about the warning of what would happen if Shimei left Jerusalem. Solomon repeats the conversation that he and Shimei had in scene one. Then Solomon asks Shimei, "Why did you not keep your oath to Yahweh and obey the command I gave you?" Solomon is not really asking Shimei for an answer to this question. Solomon asks the question because he wants to remind Shimei of Shimei's oath and show that Solomon knows Shimei disobeyed.

To use Yahweh's name to make a promise is very serious. If a person does not keep an oath or a promise made in Yahweh's name, that person is guilty of breaking the third commandment, which says, "You shall not take Yahweh's name in vain." The person who does this is not respecting Yahweh's name.

Next, Solomon reminds Shimei about the way Shimei cursed and insulted King David. Solomon says, "You know in your heart all the wrong you did to my father, David." Solomon means that even though Shimei does not say it out loud, Shimei really knows inside that he was wrong to curse and insult David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you say that someone "knows in their heart" the truth about something? Share about a time when you acted like everything was okay, but you "knew in your heart" that something was wrong. Pause this audio here.

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Solomon continues on to say that now Yahweh will punish Shimei for his sin, that Yahweh will bless Solomon, and that "the throne of David" will continue forever. Remember, we learned in the previous story that "throne" here does not mean a piece of royal furniture. It means that David's kingdom will continue forever.

In the story, Solomon says many things to Shimei. The storyteller makes it clear who is speaking by reminding the listener this way: "The king also said to Shimei."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If one person in the story speaks many things, how will you remind your listener which person is speaking? Pause this audio here.

After Solomon is finished speaking to Shimei, he orders Benaiah to kill Shimei, and Benaiah obeys.

In scene four, we see that Solomon is now firmly in control of his kingdom. The storyteller says that Solomon's kingdom is in Solomon's hands, which means that Solomon has full power and control over his kingdom. Storytellers often used the idea of a person's hands to show that the person had power over that thing.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you talk about Solomon's kingdom being firmly in Solomon's hands? Pause this audio here.

The people who supported Adonijah or did not support Solomon's father, King David, no longer threaten King Solomon. This strong closing statement shows that everything that has happened in this story and the previous stories has given Solomon strong control of his kingdom.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:36–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Shimei
- The messenger or messengers who tell Shimei to come and meet with King Solomon
- Shimei's two slaves
- Achish, king of Gath
- The person who tells Shimei that his slaves are in Gath
- The person who tells Solomon that Shimei left Jerusalem
- The messenger or messengers who tell Shimei to come back to meet with King Solomon
- And Benaiah

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

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In the first scene, King Solomon meets with Shimei and tells him to build a house in Jerusalem. King Solomon tells Shimei that he must stay in Jerusalem and that if Shimei leaves the city, Shimei will die. Shimei agrees that he will stay in Jerusalem.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shimei, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am relieved that King Solomon is giving me a chance to live! or
- I wonder if King Solomon knows about all the bad things I said to King David, his father; or
- It will be hard for me to take care of my property in Bahurim if I am stuck here in Jerusalem.

Continue the drama.

In the second scene, Shimei's two slaves run away to Gath. Someone tells Shimei where the two slaves are. Shimei leaves Jerusalem and goes to Gath to find and bring back his slaves.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shimei, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have a right to go and reclaim my property, so it is okay for me to leave Jerusalem; or
- I am nervous. I hope Solomon does not find out.

Continue the drama.

In the third scene, someone tells King Solomon that Shimei left Jerusalem and came back. King Solomon calls for Shimei to come see Solomon. King Solomon reminds Shimei that he promised not to leave Jerusalem and asks why Shimei broke his promise. King Solomon reminds Shimei of the wrong way Shimei treated David. Solomon orders Benaiah to kill Shimei, and Benaiah obeys.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Now I can finally fulfill my father David's wishes and give Shimei a just punishment; or
- I cannot believe Shimei would break an oath he made to Yahweh and to me! What a fool.

Continue the drama.

In the fourth scene, we see that Solomon clearly has full control of his kingdom.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope God blesses me and my kingdom; or
- I am a good son and king. I did everything my father, David, asked me to do.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 2:36–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King Solomon sends for Shimei two different times in this story. "Sends for" means that Solomon sends messengers or soldiers to bring Shimei to Solomon. For more information about king, refer to the Master Glossary, and use the same word you have used in previous passages.

King Solomon says that if Shimei disobeys Solomon, Shimei's **blood**, or **guilt**, will be on his own head. Remember that this means that Shimei is responsible, or guilty, for his own wrong actions. If you use the word blood in your translation, use the same word or phrase for blood as you have used in previous passages, and remember that blood is in the Master Glossary. If you use the word guilt in your translation, use the same word or phrase for guilt as you have used in previous passages, and remember that guilt is in the Master Glossary.

When Shimei agrees to obey King Solomon, Shimei says that he is King Solomon's **servant**. This does not mean that Shimei becomes a servant in King Solomon's household. Shimei calls himself Solomon's servant to show

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humility and respect to King Solomon. To call himself a servant also shows that Shimei understands that now he is not free to come and go from Jerusalem as he pleases. Use the same word or phrase for servant as you used in previous passages. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Shimei calls King Solomon "my **lord** the king." Here, Shimei means that King Solomon is Shimei's master and has authority over him. Use the same word or phrase for "my lord the king" as you used in previous passages. For more information on lord, refer to the Master Glossary.

When Shimei leaves Jerusalem to search for the runaway servants, or slaves, in Gath, Shimei saddles his **donkey**. This means that Shimei got on his donkey and rode the donkey to Gath. For more information on donkey, refer to the Master Glossary, and use the same word for donkey that you have used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a saddled donkey as a group. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller uses the same word for Shimei's slaves as he uses for a servant in other places. This kind of servant has no control over their own life. They cannot leave their master, and they usually have no choice over anything in their lives.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **servant** when it means a **slave** who has no choice over who he works for or what he does. Use the same word for servant when it means this kind of slave as you have used in other passages in the Bible. Pause this audio here.

When Solomon speaks to Shimei the second time, Solomon asks, "Did I not make you **swear by** Yahweh…"? "Swear by" means that Shimei made an **oath** to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for **swear by** or **oath** as you used in previous passages. For more information on oath, refer to the Master Glossary.

Solomon says that **Yahweh** will **repay** Shimei for the wrong things he did against King David. Yahweh will punish Shimei for the **evil** things he did. Use the same word for repay as you used in previous passages. For more information about Yahweh and evil, refer to the Master Glossary, and use the same words as you have used in previous passages.

When Solomon says "King Solomon will be blessed," Solomon says his own name. Solomon means that Yahweh will **bless** him. Use the same word for bless that you have used in previous passages. For more information on bless, refer to the Master Glossary.

Solomon also says that David's **throne** will remain secure before Yahweh forever. Next, we learn that Solomon's **kingdom** is strongly in his hands, or in his power. The phrases "the throne will remain secure" and "the kingdom is established" mean the same thing. Both phrases mean that the kingdom that David, Solomon, and their descendants rule is strong and will continue. Use the same words for throne and kingdom as you used in previous passages. For more information on kingdom, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (882 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Kings 3:1–15

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 3:1–15 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:1–15 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, King Solomon made his kingdom safe by dealing with his enemies. In this story, King Solomon married the daughter of Pharaoh, the king of Egypt. Because of this, the kingdom of Israel and the kingdom of Egypt became allies. Kingdoms that were allies would not go to war with one another and would defend each other if another enemy attacked. To make a marriage between one king and the daughter of another king or his close relative was a common way people made this kind of alliance. It is likely that it was the king of Egypt who suggested this alliance because he saw that the kingdom of Israel was becoming stronger.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a different community that your community would ask or has asked to help you in times of war. Why did this community help you? Describe your community's relationship with that community and explain the reason you are united. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon gave the daughter of the Pharaoh a temporary place to stay in Jerusalem, the City of David, until Solomon finished building his own palace. We know from stories in 1 Chronicles that during this time, King Solomon also built the temple of Yahweh and the wall around Jerusalem. Any place that the ark of the covenant had touched became holy. Therefore, King Solomon would not put Pharaoh's daughter in his father David's palace because the ark of the covenant of Yahweh was nearby.

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This marriage shows that King Solomon had been able to establish his kingdom internationally. However, the people of Israel were still sacrificing at the high places. High places were local shrines or altars that people had dedicated to Yahweh. There were many of these high places in different places throughout Israel. Yahweh had commanded that the people of Israel make their offerings to Yahweh in the place where Yahweh had chosen, Jerusalem. But Solomon had not yet built the temple for the people to honor and worship Yahweh. It is likely that the storyteller wants us to see that there is still work to be done to make Solomon's kingdom perfect.

Solomon loved Yahweh by doing everything that Solomon's father, David, had commanded him. King David had commanded Solomon to obey everything that Yahweh had commanded in the law of Moses. However, Solomon still sacrificed and burned incense at the local altars. It is likely that the storyteller is showing that Solomon had not completely obeyed Yahweh yet because Solomon had not yet built the temple. The storyteller could also be explaining to us that Solomon had not completely obeyed Yahweh because Solomon was committed to the high places. Yahweh allowed people to sacrifice to Yahweh at the high places only until people built the temple. One day, King Solomon went to sacrifice at the altar that was in Gibeon. Gibeon was a great city located about ten kilometers to the northwest of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem to Gibeon as a group. Pause this audio here.

The altar at Gibeon was the primary altar of all the local altars in Israel because the bronze altar of sacrifice and the Tent of Meeting that Moses had made were in Gibeon. But the ark of the covenant was in another tent near King David's palace in Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar and the Tent of Meeting as a group. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon had gone to sacrifice in Gibeon many times and had offered many burnt offerings there. To make a burnt offering, the people of Israel killed the animal and burnt it completely on the altar. A person offered a burnt offering to dedicate himself to Yahweh as completely as he had burnt the animal. It is likely that King Solomon had gone to Gibeon to dedicate his kingdom to Yahweh.

While Solomon was in Gibeon, Yahweh appeared to Solomon at night in a dream and told Solomon to ask for anything that Solomon wanted Yahweh to give him. It was rare that Yahweh would appear or speak to someone in a dream.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell stories of people in the history of your culture who received a message from God or spirits through a dream. Pause this audio here.

Solomon responded to Yahweh while still in his dream. Solomon said that Yahweh had been kind to Yahweh's servant, David, and that David had behaved in a good, loyal, and honest way with Yahweh. Solomon said that Yahweh had shown David constant love and friendship by making one of David's sons king of Israel. Yahweh, Solomon's God, had made Solomon king of Israel even though Solomon was a little child. Solomon was not a little child when he became king, but Solomon was young and inexperienced. Solomon said that he did not know how to go out or come in or how to rule the many people of Israel, the people whom Yahweh had chosen to be Yahweh's own people. Solomon, therefore, asked Yahweh to give him an understanding heart that is able to know the difference between good and evil. The Israelites thought of the heart as the place where a person's feelings, thoughts, and intentions come from. Solomon was asking Yahweh for intelligence to rule. Solomon said that without Yahweh's help, no one would be able to rule Yahweh's many people.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about the youngest leader your community has ever had. List the qualities that a leader needs in order to be able to rule successfully. What qualities of leadership did the youngest leader of your community have no experience in? Pause this audio here.

The words of Solomon were pleasing in the sight of Yahweh. The storyteller calls Yahweh by a respectful title that means master or lord. Yahweh told Solomon that Yahweh would give Solomon wisdom. Solomon had not asked for a long life, wealth, or revenge on his enemies. Instead, Solomon had asked for wisdom to rule justly. Yahweh said that Yahweh would give Solomon greater wisdom than any king who had come before Solomon or any king who would come after Solomon. Yahweh also said that Yahweh gave Solomon the things that Solomon had not asked for: wealth and honor, so that no other king could compare with Solomon as long as Solomon lived. Yahweh also promised Solomon that if Solomon walked in Yahweh's ways or obeyed Yahweh's laws and commands as David had done, Yahweh would give Solomon a long life.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about your greatest leader and the things that the leader owned. What would people in your community most want from all the things that the leader owned? Pause this audio here.

Solomon woke up and realized that Yahweh had spoken to Solomon in a dream. Solomon returned to Jerusalem and stood before the ark of the covenant of the Lord. The storyteller does not tell us why Solomon stood before the ark of the covenant, but it is likely to confirm and celebrate the agreement that Yahweh had made with Solomon in the dream. Solomon offered burnt offerings and peace or fellowship offerings. Solomon was likely dedicating himself to Yahweh with the burnt offerings and celebrating his relationship with Yahweh with the peace offerings. When people ate a meal together in that culture, they were showing the good relationships they had with each other. In a peace offering, people burned part of an animal on the altar, and they ate the rest of the meat. This was like having a meal with Yahweh, and it showed that the people were in a good relationship with Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How have the leaders of your community communicated with God or the spirits? How would the leaders physically respond to a message that God told them in a dream? Pause this audio here.

Then Solomon made a feast for all his servants. It is likely that this feast was somewhere else, not next to the ark of the covenant.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has seven scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon made an alliance with Pharaoh, King of Egypt, by marrying

Pharaoh's daughter. King Solomon brought Pharaoh's daughter to live in the City of David until Solomon had finished building a palace for himself, Yahweh's temple, and the wall around Jerusalem.

In the second scene: The people were still making offerings at the high places, or local altars, because they had not yet built the temple to honor and worship Yahweh.

In the third scene: King Solomon loved Yahweh and obeyed all the commands that Solomon's father gave him, but Solomon still made offerings at the local altars. Solomon offered many burnt offerings at Gibeon, the most important local altar. One day, Yahweh appeared to King Solomon at Gibeon in a dream. Yahweh asked Solomon what gift Solomon would like from Yahweh.

In the fourth scene: Solomon said that Yahweh had shown Solomon's father, David, constant friendship by making Solomon king. Solomon told Yahweh how young and inexperienced Solomon was to rule Yahweh's great people. So Solomon asked Yahweh for wisdom to rule justly.

In the fifth scene: Yahweh was pleased that Solomon had asked for wisdom and not long life, riches, or the death of his enemies. So, Yahweh gave Solomon wisdom and also riches and a great reputation. Yahweh also promised to give Solomon a long life if Solomon obeyed Yahweh as David had.

In the sixth scene: Solomon went back to Jerusalem and offered burnt offerings and peace or fellowship offerings in front of the ark of the covenant of Yahweh.

In the seventh scene: Solomon made a feast for all his servants.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King Solomon
- Pharaoh, king of Egypt

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- Pharaoh's daughter
- The people of Israel
- King David
- And King Solomon's servants

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, King Solomon married the king of Egypt's daughter. People call the king of Egypt, "Pharaoh." Pharaoh is not the king of Egypt's personal name, but his title.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What titles do you give various leaders in your community? Pause audio here.

By marrying Pharaoh's daughter, King Solomon became the son-in-law of Pharaoh, and the kingdoms of Israel and Egypt became allies. Allies are kingdoms that do not attack each other. Instead, allies help each other if others attack them.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about two communities that have an alliance or an agreement of friendship. Discuss how the two communities confirmed their alliance. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use for alliance. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon gave Pharaoh's daughter a temporary place to live in Jerusalem. The people also called Jerusalem the City of David because David captured it from the Jebusites. Pharaoh's daughter lived in that temporary place until Solomon finished building his own house or palace, the house or temple of Yahweh, and the wall around Jerusalem. It took Solomon 13 years to build his palace.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call the house of a king in your language? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller calls the temple "the house of Yahweh" because Yahweh's presence would be in the temple when the people put the ark there. Solomon started building the temple four years after he became king, and Solomon spent seven years building the temple. Jerusalem was a walled city. People built walls around important cities to protect the people and the wealth inside the city. It is likely that Solomon was extending or repairing a wall that already existed.

Stop here and look at a picture of an example of a walled city as a group. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the people of Israel were still sacrificing at the high places or local altars. The people had been doing this from the days when they entered the land with Joshua. Even at this time, the people were still sacrificing at the local altars because they had not yet built the house for Yahweh's name. When someone builds something for the name of Yahweh, it means that they are building it to honor and praise Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about temples, shrines, altars, or any places of worship in your country. By what names do people call them and why? How will you say that Solomon had not yet built the house for Yahweh's name? Pause this audio here.

High places were local altars or places of sacrifice. The tribes of the Canaanites that lived in the land before the people of Israel often built their altars on high places like hills and mountains, so people often knew these local altars as "high places." Many of the altars that the people of Israel built were not on hills or mountains, and the people of Israel dedicated these places to Yahweh. Therefore "high places" in this story refers to local sacred places that the people dedicated to Yahweh. Yahweh wanted the people to make their offerings in Jerusalem, but Solomon had not built the temple yet. Therefore, the people of Israel built many altars near their cities. After Solomon finished building the temple, Yahweh did not want his people to sacrifice at these altars.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about the sacrifice rituals that your community and the communities around you perform. Compare the different places they perform their rituals. Pay attention to the words and phrases that you use for the places where people offer the sacrifices. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller tells us that Solomon loved Yahweh. Solomon showed that he loved Yahweh by following his father's statutes. David had commanded Solomon to obey all that Yahweh had commanded in the law of Moses. But even though Solomon loved Yahweh, Solomon still sacrificed at local altars. Solomon sacrificed

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at more than one local altar. The storyteller says that Solomon made sacrifices and made the smoke go up. To make the smoke go up could refer to burning an animal or vegetable offerings or burning incense. It is likely that Solomon made sacrifices and offered incense offerings. The contrast between Solomon loving Yahweh and sacrificing at the local altars shows that Solomon had not yet finished the work that Yahweh had given him. Solomon had not yet built the temple.

Solomon often went to sacrifice at the altar in Gibeon, a great city about 10 kilometers from Jerusalem. Over the years, Solomon had sacrificed at least 1,000 burnt offerings on the altar at Gibeon! The altar at Gibeon was the most important local altar because the bronze altar of sacrifice and the Tent of Meeting that Moses made were there. This time, Solomon had gone to Gibeon to offer burnt offerings, most likely to dedicate his kingdom to Yahweh. While Solomon was at Gibeon, Yahweh appeared to Solomon at night in a dream and God told Solomon to ask for anything he wanted. The storyteller uses the proper name for Yahweh and the more general word for God in the same statement.

In the fourth scene, Solomon, who was still dreaming, answered Yahweh. Solomon told Yahweh that Yahweh had shown steadfast, or loyal, love to Solomon's father, David. Solomon called David Yahweh's servant because David served and respected Yahweh. Solomon said that Yahweh showed steadfast love to David because David walked before Yahweh in faithfulness, in righteousness, and in uprightness of heart. Solomon was talking about David's behaviour and character toward Yahweh when he talked about how David walked before Yahweh. To walk in faithfulness is to be loyal, dependable, and trustworthy. When a person walks in righteousness with Yahweh, the person behaves in a right way because they have a good relationship with Yahweh. A person who walks in uprightness of heart is a person who is committed to do Yahweh's will. That person behaves honestly and desires to please Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about someone who has pretended to be something with his words, but his behaviour has been the opposite of his words; for example, a judge who takes bribes. Then discuss, which words or phrases do you use to describe the behaviour of an honest judge who does not take bribes? Pause this audio here.

Solomon said that Yahweh had continued to show steadfast love to David by giving David a son, Solomon, to sit on David's throne, which means to be king of Israel. Solomon spoke these words to Yahweh before he asked for what he wanted. Solomon wanted to thank and praise Yahweh.

Then Solomon told Yahweh that Yahweh, Solomon's own God, had made Solomon king even though Solomon was a little child. Solomon showed that he was committed to Yahweh and had a personal relationship with Yahweh when he called Yahweh his own God. Solomon said that he was a little child, or inexperienced, and did not know how to go out or come in. Going out and coming in is usually a special way to talk about the way a person leads an army to war. In this case, Solomon was saying that he was young and did not know how to rule or how to take his army to war. Solomon said that Solomon, the servant of Yahweh, was in the middle of the many or countless people that Yahweh had chosen. Solomon described the many people as a great and numberless people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How can you describe or speak of a group of people so many that no one could count them? Pause audio here.

Solomon was telling Yahweh how small Solomon felt for the great work that Yahweh had given Solomon. Solomon asked Yahweh to give him an understanding heart to rule Yahweh's people and to know the difference between good and evil. Solomon was asking Yahweh to give Solomon wisdom and intelligence to rule justly. Then Solomon asked Yahweh if there was anyone who would be able to rule Yahweh's many people. Solomon did not expect an answer. Solomon was saying that without Yahweh's help, no one could rule Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe the most honest, fair, and honorable leader or judge you have ever had. Talk about that person's behaviour and decisions, and how he treated different classes of people and how the community spoke about him. Pay attention to the words and phrases that you use to describe his character. Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, the storyteller calls Yahweh the lord, or master. This is a respectful title. Yahweh was pleased because Solomon asked for wisdom and did not ask for a long life, riches, or the death of his enemies. The storyteller repeats slowly and clearly each thing Solomon did not ask for so that he can show a strong contrast

between what Solomon did ask for and what he did not ask for. Yahweh told Solomon to look and see how Yahweh would do what Solomon had asked for, and to watch how Yahweh would give Solomon greater wisdom than anyone who had lived before Solomon or would live after Solomon.

Stop here and discuss a word or phrase that you use in your language to focus the attention of the listener on the thing you are about to say next, as Yahweh did here when he asked Solomon to see what he would do for Solomon. Pause this audio here.

And Yahweh also gave Solomon the things that Solomon had not asked for, like wealth, honor, and respect. Yahweh said that no king would have riches or respect to compare with Solomon as long as Solomon lived. Yahweh also promised Solomon a long life, but only if Solomon walked in Yahweh's ways or obeyed Yahweh's statutes and commands as David did.

In the sixth scene, Solomon woke up and realized that he had been dreaming.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have a person tell about a great dream that they had. After the person has told the dream, they should finish by saying how they woke up and realised that it was a dream. Pay attention to the words that the person uses to focus your attention on the fact that it was a dream. Pause this audio here.

Solomon returned to Jerusalem and came and stood before the ark of the covenant. The ark of the covenant was in a tent near David's palace. Solomon made burnt offerings and peace or fellowship offerings. People completely burnt the burnt offering on the altar, but they only burnt some of the peace offering and ate the rest.

In the seventh scene, Solomon made a feast for all his servants. It is likely that this was in a different place and a short time later.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has seven scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King Solomon
- Pharaoh, king of Egypt
- Pharaoh's daughter
- The people of Israel
- King David
- And King Solomon's servants

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

1 Kings 3:1–15

King Solomon made an alliance with Pharaoh, the king of Egypt, when he married Pharaoh's daughter. King Solomon brought Pharaoh's daughter to live in the City of David until he had finished building a palace for himself, Yahweh's temple, and the wall around Jerusalem.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Pharaoh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy; or
- I feel safe and protected by my strong ally; or
- Egypt rejoices.

Ask the person playing Pharaoh's daughter, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel so happy to be married to a strong king; or
- I feel loved and cherished; or
- I feel special and honoured.

Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel respected; or
- I feel excited. I have many great projects; or
- I am pleased with my relationship with Pharaoh.

Continue the drama.

In the second scene, the people were sacrificing at the local altars because Solomon had not yet built the temple to honor and worship Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We feel sad because we are spread across the country and worship at different places; or
- We feel worried that we might worship in the wrong way; or
- We feel hopeful that the temple will be built soon.

Continue the drama.

In the third scene, King Solomon loved Yahweh and obeyed all the commands that his father gave him, but Solomon still made offerings at the local altars. Solomon offered many burnt offerings at Gibeon, the leading local altar. One day, Yahweh appeared to King Solomon at Gibeon in a dream. Yahweh asked Solomon what gift Solomon would like from Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I love Solomon; or
- I am pleased with Solomon; or
- Solomon respects me and is careful to walk before me as his father did. I want to bless Solomon.

Continue the drama.

In the fourth scene, Solomon said that Yahweh had shown his father, David, constant friendship when Yahweh made Solomon king. Solomon told Yahweh how young and inexperienced Solomon was to rule Yahweh's people. Solomon asked for wisdom.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel terrified. Yahweh is awesome. How can I see Yahweh and live? or
- I feel blessed and loved by Yahweh. I want Yahweh to give me the steadfast love that he gave my father; or

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- I am scared that I will rule unjustly. I am weak and small, and there are so many people! I am terrified that I might make Yahweh angry if I do not lead Yahweh's people well. I need Yahweh's help. I am desperate.

Continue the drama.

In the fifth scene, Yahweh was pleased that Solomon had asked for wisdom and not long life, riches, or the deaths of his enemies. So Yahweh gave Solomon wisdom and also riches and a great reputation. Yahweh also promised to give Solomon a long life if Solomon obeyed Yahweh as David had.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very happy; or
- I love Solomon's heart. Solomon cares for the things that I care for; or
- I feel generous. I will bless Solomon and give him more than he has asked for.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed by Yahweh's love; or
- I feel overwhelmed by Yahweh's generosity; or
- I feel strengthened and ready to rule.

Continue the drama.

In the sixth scene, Solomon woke up and realized that it was a dream. Solomon went back to Jerusalem and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings in front of the ark of the covenant of Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Wow! What an amazing dream. Yahweh spoke to me as he spoke to our father Jacob in a dream; or
- I just want to be in the presence of Yahweh. I will stand before Yahweh in Jerusalem; or
- I am dedicated to Yahweh. I feel blessed and honored greatly.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honoured; or
- I feel respected; or
- I am pleased by the sweet smell of Solomon's sacrifice.

Continue the drama.

In the seventh scene, Solomon made a feast for all his servants.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are rejoicing; or
- We feel joy; or
- Our king has made a great feast, and we are celebrating in Jerusalem.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Solomon made a marriage alliance with Pharaoh, the king of Egypt. Pharaoh was a title for the king of the country of Egypt.

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Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Pharaoh**. Look up Pharaoh in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Use the same word or phrase for **king** as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Solomon brought Pharaoh's daughter to live in the **City of David** until he finished building his own house or palace and the house of Yahweh. Use the same phrase for "City of David" as you have used in previous passages. The house of Yahweh is a way to talk about the place on earth where Yahweh lived among his people. Here, "house of Yahweh" refers to the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **house of Yahweh**. Look up "house of God" and "temple" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A **palace** is the place or house where the king lives. Discuss this question as a group: What would you call the house of a king in your language? Pause audio here.

Use the same word or phrase for **Yahweh** as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

The people were **sacrificing** or making offerings at the high places because the temple to honor Yahweh had not yet been built. Use the same word or phrase for sacrifice as you used in previous passages. For more information on sacrifice, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **high places**. Remember that people often built a high place on a hill or mountain, but a high place is any place where people sacrifice to their gods locally. If you have already translated "high place" in another book of the Bible, use the same word here. Pause this audio here.

Solomon loved Yahweh and was walking in the **statutes** of David, Solomon's father, except that Solomon sacrificed and made sacrifices to smoke at high places. Making sacrifices "smoke" likely refers to burning incense, but it is not clear. Statutes usually refer to a law or rule about how to perform duties in the tabernacle or temple. In this case, statutes refer to the instructions or commands that David gave to Solomon. Use the same word or phrase for statutes as you used in previous passages. For more information on statutes, refer to the Master Glossary.

Solomon used to offer 1,000 burnt offerings at the altar at Gibeon. A burnt offering is a form of sacrifice that people bring to God. When a person brings God a burnt offering, the person kills an animal and burns this animal completely on an altar. An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to God. An altar is like a table or a platform that people make of earth or large stones. People placed gifts for God on this table. Often, this meant that people then burned the gift. The gift could be an animal, food items, or sweet-smelling spices.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **burnt offerings**. Look up burnt offerings in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Use the same word or phrase for **altar** as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream at night, and **God** asked Solomon to ask for anything that Solomon wanted. Dreams happen when you are sleeping. In a dream, you experience some events that are not really happening, or you see things that are not really there. Yahweh can use dreams to communicate with people. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **dream**. Look up dream in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

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Solomon said that Yahweh had shown his **servant** David **steadfast love** because David walked before Yahweh in faithfulness, righteousness, and uprightness of heart. A servant usually refers to someone who works for someone else, but in this case, it means that David is under the authority of Yahweh and is a worshipper of Yahweh. Steadfast love refers to loyal love from Yahweh. Sometimes people translate steadfast love as kindness. Steadfast love is the kindness or help that a leader or very important person gives to someone under their authority. Use the same word or phrase for servant and steadfast love as you used in previous passages. For more information on servant and steadfast love, refer to the Master Glossary.

Walking in faithfulness is to be loyal and dependable. Walking in faithfulness is similar in meaning to steadfast love, but the focus is clearly on being someone that people can trust to do the right thing. A person who walks in righteousness behaves in the right way. The person who wants to obey Yahweh and wants to do things that please Yahweh is righteous, even though they may still make mistakes and unintentionally disobey Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **faithfulness** and **righteousness**. Look up righteousness in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

“Uprightness of heart” is a special way to talk about having a good and honest heart. It means trying to do what is right and being fair and truthful.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe “**uprightness of heart**.” If you use the word for heart in your translation, use the same word for heart that you have used previously, and refer to heart in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

Solomon said that Yahweh had been faithful to his father, David, by appointing Solomon to **sit on the throne** that David had sat on. To sit on a throne is a special way to talk about someone ruling over a kingdom. Translate the idea of sitting on a throne in the same way that you previously translated it.

Solomon asked Yahweh for wisdom to judge Yahweh’s people. When someone judges, they look at people’s actions and decide if what the person does is right or wrong, and therefore if the person is guilty or innocent of breaking a law. A judge will punish the person if the judge decides that the person is guilty of doing wrong. In this case, Solomon talks about judging Yahweh’s people as the thing that a ruler does to rule or govern people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **judge**. Look up judge in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh was pleased because Solomon had asked for **wisdom** to know justice. Justice is when someone treats someone else fairly according to the law. When justice happens in an entire society, then everybody treats each other equally and fairly. In a just society, people in authority punish those who do wrong and protect people who are poor and weak. Use the same word for wisdom that you have used previously, and remember that wisdom is in the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **justice**. Look up justice in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh summarizes what Solomon asks for, and Yahweh says that he will give Solomon a wise and understanding heart.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that Yahweh will give Solomon a **wise and understanding heart**. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also promised to give Solomon a long life if Solomon walked in the ways of Yahweh and kept Yahweh’s statutes and **commandments.** Use the same word or phrase for commandments as you used in previous passages. For more information on commandments, refer to the Master Glossary.

Solomon returned to Jerusalem and stood before the ark of the covenant of Yahweh. The ark refers to the rectangular chest of acacia wood that Yahweh asked Moses to make. People sometimes call this chest the ark of the covenant because the laws that Yahweh gave Moses are a strong promise, or covenant, between Yahweh and his people. This law testifies, or shows, that the Israelites are Yahweh’s special people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**ark of the covenant**." In a previous story in 1 Kings, you have used the term "ark of Adonai Yahweh," but the storyteller calls the ark the "ark of the covenant" here. Look up "ark of the covenant" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon offered burnt offerings and peace or fellowship offerings and made a feast for all his servants. People offered peace or fellowship offerings to establish and maintain good relations with Yahweh. The people offered some of the meat of the animal to Yahweh and ate the rest of it.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **peace or fellowship offerings**. Look up "peace or fellowship offerings" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 3:1–15

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (895 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (11.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (9.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Kings 3:16–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 3:16–28 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:16–28 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:16–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream and gave Solomon more wisdom than anyone who had ever lived before Solomon or would live after him. In this story, Solomon uses his wisdom to justly judge a difficult case.

One day, two prostitutes, or women who slept with men for money, came and stood before King Solomon. People of Israel could come to the king and stand before him so that he could judge their cases and decide who was right and who was wrong. The king of Israel was the highest judge in the land. When there was a difficult case that no other judge could solve, the people brought that case to the king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss the most difficult case that there has ever been in your community. Who gave the final decision in that case? Pause this audio here.

The first woman spoke and said to King Solomon that she and the second woman lived in the same house. The first woman said that she had given birth to a child while she lived with the other woman in the same house. And it happened that on the third day after the first woman had given birth, the second woman also gave birth to a child. The two women were alone in the house and there was no visitor with them. It is likely that she meant that there were no male customers there, but the main point is that the women were alone with their children.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how long does a woman stay indoors after she gives birth? How long is it before anyone can visit the woman? Who comes to visit first: male friends, female friends, or both together? Pause this audio here.

Both women gave birth to a son. The first woman told the king that the son of the second woman had died because his mother rolled onto him at night. The second woman then took the boy who was still alive from the first woman whilst the first woman slept, and put her dead son next to the first woman. The second woman took the first woman's boy who was alive and put him on her own breast.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do newborn babies sleep at night in your culture? What kind of things do these babies' mothers do to protect their babies at night? Pause this audio here.

The first woman said that when she woke up in the morning to give her baby milk, she was shocked to find her baby dead. But when the morning light became brighter and she looked at the dead boy more closely, she was shocked to see that it was not the son that she had given birth to.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell stories of people who have stolen small babies or people who have had their small babies stolen from them. Also, discuss how a mother can tell that a newborn baby is not hers? Pause audio here.

While the first woman was telling the king these things, the second woman interrupted and challenged the first woman's story. The second woman said that it was not true and that the living child was her child and the dead child was the first woman's child. But the first woman insisted that the living child was hers and the dead child belonged to the second woman. The two women argued like this in front of the king.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell stories of people who have argued and shouted at one another in front of others. Talk about how those people accused and blamed one another. Describe the scene, the emotions, the

kind of language and volume they used, and how they spoke to each other. How did the people who watched respond? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon said that both women claimed to be the mother of the living child and said that the other woman was the mother of the dead child. Then the king asked his servants to bring him a sword, and they brought him a sword.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sword as a group. Pause this audio here.

Then the king told his servants to cut the living child into two parts and to give a part to each of the two women.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about the strangest decision a judge has ever made in your community. Describe how the people who listened to the case reacted when they heard the decision. If you know of any cases where the decision was cruel or extremely harsh, focus on those stories. Pause this audio here.

The true mother of the living child felt very strong mercy for her child because she loved him. So she begged the king strongly not to have the servants kill the boy. The true mother told the king to tell his servants to give the living boy to the other woman. The true mother preferred to lose the child than to see the servants kill him. But the other woman shouted that people should cut the living child in two so that neither of the two women would have him.

Stop here and talk about a time when you felt such strong compassion or mercy for someone that you had to say something to others about the person. Pause this audio here.

Then the king responded and told his servants not to kill the boy. The king said that the first woman, the woman who stopped the king from killing the child, was the true mother of the child. The king told his servants to give that woman the living child.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about the person that the people of your community consider to be the wisest person. Tell stories of some of the things that this person did and how what he did shows his wisdom. Pause this audio here.

All the people of Israel heard about the just decision that the king had made in this case. Because of this, all the people of Israel stood in awe, or greatly respected, the king. And the people recognised that Yahweh had given King Solomon the wisdom of God to judge rightly.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about a leader who people in your community believed was close to divine beings because of things that he was able to do. How did the people treat this leader?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:16–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has six scenes.

In the first scene: Two prostitutes came and stood before King Solomon because they wanted him to settle a case for them.

In the second scene: The first woman told the king how she and the second woman had given birth to sons in the same house, three days apart. The first woman said that the second woman had killed her baby by sleeping on him. The second woman had then exchanged her dead baby in the middle of the night with the first woman's living son. The first woman said that she had been shocked to find her baby dead when she woke up to feed him, but when she looked at him closely in the morning, she realised that it was not her baby.

In the third scene: The second woman interrupted and said the living child was hers, and the dead child belonged to the first woman. The first woman said that the living baby was hers and the dead baby was the second woman's. The two women argued like this before the king.

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In the fourth scene: King Solomon told his servants to bring a sword because both women claimed the living child. When people arrived with the sword, King Solomon told his servants to cut the living baby in two and give each woman half.

In the fifth scene: The true mother, the first woman, of the child felt great love for her child. She begged King Solomon not to kill the baby but to give the baby to the other woman. But the second woman wanted people to kill the baby so that neither of the women would get him. King Solomon said that the first woman was the true mother and gave the baby to her.

In the sixth scene: All the people of Israel heard about the judgment that the king had passed in that case. The people of Israel greatly respected King Solomon, and they recognised that God had given Solomon wisdom to judge justly.

The characters in this passage are:

- God
- King Solomon
- The first woman
- The second woman
- The living child
- The dead child
- The servants of King Solomon
- And all the people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, two women who were prostitutes came to King Solomon and stood before him. We do not know how long after the previous story this story took place.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about how you connect events in a story without giving a definite time. For example, you may say "one day" or "sometime later." Decide together the best word or phrase to use at the beginning of this story. Pause this audio here.

You will notice that the storyteller does not name the king as King Solomon, although we know that Solomon is the king. You may use King Solomon's name in this story if it would make the story clearer. When people of Israel had disagreements, they went to a judge for a solution. If the case was too difficult, the people brought the disagreement to the king. The two prostitutes therefore stood before the king because they wanted the king to judge their case.

Stop here and discuss the question as a group: What do you call women who sleep with men for money? Make sure you choose a word that is not too offensive to say publicly. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller tells us the words that the women spoke directly.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Select a well-known story in which the characters in the story speak to one another. Have one member of your group tell the story to the rest of the group in two different ways. In the first way, he or she should tell the group the words that the characters in the story spoke directly. In the other, he or she should tell the words of the character in the story indirectly by speaking for the character themselves. Decide which of the two styles makes the story easier to understand in your language. Pause this audio here.

The first woman addressed the king with a common phrase that the people of Israel used to start a conversation with someone more important than they were. People would begin by humbly asking for permission to speak. To do this, people would say something like, "Please, my lord."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Which common phrases do you use in your community to ask permission to speak when you begin a conversation with very important people? Pause this audio here.

The first woman told King Solomon that she and the second woman lived in the same house and that she had given birth to a child while she lived there. On the third day after the first woman gave birth, the second woman also gave birth to a child. The people of Israel counted the day of a child's birth as its first day.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you count the days of the life of a newborn baby? For example, if a child is born in the afternoon, how old will you say the child is the following afternoon? Pause this audio here.

The first woman said that there was no stranger with them, which means that the two women were alone in the house. The woman was saying that no one had visited their house since the day that the babies were born.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have a person tell a story that includes a conversation between two unnamed women. Pay attention to the language the person uses to show which woman is talking in the story as they tell it. Pause this audio here.

The first woman then said that in the night, the second woman rolled onto her son and killed him. The storyteller does not tell us which night this happened, whether it was the night that the second woman's baby was born or sometime after that. It is also not clear whether the second woman rolled onto her son accidentally or on purpose, but it was most likely an accident. The first woman then said that after the second woman had killed her own baby, the second woman got up at midnight or in the middle of the night and exchanged their babies. The woman does not give an exact time of the night when this happened.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss the names you use in your language to describe different parts of the night. Pause audio here.

The first woman said that the second woman took the living boy from the first woman whilst the first woman slept and put her dead son next to the first woman. The second woman then put the living boy on her own breast.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call the part of the body where you hold close the people that you love, for example, where mothers hold their babies and keep them close? Pause this audio here.

The first woman referred to herself as the female servant of the king to show respect to the king. The first woman said that when she woke up in the morning, to nurse or feed her baby, she was shocked to find that her son was dead. But when the first woman looked at the baby closely, in the morning, she realized it was not the child that she had given birth to. The first woman uses language that shows that she was shocked and surprised both when she found a dead baby by her side and when she later realised that the dead child was not her own child. The first woman speaks of two mornings, probably because the first time she woke up, it was early morning and still dark, and the second time it was fully morning.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have someone tell a story about a time they stayed in a rural village where there is no electricity, and something scared or surprised them in the dark. The person should describe the time of the night or the morning when this thing happened. If you have words that divide the hours of the night and morning, the person should use them. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use when you talk about being surprised and scared. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the second woman interrupted the first woman and said that the living child was hers and the dead child belonged to the first woman. The women were shouting and talking at the same time. The women argued like this before the king. It is likely that the women did this for a while.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In step two, you discussed two people who argued and shouted at each other in front of other people. Which words and phrases did you use to describe the two people who were arguing? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, King Solomon repeated what both women were claiming. It is likely that King Solomon was frustrated with the women for arguing. Each woman claimed to be the mother of the living child and said the other woman was the mother of the dead child. So King Solomon asked his servants to bring him a sword. People had different kinds of swords at this time. It is not clear which specific type of sword the king asked for. The king's servant brought the king a sword, and the king told the servants to cut the living child in two and give each woman half.

In the fifth scene, the woman who was the true mother of the living boy begged the king not to kill the boy. At this point, the storyteller does not say which woman is which. The true mother called the king her lord or master and pleaded with him to tell his servants not to kill the boy but to give him to the other woman. The true mother used forceful language when she told the king that he must not kill the boy. The storyteller says that the woman

felt burning mercy or compassion for the baby. In other words, the woman felt very strong compassion, or love, and mercy for her son.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Remember your discussion from step two about a time when you felt strong love and mercy for someone. Pay attention to the words and phrases you used to describe this kind of feeling. How will you talk about this woman's strong compassion and mercy? Pause this audio here.

But the other woman was shouting that the servants should cut the living child in two so that neither woman would have the baby.

King Solomon responded and told his servants not to kill the boy. King Solomon also used the same kind of strong language that the true mother had used when she told him not to kill the child. King Solomon told his servants to give this woman the child because she was the real mother. King Solomon knew that she was the true mother because she showed great compassion for the child and wanted him to live. The storyteller uses a word that does not make it clear which woman the king gave the baby to, but it is likely the first woman.

In the sixth scene, all the people of Israel heard about the king's wise decision and how he had given a just judgment.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In step two, you talked about the wisest person in your community and the things that person did to show their wisdom. Now discuss how the people of your community reacted to the wise things that person did. Pause this audio here.

The people stood in awe of or respected King Solomon because they recognized that Solomon had the wisdom of God to judge rightly.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:16–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has six scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- God
- King Solomon
- The first woman
- The second woman
- The living child
- The dead child
- The servants of King Solomon
- And all the people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

1 Kings 3:16–28

Two prostitutes came and stood before King Solomon so that he could choose who was right and who was wrong in their case.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- My people need me; or
- I feel pressure to be a good and just king; or
- I love Yahweh, and I want my kingdom to be pleasing to Yahweh.

Continue the drama.

The first woman told the king how she and the other woman had given birth to sons in the same house, three days apart. The first woman said that the second woman had rolled over onto her baby so that he died, and then had exchanged him in the middle of the night with her living son. The first woman said that she had been shocked to find her baby dead when she woke up to feed him, but when she looked at him closely in the morning, she realised that it was not her baby.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the first woman, the mother of the living child, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel sorrow and great pain in my heart; or
- I feel hopeful that the king will see the truth. I want my son back; or
- I feel angry with this woman and sorry for her dead child.

Ask the person playing the second woman, the mother of the dead child, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel angry; or
- I hate this woman; or
- This is my child. I will not let him go!

Continue the drama.

The second woman interrupted and said the living child was hers and that the dead child belonged to the first woman. But the first woman said that the living baby was hers and the dead baby was the second woman’s. The two women argued like this before the king.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the servants of King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We feel confused by these women. Who is telling the truth? or
- We are curious to see what the king will decide; or
- We feel frustrated by the women shouting, and we do not understand their argument.

Continue the drama.

King Solomon told his servants to bring him a sword. When the servants brought the sword, King Solomon told his servants to cut the living baby in two and give each woman half of the baby.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel challenged by this difficult case; or
- I am committed to finding the truth and doing the right thing; or
- I am clever enough to find a solution.

Ask the person playing the first woman, the mother of the living child, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel horrified. I am scared for my child. My heart will break with sorrow for my son; or
- I feel even more sad and broken than before. I do not want my child to die; or
- I am ready to do anything to save my son.

Continue the drama.

The true mother of the child felt great pity and sadness for her child, and she begged King Solomon to give the baby to the other woman. But the other woman wanted the servants to kill the baby so that neither of the women would get the baby. King Solomon said that the first woman was the true mother and gave the baby to her.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the mother of the dead child, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy with the king’s decision. Kill the child. I do not care; or
- I feel envious that her son is alive, and mine is dead; or
- I am angry enough to kill the child myself.

Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy my plan has worked; or
- I feel compassion for the mother of the child; or
- I am angry with the woman who lies.

Ask the person playing the servants of the king, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Wow! I am amazed by the king’s wisdom; or
- I am so happy with the simple solution to a difficult case; or
- We are crying tears of joy with the mother of the child.

Continue the drama.

All the people of Israel heard about the judgment that the king had passed in that case. The people of Israel greatly respected King Solomon, and they recognised that God had given Solomon wisdom to judge justly.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel amazed; or
- I am impressed; or
- I am afraid to lie to the king or do anything evil. God has given the king great wisdom.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 3:16–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Two prostitutes came and stood before the king. A prostitute is a woman who sleeps with men for money.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **prostitutes**. It is important that you choose a word that you can use in a public setting. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Use the same word or phrase for **king** as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

The first woman asked to speak to her **lord**, the king. Use the same word or phrase for “lord” or “master” as you used in previous passages. For more information on lord, refer to the Master Glossary.

The woman called herself King Solomon’s female **servant**. If you have used a term for “female servant” in the past, use the same word or phrase for female servant here. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

When all **Israel** or the people of Israel heard the **judgment** that the king had given, they were in awe of or greatly respected the king. The people of Israel recognise that Solomon had **wisdom** from **God** to do justice.

Use the same word or phrase for Israel, judgment, wisdom, and God as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, judge, wisdom and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Justice is when someone treats someone else fairly according to the law. When justice happens in an entire society, then everybody treats each other equally and fairly. In a just society, people in authority, like King Solomon, punish those who do wrong and protect people who are poor and weak. Use the same word or phrase for justice as you used in previous passages. For more information on justice, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 3:16–28

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (890 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (10.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Kings 4:1–19

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 4:1–19 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:1–19 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.

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3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, King Solomon used the wisdom that Yahweh had given him to decide a difficult case. All the people of Israel were amazed and respected Solomon when they saw the wisdom that Yahweh had given him.

In this story, the storyteller tells us how King Solomon organised the leaders or officials who worked under Solomon.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about how your ancestors used to organise leaders and their helpers in your community. If you organise leadership in your community differently today, discuss the differences. Pause this audio here.

Later, in the days of the next king, King Solomon's son, the nation of Israel divided into two kingdoms, Judah and Israel. King Solomon ruled all Israel before it was divided into Judah and Israel.

The storyteller lists the leaders that King Solomon chose to work under him according to their roles. Azariah, the son of Zadok, was the priest. It is likely that Azariah was really the grandson of Zadok, who was also a priest. The people of Israel often refer to someone as the son of their grandfather if the grandfather was a well-known or important man. It is likely that Azariah was the high priest, the most important and senior priest in all of Israel.

Elihoreph and Ahijah, both sons of a man named Shisha, were the king's secretaries or scribes. Secretaries were educated men who worked closely with the king and wrote things down for the king. These men probably had other responsibilities and were very important men in Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Describe what kinds of people in your government write things down for the leader and assist the leader closely. Pause this audio here.

Jehoshaphat, son of Ahilud, was the recorder. A recorder was likely the person who kept records of what the king had done and the decisions that he had made. In the story of King Solomon, Jehoshapat is called a royal historian.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Who is responsible for keeping records of the history of your leaders? Pause this audio here.

Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, was the leader or commander of the army of Israel. Zadok and Abiathar were both priests. They were not the high priest. It is possible that the storyteller did not include Zadok and Abiathar in his list and that someone else later added them. In an earlier story, King Solomon had sent Abiathar away from Jerusalem because Abiathar had supported Adonijah. Yahweh had also promised to remove the family of Eli from being priests, and Abiathar was of the family of Eli.

In the days of King David, and before kings started to rule Israel, leaders had divided Israel according to the tribal territories. But Solomon divided Israel into 12 regions or districts and chose leaders for each district. It is likely that Solomon divided Israel in this new way so that Solomon could unite the people and give them one national identity rather than the 12 tribal identities they had before. The 12 districts would also be responsible for supplying food for King Solomon and his household. Azariah, the son of Nathan, was the one who supervised the leaders of each region.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: List the regions that your government leaders manage or organize. How do you divide these areas? Discuss the tribal identity of the regions and compare it to the national identity and unity of your country. Pause audio here.

Zabud the priest, Nathan's son, was the king's friend. The king trusted Zabud, and Zabud probably gave the king advice.

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Ahishar was in charge of King Solomon's property. It is likely that Ahishar was also in charge of the palace officials, the palace, and other properties that belonged to the king.

Adoniram, the son of Abda, managed the unpaid workmen or laborers. It was common for kings in those days to force people, usually from countries they had defeated, to build buildings and walls around cities and to do other construction projects without pay. King Solomon's forced labor may have included some people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about leaders who forced other people to work for them or for the community without pay. Why did the leader force these people to work without pay? Pause this audio here.

Solomon had 12 governors over the 12 districts that he had created. King Solomon likely chose 12 districts to match the number of months in a year. The 12 governors of the districts were responsible for providing the king and his household with food. Each governor had to provide food for one month of the year. These 12 districts were in the north of Israel, and they did not include the area where the tribe of Judah lived.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss how your community provides for the greatest chief, king, or leader and his family. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller lists the names of the governors of these districts.

Ben-Hur was the governor of the district around Mount Ephraim. Ben-Deker was the governor of the district that included the towns of Makaz, Shaalbim, Beth Shemesh, and Elon Bethhanan.

Ben-Hesed was the governor in charge of the towns of Arubboth and Socoh and all the land around Hepher.

Ben-Abinadab, who had married one of King Solomon's daughters, Taphath, was the governor of the district of Naphoth Dor.

Baana, son of Ahilud, was the governor in charge of the district that included the towns of Taanach and Megiddo and the whole region around the town of Beth Shan. This area was next to the town of Zarethan, which was below the town of Jezreel. Baana's territory stretched from Beth Shan to Abel Meholah and to the far side of the town of Jokmeam.

Ben-Geber was the governor of the district that included the city of Ramoth in the region of Gilead. The descendants of Jair, son of Manasseh, had settled in the villages there. Ben-Geber was in charge of their villages as well as the territory of Argob in Bashan. The region of Argob had 60 large cities. Each city had walls and gates with bronze bars. It was common for people to build walls around cities for protection. People locked the gates of the cities using bronze or metal bars.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a walled city and the gates of the city. Discuss this question as a group: How do you protect your cities or towns from invaders? Pause this audio here.

Ahinadab, the son of Iddo, was the governor of the district of Mahanaim. Mahanaim was a city east of the Jordan River in Gilead

Ahimaaz was the governor of the district that was in the land of Naphtali. Ahimaaz had married another of King Solomon's daughters, Basemath.

Baana, the son of Hushai, was the governor of the district that was in the land of Asher and the town of Aloth.

Jehoshaphat, the son of Paruah, was the governor in charge of the district that was in the land of Issachar.

Shimei, the son of Ela, was the governor in charge of the district that was in the territory of Benjamin.

Geber, son of Uri, was the governor in charge of the district of Gilead. This was where Sihon, king of the Amorites, and Og, king of the people of Bashan, had once ruled.

Stop here and discuss as a group how your country divides up areas that governors or area leaders lead. If you can, list the areas and the people who govern each area. Pause this audio here.

There was one governor who supervised all these 12 governors.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

1 Kings 4:1–19

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon was ruling over all of Israel.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists the names of the chief officials of King Solomon and what they did.

In the third scene: The storyteller lists the 12 governors that King Solomon had chosen to be in charge of supplying the palace with food, each for one month of the year.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Azariah, son of Zadok, the priest
- Elihoreph and Ahijah, sons of Shisha, the secretaries
- Jehoshaphat, son of Ahilud, the recorder
- Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, the commander of the army of Israel
- Zadok and Abiathar, priests
- Azariah, son of Nathan, leader of the district governors
- Zabud, son of Nathan, the king's friend or special adviser
- Ahishar, the palace administrator
- Adoniram, son of Abda, the leader of the forced labor
- The 12 district governors: Ben-Hur, Ben-Deker, Ben-Hesed, Ben-Abinadab, Baana son of Ahilud, Ben-Geber, Ahinadab son of Iddo, Ahimaaz, Baana son of Hushai, Jehoshaphat son of Paruah, Shimei son of Ela, Geber son of Uri
- Taphath, daughter of Solomon and wife of Ben-Abinadab
- Basemath, daughter of Solomon and wife of Ahimaaz
- Sihon, king of the Amorites
- And Og, king of Bashan

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller tells us that Solomon was ruling all Israel. The storyteller may be telling us this because soon after King Solomon died, people divided Israel into two kingdoms. But during this time, Solomon ruled over all of the 12 tribes of Israel. King Solomon chose and organized the leaders who worked for him.

Stop and talk with your group: Discuss when the people in your community got a new leader and the things that the leader changed in the organisation of your community. For example, the leader might have changed the people in important positions or the way he used or taxed the land. Pause the audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller lists the men who were King Solomon's most important officials. The people of Israel usually used one word for many kinds of leaders. People stated the job of the leader to make it specific which type of leader he was.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Discuss the leaders who work in your country's government. Try to rank their leadership positions based on how important each person is. Pause this audio here.

Azariah, son of Zadok, was the priest. The people of Israel sometimes call both sons and grandsons by the word "sons." It is likely that Azariah was actually Zadok's grandson. The storyteller says that Azariah was the priest in such a way that it is likely that this means that Azariah was the high priest, or the most important priest in Israel.

Elihoreph and Ahijah, the sons of Shisha, were the king's secretaries. We do not know exactly what the secretaries did, but they did more than the people we call secretaries today. A king dealt with many matters and made many judgments that he needed to remember. It is likely that Elihoreph and Ahijah were educated men who worked closely with the king and wrote things down. Elihoreph and Ahijah may even have served as representatives of the king. Jehoshaphat, son of Ahilud, was the recorder. It is also not clear exactly what a recorder did. In the

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story of David, the storyteller called Jehoshaphat a royal historian. A royal historian is a person who studies and writes about kings and queens and their children. It is also possible that a recorder was the king's spokesman who reported to the king and told the king's decisions to the people.

Stop and do this activity as a group: Have a person appear before a king. The person should tell the king the problems his community is facing. As this is happening, someone who plays the king's secretary should write down all the things that the person says. The king should call his recorder or royal historian and ask him how the kings who came before him dealt with similar issues. Pay close attention to the words and phrases that you use for secretary and royal historian. Pause the audio here.

Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, was the commander of the army of Israel.

Zadok and Abiathar were priests. The storyteller has already told us that Azariah, the son of Zadok, was the priest. It is possible that the storyteller may not have listed Zadok and Abiathar originally, and someone added their names later. You will remember that Solomon had sent Abiathar away from Jerusalem because Abiathar had supported Adonijah. Yahweh had also promised that he would remove Eli's family from being priests, and Abiathar was part of that family.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Discuss the ranks your community has for priests. What do you call the lower-ranked priest? Pause this audio here.

Azariah, son of Nathan, supervised the leaders of each region. Solomon divided Israel into districts and chose leaders for each one. Nathan made sure that each leader did their work correctly.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about someone who oversees a group of leaders to make sure the leaders do their work correctly. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use to describe that person's work. Pause this audio here.

Zabud, the son of Nathan, a priest of Yahweh, was the king's friend. "King's friend" was the title of the king's trusted and personal advisor.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about a leader of your country who had to deal with difficult things or who had great successes. Tell of the people who were his closest advisors. What phrase or word would you use to describe the position of such a close advisor? Pause this audio here.

Ahishar managed Solomon's property. Ahishar was probably in charge of the palace and the palace workers.

Adoniram, son of Abda, managed the forced labor, or the people whom Solomon made to work against their will and without pay. It is possible that Adoniram is the same man who was also in charge of King David's forced labor.

Stop here and remember your discussion from step two about a leader who forced other people to work for him without pay. What did you call that leader, and what did you call the people whom the leader forced to work? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller lists the men that King Solomon had chosen to be in charge of the 12 districts he had created. Each of these men had to provide food from their district to the king and his household for one month. The king's household includes his family, servants, palace officials, and his horses.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about someone whom a leader has chosen to be in charge of a region within that leader's control. Choose a word that communicates the idea of someone whom the leader chooses to stand in place of the leader. Pay attention to the words and phrases that you use to describe that person. Pause the audio here.

The storyteller lists the names of these men and the districts they were in charge of.

Ben-Hur, or the son of Hur, was in charge of the hilly country around Ephraim.

Ben-Deker, or the son of Deker, was in charge of the cities of Makaz, Shaalbim, Beth Shemesh, and Elon Bethhanan.

Ben-Hesed, or the son of Hesed, was in charge of the cities of Arubboth, Socoh, and the land around Hepher.

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Ben-Abinadab, or the son of Abinadab, was in charge of Naphoth Dor. Ben-Abinadab married Taphath, Solomon's daughter.

Baana, son of Ahilud, was in charge of the cities of Taanach, Megiddo, Beth Shan, Zarethan, Jezreel, Abel Meholah, and Jokmeam.

Ben-Geber, or the son of Geber, was in charge of the city of Ramoth in Gilead. The tent villages of Jair, son of Manasseh, were his, as well as the region of Argob in Bashan with its 60 walled cities with gates of bronze. These were well-protected cities.

Ahinadab, the son of Iddo, was in charge of the city of Mahanaim. Mahanaim was east of the Jordan River.

Ahimaaz was in charge of the land that belonged to the tribe of Naphtali. Ahimaaz had married another one of Solomon's daughters, called Basemath.

Baana, the son of Hushai, was in charge of the land that belonged to the tribe of Asher and the city of Aloth. This is the second man named Baana that the storyteller mentioned in the list, but the two men had different fathers.

Jehoshaphat, the son of Paruah, was in charge of the land that belonged to the tribe of Issachar.

Shimei, the son of Ela, was in charge of the territory that belonged to the tribe of Benjamin.

Geber, the son of Uri, was in charge of the region of Gilead. This is where Sihon, king of the Amorites, and Og, king of Bashan, used to rule.

One governor supervised all 12 men who were in charge of the districts. This person was likely Azariah, son of Nathan, who supervised the leaders of each region.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Remind each other of the list you made in step two of the areas that governors in your land lead. Pay attention to the way that you listed the names of the regional leaders and the areas that they lead. Practice telling the list from this passage in the most natural way that you can. Pause audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Azariah, son of Zadok, the priest
- Elihoreph and Ahijah, sons of Shisha, the secretaries
- Jehoshaphat, son of Ahilud, the recorder
- Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, the commander of the army of Israel
- Zadok and Abiathar, priests
- Azariah, son of Nathan, leader of the district governors
- Zabud, son of Nathan, the king's friend or special adviser
- Ahishar, the palace administrator
- Adoniram, son of Abda, the leader of the forced labor
- The 12 district governors: Ben-Hur, Ben-Deker, Ben-Hesed, Ben-Abinadab, Baana son of Ahilud, Ben-Geber, Ahinadab son of Iddo, Ahimaaz, Baana son of Hushai, Jehoshaphat son of Paruah, Shimei son of Ela, Geber son of Uri
- Taphath, daughter of Solomon and wife of Ben-Abinadab
- Basemath, daughter of Solomon and wife of Ahimaaz

1 Kings 4:1–19

- Sihon, king of the Amorites
- And Og, king of Bashan

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller tells us that Solomon ruled all Israel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy and excited to make some changes in the leadership of Israel; or
- I am strengthened by the changes I have made; or
- I feel strongly supported by the whole of Israel and the leaders I have chosen.

Continue the drama.

In the second scene, the storyteller lists the men who were King Solomon's high or chief officials.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Azariah, son of Zadok, the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy because Yahweh has chosen me as high priest of his people; or
- I am blessed to be high priest in a time when a godly king like Solomon is ruling; or
- I feel grateful for King Solomon's wise rule.

Ask the person playing Azariah son of Nathan, the leader of the district governors, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel a huge responsibility to make sure that we provide all of the king's food; or
- I am honoured that the king gave me such a high position; or
- I really want to do well.

Ask the person playing Adoniram, son of Abda, the leader of the forced labor, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is wonderful; or
- I am ready to do the work the king wants done; or
- I am excited about the many building projects the king has. I will make sure the forced labor works hard.

Ask the person playing Zabud, son of Nathan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very special and important; or
- I feel loved and honored by the king more than any other man; or
- It is a serious responsibility to advise the king wisely.

Continue the drama.

The storyteller lists the 12 governors that King Solomon had chosen to be in charge of supplying the palace with food, each for one month of the year.

1 Kings 4:1–19

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel a great responsibility to finish the work that Yahweh has given me; or
- I am excited to organise the nation in the best way possible. I have many changes to make; or
- I feel happy that my changes are working well.

Ask the person playing Azariah, son of Nathan, leader of the regional governors, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy and honoured that King Solomon chose me to govern the 12 district leaders; or
- I have a great responsibility to make sure that the governors provide for the king and his household; or
- I feel happy that people throughout the country respect me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King Solomon ruled over **Israel**. The storyteller lists King Solomon’s high officials. Use the same words or phrases for king and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on king and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

High officials refer to leaders. The people of Israel use the same word for many different kinds of leaders. These leaders helped King Solomon in his government and in leading the people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **high officials** in this story. You may use the same word you used earlier in 1 Kings 1:9 and 1 Kings 1:47 to talk about King David’s government and military officials. Pause this audio here.

Elihoreph and Ahijah were secretaries. Jehoshaphat, son of Ahilud, was the recorder. We do not know exactly what secretaries did, but the language suggests a job that included writing and speaking. It is possible that Elihoreph and Ahijah wrote things down for the king and maybe even represented the king as his messengers. We also do not know exactly what a recorder did, but the language suggests that the recorder helped the king remember what he and previous kings had decided about similar issues in the past. The storyteller called Jehoshaphat a royal historian in the story of David. Therefore, a recorder was the person who recorded the words and actions of the king.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for “**secretaries**” and “**recorder**.” Use words that maintain a difference between the two jobs. You may want to listen to your translation of 2 Samuel 8:16–17, if possible, and use the same words here that you used there. Pause this audio here.

Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, was over all the **army** and Zadok and Abiathar were **priests**. The army refers to the warriors or fighting men of Israel. Benaiah was their leader or **commander**. Priests were people who worked in the tabernacle of Yahweh. Yahweh had appointed priests to be between Yahweh and the people. Use the same words or phrases for army, commander, and priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Azariah, son of Nathan, was in charge of the regional or district officials, and Zabud, son of Nathan, a priest, was the king’s friend. “King’s friend” was the title of the king’s closest and trusted personal advisor. This person would have given the king advice about how to attack enemies, how to rule his country, and how to solve arguments among his people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for “**king’s friend**.” If you have already translated 2 Samuel 15:37, you may listen to how you translated the idea of “king’s friend” there and translate it in the same way here. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 4:1–19

Ahishar was in charge of the king's palace, or household, and Adoniram, son of Abda, was in charge of the forced labour. Forced labour refers to all the people whom the king made to work for him without payment. Usually, kings made their enemies, whom they had captured in war, work for them.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **forced labour**. Pause this audio here.

Ahishar took care of the people in the king's house, or palace. Ahishar also made sure that the king had everything he needed. In other words, Ahishar took care of the entire **household**, or the people who lived in the king's house. Look up household in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon had appointed 12 governors who provided food for the king and his household. Governors were the men who represented the king to their district, or region of the country, and represented their district to the king. Governors were in charge of their own district on behalf of the king. Governors would also be responsible to the king if things did not go well in their district.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for these **governors** and their **districts**, or regions. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Ben-Geber was the governor of Ramoth Gilead. The villages, or very small towns, of Jair son of Manasseh in Gilead were his, as well as the region of Argob in Bashan and its 60 large walled cities with **bronze** bars on the gate. Bronze is a strong metal that people made when they mixed copper and tin. Use the same word or phrase for bronze as you used in previous passages. For more information on bronze, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 4:1–19

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (855 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.5 MB)

- Filling the Gaps (3.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 4:20–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 4:20–28 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:20–28 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:20–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the storyteller told us about Solomon's officials and the districts that they managed for Solomon. In this story, the storyteller describes how good life was for the Israelites while Solomon was king.

At the beginning of this story, the storyteller tells us that the people of Judah and Israel were as numerous as the sand on the seashore. You will remember that the storyteller sometimes uses the phrase "Judah and Israel" to talk about all of the people of Israel. The phrase "as numerous as the sand on the seashore" means a very large number, so large that it is impossible to count. The storyteller might use this phrase to remind his hearers of the promise that God made to Abraham that Abraham would have so many descendants they would be impossible to count, like grains of sand at the seashore.

The storyteller tells us two times that Solomon ruled over the lands from the Euphrates River in the north, down to the border with the land of the Philistines and the border of Egypt in the south. The second time the storyteller tells us about the borders of Solomon's territory, he names two towns: Tiphsah, which was the city farthest north in Solomon's kingdom, and Gaza, which was at the border with the Philistines' land.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel during Solomon's time that shows Tiphsah and Gaza. Pause this audio here.

Solomon ruled over land that went beyond the borders of the 12 tribes of Israel. The leaders of other nearby countries brought Solomon tribute. Tribute is money or gifts that a weaker ruler gives to a stronger ruler. Sometimes, the weaker rulers give tribute to stop the stronger ruler from attacking them. Other times, the weaker rulers give tribute to get the stronger ruler to protect them. This is one way Solomon became rich. When the storyteller says that all the kingdoms in the area served Solomon, it means the other kings knew Solomon was more powerful than they were, and they followed Solomon's commands.

Many people worked for King Solomon. Some of these people came to Solomon's palace to eat meals that the king provided. In this story, the storyteller tells us how much food Solomon needed each day for Solomon to feed all of his officials. Solomon's cooks used fine flour and coarse-ground flour to make bread, and they also served a large amount of meat each day.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Describe a situation in your country where an employer provides food for his employees. Does the employer feed his employees every day? What kind of food does the employer provide? Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 4:20–28

While Solomon was alive, the people of Israel lived safely because Solomon kept peace with all the countries around them. The town of Dan was in the far north of Israel. The town of Beersheba was in the far south of Israel. “From Dan as far as Beersheba” is a way to say “From one end of the country to another” or “throughout the entire country.”

During this time, every family had its own grapevines and fig trees. The Israelites grew grapes to make wine, which was a common drink back then. A fig tree is a tree that grows tasty fruit called figs.

Stop here and look at a picture of a grapevine and a fig tree. Look also at a picture of a person who holds a fig. Pause this audio here.

In the Bible, grapevines and fig trees represent peace and prosperity. If the people had grapevines and fig trees, then the people had enough food and drink and did not have to worry.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your culture, what kind of food and drink do people need to have in order to feel like they have all that they need? Pause this audio here.

Even though Solomon got along well with his neighbors, Solomon also built a strong army. One way we know Solomon’s army was powerful is that Solomon had many horses, chariots, and horsemen.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In the area where you live, how do you determine how strong an army is? Does the army’s strength depend on the number of soldiers, or the number of guns, vehicles, bombs, or other weapons? Pause this audio here.

Solomon kept his horses in stalls. A stall is an enclosure inside a building that people specially build to keep horses in. Keeping horses inside protects the horses from wild animals and thieves. If a horse was especially valuable, its owner was more likely to keep it in a stall.

Stop here and look at a picture of a horse in a stall. Pause this audio here.

Solomon received food from the governors of the districts of Israel. The storyteller tells us that Solomon had plenty of food not only for the people who worked for him, but also for his horses. The governors of the districts brought barley for the horses to eat and straw to put in the horses’ stalls. Barley is a kind of grain, similar to wheat. People usually grind wheat to make flour, while barley is better to eat whole.

Stop here and look at a picture of a head of barley. Pause this audio here.

Straw comes from the stalks of both barley and wheat. People put straw into a horse’s stall to help keep the horse warm and give it a soft place to sleep. Each month, the district governor brought these supplies to the places where the army kept the horses so that the people could care for the horses well.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:20–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us how big, strong, and wealthy Solomon’s kingdom is.

In the second scene: The storyteller tells us about how much food Solomon and his officials ate each day at Solomon’s palace

In the third scene: The storyteller describes how safe and secure everyone in Israel was during Solomon’s reign.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller tells us about Solomon’s horses and chariots.

The characters in this passage are:

- The people of Judah and Israel
- King Solomon

- The people of the countries that Solomon conquered
- And the district governors of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In scene one, the storyteller begins by telling us that the people of Judah and Israel were as many as the sand on the seashore. The phrase "as many as the sand on the seashore" uses the exact words that Yahweh had said to Abraham about his descendants many years before. When the storyteller said this, he wanted to remind his audience that Yahweh had assured Abraham that Abraham would have so many descendants that no one would be able to count them. If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have already translated this phrase. It would be helpful to go back and listen to how you translated it.

Stop here and look at a picture of sand on a seashore. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and listen to Genesis chapter 22 if it is available in your language. After the angel of Yahweh stopped Abraham from sacrificing Isaac, the angel gave Abraham a message from Yahweh that included the promise that Abraham's descendants would be as many as the sand on the seashore. Pay close attention to how you translated this phrase. Pause this audio here.

During the reign of Solomon, the people of Judah and Israel were eating, drinking, and rejoicing. This means that they had plenty of food and drink and felt very happy. The way the storyteller says this shows that this was how the people felt throughout all 40 years of Solomon's reign.

Solomon ruled over a large territory. The northern border of Solomon's territory was the Euphrates River. The Euphrates River is the modern-day name of a large river that flows through the modern-day countries of Syria and Iraq. Some translations of this passage just say "the river," but we recommend that you include the name of the river so that your audience will clearly understand which river the storyteller is talking about.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel during the reign of Solomon that shows the Euphrates River. Pause this audio here.

Even Solomon, with all his power, did not conquer the territory of the Philistines. The Philistines were a people group that lived along the coast of the Mediterranean Sea between the territory of Israel and the territory of Egypt. The Israelites frequently had conflict with the Philistines.

Solomon also ruled in areas where non-Israelites lived. These non-Israelites had to pay tribute to Solomon. Tribute is a gift or payment that one group gives to another group to show respect or keep the peace. Usually, the group that pays tribute is less powerful than the group that receives the payment.

The non-Israelites paid tribute to Solomon in order to live peacefully within his territory. When the storyteller says that the conquered people served Solomon, it does not mean that they became servants in his household. Rather, it means that they were loyal to Solomon and did whatever Solomon told them to do.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your language, what words or phrases do you have to describe a situation where one group is loyal to a leader and does whatever he or she tells them to do? Pause this audio here.

In scene two, the storyteller describes the large amount of food that Solomon's family, officials, and guests ate every day at Solomon's palace. When you listened to three different versions of this passage, you probably heard different words to describe the amount of fine flour and coarse flour, or meal, that people used every day in Solomon's palace. You might have heard the word "cors" to describe the amount of flour. This word sounds like the word in the original language, but Bible scholars do not agree on how big a cor was. You also might have heard the word "bushel," which is a modern-day measurement for grain. You also might have heard words like "kilograms" or "liters," which are modern-day measurements. We recommend you use a word here that your listeners will recognize. The correct amounts in modern-day measurements are around 9,000 liters of fine flour and 18,000 liters of coarse flour.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, how do you measure grain? How familiar are your people with the words that people used to measure grain? If you do not have common words to measure grain, how will you translate the word "cor"? Pause this audio here.

When you listened to this scene, you probably heard many different words for animals. The first two kinds of animals are both cows, but they ate different food. The first group ate grain to help them get big and fat. The second group lived in fields and ate grass. Most people thought the meat from the grain-fed cows tasted better than the meat from the grass-fed cows. You might hear the storyteller call them “10 stall-fed cows” and “20 grass-fed cows,” or “10 fattened oxen” and “20 oxen from the pastures.” We suggest you translate these phrases so it is clear they are the same kind of animal, but they ate different food.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these two phrases. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites ate both sheep and goats. The word the storyteller used here can mean either animal. Deer, gazelles, and roebucks are similar kinds of animals that the Israelites hunted. The first kind of deer is a male deer that could weigh as much as 140 kilograms. Gazelles and roebucks were smaller.

Stop here and look at pictures of a deer, a gazelle, and a roebuck. Pause this audio here.

The last animal that the storyteller mentions is a type of bird. Bible scholars do not agree on what kind of bird this was. The Israelites raised many different types of birds for food. When you listened to three different versions of this passage, you might have heard the storyteller call this kind of bird “fattened fowl,” “choice fowl,” “fattened geese,” or “choice poultry.” All of these phrases mean that people fed the birds well to make them fat and good to eat.

Stop here and discuss these questions: What kind of birds do your people raise for food? What words do you have to describe birds that people raise for food? Pause this audio here.

In scene three, the storyteller tells us again about the borders of Solomon’s land. This time, the storyteller includes the names of two towns on the borders. These towns are Tiphsah in the north and Gaza in the south.

The storyteller also says that Solomon had peace all around him. This means Solomon got along with all his neighbors and did not have to fight any battles. The Israelites believed Yahweh gave them this peaceful time as a blessing. From Dan to Beersheba, the Israelites were safe and secure. Dan was the name of a city in the far north of Israel, where members of the tribe of Dan lived. Beersheba was the name of a town in the far south of Israel, where members of the tribe of Simeon lived. “From Dan to Beersheba” is a way to say “throughout the land of Israel” or “in the entire land of Israel.”

In scene four, the storyteller tells us about Solomon’s horses, chariots, and horsemen. When you listened to three different versions of this story, you might have heard some say “Solomon had 40,000 stalls for his chariot horses,” and others might have said “Solomon had 4,000 stalls for his chariot horses.” We recommend that you use the number 40,000.

In this part of the story, you also might have heard that “Solomon had 12,000 horses” or that “Solomon had 12,000 horsemen.” A horseman is someone who rides or takes care of horses. Bible scholars do not agree on which one the storyteller meant here, and either translation choice is acceptable.

A chariot is a kind of cart that soldiers would hitch to horses and use in battle. At least two soldiers rode in the chariot. One of these soldiers controlled the horses while the other soldier could shoot arrows at enemy soldiers, throw objects at them, or stab them with his sword. Horses are much faster than humans, so the soldiers in the chariot could move much faster than the enemy soldiers around them. The chariot also provided some protection for the soldiers inside.

Stop here and look at a picture of a chariot. Pause this audio here.

Solomon’s 12 district governors did a good job of providing food and other supplies for the king. These deputies not only provided food for King Solomon, his family, and all of Solomon’s officials, but the deputies also provided food and straw for Solomon’s horses.

In this part of the story, the storyteller uses two different words for Solomon’s horses. The first word is the normal word for horses. The second word means special horses that people used for a certain job. Bible experts do not agree on what the job was. But it seems like the horses needed to be fast, so most Bibles call them very fast horses.

Stop here and discuss how you will describe this group of horses. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 4:20–28

Solomon put his horses in the chariot cities around Israel. The district governors had to make sure the supplies for the horses reached the places where the horses were. The storyteller says that the governors did a very good job of this and did not leave out anything. The governors brought the amount they needed to bring. This shows that Solomon's government worked effectively and took good care of both the people and the horses.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:20–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The people of Judah and Israel
- King Solomon
- The people of the countries that Solomon conquered
- And the district governors of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The people of Judah and Israel were as many as the sand on the seashore, and the people ate, drank, and rejoiced. Solomon ruled over all the kingdoms from the Euphrates River in the north to the land of the Philistines and the border of Egypt in the south. These countries brought tribute and served Solomon all the days of his life.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- My people have grown numerous and prosperous! The promises God gave to our ancestor Abraham have come true! or
- It is so rare for my people to be at peace. I will work hard to preserve this time of strength and prosperity; or
- I am grateful to Yahweh for all he has done for me and my people.

Ask the people playing the people of Judah and Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" They might answer things like:

- We are so grateful for King Solomon because he has made our country strong and safe; or
- We feel relieved that our people no longer have to worry about war or hunger; or
- We love Yahweh. Yahweh has blessed us so much. Yahweh has been faithful to his promises.

Ask the people playing the rulers of the conquered lands, "What are you feeling or thinking?" They might answer things like:

- I do not like to pay tribute to Solomon, but it is smarter to bring tribute than to wage war; or
- Even though we are subject to Solomon, our people have survived, and Solomon treats us fairly well; or
- Maybe if we make an alliance with Solomon, we can gain his favor and get some of Solomon's wealth.

Continue the drama.

Every day, Solomon's palace used 5,000 liters of fine flour and 10,000 liters of coarse flour, 10 fattened cattle and 20 pasture-fed cattle, 100 sheep and goats, as well as deer, gazelles, roebucks, and choice fowl.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We have so many people to feed. I hope we do not experience a shortage or famine; or
- I am grateful that I am able to provide such good food for my people; or
- Yahweh has truly blessed me and this nation.

Ask the people playing the people of Judah and Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" They might answer things like:

- We feel proud that we live in such a great nation with so much good food; or
- We feel pleased that God has given us such a good king; or
- We hope that our nation will continue to be this prosperous and successful.

Continue the drama.

Solomon ruled over all the kingdoms west of the Euphrates River, from Tiphsah to Gaza, and there was peace with all the neighboring countries. During Solomon's lifetime, Judah and Israel lived in safety throughout the whole country from Dan to Beersheba, and each family had its own grapevines and fig trees.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I must continue to be strong enough to keep this nation safe and feed them well; or
- I am glad that we are at peace with all our neighbors; or
- I feel awe that Yahweh's promises to our ancestors have come true during my lifetime.

Ask the people playing the people of Judah and Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" They might answer things like:

- Our ancestors would be so happy to know that our country is rich and safe; or
- We are so glad that we do not have to worry about having enough food and wine! or
- We hope that this prosperity and peace will continue for our children and grandchildren; or
- We feel proud that our nation is such a great nation.

Continue the drama.

Solomon had 40,000 stalls of horses for his chariots, and 12,000 horsemen. The district governors faithfully provided food for King Solomon and his officials. Each governor made sure nothing was lacking during the month assigned to him. Each governor also brought to the proper places the amount they needed to bring of barley and straw for the horses and chariot horses.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud that our army is so large and strong; or
- If any of these nations rebel against me, I feel confident that our army is strong enough to crush them; or
- I am grateful that all my district governors are faithful and do their jobs well.

Ask the people playing the district governors, "What are you feeling or thinking?" They might answer things like:

- It is a lot of work to feed everyone at the palace and all the chariot horses; or
- I am happy to do my part to keep our country safe and secure; or
- I am proud to serve such a great king as Solomon.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:20–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

1 Kings 4:20–28

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The people of **Judah** and **Israel** were as many as the sand on the seashore. The people ate, drank, and rejoiced. Solomon ruled over all the **kingdoms** from the **Euphrates River** in the north to the land of the **Philistines** and the border of Egypt in the south. Be sure to translate Judah, Israel, kingdom, Euphrates River, and Philistines the same way that you have in previous passages. For more information on "Israel," "Judah," and "kingdom," refer to the Master Glossary.

If necessary, stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter 2. Pay attention to the name you used for the fourth river—this is the Euphrates River. Pause this audio here.

If necessary, stop here and listen again to 2 Samuel 23:16, where you translated the word for "Philistines." Pause this audio here.

These countries brought tribute and served Solomon all the days of his life.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the word "**tribute**." If necessary, listen again to 2 Samuel 8:6 to remember how you translated the word "tribute." Pause this audio here.

Every day, Solomon's palace used about 9,000 liters of fine flour and 18,000 liters of coarse flour, 10 fattened cattle and 20 pasture-fed cattle, 100 sheep and goats, as well as deer, gazelles, roebucks and choice fowl.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the names of these animals: **fattened cattle**, **pasture-fed cattle**, **sheep** and **goats**, **deer**, **gazelles**, **roebucks**, and **fowl**. Look at pictures again of deer, gazelle, and roebucks, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Solomon ruled over all the **kingdoms** west of the Euphrates River, from Tiphsah to **Gaza**, and Judah and Israel had **peace** with all the neighboring countries. Translate peace in the same way you did in previous passages in 1 Kings, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about peace.

If necessary, stop here and listen to 1 Samuel 6:17 and be sure to translate the name "Gaza" the same way you did there. Pause this audio here.

During Solomon's lifetime, Judah and Israel lived in safety throughout the whole country from Dan to Beersheba, and each family had its own grapevines and its own fig trees.

If necessary, stop here and listen to your translation of 2 Samuel 24:15, and be sure to translate **Dan** and **Beersheba** the same way you did there. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at pictures of grapevines and fig trees again as a group. What will you call these in your translation? Pause this audio here.

Solomon had 40,000 stalls of horses for his **chariots**, and 12,000 horsemen. Be sure to translate chariot the same way that you did in previous passages.

> The **district governors** faithfully provided food for King Solomon and his officials. Each governor made sure nothing was lacking during the month assigned to him. The governors also brought to the proper places their quotas of barley and straw for the horses and swift steeds. Be sure to translate "governor" the same way you did in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 4:20–28

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (858 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 4:29–34

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 4:29–34 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:29–34 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This section of 1 Kings describes how wise Solomon was. The ancient people believed that wisdom came from a god. But the Israelites knew that God gives people true wisdom. And God is willing to give wisdom to those who ask for it. We remember that when Solomon prayed to God, Solomon did not ask for long life, wealth, or that God would punish Solomon's enemies. Instead, Solomon asked God to give Solomon a mind that could understand the situation, so that Solomon could rule God's people in a wise and just way. Then God answered Solomon's

prayer and gave Solomon wisdom. In this story, the storyteller reminds us that God gave Solomon wisdom. And the storyteller describes the greatness of Solomon's wisdom.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your culture treat a person who is very wise? Pause this audio here.

God gave Solomon a lot of wisdom and understanding. The storyteller says that Solomon knew as many things as grains of sand on a seashore! That is a lot of things to know! No one could understand or count all of Solomon's knowledge.

Stop here and look at a picture of a seashore as a group. Pause this audio here.

Then the storyteller gives us some people of the East and Egypt as examples of people of wisdom. The "people of the East" refers to the tribes that lived east and southeast of the Jordan River down to the Dead Sea.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Israel and the areas that surround Israel. Pause this audio here.

People back then considered these nations to be very wise and often asked their wise men for guidance and answers. But Solomon was wiser than all the wise people in those two nations.

The storyteller mentioned four men whom the people of Israel would know. Solomon is wiser than Ethan the Ezrahite and the sons of Mahol, who were Heman, Calcol, and Darda.

Solomon wrote 3,000 proverbs and 1,005 songs. Both proverbs and songs often contained wise sayings and teachings. Many people believed that Solomon wrote the books of Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, and Song of Solomon, which are also in the Bible. People call these books wisdom writings.

[Solomon knew about many different subjects. Solomon knew about trees and plants, such as the Lebanon cedar trees and the hyssop plant.]{.mark} Cedar trees are tall and valuable trees that grow all over the country of Lebanon. At this time, people used cedars to build temples and palaces because cedar wood was very strong and beautiful. On the other hand, hyssop is a plant that commonly grows between the stones or bricks in walls. Solomon has a wide knowledge of trees and plants, from the biggest to the smallest.

Stop here and look at a picture of cedar trees and hyssop as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon also knew about the different types of animals, birds, reptiles, and fish. Solomon was familiar with the animals that live on the farm, wild animals, animals that fly in the air, animals that crawl both in water and on land, and animals that live in water.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kinds of animals live in your area? How do you group them together? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the kings from other lands send people to learn from Solomon. As people listen to Solomon, Solomon influences the people and kings in nearby nations, which makes Solomon even more powerful.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do your leaders respond to a leader in their area who is very wise?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller says that God gave Solomon great wisdom.

In the second scene: The storyteller compares Solomon's wisdom with other nations and other wise men.

In the third scene: The storyteller shows Solomon's knowledge of different topics.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller shows how people from all over the world come to hear Solomon's wisdom.

The characters in this passage are:

- God
- Solomon
- Ethan, the Ezrahite
- Heman, Calcol, and Darda, the sons of Mahol
- And people who came from other nations

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller identifies God as the one who gave wisdom, deep understanding, and a wide heart to Solomon. Although wisdom, understanding about many things, and a wide heart or knowledge may have similar meanings, these three words emphasize that Solomon is very wise.

The storyteller uses special language in order to describe the greatness of Solomon's wisdom. For example, the storyteller uses the image of the heart to say that Solomon had a wide knowledge of how things worked. In the past, people used the word for heart to describe the way that people think, feel, and make decisions. A person with a wide heart describes a person who knows things well.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what words will you use for wisdom, knowledge, and a wide understanding or heart? Pause this audio here.

In fact, the storyteller compares the wisdom of Solomon to the sand on the seashore. Just as no one can count all the sand on the seashore, no one can count or measure the things that Solomon knows. Of course, this is an exaggeration. No human being can possibly know everything. But the storyteller wants to point out that Solomon was truly the wisest person at that time. A seashore is a place where the sea meets the land. The seashore is usually full of sand, stones, or rocks. Solomon knows about as many things as there are pieces of sand on a seashore, which no one can ever count. The storyteller means that no one can measure how much Solomon knows!

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a seashore and sand. Discuss this question as a group: How will you describe a thing, or a group of things, that is so big that no one can measure it? Remember that the storyteller uses the sand on the seashore to show how great Solomon's wisdom is. In the previous passage, the storyteller used sand on the seashore to show how many descendants Abraham would have. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller continues to describe the wisdom of Solomon. The storyteller compares Solomon's wisdom with the wisdom of other nations and other wise people. The storyteller particularly mentions the wisdom of the people of the East, the nation of Egypt. Solomon even describes wise men from Israel. Solomon's wisdom is greater than Ethan the Ezrahite from a place called Ezrah, and the sons of Mahol: Heman, Calcol, and Darda. The storyteller uses these names to show that Solomon is wiser than the wise men in the Israelites' own country. The storyteller mentions the names of people whom the Israelites know. But the wisdom of Solomon is greater than these nations and people.

In the third scene, the storyteller gives specific examples of Solomon's wisdom and knowledge. The storyteller mentions that Solomon wrote 3,000 wise sayings and 1,005 songs. This shows that Solomon knows how to speak in wise and beautiful ways. Then the storyteller mentions that Solomon also knows about plants and trees. Solomon talks about cedar trees and hyssop. People know that cedar trees are big trees and hyssop plants are small plants. This shows that Solomon knows a lot about plants, from big to small plants. Finally, the storyteller mentions that Solomon also knows about all kinds of land animals, birds, reptiles, and fish. Reptiles are animals that can live in water and on land. This shows that Solomon knows a lot about animals, too. Solomon knows about many things in the world. Solomon knows how to speak well and compose songs. Solomon also knows a lot about plants and animals.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the animals so that it is clear that Solomon knows about every kind of animal. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller shows that the nations around Israel heard about Solomon's great wisdom. So the kings of those nations sent people to come to Solomon to listen to Solomon speak wisely.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

1 Kings 4:29–34

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- God
- Solomon
- Ethan, the Ezrahite
- Heman, Calcol, and Darda, the sons of Mahol
- And people who came from other nations

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces God as the source of Solomon's great wisdom.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing God, "What are you feeling or thinking when you give Solomon great wisdom?" The person might answer things like:

- I think I can trust Solomon with such a gift; or
- I feel hopeful that Solomon will use the wisdom I gave him to lead the Israelites responsibly.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking when you receive the gift of wisdom from God?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel humbled because God gave me this gift of wisdom so I can properly lead the people of God.

Continue the drama.

In the second scene, the storyteller compares the wisdom of Solomon with that of other people. The storyteller talks about the people of the East, the people of Egypt, Ethan the Ezrahite, Heman, Calcol, and Darda. The wisdom of Solomon is far greater than these people.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking when you find out that you are the wisest person among all nations?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud that I am the wisest person among all nations; or
- I think I can help other nations with my wisdom.

Ask the person playing the people of the East, the people of Egypt, Ethan the Ezrahite, Heman, Calcol, and Darda, "What are you feeling or thinking when you learn that there is a person who is wiser than you?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel amazed that a person can have such great wisdom; or
- I think I need to meet that person and honor him; or
- I am jealous of the wise person!

1 Kings 4:29–34

Continue the drama.

In the third scene, the storyteller gives actual examples of Solomon's great wisdom. Then the storyteller says that Solomon wrote a lot of proverbs and songs. Then the storyteller adds that Solomon knows a lot about plants and animals.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking because you know a lot about the different kinds of plants and animals?" The person might answer things like:

- I think I can help more people as they farm and raise farm animals if I have such a wide understanding of plants and animals; or
- I feel very proud because I have a wide knowledge of plants and animals compared to other people.

Continue the drama.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller mentions the effect of Solomon's great wisdom on other people. People from different kingdoms and nations will gather around Solomon. These people will stay and listen to Solomon.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking as people surround you, admire you, and want to listen to you?" The person might answer things like:

- I think I need to praise God because he gave me great wisdom; or
- I feel I have [become a great king, as I should.]{.mark}

Ask the person playing the people of the other nations, "What are you feeling or thinking when you come to Solomon?" The person might answer things like:

- I think it is a rare opportunity to meet the wisest person on earth; or
- I feel afraid to meet Solomon.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 4:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this story, the storyteller describes the wisdom that Solomon received from **God**. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

The storyteller mentioned the word **wisdom** many times. For more information on wisdom, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word for wisdom as you used in previous passages.

God also gave Solomon deep knowledge or understanding and a wide heart. Wisdom, deep knowledge, and a wide or understanding heart all mean similar things. Someone understands well when they have knowledge about something and can respond appropriately because they know what to do. That person is able to make decisions well. We remember the prayer of Solomon from a past section in this book when Solomon prayed to Yahweh for wisdom. Back then, Solomon asked Yahweh for wisdom so that Solomon could understand and decide between what is right and what is wrong.

Stop here and decide as a group what words or phrases you will use for Solomon's **deep knowledge** and **wide or understanding heart**. If you use the word for heart in your translation, refer to the Master Glossary for more information about heart, and use the same word for heart that you have used in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Solomon's wisdom was greater than the men from the East. East is the direction that the sun rises.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **East**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon becomes very famous to the nations around Israel. A nation is a group of people who live together in a location. A nation also has a ruler that governs the people.

1 Kings 4:29–34

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **nation**. Look up “nation” in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Because of Solomon’s wisdom, Solomon is able to write proverbs and songs. A proverb is a short, wise saying that is easy to remember.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **proverb**. Look up “proverb” in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon also knew a lot about plants and trees. This section talks about trees and plants, like **cedar trees** and **hyssops**. Cedar is a type of tree that grows in Lebanon. Hyssop is a type of plant that grows in Israel. In Bible times, people used hyssop for rituals and ceremonial cleansing. Use the same words or phrases throughout the book of Kings.

Stop here and look at a picture of cedar trees and hyssop as a group. Pause this audio here.

Finally, the storyteller mentioned reptiles as one of the groups of animals that Solomon knew about. Reptiles are animals that have dry skin with scales or bony plates. These animals usually lay eggs. Reptiles can also live in water and on land. Some kinds of reptiles are snakes, lizards, and turtles.

Stop here and look at a picture of reptiles as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **land animals**, **birds**, **reptiles**, and **fish**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller mentions the **kings** of the world. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory. For more information on kings, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 4:29–34

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (998 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1022 KB)

1 Kings 5:1–12

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 5:1–12 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:1–12 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This story is also in 2 Chronicles 2:1–18. You can listen to your translation of 2 Chronicles 2:1–18 if you have already translated it. Since this story is different in 2 Chronicles, take note of each story's differences. Sometimes the order of the scenes differs. Notice the details carefully.

Pause this audio here.

Solomon is the new king of Israel. We also remember from the previous section that Solomon received great wisdom from God. In this section, Solomon is about to start a very important project. Solomon will lead the Israelites to build the temple of Yahweh.

In the past, King Hiram and King David were on good terms. King Hiram sent King David cedar logs and workers in order to build David's palace. This time, King Hiram of Tyre hears that the people of Israel have anointed Solomon as their king. Then King Hiram sends servants to represent Hiram before King Solomon.

Tyre is a city in Phoenicia, which is in the present-day country of Lebanon. The people of Tyre are rich because Tyre is located beside the sea, where people come in their ships to trade valuable things. The people of Tyre trade cedar logs from the forests of Lebanon. Cedar logs have good qualities for when people make houses and other buildings.

Stop here and look at a map of the countries near the Mediterranean Sea during this time. Then locate Israel, the forests of Lebanon, and Phoenicia as a group. Pause this audio here.

King Hiram wants to honor the friendship he had with King David and to continue that friendship with Solomon, the new king of Israel. Solomon also wants to continue the close friendship with King Hiram of Tyre. Then Solomon sends the servants of King Hiram back to Tyre with a message to King Hiram.

1 Kings 5:1–12

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you continue good relationships with other tribes or nations? For example, when a person becomes the new leader of a country, how do your leaders continue to keep peace between your countries? How do they show that the countries are still friends? Pause this audio here.

Solomon tells King Hiram that David wanted to build a temple for Yahweh while David ruled in Israel. But Yahweh did not allow David to build a temple for Yahweh because of the wars that David fought. David's mission was to defeat all the enemy nations and bring peace to Israel. Since David will not be able to build a temple for Yahweh, Yahweh told David that David's son, who will be the next king, will build the temple for Yahweh. Now, Solomon is the new king of Israel. Solomon is the one who will build the temple. So Solomon wants King Hiram's help to build the temple of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think Yahweh wanted to wait until Israel was at peace before Yahweh allowed his kings to build a temple to him? Pause this audio here.

Solomon specifically asks King Hiram to provide cedar logs and wood cutters. We remember from the previous section that Solomon knows about cedar logs from the Lebanon mountains. But Tyre is not only famous for the cedar logs. The people there are also highly skilled woodworkers, especially the people from the city of Sidon in Phoenicia, whom people called Sidonians. In fact, while David was king, King Hiram of Tyre sent logs and woodworkers from Lebanon to help build a palace for David. That is why Solomon asks for wood from King Hiram. In return, Solomon promises King Hiram that Solomon will pay the wages of the woodworkers. Solomon also tells King Hiram that Solomon will send his servants to help with the work. These servants are not the kind of servants who work in the house, but people whom Solomon forces to work for him for a certain amount of time in order to complete some sort of building project.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do your people grow or produce? What products do you grow in your land or trade with other countries? What skills do other people say that people in your area are good at? Pause this audio here.

King Hiram receives Solomon's message and praises Yahweh. King Hiram promises Solomon to give the cedar logs that Solomon asked for. King Hiram will also give Solomon cypress wood from cypress trees in addition to cedar wood.

Stop here and look at a picture of cedar trees and cypress trees as a group. Pause this audio here.

Then King Hiram explains his plans about how to bring the logs to Solomon. King Hiram will command Hiram's workers to get the logs from the Lebanon mountain range and bring them to the Mediterranean Sea. Then the workers will tie the logs together and make them into rafts. It will be easier for people to float those logs through the sea rather than to pull those logs through the land to Israel. Hiram's workers will tie the logs together to make rafts. Then boats will pull the rafts. When the workers arrive at the location that Solomon chooses, the workers will take the rafts apart. Solomon's workers can then transport those logs to the place where people will build the temple.

Stop here as a group and look at the map to find the forests of Lebanon, Phoenicia, Israel, and the Mediterranean Sea. Pause this audio here.

King Hiram agrees to do all these things for Solomon if Solomon will provide food for King Hiram and the people who live with King Hiram. Although the location of Tyre has many good trees, the land of Tyre was not good for people to grow crops. In order to solve this problem, the people of Tyre traded their logs for food or crops. Solomon follows the suggestion of Hiram. Hiram sends the logs, and then Solomon sends the food. Every year, Solomon gives 2,000 tons of wheat and 400,000 liters of pure olive oil. Wheat and olive oil are two main foods during this time.

Solomon's relationship with King Hiram shows that Yahweh really has given Solomon wisdom. We remember that Solomon had asked Yahweh for wisdom in order to lead the people in the right and just way. Because of Solomon's wisdom, King Solomon and King Hiram make a treaty. A treaty is a formal agreement between countries to keep peace and good relationships.

1 Kings 5:1–12

The storyteller shows us that one of the effects of King Solomon's good leadership is to make peace and treaties with other nations.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: King Hiram hears that Solomon is the new king of Israel. King Hiram then sends representatives to Solomon after he hears the news that the people anointed Solomon as the new king of Israel.

In the second scene: Solomon sends a message back to King Hiram.

In the third scene: King Hiram agrees to King Solomon's request.

In the fourth scene: King Hiram sends the wood, and King Solomon sends the food. King Solomon and King Hiram make a treaty with each other.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh, Solomon's God
- King Hiram of Tyre
- King Solomon
- Hiram's representatives from Tyre
- Sidonian woodworkers
- King Hiram's household
- Hiram's workers
- And Solomon's workers

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller reminds us that Hiram has been friends with Solomon's father, David, for a long time. Then Hiram hears that the people of Israel have anointed Solomon to be the new king. King Hiram of Tyre sends his servants, or special messengers, to King Solomon.

In the second scene, Solomon sends a message back to King Hiram about Solomon's plan to build the temple for Yahweh. Solomon explains to King Hiram why King David was not able to build the temple for the name of Yahweh, his God. When someone builds a "house" or temple for someone's name, that person is building that temple for the honor of that person. King David really wanted to build a house to honor Yahweh, his God. Yahweh did not allow David to build a temple for Yahweh because, while David was king of Israel, David fought many wars. David could not build the house for Yahweh when there was no peace in Israel.

Yahweh will only allow David to build a temple for Yahweh when Yahweh puts David's enemies "under the soles of his feet," or when David defeats and completely destroys all the enemies of Israel. When someone puts people "under their feet," they are saying that they have power over those people, or they destroy those people.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about Yahweh putting David's enemies under David's feet. Pause this audio here.

But this time is different. There is rest in Israel "on every side." This means that Israel is secure and has peace with the nations that surround the country of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about Solomon having rest on every side. Pause this audio here.

Now, it is the right time to build a temple to honor Yahweh. Yahweh himself said to David that David's son, whom Yahweh will "put on the throne" in David's place, will build a temple for the name of Yahweh. You will remember that a throne is a special seat that kings of that time sat on when they ruled. When a new king comes to the throne, it means that a new king begins to rule after the former king dies or stops ruling. Yahweh says

1 Kings 5:1–12

that David's son, meaning Solomon, will build the temple for the name, or honor, of Yahweh. A person's name represents that person's reputation and their presence. Yahweh wants his people to build a house for Yahweh's name, which means that Yahweh wants his people to honor him and to recognize that Yahweh's presence will live in that temple.

After Solomon explains why Solomon will build the temple, Solomon then presents his request to King Hiram. Solomon has a wide knowledge of cedar trees, so he knows that cedar is a good wood to build things with. And this time, Solomon asks King Hiram to supply cedar wood for the Israelites to use to build the temple. Solomon also asks King Hiram for skilled people who can cut and do woodwork. Solomon will pay the workers because the people of Sidon are very skilled in woodworking.

In the third scene, King Hiram is happy with what Solomon said in his message. First, King Hiram praises Yahweh because Yahweh gave David a wise son to be the king of Israel. Then King Hiram agrees to what Solomon requested. But Hiram agrees to do something a bit different from what Solomon asked him to do. Hiram says he will also send cypress trees. Then King Hiram explains how Hiram's workers will bring the wood to Israel. Although Hiram says that he will work with the wood, he really means that his workers will do these things. Hiram's workers will cut down the trees and then bring the wood down to the port, or the place on the side of the sea where they will send the wood from. The workers will make the long pieces of wood into rafts by tying them together side by side so that they are like a flat boat. Then the workers will guide the rafts south down the side of the Mediterranean Sea to the place where the men of King Solomon will receive them. It is possible that the workers will use larger boats to pull the flat rafts of wood through the water. King Hiram's workers will take apart the rafts into the separate long pieces of wood. Then King Solomon can bring the long pieces of wood from the shore of the Mediterranean Sea to Jerusalem. And then, towards the end of King Hiram's letter, King Hiram asks Solomon to provide Hiram and his royal family with food in exchange for the wood.

Stop here and look at the map of the Mediterranean Sea and a picture of a raft as a group. Pause this audio here.

The final scene describes how Hiram and Solomon keep their agreement. King Hiram sends all the cedar and cypress wood that Solomon needs. Then, in exchange, King Solomon supplies King Hiram with 20,000 cors of wheat and 20,000 baths of olive oil each year. You will remember that a cor is a unit of measurement. Twenty thousand cors is about 6,000,000 liters of wheat. Twenty thousand baths of olive oil may be around 400,000 liters of olive oil. These are very large amounts of wheat and oil! You may just say that King Solomon sent King Hiram 20,000 measures of wheat and 20,000 measures of olive oil each year, because we are not sure exactly how much of each of these things he sent.

This exchange continues for many years. Then the storyteller mentions again that Yahweh gave Solomon wisdom, just like Yahweh promised Solomon. Then, finally, the storyteller describes the peace between King Solomon and King Hiram. The two kings continue to have peace because they make a treaty, or a solemn promise that they will not fight against each other.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh, Solomon's God
- King Hiram of Tyre
- King Solomon
- Hiram's representatives from Tyre
- Sidonian woodworkers
- King Hiram's household
- Hiram's workers

1 Kings 5:1–12

- And Solomon's workers

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

King Hiram has been friends with King David for a long time. Now, King Hiram hears that the people have anointed King Solomon as the next king of Israel. King Hiram sends a message to King Solomon, and King Solomon sends a message back to Hiram.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel grateful to Yahweh for this great responsibility; or
- I need to continue the good friendship my father had with King Hiram.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Hiram, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very happy that Yahweh gave Israel a new king; or
- I think I need to continue the good relationship that I had with David with the new king of Israel.

Continue the drama.

King Solomon tells King Hiram that Solomon's father, David, could not build the temple for Yahweh because David fought many wars. Now King Solomon has rest from his enemies. Yahweh had told King David that King David's son would build the temple to Yahweh, and Solomon now plans to build the temple. King Solomon asks King Hiram to cut cedar trees from his area for Solomon and send them to Solomon in Israel. Solomon says that Solomon's workers will work with King Hiram, and Solomon will pay King Hiram's men. Solomon then says that he knows that the Sidonian men are the best at working with the cedar tree wood.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Sidonians, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We feel very honored; or
- We think we need to prove ourselves.

Continue the drama.

King Hiram praises Yahweh because Yahweh has given David a wise son to rule over Israel. King Hiram promises to send both cedar wood and cypress wood. King Hiram says that his workers will cut the trees and make them into rafts. Hiram's workers will tie the wood together into flat rafts and guide the rafts to float on the Mediterranean Sea from Tyre down the coast. Then Hiram's workers will break up the rafts into separate pieces of wood, and Solomon's men will take the wood to Jerusalem. Finally, King Hiram asks Solomon to provide him with food for Hiram's household.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Hiram, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I can see that David's God is very wise! or
- I want to help Solomon because I want his God to be kind to me.

1 Kings 5:1–12

Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What do you feel or think when King Hiram agrees to provide you with a supply of timbers?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel assured that King Hiram supports my project; or
- I think King Hiram is a good friend and will help me.

Continue the drama.

Hiram supplies Solomon with cedar and cypress wood each year, and Solomon also sends Hiram a lot of wheat and olive oil every year. Yahweh gives Solomon wisdom, and King Hiram and King Solomon have peace between them. The two kings make a treaty, or an agreement, that they will not fight each other.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In the first scene, **King** Hiram from **Tyre** sends his servants to represent him and give his greetings to King Solomon, whom the people had **anointed** king of Israel. For more information on Tyre, king, and anoint, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this story, the servants are not people who work in the house, but trusted messengers who represent their king.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate **servants** in this story when it means a trusted messenger. If you choose to use the word for servant, you can refer to servant in the Master Glossary for more information.

In the second scene, Solomon shares his plan to build the temple, or a “house for the name of **Yahweh** his **God**.” Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and God as you have used previously, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the “**house** or **temple** for the name of Yahweh his God.” Look up the house of God and temple in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon says that he has rest on every side, and that he has no more enemies or evil things happening to his country.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that Solomon has **rest** on every side, and no more enemies and **evil** things happening. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about evil, if necessary. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has told King David that he will put David’s son on David’s **throne**. Use the same word or phrase for throne as you have used in previous passages.

King Hiram **blesses**, or **praises** Yahweh. When someone blesses someone else, they wish good things for that person. When people bless or praise Yahweh, it means about the same thing, so you can say either bless or praise here. Use the same word or phrase for bless or praise as you did in 1 Kings 1:48 when King David praised Yahweh. For more information about bless and praise, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Hiram says that Yahweh has given David a **wise** son. Use the same word or phrase for wise as you have in previous passages, and refer to wisdom in the Master Glossary for more information.

King Hiram will send cedar and cypress logs to King Solomon. Cedar trees and cypress trees grow in the forest of Lebanon.

Stop here and look at a picture of cedar trees and cypress trees as a group. Discuss what you will call these trees in your translation. Pause this audio here.

Part of King Hiram’s way to deliver the logs to King Solomon is to use rafts. Rafts are logs that people join together with ropes to serve as transportation over the sea. This sea was the Mediterranean Sea, which is a very

1 Kings 5:1–12

large body of water. The rafts would float on the water south from the city of Tyre to a place on the coast of Israel.

Stop here and look at the map of Israel and Lebanon again. Find the city of Tyre on the map and the country of Israel. Also, look at a picture of a raft as a group. Discuss how you will talk about these **rafts** in your translation. Pause this audio here.

Hiram asks for food for his **household**. Use the same word or phrase for household that you have used in previous passages, and refer to household in the Master Glossary for more information.

In the final scene, the storyteller says that King Hiram keeps his promise of support to Solomon. In return, Solomon sends back 20,000 cors, or about 6,000,000 liters of wheat and 20,000 baths, or about 400,000 liters of olive oil. The Israelites grew wheat and olives. People then smashed olives to make olive oil.

Stop here and decide how you will translate these measurements of volume. Remember that you may just say that he sent 20,000 measures of wheat and olive oil each year. Look at pictures of wheat and olives as a group. Pause this audio here.

King Hiram and King Solomon had **peace** and made a treaty, or a covenant, not to fight with each other. Use the same word for peace as you have used in previous passages, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about peace.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **covenant** here, when it is a strong agreement between two countries not to fight each other. For more information about this word, you may refer to covenant in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 5:1–12

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (777 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.8 MB)

- Embodying the Text (3.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1014 KB)

1 Kings 5:13–18

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 5:13–18 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:13–18 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:13–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You can also listen to your translation of this same story in 2 Chronicles 2:1–18 if you have already translated it. Since this story in 2 Chronicles is slightly different, take note of their differences. Sometimes the order of the scenes differs.

Pause this audio here.

This story shows how King Solomon organizes his workers specifically to gather materials for people to build the temple. Solomon gathers workers from all over Israel and forces them to work for Solomon. Solomon gives the workers specific tasks. Solomon assigns Adoniram to take charge of the workers. Adoniram also served David during David's rule.

During Solomon's time, when a king had a building project, that king could order his citizens to work on the project for a certain amount of time. The king required these people to work without payment, but when their time was finished, they were free to go. This is different than when the Israelites forced foreigners that they had captured in war to become slaves and work for them without pay, and for a very long time. Remember that in the previous story, King Solomon promised King Hiram that King Solomon would send workers to Phoenicia, or Lebanon, to help gather the wood. King Solomon gathers 30,000 workers. Then King Solomon divides them into three groups of 10,000 workers in each group and sends them to Phoenicia, one group at a time. Each group of workers will work there for one month and then come back to stay in Israel for two months. So the Israelite workers have to work a total of four months each year in Phoenicia.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your people's history, what story can you tell about a time when a leader ordered a lot of people to work on a project together? How did your leader do that? Pause this audio here.

Meanwhile, Solomon also gathers workers who stay in the hill country of Israel to gather stone for the temple. There are a total of 150,000 workers for this group. Eighty thousand workers will quarry the stones from the hillside and cut them into different sizes. And there are 70,000 workers who will carry the stones to Jerusalem, where people are building the temple. Solomon also assigns 3,300 supervisors who will help supervise the work. Solomon orders the workers to dig out from the hillside huge numbers of high-quality stones. People will use these stones as the foundation for the temple. The foundation of any structure is very important. The foundation

1 Kings 5:13–18

holds the structure together. Some people “dress” or cut high-quality stones, shape them into large square blocks, and then bury them under the ground. Then the people will pile other stones on top of these stones.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What materials do you use when you build big places of worship? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at pictures of a stone quarry, wood, and quarry stones as a group. Pause this audio here.

The last part of this story concludes the organization of the workers for the building of the temple. The skilled builders of King Solomon and the skilled builders of King Hiram, along with the workers from Gebal, prepared the wood and the stones to build the temple. Gebal is a city on the coast of Phoenicia that people call Byblos today.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the locations of Gebal or Byblos, Lebanon or Phoenicia, the Phoenician forest, the hill country of Israel, and Jerusalem.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:13–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon sends three groups of 10,000 Israelites to help gather wood in Phoenicia. Each group goes to Phoenicia for one month. King Solomon assigns Adoniram to supervise the workers in Phoenicia.

In the second scene: 150,000 workers carry stones and wood, and cut stone. 3,300 supervisors supervise all of the workers who help build the foundation of the temple.

In the third scene: The storyteller summarizes the work that the workers of King Solomon, the workers of King Hiram, and the workers from the city of Gebal do.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Israelite workers
- The workers whom King Solomon sent to Phoenicia in groups of 10,000 men each
- The men who cut stone out of the ground
- The men who carried the wood and stone
- And the craftsmen who cut the stone
- Adoniram
- 3,300 supervisors
- King Hiram
- And King Hiram’s skilled builders, including the workers from Gebal

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage’s setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller presents how King Solomon organizes the workers for the project. King Solomon gathers workers from all over Israel and assigns them to forced labor. The first group goes to Phoenicia. Solomon assigns 30,000 workers to work in Phoenicia. Solomon divides the 30,000 workers into three groups, with 10,000 workers in each group. The first group works in Phoenicia for a month and then goes back to Israel. Then the second group goes to Phoenicia and works there for one month. Then, after a month, the second group comes back to Israel. Then the third group goes to Phoenicia and works in Phoenicia for one month. While one of the groups is working in Phoenicia, the other two groups stay in Israel. King Solomon orders this rotation of work throughout the building project. You will remember that King Solomon had already appointed Adoniram in an earlier story to be in charge of forced labor.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of Phoenicia and Israel as a group. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 5:13–18

In the second scene, the storyteller tells the number of King Solomon's workers who quarry, or dig, large stones from the hills of Israel. Eighty thousand workers will carve and dig out huge rocks from the hillside. Then 70,000 workers will carry the stones from the hillside to Jerusalem, where people will build the foundation of the temple. Solomon assigns 3,300 supervisors to instruct the workers. The supervisors will make sure that the workers follow King Solomon's instructions. King Solomon instructs the workers to take large blocks of high-quality, or very hard, stones. The workers will shape or cut these stones into squares and use them as the foundation for the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for the men who dig the stones from the hills, the men who carry the stones to Jerusalem, the supervisors who make sure the men follow instructions, and the workers who will shape or cut the stones into square blocks for the foundation of the temple. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at pictures of the stone quarry, wood, and quarry stones again. How will you describe this in your translation? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller summarizes the work that King Solomon's and King Hiram's workers do with the wood and with the stone. The craftsmen, or skilled builders, from King Solomon, the skilled builders from King Hiram, and the workers of Gebal cut and prepare the stones and the wood so that they can build the temple foundation.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words will you use to describe the skilled builders? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:13–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Israelite workers
- The workers whom King Solomon sent to Phoenicia in groups of 10,000 men each
- The men who cut stone out of the ground
- The men who carried the wood and stone
- And the craftsmen who cut the stone
- Adoniram
- 3,300 supervisors
- King Hiram
- And King Hiram's skilled builders, including the workers from Gebal

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces King Solomon. King Solomon divides the workers into three groups. King Solomon sends each group to work in Phoenicia for one month at a time. The rotation of the work will continue until they gather the materials they need to build the temple. King Solomon puts Adoniram in charge of the groups of people that Solomon forces to work for him.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very happy that Yahweh trusts me with this task.

Ask the person playing the workers, "What do you feel?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel thankful that I have the privilege to work in Phoenicia; or
- I feel sad because I will be separated from my family.

Ask the person playing Adoniram, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel responsible for the result of the project; or
- I feel honored to serve Yahweh and King Solomon through this project.

Continue the drama

In the second scene, King Solomon calls two more groups of workers. King Solomon commands one group of 80,000 workers to dig out rocks from the hillside. And then King Solomon commands the other group of 70,000 workers to carry those rocks from the hillside to Jerusalem, where they will build the temple. Then King Solomon assigns 3,300 men as supervisors and commands them to lead the workers.

Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you thinking when you choose Adoniram and the foremen to supervise the work in Phoenicia and Israel?" The person might answer things like:

- I think there are so many workers that I could not supervise them all. I am afraid that this is too much work! or
- I think there are many people who are capable of leading the workers. I am glad I have help!

Ask the person playing Adoniram and the foremen, "What are you feeling or thinking when King Solomon chooses you for this work?" The person might answer things like:

- We feel responsible for the result of the project; or
- We feel honored to serve Yahweh and King Solomon through this project.

Continue the drama.

In the third scene, the storyteller says that King Solomon's builders, King Hiram's builders, and the workers from the city of Gebal all work together to build the temple.

Ask the people playing as the workers of Gebal, "What are you feeling when you know that you are serving Yahweh alongside the workers of King Solomon and King Hiram?" The people of Gebal might answer things like:

- We feel honored because we are serving Yahweh alongside King Solomon and King Hiram.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 5:13–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In the first scene, **King** Solomon gathers workers from **Israel** to build the **temple** and places them into **forced labor**. King Solomon assigns the first large group of workers to work in Phoenicia. These workers will help the workers of King Hiram cut and prepare wood from Phoenicia. Use the same words or phrases for king, Israel, and temple as you used in previous passages. For more information on "king" and "temple," refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for "forced labor" as you used in 1 Kings 4:6.

In the second scene, King Solomon also gathers Israelite workers to dig stones from the hillside, workers to carry the stones to Jerusalem, and supervisors. Other workers will “dress” or cut those stones into different shapes and sizes. The supervisors manage and direct the workers.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for workers who dig stones from the hillside, workers who carry stones, supervisors, and workers who cut the stones into different shapes and sizes. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at the pictures of the stone quarry, wood, and quarry stones again. How will you describe this in your translation? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller summarizes the story and says that King Solomon’s skilled builders, King Hiram’s skilled builders, and the workers of Gebal cut and prepare the wood and stone.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for skilled builders.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 5:13–18

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (799 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1024 KB)

1 Kings 6:1–13

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 6:1–13 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:1–13 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, you learned about the workers that King Solomon used to prepare to build the temple. These men came from all around Israel to cut and shape stones for the temple.

In this story, Solomon begins to build the temple or house of Yahweh. This temple is where the Israelites will worship Yahweh. You will remember from a previous passage that Yahweh promised that David's son, Solomon, would build a temple for Yahweh. Although David gathered many of the materials people would need to build the temple, it was Solomon who now directed people as they did the work. We hear this same information in another book of the Bible as well.

Stop here and listen as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 3:1–14, where we hear this same information, listen to your translation of that passage as a group. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says the people of Israel left Egypt 480 years before Solomon begins to build the temple. However, the storyteller may not mean exactly 480 years. The storyteller may use the number 480 to talk about the 12 generations of people who lived and died between the time the Israelites left Egypt and the time Solomon begins to build the temple. A generation refers to a group of people who lived at the same time and belonged to the same age group. The Israelites believed that a generation lasted about 40 years. So if 12 generations of people lived during this time, the total number of years that passed between the time the Israelites left Egypt and the time Solomon begins to build would be 480. However, storytellers in the Bible sometimes use the number 12 as special language, so it is also possible that the storyteller does not mean 12 actual generations, but just that all of the people who lived between the time of the exodus and the time when Solomon builds the temple have died.

Stop here and discuss as a group: When do people in your culture use numbers in a special way to mean something other than the number itself? Pause this audio here.

At the time of this story, Solomon has been the king over Israel for four years. In the second month of that year, in the spring month called Ziv, Solomon orders his workmen to begin to build Yahweh's temple. People probably called the month Ziv, which means "bloom," because flowers bloomed during that time of the year.

The storyteller provides details about the size and construction of the temple, but we do not know every detail about how the temple looked. Another passage in the Bible tells us that Solomon builds the temple in Jerusalem.

Solomon builds his temple for Yahweh in the shape of a rectangle. The temple's walls are 60 cubits long, 20 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high. A cubit is the way people talked about how long something was. One cubit is as long as the distance between a grown adult man's elbow and his fingertips, or about 50 centimeters. So the temple is about 30 meters long, 10 meters wide, and 15 meters high. There is a portico or porch at the front of the temple that stretches across the width of the front wall. A portico or porch is part of a structure with columns instead of walls to hold up the roof. Therefore, this area is 20 cubits or 10 meters long, and it extends 10 cubits or 5 meters out from the front wall of the temple.

Solomon directs his workmen to make openings in the walls of the temple. We are not sure exactly how these openings looked. These openings may have been decorative windows in the walls of the temple. These openings

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were probably wider on the inside than they were on the outside, and people may have made these openings to let smoke out of the main hall of the temple. The openings probably did not allow much light to enter the temple.

Solomon builds another structure against the outside of the walls of the main room and the inner sanctuary of the temple that goes along the sides and the rear of the temple. This outside structure contains small rooms. The workmen build the rooms on three levels. Some rooms are on the bottom level, which is 5 cubits or 2.5 meters wide. Some rooms are above the bottom level, and this middle level is 6 cubits or 3 meters wide. Some more rooms are on the top level, and this top level is 7 cubits or 3.5 meters wide. We do not know exactly how many rooms are in this structure that is separate from the temple.

Stop here and look at pictures of what the temple may have looked like, including the portico and the connected structure with rooms. Discuss as a group: What do places for worship look like in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Solomon builds ledges for support around the sides of the outer temple walls. Solomon does this so he will not have to insert any support beams into the walls of the temple. The support beams lay on the ledges. Solomon builds the temple with blocks of stone that workers had prepared at the quarry or deep pit where the workers found them. But at the place where Solomon builds the temple, no one hears noise from tools like a hammer, chisel, or other iron tools. A hammer is a tool people use to break things or hit nails. People used a hammer and a chisel together to break up and shape stone. No one hears any noise from tools at the temple during the entire time workers build the temple. When Yahweh gave Yahweh's laws to the people, Yahweh told the people that they should not use tools to shape the stones they used to build special places. Yahweh may have wanted the quiet from the lack of tools at the temple site to remind the people that the temple is holy and special.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a stone quarry, an iron hammer, and an iron chisel. Pause this audio here.

Solomon finishes the construction of the temple and uses long pieces of cedar wood for the flat roof. The kind of cedar wood Solomon used is very hard, so people use it to build structures. Solomon finishes the structure around the walls of the temple. We do not know how many rooms this structure contains, but each room or each level is about 5 cubits or 2.5 meters high from floor to ceiling. Planks or boards that people made of cedar wood connect these rooms to the temple.

Then Solomon hears a message from Yahweh. This message probably comes through a prophet whose name we do not know. This message is about the temple Solomon is building. Yahweh tells Solomon to obey all the laws and directions Yahweh has given. If Solomon lives this way, Yahweh will do what Yahweh promised to David, Solomon's father. Yahweh will live among the people of Israel in the temple, and Yahweh will never leave the people. Yahweh reminds Solomon [of the true significance of the temple. It is like a fulfillment of the promise Yahweh made to his people when he rescued them from Egypt and promised to live with them in the land Yahweh would give them. That is why this part of the story starts with the storyteller reminding us of the Israelites' journey from Egypt and ends by reminding us that Yahweh can now live with his people.]{.mark}

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller begins his story of when Solomon built the temple.

In the second scene: Solomon describes the length and width of the temple. Solomon builds the temple 60 cubits long, 20 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high, and the portico that stretches in the front extends out 10 cubits from the temple wall. Solomon also cuts openings like windows in the walls of the temple and builds a separate structure with three levels around the walls of the temple. The bottom level is 5 cubits wide, the middle level

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is 6 cubits wide, and the top level is 7 cubits wide. Wooden beams lay on the ledges of the temple walls and connect the temple to the other structure.

In the third scene: Solomon cuts the stones for the temple at another place, and no one hears the noise of any metal tools at the site of the temple.

In the fourth scene: Solomon describes the height and appearance of the separate structure. People enter the separate structure on the south side of the temple. The side rooms in the outside structure are 5 cubits high. Solomon connects this structure to the temple with wooden beams that people make out of cedar To complete the temple and the outside structure, Solomon uses long flat pieces of cedar wood to build the roof.

In the fifth scene: Yahweh gives Solomon a message that if Solomon obeys Yahweh's laws and commands, Yahweh will keep Yahweh's promise to King David. Yahweh will live in the temple and be with the people of Israel forever.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- People of Israel
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, when Solomon has been king of Israel for four years, Solomon starts to build a house or temple for Yahweh. This temple will be a place for the people of Israel to worship Yahweh. People begin to construct the temple in the spring during the month of Ziv, which is the second month of Israel's year. The storyteller says it has been 480 years since the people of Israel left the land of Egypt.

The connection between the time Yahweh rescued the Israelites from Egypt and the time Solomon begins to build the temple lets the people of Israel know that both events are very important. Yahweh promised that Yahweh would lead the people of Israel to the land Yahweh promised them, and the people would live in the land with Yahweh forever. When Solomon builds a permanent temple to worship Yahweh, the people of Israel can remember that Yahweh keeps Yahweh's promise to live with the people in the land.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do people in your culture remember when significant events happen? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Solomon instructs workers to build the temple. Even though the storyteller talks about how Solomon himself builds and decorates the temple, we know this means workers build and decorate the temple. The storyteller begins to talk about the width and length of the temple building. The temple Solomon begins to build is 60 cubits long, 20 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high. A cubit is a way to measure how long something is. Solomon builds a portico or porch at the front of the temple. This portico is as wide as the rest of the temple, and it extends 10 cubits from the temple. Solomon cuts openings in the walls of the temple. These openings are like windows, but we are not sure exactly how they looked. Workers probably cut these openings into the top part of the temple walls. The openings were not very wide, and they may have had frames or decorations around them. The openings did not have any glass in them.

Next, the storyteller describes the width of the separate structure around the temple. Solomon builds another structure against the outside walls of the temple that contains three levels with small rooms on each level. Solomon puts the window openings above these three levels in the wall of the temple. The lowest level is 5 cubits wide, the middle level is 6 cubits wide, and the top level is 7 cubits wide. Because we are not sure what shape these rooms may have been, they may have hung over one another so that the structure appeared to get wider from the bottom to the top level. Or, the rooms may have looked like stairs so that the wall appeared to get narrower from the bottom to the top level. Solomon cuts ledges into the walls of the temple. The wooden beams that support the outside structure sit on the ledges so that none of the wooden beams go into the walls of the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Look at pictures or diagrams of how the temple may have looked. How will you describe the measurements and layout of the temple in a way that people in your culture can understand? Pause this audio here.

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In the third scene, [workers cut all of the rocks they will use to build the temple so that the rocks will fit together tightly to make a strong, square building. Solomon has the workers cut the rocks at the quarry or mine so that no one hears any noise of iron tools, like a hammer or chisel, at the place where they build the temple.]{.mark} During the whole time Solomon builds the temple, no one hears noise from metal tools.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller talks more about the separate structure around the temple. Solomon puts the door to enter the rooms in the lowest level of the outside structure on the south side of the temple. The front of the temple faces east, and the rear of the temple faces west. Solomon builds a stairway for people to go up to the rooms on the middle and top levels. We do not know exactly how the stairway looked, but it may have been in the shape of a spiral.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a winding stairway. Pause this audio here

Then the storyteller talks about the height of the temple and its roof. Solomon completes the temple and puts a roof of wooden planks on the top. Solomon makes this roof of cedar wood, and it is probably flat. The outside structure Solomon builds has rooms or levels that are 5 cubits high. We do not know exactly how people use these rooms, but temple workers probably use some of them for storage. Wooden beams connect the structure with the rooms to the temple.

In the fifth scene, Solomon hears the word of Yahweh. Yahweh probably speaks to Solomon through a prophet. Prophets often used the phrase “word of Yahweh” to show people that they spoke words that came directly from Yahweh. Yahweh tells Solomon, “I want to say something to you about this temple you are building. You must obey all the laws and directions I have given you.” In the Bible, when storytellers use statutes, ordinances, and commands together, we can simply say that these are Yahweh’s laws and directions. Solomon should obey all that Yahweh says. Yahweh continues to tell Solomon, “If you live this way, I will do for you what I promised King David, your father. I will live here among my people, the people of Israel. I will not abandon them.”

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- People of Israel
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

During the fourth year of Solomon’s reign, in the mid-spring month of Ziv, Solomon begins to build the temple. Four hundred and eighty years have passed since the Israelites left Egypt. The temple is 60 cubits long, 20 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high. The portico that stretches across the width of the temple in the front extends out 10

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cubits from the front of the temple. Solomon also cuts openings like windows in the walls of the temple and builds a separate structure around the walls of the temple. This separate structure has three levels. The bottom level is 5 cubits wide, the middle level is 6 cubits wide, and the top level is 7 cubits wide. Wooden beams lay on the ledges of the temple walls and connect the temple to the other structure.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I rejoice because I can build a permanent house where we can worship Yahweh; or
- I feel proud because I can build the temple out of all the materials my father, David, collected.

Continue the drama.

Workers cut the stones for the temple at another place, and no one hears the noise of any metal tools at the site of the temple. On the south side of the temple, Solomon makes a way to enter the separate structure that is outside the temple walls. From there, people can use a stairway to go up to the rooms in the middle and top levels. Solomon completes the side rooms in the outside structure, and each room is 5 cubits high. The workers connect this structure to the temple with beams they make from cedar wood. To complete the temple and the outside structure, Solomon uses long, flat pieces of cedar wood to build the roof.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We feel happy that our hard work has made a place for us to worship Yahweh; or
- We feel amazed that we can build the temple that Yahweh promised King David.

Continue the drama.

Yahweh delivers a message to Solomon. Yahweh tells Solomon, "I want to say something to you about this temple you are building. You must obey all the laws and directions I have given you. If you live this way, I will do for you what I promised King David, your father. I will live here among my people, the people of Israel. I will not leave them."

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel pleased that Solomon has built this temple for me; or
- I feel hopeful that Solomon and the people of Israel will obey my commands so I can live in this temple with my people, Israel.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Stop here and listen again as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 3:1–14, where we hear this same information, listen to your translation of that passage as a group. Pause this audio here.

When Solomon had been **king** over **Israel** for four years, in the springtime month of Ziv, which is the second month of the year in Israel, Solomon began to build the **temple**. Israel is the name of the territory where the Israelites lived. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a region or a country. The temple is the place where the Israelites worshiped Yahweh. People also call the temple "the house of Yahweh." For more information on Israel, king, and temple, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Israel, king, and temple as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of what the temple may have looked like as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon builds the temple for **Yahweh**. Yahweh is a name God gives himself. This name reminds people of the covenant or special promise God made to the Israelites. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

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The temple Solomon builds is 60 cubits long, 20 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high. A cubit is a way to measure how long something is. One cubit is about as long as a man's arm from his elbow to his fingertips, which is about 50 centimeters.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cubit**. Look up cubit in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The portico or entry room for the temple is 20 cubits wide, and it extends out 10 cubits from the front of the temple. A portico, which people sometimes call a porch, is part of a structure that has columns instead of walls to hold up the roof. Solomon cuts out narrow windows in the temple walls. Solomon then builds a structure around the outside of the temple walls. This structure has many small rooms in it.

Stop here and look at a picture of a portico and a picture of what the separate structure around the temple may have looked like. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **portico**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Workers shape the stones they will use to build the temple at the **quarry**. A quarry is usually a large, deep pit where workers take out stone. We know from previous stories that these quarries may have been in the hills of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for quarry that you have used in the previous passages.

At the place where the workmen build the temple, no one uses metal tools such as a hammer or chisel, so no one hears the noise of iron tools at the place where people build the temple. A hammer is a tool with a wooden handle and a metal end that people use to break things or to hit nails. People use a hammer and a chisel together to break up and shape stone. People probably made these tools out of iron.

Stop here and look at a picture of a hammer and a chisel. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **hammer** and **chisel**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that Solomon built the separate structure around the outside of the main room and the inner room, or sanctuary of the temple. The sanctuary is another word for the Most Holy Place, or the innermost room in the temple where the priests kept the ark of the covenant.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sanctuary**. Refer to sanctuary in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The entrance to the structure with the rooms is on the south side of the temple. From that entrance, a person can go up a stairway to the middle level or to the top level. This is probably a winding stairway, which winds around a central post or column, so the stairs look like a spiral.

Stop here and look at a picture of a winding stairway. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **stairway**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon completes the temple with a flat roof that people make with wooden planks. Then the **word** of Yahweh, or a message from Yahweh, comes to Solomon. Use the same word or phrase for "word" of Yahweh that you have used previously, and refer to "word" in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh tells Solomon to obey all of Yahweh's statutes, ordinances, and commands. For more information on statutes, ordinances, and commands, refer to the Master Glossary. Remember that when a storyteller uses these words together, you may simply say that Yahweh tells Solomon to obey all of "Yahweh's laws and instructions."

Stop here and decide as a group if you will use the three words for **statutes**, **ordinances**, and **commands**, or if you will simply say "Yahweh's laws and instructions."

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (489 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (1.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (721 KB)

1 Kings 6:14–38

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 6:14–38 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:14–38 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:14–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, Solomon began to make his workers build the temple for Yahweh. You will remember that, even though the storyteller says Solomon built the temple, we know Solomon directed many people to

help build Yahweh's temple. Solomon used stone to build the temple walls and the structure around the temple. Yahweh then told Solomon that if Solomon obeyed Yahweh's commands, Yahweh would live among the people of Israel forever.

In this passage, you will hear more details about how Solomon builds and finishes the inside of the temple.

Stop here and listen as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 3:1–14, where we hear this same information, listen to your translation of that passage as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon covers the inside of the temple walls with flat wooden boards that people made from cedar trees. These boards cover the walls from the floor to the ceiling. Solomon also covers the floor with wooden boards that people made from cypress trees. People used cedar and something like cypress wood together to make expensive and special things. Solomon uses the best materials to show how much Solomon loves Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of cypress and cedar trees as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon takes more cedar boards and makes a wall on the inside of the temple to create a separate room at the back of the temple. Solomon places this wall 20 cubits from the back wall of the temple. You will remember from previous passages that people used cubits to measure length, and a cubit measures the distance between a man's elbow and the tips of his fingers, or about 50 centimeters. Solomon uses this inside wall to create an inner special room that people call the inner sanctuary, or the Most Holy Place. The main hall of the temple, however, measures 40 cubits or about 20 meters long.

Stop here as a group and look at a diagram of the temple that includes the main hall and the Most Holy Place. Pause this audio here.

Cedar wood covers the inside of the entire temple, including the main hall and the Most Holy Place. Craftsmen carve pictures of gourd vines and flower blossoms into the wood. A gourd vine grows fruit that looks like a type of melon. People used carvings of gourds and flower blossoms to make things beautiful during the time Solomon built the temple. People seemed to especially like using gourds and flower blossoms for holy areas. Because cedar wood covers the stone blocks Solomon used to build the temple, no one can see any stone anywhere inside the temple.

Stop here and look at a picture of a gourd vine and flower blossom that people carved in wood as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon prepares the Most Holy Place in the temple. Solomon will put the ark of the covenant in the Most Holy Place. The ark of the covenant represents the presence of Yahweh and contains the tablets with Yahweh's law. The Most Holy Place measures 20 cubits or 10 meters long, 20 cubits or 10 meters wide, and 20 cubits or 10 meters high. We know from another passage in the Bible that the temple is 30 cubits high, so the Most Holy Place may have been higher up with stairs going up to it, or Solomon's workers may have left an open space above the Most Holy Place that was not part of the Most Holy Place. Solomon covers the inside walls of the Most Holy Place with good-quality gold. Solomon also covers the altar that people made of cedar with gold. Priests use the altar to burn incense, and they set the altar in the main hall, right outside the Most Holy Place.

Stop here and look at a picture of the ark of the covenant as a group. Look at a picture of gold metal. Pause this audio here.

Solomon also covers all the inside walls in the main hall of the temple with gold. Solomon places gold chains across the wall in front of the Most Holy Place. People use links of metal that they connect together to make chains. Solomon may have used these chains to hang a curtain. Solomon uses gold to cover the entire inside of the temple, which includes the main hall and the Most Holy Place.

Solomon carves two statues of cherubs out of olive wood for the Most Holy Place. You will remember from the previous passage that a cherub is a type of angel, and more than one cherub is cherubim. The cherubs may have guarded the ark because it was a special holy place, or they may represent Yahweh's throne. Solomon makes each cherub 10 cubits or 5 meters high. The first cherub has two wings that are each 5 cubits or 2.5 meters long, so the distance between the tips of the 2 wings is 10 cubits or 5 meters. The second cherub's wings are also 10 cubits long because the cherubs are the same size and shape. One cherub's wing tip touches one wall, and the other cherub's wing tip touches the opposite wall. The wings of the cherubim touch in the middle of the Most

Holy Place. Solomon places the cherubim on the ground inside the Most Holy Place with their wings spread out. We know from another passage in the Bible that the cherubim face out, towards the main hall of the temple. Solomon will put the ark of the covenant under the cherubim's wings. Solomon covers the cherubim with gold.

Solomon decorates the walls in the Most Holy Place and the main hall in the temple with cherubs, palm trees, and flower blossoms. Solomon also covers the floor of the entire inside of the temple with gold.

Stop here and look at a picture of cherubim as a group. Look at a picture of a palm tree that people carved into wood. Pause this audio here.

In the doorway to the Most Holy Place, Solomon places double doors that people have made from wood from an olive tree. Solomon probably makes two doors that each open in the same direction, so the doorway can be wider than a single door. We are not sure if the doorway stretches over one-fifth of the wall to the Most Holy Place or if the doors had five sections. Solomon decorates the doors with carvings of cherubs, palm trees, and flower blossoms. Then, Solomon covers the carvings with a layer of gold. From another passage in the Bible, we know Solomon also places a curtain in the doorway to the Most Holy Place. The curtain may have remained over the entrance even when someone opened the doors so that no one could see into the Most Holy Place. Because Yahweh lives in the Most Holy Place, no one could enter or even look inside it. Only the high priest could go into the presence of Yahweh in the Most Holy Place, and the high priest only entered one time per year.

In the same way, Solomon puts double doors in the entrance to the temple. Solomon makes door frames out of wood from an olive tree. We are not sure if the doorway is one-fourth as wide as the whole temple or if Solomon makes double doors with four sections. Solomon makes the doors out of wood from a cypress tree. Each door probably has two sections that turn on hinges. Solomon decorates the sections with carvings of cherubim, palm trees, and flower blossoms and spreads gold over the carvings.

Now the storyteller talks more about the outside of the temple. Solomon makes the inner courtyard wall with rows of cut stone and cedar wood. Solomon also builds walls all the way around an open area just outside the temple. Solomon makes the walls out of three layers of cut stone, followed by a row of wooden beams that people make from cedar. We do not know how thick the wall is. Solomon may use this pattern because it makes the walls strong enough to survive an earthquake.

Solomon built the foundation for Yahweh's house during the fourth year that Solomon was king over Israel. Solomon began to build the temple during the month called Ziv, which is the second month of the year in Israel. When Solomon had been king over Israel for 11 years, Solomon completed the temple during the month of Bul, the eighth month of the year in Israel. Solomon's workers completed the temple exactly the way Solomon planned. Solomon actually took seven years and six months to completely build Yahweh's temple, but the storyteller shortens that number to seven years because the number seven represents wholeness or completion.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:14–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Solomon finishes building the temple. Solomon covers the entire inside of the temple with wooden cedar boards and uses wooden cypress boards to cover the floor. Solomon builds a wall to separate the main hall from the Most Holy Place. Solomon covers all the stone in the temple with wood.

In the second scene: Solomon prepares the Most Holy Place. Solomon covers the Most Holy Place and the incense altar with gold and puts gold chains across the doorway. Solomon puts two cherubim in the Most Holy Place and covers them with gold. Solomon decorates the wall with carvings, covers the carvings with gold, and makes double doors that he covers with gold for the doorway.

In the third scene: Solomon makes double doors for the entrance to the temple and covers them with gold. Solomon decorates the doors with carvings. Solomon builds the walls of the inner courtyard.

In the fourth scene: Solomon takes seven years to build the temple.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Workers
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Solomon builds and finishes the temple. Like the previous passage, the storyteller says Solomon does the work to build the temple, but the storyteller means that Solomon directs other people to do the work. Many workers help to build the temple of Yahweh.

Stop here and review as a group: For the previous passage, how did you help your audience understand that Solomon did not build the temple by himself? How will you do the same thing in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Solomon covers the stone on the inside of the temple walls with wooden boards that people make from cedar wood. Solomon covers the whole inside of the temple, from the floor to the ceiling, with cedar boards. Solomon covers every part of the walls inside the temple with cedar boards. Solomon covers the floor of the temple with boards that people make from cypress wood. Cedar trees and cypress trees look similar, and both trees have a pleasant smell. Solomon uses cedar boards to create a wall towards the back of the temple, 20 cubits from the back wall of the temple. This wall creates an inner sanctuary that Solomon calls the Most Holy Place. The main hall of the temple is 40 cubits long, and the Most Holy Place is 20 cubits long. Solomon uses cedar boards to cover the entire inside of the temple and carves pictures of gourds and flower blossoms into the wood of the walls. Solomon uses so much cedar wood that no one can see any stone on the inside of the temple because the wood covers all the stone.

In the second scene, Solomon prepares the Most Holy Place. Solomon will put the ark of the covenant in the Most Holy Place. The Most Holy Place is 20 cubits long, 20 cubits wide, and 20 cubits high. Solomon covers the inside of the Most Holy Place completely with high-quality gold. Solomon also covers the altar that sits right outside the Most Holy Place with gold. Solomon covers the whole inside of the temple, the main hall and the Most Holy Place, with gold. Solomon also puts gold chains across the doorway to the Most Holy Place.

Solomon makes two cherubim out of olive wood for the Most Holy Place. Each cherub is 10 cubits high, and each cherub has two wings. Each wing measures 5 cubits long, so both wings together measure 10 cubits. Solomon makes the cherubs exactly the same in size and in shape. Solomon places the cherubim inside the Most Holy Place with their wings stretched out. We know from another passage that the cherubim faced out towards the main hall of the temple. The cherubim's wings touch opposite walls, and the wings touch each other in the middle of the Most Holy Place. Solomon also covers the cherubim with gold.

Solomon carves pictures of cherubim, palm trees, and flower blossoms on all the walls inside the temple. Gold covers the walls and the floor of every part of the inside of the temple. Solomon makes double doors out of olive wood for the Most Holy Place. In the original language, we are not sure if the storyteller says these doors stretch across one-fifth of the wall to the Most Holy Place or if the doors contain five sections. Craftsmen carve pictures of cherubim, palm trees, and flower blossoms on the doors and cover the doors with gold.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What kinds of designs do you use to decorate the most important religious or holy items in your culture? How will you describe the designs Solomon used to decorate the inside of the temple? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Solomon makes double doors for the doorway that leads people from the outside into the main hall of the temple. Solomon makes these doors in the same way he made doors for the entrance to the Most Holy Place. In the original language, we are not sure if the storyteller says these doors measure one-fourth of the width of the whole temple, or if the doors contain four sections. Solomon makes the door frames out of olive wood, and Solomon uses cypress wood to make the doors. The doors turn on hinges. Solomon carves cherubim, palm trees, and flower blossoms into the doors and covers the carvings with an even layer of gold.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What words will you use to describe the different doors Solomon uses in the temple? Pause this audio here.

Solomon builds an inner court in front of the temple with walls that workers make out of one layer of cedar beams for every three layers of stone.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller says that Solomon laid the foundation for the temple during the fourth year of Solomon's reign as king. This happened during Ziv, which is the second month of the year in Israel. In the 11th year of Solomon's reign, Solomon finished building the temple. Solomon finished during the month of Bul, which is the eighth month of the year in Israel. Solomon built the temple exactly as he had decided to build it, and Solomon took seven years to complete it.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:14–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Workers
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Solomon finishes building the temple. Solomon uses boards of cedar wood to cover the inside walls of the temple, and Solomon uses boards of cypress wood to cover the floors. Solomon makes a wall inside the temple to separate the main hall from the Most Holy Place. Solomon covers the cedar boards with carvings of gourds and flower blossoms. No one can see any stone inside the temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy that I can make the inside of the temple so beautiful; or
- I feel certain that Yahweh will like the temple I directed workers to build.

Continue the drama.

Solomon prepares the Most Holy Place, where Solomon will place the Ark of the Covenant. The Most Holy Place is 20 cubits wide, 20 cubits long, and 20 cubits high. Solomon covers the inside of the Most Holy Place with high-quality gold. Solomon also covers the altar for burning incense with gold. Solomon puts chains of gold across the entrance to the Most Holy Place.

Solomon makes two cherubim out of olive wood to put in the Most Holy Place, and Solomon covers the cherubim with gold. The cherubim's wings touch the opposite walls, and their wings touch each other in the middle of the Most Holy Place. The cherubim are the same in size and shape. Solomon carves pictures of more cherubim, palm trees, and flower blossoms on each wall and covers the carvings with gold. Solomon makes double doors for the doorway to the Most Holy Place, and Solomon covers the doors with gold.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the workers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We feel pleased to be able to use our skills in carving wood and laying gold to create a beautiful place for Yahweh; or
- We rejoice that Solomon wants to honor Yahweh with a permanent temple.

Continue the drama.

Solomon makes double doors for the entrance to the temple and covers the doors with gold. Solomon decorates the doors with carvings of cherubim, palm trees, and flower blossoms and covers the decorations with gold. Solomon builds the walls of the inner courtyard out of a layer of cedar beams, followed by three layers of stone. Solomon began to build the temple during the fourth year of his reign, during Israel's second month of Ziv. Solomon finished building the temple in the 11th year of his reign during Israel's eighth month of Bul. Solomon took seven years to build the temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy that Solomon directs the people of Israel to honor me with such a beautiful structure; or
- I feel confident that the people of Israel will remember me and obey me when they worship in this temple.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 6:14–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Stop here and listen again as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 3:1–14, where we hear this same information, listen to your translation of that passage again. Pause this audio here.

Solomon finishes building the **temple** for **Yahweh**. The temple is the place where the Israelites worshiped God. Yahweh is the name that God gives himself, and it reminds people of the covenant God made with the people of Israel. Use the same words or phrases for temple and Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on temple and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Solomon covers the entire inside walls of the temple with boards of cedar wood, and Solomon uses boards of cypress wood to cover the floors. Solomon measures off 20 **cubits** at the back of the main hall and makes a wall between that space and the main hall. People used cubits to measure length, and a cubit measures about 50 centimeters. Use the same word or phrase for cubit as you used in previous passages. For more information on cubit, refer to the Master Glossary.

This wall separates the main hall from the inner "sanctuary" or Most Holy Place. The sanctuary means "a holy place," and people can use this word to mean either the Most Holy Place or the entire temple building itself. In this case, the inner sanctuary is another way to say the Most Holy Place, and the storyteller uses both the words "inner sanctuary" and "Most Holy Place" to describe the place where Yahweh lived in the temple. The Most Holy Place is the holiest place in the temple, and it is where Solomon placed the ark of the covenant.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that Solomon built a wall to separate the main hall from the **sanctuary**, the **Most Holy Place**. Use the same words or phrases for sanctuary and Most Holy Place as you used in previous passages or in previous books of the Bible. For more information on "sanctuary" and "Most Holy Place," refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

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Solomon covers the cedar boards with carvings of gourds and flower blossoms, and no one can see any of the stones under the cedar boards. Solomon prepares to put the **ark of the covenant** inside the Most Holy Place. The ark refers to the box Moses made that contains God's law. The Israelites also believed that God lived above the ark. Use the same word or phrase for "ark of the covenant" that you used in previous passages. For more information on the ark of the covenant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and look at a picture of the ark of the covenant as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon covers the entire inside of the temple with **gold**, including the walls of the main hall and the Most Holy Place. Solomon also covers the altar of incense, which sits right outside the Most Holy Place, with gold. Gold is a yellow precious metal that is very expensive. Use the same word or phrase for gold as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of gold metal as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon makes two identical cherubs out of olive wood and covers them with gold. A cherub is a type of angel who guards holy spaces. When there is more than one cherub, people call this "cherubim."

Stop here and look at a picture of cherubim as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cherubim**. Use the same words or phrases for cherubim as you used in previous books of the Bible. For more information on cherubim, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Solomon makes double doors for the entrance to the Most Holy Place and for the entrance to the temple. Solomon covers the doors with carvings of cherubim, palm trees, and flower blossoms, and Solomon covers the doors evenly with gold. Double doors refer to a pair of doors that open on hinges and create a larger opening for a room.

Stop here and look at a picture of double doors as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss what word or phrase you will use for **double doors**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon builds an inner courtyard wall with layers of cedar beams and stone, and Solomon finishes the temple. A courtyard is the open area around the temple building, so the wall surrounds the courtyard.

Stop here and discuss what word or phrase you will use for **courtyard**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon built the **foundation** of the temple in the fourth year of his reign, and Solomon finished in the 11th year of his reign. Solomon took seven years to complete the temple. Use the same word or phrase for foundation as you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 6:14–38

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (501 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (726 KB)

1 Kings 7:1–12

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 7:1–12 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:1–12 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, you heard a description of how Solomon ordered workers to build the inside of the temple. Even though the storyteller said Solomon built the temple, we know that Solomon directed many workers to help build Yahweh's temple. Solomon built the main hall and the Most Holy Place and covered all of the inside of the temple with gold. Solomon took seven years to finish building the temple for Yahweh.

In this passage, however, Solomon builds a palace complex south of the temple. People build a palace, or a large home, for important people or rulers. The palace complex contains Solomon's home along with four other buildings. Solomon takes 13 years to finish building the entire palace complex.

Stop here and look at a picture of a palace from the time of Solomon as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon builds the first structure and calls it the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon. Solomon probably uses this building as a large ceremonial or assembly hall, and people may gather there to see King Solomon. Solomon also may store weapons or precious objects there. Workers make this palace with four rows of columns that they make from cedar wood. A column is a round pillar that stands upright and supports the structure of a building. These columns hold up beams that people make of cedar wood. People make these horizontal wooden beams to support the weight of a structure.

1 Kings 7:1–12

Solomon probably gives the hall its name because Solomon uses cedar wood from the forest of Lebanon to build it. Phoenicia, or modern-day Lebanon, is a country located north of Israel that has many forests of cedar trees. People may have thought that the columns in this structure look like a forest. A forest is a large area of land where many trees grow close together to cover the whole area.

Stop here and look at a picture of a forest of cedar trees as a group. Look at a picture of a column. Look at a map that shows the area of Phoenicia and the forests of Lebanon. Pause this audio here.

This palace measures 100 cubits or 50 meters long, 50 cubits or 25 meters wide, and 30 cubits or 15 meters high. You will remember from previous passages that people use cubits to measure length. One cubit measures about 50 centimeters. Solomon's workers make a flat roof by placing cedar planks over the cedar beams that sit on top of the columns. The cedar beams that rest on the columns help to support or hold up the roof. Solomon uses 45 beams, and Solomon puts 15 beams in each row.

The workers build the main hall for the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon with window openings for light. Solomon arranges these windows in three rows high up on opposite walls. All the door openings have frames with four sides. Solomon probably places the door frames in the front part of the hall in three rows on opposite walls so that the doors face each other. This palace probably has three upper levels around the sides of the building.

Solomon builds another structure with a colonnade or rows of columns that support the roof. People may have called this structure the Hall of Columns. This hall measures 50 cubits or 25 meters long and 30 cubits or 15 meters wide. A covered porch goes all the way across the front of the hall, and columns support the covering of the porch. We do not know how tall this hall is. We are not sure exactly how Solomon uses this hall, but people may wait in this hall before seeing King Solomon.

Solomon also builds a hall for his throne. A throne is a ceremonial chair for a king or ruler. Solomon plans to sit in this hall and judge the people of Israel. When a person judges, that person decides if the actions that another person does are right or wrong. Solomon probably listens when people in his kingdom have a disagreement that no one else can resolve, and then Solomon decides who is right. Solomon calls this hall the Hall of Justice. Solomon covers this entire hall, from the floor to the ceiling, with boards of cedar wood. The storyteller does not give measurements for this hall.

Solomon probably builds his own home, where he actually lives, in a courtyard behind the Hall of Justice. Solomon builds his home in a similar way to the Hall of Justice. Solomon builds another palace that looks like his own home for the daughter of Pharaoh. Pharaoh's daughter was one of Solomon's wives. You may remember from a previous passage that Pharaoh was a title people used for the king of the country of Egypt. Because the storyteller gives no description, we do not know how Solomon's house looked or how the house for Pharaoh's daughter looked.

Solomon builds all these buildings, from the outside hall to the large courtyard, and from the floors to the ceilings, with high-quality, or very strong, stone blocks. Solomon probably uses limestone, a white-colored stone that people find in Israel. Workers cut these stone blocks carefully and smooth all their edges. Solomon lays the foundation for the buildings with large, high-quality stones. These stones measure 8 to 9 cubits or 4 to 5 meters across. On top of these foundation stones, Solomon places high-quality stones that people cut to the correct size for walls. Solomon also uses rows of cedar wood for the walls. These may be cedar beams, or they may be pieces of cedar wood that lie over the walls.

Solomon constructs the walls for the large courtyard around his house with a pattern of three rows of stone blocks followed by one row of cedar beams. Solomon had constructed the inside courtyard for the temple and the portico in a similar way. Solomon probably uses this method of construction for the walls because it makes the walls strong.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

1 Kings 7:1–12

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Solomon takes 13 years to build a palace complex for himself. First, Solomon builds the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon. The palace has rows of columns and a roof of cedar wood. The palace has windows and doors in rows of three that face each other.

In the second scene: Solomon builds a hall with rows of columns and a portico in front of it. Solomon builds the Hall of Justice. Solomon sits on his throne in this hall and judges the people of Israel. Solomon builds a home for himself and a home for his wife, the daughter of the Pharaoh.

In the third scene: Solomon uses large blocks of high-quality stone to build each structure. Workers cut and smooth each stone. Solomon also uses cedar beams to build each structure. Solomon builds a large courtyard around his house with one layer of cedar beams and three layers of cut stone, just like Solomon built the wall for the courtyard of Yahweh's temple.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Workers
- Pharaoh
- Pharaoh's daughter
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller interrupts his explanation of how Solomon builds the temple to talk about Solomon's palace complex. You will remember from previous passages that even though the storyteller says Solomon builds, Solomon tells workers to build structures for the temple and for his palace. After this passage, the storyteller will continue to talk about how Solomon builds and furnishes the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story, but in the middle of your story, tell a different story. Then go back to finish your original story. How do you help your audience understand the order and details of your stories and how they relate to one another? Pause this audio here.

Even though Solomon took seven years to build the temple for Yahweh, Solomon takes 13 years to build a palace complex for himself. Solomon probably built and completed the temple first, and then Solomon begins to build his palace. Solomon finishes building all the structures included in his palace complex after 13 years.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you help your audience understand the different lengths of time Solomon took to build Yahweh's temple and Solomon's palace? Pause this audio here.

Solomon builds the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon. This palace measures 100 cubits or 50 meters long, 50 cubits or 25 meters wide, and 30 cubits or 15 meters high. The palace has four rows of columns or pillars that workers make from cedar wood, and these columns hold up beams that the workers also make from cedar. Above the beams, Solomon makes the roof of the palace out of cedar. Although we are not sure, most likely Solomon uses 45 beams to make three rows of 15 cedar beams. Solomon places windows in three rows that face each other high up on opposite walls. Solomon makes doorways in the front part of the palace. The doorways face each other in sets of three, and each doorway has a rectangular frame.

In the second scene, Solomon builds a hall or long room with many columns in rows, called colonnades, and people may have named this hall the Hall of Columns. This hall is 50 cubits or 25 meters long and 30 cubits or 15 meters wide. Across the front of this hall, Solomon builds a portico or porch, which is like a room without walls but with columns that hold up a roof. We are not sure if this hall was the entrance to the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon or the entrance to the next building, the Hall of Justice.

Solomon puts his throne in the Hall of Justice. Solomon sits on his throne to judge the people in the Hall of Justice. Solomon covers the entire inside of the Hall of Justice, from the floor to the ceiling, with boards of cedar wood. Solomon builds his own palace, where Solomon lives, in a similar way to the Hall of Justice. Solomon also builds a palace for his wife, the daughter of the Pharaoh, in a similar way.

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Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you describe each building? What will you call each building? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Solomon constructs every building with high-quality, or very hard, stone. Solomon's workers carefully cut the stone and smooth its edges. From the outside halls to the large courtyard and from floor to ceiling, Solomon makes every structure out of this stone. Solomon uses large, high-quality stones that measure 8 to 10 cubits or 4 to 5 meters across to lay the foundations of the buildings. On top of the foundation, Solomon places more high-quality stones that workers cut to the right size to build the walls. Solomon also uses beams of cedar to make walls. People are not sure if these cedar beams overlay the stone walls or if these are ceiling beams. Scholars are not sure what the storyteller means in the original language. The large courtyard that surrounds these buildings has a wall that people make with three layers of cut stone blocks, followed by a layer of cedar beams. Solomon builds this wall in the same way Solomon built the wall in the inner courtyard and entryway of the temple.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Workers
- Pharaoh
- Pharaoh's daughter
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Solomon takes 13 years to build a palace complex for himself. The first building Solomon constructs is the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon. Solomon makes this building 100 cubits long, 50 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high. Solomon uses four rows of cedar pillars, and Solomon places cedar beams on top of the pillars. The beams help to support the roof that Solomon also makes of cedar. Solomon uses 45 beams with 15 beams in each row. Solomon builds windows in three rows that face each other, and Solomon makes rectangular door frames. Solomon puts the doors in sets of three in the front part of the palace. The doors also face each other.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that Solomon has the resources to construct a building where he rules over the people of Israel; or
- Solomon built my temple first, so I know Solomon loves and worships me; or

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- Solomon spent more time building the palace than the temple. I wonder how important I really am to Solomon; or
- I feel hopeful that Solomon will use his palace complex to serve the people of Israel well.

Continue the drama.

Solomon builds the Hall of Columns, a hall with rows of columns and with a covered porch across the front. This hall is 50 cubits long and 30 cubits wide. Then Solomon builds the Hall of Justice, where Solomon sits on his throne to judge the people of Israel. Solomon covers the entire Hall of Justice, from the floor to the ceiling, with cedar wood. Solomon builds his own palace and a palace for Solomon's wife, the Pharaoh's daughter, in a similar way.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the workers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We feel honored to help Solomon build these important buildings; or
- We believe other countries will show us respect because we have such great resources to build a beautiful temple and palace.

Continue the drama.

Solomon uses high-quality stone to construct every building in the palace complex, from the outside to the courtyard and from the bottom to the top. Workers cut these stones to size and smooth their faces and edges. Solomon uses large, high-quality stones that are 8 to 10 cubits across to build a foundation. On top of the foundation, Solomon lays high-quality stones that workers cut to the right size for windows and cedar beams. Solomon surrounds the large courtyard with a wall that people make from three layers of cut stone and one layer of cedar beams. Solomon had also built the wall for the inner courtyard of the temple in the same way.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I rejoice in the beauty of my palace; or
- I feel confident that the people of Israel will respect me even more when they see my beautiful palace next to the temple I built.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Solomon took 13 years to completely build his **palace**. In the original language, the storyteller says Solomon built "Solomon's own house," but we know it was a special house for kings. A palace is a large house for a king or other important ruler. Solomon constructed his palace and four other buildings to create a palace complex. Use the same word or phrase for palace as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a palace in the same area and time as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon built the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon. A forest is a large area of land where many trees grow close together to cover the whole area.

Stop here and look at a picture of a forest of cedar trees. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **forest**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Palace of the Forest of Lebanon was 100 **cubits** long, 50 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high. People use a cubit to measure length. One cubit is the distance between a man's elbow and the tips of his fingers, or about 50 centimeters. Use the same word or phrase for cubit as you used in previous passages. For more information on cubit, refer to the Master Glossary.

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Solomon's workers built columns that they made of **cedar** in the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon and in the colonnade, which is a row of columns. A column is a pillar that stands upright. Columns are usually cylindrical in shape and sometimes support other parts of a building. Use the same words for cedar wood as you have used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **column** and for **colonnade**. Look at a picture of a column. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon built a **portico** in front of the colonnade. A portico is an open structure with no walls and with columns that support a roof. Use the same word or phrase for portico as you used in previous passages.

Solomon placed his **throne** in the Hall of Justice. A throne is a ceremonial chair for a king. Use the same word or phrase for throne as you used in previous passages.

Solomon would **judge**, or make decisions about what was right or wrong, in the Hall of **Justice**. Solomon called it the Hall of Justice because that is the place where he would judge or make decisions fairly. Use the same words for justice and for judge as you have used in previous passages. Refer to justice and judge in the Master Glossary for more information.

Solomon made a palace for himself and a palace for his wife, the daughter of **Pharaoh**. Pharaoh is what people called the king of the country called Egypt. Use the same word or phrase for Pharaoh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Pharaoh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Solomon used high-quality, or very hard, stone to build every structure, from the **foundation** to the eaves, or the top of the roof. Use the same word or phrase for foundation as you have used in previous passages.

Solomon built the wall around the large **courtyard** out of layers of cut stone and cedar beams. Solomon built this wall in a similar way to the way he built the wall around the inner courtyard of the temple of Yahweh. Use the same word for courtyard that you have used in previous passages.

The **temple** is the place where the Israelites worshiped God. **Yahweh** is God's personal name for himself. Use the same words or phrases for temple and for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on temple and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 7:1–12

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (520 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (725 KB)

1 Kings 7:13–22

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 7:13–22 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:13–22 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:13–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the storyteller interrupted the details about how Solomon built the temple to talk about Solomon's palace complex. Solomon built five buildings south of the temple, including the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon, a Hall of Columns, the Hall of Justice, a palace for Solomon, and a palace for the daughter of Pharaoh, who was Solomon's wife.

In this passage, the storyteller returns to talking about how Solomon builds and furnishes the temple. King Solomon sends a message to the city of Tyre, a city on the coast of the Mediterranean Sea. Solomon wants a man named Huram to help Solomon with the temple. In some translations, people call this man "Hiram," but this is not the same Hiram who is the king of Tyre. Huram's mother came from the Israelite tribe of Naphtali, but Huram's father had died. Huram's father had lived in Tyre and had been a craftsman who used bronze. Bronze is a metal that people make from copper and tin. Huram is a very skilled craftsman who works with bronze. Huram has lots of experience creating different types of objects from bronze. Huram travels from Tyre to Jerusalem and comes to work for Solomon. Huram completes every task that Solomon gives Huram.

Stop here and listen as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 3:15–17, which contains the same information, listen to your version of that passage now. Pause this audio here.

Look at a map that includes the cities of Tyre and Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

Huram casts two bronze pillars. First, Huram heats copper and tin in a fire until it becomes so hot that it melts together to become bronze. Then Huram pours this hot liquid bronze into a mold or a shape of the pillar that people had dug into the ground. Then Huram waits for the bronze to cool down so that it hardens into the final shape of the pillar. Each pillar is 18 cubits or 9 meters high and 12 cubits or 6 meters around. You will remember from previous passages that a person uses a cubit to describe the length of an object, and a cubit measures

1 Kings 7:13–22

about 50 centimeters. These pillars probably stood alone and did not support any part of the temple walls or roof. From another passage in the Bible, we know that these pillars are probably hollow or empty on the inside, and that the walls of these pillars that Huram makes from bronze metal are about four fingers thick. During this time, people used fingers to measure objects. Four fingers are about the width of a hand, or about 7.5 to 8 centimeters.

Stop here and look at a picture of bronze metal as a group. Pause this audio here.

Huram creates two capitals or tops to sit on top of each pillar. Huram makes these capitals out of bronze as well. Each capital measures 5 cubits or 2.5 meters tall. Huram hangs seven bronze chains on each capital for decoration. These chains may look like braids of metal that Huram twists together. Huram creates bronze objects that he shapes to look like pomegranate fruit. Pomegranates are reddish fruits about the size of a human fist. Huram puts these bronze objects in two rows around the chains to decorate each of the capitals.

Now, the storyteller gives more details about how Huram decorates the two large pillars. Huram molds the capitals or tops of each pillar in the shape of a lily flower. A lily is a red or white flower with four large petals. Each capital may look like a bronze bowl with bronze petals like a flower, or Huram may shape the capital like a bowl and carve petals into it.

Now the storyteller says that the capitals are 4 cubits or 2 meters high. Earlier, the storyteller said the capitals are 5 cubits high. This may mean that Huram makes two capitals on top of each other, one that measures 5 cubits high and one that measures 4 cubits high. The capitals sit on top of the pillars at the entrance to the temple. On the capital of each pillar, above the bowl-shaped part next to the network of chains, Huram places 200 bronze pomegranates in rows that go around the capital. Even though the storyteller gives details about the capitals, we are still not certain exactly how the capitals looked.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a metal decorative chain or braid, a pomegranate, and a picture of lilies. Pause this audio here.

Huram places the pillars in front of the entrance to Yahweh's temple. Huram names the two pillars. Huram names the pillar on the right or south side Jakin, and Huram names the pillar on the left or north side Boaz. The temple faces to the east, so these pillars sit on each side of the entrance to the temple. The name Jakin means, "Yahweh will establish," and the name Boaz means, "in Yahweh's strength." We are not sure why Solomon asks Huram to build the pillars, but the pillars may remind the people of Yahweh, who established the throne of King David and David's descendants and whose strength causes the king to rejoice.

So, Huram completes the work on the two pillars for Solomon.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:13–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Solomon sends a message to Tyre and asks for a man named Huram to come to Jerusalem. Huram has great skill and experience in working with bronze, and Huram comes to work for King Solomon.

In the second scene: Huram casts two pillars out of bronze. Huram places capitals on top of each pillar. Huram makes both pillars the same height and width. Huram places chains and rows of bronze pomegranates on each capital for decoration. Huram shapes each capital like a lily flower. Huram names the pillar to the south Jakin, and Huram names the pillar to the north Boaz. Huram places the pillars in front of the entrance to the temple. And so Huram finishes the work on the pillars.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- The workers who helped Huram

1 Kings 7:13–22

- And Huram

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Solomon had already sent a message to Tyre. Solomon had asked a man named Huram to come and help Solomon complete the temple. Huram's mother came from the Israelite tribe of Naphtali. Huram's father, who came from Tyre, had died. Huram's father was a bronze craftsman, so Huram had great skill and knowledge about working with bronze. Huram knew how to make many objects out of bronze. Huram had agreed to help Solomon and had come to Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Solomon had already brought Huram to Jerusalem before the rest of this story happens. What words will help your audience understand that this part of the story has already happened? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Huram casts two pillars out of bronze. You will remember that people make bronze when they heat tin and copper together in a very hot fire so that it melts to create a different metal. Each pillar measures 18 cubits or 9 meters high and 12 cubits or 6 meters around. Huram makes a bronze capital for the top of each pillar. These capitals each measure 4 or 5 cubits high. On each pillar, Huram makes seven chains and weaves or braids those chains together at the top around the capital. Huram shapes the capitals like lily flowers. Huram also makes bronze objects that look like pomegranate fruit. Huram places the bronze pomegranates in two rows around each capital. Huram places 200 bronze pomegranates on each pillar on top of the bowl-shaped part and next to the network of bronze chains.

Stop here and discuss as a group: The storyteller's language can be difficult to understand or to picture because it is not very clear. How will you describe the capitals on top of the pillars in a way that your audience can understand? Pause this audio here.

Huram places each pillar with its lily-shaped capital in front of the entrance to Yahweh's temple. Huram names the pillar on the south side Jakin, which means "Yahweh will establish." Huram names the pillar on the north side Boaz, which means "in Yahweh's strength." And so Huram completes the work on the bronze pillars at the entrance to the temple.

Stop here and look at a drawing of what these pillars may have looked like as a group. Discuss what words you will use to describe the names of the pillars. How will you help your audience understand why the names of the pillars are important? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:13–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- The workers who helped Huram
- And Huram

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

1 Kings 7:13–22

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Solomon sends a message to Tyre and asks for a man named Huram to come to Jerusalem. Huram's mother comes from the tribe of Naphtali, but Huram's father, who was a craftsman who worked with bronze, has died. Huram has great skill and experience working with bronze, and Huram comes to work for King Solomon.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Huram, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored to help Solomon build a temple for Yahweh; or
- I feel surprised that Solomon would choose me to help him because my father was not born in Israel.

Continue the drama.

Huram casts two pillars out of bronze. Each pillar is 18 cubits or 9 meters high and 12 cubits or 6 meters around. Huram makes a bronze capital for the top of each pillar. These capitals each measure 4 or 5 cubits high. Huram places a network of seven woven or braided chains on each capital on top of each pillar. Huram shapes the capitals like lily flowers. Huram makes bronze objects that look like pomegranate fruit. Huram places the bronze pomegranates in two rows around each capital. Huram places 200 bronze pomegranates on each pillar on top of the bowl-shaped part and next to the network of bronze chains.

Huram places each pillar with its lily-shaped capital in front of the entrance to Yahweh's temple. Huram names the pillar on the south side Jakin, which means "Yahweh will establish." Huram names the pillar on the north side Boaz, which means "in Yahweh's strength." And so Huram completes the work on the bronze pillars at the entrance to the temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy that these pillars will remind the Israelite people how Yahweh establishes our nation and gives strength to our people; or
- I feel grateful that Huram can come to help make beautiful things in the temple.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:13–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Stop here and listen again as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 3:15–17, which contains the same information, listen to your version of that passage now. Pause this audio here.

Solomon sends a message to the city of **Tyre**. Tyre is a city in Phoenicia, a region located north of Israel on the coast of the Mediterranean Sea. Today, this area is a country called Lebanon. Look up Tyre in the Master Glossary for more information, and translate Tyre in the same way you have in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the city of Tyre. Pause this audio here.

Solomon calls Huram. Huram's mother is a widow. A widow is a woman whose husband has died.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **widow**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon wants Huram, a craftsman who is very skilled at working with **bronze**, to come help build the temple. Bronze is a metal that people make when they combine copper and tin. Use the same word or phrase for bronze as you used in previous passages. For more information on bronze, refer to the Master Glossary.

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Huram casts two bronze pillars. Huram pours liquid metal into a mold or shape of the final object Huram desires. Then Huram allows the metal to cool.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cast**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Huram molds two **pillars**, or tall vertical structures. Use the same word or phrase for pillar as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a drawing of two pillars as a group. Pause this audio here.

Each pillar was 18 **cubits** high and 12 cubits around. A person uses a cubit to describe the length of an object. A cubit measures about as long as the distance between a man's elbow and his fingertips, or 50 centimeters. Use the same word or phrase for cubit as you used in previous passages. For more information on cubit, refer to the Master Glossary.

Huram made a capital for each pillar. A "capital" is special language that refers to an object on the top of a pillar or column.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **capital**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Huram decorates the capitals with a network of chains and with rows of pomegranates. These chains probably look like bronze twisted into a decorative braid. A pomegranate is a reddish fruit that is about the size of an orange.

Stop here and look at a picture of a metal chain or braid and a picture of a pomegranate as a group. Discuss what word or phrase you will use for **chain** and for **pomegranate**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Huram shaped the capitals to look like lilies. Lilies are large red or white flowers with four petals.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lily as a group. Discuss what word or phrase you will use for **lilies**. If you have translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 7:13–22

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (531 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (1.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (748 KB)

1 Kings 7:23–39

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 7:23–39 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:23–39 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:23–39 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, Solomon had asked Huram, the craftsman from Tyre, to help with the temple. Huram cast two large bronze pillars that he placed in front of the entrance to the temple. Huram decorated the pillars with bronze pomegranates and networks of chains. Huram completed this part of the temple.

In this passage, Huram continues to make items out of bronze for the temple.

Stop here and listen as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 3:15–4:10, which contains some of the same information, listen to your translation of that passage. Pause this audio here.

Next, Huram makes a large, round bronze bowl to hold water. People call this very large bowl the Sea. The Sea measures 10 cubits or 5 meters across the top, and it is 5 cubits or 2.5 meters high. Workers use a line of string that measures 30 cubits or 15 meters to measure around the Sea. Workers often used a line that people made of string to measure the distance around an object. You will remember from previous passages that people used cubits to measure the length of an object. Under the rim or edge of the Sea, Huram places bronze decorations in the shape of small gourds. A gourd is a fruit that grows in Israel. Gourds resemble melons or pumpkins, and people cut gourds in half lengthwise and use them to dip liquids. Huram uses 10 bronze gourds for every cubit or 20 bronze gourds for every meter. Huram arranges the gourds in two rows and uses the same mold to create the Sea and the gourds all at the same time.

Stop here and look at a picture of a gourd. Pause this audio here.

The Sea rests on top of 12 statues that look like bulls. A bull is a large animal with four legs. These bulls were probably oxen, which means they had been castrated. People often used oxen to help with farming. But people also killed bulls to eat or as sacrifices in the temple. The bulls face outward or away from each other and the bowl. Three bulls face north. Three bulls face east. Three bulls face south. And three bulls face west. The Sea

sits on the flat backs of the bulls. We are not sure if Huram makes the bulls out of bronze or out of stone. The storyteller also does not tell us how big Huram makes the bulls, but we know Huram makes them big enough to support the Sea. The bulls may represent the 12 tribes of Israel.

The wall of the Sea is about a handbreadth, or four fingers thick. People used a handbreadth, or 7.5 centimeters, to measure distance. Huram makes the rim of the Sea curve outward like the rim of a cup or the petals of a lily flower. A lily is a large flower with white or red petals that curve outward. The Sea holds 2,000 baths of water. We are not sure exactly how much liquid a bath might measure, but the Sea probably holds around 40,000 liters. We know from another passage in the Bible that priests use the Sea to wash themselves.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bull. Look at a picture of a lily flower. Pause this audio here.

Next, Huram makes 10 bronze stands to hold water bowls. Each stand measures 4 cubits or 2 meters long, 4 cubits or 2 meters wide, and 3 cubits or 1.5 meters high. People can move these stands from one place to another within the temple. Huram makes each stand with bronze panels that attach to frames. The panels form the shape of a box with frames around each panel. Huram engraves figures of lions, bulls, and cherubim into the bronze panels and the frames. A lion is a large cat that eats other animals. People used lions to symbolize things like victory. A cherub is a type of angel, and cherubim are more than one cherub. Huram engraves decorative circular patterns or wreaths into the metal above and below the figures.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lion and cherubim as a group. Look at a decorative spiral pattern. Look at a picture of a stand that can move, similar to the one Huram makes. Pause this audio here.

Huram makes four bronze wheels attached to bronze axles at the bottom of each stand. The axle is a rod that goes through the center of each wheel and allows the wheel to turn. Each stand holds a water basin with four short bronze legs decorated with wreaths or circular patterns. Huram places an opening inside each frame to support a water basin. Huram makes the opening round, and the distance across the opening is 1.5 cubits or about 75 centimeters. Around the opening, Huram molds a circular frame that looks like a king's crown. This frame measures one cubit or one-half meter deep. Huram engraves designs around the crown. However, the metal panels that hold up the water basins are square, not round. Huram probably places these panels underneath the opening for the water basin.

Huram probably attaches the four wheels to the four corners of the bottom bronze panel. Then Huram attaches the axles to each stand. Each wheel measures 1.5 cubits or about 75 centimeters across. Huram builds the wheels to look like small chariot wheels. A chariot is a vehicle with two wheels that horses would pull, and people used chariots during wars. Huram makes the entire wheel, including the axles, rims, spokes, and hubs, out of bronze. The rim of a wheel is its outer edge. The spokes are rods that connect the hub, or central part of the wheel, to the rim.

Stop here and look at a picture of chariot wheels as a group. Note the axle, rim, spokes, and hub. Pause this audio here.

Huram makes a handle for each corner of each stand. Huram makes the stand and handles all at the same time from the same mold. People probably use the handles to push or pull the stands. Huram makes a circular support band for the top of each stand that measures one-half cubit or about 25 centimeters high. Huram makes the upper supports for each stand together with the panels in one piece. Huram decorates the supports and panels with figures of cherubim, lions, and palm trees. Palm trees have one large trunk with leaves that branch out on top. Huram covers every part of the stands that people can see with decorations, including wreaths. Huram creates each of the 10 stands in the same way. Huram uses the same mold for each stand, so the stands have the same size and shape.

Huram also makes 10 water basins out of bronze. Each basin holds 40 baths or about 1,000 liters of water and measures 4 cubits or 2 meters across the rim. One water basin sits on the top of each bronze stand. Huram puts five stands on the south side of the temple and five stands on the north side of the temple. Huram places the Sea on the southeast corner of the temple.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:23–39 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Huram casts the large, round bronze water tank called the Sea and decorates it with gourds. Huram places the Sea on 12 figures that look like oxen bulls. Three bulls face in each direction. The rim of the Sea flares out like a lily flower or the rim of a cup.

In the second scene: Huram also makes 10 movable bronze stands to hold water basins. Huram decorates the stands with figures of lions, bulls, cherubim, and wreaths. Huram makes four bronze wheels with axles for each stand. Huram places a round opening like a crown inside each frame to support a water basin. Huram attaches the wheels to each stand.

In the third scene: Huram places handles at the corners of each stand. Huram decorates every part of the stands with engravings and wreaths. Each stand has the same size and shape. Huram also makes 10 water basins, one for each stand. Huram places the water basins and the Sea outside the temple.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Yahweh
- The workers who help Huram
- And Huram

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Huram casts a large, round water tank out of bronze. People call the tank the Sea. The tank measures 10 cubits across from rim to rim and is 5 cubits high. Huram measures the distance around the Sea to be 30 cubits. Below the rim of the Sea, Huram casts two rows of bronze gourds. Huram places 10 gourds for every cubit around the Sea. Huram casts the Sea and the gourds all at once from the same mold.

Huram makes 12 figures of bulls. We do not know the size of the bulls, but they are large enough to support the Sea. Huram makes the bulls out of bronze or stone. Huram places the Sea on the backs of the bulls. Three bulls face in each direction, north, south, east, and west. East is the direction that the sun rises. The Sea sits on the bulls' backs. The hindquarters of the bulls all face each other. Huram makes the Sea with a rim like a cup or a lily blossom. The bronze that makes the Sea is about a handbreadth or four fingers thick. The Sea holds 2,000 baths of liquid. We do not know the exact measure of a bath, but the Sea probably holds around 40,000 liters of water.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you measure the size and shape of things in your culture? What words will help you communicate the size and shape of these objects to your audience? Pause this audio here.

Discuss as a group how you will talk about north, south, east, and west. Remember that east is the direction that the sun rises from. West is the opposite direction of east. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Huram makes 10 movable stands out of bronze. Each stand measures 4 cubits long, 4 cubits wide, and 3 cubits high. Huram uses bronze panels that he attaches to a frame, so the stand looks like a box with frames around each panel. Huram decorates each panel with figures of lions, bulls, and cherubim. Huram also decorates the frames with wreaths or circular patterns.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do people decorate important objects in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Huram puts four wheels with axles at the bottom of each stand. At each of the four corners of each stand, Huram places bronze supports like legs to hold a water basin. Huram also decorates these supports with wreaths. Huram makes an opening at the top of the frame of each cart. Huram makes the opening round, and the distance across the opening is 1.5 cubits. Around the opening, Huram molds a circular frame that looks like a crown. This frame measures one cubit deep. Huram decorates the area around the crown opening with more circular patterns. Even though the opening for the water basin is round, the metal panel that holds up the water basin is square.

Huram probably attaches the four wheels to the four corners of the bottom bronze panel. Then Huram attaches the axles to each stand. Each wheel measures 1.5 cubits across. Huram builds the wheels to look like small chariot wheels. Huram makes the entire wheel, including the axles, rims, spokes, and hubs, out of bronze.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you talk about objects that look like other objects in your culture? How will you describe an opening that looks like a crown or wheels like a chariot? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Huram makes a handle for each corner of each stand. Huram makes the stand and handles all at the same time from the same mold. Huram makes a circular support band for the top of each stand that measures one-half cubit high. Huram makes the upper supports for each stand together with the bronze panels in one piece. Huram decorates the supports and panels with figures of cherubim, lions, and palm trees. Huram covers every part of the stands that people can see with decorations that include wreaths or circular patterns. Huram creates each of the 10 stands in the same way. Huram uses the same mold for each stand, so all of the stands are the same size and shape.

Huram also makes 10 water basins out of bronze. Each basin probably holds around 1,000 liters of water, and each basin measures 4 cubits across the rim. One water basin sits on top of each bronze movable stand. Huram puts five stands with basins outside the south side of the temple, and Huram puts five stands with basins outside the north side of the temple. Huram puts the Sea outside the southeast corner of the temple.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:23–39 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Yahweh
- The workers who help Huram
- And Huram

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Huram casts a large, round water tank out of bronze. Huram calls the tank the Sea. The tank measures 10 cubits across from rim to rim and is 5 cubits high. Huram measures the distance around the Sea to be 30 cubits. Below the rim of the Sea, Huram casts two rows of gourds. Huram places 10 gourds for every cubit around the Sea. Huram casts the Sea and the gourds all at once from the same mold. Huram makes 12 figures like bulls to hold the Sea. Three bulls face in each direction, and the Sea sits on the bulls’ backs. The Sea is about four fingers thick, has a rim like a cup or a lily flower, and holds around 40,000 liters of water.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that the priests will be able to wash themselves in something as beautiful as the Sea; or
- I feel hopeful that Yahweh will bless Huram's work.

Continue the drama.

Huram makes 10 movable stands out of bronze. Each stand is 4 cubits long, 4 cubits wide, and 3 cubits high. Huram uses bronze panels that he attaches to a frame of supports. Huram decorates each panel with figures of lions, bulls, and cherubim. Huram also decorates the frames with wreaths or circular patterns.

Huram puts four wheels with axles at the bottom of each stand. At each of the four corners of each stand, Huram places bronze supports like legs to hold a water basin. Huram also decorates these supports with wreaths. Huram makes an opening at the top of the frame of each cart. Huram makes the opening round, and the distance across the opening is 1.5 cubits. Around the opening, Huram molds a circular frame that looks like a crown. This opening measures one cubit deep. Huram decorates the area around the crown opening with more circular patterns. Even though the opening for the water basin is round, the metal panel that holds up the water basin is square.

Huram probably attaches the four wheels to the four corners of the bottom bronze panel. Then Huram attaches the axles to each stand. Each wheel measures 1.5 cubits across. Huram builds the wheels to look like small chariot wheels. Huram makes the entire wheel, including the axles, rims, spokes, and hubs, out of bronze.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Huram, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel confident that Solomon will like the beautiful objects I make out of bronze; or
- I feel pleased with the details of my decorations on the objects I make for the temple.

Continue the drama.

Huram makes a handle for each corner of each stand. Huram makes the stand and handles all at the same time from the same mold. Huram makes a circular support band for the top of each stand that measures one-half cubit high. Huram makes the upper supports for each stand together with the panels in one piece. Huram decorates the supports and panels with figures of cherubim, lions, and palm trees. Huram covers every part of the stands that people can see with decorations that include wreaths. Huram creates each of the 10 stands in the same way.

Huram also makes 10 water basins out of bronze. Each basin probably holds around 1,000 liters of water, and each basin measures 4 cubits across the rim. One water basin sits on top of each bronze movable stand. Huram puts five stands with basins outside the south side of the temple, and Huram puts five stands with basins outside the north side of the temple. Huram puts the Sea outside the southeast corner of the temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that Solomon and Huram want my temple to be beautiful; or
- I am pleased that Huram wants to use his knowledge about working with bronze to make my temple so beautiful.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:23–39 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Huram **casts** a large, round bronze bowl to hold water, and people call it the Sea. People pour liquid metal into a mold to cast the metal into a particular shape. Use the same word or phrase for cast as you used in previous passages.

Huram makes the Sea measure 10 **cubits** from rim to rim, 5 cubits high, and 30 cubits around. People use cubits to measure length. A cubit is the distance from a man's elbow to the tips of his fingers and measures about 50 centimeters. Use the same word or phrase for cubit as you used in previous passages. For more information on cubit, refer to the Master Glossary.

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Huram decorates the Sea under its rim with metal objects that look like **gourds**. A gourd is a fruit that grows in Israel. Gourds resemble melons or pumpkins, and people cut gourds in half lengthwise and use them to dip or hold liquids like a cup or a bowl. Use the same word or phrase for gourd as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a gourd as a group. Pause this audio here.

Huram places the sea on the backs of 12 statues of bulls. These bulls were probably oxen, which are large animals with four legs. People often used bulls to help with farming. But people also killed bulls to eat or as sacrifices in the temple.

Stop here and look at a picture of oxen as a group. Discuss what word or phrase you will use for **bull**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Huram makes the bronze walls of the Sea a handbreadth thick. People used a handbreadth, or about four fingers or 7.5 centimeters, to measure distance.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **handbreadth.** If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Huram makes the rim or edge of the Sea like the rim of a cup or like a lily flower. A lily is a large flower with white or red petals that curve outward. Use the same word or phrase for lily as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lily flower as a group. Pause this audio here.

Huram makes the Sea large enough to hold 2,000 baths of water, which is about 40,000 liters. People used baths to measure the volume of liquid.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about these measurements. If you use the idea of a bath, decide what word or phrase you will use for **bath**. If you have used the word for bath in 1 Kings 5:11, use the same word you used there. Pause this audio here.

Huram makes the Sea and the 10 movable stands out of **bronze**, which is a metal that people make from copper and tin. Use the same word or phrase for bronze as you used in previous passages. For more information on bronze, refer to the Master Glossary.

Huram decorates the frames and panels of the movable stands with pictures of lions, bulls, and **cherubim**. A lion is a large carnivorous cat that people used to symbolize various things, like victory. A cherub is a type of angel that guards holy places, and cherubim are more than one cherub. Use the same word or phrase for cherubim as you used in previous passages. For more information on cherubim, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lion and cherubim as a group. Discuss what word or phrase you will use for **lion**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase as you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Huram places four bronze wheels on the bottom of each stand. The wheels looked like small chariot wheels with axles, rims, spokes, and hubs made from bronze. The axle is a rod that goes through the center of each wheel and allows the wheel to turn. The rim of a wheel is its outer edge. The spokes are rods that connect the hub, or the central solid part of the wheel, to the rim.

Stop here and look at a picture of a wheel including its axle, rim, spokes, and hub. Look at a picture of a chariot with its wheels. Discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **axle**, **rim**, **spokes**, and **hub**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words or phrases you have used there. Use the same word or phrase for **chariot** as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 7:23–39

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (544 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (728 KB)

1 Kings 7:40–51

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 7:40–51 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:40–51 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:40–51 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, King Solomon directed Huram the craftsman to make the Sea that sits on the backs of the 12 large bulls. Huram also made 10 water basins and movable stands. Huram made all these things out of bronze metal.

In this passage, the storyteller gives a list of the furnishings, or the furniture and decorations, for the temple. Solomon directs Huram to make some objects out of bronze. Solomon directs other workers to make objects out of gold.

Stop here and listen as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 4:11–5:1, which contains the same information, listen to your translation now. Pause this audio here.

Huram makes small bowls for ashes, shovels, and small basins. People use the small bowls to carry ashes from the altar where people burn sacrifices. A shovel is a tool with a broad, flat blade and a handle that may have been just over one-half meter long. People use small shovels to move hot coals and to scoop ashes from the altar. People use small basins to catch the blood from animal sacrifices. These basins are probably a little bigger than the bowls people use to carry ashes. People worship Yahweh by making sacrifices on the altar, and then they sprinkle the blood from the basins onto the altar, so people call these basins sprinkling basins.

Stop here and look at a picture of a small bowl, a small shovel, and a small basin. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller gives a summary of all the work King Solomon gives Huram to complete for Yahweh's temple. This is what Huram makes out of bronze. Huram makes the two bronze pillars with the bowl-shaped capitals on top. You will remember that people make capitals as decorative tops for a pillar or column. Huram also makes the braided chains that decorate the capitals. Huram makes 400 images of pomegranates. Huram uses two rows of pomegranates to decorate each chain on the bowl-shaped capitals, one on top of each pillar. You will remember that a pomegranate is a reddish fruit about the size of a human fist. Huram makes 10 movable stands, and each stand holds a water basin. Huram makes the Sea and the 12 figures that look like bulls that hold up the Sea. Huram makes the bowls for ashes, shovels, and sprinkling basins. Huram makes each of these items out of bronze that people have rubbed to make it shiny, just as King Solomon directed him to do. People use these objects in Yahweh's temple.

Stop here and look at a picture of a pillar, a capital, chains, a pomegranate, a wash basin in a movable stand, and a bull as a group. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon orders his workers to make these objects out of bronze. The workers melt the bronze until it becomes liquid. Then the workers dig molds out of clay in the ground and pour the liquid bronze into the clay molds. When the bronze cools, it hardens into the shape of the mold. The workers do this in the lower plain of the Jordan River between the towns of Succoth and Zarethan. The plain of the Jordan refers to the lower valley of the Jordan River, which is south of the Dead Sea. Succoth was a town east of the Jordan River and west of the Jabbok River. Zarethan was a town east of the Jordan River, but we do not know exactly where it may have been. This land contained a lot of clay that workers used to make clay molds. Solomon does not weigh the objects Huram makes out of bronze because Huram makes so many objects. So, no one knows how much bronze people used to make the objects for the temple.

Stop here and look at a map of the valley of the Jordan River as a group. Find the cities of Succoth and Zarethan. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon also directs workers to make all the gold furnishings for the inside of Yahweh's temple. Solomon makes the gold altar for incense. Solomon makes the gold table where people put the bread of the Presence. Every week on the Sabbath day, or religious day of rest, people put fresh bread on the table as an offering to Yahweh. Workers probably make the altar and the table out of wood and cover the wood with good-quality gold. Solomon makes 10 lampstands out of high-quality gold and places five lampstands inside the main hall of the temple on each side of the door that goes into the Most Holy Place. The lampstands probably have a cylinder shape with tops and bottoms that flare outward. Solomon makes gold flowers that decorate the lampstands. Solomon also makes lamps and gold tongs for the fire. People probably make the lamps out of ceramic, and the lamps have a wick made of flax that uses olive oil as fuel. Tongs are a tool with two arms joined at one end that people can use to pick things up. People probably use gold tongs to trim wicks or to remove burned wicks from the lamps.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the altar, a lampstand with a lamp, and a pair of tongs. Pause this audio here.

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Solomon also makes other objects out of high-quality gold, including basins, wick trimmers or shears that people use to cut wicks, sprinkling basins, dishes to carry incense, and censers or firepans to carry burning incense. Solomon also makes sockets or hinges out of bronze and covers them with gold. Solomon uses these sockets for the doors that lead into the Most Holy Place and for the doors that lead into the main hall of Yahweh's temple. People use sockets to help doors swing open or shut.

Stop here and look at a picture of a wick trimmer, a censer, and gold sockets or hinges as a group. Pause this audio here.

When King Solomon finishes all his work for Yahweh's temple, Solomon gathers all the things his father David had dedicated to Yahweh. David had given various valuable articles to Yahweh. People made some of these articles from silver and gold. Solomon puts all these things in the treasure room, or the rooms where Solomon keeps valuable treasures, inside Yahweh's temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Where might people keep valuable treasures in your culture?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:40–51 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Solomon had asked Huram to make several items out of polished bronze for Yahweh's temple, and Huram finishes that work. Workmen pour liquid bronze into clay molds in the ground in the plain of the Jordan River Valley. Solomon does not ask anyone to weigh the bronze, so no one knows how much bronze Huram uses.

In the second scene: Solomon's workers make the furnishings for Yahweh's temple out of high-quality gold. When Solomon knows the workers have finished, Solomon puts all the articles, including silver and gold that King David had dedicated to Yahweh, in the treasure room of the temple.

The characters in this passage are:

- Huram
- Solomon
- Solomon's workers
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Huram makes objects out of bronze for people to use in Yahweh's temple. Huram makes small bowls for ashes, small shovels, and small basins for sprinkling blood.

King Solomon had directed Huram to make these items for Yahweh's temple out of bronze, and Huram completed the work. In this passage, the storyteller gives a summary of all the work Huram completed for Yahweh's temple. The storyteller has described most of these items already in previous passages.

Huram made the two large pillars that stand at the entrance to the temple. On top of each pillar rests a bowl-shaped capital, or decorative top. Huram decorated the capitals with chains. Huram placed two rows of chains on each capital. Huram decorated the chains with images that look like pomegranates. Pomegranates are reddish fruits about the size of a human fist. In another passage in the Bible, the storyteller says Huram made 400 images of pomegranates. Huram used two rows of pomegranates to decorate each chain on the bowl-shaped capitals, and Huram placed one capital on top of each pillar.

Huram also made 10 water basins on 10 movable stands. People used these basins to wash the things they used for burnt offerings. Huram made a large water tank called the Sea, and Huram made the 12 images that look like bulls that support the Sea. Priests use the Sea to wash themselves. Huram made the small bowls for ashes,

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the small shovels, and the small basins for sprinkling blood. Huram made all these objects out of bronze that workers polish until they look shiny.

Stop here and discuss as a group: The storyteller uses this passage to give a summary, or a list, of what Huram makes. Listen to your translation of 1 Kings 7:13–39, where the storyteller already talked about these objects that Huram made. Use this passage to remember how you already described these objects. Use the same words here for these objects as you used in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Solomon had directed Huram and other workers to make these objects for Yahweh's temple. Solomon's workers cast the items by melting bronze and then pouring it into clay molds that the workers dug in the ground. The workers did this work in the plain of the Jordan River, which is the lower valley of the Jordan River between the towns of Succoth and Zarethan. Solomon did not ask any worker to weigh any of the bronze objects that Huram made because Huram made so many objects. So, no one knows how much bronze Huram and the workers used to make objects for Yahweh's temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you talk about Huram casting these objects in clay? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Solomon also makes the furnishings for the inside of Yahweh's temple out of pure or good-quality gold. However, even though the storyteller says Solomon makes these objects, Solomon does not actually do the work himself. Solomon directs his workers and craftsmen to make these objects out of gold.

Solomon makes the incense altar and the table that holds the bread of the Presence. Solomon makes 10 lampstands and puts five lampstands on each side of the entrance to the Most Holy Place. Solomon makes the gold flowers that decorate the lampstands, the lamps that go on the lampstands, and the tongs to trim or to remove the wicks from the lamps. Solomon makes bowls, wick trimmers, basins for sprinkling blood, dishes for incense, and censers to hold burning incense. Solomon makes sockets for the doors to the Most Holy Place and for the doors at the entrance to the main hall of the temple. Solomon probably makes these sockets out of bronze and covers the bronze with gold.

Stop here as a group and listen to your translation of Exodus 37:17–38:8. In this passage, Moses describes some similar objects that people made for the tabernacle. If you have already translated this passage, use your translation to help you talk about these objects that Huram made for the temple. Pause this audio here.

If it helps you, look again at a picture of a pillar, a capital, chains, a pomegranate, a wash basin in a movable stand, a bull, the altar, a lampstand with a lamp, a pair of tongs, a wick-trimmer, a censer, and gold sockets or hinges. Pause this audio here.

When Solomon makes all the objects for Yahweh's temple, Solomon brings all the gold and silver furnishings that his father, King David, had dedicated to Yahweh. Solomon puts these things in the treasure room in Yahweh's temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What kinds of furnishings do you use for holy places in your culture? How will you describe the special furnishings Solomon uses for Yahweh's temple? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:40–51 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Huram
- Solomon
- Solomon's workers
- And Yahweh

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As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Huram makes bowls for ashes, shovels, and small basins out of bronze. Now we hear a summary of the work King Solomon asks Huram to do. Huram makes several items out of bronze. Huram makes the two large pillars that stand at the entrance to the temple. On top of each pillar rests a bowl-shaped capital, or top. Huram decorates the capitals with chains. Huram places two rows of chains on each capital. Huram decorates the chains with images that look like pomegranates. Huram also makes 10 water basins on 10 movable stands. Huram makes a large water tank called the Sea, and Huram makes the 12 images like bulls that support the Sea.

Huram makes all these objects out of bronze that workers polish until they look shiny. Solomon's workers cast the items in clay molds that they dig in the ground. The workers do this work in the lower plain of the Jordan River between the towns of Succoth and Zarethan.

Solomon does not weigh any of the bronze objects that Huram makes because Huram makes so many objects. So, no one knows how much bronze Huram and the workers use to make objects for Yahweh's temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Huram, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel pleased when I see all the beautiful things I have made for Yahweh's temple; or
- I feel happy that King Solomon chose me to help him complete Yahweh's temple.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel certain that Yahweh is pleased with Huram's work; or
- I think the Israelite people and the other nations around us will feel impressed when they see Yahweh's temple.

Continue the drama.

Solomon also makes the furnishings for the inside of Yahweh's temple out of high-quality gold. Solomon makes the altar and the table that holds the bread of the Presence. Solomon makes 10 lampstands and puts five on each side of the entrance to the Most Holy Place. Solomon makes the gold flowers that decorate the lampstands, and Solomon makes the lamps and tongs. Solomon makes bowls, wick trimmers, basins for sprinkling blood, dishes for incense, and censers to hold burning incense. Solomon makes sockets for the doors to the Most Holy Place and for the doors at the entrance to the main hall of the temple.

When Solomon makes all the objects for Yahweh's temple, Solomon brings all the gold and silver furnishings that his father, King David, had dedicated to Yahweh. Solomon puts these things in the treasure room in Yahweh's temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel pleased to see the beautiful temple Solomon made for me to live in; or
- I feel love for Solomon and for my people, the Israelites. The people have worked very hard to make me a beautiful place to live.

Ask the people playing Solomon's workers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

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- We feel weary because Solomon has required us to work very hard to build Yahweh's temple and to craft the objects in it; or
- We feel happy that we have finished Yahweh's temple; or
- We feel satisfied to see the beauty of Yahweh's temple.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 7:40–51 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Stop here and listen as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 4:11–5:1, which contains the same information, listen to your translation now. Pause this audio here.

Huram completes the items **King** Solomon asked him to make for **Yahweh's temple**. Yahweh is a name that God gives himself, and it reminds people of the covenant Yahweh made with the Israelites. Israelites worship Yahweh in the temple. Use the same words or phrases for king, Yahweh, and temple as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and temple, refer to the Master Glossary.

Huram makes two **pillars** for the front entrance of the temple. People usually make tall, vertical structures called pillars out of metal, wood, or stone. Pillars may help to support a building, or people may use pillars as decoration. Use the same word or phrase for pillar as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a pillar as a group. Pause this audio here.

Huram puts a **capital** on the top of each pillar. The word capital is special language that people use to talk about the decorative top of a pillar in Solomon's temple. Huram shapes them to look like bowls and decorates the capitals with **chains** and **pomegranates**. People probably weave metal together in the shape of a braid to make these chains. Pomegranates are reddish fruits about the same size as a human's fist. Use the same words or phrases for capital, chains, and pomegranate as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a capital, chains, and a pomegranate. Pause this audio here.

Huram makes 10 water basins in movable stands, the Sea and the **bulls** that support it, bowls and shovels for ashes, and small basins that hold blood from sacrifices. Huram makes all the objects for the temple out of **bronze** that people polish so that the objects look shiny. Bronze is a type of metal that people make from copper and tin. Use the same words or phrases for bulls and bronze as you used in previous passages. For more information on bronze, refer to the Master Glossary.

Huram and the other workers cast the bronze objects in the plain of the **Jordan River** between the towns of Succoth and Zarethan. The Jordan River is a long river that runs through Israel from north to south. Use the same word or phrase for Jordan River as you used in previous passages. For more information on Jordan River, refer to the Master Glossary.

Solomon makes the **furnishings** for Yahweh's temple. Furnishings include furniture and other items people use to decorate a building or a room. Use the same word or phrase for furnishings as you used in previous passages.

Solomon makes objects for Yahweh's temple out of **gold**. Gold is a precious yellow metal. Use the same word or phrase for gold as you used in previous passages.

Solomon makes the incense **altar** and the table for the bread of the Presence. An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to a god. The Israelites made sacrifices on the altar to Yahweh. Priests put 12 loaves of bread on a table just outside the Most Holy Place to remind the Israelites that Yahweh lives in the temple. The people call this the bread of the Presence. Use the same word or phrase for altar as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **bread of the Presence**. For more information about "bread of the Presence," refer to the Master Glossary. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon makes 10 **lampstands** and puts five on each side of the door to the Most Holy Place. People light wicks in lamps that they place on lampstands to provide light. Use the same word or phrase for lampstand as you used in previous passages.

Solomon makes tongs, wick trimmers, and censers for the temple. People make tools like tongs with two short arms joined at one end. People probably use tongs to pick things up or to remove burnt wicks. People probably make wicks out of flax that people can light with fire. People use wick trimmers to cut the wicks to keep the wicks from getting too long and burning too quickly. People use a censer to carry hot coals or burning incense.

Stop here and look at a picture of tongs, wick trimmers, and a censer. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **tongs**, **wick trimmer**, and **censer**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon makes sockets for the doors that go into the **Most Holy Place** and for the doors that lead into the main hall of the temple from the outside. People use sockets or hinges to help doors swing open and shut. People probably make sockets out of a stronger metal like bronze, and then Solomon covers them with gold. Use the same word or phrase for Most Holy Place as you have used in previous passages. Most Holy Place is in the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sockets**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon places the items David dedicated to Yahweh in the treasuries in the temple. People put expensive and important gifts for Yahweh in the treasuries that Solomon made in Yahweh's temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **treasuries**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 7:40–51

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (549 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.4 MB)

- Defining the Scenes (3.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (688 KB)

1 Kings 8:1–11

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 8:1–11 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:1–11 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, King Solomon finished building and furnishing the temple. While the previous story shows all of the new items and parts of the temple, this story focuses more on items that King Solomon still needs to bring to the temple and how the Israelites move these items to the temple.

Stop here and review the photo of King Solomon's temple as a group. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon cannot complete the temple fully until the ark of the covenant, the Tent of Meeting, and any furnishings the priests use in the Tent of Meeting are in the temple. King Solomon asks the elders and heads or chiefs of the Israelite tribes to gather together and to join the people who will bring the ark of the covenant, the Tent of Meeting, and the furnishings to the temple. You will remember that the Tent of Meeting is the temporary tent that the Israelites used to meet with Yahweh before Solomon built the temple.

Stop here and look at a photo of the ark of the covenant as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop and look at a photo or illustration of the Tent of Meeting and furnishings. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of a time when you were close to completing a task, but you had to wait for someone or something else to happen before you could finish. How did you feel? Discuss this question with the group. Pause this audio here.

It is important to pay attention to the people that King Solomon gathers together for this process. The term "elders" likely refers to the older men who oversee the people of Israel, and "heads" or "chiefs" likely means the men who are in charge of leading their households and different tribes. It is possible that these are all the same leaders, but it is also possible that there are different sets of leaders who help look after the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about the types of leadership in your community. Discuss as a group the different kinds of leaders and who takes care of the different groups of people in your community. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon wants the elders to walk with the people who will carry the ark, the Tent of Meeting, and the furnishings from Zion to King Solomon's location, north of Zion. People sometimes use Zion as another name

1 Kings 8:1–11

for Jerusalem or the City of David. It is likely that the storyteller uses Zion here to show that King Solomon is moving the ark from King David's Jerusalem to the new location of the temple in a different place.

It is also important to notice the time of year when King Solomon starts this process. The storyteller says that King Solomon chooses the seventh month. The storyteller calls this month "Ethanim," which is a Canaanite name. This is unusual because the Israelites no longer [call this month by this name at the time the storyteller writes this book.]{.mark} However, the storyteller likely does this to show the time of year and month so that the reader can understand that the seventh month means the seventh month when Solomon finished the temple, and not the seventh month in the time that the storyteller wrote the story. The seventh month is likely the same as mid-September or October today.

At this time of year, the Israelites celebrated a feast called the Festival of Tabernacles. The Festival of Tabernacles was likely a perfect time for King Solomon, because the festival celebrates when the Israelites left Egypt and had to live in temporary shelters. The festival also celebrates how Yahweh gave the Israelites a permanent place to live after the Israelites wandered for years in the desert. The Festival of Tabernacles is a pilgrimage feast, which means that the tribes of Israel travel to Jerusalem for this festival. This also means that the elders, chiefs, and men of Israel are in Jerusalem at the time that King Solomon asks for them to come to the temple. It is likely that King Solomon finished the temple and then waited for this festival so that the people who were allowed to transport the ark of the covenant, the Tent of Meeting, and the furnishings could easily bring everything to the new temple. This also means that the people of Israel could all be at the temple together to see the dedication.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of celebrations or festivals you have in your community that help you remember specific days or events. How do you celebrate? Pause this audio here.

Only men from the tribe of Levi can carry the pieces from Zion to the new temple. The priests, who are from the tribe of Levi, are the only people Yahweh has allowed to carry the ark of the covenant. The Levites who are not priests are allowed to carry the Tent of Meeting and the furnishings from the Tent of Meeting. It is likely that King Solomon and the people of Israel traveled with the priests and other Levites. It is also likely that King Solomon and the people of Israel sacrificed cattle and sheep during the journey, as well as at the temple. The storyteller says that the people sacrificed so many cattle and sheep that they could not keep count of them all.

Stop here and look at pictures of cattle and sheep. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of what a priest looked like and the clothing they wore. Pause this audio here.

When the priests arrive at the temple, the priests carry the ark of the covenant into the temple's inner room, called the Most Holy Place. It is important to remember that there are two rooms within the building where the priests perform their priestly duties. The Holy Place is a room or space where all priests can go. Only the high priest can go into the Most Holy Place, which some people call the Inner Sanctuary.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a photo or diagram of the Holy Place and the Most Holy Place. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what places or areas can only certain people go into? Pause this audio here.

The priests place the ark of the covenant under the wings of two cherubim angels that people made from olive wood and covered in gold. The cherubim are probably a larger version of the smaller cherubim that used to rest on the corners of the ark. The larger cherubim spread their wings over the entire ark and the carrying poles to show that this is Yahweh's resting place. The carrying poles for the ark are so long that a priest can see the poles as they are standing in the Holy Place, but not outside the Holy Place. This likely means that the poles press into the curtain that separates the Holy Place and the Most Holy Place. The storyteller says that the poles are still attached to the ark, but this likely means that the poles are there at the time the storyteller writes this. It is likely that the storyteller shares this section to help the reader visualize the new space of the temple.

Stop here and look at an illustration of cherubim. Also, look at an illustration of what the cherubim looked like in Solomon's temple. Pause this audio here.

It is important to remember that Moses put two tablets in the ark of the covenant. These flat stones represent the covenant that Yahweh made with the Israelites on Mount Horeb, also known as Mount Sinai. The storyteller

1 Kings 8:1–11

says that these two tablets, which show God's covenant with Israel after they were free from Egypt, are the only items inside the ark of the covenant.

Stop here and look at an illustration of the two tablets that Moses put into the ark of the covenant. Pause this audio here.

After the priests place the ark of the covenant in the Most Holy Place and leave, a cloud fills the temple. The cloud is the presence and glory of Yahweh, and the cloud is so thick that the priests cannot carry out their priestly duties. It is important to remember that when Moses finished building the Tent of Meeting, a cloud covered the tent and Yahweh's glory filled the space. The storyteller likely uses this same description to show that Yahweh's presence is now in the new temple and that Yahweh is blessing the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Think of a time when a room was so full that you could not go in. This could be a time when there were too many people in a room, or when a room was too hot or even filled with smoke. Imagine how it felt, and then discuss the cloud that filled the temple. Discuss how this might have felt and how you would feel.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon gathers together the elders and chiefs of the people of Israel.

In the second scene: The priests bring the ark of the covenant to the temple, and the Levites bring the Tent of Meeting and furnishings to the temple.

In the third scene: The people of Israel sacrifice cattle and sheep.

In the fourth scene: The priests bring the ark of the covenant into the Most Holy Place.

In the fifth scene: The priests leave the Most Holy Place, and Yahweh's presence fills the temple.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Yahweh
- Elders and chiefs of the people of Israel
- Priests
- Other Levites
- And people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, King Solomon has just finished building the temple. King Solomon wants the priests to bring the ark of the covenant and the Levites to bring the Tent of Meeting and furnishings from Zion to the temple near where King Solomon lives. The people of Israel are gathering in Jerusalem for the Festival of Tabernacles and can travel easily to King Solomon. King Solomon likely knows that the temple is not finished until the priests and Levites bring these items. King Solomon also likely chooses the Festival of Tabernacles as a time to do this because the festival requires all people of Israel to travel to Jerusalem.

Stop here and review the picture of King Solomon's Temple as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In this passage, a festival is a gathering where people celebrate an event or special occasion. In your language, how would you translate "festival"? Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 8:1–11

King Solomon gathers together the elders and chiefs of the people of Israel, who are probably already there for the festival. This is important because the leaders and chiefs are in charge of looking after the people and communicating King Solomon's commands to the people.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What words or phrases do you use in your culture for leaders or chiefs? How can you best translate this? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, once the elders and leaders gather together with Solomon, the priests and Levites prepare to go to the temple. The priests carry the ark of the covenant with the poles. The other Levites carry the Tent of Meeting and the other furnishings from the Tent of Meeting. The elders and chiefs travel with the priests and Levites who transport all that King Solomon has asked for.

Stop here and look at a photo of the priests carrying the ark of the covenant as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop and look at a photo or illustration of the Tent of Meeting. Pause this audio here.

Stop and look at the various furnishings people used in the Tent of Meeting. Pause this audio here.

It is important that the priests are the only ones who carry or touch the poles of the ark, just as Yahweh told them to. It is also important that only the other Levites carry the Tent of Meeting and furnishings, because Yahweh gave the Levites the duty to care for the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about duties in your culture that only certain people can perform. How can you use this information to talk about the Levites in this passage? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the priests, Levites, and other leaders arrive at the temple with King Solomon and the people of Israel. The people of Israel sacrifice so many cattle and sheep that it is impossible to count all of the sacrifices! The people are sacrificing in front of the ark of the covenant, in the temple courtyard, before the priests take the ark into the Most Holy Place. King Solomon and the people dedicate the temple to Yahweh and honor Yahweh with these sacrifices.

Stop here and look at pictures of cattle and sheep. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the priests carry the ark of the covenant through the Holy Place into the Most Holy Place. Only the priests can enter these spaces. The priests place the ark of the covenant under the outspread cherubim wings, leave the poles in the ark, and then leave and most likely close the curtain. After this moment, only the high priest can enter the Most Holy Place one day of the year.

Stop here and look at a picture of what a priest looked like and the clothing they wore. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a photo or illustration of cherubim. Also, look at a photo or illustration of what the cherubim looked like in Solomon's temple. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Look again at the cherubim. Discuss as a group how you can describe the cherubim and what words you can use to show the difference between a real angel and the carved angel. Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, after the priests leave the Most Holy Place, a cloud fills the temple. The cloud represents Yahweh's presence and glory. The cloud is so thick that the priests cannot carry out their priestly duties, and the priests have to leave the sanctuary. Yahweh often showed that Yahweh was in a space when Yahweh filled that space with a cloud or bright light. The cloud is important because it shows that Yahweh now fills the temple and rests in the place that King Solomon built to honor Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you describe the cloud? In your culture, how do you show that something like a cloud represents a person? For example, what kinds of symbols or objects show that a king lives in a certain place, even when you cannot see the king? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 8:1–11

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Yahweh
- Elders and chiefs of the people of Israel
- Priests
- Other Levites
- And people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

After King Solomon finished building the temple, King Solomon sent a message to the elders and chiefs of the people of Israel. All of the people of Israel were in Jerusalem for the Festival of Tabernacles. King Solomon asked the elders and chiefs to go with the priests who carried the ark of the covenant to the new temple. The priests carried the ark with the poles, and the other Levites also carried the Tent of Meeting and its furnishings to the new temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing priests, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- What an honor to carry the ark to the temple! or
- We must be careful! or
- We must not forget anything!

Continue the drama.

Once the elders and all leaders of Israel gathered together with Solomon, the priests and Levites went to the new temple. The priests walked and carried the ark of the covenant, and the other Levites also walked and carried the Tent of Meeting and its furnishings. The elders and chiefs of the tribes of Israel traveled to the temple with King Solomon and the other Israelites.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the other Levites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We must carry everything carefully for Yahweh; or
- I am very tired from walking and carrying everything! or
- I wonder what the temple will look like.

Continue the drama.

When all of the elders, leaders, priests, and other Levites reached the temple, the [priests stopped in the temple courtyard, and King Solomon and the people of Israel sacrificed so many cattle]{.mark} and sheep for Yahweh that it was impossible to count all of the sacrifices!

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Finally, everyone has arrived! or
- I can now dedicate the temple properly! or
- Surely Yahweh will be pleased with all of these sacrifices!

Ask the people playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- There cannot possibly be any more animals left! or
- I wonder what Yahweh thinks about all of this! or
- I feel excited to have the temple completed!

Continue the drama.

The priests carried the ark of the covenant through the Holy Place and into the Most Holy Place. The priests placed the ark of the covenant, with the two stone tablets that Moses put into the ark, under the cherubim that covered the ark of the covenant and the poles.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the priests, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I am so relieved that we brought the ark here safely! or
- I am in awe of the cherubim! or
- I must make sure the curtain is closed.

Continue the drama.

After the priests left the ark of the covenant in the Most Holy Place, a cloud filled the entire temple. The cloud was Yahweh’s presence, and Yahweh showed that he was pleased with the temple. The cloud was so thick that the priests could not enter the temple to perform their priestly duties. Yahweh’s presence filled the temple, and all of the people could see that Yahweh was pleased and that Yahweh was now in the temple.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- King Solomon has truly honored and obeyed me! or
- Everything looks exactly like I wanted it to; or
- I love King Solomon and the people of Israel!

Ask the people playing the priests, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- How can we perform our duties in the temple if we cannot get in? or
- I can feel Yahweh’s presence here! or
- We must help the people of Israel understand what is happening.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, King Solomon summons the elders and chiefs or leaders of the people of Israel. The elders oversee the entire population of the people of Israel. The chiefs are leaders of different groups or tribes of people. Although the storyteller does not tell us the name of this festival, King Solomon chooses to do this during the time of the seventh month, during the Festival of Tabernacles. You will remember that the people

1 Kings 8:1–11

of Israel celebrated the Festival of Tabernacles to remember when Yahweh provided shelter for them after they left Egypt.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **chiefs**, **elders**, and **Festival of Tabernacles**, if you choose to use the name of the festival. Look up king, Israel, elders, and Festival of Tabernacles in the Master Glossary for more information.

King Solomon wants the **priests** and other Levites to bring the **ark of the covenant**, the **Tent of Meeting**, also known as the **tabernacle**, and the "**holy**" or special tent furnishings from their location in Jerusalem, also called Zion, north to where King Solomon has built the **temple**. Remember that the priests and Levites were both part of the tribe of Levi. Priests offered Sacrifices to Yahweh for the people of Israel. Other Levites served the temple in other ways, such as playing music, singing, and doing other tasks for the temple. The ark of the covenant was the oblong chest made of wood and covered in gold. The presence of Yahweh rested on top of the ark on the atonement seat. The tabernacle was the movable tent where Yahweh's presence rested. The temple became the permanent building for Yahweh's presence and the ark of the covenant. Use the same words or phrases for holy, priests, ark of the covenant, and temple as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, priests, Levites, ark of the covenant, tabernacle, and temple, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **Zion** and **Levites**. Look up Levites and Zion in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The people of Israel sacrifice so many cattle and sheep that no one can count all of the animals. Use the same word or phrase for **sacrificing** as you used in previous passages. For more information on sacrifice, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priests take the ark of the covenant through the **Holy Place** into the **Most Holy Place** or inner **sanctuary**. The priests place the ark of the covenant under the **cherubim** with wings that stretch over the entire length of the ark and the carrying poles. Use the same words or phrases for cherubim, sanctuary, Holy Place, and Most Holy Place as you used in previous passages. For more information on cherubim, sanctuary, Holy Place, and Most Holy Place, refer to the Master Glossary.

When the priests leave the Most Holy Place, a cloud fills the temple, and Yahweh's presence and glory enters the temple to stay and rest there. The cloud is so thick that the priests cannot perform their priestly duties in the temple. The cloud represents the glory, or majesty, of Yahweh and Yahweh's presence.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **cloud** and **glory**. Look up glory and Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 8:1–11

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (794 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 8:12–21

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 8:12–21 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:12–21 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:12–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, Yahweh saw everything that King Solomon and the people of Israel did. When the priests placed the ark of the covenant in the Most Holy Place, Yahweh responded when he filled the temple with a thick cloud. In this passage, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh in a prayer and then addresses the people of Israel in response to Yahweh's presence in the temple.

Stop here and review the photo of King Solomon's Temple. Pause this audio here.

This passage is almost exactly the same as 2 Chronicles 6:1–11 that you may have translated previously.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 6:1–11, listen to your translation of that passage. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon begins his prayer when Solomon says words that Yahweh spoke previously. In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh spoke to Moses and told Moses not to allow his brother Aaron to go into the Most Holy Place. Yahweh also said that Yahweh would come in a dark cloud into the Most Holy Place over the ark of the covenant. You will remember that Yahweh did the same thing in the tabernacle when Moses was leading the Israelites in the wilderness. This was a sign that Yahweh was pleased and was present in the tabernacle. King Solomon recognizes this, and King Solomon tells Yahweh that King Solomon has built a magnificent temple for Yahweh to live in forever.

1 Kings 8:12–21

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember that the people of Israel likely knew the story of Moses and Yahweh's presence in the tabernacle. How do you think people felt when they saw Yahweh come in a cloud like this? How would you feel if you saw this yourself instead of only hearing about it? Pause this audio here.

After King Solomon prays to Yahweh, King Solomon then turns away from the temple and faces the assembly, or the group of the people of Israel. Assemblies are large groups of people who gather together for a common reason. King Solomon then blesses the people. Again, King Solomon does the same act that Moses did at the tabernacle. King Solomon sees all that has happened, and King Solomon honors Yahweh and then speaks Yahweh's blessings over the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about the most important or famous person in your country. This could be a king or a leader. How would you feel if this person recognized you and spoke kind words to you? In your culture, how do leaders bless or honor other people? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon begins his prayer by praising Yahweh, the God of Israel. King Solomon is reminding the Israelites that they are Yahweh's special people. Yahweh is the Israelites' God! King Solomon says he praises Yahweh because Yahweh has fulfilled Yahweh's promises through Yahweh's hands, or Yahweh's power. Yahweh fulfilled his promise to Solomon's father, King David, that Solomon would be king and build the temple. King Solomon likely wants to remind the people that Yahweh is faithful and trustworthy.

In the next section, King Solomon speaks words that Yahweh has already spoken. King Solomon quotes Yahweh when Solomon says, "Since the day I brought my people Israel out of Egypt, I have not chosen a city in any tribe of Israel for people to build a temple where my people can worship me, but I have chosen David to rule my people Israel."

In this part of the passage, King Solomon likely shares what Yahweh said to King David to explain why King David did not build the temple sooner. Yahweh wanted King David to rule over the people of Israel, but Yahweh did not give King David permission or instructions to build a temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Imagine that you are King David. How would you feel if you were king and you wanted to build a temple, but Yahweh would not let you? Describe your feelings and thoughts. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who is allowed to build or create holy places, like temples? Who chooses when it is the right time or place to make these holy places? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon [then quotes Yahweh again to remind the people of Israel why King Solomon built the temple.] {.mark} Yahweh did not let King David build the temple, even though Yahweh loved King David and King David wanted to build the temple to honor Yahweh's name. However, Yahweh did have a plan. Yahweh told King David that King David's son, King Solomon, would build the Temple. When Solomon repeats Yahweh's words, King Solomon reminds the people of Israel that Yahweh is faithful and is in control of all things, including time.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story of a time when you thought someone would choose you for a special role, but the person chose someone else instead. Share with the group how you felt. Pause this audio here.

After King Solomon reminds the people of what Yahweh said, King Solomon then confirms that what Yahweh said has happened. Yahweh has kept all of Yahweh's promises. Solomon is king and has built the temple for Yahweh, just as Yahweh promised. Yahweh promised that King Solomon would sit on the throne and rule over Israel. A throne is a special seat for a king that shows the king's importance and power. Again, King Solomon says that he has built the temple for "Yahweh, the God of Israel."

Stop here and look at a picture of a throne. Pause this audio here.

[To finish his reminder to the people, King Solomon explains that King Solomon has built a place where people can put the ark of the covenant. In the ark are the stone tablets. These tablets are a reminder of Yahweh's covenant with the people of Israel after Yahweh led the people of Israel out of Egypt. King Solomon reminds the people of Israel that Yahweh made promises to their ancestors. Yahweh will keep those promises just as Yahweh kept his promises to David.]{.mark}

1 Kings 8:12–21

Stop here and look at a picture of the ark of the covenant. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of the stone tablets. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you pass information down through generations so that people will know what happened during their ancestors' lives? How do you keep a record of all that has happened?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:12–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon faces the temple and speaks to Yahweh.

In the second scene: King Solomon turns around and blesses the people of Israel. King Solomon reminds the people of how Yahweh keeps his promises.

The characters in this passage are:

- Storyteller
- King Solomon
- Yahweh
- People of Israel
- And King David

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this entire passage, King Solomon is the only one who speaks. King Solomon speaks to Yahweh and to the people of Israel. King Solomon's speech has several parts. King Solomon praises Yahweh. King Solomon also tells why he built the temple instead of his father, King David. King Solomon shows the people that Yahweh has fulfilled Yahweh's promises. King Solomon's speech honors Yahweh and reminds people of who Yahweh is and that they should also honor Yahweh.

In the first scene, King Solomon faces the temple and speaks to Yahweh. King Solomon reminds Yahweh, and everyone who listens, that Yahweh previously said that he would live in a dark cloud. You will remember that Yahweh told Moses many years before that Yahweh would live in the dark cloud. King Solomon then offers the temple to Yahweh so that Yahweh can have a place to live in forever.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: It sounds like King Solomon speaks about Yahweh when Solomon says that Yahweh said he would live in a dark cloud. Then King Solomon speaks directly to Yahweh. How will you show the shift in who King Solomon is talking to? It is possible that King Solomon is talking directly to Yahweh from the beginning of this passage, and you can translate it in that way if you wish. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how will you translate this part so that people will understand that King Solomon is repeating words that Yahweh had already said many years earlier? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, King Solomon turns and speaks to the people of Israel. The storyteller says that the people are standing as an assembly, so King Solomon is likely talking to people who are purposely listening to Solomon. The storyteller says that King Solomon blesses the people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what types of blessings do people speak over other people? Think of examples of how people might speak words to comfort people or to remind them of how Yahweh blesses them. Pause this audio here.

In this section, King Solomon talks about both what Yahweh does now and what Yahweh has said and done in the past. King Solomon starts by praising "Yahweh, the God of Israel" for helping King Solomon do what Yahweh

1 Kings 8:12–21

told King David that King Solomon would do through Yahweh's hands or power. The storyteller is not saying that Yahweh's actual hand built the temple. But the storyteller is likely saying that Yahweh made it possible for King Solomon and the people to complete the temple with Yahweh's power.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you tell a story in your language, how do you show that something happens now and that something happened in the past? What words would you use to help someone understand when something happened? Pause this audio here.

Solomon says that Yahweh used his own mouth to speak to King David. We see that Yahweh directly acted and spoke to King David and to King Solomon several times about Yahweh's plans. Yahweh did not give a specific place for anyone to build a temple for him in King David's time. Yahweh said that David would not build a temple for "his name," or Yahweh's name, which means a temple for Yahweh and where Yahweh would be present. But Yahweh did bless King David and chose King David to rule over the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you show that a person is quoting someone else instead of using their own words? How can you show when King Solomon is quoting Yahweh and when King Solomon is using Solomon's own words? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon explains that his father, King David, "had it in his heart" to build a temple for Yahweh. In the original language, people use the heart and mind to describe the places where they think, feel, and process information. King David really wanted to build a temple. Then King Solomon again quotes Yahweh's words that Yahweh spoke to King David. Yahweh told King David that Yahweh was pleased that King David wanted to build a temple for Yahweh. However, Yahweh told King David that King David would not be the one to build the temple. Instead, Yahweh chose King Solomon, King David's own "flesh and blood," to build the temple for Yahweh. In this case, flesh and blood means King David's son.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you show that someone is related to someone else in their family? What are some other words or phrases you could use to show that someone is truly another person's son? Think about how you can translate "flesh and blood" to show this. Pause this audio here.

It is important to remember that King Solomon is not saying that he built the temple by himself. This means that King Solomon appointed people to build the temple and watched over the process.

King Solomon finishes this speech by making it clear to the people that Yahweh has answered and fulfilled the promises that Yahweh made to King David. King Solomon now sits on Israel's throne and rules over the people of Israel. King Solomon has also built the temple for Yahweh and has placed the ark of the covenant in the temple. King Solomon reminds the people that the stone tablets are in the ark of the covenant. The tablets represent the covenant that Yahweh made with Moses and the people of Israel when Yahweh rescued the people of Israel from Egypt.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think King Solomon repeats Yahweh's promises? What are some reasons why you might repeat stories or phrases? Why is this helpful? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of a throne. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of the ark of the covenant. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of the stone tablets. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:12–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Storyteller

1 Kings 8:12–21

- King Solomon
- Yahweh
- People of Israel
- And King David

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

After King Solomon built a temple for Yahweh, King Solomon faced the temple and spoke to Yahweh. King Solomon said that in a previous time, Yahweh said he would dwell in a dark cloud. King Solomon then says that King Solomon has built a temple for Yahweh to live in forever. The temple has a dark cloud inside, and this shows that Yahweh accepted the temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope Yahweh approves of this temple! or
- Look at how much better this temple is than a temporary tabernacle! or
- I feel proud of what I have accomplished; or
- I am so glad we have a permanent place to worship Yahweh!

Continue the drama.

After King Solomon spoke to Yahweh, King Solomon faced all of the people of Israel who were standing in front of him. King Solomon blessed the people.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I must be quiet and listen to King Solomon! or
- I am excited to hear what King Solomon is going to say to us! or
- Look at this beautiful temple!

Continue the drama.

King Solomon praised Yahweh by saying, "Praise be to Yahweh, the God of Israel!" King Solomon then told the people why he was praising Yahweh. King Solomon praised Yahweh because Yahweh fulfilled the promise that Yahweh made to King David.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I remember exactly what King Solomon is saying! or
- I love it when King Solomon honors me! or
- It makes me happy when King Solomon sees what I have done for Solomon!

Continue the drama.

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King Solomon speaks about what Yahweh did when Solomon reminds the people of Israel of the time when Yahweh led the people of Israel out of Egypt. Yahweh did not choose a place anywhere in Israel for anyone to build a temple. Instead, Yahweh chose King Solomon's father, King David, to rule the people of Israel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want the people to see Yahweh's faithfulness! or
- I am in awe of all Yahweh has done! or
- I wonder why Yahweh chose me!

Continue the drama.

King Solomon then tells the people of Israel that his father, King David, wanted to build a temple for Yahweh. King Solomon then tells the people of Israel what Yahweh said to King David. Yahweh told King David that King David was right to want to build the temple for Yahweh. But Yahweh then told King David that King David could not be the person to build the temple. Instead, Yahweh said that King Solomon would build the temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wish I could build the temple! or
- I am thankful that my son will get to build the temple; or
- I am sad that I will not get to see the temple.

Continue the drama.

King Solomon declares that Yahweh has fulfilled the promises that Yahweh made to King David. King Solomon now sits on the throne of Israel and has built the temple for Yahweh. King Solomon placed the ark of the covenant in the temple with the stone tablets in the ark to represent the covenant that Yahweh made when Yahweh led the people of Israel out of Egypt.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Wow! Look at all Yahweh has done! or
- I feel like I can trust Yahweh when he speaks! or
- I am glad that Yahweh approves of our king!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:12–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

After Yahweh's presence fills the **temple**, **King** Solomon faces the temple and speaks to Yahweh. King Solomon says that Yahweh previously said that Yahweh would dwell or live in a dark **cloud**. Someone dwells in a place when they have settled in that place as their home. King Solomon says that he has built a magnificent temple for Yahweh where Yahweh can live forever. Use the same words or phrases for king, temple, and cloud as you used in previous passages. Look up king and temple in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **dwell**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

After King Solomon speaks to **Yahweh**, King Solomon turns around and faces the assembly of **Israel**. People gather in an assembly when they gather all together for a specific purpose. King Solomon **praises** or **blesses** Yahweh, the **God** of Israel, and tells the people of Israel that Yahweh has done what Yahweh told King Solomon's father, King David, he would do. Look up Israel, God, Yahweh, and praise or bless in the Master Glossary for more information, and translate these ideas in the same way you have in previous passages.

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Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**assembly**," or gathering of people. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon says that King David had it in his **heart** to build a house for Yahweh. Yahweh told King David that Yahweh had not chosen any city in any **tribe** of Israel for anyone to build a temple. However, Yahweh did choose for King David to rule over the people of Israel. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about heart, and use the same words or phrases for heart and tribe as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh said that King David's son, King David's own "flesh and blood," would build the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **flesh and blood**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Finally, King Solomon reminds the people of Israel that King Solomon placed the **ark of the covenant** in the temple. The ark of the covenant contains the stone tablets that represent the **covenant** Yahweh made with the people's ancestors when Yahweh rescued the people of Israel's ancestors from Egypt. Use the same words or phrases for ark of the covenant and covenant as you used in previous passages. Look up "ark of the covenant" and covenant in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 8:12–21

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (914 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 8:22–30

1 Kings 8:22–30

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 8:22–30 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:22–30 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:22–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, King Solomon continues to pray to Yahweh in front of the people of Israel. This passage contains two sections of King Solomon's prayer. In the first part of King Solomon's prayer, King Solomon praises Yahweh for how Yahweh has kept and fulfilled Yahweh's covenant or promise to King Solomon's father, King David. In the second part of this prayer, King Solomon asks that Yahweh continue to listen to the Israelites.

As King Solomon prays to Yahweh, King Solomon stands facing the bronze temple altar. The people of Israel stand behind King Solomon, who stretches out his hands to heaven. This is the altar that is in front of the temple building.

Stop here and look at an image of King Solomon's Temple, including the altar. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon declares that Yahweh is the most powerful God in all the earth, in all of heaven, and in every place below the earth. This is important because other people groups outside of the people of Israel worshipped many gods during King Solomon's time. King Solomon honors Yahweh as the only God that the people of Israel worship.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what types of worship or traditional practices do people perform? What kinds of gods do people in your area worship? How do people worship these gods? How do you show that you only worship Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon describes Yahweh as the God who keeps Yahweh's "covenant of love" with the people of Israel. The people of Israel are Yahweh's servants who walk in or obey Yahweh's ways and commands. In this covenant, both Yahweh and the people of Israel promised to act in certain ways. Yahweh promised to love and show kindness to the people of Israel, and the people of Israel promised to obey Yahweh's commands.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what types of agreements or covenants do leaders make with their people? Think about your family structure and community structure. How do people agree and then make sure that they keep the agreements? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon again declares that Yahweh has kept the promises that Yahweh made to King David. Yahweh has chosen King Solomon to be king after King David, and Yahweh has allowed King Solomon to build the temple.

Then King Solomon asks Yahweh to keep his promises in the future. King Solomon quotes Yahweh's words when King Solomon says that Yahweh promised King David that one of David's descendants would always sit on the throne of Israel, or be king over Israel. But David's descendants must obey Yahweh as David did. After King Solomon speaks about the original covenant, King Solomon asks Yahweh to be faithful to continue to keep the covenant and the words that Yahweh spoke to King David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of a time when you wanted to encourage a trustworthy person to keep a promise that this person made. How did you remind this person that they should continue to keep this promise? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon then prays that Yahweh would pay attention to the prayers that the people of Israel would pray. King Solomon asks Yahweh if Yahweh would live on earth, even though the heavens cannot contain the power of Yahweh. The "heavens" is the place where God lives with his angels. King Solomon says that even the wonderful temple that King Solomon has built for Yahweh is still too small for such a powerful God! King Solomon knows that the temple cannot contain Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, where do people believe that gods live? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon does not expect Yahweh to contain himself in the temple. King Solomon knows that Yahweh is greater than any building a human could build. Instead, King Solomon describes what King Solomon hopes that Yahweh will do.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you recognize Yahweh's ability to be both God over all things and also a God who listens to your prayers? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon asks Yahweh to pay attention to the prayers of Yahweh's people from the temple. King Solomon reminds Yahweh that Yahweh said that people would worship Yahweh's name in one place. This is the moment that King Solomon shows what he is actually praying for. King Solomon wants Yahweh's name present in the temple. In biblical times, a person's name showed that person's character. King Solomon wants Yahweh himself to be with Yahweh's people in the temple, even though Yahweh is too great for the temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, where do people go to worship deities? Does your culture have special types of buildings or structures for deities? Do people often speak to deities in these special places? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon then asks Yahweh to listen to King Solomon, Yahweh's servant, and to the Israelites, Yahweh's people. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the prayers from heaven, which is where Yahweh lives. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the prayers of the people and then forgive the people of Israel when they pray from the temple. King Solomon and the people of Israel see the temple as the place where Yahweh's people can come to Yahweh and where Yahweh meets his people.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:22–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon stands in front of the bronze altar in the temple courtyard and thanks Yahweh for keeping Yahweh's promises.

In the second scene: King Solomon asks Yahweh to listen to Solomon's prayers and the prayers of Yahweh's people when they pray towards the temple.

The characters in this passage are:

- Storyteller
- King Solomon
- People of Israel
- King David
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

1 Kings 8:22–30

In this passage, Solomon begins his long prayer to Yahweh when Solomon dedicates the temple to Yahweh. Most of the characters in the story either watch King Solomon, or King Solomon speaks about these characters or to them. It is good for you to remember that the Israelites and Yahweh are both present as Solomon prays.

In the first scene, King Solomon begins a longer prayer to Yahweh. King Solomon faces the altar in the courtyard of the temple. The assembly, or special gathering, of Israelites stands behind King Solomon as King Solomon raises his hands to heaven to pray to Yahweh. This was a common way for people to pray during King Solomon's time.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you show action or show specific ways that a person stands or moves? For example, how can you make sure the listener understands that the people were behind King Solomon? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon begins to pray and thank Yahweh. King Solomon recognizes that Yahweh is the God above all other gods when King Solomon says that there is no other god in the highest part of heaven or the lowest place under the earth or on earth that compares to Yahweh. In other words, King Solomon says that Yahweh is the greatest god of all gods anywhere. King Solomon then shows Yahweh as a personal and present God when King Solomon shows that Yahweh makes covenants with Yahweh's people and loyally loves his people, the Israelites. King Solomon also says that the people of Israel keep Yahweh's commands with all their heart. When someone does something "with all their heart," that person does that thing happily and well.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: King Solomon has changed from talking about Yahweh to talking to Yahweh. How will you make it clear that King Solomon is talking to Yahweh here? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon recognizes that Yahweh kept his earlier covenant with King David when Yahweh chose King Solomon to be king and allowed King Solomon to build the temple. Solomon says that Yahweh said the promise with his mouth, and Yahweh kept his promise with his hand, or with his power. King Solomon is saying that the Israelites can see that Yahweh kept his promise because Yahweh has made King Solomon, David's son, king of Israel, and King Solomon has built the house for Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you translate that Yahweh said a promise with his mouth and kept the promise with his hand, or power? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon now asks Yahweh to keep another specific covenant that Yahweh made with King David. King Solomon quotes Yahweh when King Solomon refers to how Yahweh promised King David that Yahweh would continue to give the people of Israel a king from King David's family line. David's descendants must follow Yahweh's commands just as King David did. King Solomon wants Yahweh to continue this covenant with King Solomon.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: This section has a quote from Yahweh inside King Solomon's prayer. In your language, how can you translate this to show when Solomon speaks his own words and when Solomon quotes Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the prayers of King Solomon and Yahweh's people. First, King Solomon asks this question: "Will God really live on earth? The heavens cannot hold you, and neither can this temple!" Solomon means that he does not believe that Yahweh is supposed to live only in the temple on earth. King Solomon understands that if heaven cannot contain Yahweh, a temple that people built cannot contain Yahweh either. King Solomon is asking a question that he does not expect Yahweh to answer. Instead, Solomon is praising Yahweh for being so great that Yahweh cannot live in one place.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this section to show that King Solomon believes that Yahweh can live anywhere, and no one place is the only place Yahweh lives? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon begs Yahweh to respond to the prayers that King Solomon and the people of Israel pray now and will pray in the future. King Solomon asks Yahweh to open Yahweh's eyes and to give full attention to Yahweh's people's prayers and to what happens in the temple during the day and the night, or all the time. To open your eyes to something means to pay attention and watch what happens, just as a person with their eyes open can see and pay attention to something.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you speak about the way that someone pays attention to something or someone? Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 8:22–30

King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear and listen to King Solomon and the people of Israel when they pray anytime during the day or night. King Solomon again quotes Yahweh when King Solomon says that Yahweh once promised that Yahweh's "Name would be there" in one place for people to worship Yahweh. King Solomon probably wants to show that Yahweh promises to be present in the temple to meet with the people. King Solomon finishes this part of the prayer when Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the supplications of Yahweh's people when they pray in the temple. Supplication is a way that people can pray to Yahweh. In this case, the people are strongly asking Yahweh to do something for them.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you strongly ask God to do something for you? Pause this audio here.

You will notice that King Solomon speaks about himself in this section as if Solomon were speaking about someone else. King Solomon calls himself Yahweh's "servant."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show that Solomon is talking about himself when he refers to Yahweh's servant? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon asks Yahweh to forgive the people of Israel when Yahweh hears the prayers that the people pray "towards this place," the temple. If the Israelites were not near the temple, the Israelites could face the direction of the temple to pray, to show that they were praying to Yahweh. King Solomon expects that Yahweh will hear these prayers and Yahweh will forgive his people of their disobedience. Yahweh will answer these prayers from heaven, the place where Yahweh lives.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:22–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Storyteller
- King Solomon
- People of Israel
- King David
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses. The storyteller should share the drama.

Before King Solomon prayed to dedicate the temple to Yahweh, King Solomon turned to face the altar in the temple court. The people of Israel stood behind King Solomon as King Solomon spread his hands to heaven to pray to Yahweh.

1 Kings 8:22–30

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I wonder what King Solomon is going to say? or
- I feel like I can trust King Solomon to lead us! or
- I need to focus on what King Solomon will pray for!

Continue the drama.

King Solomon began his prayer when Solomon praised Yahweh and recognized that no other god exists anywhere on earth, above the earth, or below the earth that can ever compare to Yahweh. King Solomon recognized that Yahweh is trustworthy to keep Yahweh’s covenants with people who keep Yahweh’s commands. King Solomon also recognized that Yahweh kept the covenant that Yahweh had made with King David when Yahweh chose Solomon to be king and allowed King Solomon to build the temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I love my servant, King Solomon! or
- I feel honored by King Solomon! or
- I remember the covenant I made with King David.

Continue the drama.

King Solomon then asked Yahweh to keep another covenant that Yahweh had made with King David. King Solomon asked Yahweh to always provide a new king from King David’s family line to sit on Israel’s throne. King Solomon also recognized that David’s descendants must keep Yahweh’s commands in order to continue to rule Israel. King Solomon asked Yahweh to fulfill this promise.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I hope Yahweh continues to be trustworthy! or
- I wonder if Yahweh is hearing my prayers! or
- I feel nervous that Yahweh will change his mind!

Continue the drama.

King Solomon again acknowledged how big and powerful Yahweh is. King Solomon asked, “But, will God really live on earth?” King Solomon recognized that heaven cannot contain Yahweh’s power, and the temple is not supposed to contain Yahweh either. Instead, King Solomon asked Yahweh’s name to rest in the temple as Yahweh had promised in another covenant to Moses. King Solomon asked Yahweh to open Yahweh’s eyes to all that happens in the temple, both day and night. King Solomon wanted Yahweh to hear the prayers that both King Solomon and the people of Israel prayed in the temple. King Solomon asked Yahweh to hear the pleas of the people and to forgive the people of Israel when Yahweh hears their prayers.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Solomon is right! Nothing can contain me! or
- I am honored to have my name in the temple! or
- I will hear the people’s prayers!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:22–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 8:22–30

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **King** Solomon turns away from the **assembly** of **Israel** and faces the **altar** of Yahweh. In the temple, the altar is a large structure where priests make burnt animal sacrifices. King Solomon stretches out his hands to heaven and prays to **Yahweh**. Heaven is the place where Yahweh lives with his angels. Use the same words or phrases for assembly, altar, king, Yahweh, Israelites, and Israel as you have in previous passages. For more information, refer to these words in the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **heaven**. Look up heaven in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon honors Yahweh as the only **God** among other **gods**. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. Look up God in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that there is no god like Yahweh. For more information about how to talk about false gods that are not Yahweh, refer to “gods” in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Solomon says that Yahweh kept his **covenant** of **steadfast love** with Yahweh’s **servants,** who are Solomon, David, and the Israelites. This covenant is a commitment that requires both people to keep promises to each other. Use the same words or phrases for covenant, steadfast love, and servants as you have used in previous passages. Covenant, steadfast love, and servant are in the Master Glossary.

King Solomon reminds Yahweh that Yahweh promised that there would be a **descendant** of David on the **throne** of Israel forever. Use the same words or phrases for descendants and throne as you have used in previous passages. Descendants is in the Master Glossary.

King Solomon recognizes that King Solomon’s **temple** cannot contain Yahweh! King Solomon knows that Yahweh’s **name** is the most important part of the temple. Use the same words or phrases for temple and the name of Yahweh as you have used in previous passages. Temple is in the Master Glossary.

King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the prayers and supplications of the people of Israel. When someone prays, that person is talking to God. Supplication is a type of prayer when people ask humbly, but very strongly, for Yahweh to hear them and answer them.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **supplication** and **pray**. Look up prayer in the Master Glossary for more information about the different types of prayers to Yahweh. If you have already translated these types of prayers in another book of the Bible, you may be able to use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon asks that Yahweh hear the people’s prayers and then forgive the people. When Yahweh forgives people, Yahweh has mercy on them and does not punish them as they deserve.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **forgive**. Forgive is in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 8:22–30

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (922 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 8:31–53

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 8:31–53 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:31–53 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:31–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, King Solomon continues the prayer to Yahweh that Solomon began praying in the previous passage. In this section, King Solomon makes seven requests to Yahweh. King Solomon mostly talks to Yahweh about the whole nation of Israel. In each request, King Solomon gives examples of what may happen, and then King Solomon asks Yahweh to respond in a certain way.

First, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about oaths or promises that people might make to one another because one person has done something wrong to someone else. In this case, both people must stand before the altar in front of the temple and allow Yahweh to judge who is telling the truth. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear both people's arguments and then punish the guilty person and show who is innocent.

Stop here and look at an image of the temple and of an image of the altar in the temple courtyard. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people decide who is telling the truth and who is lying? How do people decide if someone is guilty or innocent? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon knows how the people of Israel have disobeyed Yahweh before, and Yahweh has allowed enemy armies to conquer the people. In his second request, King Solomon asks Yahweh for something in the future. Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the people of Israel when they repent and turn back to Yahweh after an enemy army defeats the people of Israel because they disobeyed. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear from heaven and listen to the people's prayers in the temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of a time when you prayed for a situation that had not happened yet. What did you pray, and why? Pause this audio here.

In King Solomon's third request, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about drought. Drought can happen when there is no rain for a long period of time. Again, King Solomon seems to expect that drought will happen, and King Solomon also recognizes that Yahweh may bring the drought because of the people's sins. King Solomon asks Yahweh to listen and respond to the people of Israel when the people of Israel realize that they have sinned and turn back to Yahweh and pray. King Solomon prays that Yahweh would forgive the people of Israel. Then King Solomon asks that Yahweh would teach the people of Israel how to live in the right way. Finally, King Solomon then asks that Yahweh would end the drought and send rain on the land that Yahweh promised to the people of Israel as their inheritance.

Stop here and look at an image of the effects of drought. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at an image of land that is flourishing from rain. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about a time when your land had no rain for a long time. What happened to the plants? What happened to the animals and people? How did you feel and respond? Pause this audio here.

In King Solomon's fourth request, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about any kind of disaster in the land. First, King Solomon talks about famine and "plague" or terrible sickness. Famine means that people have no food. Terrible sickness means that people have diseases, and that the diseases have spread to many people. King Solomon then lists specific events that could happen, such as hot and dry winds, moisture that rots crops, locusts or grasshoppers, and people who attack from another country. Locusts and grasshoppers are both insects that can easily destroy crops when they eat the crops quickly. A siege happens when an enemy surrounds a city and prevents the people in the city from trading or receiving any supplies or food. In time, the people in the city would have no choice but to leave their city and fight. Again, King Solomon knows the typical problems that his people will have.

Stop here and look at an image of a blighted plant. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at an image of a plant with mildew. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at images of grasshoppers and locusts. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Think about your community's history and even your family's history. Talk about a time when you or your community experienced a terrible sickness or drought. Share your experiences with the group. Pause this audio here.

The people of Israel must recognize the suffering they have "in their hearts" and turn to Yahweh. King Solomon says that the people will spread their hands to the temple to show that they know that God, who lives in the temple among the people of Israel, is the source of their help. The people must pray and strongly ask for Yahweh's forgiveness. King Solomon then simply asks Yahweh to do two things: Forgive and act. King Solomon recognizes that only Yahweh knows every person's motives and attitudes, and King Solomon asks Yahweh to choose how to respond to each person. King Solomon asks Yahweh to remind each person who Yahweh is and that they should honor Yahweh for as long as the people live in Yahweh's land that Yahweh has given to the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you normally pray in your culture? What kinds of things do you normally pray for? Pause this audio here.

In King Solomon's fifth request, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about foreigners who are not Israelites but who hear and believe in Yahweh. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the foreigner's prayers, because the foreigner has heard people speak about Yahweh's power and strength. King Solomon then boldly asks Yahweh to do whatever the foreigner asks. King Solomon believes that the foreigner can tell all people about the character of the God

of Israel, so that all people, not just the Israelites, will fear Yahweh. Lastly, King Solomon wants all people to know that the temple bears Yahweh's name and Yahweh's name alone. Then people will know that the temple is the place where God is present and that they should worship God there.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about a time when you prayed for or were kind to foreigners who used to be your enemies. Share your story with the group. Pause this audio here.

In King Solomon's sixth request, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh and asks Yahweh to give victory to the people of Israel when Yahweh tells them to fight a war with enemies. King Solomon describes to Yahweh that the people will look toward the city that Yahweh has chosen for the people of Israel. The people will also look toward where the temple is as the people pray. When this happens, King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the people's prayers and supplications, to make the Israelites strong, and to cause the Israelites to defeat their enemies.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people do with their bodies when they pray? Pause this audio here.

Finally, King Solomon talks about the times when the Israelites will sin [and when enemy armies will force the Israelites to leave their own land and be slaves in a foreign land.]{.mark} Even though Yahweh is angry when the Israelites sin, King Solomon asks Yahweh to listen to the Israelites' prayer when they turn back to Yahweh and obey him. The Israelites must confess that they have sinned and decide to change before Yahweh will forgive the Israelites and save them. If the people then pray, King Solomon asks that Yahweh save the people of Israel from their captors and cause the enemies to show compassion to the Israelites! King Solomon also reminds Yahweh of how the people of Israel are Yahweh's chosen people, whom Yahweh rescued from their very difficult situation in Egypt, which he compares to a hot furnace!

Stop here and look at an image of a furnace. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people show that they are truly sorry and show that they will act in a different way? Pause this audio here.

To close his prayer, King Solomon now asks for blessings and recognizes who Yahweh is and what Yahweh has done. King Solomon asks Yahweh to see and listen to all that the people of Israel pray to Yahweh and to hear what King Solomon prays. King Solomon reminds Yahweh that Yahweh chose the people of Israel out of all the other people to be Yahweh's inheritance. King Solomon reminds Yahweh that Yahweh declared that the Israelites were his own people since the time of Moses. King Solomon honors what Yahweh did for the people of Israel by calling him Adonai Yahweh as a sign of respect. King Solomon asks Yahweh to continue to listen to and answer the people of Israel.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:31–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has eight scenes. Even though King Solomon is praying during the whole scene, it may be easier to act out Solomon's separate requests as separate scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon asks Yahweh to judge people when one person accuses another person of doing something wrong.

In the second scene: King Solomon asks Yahweh to save the Israelites from their enemies, to return the Israelites to the land Yahweh gave them, and to forgive the Israelites when they pray and turn back to Yahweh.

In the third scene: King Solomon asks Yahweh to forgive the Israelites when they pray and to send rain to end the drought.

In the fourth scene: King Solomon asks Yahweh to forgive the Israelites when they pray and to stop disease and disaster from happening.

In the fifth scene: King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear foreigners when they pray to Yahweh.

In the sixth scene: King Solomon asks Yahweh to give the Israelites victory when Yahweh sends the Israelites to fight enemies.

In the seventh scene: King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear and forgive the Israelites when they pray and to release them from captivity by their enemies.

In the eighth scene: King Solomon prays for Yahweh to see and listen to all of the prayers of King Solomon and Israel.

The characters in this passage are:

- Storyteller
- King Solomon
- Yahweh
- People of Israel—this group can act out any part of the drama with people of Israel
- Two people at the altar
- Enemies of Israel—this group can act out any part of the drama with enemies
- Foreigners
- All peoples of the earth
- The Israelites' ancestors
- And Moses

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, each scene represents a different part of King Solomon's prayer to Yahweh. Each scene seems to act as a shorter prayer within the larger prayer. King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about seven situations that will probably happen in Israel. These situations are things that Yahweh has talked about before. Yahweh has promised that Yahweh will act in the way that Solomon asks him to now. Just like the beginning of this prayer, Solomon asks Yahweh to do what Yahweh promised. King Solomon also asks Yahweh to show mercy on the people of Israel when they repent.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you pray for things or situations that might happen in the future? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon seems to use a pattern when he prays. King Solomon recognizes that something will happen. King Solomon then mentions whether or not the people's sins have caused the thing to happen. King Solomon says that the people must be sorry and ask for Yahweh's forgiveness. Solomon asks that Yahweh hear the people and forgive the people. Lastly, Solomon asks that Yahweh give something to the people in a specific way. This is a common pattern for most scenes.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think back through each section and notice the pattern. Notice how King Solomon uses a lot of the same phrases throughout the prayer. How can you show this pattern in your translation? You will probably want to translate these phrases in the same way throughout the prayer. Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about what to do if someone accuses a neighbor of doing something against the person. In this situation, a neighbor can mean a friend or any other person. King Solomon says that both people will stand in front of the altar in the temple courtyard and take an oath, or a strong promise, that they are innocent. King Solomon then asks Yahweh to judge who is telling the truth. King Solomon asks Yahweh to punish the person who does something wrong and to also clear the innocent person of any judgment.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people talk when they want to emphasize that they are telling the truth? What kinds of words or phrases do you have that might be the same as what King Solomon uses for "oath" in this passage? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about when the Israelites sin and when Yahweh allows enemies to defeat the Israelites. King Solomon uses the word "when," which means that King Solomon expects this situation to happen at some point. However, King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear when the Israelites pray and make supplication to Yahweh. You will remember that when people make supplication, people are very sincerely

and humbly begging Yahweh to do something for them. King Solomon also asks Yahweh to forgive the Israelites and return the Israelites to the land that Yahweh gave to their ancestors.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how can you describe supplication? Take time to review the words you used in the last passage for how the Israelites talk to Yahweh through supplication and prayer. Discuss which terms you can use in this passage. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about when the Israelites sin and when Yahweh "shuts up the heavens," which means that Yahweh stops rain from falling from the sky.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate that Yahweh has "shut up the heavens," or stopped rain from falling from the sky? Pause this audio here.

When there is a drought, it does not rain for a very long time. A drought can make it difficult for people to grow crops and make food. Again, King Solomon recognizes that the people of Israel may sin against Yahweh and cause the drought. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the prayers of the people and to forgive the people. King Solomon also asks Yahweh to teach the people of Israel the right way to act and then to send rain down onto the land that Yahweh gave as an inheritance to the people of Israel. Many years before, Yahweh gave the land of Israel as a gift to the Israelites. This is not the same as an inheritance that a person receives after someone dies. Yahweh provides the land of Israel, this special place, for the Israelites because Yahweh loves and provides for the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you describe that Yahweh has given the land to the people of Israel as an inheritance? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, King Solomon begins to list different types of disasters that could happen to the people of Israel. King Solomon says that the people of Israel could experience famine or plague. Famine is when a large part of the population cannot grow crops and has no food. King Solomon lists different ways that this may happen, like blight, mildew, locusts, or grasshoppers, which all destroy plants that people eat. King Solomon also talks about when an enemy besieges or surrounds an Israelite city. Then the people inside would run out of food. King Solomon finishes the list by saying "whatever disaster or disease" and seems to make sure that he is listing every possible disaster. When these disasters happen, the people can pray to Yahweh, just as Yahweh said they can. The people of Israel must recognize the suffering they "hold in their hearts." This means that the Israelites recognize that they are suffering because they have sinned. Yahweh knows what is "in our hearts," or what we think or feel. The Israelites have sinned. The Israelites must ask God to forgive them and must stop sinning. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the prayers and forgive the people. King Solomon also asks Yahweh to deal with each person so that each person will always "fear," or honor, Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what words do you have like "fear" that can have different meanings? How can you show that fear means to honor Yahweh in this passage? Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about foreigners who may hear about Yahweh and travel to where the people of Israel live. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the prayers of the foreigners who believe and pray towards the temple. King Solomon knows that if Yahweh hears a foreigner's prayer and answers the prayer, the people of Israel and all people will see what Yahweh does and how Yahweh answers, and will know who Yahweh is and fear him. King Solomon wants everyone to know that the temple only exists for people to honor and praise Yahweh's name. When King Solomon talks about Yahweh's strength and power, Solomon says that Yahweh's name is great, Yahweh has a mighty hand, and Yahweh has an outstretched arm. This means that Yahweh is strong and powerful and deserves the highest honor.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In this passage, King Solomon says that the temple exists for Yahweh's name. In your culture, how do names show the character and reputation of a person? How can you translate this passage to show why Yahweh's name and reputation were important in the temple? How will you translate that Yahweh has a mighty hand and outstretched arm, or that Yahweh has great power? Pause this audio here.

In the sixth scene, King Solomon asks Yahweh to give the people of Israel victory when Yahweh sends the people of Israel to fight against other nations. The people of Israel must turn in the direction of the city where Yahweh

is, and the people must pray towards the temple. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the prayers and pleas and to cause the Israelites to win!

In the seventh scene, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about captivity. King Solomon recognizes that the people of Israel will sin. King Solomon also says that Yahweh will allow other nations to capture the people of Israel and keep them in captivity. This is the punishment that Yahweh promised if the Israelites continued to sin against Yahweh. However, King Solomon asks Yahweh to see and hear when the people of Israel turn back to Yahweh with their heart and soul and pray for Yahweh's forgiveness. King Solomon uses the words "sin," "wrong," and "evil" to show how much they realize that they have acted in horrible ways against Yahweh. King Solomon knows that the people must show that they need forgiveness and must ask Yahweh with sincere prayers to forgive them. King Solomon asks Yahweh then to forgive the people and to bring the people back to the land that Yahweh gave as inheritance to the people of Israel when they left Egypt. King Solomon compares Egypt to an iron-smelting furnace! An iron-smelting furnace is a chamber that melts iron with very high heat and pressure. In this case, the furnace is an image that represents the suffering that Israel endured in Egypt.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: This passage speaks about a person's heart and soul and how a person makes decisions. In your language, how can you translate "heart and soul" to show how a person changes their behavior and decides to act differently? Pause this audio here.

In the eighth scene, King Solomon finishes this long series of requests by asking Yahweh to open his eyes to King Solomon's and the Israelites' prayers. Throughout the prayer, King Solomon uses different body parts, like Yahweh's eyes or outstretched hand, to describe Yahweh. This does not mean that Yahweh has the body of a human. King Solomon uses this special language to help the Israelites understand Yahweh's power and actions. King Solomon seems to give a reason why Yahweh should listen to the people of Israel. King Solomon says that Yahweh chose the people of Israel out of every other nation and called the people of Israel "Yahweh's inheritance." King Solomon emphasizes this inheritance through the prayer as Solomon continues to refer to the Israelites as Yahweh's people. King Solomon reminds Yahweh that Yahweh said this to Moses as Yahweh led the ancestors of the people of Israel out of Egypt.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Throughout the prayer, King Solomon refers to the Israelites as Yahweh's people. In your culture, how do you include ways that God has shown his faithfulness in your stories and prayers? How can you show God's faithfulness when you share stories? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:31–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has eight scenes. Even though King Solomon prays a prayer for the whole scene, it may be easier to act out the separate requests as separate scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Storyteller
- King Solomon
- Yahweh
- People of Israel—this group can act out any part of the drama with people of Israel
- Two people at the Altar
- Enemies of Israel—this group can act out any part of the drama with enemies
- Foreigners
- All peoples of the Earth
- The Israelites' ancestors
- And Moses

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

1 Kings 8:31–53

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses. The storyteller should share the drama.

First, King Solomon prays to Yahweh about oaths that people swear when they disagree. King Solomon says that when a person brings harm to another person, the two people stand in front of the temple altar and make an oath and promise that they have not done a harmful act. King Solomon then asks Yahweh to judge the two people and to condemn the guilty person and show the innocence of the person who has not done a harmful act.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the guilty person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am afraid of what Yahweh will do! or
- I feel anxious that everyone will know what I did! or
- I should not have done this sin!

Continue the drama.

Second, King Solomon prays to Yahweh about when the Israelites sin and when Yahweh allows enemies to defeat the Israelites. When the Israelites turn back to Yahweh and praise Yahweh sincerely, King Solomon asks that Yahweh listen. Then Yahweh can forgive the people and bring the people of Israel back to the land that Yahweh promised to the people of Israel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Please hear my prayer, Yahweh! or
- I have faith that Yahweh will hear me! or
- I hope the people of Israel remember this prayer.

Continue the drama.

Third, King Solomon prays to Yahweh about drought in the land. King Solomon knows that Yahweh can make the rain stop when the people of Israel do not follow Yahweh. When drought happens in this way, King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the people of Israel when the people pray to Yahweh and no longer sin. King Solomon also asks Yahweh to teach the people the right way to live and to send rain down on the land that Yahweh gave to the people of Israel as an inheritance.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad when my people sin against me! or
- King Solomon is very wise; or
- I want to listen to my people when they pray.

Continue the drama.

1 Kings 8:31–53

Fourth, King Solomon prays to Yahweh about famine and plagues. King Solomon recognizes the different ways that famine can happen. King Solomon knows that the people of Israel will sin and that Yahweh will then allow blights, mildew, locusts, and grasshoppers to destroy their crops and enemies to besiege their cities. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the people when they are in the middle of any disaster or disease and begin to pray. King Solomon asks Yahweh to see the people as they spread their hands towards the temple and pray to Yahweh for forgiveness. King Solomon then asks Yahweh to forgive the people and to deal with each person because of what they think in their hearts. Yahweh knows what people think and how to treat each person so that each person will always fear and honor Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" A person might answer things like:

- We are going to lose all of our crops! or
- I am scared of what is going to happen next! or
- Why is this happening to us?

Continue the drama.

Fifth, King Solomon prays to Yahweh about how to treat foreigners who travel to Israel because they have heard about Yahweh. King Solomon recognizes that the foreigners will likely arrive because the foreigners have learned about Yahweh's great name, mighty hand, and outstretched arm! King Solomon then asks that Yahweh would hear the foreigner's prayer and give the foreigner whatever they ask for. King Solomon believes that all people will see what Yahweh does, will honor Yahweh, and will know that people honor Yahweh in the temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the foreigner, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so grateful to know Yahweh! or
- I trust that Yahweh will answer! or
- I must tell other people about Yahweh!

Continue the drama.

Sixth, King Solomon prays to Yahweh for victory for the people of Israel when Yahweh sends the Israelites to fight with their enemies in different places. King Solomon asks Yahweh to cause the Israelites to win when the people pray towards the city and temple.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We need Yahweh's help! or
- We must remember to pray to ask Yahweh for help; or
- I feel afraid of going to war!

Continue the drama.

Seventh, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh about possible captivity in the future. King Solomon realizes that the people of Israel may sin against Yahweh, and then enemies may capture the people. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the people as they pray from the different lands and ask for forgiveness. King Solomon asks Yahweh to forgive the people and to allow the captors to show mercy and release the people of Israel. King Solomon reminds Yahweh that the people of Israel are Yahweh's inheritance that Yahweh led out of Egypt.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I pray my people will never suffer in captivity again! or
- I hope Yahweh frees us in the future! or
- Please hear my prayers, Yahweh!

Continue the drama.

King Solomon finishes this series of smaller prayers by asking Yahweh to open Yahweh's eyes to the people of Israel and hear their prayers. King Solomon also asks Yahweh to hear King Solomon's pleas. King Solomon again reminds Yahweh that Yahweh chose the people of Israel out of all other nations to be Yahweh's inheritance. King Solomon refers back to when Yahweh spoke through Moses and led the people of Israel out of Egypt.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope the people of Israel follow Yahweh! or
- I hope Yahweh answers! or
- I feel at peace after praying to Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:31–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King Solomon begins to pray for neighbors, or people, who must take **oath**s before the **altar** in the **temple**. When two people disagree, those people must stand before the altar and take an oath to say that they are innocent. For more information on altar, temple, and oath, refer to the Master Glossary, and use the same words or phrases as you have in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **neighbor**. In this case, a neighbor can mean any person you interact with. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about neighbor. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon asks Yahweh to then **judge** Yahweh's **servants** and condemn the **guilty** person and vindicate the innocent person. In this passage, a servant is someone who is devoted to Yahweh. You will remember that when someone judges another person, they decide if that person is guilty or innocent. To condemn a person means to punish a person. To vindicate means to say that someone is innocent. For more information on judge, servants, and guilty, refer to the Master Glossary, and use the same words or phrases as you have in previous passages.

King Solomon then speaks to Yahweh about future moments when the people of Israel might sin against Yahweh and another army defeats the Israelites. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the people when they **pray** for **forgiveness** and **praise** or thank Yahweh. King Solomon says that the people will pray in **supplication** in the temple. You will remember that supplication means to pray sincerely and humbly. In other words, the people of Israel need to show that they mean what they are praying. Then King Solomon asks Yahweh to forgive the people's **sins**. Sin is when a person does anything that goes against what Yahweh asks them to do. Use the same word or phrase for pray, forgive, supplication, and praise as you did in previous passages. Look up pray, forgive, and praise in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sin**. Look up sin in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon then says that Yahweh shuts up the heavens so that it does not rain**,** which means that Yahweh brings drought. King Solomon talks about "heavens" to mean the sky from which rain falls, and not the place where Yahweh lives.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **heaven**. If you have already translated heaven to mean "sky" in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Look up heaven in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the prayers of the people and to send rain to the land that Yahweh gave to the people of Israel as their inheritance. In this passage, King Solomon also says that Yahweh calls the Israelites

his inheritance, or treasure. This means that the land belongs to the Israelites because Yahweh has given it to them, and that the people of Israel belong to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **inheritance**. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon then speaks to Yahweh about famine and plague. Famine happens when people experience a widespread loss of crops and food. Plague happens when diseases, illnesses, or disasters spread to many people. King Solomon also lists other things that cause famine, such as blight, mildew, grasshoppers, locusts, and a siege on a city. Blight is when hot and dry winds blow and destroy crops. Mildew is when plants become too damp and rot. To besiege a city means that people from another land surround a city so that people cannot leave the city or receive supplies from outside the city walls.

Stop here and look at the photos again of a land that has experienced blight or mildew. Look at photos of grasshoppers and locusts. Discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **famine**, **plague**, **disease**, **blight**, **mildew**, **grasshoppers**, **locusts**, and **siege**. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about siege. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh knows people's **hearts**, and Yahweh wants everyone to fear Yahweh. You will remember that a person's heart is the way that people in the Bible talked about where a person's thoughts, feelings, and decisions happen. When someone fears Yahweh, they honor and respect Yahweh very much. Use the same word or phrase for heart as you have used previously, and refer to heart in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate that people should **fear** Yahweh. For more information, refer to "fear of God" in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon wants Yahweh to protect the land that Yahweh gave to the **ancestors** of the people of Israel. Ancestors are people in a person's family who are older than that person or lived before that person. Use the same word or phrase for ancestors as you used in previous passages.

King Solomon then speaks to Yahweh about the foreigner who might hear about Yahweh and travel to where the people of Israel live. King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the foreigner when the foreigner prays towards the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **foreigner**. Look up foreigner in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon then speaks to Yahweh about the people of Israel going to war. King Solomon asks **Yahweh** to bring victory to the people of Israel when they pray to Yahweh in the city and temple that honors Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. Look up Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information.

King Solomon then prays to Yahweh about captivity. King Solomon again knows that the people will likely sin and that captors, or enemies who capture the people, will take the people and hold them captive in another land.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **captive** and **captor**. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon asks Yahweh to hear the people when they repent or turn away from their sins and return to follow Yahweh. The people stop acting in wrong and wicked ways.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **repent** and **wicked**. Look up repent and wicked in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon says that the people turn back to Yahweh with their "**heart and soul**," which means they show that they are completely devoted to Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases for "heart and soul" as you used in 1 Kings 2:4, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about soul.

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King Solomon prays that Yahweh will cause the captors to show mercy and that the people will leave other lands the way the people left Egypt. When a person shows mercy to another person, they act kindly toward them.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **mercy**. Look up mercy in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon compares Egypt to an iron-smelting furnace.

Stop here and look at the picture of an **iron-smelting furnace** again as a group. What words will you use to translate this? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon finishes his prayer by asking Yahweh to open Yahweh's eyes and ears to all that King Solomon and the people of Israel are praying. King Solomon uses the special name of **Adonai** Yahweh to show how much he honors Yahweh. Adonai means master. Use the same title for Adonai Yahweh here as you used in 1 Kings 2:26, and refer to Adonai in the Master Glossary for more information.

King Solomon reminds Yahweh that Yahweh chose Israel over all other **nations** to hold Yahweh's inheritance. Use the same word or phrase for nations as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **Adonai**. Look up Adonai in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (947 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (10.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (6.8 MB)

- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 8:54–61

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 8:54–61 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:54–61 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:54–61 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, King Solomon prayed to Yahweh. Solomon asked Yahweh to help the people of Israel whenever the Israelites ask for help. In this passage, Solomon blesses the Israelites.

While Solomon prayed in the last story, Solomon first stood, then knelt in front of Yahweh's altar. At the beginning of this story, Solomon stands up to bless the Israelites. A blessing is similar to a prayer. Solomon asks that Yahweh do good things for the people of Israel. Solomon wants the close relationship between Yahweh and the Israelites to continue.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you bless people in your culture? Why do you bless one another? How is a blessing different than a prayer? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When Solomon prays, Solomon stands with his arms raised, and then Solomon kneels. What do you do with your body when you pray? When Solomon blesses the people, Solomon stands and speaks loudly. What do you do with your body when you bless someone? Pause this audio here.

Solomon first "blesses" or worships Yahweh. Solomon thanks and praises Yahweh because Yahweh has caused the Israelites to have rest from war. Because of Yahweh, the Israelites do not have to fight their enemies but can live peacefully. Long ago, Yahweh promised the Israelites' ancestors that Yahweh would bring the Israelites to a place where the Israelites could live peacefully. Yahweh told this promise to Moses, Yahweh's servant. Then Moses told the Israelites what Yahweh had said. Yahweh made other promises to the Israelites as well, and Yahweh has kept every promise Yahweh made.

Solomon asks that Yahweh continue to be with the Israelites, just like Yahweh was with the Israelites' ancestors. Solomon also asks that Yahweh help the Israelites love and focus on Yahweh. Then the Israelites can live in a way that pleases Yahweh and obey Yahweh's commands. Remember that Yahweh also gave Moses and the Israelites' ancestors a set of instructions that showed the Israelites how to live in the right way. Solomon wants Yahweh to help the Israelites live in this good and right way.

Solomon also asks that Yahweh always remember what Solomon prayed today. Solomon is probably not worried that Yahweh will forget what Solomon said. Solomon wants Yahweh to pay attention to what the Israelites need and help the Israelites in every situation, just like Solomon asked when Solomon prayed. When other people groups see how Yahweh helps the Israelites, then those people will understand that Yahweh is the only true God. People will then know that all the false gods that other people worship are not real, like Yahweh is.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when God did something amazing in your community. How did people react? What did people say about God? Pause this audio here.

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Finally, Solomon asks that the Israelites be completely faithful to Yahweh, their God. Right now, the Israelites honor and obey Yahweh. The Israelites have built the temple, offered sacrifices, and focused on Yahweh. The Israelites obey Yahweh's statutes and commands, so this is a beautiful and joyful time! Solomon says, "May you Israelites always act like this!"

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone blessed someone else during a celebration, like at a wedding. What did the person say in this blessing?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:54–61 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Solomon finishes his prayer and then blesses the Israelites. First, Solomon praises Yahweh and asks that Yahweh never leave the Israelites.

In the second scene: Solomon asks that the people follow Yahweh faithfully.

In the third scene: Solomon asks that Yahweh act justly to help Solomon and the Israelites, so that all people will know that Yahweh is truly God. The Israelites should be faithful in response to Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Yahweh, the Israelites' God
- The Israelites
- Moses, Yahweh's servant
- The Israelites' ancestors
- And all the people on earth

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that when Solomon began to pray a few passages ago, Solomon stood in front of the altar in the temple courtyard. Solomon lifted his hands towards God in heaven. In the first scene in this passage, the storyteller tells us that at some point during his prayer, Solomon knelt or bowed down on his knees. Now Solomon has finished his prayer, so Solomon stands up again. The storyteller uses two words to describe how Solomon prayed. These words mean about the same thing and are the same two words Solomon himself used in Solomon's prayer. The first word is a general word for prayer, while the second word is a special kind of prayer that means to ask Yahweh for help.

As Solomon stands now, Solomon speaks loudly and blesses all the people of Israel who had gathered at the temple. Solomon's blessing is like a prayer, because Solomon asks that Yahweh do certain things. But instead of talking to God, Solomon talks to the Israelites about God. Solomon says, "May Yahweh do these things, and may you, the Israelites, do these things."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you bless someone, who do you speak to? Who do you ask to give good things to the person you bless? Discuss how you will show that Solomon's blessing is different than Solomon's prayer. Pause this audio here.

To begin his blessing, Solomon says, "Bless Yahweh!" To bless Yahweh means to worship and praise Yahweh, so some translations say "Praise Yahweh" here. Solomon both praises Yahweh and urges the Israelites to praise Yahweh too. Solomon praises Yahweh because Yahweh has given rest to the Israelites, which means that Yahweh has caused the Israelites to live safely and peacefully. The Israelites do not have to fear that enemies will attack.

This is exactly what Yahweh promised to the Israelites' ancestors many years ago. Yahweh made many promises to the Israelites, which Yahweh told to Moses, Yahweh's servant. Moses then told the Israelites' ancestors what

Yahweh promised. Solomon says that not one word of Yahweh's promises has failed. This means that Yahweh kept every promise that Yahweh made.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about the way that someone does all that they promise to do? Discuss how you want to translate the way that Solomon says that Yahweh has kept all of his promises. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has constantly been with and helped the Israelites' ancestors. Solomon asks that Yahweh continue to be with the Israelites now. Notice how Solomon says this in three different ways. Solomon asks that Yahweh be with the Israelites, that Yahweh never leave the Israelites, and that Yahweh never abandon the Israelites. Solomon uses these different ways to say the same thing to show how strongly Solomon wants this.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you emphasize something that is important to you? When are some times when you would say what you want in a few different ways? Discuss how you will translate what Solomon says here. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Solomon asks that Yahweh "incline" or turn the people's hearts to Yahweh. Remember that people used the heart to represent the part of a person where a person feels, thinks, and makes decisions. When someone's heart is "for" someone, that person loves and is completely loyal to that person. So Solomon wants Yahweh to help the Israelites love and be loyal to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you talk about the way that someone deeply loves and is devoted and loyal to someone? Discuss how you want to translate the way Solomon wants Yahweh to turn the Israelites' hearts to Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

If the Israelites love Yahweh, the Israelites will want to walk in obedience. Remember that "to walk" means to live or behave. Solomon wants the Israelites to obey Yahweh and live as Yahweh wants. Solomon wants the Israelites to obey Yahweh's commands, ordinances, and statutes. Remember that people often use these words together to talk about all of Yahweh's commands. These are the religious laws that Yahweh gave to the Israelites' ancestors for all the Israelites to obey.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If you want, review or remind each other how you have translated Yahweh's commands, ordinances, and statutes earlier in this book. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Solomon asks that Solomon's words be near to Yahweh. Solomon wants Yahweh to remember or pay attention to what Solomon has prayed in the last few passages. It is easy to remember or pay attention to something that is near you! Remember that Solomon prayed for things that would happen in the future, such as when the Israelites fight their enemies. When those things happen in the future, Solomon wants Yahweh to remember what Solomon asked today. Solomon wants Yahweh to remember Solomon's prayer during both the day and the night, which is another way to say "always."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you talk about the way someone does something and never stops doing that thing? How would you urge someone to remember what you said? Discuss how you want to translate the way Solomon asks that Yahweh always remember Solomon's prayer. Pause this audio here.

Solomon asks that Yahweh would act justly towards Solomon and the Israelites. Some translations say that Yahweh would uphold the cause of Solomon and the Israelites. Remember that Solomon also prayed this in the last passage. Solomon wants Yahweh to treat the Israelites fairly and help them. Solomon asks this respectfully and calls himself Yahweh's servant. Solomon wants Yahweh to help the Israelites so that other people can see what Yahweh is like. Then all the people groups all over the world will understand that Yahweh is truly God and that there is no other God.

Finally, Solomon wants the Israelites to fully commit their hearts to Yahweh. Solomon means that the Israelites should be completely faithful to Yahweh. Notice how Solomon emphasizes that Yahweh is the Israelites' God. The Israelites should be faithful to their own God! The Israelites should obey Yahweh's commands, just like the Israelites do now. The Israelites must live in a way that pleases Yahweh. When Solomon says this blessing, Solomon both asks Yahweh that this would happen, but also asks the people to continue to act in this good way.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about some times when you would bless people who are about to do something, such as at a wedding. Perhaps you would say something to the new husband and wife like, “May you be good and faithful to each other.” When you say something like this, how do you expect the new husband and wife to respond? What do you want those people to do? What are some other blessings where you ask both God and people to do good things? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:54–61 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Yahweh, the Israelites’ God
- The Israelites
- Moses, Yahweh’s servant
- The Israelites’ ancestors
- And all the people on earth

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

While Solomon prayed in the last story, Solomon knelt in front of Yahweh’s altar and raised his hands to heaven. Then Solomon finished his prayer to Yahweh to ask for Yahweh’s help. Then Solomon stood up in front of Yahweh’s altar. As Solomon stood, Solomon loudly blessed all the people of Israel who had gathered there. Solomon said, “Praise Yahweh! Just as Yahweh promised, Yahweh has given his people, the Israelites, rest from war. Through his servant Moses, Yahweh gave many good promises. Yahweh has kept all of his promises.”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so thankful for all the good things Yahweh promised to do for us. Yahweh has done everything he said he would do! or
- I am so happy! We have finished this beautiful temple. We have a good land where we live peacefully. Yahweh has caused all this to happen! or
- I want the Israelites to remember that Yahweh deserves all praise for the good things we have.

Continue the drama.

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Then Solomon said, “May Yahweh our God be with us as Yahweh was with our ancestors. May Yahweh never leave us or abandon us. May Yahweh help us to love Yahweh, so that we live as Yahweh wants. May we follow the commands, decrees, and laws for justice that Yahweh gave to our ancestors.”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that the Israelites remember the good instructions that I have given them. These instructions will help the Israelites live peacefully with each other and have a good relationship with me; or
- I love the Israelites and want to have a good relationship with them. I want the Israelites to love me and be faithful to me; or
- Solomon honors me as he prays and blesses the people. Solomon leads the Israelites well, and I am pleased with Solomon.

Continue the drama.

Then Solomon said, “May Yahweh always remember these prayers I have prayed. May Yahweh act justly to help me, his servant, and his people, the Israelites. May Yahweh help us with whatever we need each day. Then all the nations of the earth will know that Yahweh is truly God, and that there are no other gods. May you Israelites be completely faithful to Yahweh, our God. May you obey Yahweh’s decrees and commands, just as you do today.”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I help the Israelites because I love the Israelites, but also so that the other nations will see who I am. I want all people everywhere to know that I am truly God; or
- I listen when people pray and remember what they ask; or
- I will continue to keep my promises and take care of the Israelites.

Ask the person playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so thankful that Yahweh is our God. Yahweh is powerful and has given many good things to us; or
- I am honored that Solomon blesses all of us. Solomon is a good king, and I am glad that Solomon leads us; or
- I have seen and heard many amazing things today. Solomon has told and reminded us what Yahweh is like. I want to obey Yahweh because Yahweh is such a good God.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:54–61 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

At the beginning of this passage, Solomon finishes his **prayer** and supplications. These two words can both refer to the way a person speaks to God. The first word is a general word for prayer, while the second means the way people ask Yahweh for help. For more information on prayer, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for prayer and supplication as you used in previous passages.

While Solomon prayed, Solomon knelt or **bowed** down. A person can bow down when they kneel. Sometimes, a person who kneels also puts their head to the ground. For more information on kneel or bow down, refer to bow in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for kneel or bow down as you used in previous passages.

Solomon also lifted his hands towards the **heavens**. Heaven or the heavens can mean both the sky and the place where God lives. In this case, Solomon seems to be lifting his hands toward God, who lives in heaven. For more information on heaven, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for heaven as you used in previous passages.

Then Solomon stands in front of **Yahweh’s altar**. An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to God. This is the bronze altar in the temple courtyard. Yahweh is God’s personal name. For more information

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on altar and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh's altar as you used in previous passages.

Solomon **blesses** the **assembly** of the people of Israel. You will remember that people form an assembly when they gather together for a special purpose. Use the same word or phrase for assembly as you did in previous passages. When a human speaks a blessing over another person, they pray that God will do good things for this other person. Solomon also blesses Yahweh. When a person blesses God, it means that they worship God and thank God for his goodness and blessings. So some translations say "Praise Yahweh" instead of "Bless Yahweh." For more information on bless or "praise," refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the way people bless each other, and for the way people bless God, as you used in previous passages.

Solomon says that Yahweh has given his people **rest**, which means that there is no more war or evil things happening around them. Use the same word or phrase for rest as you used in 1 Kings 5:4.

Solomon talks about Yahweh's people, **Israel**. Here, the word Israel means the same as Israelites, or as "people of Israel." For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

Solomon calls Moses Yahweh's **servant**. Solomon also calls himself Yahweh's servant. This is a respectful way to refer to yourself. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for servant as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh is the Israelites' **God**. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Solomon asks that Yahweh be with the Israelites like Yahweh was with the Israelites' "**fathers**," which here means ancestors. Use the same word or phrase for ancestors or fathers as you used in previous passages.

Solomon wants all the people groups of the earth to know Yahweh. A people group is a group of people who speak a common language and have a common culture. Although the storyteller does not say "nations of people," you may use the idea of a nation in your translation if you would like.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the **peoples** or "**nations**" of the earth. If necessary, refer to nation in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

Solomon asks that Yahweh turn the Israelites' **hearts** to Yahweh. People use the "heart" to mean the place where a person thinks, feels, and decides things. So Solomon wants Yahweh to cause the Israelites to love and be loyal to Yahweh. Solomon also asks that the Israelites fully commit their hearts to Yahweh. Solomon wants the Israelites to be completely faithful to Yahweh. For more information on heart, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for heart as you used in previous passages.

Solomon wants the Israelites to obey Yahweh's **commands**, **ordinances**, and **statutes**. A command is a law, a rule, or an instruction. A statute may refer to a special required task or instructions for living in society. When Solomon says commands, ordinances, and statutes, Solomon means the set of instructions that God has given the people of Israel. Sometimes people also call this the "**law**." You may choose to summarize these three words and just talk about Yahweh's commands to his people. For more information on commands, ordinances, statutes, and law, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for commands, ordinances, and statutes as you used in previous passages.

Solomon asks that Yahweh would give **justice** to the Israelites or treat the Israelites in a just way. Justice is when someone treats someone else fairly according to the law. For more information on justice, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for justice as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 8:54–61

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (799 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1002 KB)

1 Kings 8:62–66

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 8:62–66 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:62–66 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:62–66 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, King Solomon blessed the Israelites because Solomon wanted the good relationship between Yahweh and the Israelites to continue. In this passage, Solomon and the Israelites continue to celebrate Yahweh at the new temple. Solomon and the Israelites offer many sacrifices to Yahweh and celebrate a festival. At the end of two weeks, all the Israelites go home happy.

1 Kings 8:62–66

This passage begins right after Solomon blessed the Israelites in the last passage. Solomon and the Israelites offer many sacrifices to Yahweh in Yahweh's presence. Remember that the temple is where Yahweh said Yahweh's presence would be. Solomon and the Israelites give peace offerings to Yahweh there at the temple. People would give peace or fellowship offerings to show that they wanted to have a good relationship with Yahweh and to celebrate their relationship with Yahweh. People would completely burn the fat and certain parts of the animal to show that they gave those parts to God. Then the people and the priests would cook and eat the rest of the meat. For the peace offerings, Solomon and the Israelites give 22,000 cattle, which may include both male and female animals as well as adult and young animals. Cattle are animals like bulls and cows.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bull and a cow as a group. Pause this audio here.

Solomon and the Israelites also give 120,000 sheep and goats. The cattle, sheep, and goats are all for the peace offerings. Solomon and the Israelites give these offerings to dedicate or use the temple for the first time.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sheep and a goat as a group. Pause this audio here.

On the same day that Solomon and the Israelites dedicate the temple, Solomon also consecrates part of the temple. Solomon makes the middle part of the temple courtyard "holy" or acceptable for worship. This part of the courtyard is probably the court of the priests or the inner court.

Stop here and look at a diagram of the temple as a group. Find the inner court. Pause this audio here.

Solomon makes this area holy because the Israelites need more space to offer their sacrifices. The Israelites bring so many sacrifices that the priests cannot put all of the sacrifices on the bronze sacrifice altar. The bronze altar is too small! So the priests probably make some temporary altars in the holy space in the courtyard for the different kinds of offerings.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar as a group. In your culture, what kind of special places do people have to offer gifts to gods? When are some times when people would make temporary or extra places to offer gifts? How do people make these special places ready for people to use? Pause this audio here.

There are the burnt offerings, which are animals that people cut up and burn on the altar. There are also the grain offerings, which are grain that people would mix together with sweet-smelling spices and oil. The priests would also burn this grain mixture on an altar. The priests would also burn the fat of the peace offerings on the altar. The fat pieces included the inner organs and the fat on the organs.

In this way, King Solomon, together with all the people of Israel, celebrates the festival. We know from the time of year that this was the Festival of Tabernacles. Remember that this was the festival where the Israelites remembered how God took care of the Israelites while they traveled and lived in tents instead of in permanent houses. This was a yearly festival when the Israelites would all gather at the place of worship for the celebration. The Israelites come from all over the land of Israel. Israelites come from as far north as Lebo Hamath or the entrance of Hamath. This place could be a trail through the mountains or a city about 290 kilometers north of Jerusalem. This was the northern edge of the land Yahweh promised to the Israelites.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find Lebo Hamath. Pause this audio here.

Israelites also come from as far south as the "Wadi" or Brook of Egypt. A wadi is a valley or deep gully that is usually dry in the dry season but has rushing water in the rainy season. This is probably the Wadi-el-Arish, which is about 150 kilometers southwest of Jerusalem. This was the southern edge of the land Yahweh promised to the Israelites.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the Wadi-el-Arish. Look also at a picture of a wadi. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites celebrate for two weeks. The Israelites probably dedicate the temple for the first seven days. Then the Israelites celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles for the other seven days. At the end of that time, King Solomon sends all the Israelites back to their homes. The Israelites first bless King Solomon. In this time, people often blessed each other when they said goodbye. Then the Israelites travel home. The Israelites are happy because of what Yahweh has done for David and the Israelites. Remember that Yahweh promised David that David's son would build the temple. Solomon has built the beautiful temple, just like Yahweh promised!

1 Kings 8:62–66

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you say goodbye to one another? How would you respectfully say goodbye to a leader? What kind of special greetings or goodbyes do you say at celebration times?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:62–66 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon and the Israelites offer many animals as peace offerings to dedicate the temple.

In the second scene: King Solomon makes part of the temple courtyard holy for all of the offerings.

In the third scene: King Solomon and the Israelites celebrate for 14 days.

In the fourth scene: At the end of the celebration, King Solomon sends the Israelites to their homes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- The Israelites
- Yahweh
- David, Yahweh's servant
- And the priests

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, King Solomon and the Israelites offer sacrifices before Yahweh. Remember that when someone offers a sacrifice "before Yahweh," it might mean both that they offer the sacrifice to Yahweh and in Yahweh's presence, which is at the temple. In the next sentence, the storyteller says that Solomon offers many animals as peace offerings. The storyteller probably means that both King Solomon and all the Israelites offer these animals, since the storyteller then says that this is how King Solomon and the Israelites dedicate the temple.

King Solomon and the Israelites offer 22,000 cattle and 120,000 sheep and goats as peace or fellowship offerings. Although the storyteller does not mention the priests here, the priests and Levites probably sacrifice the animals. The people would help prepare the animals, but certain parts of the job were for the priests. The storyteller says that Solomon does things like offer sacrifices and dedicate the temple. Solomon probably had people to help him do these things, but Solomon was king and was in charge. Although the storyteller does not mention the priests in this passage, we know from the previous stories that the priests were there too.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a leader who did many things in your community. When are some times when you would mention all the people who helped the leader, and some times when you would just talk about how the leader led? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon and the Israelites offer the cattle, sheep, and goats to dedicate the temple. Here, to dedicate means to use something for the first time.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when your community finished a new building that had a specific purpose, like a church or a school. How did you celebrate that you could use the building for that purpose for the first time? How would you talk about the way that people celebrate that they can use something for the first time? Pause this audio here.

The second scene happens on the same day. King Solomon consecrates part of the temple courtyard. To consecrate something means to make it holy or acceptable for worship. Solomon consecrates this part of the temple courtyard to make more space for the sacrifices and offerings. Normally, the priests would offer sacrifices on the bronze altar. However, the altar is too small for all the sacrifices. So Solomon consecrates part of the temple

courtyard. Solomon probably does a ritual to prepare that part of the courtyard, and then priests probably set up some temporary altars there.

The storyteller says that Solomon then offers the burnt offerings, grain offerings, and fat pieces from the peace offerings in that part of the courtyard. It is possible that Solomon helped with the offerings, but the priests and Levites probably did most of the work, as that was their job.

In the third scene, the storyteller reminds us that Solomon and the Israelites also celebrate the festival at this time. Remember that although the storyteller does not say the name of the festival, we know that this is the Festival of Tabernacles because of the time of year that this story happens. This was a normal gathering time for the Israelites, so Israelites had gathered from all over Israel. The storyteller says that people came even from the north and south borders, to show that people came from all over Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Where are the borders of your people's land? What places in your land are farthest from where you live? In your language, how do you emphasize that people come from everywhere, even the farthest places? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also tells us how long Solomon and the Israelites celebrate at the temple. The storyteller says the Israelites celebrate for seven days and seven days more, 14 days in all. This probably means that the Israelites dedicate the temple for seven days, then celebrate the festival for seven more days. Some translations just say the Israelites celebrate for seven days, not 14, but it is more likely that the Israelites celebrated for 14 days. Notice how the storyteller says that the Israelites celebrate the feast before "Yahweh our God." The storyteller's God is Yahweh, too!

Stop here and discuss as a group how you want to translate the way the storyteller describes how long Solomon and the Israelites celebrated. How would you talk about a celebration that happens in two parts? How would you talk about the total time of the celebration? Pause this audio here.

The fourth scene happens at the end of the festival. The storyteller calls this the eighth day, which is probably the eighth day from the beginning of the Festival of Tabernacles. So this is at the end of the 14 days. King Solomon sends the Israelites back to their homes. First, the Israelites bless King Solomon. This may mean that the Israelites thank Solomon or ask God for good things for Solomon. This is a normal way to say goodbye.

Then the people travel home. The people are joyful and glad in their hearts, which is another way to say that the people are happy. The Israelites are happy because of what Yahweh has done for Yahweh's servant David and Yahweh's people, the Israelites. The Israelites probably think about how Yahweh did what Yahweh promised David and caused the Israelites to build the beautiful temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you celebrated something good with your community. How did you feel after you celebrated? Discuss how you want to translate about the way the Israelites were deeply happy and satisfied because of the good things Yahweh has done. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:62–66 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- The Israelites
- Yahweh
- David, Yahweh's servant
- And the priests

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

1 Kings 8:62–66

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Then King Solomon and all the people of Israel gave sacrifices to Yahweh. These sacrifices were peace offerings to Yahweh. The peace offerings were 22,000 cattle and 120,000 sheep and goats. So this was how King Solomon and all the Israelites dedicated the temple of Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I respect Yahweh so much that I want to honor Yahweh through my offerings; or
- I want to have a good relationship with Yahweh and will show this with my peace offering; or
- This is a wonderful time for our people! We have worked together to build the temple, and now we celebrate Yahweh together as a people.

Continue the drama.

On that same day, King Solomon made part of the courtyard holy. This was the center area of the courtyard in front of the house of Yahweh. There, King Solomon offered burnt offerings, grain offerings, and the fat pieces from the peace offerings. Solomon sacrificed in the courtyard because the bronze altar that stood before Yahweh was not large enough. The altar was too small to hold the burnt sacrifices, the grain offerings, and the fat pieces from the peace offerings.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed! The Israelites have brought so many offerings that we do not have enough space! I am so glad that the Israelites want to honor and celebrate Yahweh like this! or
- I am thankful that Yahweh has treated us so kindly. I want to show how thankful I am; or
- We have offered many sacrifices all day, and I am tired. But I am tired in a good way, because we have celebrated Yahweh and worked to honor Yahweh.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so pleased that my people show that they want a good relationship with me. That is what I want too! or
- The Israelites honor me like they promised they would. I also will protect and care for them as I promised I would; or
- I love to see when my people are happy and celebrate together! I feel happy when I see them happy like this!

Continue the drama.

In this way, King Solomon, together with all the people of Israel, celebrated the festival. There was a huge crowd of people. The people came from all over Israel, from Lebo Hamath in the north to the wadi at the border of Egypt in the south. The Israelites feasted before Yahweh our God for a week. Then the Israelites feasted for another week. So in total, the Israelites feasted for 14 days.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

1 Kings 8:62–66

- I am amazed that so many of our people have gathered here! or
- I am so happy! I have seen friends and family who live in other parts of Israel. I have met new people, and we have celebrated together; or
- I will never forget this celebration. I will tell stories to my children about how good and joyful this time is.

Continue the drama.

The day after, King Solomon sent the people to their homes. The people asked God to bless Solomon. Then the people went back to their homes. The people were very glad about all the good things Yahweh had done for David, Yahweh's servant and for the Israelites, Yahweh's people.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so happy and thankful for what Yahweh has done that I want to talk about Yahweh! I will remind everyone of what Yahweh has done! I will tell stories to my children and the people who come visit me; or
- Though the celebration is over, I do not feel sad. This has been a good time for our people and I hope we will celebrate Yahweh again in the future; or
- I have a long journey to travel home, but I am so glad I came to celebrate at the temple. I feel connected with my people. We have seen and reminded each other how amazing and good our God is.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 8:62–66 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King Solomon and all the people of **Israel** offer sacrifices to **Yahweh**. For more information on king, Israel, and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for king, Israel, and Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

A **sacrifice** is a gift to God. For more information on sacrifice, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sacrifice as you used in previous passages.

Solomon and the Israelites offer three kinds of sacrifices. The first kind of sacrifice is a **peace or fellowship offering**. People gave peace offerings to show that they wanted to fellowship with Yahweh and to celebrate their relationship with Yahweh. People would burn certain fatty parts of an animal to give it to Yahweh, and then cook and eat the rest of the meat. For more information on "peace or fellowship offering," refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for peace offering as you used in previous passages.

The second kind of sacrifice is a **burnt offering**. When a person brings God a burnt offering, he kills an animal and burns this animal completely on an altar. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offering as you used in previous passages.

The third kind of sacrifice is a grain offering. A grain offering was when people brought gifts of grain, like wheat flour, which they sometimes mixed with oil, to Yahweh as an act of worship. The priest would burn the offering on the altar to symbolically give it to God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **grain offering**. Look up grain offering in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon gives **cattle**, **sheep**, and **goats** for the peace offerings. This group of cattle may include male and female cattle, as well as young and adult bulls and cows. Use the same words or phrases for cattle, sheep, and goats as you used in previous passages.

Solomon and the Israelites dedicate the temple when they give these offerings. Here, to dedicate means to open or use something for the first time. To dedicate the temple means to worship God in the temple for the first time.

1 Kings 8:62–66

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **dedicate**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The **temple** is the place where people worship Yahweh. The temple's courtyard is an open area with a wall around it. This is where the bronze altar is. For more information on temple, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for temple and courtyard as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at the diagram of the temple again as a group as needed. Find the inner court. Pause this audio here.

Solomon consecrates part of the temple courtyard. When you consecrate something, you set that thing apart to do a special task for God. This thing is now holy and belongs to God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **consecrate**. Look up consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Normally, the priests offer the sacrifices on the **bronze altar**. People combine copper and tin to make bronze. The bronze altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to God in the temple courtyard. For more information on bronze and altar, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for bronze and altar as you used in previous passages.

Solomon and the Israelites celebrate the festival. This is the **Festival of Tabernacles**. During the festival, the Israelites lived in booths or temporary shelters. This helped the Israelites to remember how God took care of the Israelites while they traveled in the wilderness and lived in tents instead of in permanent houses. For more information on the Festival of Tabernacles, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for festival as you used in previous passages.

A big **assembly** of people comes to celebrate the festival. An assembly is a special group of people who get together for a certain purpose, like a religious meeting. Use the same word or phrase for assembly as you used in previous passages.

Israelites came from as far south as the Wadi of Egypt. A wadi is a valley or deep gully that is usually dry in the dry season but has rushing water in the rainy season.

Stop here and look at a picture of a wadi. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wadi**, or dry river valley. Use the same word or phrase for wadi as you used in previous books of the Bible. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh is the Israelites' **God**. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites **bless** Solomon and then travel home. When a human blesses another person, they pray that God will do good things for this other person. For more information on bless, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for bless as you used in previous passages.

As the Israelites travel, they are joyful and glad in their **hearts**. People use the word heart to mean the place where people think, feel, and decide things. Joyful and glad in your heart is another way to say that you are happy and content, or satisfied.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that the Israelites were joyful and glad in their hearts. Pause this audio here.

The **Israelites** are happy because of the good things Yahweh has done for Yahweh's **servant** David and the Israelites. For more information on servant and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for servant and Israelites as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 8:62–66

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (801 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1017 KB)

1 Kings 9:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 9:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Solomon and the Israelites dedicated the temple and celebrated a festival. Now, in this story, Yahweh speaks to Solomon in a dream. Yahweh commands Solomon to be faithful to Yahweh. Yahweh warns

1 Kings 9:1–9

that if Solomon and his descendants are not faithful and if they worship other gods, then Yahweh will punish the Israelites.

This story begins after Solomon finishes all his building projects. This includes the temple and the palace, or the king's house. Yahweh appears to Solomon in a dream, just like Yahweh did at Gibeon, before Solomon built the temple.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the town of Gibeon and the city of Jerusalem, where the temple and the king's palace are. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Solomon that Yahweh heard what Solomon prayed when Solomon finished the temple. Yahweh is about to make an agreement with Solomon, where Yahweh will do certain things if Solomon and the Israelites do certain things. Yahweh assures Solomon that Yahweh accepts the temple. Yahweh makes this temple holy because Yahweh is present there. Yahweh promises that people will always be able to worship Yahweh at the temple. Yahweh also promises to always pay loving attention to the temple, just like Solomon asked.

Yahweh instructs Solomon to do certain things, too. Yahweh wants Solomon to be completely faithful to Yahweh. Solomon must live fairly and sincerely, just like David did. Solomon must obey Yahweh's commands, statutes, and ordinances. If Solomon does, then Yahweh will cause Solomon's descendants to rule over the people of Israel forever. Yahweh also promised this to David. Remember that David had already told Solomon about this promise that Yahweh made to David. Yahweh reminds Solomon of what Solomon already knows: Yahweh's promises and how Solomon should act.

But Yahweh also warns Solomon about what will happen if Solomon and Solomon's descendants reject Yahweh. Solomon and his descendants may choose to reject Yahweh and Yahweh's commands. Solomon and his descendants may choose to worship false gods as if they were the true God. If Solomon and his descendants act like this, then Yahweh will force the Israelites to leave the land of Israel, which Yahweh gave to the Israelites. Solomon and his descendants, who will be kings, are responsible for the whole nation. The way a king acts affects all of the people in the kingdom, not just the king. People will follow their king and do what the king does. And if a king is not faithful to Yahweh, Yahweh will punish the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how does the way a leader acts affect their people? Tell a story about a time when a leader acted in a bad way. What bad things happened to the people because of how the leader acted? How did people follow the leader's bad example? Pause this audio here.

If Solomon and his descendants disobey Yahweh, Yahweh will reject the temple, even though Yahweh made the temple holy with his presence. Then people everywhere will think that Israel is shameful and will mock Israel. The temple will no longer be a beautiful building but a pile of rocks, probably because enemies will destroy the temple. When other people pass by the temple, those people will look at the ruins and be amazed. Those people will make sounds like hisses to show how they feel shocked. Other people will no longer have respect for Israel, but scorn or treat Israel with contempt. Even other people groups would know that these disasters happened because the people of Israel were not faithful to Yahweh, but instead worshipped other gods.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss what other people groups you respect, then discuss what people groups you do not respect. Why do you respect or not respect another group? How would you feel if other people groups did not respect your people group? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh's message is a promise and warning. Solomon must be faithful to Yahweh. If Solomon and his descendants are faithful, Yahweh will be with the Israelites just like Yahweh promised. If Solomon and his descendants are not faithful, Yahweh will punish the Israelites just as Yahweh promised.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss the way a parent tells a child what will happen because of the way a child acts. Why does a parent tell the child about the good and bad things that will happen because of the way the child acts?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 9:1–9

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Solomon finishes the temple, Solomon's palace, and all his other building plans.

In the second scene: Yahweh appears to Solomon in a dream. Yahweh accepts the temple and promises to be present at the temple.

In the third scene: Yahweh reminds Solomon that Solomon must be completely faithful to Yahweh. If Solomon is faithful, then one of Solomon's descendants will always be king of the people of Israel.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh warns Solomon what will happen if Solomon and his descendants reject Yahweh. Yahweh will punish the Israelites, and even other people groups will talk about how the Israelites were not faithful to Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Yahweh
- David
- Solomon's descendants
- The Israelites
- And other people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The first scene begins some time after Solomon dedicated the temple. Solomon has achieved all he wanted to do, which probably means that Solomon has finished his building projects. Remember that when the storyteller says that Solomon built all these buildings, the storyteller means that Solomon led other people to build these buildings. The storyteller does not say exactly how many years pass between the last story and this story. The storyteller simply explains that Solomon has finished these building projects. Some people think that this story happens 13 years after Solomon finished the temple, as we know from an earlier story that it took people 13 years to build Solomon's palace.

In the second scene, the storyteller says that Yahweh appears to Solomon a second time, as Yahweh had appeared to Solomon at the town of Gibeon. Remember that the first time Yahweh appeared to Solomon was in a dream at Gibeon. So here, Yahweh appears to Solomon in a dream again. We do not know where Solomon is during this second dream.

The rest of the passage is what Yahweh says to Solomon. Yahweh says that Yahweh has heard Solomon's prayer and supplication. These are the same two words for prayer that the storyteller has used in the last few stories. Yahweh explains that Yahweh has answered Solomon's prayer, because Yahweh has consecrated the temple. Yahweh makes the temple holy when Yahweh puts his name at the temple. When Yahweh puts his name somewhere, that means that Yahweh's presence is at that place. The temple is now a place where people can worship and honor Yahweh.

Yahweh also answers Solomon's prayer to always be with the Israelites. Yahweh promises that Yahweh's eyes and heart will always be at the temple. Yahweh does not have a body as people do, but in this time, people would sometimes use a body part to represent a person as a whole. When Yahweh says his eyes will be at the temple, Yahweh means Yahweh will pay attention to the temple and the people in it, just like you pay attention to something you look at. When Yahweh says his heart will be at the temple, Yahweh means he will act in a loving way, because Yahweh feels love in his heart.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss whether you ever use a phrase like "my eyes and heart will be there" in your language. Discuss how you want to translate the way Yahweh talks about his eyes and heart. Since these parts represent Yahweh as a whole, you could also choose to say that Yahweh himself will pay attention and show love. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 9:1–9

In the third scene, Yahweh talks about what will happen if Solomon is faithful to Yahweh. Solomon must walk before Yahweh, or live and serve Yahweh, with integrity and uprightness of heart. Remember that people used the heart to talk about the place where people feel, think, and make decisions. When someone has "integrity and uprightness of heart," they act in a faithful, sincere, and honest way.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about someone who was so completely faithful to someone that they acted sincerely and focused all their attention on that person. How would you describe that person? How do you talk about the way that people act faithfully or sincerely? Pause this audio here.

Solomon must also observe, or obey, Yahweh's commands, statutes, and ordinances. These are the instructions for right living that Yahweh gave to the Israelites. If Solomon is faithful to Yahweh and obeys Yahweh, Yahweh will establish Solomon's throne. People used a throne, or a king's special seat, to represent the way a king rules. Yahweh means that Yahweh will cause Solomon's descendants to rule over the people of Israel forever. This is the same thing Yahweh promised to David. Yahweh then repeats what Yahweh promised to David. David will always have an heir or descendant on the throne of Israel, who will rule over the people of Israel.

Stop here, and if helpful, review how David talked about Yahweh's promise in 1 Kings 2:4. Discuss how you want to translate Yahweh's promise to Solomon here. Discuss a family line of leaders in your people's history. How do you talk about the way that the family and their descendants continued to rule or lead? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh talks about what will happen if Solomon and Solomon's descendants are not faithful. Solomon and his descendants may choose to turn away from or reject Yahweh and not obey Yahweh's commands. Solomon and his descendants may choose to serve and worship other gods instead of Yahweh. If Solomon and his descendants act in this way, Yahweh will cut off the Israelites from Israel, which is the land Yahweh gave to the Israelites. To cut off means to punish or separate. So Yahweh will force the Israelites to leave their land.

Yahweh will also reject the temple. In the original language, people would also talk about the way that a man divorces and sends away, or rejects, his wife. People showed strong emotions and grief when they talked about someone rejecting a person or a place. This is the temple that Yahweh consecrated for his name, or made holy so Yahweh could live there. Yet if the Israelites are not faithful to Yahweh, then Yahweh will reject and get rid of the temple like someone gets rid of something they hate.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you talk about the way that someone rejects something that they once loved? Discuss how you want to translate the way Yahweh says he will reject the temple. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says Israel will become a proverb or byword. Both of these words here mean taunts or mocking comments. Yahweh means that people everywhere will ridicule and mock Israel because those people will not respect Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what words do you have that mean mocking taunts or negative comments? How do you talk about the way that people think another nation is weak or shameful? Pause this audio here.

The temple will become a heap of ruins, which means that the temple will no longer be a beautiful building but only a pile of rocks. When other people pass by, those people will feel shocked, horrified, and amazed. The people will make sounds to show that they are shocked and feel scorn for Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What noises do you make or words do you say to show that something shocks or disgusts you? How do you talk about those noises or words? Discuss how you want to translate the way that people are shocked and show that they are shocked. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then describes a conversation that people will have about Israel if Yahweh punishes Israel. Some people will ask why Yahweh forced the Israelites to leave and treated the temple like this. Other people will explain that Yahweh caused this disaster because the Israelites abandoned Yahweh, or were not loyal to Yahweh. People will say that even though Yahweh brought the Israelites' ancestors from Egypt to the good land of Israel, the Israelites chose other gods. The Israelites embraced, or became deeply loyal to, those false gods. The Israelites worshiped and served those false gods. Everyone will know that Yahweh caused this disaster, or evil thing, on the Israelites because of the way the Israelites acted.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

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Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Yahweh
- David
- Solomon's descendants
- The Israelites
- And other people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Solomon completed the temple for Yahweh as well as Solomon's own house. Solomon also finished all his other building plans. Then Yahweh appeared to Solomon a second time, in the same way Yahweh had appeared to Solomon at Gibeon. And Yahweh said to Solomon: "I heard your prayer. I know what you have asked me, so I have made this temple holy. You built this temple, and I made it holy because I will be present there. I will always be present at the temple and pay loving attention to it."

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed and honored that Yahweh speaks to me again! or
- I am so glad that Yahweh accepts the temple we built; or
- I am thankful that Yahweh listens to me when I pray.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that the Israelites built the temple as I asked; or
- I want to have a good relationship with my people. That is why I asked the Israelites to build the temple. Now the Israelites have a place where they can interact with me and keep that good relationship; or
- I care about the Israelites and Solomon. I will pay attention to them and respond with love when they speak to me at the temple.

Continue the drama.

Then Yahweh said, "As for you, Solomon, you must be faithful to me and live with complete and true sincerity. David, your father, lived in this way, and you must do the same. You must obey my commands and all the statutes and ordinances I give you. If you do all this, then I will always cause a man from your family line to rule over the people of Israel. I promised your father, David, that one of David's descendants would always be king of the people of Israel."

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want Solomon to lead the Israelites well. If Solomon lives in the right way, which I have told the Israelites, then Solomon will be a good king; or
- I will help Solomon live in the right way. Solomon must rely on me; or
- I loved David, and I love Solomon. I want to care for and protect their family.

Continue the drama.

Then Yahweh said, "But if you or your descendants ever reject me and do not obey the commands and statutes I have given you and begin to serve and worship other gods, then I will remove the people of Israel from the land I have given them. I will reject this temple that I made holy for myself. Then all the other peoples will speak scornfully and mockingly of Israel. This temple will become a pile of stones. Everyone who sees it will be astonished. Those people will look at the temple with scorn and ask, 'Why did Yahweh do this terrible thing to this land and to his house?' Other people will answer, 'Because the people of Israel have rejected Yahweh their God, who long ago led their ancestors from Egypt. Instead, the Israelites began to worship and bow down before different gods. That is the reason why Yahweh punished the Israelites so harshly.'"

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing other people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am shocked and horrified at what happened to the Israelites; or
- The Israelites are a weak and shameful people! The Israelites did not worship their own God correctly! The Israelites could not even stay in their own land! or
- If this is how Israel's God treats people who disobey him, then Israel's God must be powerful and worthy of respect.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have heard this warning before, but it still shocks me. I hope my descendants remain faithful to Yahweh. I do not want these horrible things to happen to our people; or
- Yahweh has made me wise. I am sure it will be easy to continue to be faithful to Yahweh; or
- I am not worried about this warning. I serve Yahweh now, and I am sure I will continue to serve Yahweh in the future.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

This story begins after Solomon has finished **Yahweh's temple** and the **palace**, or the king's house. The temple is the place where people worship God. Yahweh is God's personal name. For more information on temple and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for temple, Yahweh, and the king's palace as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh has heard Solomon's **prayer** and **supplications**. These two words can both refer to the way a person speaks to God. When someone prays a supplication, they are specifically asking God to do something for them. For more information on prayer, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for prayer and supplication as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh has **consecrated** the temple. When you consecrate something, you set that thing apart to do a special task for God. This thing is now holy and belongs to God. For more information on consecrate, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in previous passages.

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Yahweh says his eyes and his heart will be at the temple. People use “heart” to mean the place where a person thinks, feels, and decides things. Yahweh means that Yahweh will always be present at the temple and pay loving attention to the temple. For more information on heart, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that Yahweh’s **eyes** and **heart** will be at the temple. Pause this audio here.

Solomon must obey Yahweh’s **commandments**, **statutes**, and **ordinances**. These are all the instructions that Yahweh has given to the people of Israel. Sometimes people also call these the **law**. For more information on commandments, statutes, and ordinances, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for commandments, statutes, and ordinances as you used in previous passages. Remember that you may summarize these three types of laws and just say that Solomon must obey Yahweh’s instructions or laws.

Yahweh says that if Solomon is faithful to Yahweh, Yahweh will establish the throne of Solomon’s **kingdom** over **Israel**. A kingdom is the territory or the people that a king rules. Israel here means the people of Israel. You will remember that people often use a throne or a king’s special seat to represent the way a king rules. Yahweh means that a person from Solomon’s family line will always be king over the Israelites. For more information on kingdom and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for kingdom and Israel as you used in previous passages.

Solomon and his **descendants** must always be faithful to Yahweh. A person’s descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future generations from the same family line. For more information on descendant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for descendant as you used in previous passages.

If the Israelites worship and serve other false gods, Yahweh will punish the Israelites. In the original language, to worship literally means to bow down, but most translations use a more general word for worship. Sometimes people worship other spirit beings or idols as if they have power. When people worship those false gods, they give honor to those gods and serve those false gods as if they were the real, true God.

Stop here and discuss what word or phrase you will use for **worship**. For more information on worship, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for worship as you used in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **gods** or **false gods**. Look up gods in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Other people will know that the Israelites did not worship Yahweh, the Israelites’ **God**, as the Israelites should. This is the more general word for Yahweh. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 9:1–9

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (782 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1006 KB)

1 Kings 9:10–25

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 9:10–25 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:10–25 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:10–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, Yahweh appeared to Solomon and promised him that if Solomon was faithful to Yahweh, then Solomon's descendants would reign over Israel forever. But if Solomon or his descendants turned away from Yahweh and worshiped other gods, Yahweh would remove the people of Israel from their land and reject the temple that Solomon had built for Yahweh. In this story, the storyteller tells us more about Solomon's building projects.

If you have already translated the book of 2 Chronicles, then you have already translated one version of this story. It might be helpful to go back and listen to how you translated that story. If the book of 2 Chronicles is available in your language, stop here and listen to 2 Chronicles chapter 8. Pause this audio here.

It took King Solomon 20 years to finish building the house of Yahweh and the king's house, or royal palace. In a previous story, the storyteller said that it took seven years to finish building the temple and 13 years to finish building the king's house. During that time, Solomon received wood and gold from Hiram, the king of Tyre. In return, Solomon gave Hiram 20 towns in a part of Israel called Galilee. This means that those towns became part of Hiram's territory, and Hiram was king over the people who lived there.

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Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of Israel, including the location of Galilee and the city of Tyre. Pause this audio here.

Galilee was in the northern part of Israel. It was the closest part of Israel to Tyre. When King Hiram came to see the towns, he was not pleased with them. This is why Hiram gave them the name "Cabul." Cabul means "worthless" or "nothing."

King Solomon used forced labor, or slaves, for his building projects. This was very common in the ancient world. The people Solomon used as slaves were the descendants of the Canaanites that the Israelites had not been able to remove from the land. The laws that Yahweh gave to Israel through Moses did not allow Solomon to enslave Israelites to do forced labor, so Solomon made Israelites his soldiers, officers, and commanders.

Stop here and discuss these questions: How common is forced labor or slavery in your area? If it is not common now, was it ever common in the past? Which people were slaves? What do you think about the fact that King Solomon had slaves? Pause this audio here.

In this story, Solomon used forced labor to build the house of Yahweh, the king's house, and something called "the Millo." Bible scholars do not agree on what "the Millo" means. For this reason, some versions of the Bible translate this word to sound like the word in the original language and do not try to explain what it means. But some Bible scholars think the word means "terraces" or "landfill." A terrace is a flat area that people build on, or into, a hill.

Stop here and look at a picture of a terrace. Pause this audio here.

A landfill is an area where someone uses dirt or other materials to fill in a gap in the ground.

King Solomon also used forced labor to build a wall around Jerusalem and to build three cities that people called Hazor, Megiddo, and Gezer.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of the cities of Hazor, Megiddo, and Gezer. Continue to look at this map during the following discussion. Pause this audio here.

In those days, people commonly built walls around large cities. The walls provided protection from anyone who might try to attack a city. The cities of Hazor, Megiddo, and Gezer existed before Solomon became king. Hazor was in the far north near the border. Megiddo was located on a trade route. Gezer was near Jerusalem and also located on important trade routes. Earlier, the pharaoh of Egypt had destroyed Gezer and killed the Canaanites who lived there, so Solomon had to rebuild it. We do not know if Solomon had to rebuild Hazor and Megiddo as well, or if he just made them much bigger and stronger.

Solomon married Pharaoh's daughter. Pharaoh gave the city of Gezer to his daughter as a dowry, or wedding gift.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, when a woman gets married, what kinds of gifts do her parents usually give her? Do the bride and groom know ahead of time what she will receive from her parents, or is it a surprise? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon built other cities called Lower Beth Horon, Baalath, and Tamar. This last city is sometimes called "Tadmor." Lower Beth Horon is located near Jerusalem. Tamar is located south of Jerusalem near the wilderness of Judah. Bible scholars do not agree on where Baalath was located.

Solomon built cities to store extra goods in. These cities are called storage cities or supply centers. A king might store things like grain, oil, or wine in a storage city. Or the king might use a city to store materials for battle, like weapons and things that protect soldiers in battle. Solomon also built cities to house his army, and cities for his chariots and cavalry. A chariot is a kind of cart that horses pull. People used chariots to fight battles. Normally, at least two soldiers rode in a chariot. One soldier controlled the horses while the other soldier attacked his opponents. But some chariots could hold more than two soldiers. A soldier who rides in a chariot is called a "charioteer."

Stop here and look at a picture of a chariot and charioteers. Pause this audio here.

Cavalry is a word for soldiers who ride horses. Riding on a horse gave a soldier many advantages. Horses are much faster than people, so the rider could easily catch up to opposing soldiers and kill them. Because the rider

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is up higher on the horse, he can see farther than the people on the ground. A soldier on a horse might shoot arrows at his opponents, or he might ride closer to them and try to stab them with his sword.

Before Solomon finished building the King's house, Solomon's wife, the daughter of Pharaoh, was living in the City of David. Most Bible scholars believe this means that Pharaoh's daughter was living in an older part of Jerusalem, where King David had lived, and that Solomon built his palace in a different part of Jerusalem. When Pharaoh's daughter moved into the king's palace, she just moved from one part of Jerusalem to another.

The storyteller finishes this story by telling us that Solomon regularly came to the temple and made offerings to Yahweh. This reminds us that, at least for a time, Solomon did everything Yahweh required him to do.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:10–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: After King Solomon finishes building the temple of Yahweh and his own palace, Solomon gives Hiram, king of Tyre, 20 cities in the region of Galilee. But Hiram does not like these cities.

In the second scene: The storyteller tells us about the cities that King Solomon rebuilds or fortifies throughout his territory. King Solomon uses the remaining Canaanite people as forced labor for his building projects, but Solomon assigns Israelites to work as his officials, commanders, and soldiers.

In the third scene: After King Solomon's building projects are completed, Solomon moves the daughter of Pharaoh, his wife, from the City of David into the palace in Jerusalem. Solomon also makes regular offerings at the temple of Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon, Hiram, Pharaoh, and Pharaoh's daughter
- The Amorite, Hittite, Perizzite, Hivite, and Jebusite people
- Solomon's Israelite soldiers, government officials, commanders, captains, charioteers, and horsemen
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, at the end of 20 years, King Solomon had finished building the temple of Yahweh and his own palace. Solomon built the palace, the temple, and other buildings using cedar and cypress logs, which he received from King Hiram of Tyre. These are the same two kinds of wood that you already translated in chapter five of 1 Kings. It might be helpful to go back and listen to 1 Kings chapter five to remind yourselves of how you decided to translate the words for these two kinds of trees.

Stop here and listen to 1 Kings chapter five, specifically the part when Solomon sends a message to King Hiram to ask for cedar and cypress wood, and Hiram agrees to send the wood. Pause this audio here.

Solomon gave Hiram 20 cities in the region of Galilee. This means that those cities now became part of Hiram's kingdom, and Hiram was their king instead of Solomon. Most Bible scholars think that Solomon did this as a form of payment for all the wood and gold that Hiram had sent to Solomon for his building projects. But when Hiram came from Tyre to see the cities that Solomon gave him, Hiram was not pleased with the cities. Hiram did not think that the cities were very valuable to him. Hiram told his feelings to Solomon using a question that he did not expect Solomon to answer. Hiram said, "What are these cities that you have given me, my brother?" This question means, "These cities that you have given me are not good" or "I do not like these cities that you have given me."

When Hiram calls Solomon "my brother," it does not mean that Hiram and Solomon are related to each other. It was common at that time for kings who were allies to address each other like this. It was a way that those kings could show that they saw each other as equals and that they were on friendly terms with each other.

Stop here and discuss this question: Under what circumstances might you call someone who is not a relative by the words “brother,” “sister,” “cousin,” “aunt,” “uncle,” “mother,” or “father”? If it is unnatural or unclear in your language for Hiram to call Solomon “my brother,” what other word could you use to show that they had a friendly relationship as equals? Pause this audio here.

Because Hiram did not like these cities, he gave the region an insulting name. The word Cabul in the original language sounds like the word for “worthless” or “like nothing.” Since your hearers most likely will not understand what the word Cabul means, you might need to say something like “Hiram called that area Cabul, which means ‘worthless.’” The storyteller also says that this area is called Cabul “to this day.” This phrase means that when the storyteller wrote this information down, the Israelites still called that area by the name Cabul.

At the end of this scene, the storyteller says, “And Hiram sent the king more than 4,000 kilograms of gold.” Bible scholars do not agree on what this sentence means. Some scholars think it is a summary statement, meaning that over the course of 20 years, Hiram sent Solomon 120 talents, or a total of 4,000 kilograms, of gold. Other scholars think that Hiram sent Solomon more than 4,000 kilograms of gold as payment for the 20 cities in Galilee.

In the Book of Chronicles, the storyteller shares the same story but with a small difference. The Book of Chronicles says King Hiram gave some towns to King Solomon. This version of the story says Solomon gave some towns to Hiram. Bible scholars suggest two possible explanations: maybe the two kings traded land, or maybe Solomon let Hiram rule some towns for a while and later took them back. Either way, the two kings likely exchanged land to settle the cost of the supplies Hiram gave Solomon for his building projects.

Stop here and describe a situation in which two people in your culture might exchange property in order to settle an agreement. Under what circumstances might they do this? What kind of items might they exchange? Do they exchange the property permanently, or can they return the property? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller tells the events out of order. First, he tells us that Solomon used forced labor to build the temple of Yahweh, the king’s house, the Millo, the wall of Jerusalem, and the cities of Hazor, Megiddo, and Gezer. Then, the storyteller explains why Solomon needed to rebuild Gezer: some time before, the Egyptian army had attacked the city, burned it down, and killed all the Canaanites who were living there. Next, the storyteller tells us about more cities that Solomon built up throughout his kingdom. Then the storyteller jumps back in time again in order to tell us about the descendants of the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites who were still living in the land of Israel. Solomon made these people into slaves, while the Israelites served as his officers, commanders, and officials.

In your language, it might not be possible to tell a story out of order like this. Even if it is possible, it might be too confusing for your hearers to hear the story told in this way. If this is the case, you may choose to rearrange the events of the story so that they are in the order in which they happened.

Stop here and discuss whether you will tell this story in the order that the events occurred, or if you will tell the story in the order the storyteller records the events in the Bible. Pause this audio here.

This is the order in which the events of this story occurred:

First, the Israelites did not completely remove all the Canaanites from the land. When Joshua led the Israelites into the land, the Israelites allowed some Canaanites to continue living there. So when Solomon became king, there were still some descendants of the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites who lived in Israel. King Solomon made these people his slaves, and he appointed Israelites as their supervisors.

Next, King Solomon began to build the temple of Yahweh in the fourth year of his reign. Solomon used forced labor to build it. We do not know exactly when Pharaoh destroyed the city of Gezer, but we do know it was before his daughter married Solomon. We also do not know exactly when Solomon married Pharaoh’s daughter, but it was probably before Solomon finished building the temple. So this is the most likely order of events: Solomon began to build the temple of Yahweh, then Pharaoh attacked and destroyed the city of Gezer, then Solomon married Pharaoh’s daughter, and she received Gezer as a wedding gift.

Finally, Solomon finished building the temple of Yahweh in the 11th year of his reign. Then Solomon began to build the king’s house, the Millo, the wall around Jerusalem, and all of the other cities the storyteller mentions in this story.

1 Kings 9:10–25

The Canaanites were the people who lived in the Promised Land before the Israelites. The Canaanites were all descendants of a man named Canaan. Yahweh told the Israelites to drive all of the Canaanites out of the land, but the Israelites did not completely drive them out. Some groups of Canaanites still lived in parts of the Israelite territory, including in the city of Gezer.

After Pharaoh, the king of Egypt, burned down Gezer and killed all the Canaanites who lived there, he gave the city to his daughter as a wedding gift. This means that even though the king of Egypt was the one who conquered the city, he gave it to the Israelites. After Solomon rebuilt the city, the people who lived there would need to grow crops, raise livestock, and make various products that were necessary to live. It is possible that Pharaoh's daughter might have received a share of these products, or the people of the city might have paid a tax to her.

Stop here and discuss what would be the best way in your language to say that Pharaoh gave a city to his daughter as a wedding gift. Pause this audio here.

It was against the law that Moses gave to the Israelites for the Israelites to do forced labor. If Solomon used Israelites for his building projects, he would have to hire them as regular workers or use them for a short amount of time. So Solomon forced the Canaanites to do the hard physical labor. You might have heard a few different ways to say this when you listened to different versions of this story. Some translations say that Solomon conscripted or drafted the forced labor. Other translations say that Solomon imposed, raised, or levied forced labor, while yet others simply say that King Solomon used forced labor to build all these structures. Each of these is just a different way to say that King Solomon forced the non-Israelites in his territory to do this hard physical work, and that they did not have the option to say no.

Stop here and discuss this question: What are some ways in your language that you can say that a leader forced someone to work, and that person did not have the option to say no or to change jobs? Pause this audio here.

At this point in scene two, the storyteller says that the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites are still slaves in Israel "to this day." This statement means that those people were enslaved in Israel at the time that the storyteller wrote this story down. It does not mean that they are slaves in Israel right now.

This scene contains the first mention of the Millo. Bible scholars do not agree on what this term means. The Millo is a man-made structure, but Bible scholars are not sure what it is or where it was located. Some scholars think the Millo might be a large set of terraces that was located on the east side of Jerusalem. A terrace is a flat surface just outside a building. People usually build it with supports underneath. People often build a terrace on a hill or slope so that people have a flat place to walk or sit.

Stop here and look at a picture of a terrace. Pause this audio here.

Other scholars think the Millo is related to the word for "landfill," meaning a place that had to be filled in with earth in order to build something else on it. Jerusalem has many hills and valleys, so it is possible that Solomon had to fill in some places with earth in order to build the structures he wanted. Because there is so much uncertainty about this structure, many translations of the Bible simply call this place "the Millo" and do not try to explain what it is. It is acceptable to translate this word as "terrace" or "landfill," or to call it "the Millo."

Solomon built up a city near Jerusalem called Lower Beth Horon. There was another city about two kilometers away called Upper Beth Horon. Lower Beth Horon was at the bottom of a valley, while Upper Beth Horon was at the top of the valley. The city that is called Tamar or Tadmor is in the wilderness, or desert. A wilderness is a place without much water, trees, or plant life. It is very difficult to grow crops in the wilderness, and people usually do not live there.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your language, how would you describe an area of land that does not have much water, trees, or plant life? Pause this audio here.

Solomon built storage cities, or supply centers, all through the territory that he controlled. A king might store things like grain, oil, salt, or wine in a storage city. The king stored these things for use in the event of famine or shortage. The king might also use a city to store supplies for battle, like weapons and items that soldiers use to protect themselves. If the country went to war, these supplies would help the people to be better prepared than their enemy.

1 Kings 9:10–25

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your country, how do people store excess goods? Where do people store the goods? Who controls the goods? How does the military or national government store its battle supplies? Pause this audio here.

Near the end of scene two, the storyteller uses six different words and phrases to describe the roles that the Israelites filled for Solomon's building projects. The first phrase is "men of war," which means men who fight in wars. It can also be translated as "soldiers" or "fighting men."

Stop here and try to think of as many words as you can in your language that have this meaning. Pause this audio here.

The second word is "servants." This word can mean many things, from a household helper to a government official to a military commander. It describes anyone who does something for someone else. A servant is also usually of a lower social or political rank than the person he or she serves. In this case, these servants were most likely some sort of government officials.

Stop here and discuss how you might call these servants who served King Solomon as government officials. Pause this audio here.

The third word is for a person who is a leader of a group of people. You might have heard this word translated as "commanders" or "officers" who lead groups of men in the army.

Stop here and try to think of as many words as you can in your language that have this meaning. Pause this audio here.

The fourth word is a word for someone who probably works directly for the king in the army, in special fighting units. You may have heard this word translated as "captain."

Stop here and try to think of as many words as you can in your language that have this meaning. Pause this audio here.

The fifth phrase means "commanders of chariots." If an army has many chariots, it needs someone to tell the charioteers what to do in the battle. The commander of chariots probably rode in a chariot himself, but his job was to tell the other charioteers where to go and what to do. A commander of chariots would be a mid to high-ranking military official.

Stop here and discuss how to translate "commanders of chariots" in your language. Pause this audio here.

The sixth word is a word for men who work with horses. This might be soldiers who ride on horses or in chariots. You might have heard this word translated as "cavalry," "horsemen," or "charioteers."

Stop here and try to think of as many words as you can in your language that have this meaning. Pause this audio here.

The total number of Israelites who worked as supervisors for Solomon's building projects was 550 men.

In the third scene, as soon as the king's house is complete, Solomon moves Pharaoh's daughter from her temporary house in the City of David into the king's house that he built for her. Then Solomon begins to construct the Millo. After the temple of Yahweh was complete, Solomon went to the temple three times per year to make burnt offerings and peace offerings on the altar of the temple. Solomon also burned incense on the altar of incense. These rituals were important parts of the way the Israelites worshipped Yahweh. Incense is a substance that creates a lot of smoke and smells good when people burn it. There were many different kinds of incense in Israel, but priests had to use a special type of incense in the temple of Yahweh. The storyteller probably includes this statement to let the audience know that, for many years, Solomon faithfully worshipped Yahweh.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:10–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

1 Kings 9:10–25

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon, Hiram, Pharaoh, and Pharaoh's daughter
- The Amorite, Hittite, Perizzite, Hivite, and Jebusite people
- Solomon's Israelite soldiers, government officials, commanders, captains, charioteers, and horsemen
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

It took Solomon 20 years to build the temple of Yahweh and the king's house. King Hiram of Tyre had provided Solomon with all the cedar and cypress wood and all the gold he wanted for this work. After it was finished, King Solomon gave Hiram 20 towns in the region of Galilee. Hiram went to see these towns, and Hiram did not like them. Hiram said to Solomon, "My brother, these towns you have given me are not good." And Hiram called that area "Cabul," which means "good for nothing," and people still call it that name today. And Hiram had sent Solomon over 4,000 kilograms of gold.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Hiram, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel angry at Solomon for giving me such awful cities; or
- Maybe Solomon is not as honest and trustworthy as I thought he was; or
- I feel cheated because, after all I did to help Solomon, Solomon gave me these worthless cities.

Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel satisfied that I have completed such wonderful building projects; or
- I feel sad that I gave up Israelite territory; or
- I feel frustrated that Hiram is not happy with the towns I gave him.

Continue the drama.

This is the account of the forced labor that King Solomon raised to build the house of Yahweh, the king's house, the Millo, the wall of Jerusalem, and the cities of Hazor, Megiddo, and Gezer. Pharaoh, the king of Egypt, had attacked and captured Gezer. Pharaoh killed the Canaanite people who lived there and burned down the city. Then Pharaoh gave the city to his daughter as a wedding gift. So Solomon rebuilt the city of Gezer. Solomon also built up the towns of Lower Beth Horon, Baalath, and Tamar in the wilderness within his land. Solomon built storage cities and cities where he could keep his chariots and horses. Solomon built everything he desired in Jerusalem and Lebanon, and throughout his entire kingdom.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud that I am able to build so many cities in my country; or
- I feel confident that all the supplies I have stored up for my people will keep us secure; or
- I feel strong because I have such a big army and so many horses.

Ask the person playing Pharaoh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I was able to make a marriage alliance with Solomon; or
- I feel resentful that a bunch of slaves escaped from my country and have grown into a powerful nation; or
- I do not trust Solomon. Therefore, I will not give my daughter a very good wedding gift.

Ask the person playing Pharaoh's daughter, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am angry that my father made me marry this Israelite and leave Egypt; or
- I feel honored to be a queen in Israel; or
- I am glad that I have an entire town to generate income and goods for me.

Continue the drama.

For his forced labor, Solomon used the descendants of the Canaanites whom the Israelites had not killed when they took possession of their land. These included Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites, and their descendants are still slaves to this day. But Solomon did not make slaves of the Israelites. The Israelites served as his soldiers, government officials, officers, captains, commanders of chariots, and horsemen. There were 550 officials in charge of the forced labor working on Solomon's building projects.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Amorite, Hittite, Perizzite, Hivite, and Jebusite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am angry that my people are now slaves; or
- I feel hopeless. First, our people lost our land, and now we are forced to build temples and palaces for our enemies; or
- I hate the Israelites. I wish I could get away from them.

Ask the people playing the Israelite soldiers, officers, commanders, and charioteers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy and secure because our army is so big and strong; or
- I feel hopeful that our country has a bright future because of all the things that King Solomon has done; or
- I am excited to see the beautiful new cities and storehouses that King Solomon has built!

Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy that I have made my country so strong and wealthy; or
- I am glad that I can put these Canaanites to good use; or
- I am pleased with the work my people have done.

Continue the drama.

Then Solomon moved his wife, Pharaoh's daughter, from the City of David to the new house he had built for her. Then he built the Millo. Three times each year, Solomon made burnt offerings and peace offerings on the altar that he had built for Yahweh. Solomon also burned incense to Yahweh. And so Solomon finished the work of building the house of Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Pharaoh's daughter, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy and comfortable in this beautiful palace Solomon built for me; or
- I miss Egypt, and I wish I could visit my home; or
- This place is nice, but not as beautiful as the palaces back in Egypt.

Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope that Yahweh is pleased with the temple and the offerings we are making to him; or
- I hope that my wife is happy with the palace I have built for her; or
- I look forward to a time when I can rest now that all these building projects are done.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy because Solomon built a beautiful temple; or

- I am pleased that Solomon and the people are worshipping me as I told them to; or
- I am glad that Solomon was wise enough to build storage cities and cities for the chariots and horses. These provisions help keep my people safe.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:10–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

At the end of 20 years, after Solomon had finished building the temple of Yahweh and the palace, or king's house, and Hiram the King of Tyre had supplied Solomon with cedar and cypress wood and all the gold he wanted, King Solomon gave Hiram 20 **cities** in the land of Galilee. Cities are usually settlements with walls around them. Translate cities the same way you did in previous passages.

Be sure to translate **Yahweh**, **Temple of Yahweh**, and **palace** the same way you have in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on temple and Yahweh.

You translated cedar and cypress wood in a previous passage.

Stop here and listen to 1 Kings chapter five, specifically the part when Solomon sends a message to King Hiram to ask for **cedar** and **cypress wood**, and Hiram agrees to send the wood. Be sure to translate these words the same way here as you did there. Pause this audio here.

Galilee is a region in the northern part of Israel.

Stop here and discuss what word you will use for **Galilee**. See the Master Glossary for more information on Galilee. If you have already translated Galilee in another book of the Bible, make sure to translate it the same way here as you did there. Pause this audio here.

Hiram had sent King Solomon 120 talents of gold. A talent is around 34 kilograms, so this is around 4,000 kilograms of gold total.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about 120 **talents**. For more information about talent, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

This is the account of the forced labor that King Solomon conscripted to build the house of Yahweh, the palace, the Millo, the wall of Jerusalem, and the cities of Hazor, Megiddo, and Gezer.

Forced labor is a situation where a person in power, usually a king or a chief, forces other people to work for him, and those people are not free to say no. Different translations use different words to describe the process of a leader forcing people to work against their will, or they might just say, "King Solomon used forced labor."

Stop here and decide how you will say that King Solomon used **forced labor** to build the house of Yahweh and his other building projects. Pause this audio here.

Bible scholars are not sure what "the Millo" is. Many Bible translation teams have chosen to find a word that sounds similar to the word in the original language, rather than trying to describe what "the Millo" is. However, a few versions of the Bible translate this word as "terraces," "supporting terraces," or "landfill." Any of these translation choices is acceptable.

Stop here and decide whether you will translate "**the Millo**" to sound like the original language, or if you will translate it to mean "terrace" or "landfill." If you have already translated the Millo in 1 Chronicles 11:8, translate it in the same way here. Pause this audio here.

Hazor, **Megiddo**, and **Gezer** are all names of cities.

If you need to remember how you translated these names, stop here and listen to Joshua chapter 11 to remember how to translate Hazor, listen to 1 Kings chapter 4 to remember how to translate Megiddo, and listen to the last story in Judges chapter 1 to remember how to translate Gezer. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 9:10–25

Pharaoh, the king of Egypt, had attacked and captured Gezer. Pharaoh killed the Canaanite population and burned down the city. Then Pharaoh gave the city to his daughter as a wedding gift when she married Solomon. So Solomon rebuilt the city of Gezer.

The word "**Pharaoh**" is a special word for the king of Egypt. Be sure to translate Pharaoh the same way you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on Pharaoh.

The Canaanites were the descendants of a man named Canaan. The Canaanites lived in the land of Israel before the Israelites lived there.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Canaanite**. Look up Canaan in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon also built up the towns of Lower Beth Horon, Baalath, and Tamar in the wilderness within his land. Solomon built storage cities and cities where he could keep his chariots and horses. A storage city was a place where the leaders of a country could store extra goods, like food, clothing, or weapons.

Stop here and decide how you will translate **storage city**. Pause this audio here.

For his forced labor, Solomon used the descendants of the Canaanites whom the Israelites had not killed when they took possession of their land. These included Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites, and their descendants are still slaves to this day. But Solomon did not make slaves of the Israelites. The Israelites served as Solomon's fighting men, government officials, commanders, captains, commanders of chariots, and horsemen. There were 550 officials in charge of the forced labor working on Solomon's building projects.

Stop here and review and decide what words you will use to translate **fighting men**, **government officials**, **army commanders**, **captains**, **commanders of chariots**, and **horsemen**. Pause this audio here.

Then Solomon moved his wife, Pharaoh's daughter, from the **City of David** to the new house he had built for her. Then Solomon built the Millo. Three times each year, Solomon made burnt offerings and peace offerings on the altar that he had built for Yahweh. Solomon also burned incense to Yahweh. And so Solomon finished the work of building the house of Yahweh. Be sure to translate "City of David" the same way you did in previous stories.

Be sure to translate **burnt offering**, **peace or fellowship offering**, and **altar** the same way as you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on burnt offering, peace or fellowship offering, and altar.

Incense is a word for a substance that smells good when people burn it. Israelites used incense for religious purposes. Be sure to translate incense the same way as you did in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 9:10–25

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (860 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (11.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 9:26–10:13

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 9:26–10:13 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:26–10:13 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:26–10:13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, King Solomon built cities throughout the land of Israel. Solomon made storage cities and cities for his chariots and horsemen. In this story, Solomon's ships bring back gold, almugwood, and precious stones. The Queen of Sheba comes to visit Solomon in Jerusalem and brings him gifts. When the Queen of Sheba goes home, Solomon sends a large number of gifts with her.

In this story, the storyteller tells the events of the story out of order. First, he tells us that Solomon built ships in a city called Ezion Geber. These ships sailed to Ophir and brought back gold. Next, the storyteller tells us about the Queen of Sheba's visit to Solomon. Then the storyteller jumps back in time to add that Solomon's ships had not only brought back gold from Ophir, but also high-quality wood and precious stones. At the end of the story, Solomon gave the Queen of Sheba everything she had asked for, and then the queen went back to her own country.

A ship is a large boat that sails on the ocean. The boat had to be large enough to sail over large ocean waves and carry many people and a large amount of supplies for many days on the ocean.

Stop here and look at a picture of a ship on the ocean. Pause this audio here.

Solomon built ships in a city called Ezion Geber, near Elath in the land of Edom. Edom is the land where the descendants of Esau lived. King Solomon controlled this land. This area was south of Israel on the coast of the Red Sea.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and Edom that shows the location of Ezion Geber and Elath. Pause this audio here.

King Hiram sent his experienced sailors to help Solomon's men with the ships. A sailor is a person who knows how to sail a ship. Ships on the ocean were very big and needed many sailors to do different jobs required to sail the ship. Solomon's ships sailed to Ophir and brought back over 14,000 kilograms of gold, almugwood, and precious stones. Bible scholars are not sure where Ophir was located.

Kings often hosted the leaders of other countries in the palace. One king might send his officials to another king's palace to make an agreement, end a conflict, or show respect. Solomon probably hosted leaders from many other countries during his 40 years as king, but there was something special about the Queen of Sheba's visit. The Queen of Sheba heard not only about Solomon's great riches and wisdom, but also about Solomon's God, Yahweh. A queen could be the wife of a king, but a queen could also rule a country by herself. In Bible times, some queens had a lot of power, while other queens did not. Bible scholars are not sure where Sheba was located. Some scholars think Sheba was located in Arabia, while other scholars think it was located in northeast Africa.

The Queen of Sheba visited Solomon because she wanted to ask him questions to see how wise Solomon really was. When the Queen of Sheba talked with Solomon, he answered all her questions and showed her that he was indeed very wise.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Tell a story in your language about someone who tests the wisdom or knowledge of another person. How does this person test the other person? Do they use riddles, stories, questions, or something else? If you do not know any stories like this, do you know any riddles or questions that people use to show whether a person is wise and learned? If so, say them out loud. Pause this audio here.

The Queen of Sheba brought gifts for Solomon. It was common at that time for kings and queens to give each other gifts to show respect for each other. It was also a way for the king or queen to show how wealthy he or she was. The Queen of Sheba brought gold, spices, and precious stones. The queen brought these things on animals that people called camels. A camel is a large animal that is common in places where the weather is hot and dry. Camels can survive for a long time without drinking water. Camels are also easy for people to train and can carry a lot of weight, so people in this part of the world often used camels to carry goods while traveling.

Stop here and look at a picture of a camel next to a person. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon also gave gifts to the Queen of Sheba. This passage does not tell us what Solomon gave her, but it does say that Solomon gave her everything she desired and asked for.

The Queen of Sheba was very impressed by Solomon, his palace, and everything in it. The Queen of Sheba said that, although she had heard very good things about Solomon, what she saw in person was even better than what people had reported to her. The storyteller says that when the Queen of Sheba saw everything in Solomon's palace, she was so amazed that it left her breathless.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who saw something incredible and felt amazed. Pause this audio here.

Next, the Queen of Sheba blessed Solomon and his officials, and she praised Yahweh who made Solomon king. Then the queen left and returned to her own country.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, when a person is successful, to whom do they give credit for their success? To whom do others give credit for that person's success?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:26–10:13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

If you tell this story in the same order as it occurs in 1 Kings, there are four scenes.

In the first scene: Solomon builds ships at Ezion Geber. The ships sail to Ophir and bring back gold.

In the second scene: The Queen of Sheba visits Solomon, brings him gifts, and tests him with questions to see how wise Solomon really is.

In the third scene: The storyteller tells us that Solomon's ships also brought back almugwood and precious stones. Solomon used the wood to build supports for the temple of Yahweh and the king's house, and also harps and lyres for the musicians.

In the fourth scene: King Solomon gives the Queen of Sheba everything she asks for, and then the queen goes back to her own country.

If you decide to tell this story in the order that the events happened, then scenes one and three are combined, while scenes two and four are combined.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Hiram
- Hiram's sailors
- Solomon's men
- The Queen of Sheba
- The Queen of Sheba's servants
- Solomon's officials
- Palace servants
- Cupbearers
- And musicians

If you have already translated the book of 2 Chronicles, then you have already translated one version of this story. It might be helpful to go back and listen to that story now to remember how you translated it.

Stop here and listen to the first part of 2 Chronicles chapter 9, if it is available in your language. Pause this audio here.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this story, the storyteller tells the events of the story out of order. In your language, it might not be possible to tell a story out of order like this. Even if it is possible, it might be too confusing for your hearers to hear the story in this way. If this is the case, you may choose to rearrange the events of the story so that they are in the order in which they happened.

Stop here and discuss whether you will tell this story in the order that the events happened, or if you will tell the story in the order that the storyteller tells the events in the Bible. Pause this audio here.

If you choose to tell the events of the story in the order in which they happened, this is the order you would use:

First, Solomon built a fleet of ships in Ezion Geber. King Hiram sent his sailors to sail to Ophir in these ships with Solomon's men. The men brought back gold, almugwood, and precious stones. Next, Solomon used the almugwood to build the temple of Yahweh and the royal palace, and also to make musical instruments.

Then, the Queen of Sheba visited Solomon. The queen brought gifts to Solomon and tested him with hard questions. Solomon answered all of the queen's questions, and she realized that Solomon was truly very wise. When the Queen of Sheba saw that Jerusalem, the temple of Yahweh, and the palace were very beautiful, she was amazed. The queen said that even though she heard wonderful reports about Solomon and Yahweh, the reports were not half as good as what she saw when she went there. So the Queen of Sheba praised Solomon and Yahweh. Solomon gave the queen everything she wanted, then she went back to her own country.

In the first scene, Solomon built ships in Ezion Geber, near Elath in the land of Edom. When Solomon built his ships, he did not do the work himself. Rather, Solomon hired workers to build the ships for him. Ezion Geber was located on the coast of a large, narrow body of water. You might have heard different names for this body of water when you listened to three different versions of the story. Some versions call it the Red Sea, others call it the Reed Sea, and some call it the Gulf of Aqaba. "Red Sea" and "Reed Sea" are two different ways to translate

the meaning of the name in the original language. “The Gulf of Aqaba” is a modern-day name of this body of water. Any of these translation choices is acceptable.

A group of many ships is called a fleet of ships. If your language has a special word for a group of ships, you may use that word here. If not, you can say “Solomon built many ships in Ezion Geber.”

Stop here and discuss how you could say “a fleet of ships” in your language. Pause this audio here.

A sailor is a person who knows how to sail a ship. A large ship required many sailors to do different tasks to control the ship. In the original language, the storyteller calls these sailors “men who know the sea.”

Stop here and discuss how you will translate “men who know the sea” into your language. Pause this audio here.

Hiram’s sailors and Solomon’s servants sailed to Ophir and brought back 420 talents, or over 14,000 kilograms, of gold. Ophir is the name of a place. Bible scholars do not know for sure where Ophir was located.

In the second scene, the Queen of Sheba heard that King Solomon was very famous. A queen was usually the wife of a king, but sometimes a queen was the ruler of a country. A queen was usually the highest-status female in the country. If a queen was the wife of a king, then only the king had a higher status than the queen did.

Stop here and decide what word you will use for “queen.” Pause this audio here.

The Queen of Sheba heard that Solomon was famous. When someone is famous, it means that even people in faraway places know all about that person. A person might be famous because people admire them for things like intelligence, strength, kindness, or wisdom. Or a person might be famous because of things they have done, like fighting in battles or becoming rich. People far away from Israel heard stories about Solomon’s wealth and wisdom and were impressed. When people thought about Solomon, they probably thought he was a good king and a good person.

Stop here and talk about someone in your culture who is famous. Why is that person famous? What words or phrases do you use when you talk about that person? Which of these words could you use to describe how famous Solomon was? Pause this audio here.

Solomon was famous because of his wealth and wisdom, but he was also famous because of “the name of Yahweh.” The name of Yahweh represents Yahweh’s character—his power, love, and all the things Yahweh has ever done. The name of Yahweh also represents the presence of Yahweh. Solomon’s fame was because of all the things that Yahweh did for Solomon. Yahweh blessed Solomon and gave him the things he needed to build the temple, palace, and other buildings. Yahweh gave Solomon what Solomon needed to make Israel strong and secure. Also, Solomon’s success made Yahweh look good. When other people saw Solomon’s achievements and wisdom, they would think, “Yahweh is a very good God.”

Stop here and discuss how you might translate the phrase “concerning the name of Yahweh” into your language. Pause this audio here.

The purpose of the Queen of Sheba’s visit was to test Solomon’s wisdom with hard questions. The queen wanted to find out for herself if Solomon really was as wise as everyone said he was. The queen chose questions that would be difficult to answer because the answers needed good understanding or insight.

Stop here and discuss how you will say in your language that the Queen of Sheba tested Solomon’s wisdom with difficult questions. Pause this audio here.

The Queen of Sheba did not travel by herself. The queen brought along a large number of servants and attendants. The queen probably also brought soldiers to protect her from attacks on the way. You might have heard different words for this group of people when you listened to three different versions of this story. There are many different ways to say that many people traveled with the Queen of Sheba. This was a special group of people who traveled with the queen to serve her and protect her during her journey.

Stop here and discuss how you could say in your language that many people traveled with the Queen of Sheba. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 9:26–10:13

The Queen of Sheba brought many gifts to Solomon. The queen used camels to carry these goods. A camel is an animal that lives in hot, dry areas. A camel can travel for a long time without drinking water. Camels are very useful animals when people travel through dry areas.

Stop here and look again at a picture of a camel. If your language does not have a word for "camel," discuss how you could translate the word "camel" into your language. Pause this audio here.

The Queen of Sheba brought 120 talents, or about 4,000 kilograms, of gold, precious stones, and spices as a gift for Solomon. These spices were not the kind of spices people used to cook food. These were sweet-smelling substances that people used for perfume, incense, or to prepare a body for burial.

Stop here and discuss this question: What words can you think of in your language for these kinds of spices? Pause this audio here.

The Queen of Sheba asked Solomon hard questions and talked with him about many things. The queen spoke to Solomon about all the things that were in her mind or heart.

In the original language, the heart is the source of all feelings and thoughts. What is in a person's heart shows who that person truly is.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, what part of the body do you say is the source of all feelings and thoughts? What sayings do you have about a person's feelings and thoughts coming from this part of the body? How could you translate the phrase "she spoke to him about all that was in her heart" into your language? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon told the Queen of Sheba everything she wanted to know. Different Bible translations say this in different ways. Some say "nothing was too difficult for him to explain to her" or "he gave her accurate answers to every question." Other translations might say "there was nothing hidden from the king which he did not explain to her." These are different ways to say the same thing—that Solomon answered all of the queen's questions, and none of the questions were too hard for Solomon.

After the Queen of Sheba talked with Solomon, she realized that Solomon truly was very wise. Some translations say that the Queen of Sheba saw Solomon's wisdom. This might sound awkward in your language, because no one can actually see wisdom. In the original language, to see something can also mean to experience something, know something, or understand something. So this is a way to say that the Queen of Sheba realized that Solomon was very wise.

Stop here and discuss how you will say "the Queen of Sheba had seen all the wisdom of Solomon" in your language. Pause this audio here.

The Queen of Sheba saw Solomon's palace and thought it was grand and beautiful. The queen was impressed by the quality, quantity, and variety of food that Solomon served to his guests and officials. The queen was also impressed by "the seating of his officials." Bible scholars are not sure what this phrase means. This phrase might mean that Solomon had many officials and that they all ate luxurious meals in Solomon's palace. This would show that Solomon was very rich, because the king had to pay for all those people to eat in his palace. It might mean that Solomon provided very beautiful places for his officials to live. This would also show that Solomon was rich and generous to the people who worked for him. It might also mean that the offices and rooms where Solomon's officials worked were very beautiful.

The Queen of Sheba was impressed by the clothing of Solomon's servants. One type of servant was a cupbearer. The cupbearer was a high-ranking official in the king's court. The cupbearer's main job was to taste the king's drink before the king did to make sure it was not poisoned. But the cupbearer could have other jobs as well.

The Queen of Sheba was impressed by the sacrifices that Solomon made at the temple of Yahweh. Some translations include the idea that Solomon had to go up a stairway in order to go up to the temple and make the sacrifices.

After the Queen of Sheba saw all the beauty of Solomon's palace, the storyteller says that "there was no spirit left in her." In the original language, the word for spirit is also the word for breath. To have no breath left means the person is stunned or shocked by what they have just experienced. In this case, the Queen of Sheba was shocked in a good way. Everything the queen saw and heard, from King Solomon's wisdom to the beauty of his

palace, was amazing to her. The queen had expected to see good things in Solomon's palace, but everything was much better than she thought it would be. You might have heard the storyteller say that "she was overwhelmed" or "she was breathless and amazed."

Stop here and recall the story you told before about someone who saw something incredible and felt amazed. What words or phrases do you use to describe how that person felt? Pause this audio here.

The Queen of Sheba told Solomon that she had heard reports of his wisdom and the things Solomon had done, but that she did not believe them.

The Queen of Sheba did not believe the reports of Solomon's wisdom and achievements until she came and saw it with her own eyes. This is a common way to say that the Queen of Sheba found out for herself that all the reports were true. In this case, the Queen of Sheba saw Solomon's palace, heard his wisdom, ate his food, and saw all the riches that Solomon had.

After the Queen of Sheba talked to Solomon and saw his palace in person, the queen told Solomon that people had not told her even half of what Solomon had done. This means that, although the queen heard many good things about Solomon, those things were not enough to fully describe how wise Solomon was and how wealthy and beautiful Jerusalem was. The report the queen heard did not have nearly enough information to describe how wonderful Solomon's palace was and how much wisdom Solomon had.

Stop here and discuss how you will describe what the Queen of Sheba meant when she said that people had not told her even half of what Solomon had done. Pause this audio here.

When you listened to three different versions of this story, you might have heard the Queen of Sheba say, "How happy your people must be!" or you might have heard her say, "How happy your wives must be!" The word for "people" and the word for "wives" are very similar in the original language, and Bible scholars do not agree on which one is meant here. We recommend that you base your translation on whichever word is used in the Bible that your local church uses.

When the Queen of Sheba says that Solomon's people or wives must be happy, she means that they are very blessed or fortunate because of all the good things Solomon has done for them. The queen means that these people have good lives, with everything they need to be prosperous and secure. These people do not have to worry about their safety or their basic needs, and they can be proud of their people and their country. This would make them feel happy most of the time.

Stop here and discuss how you might translate "How happy your people must be" into your language. Pause this audio here.

Now, the Queen of Sheba says, "Blessed be Yahweh your God." This statement has a different meaning than when the Queen of Sheba said that Solomon's people were blessed. This statement is a way to praise or worship Yahweh. This statement means that Yahweh is a very good God and deserves to be praised because of that goodness.

The Queen of Sheba says that Yahweh set Solomon on the throne of Israel. This is just a way to say that Yahweh made Solomon king of Israel. Only a king can sit on the throne, so if Yahweh seated Solomon on the throne, that means that Yahweh made Solomon the king. Finally, the Queen of Sheba says that Yahweh made Solomon king over Israel because Yahweh loves Israel forever and wants Solomon to do justice and righteousness.

In ancient Israel, the king was the highest human authority in the land. The king was responsible for everything that happened in his country. The people could come to the king if they needed an impartial judge to help with a conflict, solve a problem, or right a wrong. The king was supposed to protect those who were poor and weak and punish those who did wrong. The king was also supposed to always follow Yahweh's law and do what was right. This is what "justice and righteousness" means.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your country, or in your people group, who is responsible to help people resolve conflict, solve problems, or fix bad situations? How do you describe the role that these people fill? Pause this audio here.

In scene three, the storyteller goes back in time. The storyteller tells us that Solomon's ships that sailed to Ophir and brought back gold also brought back precious stones and almugwood. Bible scholars are not sure exactly

what kind of wood this was, but it was good for constructing large buildings like the temple of Yahweh and the royal palace. Most translations of the Bible call it “almugwood.” The word “almug” sounds like the word for these trees in the original language. But a few translations call it “sandalwood” or “juniper wood.” Sandalwood is a kind of tree that grows in Asia. It is one of the most expensive kinds of wood in the world.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sandalwood tree. Pause this audio here.

Juniper trees grow all over the world. Some of them are very strong wood that is useful for building.

Stop here and look at pictures of a sandalwood tree and a juniper tree. Pause this audio here.

When you listened to three different versions of the passage, you might have heard that “the king used the almugwood to make supports for the house of Yahweh.” Or you might have heard that the king made railings for the house of Yahweh. Or you might have heard that the king made steps for the house of Yahweh. Bible scholars are not sure what kind of structure Solomon made from the almugwood, so any of these translation choices is acceptable.

The Israelites also used almugwood to make musical instruments. King Solomon used the wood to make harps and lyres for his musicians. A harp is a musical instrument that people make of wood. A harp uses strings to make sound. A harp is usually shaped like a triangle. A lyre also uses strings to make sound, but the people arrange the strings differently on the wood. A lyre is usually shaped more like a rectangle or oval.

Stop here and look at a picture of a harp and a lyre. What kind of stringed instruments do you have in your country? Are any of those instruments like a harp or a lyre? Pause this audio here.

Solomon’s ships brought back precious stones. These are stones that are rare and very beautiful. Because these stones are rare and beautiful, people will pay a lot of money for them. Solomon used precious stones to decorate the temple of Yahweh. The priests’ garments also contained precious stones. Women liked to use precious stones to make jewelry.

Stop here and discuss these questions: What precious stones do your people value? What do you use the stones for? Pause this audio here.

In scene four, Solomon gave the Queen of Sheba gifts. It was the normal custom for kings and queens to give each other gifts as a sign of respect and also to show how rich they were. This is what the storyteller calls the “royal generosity.” But King Solomon gave the Queen of Sheba even more than the usual amount of gifts. Solomon gave the queen whatever she requested. Then the Queen of Sheba returned to her own land with her servants.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:26–10:13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Hiram
- Hiram’s sailors
- Solomon’s men
- The Queen of Sheba
- The Queen of Sheba’s servants
- Solomon’s officials
- Palace servants
- Cupbearers
- And musicians

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

King Solomon built a fleet of ships at Ezion Geber, near Elath in the land of Edom, along the shore of the Red Sea. King Hiram sent crews of sailors to sail the ships with Solomon's men. The men sailed to Ophir and brought back to Solomon more than 4,000 kilograms of gold. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so happy to have these wonderful ships; or
- I am glad that the trip to Ophir was successful; or
- I am grateful to Hiram for sending his sailors to teach my men how to sail the ships.

Ask the people playing Solomon's men, "What are you feeling or thinking?" They might answer things like:

- I feel safe and secure now that our people have these ships; or
- I have never seen so much gold in my life; or
- I am proud to serve a king who is as strong and wise as King Solomon.

Ask the people playing Hiram's men, "What are you feeling or thinking?" They might answer things like:

- I wish we did not have to work so hard only to give all the goods to Solomon; or
- We have an important alliance with Solomon's people, so we should work together with them; or
- If King Hiram wants us to train Solomon's men to sail, then I will do my duty and train them.

Continue the drama. When the Queen of Sheba heard that Solomon was famous because of the name of Yahweh, she came to test him with difficult questions. The queen arrived in Jerusalem with a large group of attendants and a great caravan of camels loaded with spices, large quantities of gold, and precious stones. When the queen met with Solomon, she talked with him about everything that was in her heart. Solomon had answers for all of the queen's questions. Nothing was too hard for the king to explain to the Queen of Sheba. When the Queen of Sheba realized how wise Solomon was, and when she saw the palace he had built, the excellent food on his tables, the seating of his officials, the service of his waiters and their excellent clothing, his cupbearers, and the sacrifices Solomon made at the temple of Yahweh, she was completely amazed. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that this important woman has come to visit me; or
- I am pleased that the Queen of Sheba is impressed with my palace; or
- I enjoy sharing wisdom with others.

Ask the person playing the Queen of Sheba, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am impressed with this man's wisdom; or
- I feel happy and honored to have the chance to talk with such an insightful person; or
- It feels good to know someone who can answer these tricky questions; or
- I have never seen a person or a place like this before!

Continue the drama. The Queen of Sheba said to the king, "The report that I heard in my country about your achievements and your wisdom is true. But I did not believe these things until I came and saw them myself. In fact, not even half was told to me! You are much more wise and rich than anyone told me! How happy your

people must be! How happy your officials must be, who continually stand in your presence and hear your wisdom! Blessed be Yahweh your God, who has delighted in you and placed you on the throne of Israel. Because of Yahweh's eternal love for Israel, he has made you king to do what is right and just." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very pleased that my country and I have made such a good impression on this woman; or
- I like the Queen of Sheba. Perhaps we can be allies with her country; or
- I am glad that the Queen of Sheba is giving glory to Yahweh, because he is the one who made all of this possible.

Ask the person playing the Queen of Sheba, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Solomon's God has blessed him abundantly; or
- I want my country to be as rich and as beautiful as Israel; or
- I cannot say enough good things about Solomon and his achievements.

Ask the people playing King Solomon's officials, palace staff, and cupbearers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I feel proud to serve such a great king in such a great nation; or
- I am amazed that our food and clothes are even better than those in Sheba; or
- I am pleased that this foreigner is so impressed with our country.

Continue the drama. And also, the ships of Hiram, which brought gold from Ophir, brought in from Ophir a very great amount of almugwood and precious stones. The king made the almugwood into supports for the temple of Yahweh and for the royal palace, and he also made lyres and harps for the musicians. It was the best almugwood that anyone ever brought into Israel. No one has seen anything like it ever again. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very pleased to have all this almugwood for the temple of Yahweh and my palace; or
- These ships are very good for our country. Perhaps we should build more; or
- I feel humbled that I can provide all these beautiful things for my people.

Ask the people playing the musicians, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so happy to have such a beautiful new harp to play; or
- With all these new harps and lyres, our musicians will be truly excellent; or
- I feel proud to serve such a great king as Solomon.

Continue the drama. King Solomon gave the Queen of Sheba everything she asked for, even more than all the royal bounty that he had generously given her. Then the queen and her servants returned to the land of Sheba. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I was able to give the Queen of Sheba so many generous gifts; or
- I hope the Queen of Sheba sees Israel as an important and powerful country; or
- Thank you, Yahweh, for blessing me with wisdom that impresses the leaders of other countries.

Ask the person playing the Queen of Sheba, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel pleased to bring all these amazing gifts back to my country; or
- This was a very successful trip; or
- How will I ever explain to my people all the wonderful things I saw in Solomon's country?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 9:26–10:13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

1 Kings 9:26–10:13

If you have already translated the book of 2 Chronicles, then you have already translated one version of this story. It might be helpful to go back and listen to that story now to remember how you translated it.

Stop here and listen to the first part of 2 Chronicles chapter 9, if it is available in your language. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon built a fleet of ships at **Ezion Geber**, near **Elath** in the land of **Edom**, along the shore of the Red Sea. Use the same word you have used previously for king, and remember that king is in the Master Glossary.

If necessary, stop here and listen to Deuteronomy chapter 2, if it is available in your language, to remember how you translated **Ezion Geber** and **Elath**. Pause this audio here.

If necessary, stop here and listen to the beginning of Genesis chapter 36, if it is available in your language, to remember how you translated the name **Edom**. Pause this audio here.

If necessary, stop here and decide what word or phrase you will use for **ship**. Pause this audio here.

King Hiram sent crews of **sailors** to sail the ships with Solomon's men. The men sailed to Ophir and brought back to Solomon 420 **talents**, or more than 14,000 kilograms, of gold. If you use the word for talent, use the same word that you have used previously, and refer to talent in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and decide what word you will use to translate **sailor**. Pause this audio here.

When the Queen of Sheba heard that Solomon was famous because of the name of **Yahweh**, she came to test Solomon with difficult questions. Be sure to translate Yahweh the same way you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on Yahweh.

Stop here and decide how you will translate **queen** and **famous**. See the Master Glossary for more information on a queen. Pause this audio here.

The Queen of Sheba arrived in Jerusalem with a large group of attendants and a great caravan of **camels** loaded with spices, large quantities of gold, and precious stones. When the queen met with Solomon, she talked with him about everything that was in her heart. Solomon had answers for all of the queen's questions. Nothing was too hard for the king to explain to her. When the Queen of Sheba realized how wise Solomon was, and when she saw the **palace** he had built, the excellent food on his tables, the seating of his officials, the service of his waiters and their excellent clothing, his cupbearers, and the sacrifices Solomon made at the **temple** of Yahweh, she was completely amazed. Remember to translate palace, or king's house, and temple the same way you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on temple and camel.

If necessary, stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter 40 to remember how you translated **cupbearer**. Pause this audio here.

The Queen of Sheba said to the king, "The report that I heard in my country about your achievements and your **wisdom** is true. But I did not believe these things until I came and saw them myself. In fact, not even half was told to me! You are much more wise and rich than anyone told me!" Be sure to translate wisdom the same way that you have in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on wisdom.

The Queen of Sheba also said, "How happy your people must be! How happy your officials must be, who continually stand in your presence and hear your wisdom! **Blessed** be Yahweh your **God**, who has delighted in you and placed you on the **throne** of **Israel**." In this case, to say "Blessed be Yahweh" is a way to worship Yahweh. Be sure to translate "throne" the same way you did in previous passages. Be sure to translate "Bless, or **praise** Yahweh" the same way you have in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on bless and praise. Also, be sure to translate God the same way you have in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on God and Israel.

The queen also said, "Because of Yahweh's eternal love for Israel, he has made you king to do what is **right** and **just**."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate that the king does what is **right** and **just**. Be sure to translate the ideas of "justice" and "righteousness," or doing what is right and fair, the same way that you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on justice and righteousness. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 9:26–10:13

And also, the ships of Hiram, which brought gold from Ophir, brought in from Ophir a very great amount of **almugwood** and precious stones.

Stop here and decide how you will translate **almugwood** into your language. Will you use a word for an existing kind of wood from your language, or will you translate it to sound like the word in the original language? If necessary, you can look again at the picture of a sandalwood tree and a juniper tree to help decide what you will call this kind of wood. Pause this audio here.

The king made the almugwood into supports for the temple of Yahweh and for the palace, and he also made **lyres** and **harps** for the musicians. It was the best almugwood that people ever brought into Israel, and nothing like it has ever been seen again.

Stop here and decide what word you will use for **lyre** and what word you will use for **harp**. Look again at pictures of a harp and a lyre if you need to. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon gave the Queen of Sheba everything she asked for, even more than all the **royal bounty** that he had generously given her. Royal bounty means all the gifts that a king usually gave to another king or queen who visited his palace.

Stop here and decide how you will translate **royal bounty** into your language. Pause this audio here.

Then the Queen of Sheba and her servants returned to the land of Sheba.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 9:26–10:13

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (916 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (14.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.6 MB)

- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 10:14–29

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 10:14–29 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 10:14–29 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 10:14–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the storyteller told us about the time the Queen of Sheba visited King Solomon. In this story, the storyteller tells us more about how rich Solomon was. The storyteller includes a description of the beautiful throne that Solomon built inside the palace, the gifts he received from visitors, and the number of chariots and horses that Solomon owned.

In Bible times, people considered kings to be powerful and important if they were very rich. This story shows us that King Solomon was extremely rich. However, Yahweh had told the Israelites that their king was not supposed to own many horses, store large amounts of silver and gold, or marry a large number of wives. The kings of Israel were supposed to be different from the kings of the people around them. When Solomon built up a large army of horses and a large amount of silver and gold, Solomon disobeyed Yahweh.

Solomon received 666 talents of gold, which was almost 23,000 kilograms of gold each year. This is a very large amount of gold. In addition, Solomon received money and goods through taxes on his own people and from people in the lands around Israel.

Stop here and discuss these questions: How does the government of your country get money? Do you have to pay taxes? What sorts of things do you have to pay taxes on? Pause this audio here.

In this story, the storyteller describes some of the ways Solomon used his gold. Solomon used some of the gold to make large and small shields. A shield is a piece of equipment that soldiers used for defense in battle. A shield could protect a soldier from arrows, swords, or other objects.

Stop here and look at a picture of a soldier with a shield. Pause this audio here.

Gold is a very soft metal and is not good to use as a shield. So Solomon's soldiers probably did not use these shields in battle. Solomon probably made these shields as decoration for the House of the Forest of Lebanon. This house was a large building in Jerusalem. Bible scholars believe that Solomon occasionally took the shields out of the House of the Forest of Lebanon and used them during ceremonies. This would have shown the people how rich their king was.

Solomon used gold and ivory to make a large, beautiful throne in his palace. A throne is a special seat that only the king can sit on. Ivory is white and comes from the tusks of elephants.

Stop here and look at a picture of an elephant. Note the size and color of the tusks. Pause this audio here.

Ivory is very beautiful and easy to carve. People used ivory to make jewelry and art. In this case, Solomon used the ivory to decorate his throne. It was a very large throne, with six steps leading up to it. The lions next to the

1 Kings 10:14–29

armrests and on the steps were not real lions, but statues of lions. A lion is a large, wild cat that was common in Israel during Solomon's time. Lions are very strong and can easily kill a human. Because of this, the Israelites feared lions more than any other animal in the land. Hardly any other animal can kill a lion, so all the animals are afraid of lions too. Because the lion is so strong and every animal is afraid of a lion, many people call lions "the king of the animals."

Bible scholars think the lion statues around Solomon's throne were probably covered in gold.

Stop here and look at a picture that shows what Solomon's throne might have looked like. Pause this audio here.

Solomon had so much gold that he was able to make everyday items, like cups, plates, forks, and spoons, out of gold. Solomon had so much gold that the Israelites considered silver relatively worthless, even though most people usually consider silver to be valuable. The storyteller says that during Solomon's time, silver was as common as stones in Jerusalem. People built Jerusalem on hills that are very rocky, and Jerusalem stone is famous because it is a very good material to build with. So stones were extremely common in Jerusalem. Sycamore trees were common in the lowlands of Judah. Cedar trees were not common in Israel, and people had to import them from Tyre and other areas further north. Cedar was expensive, but Solomon was so rich that he was able to buy a large amount of cedar wood for his building projects.

The storyteller says that Solomon had a fleet of ships that sailed on the ocean with Hiram's fleet. These ships brought goods and animals from faraway countries. It is likely that this fleet of ships was in addition to the ships stationed at Ezion Geber in the far south of Israel. Hiram was the King of Tyre, and the city of Tyre was located north of Israel on the coast of the Mediterranean Sea. Israel also had a coastline on the Mediterranean Sea, so it makes the most sense for the ships of Solomon and Hiram to sail from this location.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and the kingdom of Tyre. Note that both kingdoms have a coast on the Mediterranean Sea. Pause this audio here.

Although Solomon was very rich, he was also famous for his wisdom. The storyteller says that people from all over the world came to Jerusalem to visit Solomon and listen to his wisdom, and when they came, they brought Solomon gifts. This is another way that Solomon became rich.

Solomon also owned many chariots and horses. This meant that Solomon had a powerful army. Solomon stationed the chariots in Jerusalem and in other special cities throughout Israel. Solomon purchased horses and chariots from Egypt and another place called Kue. Most Bible scholars believe Kue was located northwest of Israel in the modern-day country of Turkey. Solomon's men not only bought horses and chariots for Israel, but also sold them to the kings of the Hittites and the Arameans.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 10:14–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us how much gold Solomon received each year and describes the shields Solomon made from that gold.

In the second scene: The storyteller describes the throne that Solomon built in the palace.

In the third scene: The storyteller describes how rich Solomon was and the items that Solomon's trading ships brought to him.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller tells us that many people came to visit Solomon in order to hear his wisdom, and the people brought marvelous gifts with them.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller tells us about Solomon's chariots and horses.

The characters in this passage are:

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- King Solomon
- Traders, merchants, kings of Arabia, and governors of territories
- People who came to Jerusalem to hear Solomon's wisdom
- Solomon's sailors and Hiram's sailors
- And Solomon's horsemen and charioteers

If you have already translated the Book of 2 Chronicles, then you have already translated a version of this story. It might help to go back and listen to that story now. Stop here and listen to the second part of 2 Chronicles chapter 9, after the story of the visit of the Queen of Sheba. Pause this audio here.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller says that Solomon received 666 talents, or almost 23,000 kilograms, of gold each year. Every year, the rulers of the countries around Israel paid tribute to Solomon. A less powerful ruler pays tribute to a more powerful ruler. Because of this payment, the more powerful ruler agrees not to attack the country of the less powerful ruler.

King Solomon did not just get rich from gold—he also made money from people who did business in his land. If someone wanted to buy or sell things in Israel, they had to pay a tax to the king. Even if traders were just passing through the country, they had to pay a fee to travel there. All this money went to Solomon and helped make Solomon even richer.

The Arabian kings were the rulers of the lands to the southeast of Israel. The storyteller said that their tribute was not included in the 23,000 kilograms of gold that Solomon received each year.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and Arabia. What name does your language have for the area called Arabia? Pause this audio here.

The phrase "governors of the land" or "governors of the territories" probably refers to the governors of different areas inside Israel. A governor managed part of the country for the king. For example, in Israel, there was one governor who was responsible for managing the territory that belonged to each tribe. One job of a governor was to collect a tax from the people and give it to the king.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your country, what do you call the people who are responsible for managing different areas of the country? Could you use any of these words to translate the word "governor"? If not, what words could you use for a person who is responsible for managing one part of a country? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon hired artists to make his gold shields. Solomon did not make the shields himself. The artists made large shields and small shields. Most Bible scholars believe that people made the shields of a strong yet lightweight material like wood and then overlaid that material with gold. The larger shields required about 600 shekels, or about seven kilograms of gold, and the smaller shields required three minas, or about two kilograms of gold. Gold is a soft metal and is a poor material to use to make shields. Bible scholars believe that soldiers did not use these shields in battle, but that Solomon put them in the House of the Forest of Lebanon as decoration.

The House of the Forest of Lebanon was the largest building in Solomon's palace. Solomon built this house from cedar that came from Lebanon. This house might have been a gathering place for large groups of people, or it might have been a place to store weapons.

In the second scene, Solomon hires men to build a throne that is unlike any other throne in the world. Solomon's throne was on a platform with six steps leading up to it. When you listened to three different versions of this passage, some of them might have said that Solomon made the throne from ivory and then overlaid it with the finest gold. Most Bible scholars think it was unlikely that Solomon would have covered ivory with gold, because ivory was expensive and also very beautiful. Most Bible scholars believe that Solomon built the throne, overlaid it with gold, and then placed ivory decorations on certain parts of the throne.

Stop here and look at a picture of some ivory objects and decorations. Pause this audio here.

When you listened to three different versions of this passage, you might have heard some versions say that the top of the throne was round, while a few other versions might have said that there was a bull's head at the top of the throne. Most Bible scholars believe that the top of the throne was round because that was a very common

way to make a throne at that time. We recommend that you translate this phrase to say that the top of the throne was round.

Each step that led up to Solomon's throne had a figure of a lion on each side, and there was a figure of a lion next to each armrest on the throne. The tribe of Judah used the figure of a lion as a symbol of their tribe. Solomon was from the tribe of Judah.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lion. Pause this audio here.

In scene three, the storyteller tells us that people made all of Solomon's drinking cups from gold and that people made all of the utensils in the House of the Forest of Lebanon from pure gold. This shows that Solomon had so much gold that he could afford to use it for everyday items like cups and utensils.

Stop here and look at a picture of a gold drinking cup. Pause this audio here.

Silver is another valuable metal that people commonly used in Bible times to make coins, jewelry, utensils, or other items. In this scene, the storyteller tells us that silver was considered as nothing during Solomon's days. This is a way to say that silver had no value, or was worthless, during Solomon's reign as king. Solomon was so rich during his reign that even ordinary Israelites thought that silver was not worth very much.

Solomon had a fleet of ships called "the ships of Tarshish." Tarshish was a city located on the far western end of the Mediterranean Sea. Israel was located on the far eastern end of the Mediterranean Sea.

Stop here and look at a map of the Mediterranean Sea that shows the location of Israel and the approximate location of Tarshish. Pause this audio here.

A ship would have to sail about 1,600 kilometers to go from Israel to Tarshish. So this phrase tells us that Solomon's fleet of ships sailed in the Mediterranean Sea and could sail very long distances. Some versions might have called these ships "merchant ships" or "trading ships" because traders used them to take goods to other countries and to bring goods back home. Solomon's ships brought back gold, silver, ivory, and animals. Bible scholars are not certain what kind of animals these were. Some versions of this story say that they were "apes and peacocks," while other versions say they were "apes and baboons" or "apes and monkeys."

Monkeys are small to medium-sized, four-legged animals that have hands similar to human hands. Monkeys also have tails.

Stop here and look at a picture of a monkey. Pause this audio here.

Apes are large monkeys. Some apes can be larger than humans. Apes do not have tails.

Stop here and look at a picture of an ape. Pause this audio here.

A baboon is a specific type of medium-sized monkey.

Stop here and look at a picture of a baboon. Pause this audio here.

A peacock is a kind of bird. Peacocks have very colorful, beautiful tail feathers. People use these feathers for decorations. Women can even wear peacock feathers on their hats or clothing.

Stop here and look at a picture of a peacock. Pause this audio here.

If your language does not have a word for any of these animals, you can provide a description. For example, instead of "peacocks," you could say "exotic birds" or "birds with brightly colored feathers."

In scene four, the storyteller reminds us that Solomon was the richest and wisest king of his time. Everyone wanted to come see Solomon and hear his wise sayings. The storyteller says that God put this wisdom in Solomon's heart. In the Israelites' culture, people considered the heart to be the place where a person's thoughts, feelings, and wisdom came from.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your culture, what part of the body do you consider thoughts, feelings, and wisdom to come from? Pause this audio here.

Each person who came to see Solomon brought a gift. Some people brought silver and gold. Other people brought clothes, weapons, or spices. Some people brought horses and mules. A mule is an animal that is very similar to

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a horse, but mules can work harder and are easier to handle than horses. When a male donkey mates with a female horse, the baby will be a mule.

Stop here and look at a picture of a mule. Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, the storyteller describes Solomon's chariots and horses. Solomon had 1,400 chariots. When you listened to three different versions of this passage, some might have said that Solomon had 12,000 horses, while others said that Solomon had 12,000 horsemen. A horseman is a person who knows how to handle horses. Bible scholars do not agree on whether the original language means that Solomon had 12,000 horses or that Solomon had 12,000 horsemen. Some scholars think that translating the word as "horses" makes more sense in this story than translating it as "horsemen," but either choice is acceptable.

Solomon kept some of his horses, chariots, and charioteers in the chariot cities he had built all over Israel. The chariot cities had special buildings to keep the horses, chariots, and horsemen in. Solomon also kept some of his chariots in Jerusalem to protect the capital city. Solomon bought horses from Egypt and from a place called Kue. Bible scholars are not certain exactly where Kue was. However, scholars know that during Solomon's time, people who lived in an area in southeastern Turkey known as Cilicia had a reputation for breeding excellent horses. When you listened to three different versions of this passage, you might have heard that Solomon bought horses from Egypt and Kue, or that Solomon bought horses from Egypt and Cilicia.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the locations of Israel and Cilicia. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that the price of a chariot was about 600 shekels, or seven kilograms of silver, and the price of a horse was about 150 shekels, or two kilograms of silver. The storyteller adds that Solomon's men sold chariots and horses to the kings of the Hittite people group and the kings of the Aramean people group.

In the middle of this scene, the storyteller mentions again that silver was so common in Israel that it was as common as stones. The storyteller also claims that cedars were as common as sycamore trees in the lowlands. The Israelites had to import good-quality cedar from Lebanon, and it was expensive. In contrast, sycamore trees were very common in an area people called Shephelah, which was in the foothills of Judah. Both of these statements mean that Solomon was so rich that he could buy a lot of expensive things.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 10:14–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Traders, merchants, kings of Arabia, and governors of territories
- Solomon's sailors and Hiram's sailors
- People who came to Jerusalem to hear Solomon's wisdom
- And Solomon's horsemen and charioteers

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

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Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Every year, King Solomon received around 23,000 kilograms of gold. This was in addition to the taxes that merchants paid to Solomon, the profits from traders, and the money Solomon received from all the kings of Arabia and the governors of the country. King Solomon made 200 large shields and covered each one with about seven kilograms of hammered gold. And Solomon made 300 small shields and overlaid each one with about two kilograms of hammered gold. The king placed these shields in the House of the Forest of Lebanon.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is so nice to have the resources to make all these beautiful things; or
- All this gold will make our country more secure; or
- I feel powerful because I have so much wealth.

Ask the people playing the traders and merchants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I wish we did not have to pay these taxes and fees; or
- I wonder if I can find a way around paying these taxes and fees; or
- I do not mind paying these taxes because the king uses them to make our country strong and secure.

Ask the people playing the kings of Arabia, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not like it that I have to pay tribute to Solomon; or
- If we do not pay the tribute, I wonder if our army is strong enough to fight against Solomon's army; or
- I feel sad that we are losing our gold to a foreigner.

Ask the people playing the governors of the country, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that our country is so prosperous; or
- I do not like to pay taxes when the king wastes the money to make golden shields; or
- Did Yahweh not say that our king should not collect a lot of gold?

Continue the drama.

Then the king made a great throne that people inlaid with ivory and overlaid with the finest gold. The throne had six steps leading up to it, and the top of the throne was rounded at the back. There were armrests at either side of the seat, and a lion stood next to each armrest. Twelve lions stood on the steps, one at each end of each step. Nothing like this throne had ever been made for any other kingdom.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so proud of this beautiful throne that my workers have made! or
- I feel strong and powerful when I sit on this throne; or
- I hope other kings will come visit me and be impressed by my throne.

Continue the drama.

All of King Solomon's cups were made of gold, and all of the utensils in the House of the Forest of Lebanon were made of pure gold. Nothing was made of silver, for silver had very little value in Solomon's day. For the king had a fleet of trading ships at sea with the ships of King Hiram. Once every three years, the ships came back bringing gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks.

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Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I have so much gold, silver, and other valuable goods; or
- Our partnership with Hiram has been very profitable; or
- I wish my father, David, could have seen these days when Israel is so rich and powerful.

Ask the people playing Solomon and Hiram’s sailors, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I really enjoy sailing to Tarshish and bringing back so many good things to the king; or
- I am glad that our country has so much gold; or
- I wonder why the king needs these apes and peacocks?

Continue the drama.

So King Solomon became greater than all the kings of the earth in riches and in wisdom. People from all over the earth came to consult Solomon and hear the wisdom that God put in his heart. Year after year, everyone who visited Solomon brought him gifts of silver and gold, clothing, weapons, spices, horses, and mules.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that my wisdom can help so many people; or
- I am thankful that Yahweh gave me the gift of wisdom; or
- I am amazed by all the gifts the people are bringing to me.

Ask the people playing the people who came to hear Solomon’s wisdom, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I feel honored that the great King Solomon is willing to see me; or
- I am amazed by how wise Solomon is; or
- It was definitely worth the trip and the cost to come see such a wise king!

Continue the drama.

Solomon built up a force of 1,400 chariots and 12,000 horsemen. Solomon stationed these chariots and horsemen in the chariot cities and with the king in Jerusalem. The king made silver as common as stones in Jerusalem, and he made cedar as common as sycamore trees in the lowlands of the foothills of Judah. Solomon’s horses came from Egypt and from Cilicia, and the king’s merchants bought them from Cilicia at the standard price. They bought a chariot from Egypt for about seven kilograms of silver, and a horse for about two kilograms of silver. And they also exported them to the kings of the Hittites and the Arameans.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am pleased that our army has grown so large; or
- I hope that these chariots and horsemen will keep our nation safe for many years to come; or
- I want Israel to be the most powerful nation on earth.

Ask the people playing Solomon’s horsemen and charioteers, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- Finally, our country has an army as powerful as Egypt; or
- I feel proud to serve in such a strong army; or
- I am grateful to King Solomon for providing such good chariots and horses for our army.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 10:14–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

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Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

If you have already translated the Book of 2 Chronicles, then you have already translated a version of this story. It might help to go back and listen to that story now. Stop here and listen to the second part of 2 Chronicles chapter 9, after the story of the visit of the Queen of Sheba. Pause this audio here.

Every year, **King** Solomon received around 666 **talents**, or 23,000 kilograms of gold. This was in addition to the taxes paid by merchants, the profits from traders, and what Solomon received from all the kings of Arabia and the governors of the country. Be sure to translate king the same way as you did in previous stories. See the Master Glossary for more information on king. If you use the word for talent rather than a modern-day unit of measurement, translate it in the same way that you did previously, and refer to the Master Glossary if you need more information.

Stop here and discuss the following question. If your language does not have a name for the place called "**Arabia**," then decide how you will translate this name into your language. Also, decide how you will translate "governors" into your language. A governor is an official who manages one part of a country on behalf of the king. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon made 200 large shields and covered each one with about 600 shekels, or seven kilograms of hammered gold. And Solomon made 300 small shields and overlaid each one with about three minas, or two kilograms, of hammered gold. A shekel is a unit of weight, around 11 grams. The king placed these shields in the House of the Forest of Lebanon.

Stop here and look at a picture of a shield as a group. Decide how you will translate "**shield**" into your language. Be sure to translate "House of the Forest of Lebanon" the same way you did in previous stories. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss how you would like to translate **shekels** and **minas** as a group. You may use the modern-day kilogram unit of measurement if you would like, which would be seven kilograms of gold in each of the large shields and two kilograms of gold in each of the small shields. For more information about "shekel," refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

> Then the king made a great **throne** that people inlaid with **ivory** and overlaid with the finest gold. Be sure to translate "throne" the same way you did in previous passages.
>
> Stop here and look again at the photo of the elephant with ivory tusks. Decide how you will translate "ivory" into your language. Pause this audio here.
>
> The throne had six steps leading up to it, and the top of the throne was rounded at the back. There were armrests at either side of the seat, and a lion stood next to each armrest. Twelve lions stood on the steps, one at each end of each step. Nothing like it had ever been made for any other **kingdom**. Be sure to use the same word for kingdom as you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on kingdom.
>
> Stop here and look again at the photo of the **lion** if needed. If your language does not have a word for lion, decide how you will describe a lion for your hearers. Pause this audio here.

All of King Solomon's cups were made of gold, and all of the utensils in the House of the Forest of Lebanon were made of pure gold. Nothing was made of silver, for silver had very little value in Solomon's day. For the king had a fleet of trading ships at sea with the ships of King Hiram. Once every three years, the ships came back bringing gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks.

Stop here and look at photos of apes, peacocks, baboons, and monkeys if needed. Decide how you will translate "apes" and "peacocks" into your language. You may also use the words "baboons" and "monkeys." Pause this audio here.

So King Solomon became greater than all the kings of the earth in riches and in **wisdom**. People from all over the earth came to consult Solomon and hear the wisdom that **God** put in his **heart**. Year after year, everyone

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who visited Solomon brought him gifts of silver and gold, clothing, weapons, spices, horses, and mules. Be sure to use the same words for wisdom, heart, and God as you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on wisdom, heart, and God.

Stop here and look at the photo of a mule again if needed. Decide what word you will use for "mule." Pause this audio here.

> Solomon built up a force of 1,400 **chariots** and 12,000 horsemen. Solomon stationed them in the chariot cities and with the king in Jerusalem. The king made silver as common as stones in Jerusalem, and the king made cedar as common as sycamore trees in the lowlands of the foothills of Judah. Be sure to use the same words for chariots and chariot cities as you used before. Solomon's horses came from Egypt and from Cilicia, and the king's merchants bought them from Cilicia at the standard price.
>
> Stop here and look again at a map of Israel and Cilicia. Note the location of Cilicia. Decide how you will translate "**Cilicia**" into your language. Pause this audio here.
>
> People bought a chariot from Egypt for about 600 shekels, or seven kilograms of silver, and a horse for about 150 shekels, or two kilograms of silver. And people also exported them to the kings of the **Hittites** and the **Arameans**. Be sure to translate Hittites and Arameans the same way you did in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 10:14–29

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (890 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (9.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 11:1–13

1 Kings 11:1–13

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 11:1–13 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:1–13 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the storyteller described more about King Solomon's great wealth, wisdom, and military power. In this story, King Solomon marries many foreign women, and when Solomon becomes old, he begins to worship the gods that his wives worship. This makes Yahweh angry. So Yahweh tells Solomon that, starting with Solomon's son, Solomon's descendants will no longer rule over all 12 tribes of Israel, but only over one.

When Yahweh led the Israelites into Canaan, Yahweh told the Israelites many times not to marry any Canaanites. Yahweh told the Israelites this because Yahweh knew that if an Israelite married a Canaanite, the Canaanite would pressure the Israelite to worship the Canaanites' false gods. Then the Israelite might begin to worship those false gods instead of Yahweh. Moses and Joshua also warned the Israelites not to marry Canaanites, because then the Israelites would certainly worship the Canaanites' gods. Sadly, this is exactly what happened to King Solomon. Solomon married many foreign women, and those women wanted to worship their own gods. Solomon built places for his foreign wives to worship their gods, and eventually Solomon began to worship those gods too.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who faced pressure to do something wrong and eventually did it. What did other people say or do to that person to pressure that person? How long did that person resist the pressure before that person decided to do the wrong thing? What happened afterwards? Pause this audio here.

At this time in history, a king often had many wives. When a king had many wives, it showed that the king was rich and powerful. Solomon probably married many of these women in order to make agreements with the leaders of the Hittites, Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, and Sidonians. While the Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, and Sidonians had their own countries, the Hittites were scattered around the area in small groups.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of Israel, Moab, Ammon, Edom, and Sidon. Pause this audio here.

When Solomon made these marriage agreements with the leaders of the Hittites, Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, and Sidonians, it showed that the leaders of those countries were afraid of Solomon's power and wanted to be on good terms with Solomon.

Stop here and discuss this question: In the area where you live, how do leaders show that they are rich and powerful? Pause this audio here.

Solomon had 700 wives and 300 concubines, or wives who were of lesser status. This is a very large number of wives. Solomon definitely broke Yahweh's command that the king should not have many wives.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your area, how many wives is it appropriate for a leader to marry? Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 11:1–13

Solomon's wives turned his heart away from Yahweh, which means that Solomon did not love Yahweh as much as he once did. Because Solomon did not completely love Yahweh anymore, Solomon worshipped other gods. Yahweh told Solomon not to worship these false gods, but Solomon disobeyed Yahweh and worshipped false gods anyway.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who disobeyed a command of someone in authority. Why did that person disobey the command? What happened after? What were the consequences? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh was very angry and confronted Solomon about this. Yahweh said that Solomon had broken the special agreement Yahweh made with the Israelites and did not follow Yahweh's laws. Yahweh had every right to punish Solomon for this. Yahweh could even have chosen not to allow Solomon to be king of Israel anymore because Solomon had failed as a spiritual leader of Israel. But Yahweh also remembered that Yahweh had promised King David that someone from David's family would always be king of Israel. So Yahweh said that Yahweh would not take the entire kingdom of Israel away from Solomon. Instead, Yahweh would allow 10 of the 12 tribes of Israel to follow another leader, while Solomon's son would be king over just one tribe. This was a punishment because Solomon worshipped other gods, but Yahweh still kept his promise to David by letting someone from David's family remain king.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who showed kindness or mercy to someone because of a relationship with that person's parent. What might have happened if that person had not had a relationship with that person's parent? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also said that Yahweh would allow Solomon's son to rule over one tribe of Israel "for the sake of Jerusalem." Yahweh chose Jerusalem as the special city where Yahweh's presence would live forever and where Yahweh's people would worship Yahweh. Yahweh commanded the Israelites to build Yahweh's temple in Jerusalem and to offer sacrifices only at that location. The descendants of David who ruled over Israel had a special responsibility to protect the temple, encourage faithful worship of Yahweh, and set a good spiritual example for the people of Israel.

Yahweh always keeps his promises. Yahweh promised that someone from David's family would always be king of Israel. Yahweh also promised that Yahweh's special presence would always stay in Jerusalem. Because Yahweh made both of these promises, David's family had to keep ruling from Jerusalem, where the temple was located.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Is there a place that is special to your people group? If so, why is it special to you? What do people say about this place? How would your people feel if you could not go to this place?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon's foreign wives lead him to worship other gods besides Yahweh.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Solomon that the consequences of Solomon's idolatry will be that Solomon's descendants will lose control over all the tribes of Israel except for one.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Pharaoh's daughter
- Solomon's other foreign wives
- Solomon's concubines
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

1 Kings 11:1–13

In the first scene, the storyteller described how Solomon came to sin against Yahweh by worshipping foreign gods. Solomon loved and married many foreign women. In a previous story, we heard that Solomon married Pharaoh's daughter. When Solomon did that, he disobeyed Yahweh. The storyteller revealed that Solomon loved a large number of women from the pagan nations around Israel. Solomon's wives were Hittite women, as well as women from Moab, Ammon, Edom, and Sidon. Sadly, Solomon disobeyed Yahweh over and over.

The storyteller quoted Yahweh's law, which Moses wrote down in one of his books: "You shall not marry them, nor shall they intermarry with you." Yahweh gave this command twice, in a slightly different way each time, to emphasize how important it was.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your language, how do you emphasize something that is really important? How can you translate Yahweh's command so that your hearers know it is very important? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh commanded the Israelites not to marry foreigners because the foreigners would turn the Israelites' hearts away from Yahweh. The Israelites believed that the heart was the place where a person's feelings come from—feelings like love, happiness, anger, or sadness. If your heart is turned toward someone, it means you love that person. But if your heart is turned away from someone, it means you do not love that person. Yahweh warned the Israelites that if they married foreigners, their hearts would not love Yahweh anymore. In the original language, this phrase suggests that Solomon's heart used to be perfect in the way he loved Yahweh, but that Solomon's heart was not perfect anymore.

Stop here and discuss these questions: What words or sayings do you have in your language to describe a situation where one person used to love another person but does not love them anymore? Do any of these sayings make you think that something that was perfect has been lost? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said that if the Israelites married foreigners, the foreigners would "surely" turn the Israelites' hearts away from Yahweh. Yahweh is saying that it is certain that the Israelites' hearts would turn away from Yahweh. Yahweh wanted to emphasize this commandment even more.

Stop here and talk about words in your language that mean something will definitely happen. Which of these words might go best here? Pause this audio here.

Solomon clung to his foreign wives in love. This means that Solomon gave all of his love and loyalty to his wives and refused to change. In this case, when Solomon gave his love and loyalty to his wives, Solomon also gave his love and loyalty to their gods. In the original language, the storyteller says Solomon loved his wives so much that it was like his skin being attached to his body. Just like you cannot take off your skin without dying, Solomon could not let go of his foreign wives or their gods.

Stop here and discuss these questions: What words do you have in your language to describe a situation where one person loves another person so much that they become attached to that person the way your skin is attached to your body? Which of these words might work well here? Pause this audio here.

Solomon had 700 royal wives and 300 concubines. "Royal" means that the woman was a member of the family with the highest social status. In a country that had a king, to be royal meant that a person was a member of the king's family. Some of Solomon's wives might have been from the highest-status family in their own country, or some of them might have become royal just by marrying Solomon.

Stop here and discuss these questions: What special words do you have in your language to talk about people of the highest social status? Which of these words has a similar meaning to "royal"? Pause this audio here.

A concubine was a servant woman who had sexual relations with her master. A concubine was of lower status than a wife, but a concubine still had important legal rights. If a concubine gave birth to children, people considered those children to be the children of the man and his wife.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your culture, is there a role or a status similar to a concubine? Is it possible for a man to have a woman who is not his wife but whom it is socially acceptable for him to have children with? Pause this audio here.

After Solomon married these foreign women, Yahweh's words came true. Solomon's wives "turned his heart away," and Solomon "went after" their gods. This means that Solomon began to give his love and loyalty to the gods that his wives worshipped, instead of giving it to Yahweh only.

1 Kings 11:1–13

In this part of the story, when the storyteller talks about Milcom, Chemosh, and Molech, the storyteller uses a word that has a very negative meaning in the original language. It was a word for something so bad that it made people feel really upset or disgusted. It was something that was so bad that people wanted to stay far away from it. Furthermore, If a person went near the thing that was an abomination, that person would also become filthy and disgusting. Even worse, that person would also have to face Yahweh's judgment. When you read three different versions of this story, you probably heard this word translated in different ways. Some translations might have said something like, "Milcom, the abomination of the Ammonites." Others might have said something like, "Milcom, the disgusting god of the Ammonites." All of these are different ways to try to communicate that Yahweh thought these false gods were filthy and terrible, and that the Israelites should avoid them completely, because if the Israelites went near those gods and worshipped them, the Israelites would also become filthy and terrible.

Stop here and discuss these questions: What words do you have in your language for something that is filthy and that you should avoid completely? Which of these words could you use for the gods of the pagan people around Israel? Pause this audio here.

Ashtoreth, Milcom, Chemosh, and Molech were the names of the gods that Solomon's wives worshipped. We recommend that you translate these names to sound like the names in the Bible your local church uses. You might find that some Bibles use the name Molech instead of Milcom. This is because some Bible scholars think that Molech and Milcom were two different names for the same god. In order to make this clear, some Bibles use the name Molech whenever the storyteller mentions this god. But other Bible scholars think that Molech and Milcom were two different gods. We recommend that you listen to the version of the Bible that your local church uses and use the names that version uses.

Next, the storyteller reminds us that worshipping idols is evil in the sight of Yahweh. This means that Yahweh thinks that it is evil for people to worship idols. Solomon still followed Yahweh partially, which means that Solomon followed some of Yahweh's commands. But Solomon broke Yahweh's command not to worship other gods.

Solomon built places for his foreign wives to worship their gods. Solomon probably did not build these places with his own hands, but rather provided workers, money, and materials to build these places. Solomon should not have allowed anyone to build places of worship for foreign gods. When you listened to three different versions of this passage, you might have heard these places called "high places" or "pagan shrines". These are different ways to describe a place where people worship false gods.

To worship these false gods, Solomon's wives burned incense and made sacrifices.

In the second scene, Yahweh is extremely angry with Solomon.

Stop here and discuss these questions: What words or phrases do you use in your language to describe when a person is extremely angry? How might you translate that Yahweh was very angry with Solomon? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gave a message to Solomon. The storyteller does not tell us if Yahweh appeared to Solomon directly or if Yahweh gave the message to someone else to tell Solomon. Yahweh told Solomon that Yahweh would punish Solomon.

When Solomon worshipped other gods, Solomon broke Yahweh's covenant and Yahweh's statutes. Yahweh clearly told Solomon that this is why Yahweh would punish Solomon. Yahweh said that Yahweh would tear the kingdom away from Solomon and give it to someone else. This statement shows that Yahweh is the one who decides which man gets to be the king of Israel.

Yahweh describes the kingdom of Israel almost like an object that Yahweh gave Solomon to hold. Now, because Solomon did not do what was right, Yahweh will take or tear away the kingdom from Solomon. When people "tear" something, it is like they are tearing cloth into pieces. This word is important because later, someone in Israel will actually tear a piece of cloth into 12 pieces to show that the kingdom of Israel will be divided.

Stop here and find a piece of cloth that will be easy to tear apart. Have two people stand in front of the group and hold the piece of cloth. One person will represent Solomon, while the second person will represent Yahweh.

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Have the person who represents Yahweh tear the piece of cloth in two. Now, the person who represents Solomon will have one piece, and the person who represents Yahweh will have the second piece. What words do you use to describe this action? Yahweh is going to tear the kingdom away from Solomon's descendants like you tore this piece of cloth. How will you translate this action into your language? Pause this audio here.

Some people might get confused because first Yahweh says, "I will tear the kingdom away from you" when Yahweh is speaking to Solomon, but later Yahweh says he will not do it while Solomon is still alive. Instead, Yahweh will do it when Solomon's son is king. Yahweh means that Yahweh will take the kingdom away from Solomon's family. Back then, people believed that a man's children were a big part of his reputation and honor. So even though Solomon would not lose the kingdom himself, it probably made Solomon very sad to know that his descendants would rule over a smaller, poorer, and weaker kingdom. That made Solomon's family seem less important, and that would have felt like a punishment for Solomon, too.

Yahweh also said that Yahweh would not divide the kingdom while Solomon was still alive. Yahweh said this was because of Solomon's father, David. That means Yahweh cared so much about David that Yahweh showed kindness to Solomon, too. The special promises Yahweh made to David also passed down to David's son, Solomon. Yahweh would punish Solomon for Solomon's sin, but the punishment would not be as bad as it could have been.

Yahweh said he would give the kingdom to one of Solomon's servants. Solomon had many servants. Actually, everyone in Israel served the king in some way! But Yahweh did not tell Solomon which servant would get the kingdom. Yahweh probably did not mean a household servant who cooked Solomon's food or cleaned his house. Yahweh probably meant someone important, like a government leader or a military officer.

Stop here and discuss these questions: How have you translated the word "servant" in previous passages? Can this word refer to a government official, military officer, or other leader in the kingdom? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh told Solomon that Yahweh would allow Solomon to be the king of one tribe of Israel. Yahweh also said that this was for the sake of Solomon's father, David.

"For the sake of your father, David," means because of the promise Yahweh made to David. For the sake of Jerusalem means that Yahweh had chosen Jerusalem to be the place where Yahweh's presence would live forever. It was important to Yahweh to make sure that Jerusalem remained under the control of a descendant of David.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Pharaoh's daughter
- Solomon's other foreign wives
- Solomon's concubines
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

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The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

But King Solomon loved many foreign women, in addition to Pharaoh's daughter—women from Moab, Ammon, Edom, Sidon, and Hittite women. Solomon loved these women even though they came from nations about whom Yahweh had said to the Israelites, "You must not marry them, or allow them to marry your people, because they will definitely persuade you to worship their gods." These were the kind of women that Solomon clung to in love. Solomon had 700 royal wives and 300 concubines. Solomon's wives turned his heart away from Yahweh. As a result, when Solomon was old, Solomon's wives convinced him to worship other gods. Solomon's heart was not loyal to Yahweh his God, as the heart of Solomon's father, David, had been.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- My wives want to worship their gods. I have to give my wives what they want to keep them happy; or
- These are the women I love. Surely it is okay to make them feel happier and more at home by having places to worship their gods; or
- I married these women to make Israel secure. Maybe this is just what a king has to do; or
- I kind of enjoy these different forms of worship.

Ask the people playing Solomon's wives, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I feel relieved. I heard that Solomon was very devoted to his God, but maybe Solomon is not so devoted after all; or
- I feel grateful. Solomon has treated me well and has taken good care of me; or
- I feel happy that I can worship the gods of my ancestors and that I do not have to worship only Solomon's God; or
- It seems that Solomon has become more relaxed in his old age.

Continue the drama.

Solomon worshipped Ashtoreth, the goddess of the Sidonians, and Milcom, the abomination of the Ammonites. Solomon did what was evil and did not live the good and faithful life that Yahweh wanted, like Solomon's father, David, had done. On the hill that is east of Jerusalem, Solomon built a place for his wives to worship Chemosh, the abomination of Moab. Solomon also built a place for his wives to worship Molech, the abomination of the Ammonites. Solomon did this for all his foreign wives, who burned incense and made sacrifices to their gods.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I built an altar for this wife's gods, so I guess it is only fair to build altars for these other wives' gods; or
- I brought peace and security through these marriage alliances. I think it is wise to keep my wives happy; or
- I feel anxious about what my legacy will be. I built the temple for Yahweh, but now there are so many altars to other gods in Israel; or
- I know Yahweh said not to worship other gods, but I love this wife so much, and I do not want to disappoint her.

Ask the people playing Solomon's wives, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I feel honored! Solomon is the wisest king in the world, and Solomon built an altar for my gods. I must go there often to show Solomon how much I appreciate it; or
- When I see King Solomon worshipping my gods, my heart fills with pride; or
- I hear that Yahweh told Solomon to worship Yahweh only. I wonder if this is going to cause a problem? or
- These ignorant Israelites call my gods detestable. I hope they will learn from the example that their king is setting

1 Kings 11:1–13

Continue the drama.

So Yahweh was very angry at Solomon, because Solomon's heart had turned away from Yahweh, even though Yahweh had appeared to Solomon twice. Yahweh had commanded Solomon about this very matter and told Solomon not to follow other gods. But Solomon did not obey what Yahweh commanded. Therefore, Yahweh said to Solomon, "Because you have done this, and you have not obeyed my covenant and my statutes, as I told you to, I promise that I will tear the kingdom away from you and give it to one of your servants. But I will not do this while you are alive, for the sake of your father David; I will tear the kingdom away from your son. But I will not tear the entire kingdom away from him. I will allow your son to rule over one tribe of Israel, in keeping with the promise that I made to your father David, and for the sake of Jerusalem, which I have chosen."

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very sad. Yahweh is right, I disobeyed Yahweh and did evil; or
- I regret that I ever married these women and followed their gods; or
- I feel so guilty. My son will lose most of the kingdom, and it is all my fault; or
- I should have known better. Yahweh appeared to me twice, but I did not listen to Yahweh, and I worshipped other gods.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very angry. I gave Solomon more than any other Israelite, yet Solomon did not listen to me and he worshipped detestable idols; or
- I am disappointed. I gave Solomon great wisdom, and yet Solomon allowed his wives to lead him astray; or
- I deeply desire for my people to know me, but Solomon has made that very difficult by making all these altars and worshipping his wives' gods; or
- Although Solomon failed, I will be faithful to my covenant and my promises. This is not the end.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

But **King** Solomon loved many foreign women, in addition to **Pharaoh**'s daughter—women from **Moab**, **Ammon**, **Edom**, **Sidon**, and **Hittite** women. For more information on king and Pharaoh, refer to the Master Glossary. Be sure to translate king, Pharaoh, Moab, Ammon, Edom, Sidon, and Hittite the same way you did in previous passages.

Solomon loved his wives even though they came from **nations** about whom **Yahweh** had said to the **Israelites**, "You must not marry them, or allow them to marry your people, because they will definitely persuade you to **worship** their **gods**." For more information on nations, Yahweh, Israelites, worship and gods, refer to the Master Glossary. Be sure to translate these words the same way you did in previous passages.

These were the kind of women that Solomon clung to in love.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the phrase "**clung to in love**." Pause this audio here.

Solomon had 700 royal wives and 300 concubines. A royal wife is a wife who comes from the family with the highest social status in the country. A concubine is a man's legal wife, but she is of lower status than a royal wife.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the terms "**royal wife**" and "**concubine**." If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Solomon's wives turned his heart away from Yahweh.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the statement "turned his **heart** away." If you use the word for heart in your translation, refer to the Master Glossary for more information about heart. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 11:1–13

As a result, when Solomon was old, Solomon's wives convinced him to worship other gods. Solomon's heart was not loyal to Yahweh his **God**, as the heart of his father David had been. Use the same word for God as you have used in previous passages, and refer to God in the Master Glossary for more information.

Solomon worshipped **Ashtoreth**, the goddess of the Sidonians and **Milcom**, the abomination of the Ammonites. We recommend that you translate the names Ashtoreth and Milcom so that they sound like the names that are in the Bible your local church uses. The storyteller called both Ashtoreth and Milcom an abomination. Abomination means something that is so filthy and disgusting that people want to stay very far away from it. If a person comes close to something that is an abomination, that person might also become filthy and disgusting. And then that person would have to face Yahweh's judgment.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the word "**abomination**." Pause this audio here.

Solomon did what is **evil** and did not live the good and faithful life that Yahweh wanted, as his father, David, had done. On the hill that is east of Jerusalem, Solomon built a **high place** for his wives to worship Chemosh, the abomination of Moab. You will remember that a high place is a special place where people can worship a god closer to where they live. People often built high places on hills or higher ground, but not always. Be sure to translate evil and high places the same way you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on evil. We recommend that you translate the names Chemosh and Molech so that they sound like the names that are in the Bible your local church uses.

Solomon did this for all his foreign wives, who **burned incense** and made **sacrifices** to their gods. Be sure to translate burned incense and sacrifices the same way you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on sacrifice.

> Therefore, Yahweh said to Solomon, "Because you have done this, and you have not obeyed my **covenant** and my **statutes**, as I told you to, I promise that I will tear the **kingdom** away from you and give it to one of your **servants**." Be sure to translate covenant, statutes, kingdom, and servant the same way you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on covenant, statutes, kingdom, and servant.
>
> Stop here and decide how you will translate the phrase "**tear** the kingdom away from you."

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 11:1–13

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (869 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (9.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 11:14–25

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 11:14–25 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:14–25 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:14–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, King Solomon disobeyed Yahweh and worshipped other gods. So Yahweh decided that after Solomon's death, Solomon's descendants would only reign over one tribe of Israel. In this story, we hear about two men who caused trouble for Solomon: Hadad the Edomite and Rezon of Zobah.

Most of Solomon's time as king was peaceful and secure. But toward the end of Solomon's life, Yahweh causes two men, Hadad and Rezon, to gain enough power to cause some trouble in Israel. In the first part of this story, the storyteller tells a story from the time when King David was still alive. David and his military commander, Joab, attacked the country of Edom and killed all the men, except for a small group of servants who escaped with Hadad. Hadad was just a child when this happened. Hadad was from the royal line of Edom, which means that one of Hadad's relatives was the king of Edom. This group of servants took Hadad from Edom to a region called Midian, then to the region of Paran, and then to Egypt.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel, Edom, Midian, and Egypt. Note the location of Edom, Midian, Paran, and Egypt. Pause this audio here.

In Egypt, Pharaoh decided to be friends with Hadad and take care of him. Pharaoh gave Hadad and Hadad's father's servants a place to live and food to eat.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your country, how do people treat the royal family or the leaders of neighboring countries? For what reasons might your leaders show kindness and friendship to the leaders of other countries and their families? Pause this audio here.

When Hadad grew up, he married the sister of Pharaoh's wife. Hadad and his wife had a child named Genubath, and Genubath grew up in Pharaoh's household. Hadad and his family seemed to have a good life in Egypt. But sometime after David and Joab both died, Hadad decided to go back to Edom. The storyteller does not mention

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what Hadad does after he comes back to Edom. The storyteller only says that the things Hadad does are evil. It is possible that the storyteller assumed that his audience already knew about the things that Hadad did, and the storyteller only needed to remind his audience about those things.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Name someone that everyone you know thinks is a bad person. It could be a historical figure, a political leader, a military leader, or someone in the community. Why does everyone think this person is a bad person? When you hear this person's name, how do you feel? Pause this audio here.

Edom was southeast of Israel. The next part of the story is about Rezon, who was from Zobah, a city north of Israel. Together, these two men were able to make trouble for Solomon on opposite sides of his kingdom.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of Israel, Edom, and Zobah. Pause this audio here.

Next, the storyteller tells another story from the time when King David was still alive. The storyteller does this to explain where Rezon of Zobah came from. Rezon served Hadadezer, king of Zobah. While King David was alive, David fought and defeated Hadadezer. At some point in time, Rezon left his master Hadadezer. Then Rezon became the leader of a group of men. Rezon and this group of men traveled around the area north of Israel. The men attacked other people and stole people's property.

Eventually, Rezon and his group of followers went to Damascus, a city in the country of Aram, and Rezon became the king there. When you listened to three different versions of this story, you might have heard the storyteller call this area "Aram," or you might have heard the storyteller call this area "Syria." "Aram" was the name that the Israelites called this area. "Syria" is the modern-day name of the same region.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and Aram that shows the location of Damascus. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller calls Rezon an adversary, or enemy, of Israel. This probably means that Rezon did things like attack Israelite towns, hurt Israelite people, and steal things from the Israelites.

Hadad and Rezon both caused trouble for Israel while Solomon was king. In other stories, the storyteller describes Solomon's reign as peaceful and prosperous. Therefore, it is likely that these problems happened near the end of Solomon's life, after Solomon began to worship foreign gods instead of only worshipping Yahweh.

Stop here and tell a story about a time when one group of people attacked another group of people. Why did the first group attack the second group? What happened to the people in the second group, especially the children in that group? After the conflict was over, what did the people in the second group think about the people who attacked them? As they grew up, what did the children in the second group think about the people who attacked them?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:14–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us that after King David attacked Edom, Hadad the Edomite escaped and went to live in Egypt. When Hadad grew up, he married the sister of the Queen of Egypt and had a son.

In the second scene: Hadad hears that King David and Joab are dead and decides to go back to Edom.

In the third scene: Rezon, the son of Eliada, was the leader of a band of thieves, and then he became the king of Aram. Rezon hates the Israelites and constantly causes trouble for them. Hadad the Edomite also causes trouble for Israel.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King Solomon
- Joab, the commander of David's army

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- King David
- The men of Edom
- Hadad the Edomite
- Servants of Hadad's father
- Men of Paran
- Pharaoh
- Queen Tahpenes
- Hadad's wife
- Genubath, son of Hadad
- Rezon, son of Eliada
- Hadadezer, king of Zobah
- Rezon's followers
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Yahweh raises up an adversary against Solomon. This statement makes it clear that Yahweh was in control of these events and caused Hadad to become Solomon's adversary. "Adversary" is another word for enemy. An adversary means someone who opposes another person. An adversary might try to harm another person or stop that person from doing what he or she wants to do.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Think about the kind of person in your culture who opposes another person, tries to harm that person, or tries to stop that person from doing what he wants to do. How do you describe this kind of person? What kind of words do you use for this kind of person? Pause this audio here.

To tell Hadad's story, the storyteller must talk about things that happened before Solomon became king of Israel. The storyteller reminds us that many years before Solomon became king, King David's army fought against the army of Edom and won. After that, David's army commander, Joab, stayed in Edom and killed almost every man in Edom. Joab stayed in Edom for six months. When you listened to three different translations, you might have heard some of them say, "Joab and all of Israel stayed there six months." This means that Joab and the Israelite army stayed in Edom for six months. It does not mean that every single Israelite went to Edom. Joab and the army killed all the men in Edom, and they also buried the Israelite soldiers who died in battle.

The Israelites' custom was to bury the body of a person who had died. Usually, the Israelites buried dead bodies in caves in the hillsides, instead of putting them in a hole in the ground.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, what do you do with a person's body after that person dies? What do your people think about burying someone's body in a tomb or in the ground? Pause this audio here.

Hadad and his father's servants were the only men who escaped from David's army. The word "servants" could mean that these men worked in Hadad's father's household, or it could mean that these men were government officials. First, Hadad and his father's servants went to Midian, which is south of Edom. Then they went to a region called Paran. This route actually took them closer to Israelite territory, but they had to go that way in order to get around the Red Sea and go toward Egypt.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel, Midian, Edom, Paran, and Egypt. Pause this audio here.

In Paran, some other men joined this group, and then the entire group went to Egypt. Hadad was a young boy when all this happened. The phrase in the original language is not very specific, but it suggests that Hadad was probably around seven or eight years old.

When Hadad arrived in Egypt, Pharaoh gave Hadad and his helpers a place to live, their own land, and food. It is possible that Pharaoh was kind to Hadad because Hadad was from the royal family of Edom. When the storyteller says that Hadad found great favor with Pharaoh, it means that Pharaoh liked Hadad and was willing to help him.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your language, how do you say that a leader likes another person and does good things for that person? How will you talk about the fact that Pharaoh liked Hadad and gave Hadad good things? Pause this audio here.

When Hadad was old enough to get married, he married the sister of Pharaoh's wife. This made Hadad a member of Pharaoh's family. The storyteller says that Pharaoh gave Hadad the sister of his wife in marriage. This was a common way to say that Pharaoh arranged the marriage between Hadad and the Queen's sister.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, do men and women choose their own spouse, or does someone else choose for them? If someone else chooses for them, how do you talk about this situation? Pause this audio here.

It was a great honor for Hadad to marry the sister of Pharaoh's wife. Hadad's wife gave birth to a son named Genubath. Genubath grew up in the household of Pharaoh, which means that he spent a lot of time with Pharaoh's family members.

In scene two, the storyteller talks about what happened at the time that King David and Joab both died. The storyteller says that King David rested with his fathers. This was a common way to say that King David died. Hadad was still living in Egypt, but when he heard that David and Joab were dead, Hadad wanted to go back to Edom. Hadad asked Pharaoh for permission to leave Egypt and go back to his childhood home.

Pharaoh asked Hadad, "What do you lack here with me, that you want to go back to your own country?" Pharaoh might mean that he had given Hadad everything Hadad needed to have a good life in Egypt. Or, Pharaoh might really want to know what he could give Hadad to make Hadad stay in Egypt. Either way, it seems that Pharaoh liked Hadad and did not want Hadad to leave.

Here, it is acceptable to translate this statement as a regular question or as a question that does not expect an answer.

Stop here and decide if you will translate this as a question that does not expect an answer, or if you will translate it as a regular question. Pause this audio here.

Hadad told Pharaoh that Hadad lacked nothing. This means that Hadad had everything he wanted. But Hadad asked Pharaoh to let Hadad go back to his home country anyway. The storyteller does not tell us the rest of the story. Because the storyteller calls Hadad "an adversary of Solomon," and later in this story the storyteller says that Hadad did evil against Israel, Hadad probably did go back to Edom. From there, Hadad was able to make trouble for Solomon.

In scene three, God raised up another enemy against Solomon. The man's name was Rezon, son of Eliada. Rezon's lord was King Hadadezer of Zobah. At some point in time, Rezon ran away from his lord, Hadadezer. The city of Zobah was located north of Israel.

Stop here and look again at a map that shows Israel and Zobah. Pause this audio here.

If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, then you have already translated the story in which King David defeats King Hadadezer. It might be helpful to listen to that story to remember how you translated the names Hadadezer, Zobah, and Damascus.

Stop here and listen to the beginning of 2 Samuel chapter 8, when King David defeats Hadadezer. Pay close attention to how you translated the names Hadadezer, Zobah, and Damascus. Pause this audio here.

After David's army defeated Hadadezer's army, Rezon escaped. The storyteller does not tell us where Rezon went. The storyteller does say that Rezon gathered men to himself. This means that Rezon convinced men to join his group, and Rezon was the leader of the group. You might have heard the storyteller describe this group with many different words. This group traveled around and attacked people, stole things, and they might have even attacked King David's army.

Stop here and discuss this question: In the area where you live, what do you call a group of people that travels around to attack people and steal things? Which of these words or phrases could you use here? Pause this audio here.

When you listened to three different versions of this story, you might have heard the storyteller use different words or phrases to say that Rezon hated Israel very much. In the original language, this word also means that Rezon did not want Solomon to be the king over Zobah anymore. Instead, Rezon wanted to fight against Solomon and not obey Solomon.

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Stop here and discuss these questions: How do you say in your language that someone “hates someone very much”? How could you say that they hate a leader so much that they fight against the leader? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:14–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King Solomon
- Joab, the commander of David’s army
- King David
- The men of Edom
- Hadad the Edomite
- Servants of Hadad’s father
- Men of Paran
- Pharaoh
- Queen Tahpenes
- Hadad’s wife
- Genubath, son of Hadad
- Rezon, son of Eliada
- Hadadezer, king of Zobah
- Rezon’s followers
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

So Yahweh caused Hadad, a member of the royal family of Edom, to become an enemy of Solomon. Long before this, when King David defeated the army of Edom, Joab, the commander of his army, stayed in Edom to bury the dead Israelite soldiers. Joab and the Israelite army remained in Edom for six months. During that time, they killed every male in Edom except for Hadad and some of his father’s servants, who escaped to Egypt. This happened when Hadad was a young boy. Hadad and his father’s servants left Midian and went to Paran, where some other men joined them. Then they all went to Egypt.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hadad, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

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- I feel scared. My family is dead, I cannot go home, and I do not know what is going to happen to me; or
- I feel sad. I will never see my mother or father again, and I do not know if I will ever see my homeland again; or
- I hate David and Joab. David and Joab killed my entire family.

Ask the people playing the servants of Hadad's father, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We feel very sad. Our king is dead, many of our people are dead, and our homeland belongs to the Israelites. What will happen to us? or
- I am so angry that the Israelites did this to us. Our people are related. They should not treat us this way! or
- Perhaps if we can save Hadad, then our people might be able to survive; or
- If we can make it to Egypt, maybe we will be safe there.

Continue the drama.

Hadad and his father's servants went to Pharaoh, the king of Egypt, who gave them some land and a house and provided them with food. Hadad found great favor with Pharaoh. When Hadad grew up, Pharaoh arranged for Hadad to marry the sister of Queen Tahpenes, the sister of Pharaoh's own wife. Hadad's wife gave birth to a son, Genubath, and he grew up in the palace along with the sons of Pharaoh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hadad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am relieved. I finally have a safe place to live; or
- I am very grateful to Pharaoh, because he spared my life and took care of me and my men; or
- I love my wife and my son, but I wish they could see what my country was like before the Israelites destroyed it; or
- If I ever get a chance to get revenge on the Israelites, I will take it!

Ask the person playing Pharaoh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that Hadad is now a member of my family; or
- It was a good idea to treat Hadad well. Now Hadad owes me and will do whatever I ask; or
- I hope that the Israelites are not angry that I protected Hadad.

Continue the drama.

When Hadad heard that King David and Joab were both dead, Hadad said to Pharaoh, "Let me go back to my own country."

"Why?" Pharaoh asked Hadad. "What do you lack here in Egypt, that you suddenly want to go back home?"

"Nothing," Hadad answered. "But please let me go anyway." So Hadad went back to his homeland.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hadad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am grateful to Pharaoh, but Pharaoh must understand that I miss my own country; or
- I love my family, but I feel sad that my son has never seen my homeland; or
- This is my chance to get revenge. If I cannot get revenge against David, I will get revenge against his son; or
- It is dangerous to go back to Edom, but it means so much to me, so I will take the risk.

Ask the person playing the Pharaoh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I like Hadad. I do not want Hadad to leave. I might never see Hadad again; or
- I am confused. I gave Hadad a good life and even brought him into my own family. Why does Hadad want to go back to a destroyed country? or
- Why would Hadad take his wife and son away from a good life here and take them back to Israelite territory? or
- I understand Hadad's desire to return to his homeland. I would never want to live outside of Egypt, my homeland.

Continue the drama.

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God also caused Rezon, son of Eliada, to become an enemy of Solomon. Rezon had run away from his lord, Hadadezer, king of Zobah, and had become the leader of a gang of rebels. After David killed all the men in Hadadezer's army, Rezon and his men escaped to Damascus, and Rezon became king. Rezon was an enemy of Israel for the rest of Solomon's life, in addition to the evil that Hadad did. And Rezon hated Israel and continued to reign in Aram.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Rezon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hate the Israelites. King David killed my king and stole my homeland. I will never forgive the Israelites for that; or
- I feel proud that I was able to survive when King Hadadezer did not. Now I am the one with the power; or
- I will never let the Israelites go unchallenged. I will make sure they remember me as the one who fought back.

Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am afraid. Hadad and Rezon are causing problems. I am worried my enemies might take some of my land; or
- I am worried. If things are like this while I am still alive, what will it be like when my son becomes king? or
- I feel guilty. I know this is happening because I disobeyed Yahweh; or
- I once brought peace and prosperity to my people, but now they are paying for my sins.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:14–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

So **Yahweh** caused Hadad, a member of the royal family of Edom, to become an enemy of Solomon. The name Hadad means "loud noise" or "thunder." See the Master Glossary for more information on Yahweh.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the name **Hadad**. Will you translate the name according to what it means or according to the way it sounds? Pause this audio here.

Long before this, when **King David** defeated the army of Edom, Joab, the **commander** of David's army, was in Edom burying the dead soldiers. Joab and the **Israelite** army remained in Edom for six months. During that time, they killed every male in Edom except for Hadad and some of his father's **servants**, who escaped to Egypt. Be sure to translate king, David, commander, Israelite, and servant the same way you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on king, David, Israelite, and servant.

All this happened when Hadad was a young boy. Hadad and these men left Midian and went to Paran, where some other men joined them. Then they all went to Egypt. Be sure to translate the names **Edom**, **Egypt**, and **Midian** the same way that you did in previous passages.

Hadad and the men went to **Pharaoh**, the king of Egypt, who gave them some land and a house and provided them with food. Hadad found great favor with Pharaoh. When Hadad grew up, Pharaoh arranged for Hadad to marry the sister of **Queen** Tahpenes, the sister of Pharaoh's own wife. Tahpenes is an Egyptian name. Be sure to translate Pharaoh and queen the same way you did in previous stories. See the Master Glossary for more information about Pharaoh and "queen."

Hadad's wife gave birth to a son, Genubath, and he was raised in Pharaoh's **palace**, along with the sons of Pharaoh. The word "palace" means a king's house. Be sure to use the same word for palace, or king's house, that you used in previous stories.

God also caused Rezon, son of Eliada, to become an enemy of Solomon. Be sure to translate God the same way you have in previous passages. Note that this is the word for God and not the name Yahweh. See the Master Glossary for more information on God.

Rezon had run away from his lord, Hadadezer, king of **Zobah**, and had become the leader of a gang of rebels, a group of people who attacked other people and stole things from them. After David killed all the men in **Hadadezer**'s army, Rezon and his men escaped to **Damascus**, and Rezon became king. Be sure to translate

Hadadezer, Zobah, and Damascus the same way you did in 2 Samuel chapter 8. A lord is a master of someone who is lower status.

Stop here and decide as a group how you will translate "**master**" or "**lord**." Be sure to translate lord the same way you did in previous books of the Bible. See the Master Glossary for more information on lord. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the phrase "**gang of rebels**." Pause this audio here.

Rezon was an enemy of **Israel** for the rest of Solomon's life, in addition to the **evil** that Hadad did. And Rezon hated Israel and continued to rule in Aram, or Syria. Be sure to use the same word for Israel and evil that you used in previous stories. See the Master Glossary for more information about Israel and evil.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (861 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 11:26–43

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 11:26–43 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:26–43 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:26–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the storyteller told us about two men who caused problems during Solomon's reign: Hadad the Edomite and Rezon of Zobah. In this story, the prophet Ahijah goes to Jeroboam, son of Nebat, an Israelite from the tribe of Ephraim. Ahijah tells Jeroboam that after Solomon dies, Jeroboam will become the king over 10 tribes of Israel.

Remember that when King Solomon became old, he disobeyed Yahweh and worshipped other gods besides Yahweh. Because of this, Yahweh told Solomon that after Solomon died, Yahweh would divide the kingdom, and Solomon's son would only rule over one tribe. Yahweh chooses Jeroboam, son of Nebat, to be the king over the other 10 tribes. Jeroboam was from the tribe of Ephraim, from a town called Zeredah. The territory of Ephraim was in the center of Israel. Ephraim's territory had a lot of forests and good farmland. Zeredah was about 40 kilometers northwest of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel that shows the location of the territory of Ephraim, the town of Zeredah, and the location of Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam is a young man who works for Solomon. Jeroboam probably works on one of Solomon's construction projects, such as building the Millo or rebuilding the walls of Jerusalem. Remember, the Millo was a structure that Solomon built in Jerusalem, but no one is sure exactly what it was. The Millo might have been a terrace, a wall, or a landfill. Solomon sees that Jeroboam is strong and a very good worker. So Solomon gives Jeroboam a better job. Jeroboam becomes the boss of all the workers from his own tribe and also the workers from the tribe of Manasseh. The people of both these tribes were descendants of Joseph.

One day, Jeroboam has to go outside of Jerusalem. A man named Ahijah finds Jeroboam while Jeroboam is walking on the road, and when nobody else is around. Ahijah is a prophet whom Yahweh gave a special message to tell Jeroboam. Ahijah does not just tell Jeroboam the message, but also shows it in a way Jeroboam can see and remember. Ahijah is wearing a new cloak. A cloak is a piece of clothing that people wear over everyday clothing. A cloak is useful to keep a person warm when the weather is cold. A cloak can also help keep a person dry if it rains.

Stop here and look at a picture of a person wearing a cloak. Pause this audio here.

Ahijah takes off his cloak and tears it into 12 pieces. These pieces represent the 12 tribes of Israel. Then Ahijah tells Jeroboam to take 10 of the pieces of the cloak. Each piece represents one tribe of Israel.

Stop here and find a piece of cloth that will be easy to tear. Choose someone from the group to represent Ahijah. That person should tear the piece of cloth into 12 pieces. Then choose someone from the group to represent Jeroboam. The person who represents Ahijah should give the person who plays Jeroboam 10 pieces of cloth. Pause this audio here.

This action shows that Jeroboam will become the leader of 10 tribes. When Jeroboam holds the pieces, Jeroboam has a way to remember the promise Yahweh had made to him.

Some people might get confused because there are 12 tribes of Israel, and Solomon's son will rule over one tribe while Jeroboam will rule over 10 tribes. Ten plus one adds up to 11, which seems to leave one tribe out. But there is an easy explanation. Solomon was from the tribe of Judah, so people expected the tribe of Judah to follow

Solomon's son. So when Yahweh says that Solomon's son will rule over one tribe, it really means "your tribe plus one more tribe." Jerusalem is located in the territory that belongs to the tribe of Benjamin, so in order for Solomon's descendants to rule in Jerusalem, they also have to rule over the tribe of Benjamin.

Through the prophet Ahijah, Yahweh tells Jeroboam that some things will definitely happen. Yahweh also tells Jeroboam some things that will happen only if Jeroboam obeys Yahweh. Yahweh says that Jeroboam will definitely become the king of 10 tribes of Israel. Solomon is still king for now, but after Solomon dies, Solomon's son will only get to rule over one tribe of Israel. This was a punishment because Solomon had started to worship other gods.

Yahweh says that Solomon's son will get to rule over one tribe of Israel so that David will always have a lamp before Yahweh in Jerusalem. Yahweh uses creative language here to describe the descendants of David. The lamp represents the kings of Israel who are descended from King David. A lamp gives off light, and in the Bible, light represents hope and things that are good. As long as a descendant of David is the king of Israel, this means that Yahweh has kept his promises to David and the people of Israel. Therefore, the people can have hope.

Stop here and find a lamp, a flashlight, or a candle. If possible, have the entire team go inside a room or a closet that has no windows. Turn on the lamp or flashlight, or light the candle in the dark room. Then discuss these questions: In your culture, what does light symbolize? After you have finished this discussion, turn the light off or blow out the candle and discuss what darkness symbolizes in your culture. When you are done, turn the light back on and come out of the dark room. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells Jeroboam, "You will rule over all that your heart wants." This means that Jeroboam will rule over all of the territory that he wants. This is another one of the things that Yahweh tells Jeroboam will definitely happen.

But some of Yahweh's promises have conditions. Yahweh says if Jeroboam obeys Yahweh and does what is right, then Yahweh will always be with Jeroboam to help him. And if Jeroboam obeys Yahweh's commands, Jeroboam's descendants will be kings too and will rule over the 10 tribes.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who received a promise that had conditions. Did the person fulfill the conditions and get the promise? Or did the person fail to fulfill the conditions? Pause this audio here.

Solomon must hear about what Ahijah said to Jeroboam, because Solomon tries to kill Jeroboam. However, Solomon is not able to kill Jeroboam. Then Jeroboam goes to Egypt and stays there until Solomon dies.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and Egypt. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller finishes this story by telling us some final details about Solomon's life. Solomon ruled over Israel for 40 years. People wrote other books that talked about other things Solomon did. These books are lost now. The people bury Solomon in Jerusalem, the city of his father, David, and Solomon's son Rehoboam becomes the next king.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:26–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us that Jeroboam, son of Nebat, was a capable officer who served King Solomon.

In the second scene: Ahijah the prophet gives Jeroboam a message from Yahweh. Yahweh tells Jeroboam that Yahweh will make Jeroboam king of Israel.

In the third scene: King Solomon tries to kill Jeroboam, but Jeroboam escapes to Egypt. Then Solomon dies, and his son Rehoboam becomes king.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Jeroboam
- The labor force of the house of Joseph
- Ahijah, from Shiloh
- The Israelites
- Shishak, king of Egypt
- Rehoboam
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Jeroboam, son of Nebat, rebels against King Solomon. To rebel means to fight against a ruler or government because you do not want to follow their rules anymore. When you listened to three different versions of this story, you might have heard the storyteller say things like "Jeroboam raised a hand against the king" or "Jeroboam turned against King Solomon." These are different ways to say that Jeroboam rebelled against King Solomon.

Stop here and describe a situation where some people decided that they did not want to follow their ruler or leader anymore and began to oppose that leader. How do you describe what those people did? Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller tells us the story of Jeroboam to help explain how Jeroboam began to rebel against King Solomon. Jeroboam was part of the tribe of Ephraim, and Jeroboam came from the town of Zeredah. Jeroboam's mother was a widow named Zeruah. Jeroboam was a servant of Solomon. Remember that in the Bible, the word "servant" might mean a domestic servant, such as a person who gets paid to cook, clean, or work in the house, but "servant" can also mean a government official or any person who helps the king in some way. Most Bible scholars believe Jeroboam probably worked on one of Solomon's building projects, like the Millo. The Millo was a structure that Solomon built in Jerusalem, but Bible scholars are not sure what the Millo was. Some scholars think the Millo might have been supporting terraces, while others think it might have been a place where people filled in land. Earlier in 1 Kings, you translated a story in which the storyteller mentioned the Millo. You should translate this word here the same way you translated it there. If you need to go back and listen to that story again, listen to the middle part of 1 Kings chapter 9, where the storyteller talks about Solomon's building projects.

Stop here if necessary and listen to 1 Kings chapter 9 in your language. Pause this audio here.

Solomon also built a wall around Jerusalem. In those days, it was very common for people to build walls around large, important cities. Since Jerusalem was the capital city of Israel, Jerusalem was the most important city in Israel. When this story happened, either the wall of Jerusalem was not complete yet, or a part of the wall had broken down, and Solomon wanted his workers to fix it.

When you listened to three different versions of this story, you might have heard the storyteller describe Jeroboam with different words. The storyteller wants us to understand that Jeroboam was very strong and smart and did his work very well.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your language, how do you describe someone who is strong and smart and does their work well? Pause this audio here.

Solomon realized that Jeroboam worked hard until he got things done, and that when Jeroboam encountered a problem, Jeroboam came up with clever ways to fix that problem.

Stop here and discuss these questions: How do you describe a person who works hard until he gets things done, and who comes up with clever ways to fix a problem? Which of these words could you use to describe Jeroboam? Pause this audio here.

Because Jeroboam was such a good worker, Solomon made Jeroboam the leader of all the workers from the house of Joseph. "House of Joseph" means the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh. The people in these two tribes were descendants of Joseph, the son of Jacob. When you listened to three different versions of this story, you might have heard the storyteller say that Solomon forced these workers to work for him, like they were slaves. In

an earlier story, the storyteller said that King Solomon did not make any Israelites into slaves. So make sure that the word you choose for "forced labor" does not mean that these Israelites were slaves. A good choice might be to say that these Israelites were the people who worked hard for Solomon in building projects.

Stop here and discuss how you will say that these Israelites were the people who worked hard for Solomon in his building projects. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Jeroboam travels outside Jerusalem. The storyteller does not tell us where Jeroboam is going. While Jeroboam is on the road outside Jerusalem, Jeroboam encounters Ahijah, who is a prophet. Ahijah is a Shilonite, which means he is from the town of Shiloh. Shiloh is also in the territory of Ephraim, about 30 kilometers north of Jerusalem. When Jeroboam sees Ahijah, Ahijah is wearing a new cloak.

Stop here and look again at a picture of someone wearing a cloak. Pause this audio here.

Ahijah removes the cloak and tears it into 12 pieces. Then Ahijah tells Jeroboam to take 10 pieces. In this way, Jeroboam can see a picture of what Yahweh is about to do. Then Ahijah tells Jeroboam that Ahijah has a message for Jeroboam directly from Yahweh, the God of Israel.

Stop here and tell a story where one person speaks and quotes the words that another person said. How do you describe a situation where one person tells another person what a third person said? When you tell this story, how do you show who is saying the words? Pause this audio here.

In this message to Jeroboam, Yahweh says some similar things to what Yahweh said in the message Yahweh gave to Solomon earlier. It might be helpful for you to go back and listen to how you translated that message.

Stop here and listen to the beginning of 1 Kings chapter 11. Pay close attention to how you translated Yahweh's speech to Solomon. Pause this audio here.

First, Yahweh tells Jeroboam some things that will definitely happen. Yahweh begins this statement with a special word that means "Look" or "Pay close attention." This word means that what comes after is very important.

Stop here and discuss this question: What words or phrases does your language use to tell the listener that something very important is coming next? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh is about to tear the kingdom from the hand of Solomon and give 10 of the tribes to Jeroboam. This means that Yahweh will cause Jeroboam to become the new king over 10 tribes of Israel.

Yahweh tells Jeroboam that Solomon's descendants will continue to rule over one tribe of Israelites, because Yahweh had promised David that one of David's descendants would always rule as king in Jerusalem. Jeroboam was not a descendant of David, so Jeroboam could not rule as king in Jerusalem.

Next, Yahweh explains that Yahweh will tear the kingdom away from Solomon because Solomon worships the gods of other nations. Although Yahweh has been talking about Solomon worshipping other gods, Yahweh tells Jeroboam that "they" have turned away from Yahweh and worshipped other gods, and that "they" have not followed Yahweh's commands and statutes, or instructions. This means that Solomon led other Israelites to disobey Yahweh, too.

When you listened to three different versions of this story, you might have heard different ways to say that the people had intentionally stopped worshipping Yahweh and had started worshipping other gods. Yahweh says that the people had abandoned Yahweh completely.

Stop here and tell a story about a time when a leader did something wrong and bad things happened to them. What was the impact on that leader? What was the impact on the people around the leader? How much did the leader's actions affect the ordinary people? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh continues his message to Jeroboam and says, "They have not walked in my ways, they have not done what is right in my eyes, and they have not kept my statutes and ordinances." Yahweh actually says the same thing in three different ways. This shows that this matter was extremely important to Yahweh.

"They have not walked in my ways" means that the people have not lived the way that Yahweh wanted them to live. "They have not done what is right in my eyes" means that the people did not do the things that Yahweh

considered right. Instead, the people did things that Yahweh considered wrong. “They have not kept my statutes and ordinances” means that the people have disobeyed Yahweh’s rules.

Next, Yahweh says that Yahweh will not take the entire kingdom of Israel away from Solomon’s “hands,” or power. Yahweh also will not take the kingdom away from Solomon while Solomon is still alive. After Solomon dies, while Solomon’s son is king, Jeroboam will become king of 10 tribes of Israelites. Solomon’s son will be the king of just one tribe of Israelites. Yahweh will allow Solomon’s son to be king of one tribe because of the promise Yahweh made to David.

In this scene, Yahweh calls David “my servant” three times. In this case, “servant” simply means a person who does something for a person of higher status. Yahweh might also call David “my servant” to emphasize the fact that David almost always did exactly what Yahweh wanted David to do. David was not perfect, but David loved Yahweh and wanted to obey Yahweh all the time.

Yahweh says, “David will always have a lamp before me in Jerusalem.” The lamp is a symbol. The lamp stands for David’s family. The lamp means Yahweh will keep his promise that someone from David’s family would always be king in Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a photo of a lamp. Try to think of any sayings or poems in your language where one object represents another object. Tell each other some of these sayings or poems. Then decide how you want to translate the statement, “David will always have a lamp before me.” Pause this audio here.

Jerusalem is the place that Yahweh has chosen for “his name” to live among Yahweh’s people. In Israelite culture, Yahweh’s name often means Yahweh’s presence. Yahweh chose to send Yahweh’s presence to the temple in Jerusalem, which was the only place where the people of Israel could worship Yahweh.

Yahweh promises Jeroboam again that Jeroboam will sit on the throne of Israel. This means that Jeroboam will be king of the Israelites. And in addition, Yahweh says that Jeroboam will rule over all Jeroboam’s heart desires. Remember, the Israelites believed that all of a person’s feelings and desires come from the person’s heart. This statement means that Yahweh will allow Jeroboam to rule over all the territory that Jeroboam wants to rule over.

Stop here and discuss this question: What sayings do you have that mean a person will get everything he wants? Which of these could you use here? Pause this audio here.

The next part of Yahweh’s message to Jeroboam comes with a condition. This part of the promise will only happen if Jeroboam obeys Yahweh. Yahweh promises to establish Jeroboam’s house. This means that Jeroboam’s descendants will also be kings of Israel, but only if Jeroboam listens to Yahweh and does what is right in Yahweh’s eyes. This means that Jeroboam must obey everything Yahweh says.

At the end of Yahweh’s message, Yahweh says that he will do this to punish the descendants of David, but that the punishment will not last forever.

In the third scene, Solomon tries to have someone kill Jeroboam. Somehow, Solomon finds out about Ahijah’s message to Jeroboam, and Solomon does not like it. But Jeroboam arises and runs away to Egypt. This means that Jeroboam quickly leaves Israel. It does not mean that Jeroboam is lying down or sitting down when Jeroboam finds out that Solomon wants someone to kill Jeroboam. Jeroboam stays in Egypt until Solomon dies.

At the end of this scene, King Solomon dies. The storyteller uses specific words to give his hearers specific information about the time that Solomon ruled as king. First, the storyteller mentions that someone else wrote another book about King Solomon. This book was called the Book of the History of Solomon. The storyteller introduces this information using a question that does not expect an answer. This question means, “Someone wrote down everything that Solomon did and all his wisdom in the Book of the History of Solomon.” Nobody knows where this book is now.

At this time in Israel, people did not have books made of paper as we do now. People wrote important information on papyrus, parchment, or animal skins. Then the people rolled these items up into a scroll. Scrolls could easily become damaged, so the people kept scrolls in a safe place.

Stop here and look at a picture of a scroll. Pause this audio here.

Next, the storyteller says that Solomon ruled Israel from Jerusalem for 40 years. Then Solomon died, and the people buried Solomon in the City of David with his father. People sometimes call Jerusalem the "City of David." Finally, Solomon's son Rehoboam became the next king.

In the rest of the Book of Kings, whenever the storyteller ends his stories about a particular king, the storyteller will tell us the same information. The storyteller will name one or more books that contain stories about that king. Then the storyteller will say how long the king ruled and the name of the king's capital city. Then the storyteller will say that the king rested with his fathers, or died, and the storyteller will say where the people buried that king. Finally, the storyteller will say who became the next king.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:26–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Solomon
- Jeroboam
- The labor force of the house of Joseph
- Ahijah, from Shiloh
- The Israelites
- Shishak, king of Egypt
- Rehoboam
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Another man who rebelled against King Solomon was one of Solomon's officials, Jeroboam, son of Nebat. Jeroboam was from a town called Zeredah in Ephraim. Jeroboam's mother was a widow named Zeruah. This is the story of how Jeroboam rebelled against the king: Solomon built the Millo and repaired damage to the walls of Jerusalem, the city of his father, David. Jeroboam was a very capable man, and Solomon noticed that Jeroboam was a very hard worker. So Solomon made Jeroboam the official over all the labor force from the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh, the sons of Joseph. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am pleased with Jeroboam. Jeroboam is a very good worker; or
- With Jeroboam in charge, I do not need to worry about those workers from Ephraim and Manasseh; or
- I feel fortunate to have such a capable worker as Jeroboam to take care of Jerusalem.

Ask the person playing Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am grateful that King Solomon recognized my hard work and rewarded me; or

- I feel proud to be the boss, not just over other workers from the tribe of Ephraim, but from Manasseh too! or
- I have King Solomon's favor. If I work hard and act smart, I could become even more important!

Continue the drama. One day, when Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, the prophet Ahijah from Shiloh met Jeroboam on the road when no one else was around. Ahijah was wearing a new cloak. Then Ahijah took hold of the new cloak and tore it into 12 pieces. Ahijah said to Jeroboam, "Take 10 pieces for yourself. This is what Yahweh, the God of Israel, says to you: 'Watch, I am going to tear the kingdom away from Solomon, and I will give 10 tribes to you. But Solomon will continue to have one tribe for the sake of my servant David, and for the sake of Jerusalem, the city I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel. I am doing this because Solomon and the Israelites have turned away from me and worshipped Ashtoreth, the goddess of the Sidonians, Chemosh, the god of the Moabites, and Milcom, the god of the Ammonites. The Israelites have not followed my way, they have not done what is right in my eyes, and they have not obeyed my statutes and ordinances, as Solomon's father, David, did.'" Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am nervous. I do not know how to be a king! or
- I am afraid. If Solomon hears about this, he might try to hurt me; or
- I am surprised. I thought Solomon had been a very good king. The country is rich and powerful; or
- I feel proud because soon, 10 tribes of Israel will have to obey me!

Ask the person playing Ahijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel sad that Yahweh will split the kingdom in two. Our people will not be united anymore; or
- I am angry at Solomon. Solomon knew he should not worship foreign gods; or
- I do not want to deliver this sad message, but I must obey Yahweh.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very sad that Solomon disobeyed me and is worshipping other gods; or
- Solomon has led my people astray, and now they are worshipping false gods. I must act to show that people must not break my commandments; or
- Solomon must face consequences for his actions, but I will keep my promise to Solomon's father, David.

Continue the drama. Ahijah continued to tell Jeroboam what Yahweh said: "However, I will not take the entire kingdom away from Solomon. I made Solomon king for his entire life for the sake of my servant David. I chose David because he kept my commands and statutes. But I will tear the kingdom away from Solomon's son and make you ruler over 10 tribes. I will give one tribe to Solomon's son, so that the descendants of my servant David will continue to reign in Jerusalem. David's descendants will shine like a lamp in Jerusalem, which is the city I have chosen to be the place for my name. And I will put you on the throne of Israel, and you will rule over everything you want. If you listen to me, follow my rules, and do what I consider right, and if you obey my statutes and commands, like my servant David did, then I will always be with you. I will allow your descendants to rule over Israel forever, as I did for David. Because of Solomon's sin, I will punish the descendants of David, but the punishment will not last forever." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Ahijah said that Solomon will still be the king until Solomon dies. What am I supposed to do in the meantime? or
- I feel sad that Yahweh will soon divide my country; or
- I feel excited. I will reign over more people than Solomon's son will!

Ask the person playing Ahijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am nervous about what Solomon will do if he finds out about this message from Yahweh. Solomon could get angry and kill me; or
- I hope Jeroboam will be a good and wise king; or
- I am afraid of what is going to happen. This could be very bad for a lot of people.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that Solomon disobeyed me and now worships idols; or

- Even though Solomon sinned, his descendants are still from the royal line of David. They are still the ones I chose to rule in Jerusalem; or
- I am giving Jeroboam a chance to be a good king and receive many blessings.

Continue the drama. Solomon tried to have people kill Jeroboam, but Jeroboam ran away and went to Shishak, the pharaoh of Egypt. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so angry. I trusted Jeroboam and made him one of my top officials, but Jeroboam has betrayed me; or
- This is happening because of my sin. It is all my fault; or
- Maybe I can fix this. Maybe if someone kills Jeroboam, my son will keep the entire kingdom. How can I make that happen?

Ask the person playing Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is what I was afraid of. Solomon thinks I am a traitor. I have to escape! or
- I am grateful that Pharaoh Shishak has been kind to me. I will remember his kindness when I am king; or
- I feel eager to be the next king of Israel.

Continue the drama. And Jeroboam stayed in Egypt until Solomon died. The rest of the events of Solomon's reign as king, including all his deeds and his wisdom, are in the Book of the History of Solomon. King Solomon ruled in Jerusalem over all Israel for 40 years. Then Solomon died, and the people buried his body in the City of David, the city named for his father. And Solomon's son Rehoboam became the next king.

Ask the person playing Rehoboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am worried because my father told me that Yahweh will take the kingdom away from me; or
- I am angry that Yahweh chose Jeroboam to be king over Israel, and I will only rule over one tribe; or
- I feel sad. My father and grandfather built this wealthy, strong kingdom, but I am going to lose most of it!

Ask the person playing Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel relieved. Now that Solomon is dead, I can go back home; or
- I am happy. Now Yahweh will fulfill his promise, and I will be the king! or
- Yahweh chose me for a reason. I will be ready to lead the people when the time comes.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel sad about Solomon. I gave Solomon wisdom and riches, but he still chose to turn away from me and worship idols; or
- If Solomon had obeyed me, I could have given his son a strong kingdom. But now I am going to divide the kingdom and take it away from Rehoboam; or
- It makes me sad to divide the kingdom of Israel, but it is necessary to show the people that they must obey my commands.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 11:26–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Another man who rebelled against **King** Solomon was one of his officials, Jeroboam, son of Nebat. Jeroboam's mother was a widow, a woman whose husband had died. Be sure to use the same word for widow and king that you used in previous stories. See the Master Glossary for more information on king.

This is the story of how Jeroboam rebelled against the king: Solomon had built the **Millo** and repaired the damage to the walls of **Jerusalem**, the city of his father, David. Jeroboam was a very capable man, and Solomon noticed that Jeroboam was a very hard worker. So Solomon made Jeroboam the official over all the labor force from the tribes of **Ephraim** and **Manasseh**, the sons of **Joseph**. Be sure to translate Millo, Jerusalem, Ephraim, Manasseh, and Joseph the same way you did in previous passages.

1 Kings 11:26–43

One day, when Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, the **prophet** Ahijah from **Shiloh** met Jeroboam on the road when no one else was around. See the Master Glossary for more information on prophet and translate this word in the same way you have previously. Be sure to translate Shiloh the same way you did in 1 Kings 2:27.

Ahijah was wearing a new cloak. Then Ahijah took hold of the cloak and tore it into 12 pieces.

Stop here and look at a picture of a cloak. Decide as a group what word you will use for **cloak**. See cloak in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

Ahijah said to Jeroboam, "Take 10 pieces for yourself. This is what **Yahweh**, the **God** of **Israel**, says to you: Watch, I am going to tear the **kingdom** away from Solomon, and I will give 10 **tribes** to you." Be sure to translate Yahweh, God, Israel, kingdom, and tribe the same way you did in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on Yahweh, God, Israel, and kingdom.

Ahijah continued, "But Solomon will continue to have one tribe for the sake of my **servant** David, and for the sake of Jerusalem, the city I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel." When Yahweh says that David was Yahweh's servant, Yahweh does not mean that David was a domestic servant who cooked and cleaned. Yahweh means that David did what Yahweh wanted David to do. Be sure to use the same word for David, Jerusalem, and Israel that you used in previous stories. See the Master Glossary for more information on David, servant, Jerusalem, and Israel. Use the same word for servant as you have in previous stories when it means someone who does what Yahweh wants them to do.

Ahijah continued, "I am doing this because they have turned away from me and **worshipped** Ashtoreth, the **goddess** of the Sidonians, Chemosh, the **god** of the Moabites, and Milcom, the god of the Ammonites. They have not followed my ways, they have not done what is right in my eyes, and they have not obeyed my **statutes** and **ordinances**, as Solomon's father David did." Be sure to use the same words you used in previous stories for worship, god, female god or goddess, statutes, and ordinances. See the Master Glossary for more information on worship, god, statutes, and ordinances. Remember that when storytellers use words like "statutes and ordinances" together, they are talking about all of Yahweh's instructions or laws.

Ahijah continued to tell Jeroboam that Yahweh would not take the entire kingdom away from Solomon's "**hands**" or power. Use the same words for taking something out of someone's hands or power.

Yahweh said that he chose David because David kept Yahweh's **statutes** and **commands**.

See the Master Glossary for statutes and commands, and remember that you can also just say "Yahweh's instructions."

Yahweh wanted David's descendants to reign like a lamp shining in Jerusalem. In that time, lamps were bowl-shaped, and people filled them with oil. People put a wick, or a long string of cloth, in the oil and lit it.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **lamp**. Look at the photo of the lamp again if needed. Pause this audio here.

Ahijah continued, "And I will put you on the **throne** of Israel, and you will rule over everything your **heart** desires." Be sure to use the same word you used in previous stories for throne and heart. See the Master Glossary for more information on heart.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the phrase "**everything your heart desires**." Pause this audio here.

Yahweh promised to build a lasting house, or dynasty, for Jeroboam if Jeroboam followed Yahweh. In this case, Jeroboam's house refers to his descendants who would rule as king after him.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**house**" or dynasty. If you use the word for house, you may refer to the Master Glossary for household if needed. Pause this audio here.

Ahijah continued, "Because of Solomon's sin, I will punish the sons, or **descendants**, of David, but the punishment will not last forever." The storyteller calls the descendants of David "sons" in the original

language, but these sons refer to all of David's descendants. Use the same word or phrase you have used in previous passages, and refer to descendants in the Master Glossary if necessary.

Solomon tried to have Jeroboam killed, but Jeroboam ran away and went to Shishak, the **pharaoh** of **Egypt**. Be sure to use the same words that you used in previous stories for pharaoh and Egypt. See the Master Glossary for more information about pharaoh if needed.

Jeroboam stayed in Egypt until Solomon died. The rest of the events of Solomon's reign as king, including all Solomon's deeds and his **wisdom**, are in the Book of the History of Solomon. King Solomon ruled in Jerusalem over all Israel for 40 years. Then Solomon died and was buried in the City of David, the city named for his father. Be sure to use the same words for wisdom and "City of David" as you used in previous stories.

Stop here and look at a photo of a scroll again if needed. Decide as a group how you will talk about the title "The Book of the History of Solomon." For more information, refer to "scroll" in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 11:26–43

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (857 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (10.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 12:1–15

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 12:1–15 and put it in your hearts.

1 Kings 12:1–15

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:1–15 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, King Solomon died, and Solomon's son, Rehoboam, became the new king. Solomon's temple was in Jerusalem, the capital city of Israel, and Rehoboam also lived in Jerusalem. Now, the northern tribes of Israel gather in Shechem in the north of Israel to recognize Rehoboam as their new king. Jeroboam, who had led a rebellion against Solomon, now leads the northern tribes to ask Rehoboam to give them less work and make their lives easier. Rehoboam asks two different groups of advisers how he should answer the people of Israel, and Rehoboam decides to listen to the advice of his younger advisers instead of the advice of his older advisers.

King David and David's son, King Solomon, ruled over all of Israel. It is likely there were problems between the northern and southern tribes of Israel even before Rehoboam. But during the rule of King Rehoboam, the tribes of Israel divide into two parts: one in the north and one in the south. This passage is the start of a new section in the book of 1 Kings, and a new part of the history of the people of Israel as they lived with a divided kingdom. This passage is similar to 2 Chronicles 10:1–7 and 2 Chronicles 10:8–19. If you have already translated the two similar passages in 2 Chronicles, you should translate this passage the same way as the passages in 2 Chronicles in most places, except where there are some small differences in the passages.

Stop here and listen to your translations of 2 Chronicles 10:1–7 and 2 Chronicles 10:8–19 now, if your team has already translated these similar passages in 2 Chronicles. Pause this audio here.

As the story begins, Rehoboam goes to Shechem, which is an important religious city in the north of Israel in the land of the tribe of Ephraim. Shechem was the first religious center of the 12 tribes of Israel when the Israelites first came into the land of Canaan. The northern tribes of Israel had already gathered in Shechem to renew their loyalty to David's grandson, Rehoboam, as their new king. These tribes are: [Reuben, Simeon, Issachar, Zebulun, Dan, Naphtali, Gad, Asher, Ephraim, and Manasseh.]{.mark} However, some people think that because the northern tribes did not travel to Jerusalem to make Rehoboam their king, this shows that these tribes already planned to leave Rehoboam and make their own kingdom.

Stop here and look at a map that includes Shechem as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time your community, village, city, or nation chose a new leader. How did your community choose this leader? What did you like or dislike about the new leader? Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, is another important person in this passage. We know from a previous story that Jeroboam was from the tribe of Ephraim and that Jeroboam was a servant of King Solomon in the past. Yahweh had promised to give Jeroboam control of 10 of the tribes as a punishment because Solomon worshipped false gods. King Solomon tried to kill Jeroboam, so Jeroboam ran away to live in Egypt. Now, in this passage, Jeroboam hears the news that King Solomon has died and that Solomon's son, Rehoboam, is the new king in Israel. The storyteller gives background information that Jeroboam was living in exile in Egypt while King Solomon was still alive.

Stop here and look at a map that includes Egypt as a group. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 12:1–15

In the next part of the story, Jeroboam and the northern tribes of Israel ask Rehoboam to lighten their heavy load of work. The people say that Rehoboam's father, Solomon, put a heavy yoke on them, and they want Rehoboam to make their yoke, or burden, lighter. A yoke is a wooden bar that joins together the necks of two cows or oxen so they can work together. King Solomon forced the people to build Solomon's temple, his palace, and other buildings. It is likely that the people also had to pay heavy taxes to Solomon.

Stop here and look at a picture of a yoke as a group. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam and the people tell Rehoboam they will be loyal to Rehoboam if Rehoboam makes their lives easier. The people do not ask Rehoboam to take away their burdens completely, but to make their burdens less than their burdens were during the rule of Rehoboam's father, Solomon. It was common during Rehoboam's time for a new king to do what the people requested in exchange for their loyalty to him as their new king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about your previous discussion about a time when your community chose a new leader. Describe how your new leader was different from your previous leader. What did the new leader do or say to make the people like him? Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam tells Jeroboam and the people to leave for three days, probably so that Rehoboam can think about how to answer the people's request to lighten their heavy load of work. Rehoboam does not pray to Yahweh or talk to a prophet about what he should do. Instead, Rehoboam talks with two different groups of advisers during these three days. First, Rehoboam consults his older advisers who served his father, King Solomon. These older, experienced advisers tell Rehoboam to be a servant to the people today, and in the future, the people will always be Rehoboam's servants. A servant is someone who works for their master. In this passage, the advisers want Rehoboam to act like a servant to his people and speak kindly to the people in order to keep the loyalty of the northern tribes. Some people think the older advisers want Rehoboam to be kind to the people now, and then later, Rehoboam will be free to be harsh to the people.

Rehoboam does not listen to the advice of Rehoboam's older advisers, which is surprising because people in Israel respected the advice of older advisers. Instead, Rehoboam asks his younger advisers what they recommend Rehoboam should do. It is likely that Rehoboam already plans to follow the advice of the younger advisers before Rehoboam hears their answer. We know from a later passage that Rehoboam was 41 years old when he became king, and these younger advisers are the same age as Rehoboam. These young men grew up with Rehoboam, and they do not have the same years of experience and wisdom that Rehoboam's older advisers had.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Who do you talk to for advice in your community? Talk about a time when you asked a few different people for advice about the same situation. How was the advice different? How did you choose which advice to follow? Pause this audio here.

The younger advisers tell Rehoboam to be even harsher than Rehoboam's father, King Solomon. The younger advisers want Rehoboam to show the people that he is very strong and that Rehoboam's easiest demands will be worse than the hardest work Solomon made the people do. The younger advisers use a proverb, or saying, that Rehoboam's little finger is thicker than his father Solomon's loins, or waist. Some people think the little finger is a polite way to refer to the male sexual organ.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell some proverbs, or wise sayings, in your language. Practice explaining what each proverb means. Pause this audio here.

The younger advisers also say that Rehoboam should make the yoke even heavier for the people. The men say Solomon punished, or disciplined, the people with whips, which means Solomon was harsh on the people. A whip has a long handle, which people often make of wood, and a flexible cord that a punisher uses to hit a person.

Stop here and look at a picture of a whip as a group. Pause this audio here.

The advisers say that Rehoboam should punish the people with whips that sting like scorpions.

A scorpion is an insect in Israel that has a poisonous sting. This could mean that Rehoboam should punish the people more than Solomon. Or it could mean that Rehoboam will punish the people with whips that have pieces of sharp metal in them, which will cut into a person's body like the point of a scorpion's sting. If the tribes of Israel do not listen to King Rehoboam, then King Rehoboam will painfully punish the people.

1 Kings 12:1–15

Stop here and look at a picture of a scorpion and a picture of a whip with metal at the end of the cord. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam and the people come back to Rehoboam after three days, and King Rehoboam chooses to follow the advice of the younger advisers. King Rehoboam speaks harshly, or unkindly, with the people, and Rehoboam rejects the advice of the older advisers. This also shows that King Rehoboam rejects the wisdom of his father, King Solomon, whom people knew was very wise. If Rehoboam had listened to his people, Israel would have had an opportunity to remain one unified nation, but because King Rehoboam did not listen to his people, the nation of Israel later divided into two parts. Rehoboam adds to people's oppression. This is similar to what Pharaoh, the king of Egypt, did when Pharaoh made the Israelites work harder instead of making their burdens lighter.

In the final part of this story, the storyteller tells us that the events in this story are really from Yahweh. The reason Yahweh allowed these things to happen was because these things fulfilled the promise that Yahweh made through Ahijah the prophet in a previous passage. Remember that the prophet Ahijah was from Shiloh, and Ahijah had told Jeroboam that Yahweh would give Jeroboam 10 of the tribes of Israel. Remember that in the prophecy, Ahijah said this was a punishment on Solomon because Solomon stopped following Yahweh and followed the gods of the other nations around him.

We see that Rehoboam acted foolishly when he listened to bad advice, but the ultimate reason that the kingdom of Israel split is because Yahweh made it happen. Yahweh is in control of everything.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has seven scenes.

In the first scene: The northern tribes of Israel gather in the city of Shechem to make Rehoboam their new king.

In the second scene: The northern tribes of Israel send for Jeroboam to come back from his exile in Egypt. Jeroboam comes back to Israel.

In the third scene: Jeroboam and the people ask Rehoboam to lighten their load. Rehoboam tells the people to come back to Rehoboam in three days.

In the fourth scene: Rehoboam asks the older advisers for advice. The older advisers tell Rehoboam to answer the people with kind words.

In the fifth scene: Rehoboam rejects the advice of the older advisers. Instead, Rehoboam asks his younger advisers for advice. The younger advisers tell Rehoboam to be harsh to the people.

In the sixth scene: Jeroboam and the people come back to Rehoboam after three days. Rehoboam speaks harshly to the people. Rehoboam says he will be even harsher than his father Solomon was to them.

In the seventh scene: King Rehoboam does not listen to the people. Yahweh causes this to happen in order to fulfill the promise that Yahweh made to Jeroboam through the prophet Ahijah.

The characters in this passage are:

- Rehoboam
- The northern tribes of Israel
- Jeroboam, the son of Nebat
- Older advisers who served King Solomon in the past
- Younger advisers who are Rehoboam's age
- Yahweh
- And the prophet Ahijah, the Shilonite

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

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Remember that before this passage, King Solomon died, and now King Solomon's son, Rehoboam, is the new king of Israel. This passage is the start of a new section in the book of 1 Kings. In this passage, and in the following passages, we will see that because of King Rehoboam's choices, Israel divides into a northern kingdom and a southern kingdom. Remember that this passage is similar to 2 Chronicles 10:1–7 and 2 Chronicles 10:8–19, and it is best to translate this passage similarly to these passages in 2 Chronicles.

In the first scene, the northern tribes of Israel gather in Shechem, a city in the north of Israel. Shechem is 65 kilometers north of Jerusalem, between Mount Ebal and Mount Gerizim. Shechem is in the land of the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh. Rehoboam also goes to Shechem because the northern tribes want to recognize Rehoboam as their new king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the most natural order to translate this scene of the passage?

- All Israel gathered in Shechem to make Rehoboam their king, so then Rehoboam went to Shechem too; or
- Rehoboam went to Shechem because all Israel had gathered in Shechem to make Rehoboam their king.

Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Jeroboam hears the news that King Solomon died and that Rehoboam is the new king of Israel. Remember that the storyteller gives background information that Jeroboam was living in exile in Egypt because King Solomon tried to kill Jeroboam while King Solomon was still alive.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story that includes some background information about one of the characters. Pay attention to how you introduce the background information about the character. How will you translate this background information about Jeroboam? It might be better to say first that Jeroboam fled to Egypt, and then later Jeroboam heard the news. Pause this audio here.

It is hard to know when Jeroboam comes to Shechem. In the original language, it might mean that when Jeroboam hears the news, Jeroboam remains in Egypt, or it might mean that when Jeroboam hears the news, Jeroboam returns to Shechem from Egypt. Or it might mean that Jeroboam had been living in Egypt in exile since he came there to escape King Solomon. In a similar passage in 2 Chronicles, the storyteller says that Jeroboam returns from Egypt. Now, the northern tribes send someone to Egypt to tell Jeroboam to come back home to Israel, which Jeroboam does.

Remember that it is not clear if Jeroboam at first remains in Egypt after he hears the news or if Jeroboam immediately returns from Egypt after he hears the news.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the passage? Remember that in the similar passage in 2 Chronicles, the storyteller says that Jeroboam returns from Egypt. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam returns from Egypt to Israel. Remember that it may be that some people go to Egypt to get Jeroboam, or that Jeroboam has already come back to Israel. Most translations do not say that Jeroboam comes back to Israel, but we know from the next scene that Jeroboam is in Shechem now. In any case, the Israelites have asked Jeroboam to come with them to talk to King Rehoboam.

In the third scene, Jeroboam and the people of Israel talk to King Rehoboam. Jeroboam and the people remind Rehoboam that Solomon, Rehoboam's father, gave the people a heavy yoke of work. Remember that people put a yoke on two animals to help the animals work together. During the time of Rehoboam, people used a yoke as special language to talk about heavy burdens of work. Remember also that the people do not have a physical yoke on their necks. Solomon gave the people a lot of work, and Solomon made the people pay a lot of taxes to Solomon.

Stop here and look at a picture of a yoke again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about hard work in your culture. How will you translate this part of the passage about the heavy yoke of work that King Solomon put on the people of Israel? It is probably best to translate this in the same way that you did in the 2 Chronicles passage. Pause this audio here.

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Now, the people want Rehoboam to lessen their harsh labor and heavy yoke of work. Some people think that "harsh labor" and "heavy yoke" are two ways to say the same thing about the hard work that Solomon forced the people to do. Other people think the heavy yoke means the heavy taxes that the king made the people pay, in addition to the harsh labor. The people say that if Rehoboam lessens their work, the people will serve Rehoboam as their king. The people want Rehoboam to be a different kind of king than Solomon was.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate "harsh labor" and "heavy yoke" in this passage? Also, how will you show the contrast between the hard work that Solomon made the people do in the past and the lighter load of work that the people want Rehoboam to give to them now? A few translation examples are:

- Now, if you lighten the demands he made and do not make us work as hard, we will serve you; or
- Lighten the harsh labor demands and heavy taxes that your father imposed on us. Then we will be your loyal subjects; or
- But if you make our work easier, we will serve you and do whatever you ask.

Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam tells Jeroboam and the people to leave for three days. Rehoboam probably wants three days to think about how to answer the request of the people. The people agree and leave for three days. It may be more natural to translate this part of the scene with the exact words that Rehoboam said to the people, or with a description of what Rehoboam said to the people. Some translation examples include: "Rehoboam told the people, 'Go away for three days and then come back,'" or "Rehoboam told the people to come back in three days to hear his answer."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story that includes some talking between the characters. Do you say the exact words that the characters say to each other, or do you tell a description of what the characters said? What is the best way to translate this part of the passage where Rehoboam tells the people to come back in three days? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth and fifth scenes, Rehoboam asks two different groups for advice about how to answer the request of the people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about someone who asked a group of people for advice. Pay attention to how you talk about asking for advice. How will you translate this part of the passage where Rehoboam asks two groups of people for advice? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, Rehoboam talks with the older advisers who were alive during the time of Solomon. In the original language, it says these advisers stood before Solomon, which means they gave Solomon advice about what to do. Other ways to translate "older advisers" could be "elders" or "older men who advised Solomon." Rehoboam asks the older advisers, "How do you advise me to answer these people?" Again, it may be better to translate this as a description of what Rehoboam said: "Rehoboam asks the older advisers how they think Rehoboam should respond to the people."

The older advisers tell Rehoboam that Rehoboam should serve the people and that Rehoboam should speak good words to the people. The older advisers want Rehoboam to be kind to the people and lessen their harsh load of work. The older advisers say that if Rehoboam is kind to the people, then the people will always serve Rehoboam.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about a time when you or someone you know gave conditions to someone else in order to get the person to do something. For example, a father might tell his child that if his child helps with the father's work, the father will give the child a gift. What is the best way to translate this part of the passage about the way that the older advisers tell Rehoboam that Rehoboam must act so that the people will always serve Rehoboam? Some translation choices include:

- If you are a servant to the people today, and if you give the people a good answer, then the people will always serve you; or
- Serve the people and give the people a good answer today. Then the people will always serve you.

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Is it best to include the exact words that the older advisers told Rehoboam to say, or to say, “The older advisers told Rehoboam that he should help the people and give the people a good answer, and then the people will serve Rehoboam.” Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, Rehoboam rejects, or refuses, the advice of the older advisers. Instead, Rehoboam asks the younger advisers what to do. In the original language, the storyteller calls these younger advisers “young boys” or “children” because these advisers are inexperienced. But these younger advisers are actually grown men like Rehoboam. It may be more natural in your language if you include the information about what the people asked Rehoboam to do before Rehoboam asks the younger advisers for advice.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show the contrast between the advice of the older advisers and what Rehoboam decides to do? Would it be better in your language to translate the words that Rehoboam asked the younger advisers or a description of what Rehoboam said to the younger advisers? What should Rehoboam say first and last? Here are some translation examples:

- Rehoboam asked the younger advisers, “What is your advice? What should we tell these people?” The people say, “Lighten the load that your father, King Solomon, gave to us!” or
- Rehoboam asked the younger advisers to give Rehoboam advice about how to answer the people. Rehoboam told the younger advisers that the people had complained about the work that King Solomon had given the people. The people wanted Rehoboam to give them less work; or
- Rehoboam said to the younger advisers, “The people asked me to lighten the load of work that my father put on them. What answer do you advise me to give to the people?”

Pause this audio here.

The younger advisers repeat what the people said to Rehoboam. Again, you can include the exact words that the people said to Rehoboam, or a description of the words. It might be good to do the same thing here that you did earlier when Rehoboam asked the younger advisers for advice.

The younger advisers tell Rehoboam a proverb, or wise saying, to show that Rehoboam should act even harsher than Rehoboam’s father, Solomon. The younger advisers say that Rehoboam’s little finger is thicker than his father Solomon’s “loins” or waist. Remember that the proverb means that the easiest work that Rehoboam requires will be worse than the hardest things that Solomon required. Some people think that “little finger” means the male sexual organ.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this proverb? It might be best to translate the meaning of the proverb, as in: “I will be much harsher than my father was!” Pause this audio here.

The younger advisers give two different examples of how Rehoboam will be harsher than his father, Solomon. The advisers say that Solomon gave a heavy yoke of work to the people. Rehoboam should make the yoke even heavier for the people. The men also say that Solomon punished the people with ordinary whips, but Rehoboam should punish the people with whips that sting like scorpions. Remember, this probably means that Rehoboam will punish the people even more than Solomon did. In each example, the younger advisers emphasize the difference between how Solomon acted in the past and how the younger advisers think Rehoboam should act now.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the passage to show the contrast between the work that Solomon gave to the people and the work that Rehoboam will give to the people? Pause this audio here.

In the sixth scene, Jeroboam and the people come back to Rehoboam after three days. Remember that this is when Rehoboam told Jeroboam and the people to come back. Rehoboam speaks harshly to the people. Rehoboam rejects the advice of the older advisers and instead, Rehoboam follows the advice of the younger advisers. Rehoboam does not repeat the proverb again, but Rehoboam does repeat the two examples that the younger advisers gave to him about how Rehoboam will make life even harder for the people.

In the final scene, the storyteller gives more information about the real reason for all of the events in this passage. This comment from the storyteller is not a part of the main action of the story. Yahweh caused these things to happen, meaning Yahweh is the one controlling everything, including the unhappiness of the people of Israel and Rehoboam’s choice not to listen to the people. Remember that in a previous story, Yahweh spoke

1 Kings 12:1–15

through the prophet Ahijah to Jeroboam. Ahijah told Jeroboam that Yahweh would give 10 of the tribes of Israel to Jeroboam.

Now, in this passage, we see that Yahweh will fulfill the promise to Jeroboam because Rehoboam did not listen to the people of Israel. Remember that we will learn in later passages about how the tribes of Israel split into two kingdoms, with Rehoboam leading the southern kingdom and Jeroboam leading the northern kingdom.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story that includes a statement about why the event in the story happened. How will you translate the end of this passage to show how Yahweh fulfilled his "word," or did what he said he would do? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has seven scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Rehoboam
- All the people of Israel
- Jeroboam, the son of Nebat
- Older advisers who served King Solomon in the past
- Younger advisers who are Rehoboam's age
- Yahweh
- And the prophet Ahijah, the Shilonite

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The people of Israel traveled to Shechem to make Rehoboam their king. So, Rehoboam went to Shechem too.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are not sure if we can trust Rehoboam as our new king. We need to talk with Rehoboam before we decide to make him our king; or
- It is our duty to follow Rehoboam as our new king. Rehoboam's father, Solomon, was our king before, and now we must follow his son, Rehoboam; or
- We hope that Rehoboam will be kinder to us than his father, Solomon, was.

Continue the drama.

In the past, King Solomon tried to kill Jeroboam, so Jeroboam fled to live in Egypt. Jeroboam has been living in exile in Egypt since then. Now, Jeroboam hears the news that Rehoboam is the new king of Israel. The people of Israel ask Jeroboam to help them. At some point, Jeroboam comes back to Israel.

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Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to finally come back to my home in Israel; or
- I was afraid that Solomon would kill me, but now it is safe for me to come home because I am not afraid of this new king, Rehoboam; or
- I wonder why the people of Israel want me to come back to Israel now. Could this be part of the prophecy that the prophet Ahijah made about me?

Continue the drama.

Jeroboam and the people of Israel talk to King Rehoboam. The people say, “Your father, King Solomon, made us work very hard. But if you make our work easier, we will serve you and do whatever you ask.” Rehoboam tells the people to come back in three days to hear Rehoboam’s answer to their request. So, the people leave for three days.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We think that our request is reasonable for King Rehoboam to lessen our heavy work. We are not asking Rehoboam to take away our work, but to lessen it; or
- We hope that Rehoboam listens to our request because we cannot keep working this hard and paying this many taxes as we did for his father, King Solomon; or
- This is our chance to finally get the king to listen to us! We will be loyal to this new king if he gives us something in return; or
- We are hopeful that the king will think carefully about our request during these three days.

Also, ask the person playing Rehoboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Why are these people coming to talk to me like this? The people should make me king and then let me go back home to Jerusalem. The people should be grateful that I traveled here to Shechem to see them; or
- I need to be careful how I answer the people because I want their loyalty and support. I know that the people worked very hard for my father, King Solomon, but I also enjoy the life that I have as king in Jerusalem, and I do not want the people to stop working or paying taxes to me; or
- I am not sure what to do yet, so I will take a few days to think about my answer and ask some advisers for advice about what to do.

Continue the drama.

King Rehoboam talks with the older advisers who served his father, King Solomon, when King Solomon was alive. Rehoboam asks the older advisers, “What answer do you think I should give to the people?” The older advisers tell Rehoboam, “If you are a servant for the people today, and if you give the people a good answer, then the people will always serve you.”

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the older advisers, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We think that Rehoboam should say anything he can to make the people happy, so the people will support Rehoboam as their new king. It does not matter if Rehoboam plans to keep his promises to the people or not. In the future, Rehoboam can be harsher with the people, but today, Rehoboam should speak kindly to the people; or
- We think it is important to carefully listen to the people and speak kindly to the people. Rehoboam needs the support of the northern tribes of Israel. Rehoboam should not do anything now that would make these people of Israel mad at Rehoboam. Otherwise, the people may not support Rehoboam as their new king; or
- We are honored that the new king came to ask us for advice first. We have the most experience, and we know how to handle the requests of the different tribes of Israel.

Continue the drama.

But Rehoboam rejects the advice of the older advisers. Instead, Rehoboam asks the younger advisers what to do. These younger advisers also served Rehoboam, and they were the same age as Rehoboam. Rehoboam asks

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the younger advisers, “What should I answer the people who asked me to give them less work than my father gave to them?”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Rehoboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I do not want the people to think I am weak. If I follow the advice of the older advisers, people will say I am weaker than my father, King Solomon; or
- I prefer to see what the advisers of my own age think about this situation. I trust the people my own age more than the older advisers that my father had; or
- The people of Israel seem to complain a lot. I do not think that my father made the people work very hard; or
- I hope that my younger advisers give me better advice than the older advisers gave me. I think I will follow the advice of the younger advisers, even before I know what their advice is.

Continue the drama.

The younger advisers tell Rehoboam that Rehoboam should reject the request of the people. The people complained that Rehoboam’s father, Solomon, made them work very hard. The people wanted Rehoboam to give them less work. The younger advisers say that Rehoboam should be even harsher than Solomon was. The younger advisers say that Rehoboam should tell the people, “My little finger is thicker than my father’s waist!” The younger advisers also think Rehoboam should make the people’s work even harder. Solomon punished the people with ordinary whips, but Rehoboam should punish the people with whips that sting like scorpions!

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the younger advisers, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- Rehoboam should listen to our advice because Rehoboam knows us, and we know him. We have the best ideas for how Rehoboam can be a strong king of Israel; or
- We think it would be a bad idea to follow the advice of the older advisers. Those old men do not know the new way of doing things. Rehoboam will show them what a real king looks like, one who is even tougher than King Solomon was; or
- These people of Israel need to know that they cannot come and talk to King Rehoboam like this. These people should respect the new king and not ask him for things. Rehoboam will be even stronger and harsher than his father was!

Continue the drama.

Jeroboam and the people come back to Rehoboam on the third day. This is just as King Rehoboam told them to do. Rehoboam talks harshly to the people. Rehoboam rejects the advice of the older advisers and instead, Rehoboam follows the advice of the younger advisers. Rehoboam tells the people, “My father made you work hard, but I will make you work even harder! My father punished you with ordinary whips, but I will punish you with whips that sting like scorpions!”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Rehoboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I like the advice of my younger advisers better than the advice of my older advisers. I am the king, so I can decide what I want to do; or
- I am ready to be an even harsher and more demanding king than my father was! or
- These people need to respect me. They should never have asked me to lessen their heavy load of work, because now they will need to work even harder.

Also, ask the people playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are very disappointed that Rehoboam did not listen to us; or
- We are shocked that Rehoboam plans to be even harsher than his father was; or
- We do not plan to serve Rehoboam as our king now. We gave Rehoboam a chance to be kind to us in return for our loyalty. Rehoboam did not take the chance, and now we know that we are not welcome in the kingdom of Rehoboam. We must start to make other plans with Jeroboam as our leader.

Continue the drama.

Rehoboam refused to listen to the people of Israel. Yahweh caused this to happen in order to fulfill the promise that Ahijah the Shilonite spoke to Jeroboam, the son of Nebat.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel who are listening to this story generations after it happened, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We wish that Rehoboam had chosen to listen to the people of Israel. Maybe then there would never have been a divided kingdom of Israel; or
- We trust that Yahweh's ways are always good, even though we do not understand why Yahweh makes things happen; or
- We remember the promise that Ahijah the Shilonite made to Jeroboam in a previous story, and now we see that Yahweh keeps the promises he makes.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Rehoboam became the new king of the Israelites in the previous passage. David was the first king of Israel, and David's son, Solomon, was the second king of Israel. Rehoboam is Solomon's son. We will learn in a later passage that Rehoboam was the son of an Ammonite woman whose name was Naamah. We also know that Rehoboam's father, Solomon, wrote many proverbs to teach his sons about wisdom. In this passage, we learn that Rehoboam does not follow the wisdom of his father, Solomon.

In this passage, "**Israel**" and "Israelites" refer to the northern tribes of Israel. These northern tribes of Israel come together in an **assembly** to talk to King Rehoboam at Shechem in the north of Israel. An assembly is when people gather together for a specific purpose. Translate assembly in the same way as you did in previous passages. Shechem later becomes the first capital of the northern kingdom of Israel. Translate Israel and Israelites the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Israel and Israelites, refer to Israel and Israelites in the Master Glossary.

Jeroboam returns from his exile in **Egypt**. Egypt is the land where the Israelites lived in slavery for 400 years before Yahweh delivered them during the time of Moses and Aaron. Jeroboam was in Egypt because, in the past, **King** Solomon tried to kill Jeroboam. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory. Translate Egypt and king the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

The people of Israel ask King Rehoboam to lighten their heavy yoke of work that King Solomon gave to them. A yoke is a wooden collar with two openings that people use to tie two oxen or two other animals together. In the Bible, sometimes a yoke means slavery or hard work.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate **yoke** in this passage? Remember your discussion from step three about how to translate this part of the passage. Will you use the word yoke here, or translate it as heavy work, harsh demands, or something else? Pause this audio here.

King Rehoboam first asks the elders, or the older advisers, for advice on how to answer the people. Elders are people with authority in the community who are usually leaders of their families. These elders gave advice or wisdom to King Solomon while Solomon was alive.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate **elders** in this passage? You may want to translate elders the same as in previous passages, but these elders may have a more specific job to advise the king. For more information on elders, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The older advisers tell King Rehoboam that if Rehoboam is a **servant** to the people today, then the people will always be the king's servants in the future. A servant is someone who does work for their master. In this case, the advisors are telling the king to serve, or please, his people. Translate servant the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Rehoboam also asks the young men Rehoboam grew up with for advice. Other ways to translate this could be younger advisers, young advisers, or younger officials.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate **young men** in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam says that he will punish the people with whips that sting like scorpions.

Stop here and look at a photo of a whip that has metal at the end of the cord and a photo of a scorpion. What words or phrases will you use for whips and scorpions? Pause this audio here.

The events in this passage were from **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the personal name for God. Translate Yahweh the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh caused these events to happen in order to fulfill the **word** that Yahweh spoke to Jeroboam through Ahijah the Shilonite. The word that Yahweh spoke to Jeroboam was a promise from Yahweh. Translate "word" the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on word, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 12:1–15

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (862 KB)
- Setting the Stage (8.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (13.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (7.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Kings 12:16–24

1 Kings 12:16–24

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 12:16–24 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:16–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the northern tribes of Israel asked King Rehoboam to lessen their heavy load of work. King Rehoboam refused to listen to the people's request. Instead, King Rehoboam said he would make the people work even harder. Now, we hear how the people react. The people rebel against King Rehoboam and make Jeroboam their new king instead. King Rehoboam plans to fight against the people.

Remember that 2 Chronicles 10:8–19 and 2 Chronicles 11:1–12 are very similar passages to this passage.

Stop here and listen to your translations of 2 Chronicles 10:8–19 and 2 Chronicles 11:1–12,

if you have already translated those passages. Pause this audio here.

As the story begins, the northern tribes of Israel realize that Rehoboam will not listen to their request to lessen their heavy load of work. The people tell King Rehoboam that the people have no place in the kingdom of David now. In the original translation, the people ask King Rehoboam, "What part do we have in David, and what part do we have in the son of Jesse?" The people do not want Rehoboam to answer their question. The people know that David was Rehoboam's grandfather, the son of Jesse, and a descendant of the tribe of Judah. David and David's family have nothing to do with the people in the north of Israel.

The northern tribes of Israel also say that they should all go home to their tents. A tent is a temporary home. Tents are another way to talk about home. The people want the descendants of David to take care of themselves and their own people, but the northern tribes of Israel do not want Rehoboam to rule over them anymore. The northern tribes no longer feel like they are a part of the people of Israel.

Stop here and look at a picture of a tent. Pause this audio here.

The northern Israelites go home. However, King Rehoboam still rules over those Israelites who were originally from the northern tribes but who now live in the cities and towns of Judah in the south of Israel. We know that Rehoboam also rules over all the other people in Judah as well.

Stop here and look as a group at a map that shows the kingdoms of Israel and Judah. Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam sends out Adoniram, the man who was in charge of forcing the people to build buildings for the kings of Israel. Rehoboam probably sends Adoniram because Rehoboam wants the people of Israel to know that Rehoboam will be harsh with the people and increase their heavy yoke of work. But the Israelites do not listen to Adoniram, and the people kill Adoniram by throwing stones at him. The people probably do this to show Rehoboam that the people do not respect Rehoboam as their king and will not do any more building projects for Rehoboam.

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Rehoboam quickly gets in his chariot and rides away to Jerusalem, the capital of Israel. This means that Rehoboam was in the northern part of Israel before this, and maybe Rehoboam went with Adoniram. A chariot is a two-wheeled cart that horses pull in battle, but sometimes kings rode on chariots, too.

Stop here and look at a picture of a chariot and a map that includes Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that "Israel," meaning the northern tribes of Israel, has been rebelling against the family of David since the time this story happened. The northern tribes of Israel refuse to let a descendant of David be their king. The storyteller told these stories long after the stories happened, so the people of Israel had been rebelling for a long time.

The people of the northern tribes of Israel hear that Jeroboam is back in Israel. Remember that Jeroboam is the person who used to be a servant to Rehoboam's father, King Solomon. Jeroboam has been in exile in Egypt because King Solomon tried to kill Jeroboam. Now, the people ask Jeroboam to come meet with them. At their meeting, the people make Jeroboam the king over all of northern Israel. Only the tribe of Judah remains loyal to Rehoboam, the descendant of David. We know from a previous passage that the prophet Ahijah said that Jeroboam would be the leader of 10 of the tribes of Israel. The smaller tribe of Benjamin later becomes part of the tribe of Judah, so this is likely why the storyteller says here that only the tribe of Judah remains loyal to David's family.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about two rival leaders in your village, city, or country. How did each of the two leaders try to make people like them better than the other leader? Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam arrives in Jerusalem, the capital city of Israel. Remember that Rehoboam ran away on his chariot earlier in this passage. Rehoboam is ready for a war against the rebellious northern tribes of Israel who refuse to recognize Rehoboam as their king. Rehoboam chooses 180,000 fighting men from the tribes of Judah and Benjamin to go with him to the north. King Rehoboam wants to reunite the divided kingdom, with Rehoboam as the king over all of the tribes of Israel. We know that the tribe of Benjamin later becomes part of the tribe of Judah, and that is probably why the storyteller said earlier that only the tribe of Judah is loyal to Rehoboam, even though here we see that the tribe of Benjamin is willing to fight for Rehoboam.

But Shemaiah, the man of God, hears a word from God. God tells Shemaiah to give a message to Rehoboam and to the people of Judah and Benjamin, and to the rest of the people. The rest of the people might mean the people from the northern tribes who live in Judah. The message says that Rehoboam and the people of the southern kingdom of Judah should not fight against their brothers or relatives, the other Israelites. Instead, Yahweh tells the people to go home because Yahweh caused this thing to happen. You will remember that in an earlier story, the prophet Ahijah had said that Yahweh would take away 10 of the tribes of Israel from Rehoboam.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when two people or groups of people wanted to fight each other, but someone else convinced the people or groups of people not to fight each other. How did the person convince the other people not to fight? Pause this audio here.

The people listen to the words of Yahweh that Shemaiah, the man of God, tells them. The people all go back to their homes, just as Yahweh ordered them to do.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has six scenes.

In the first scene: The people say that they have no place in the kingdom of David now. The people go home to their tents. Rehoboam still rules over the people from the northern tribes of Israel who now live in the land of the tribe of Judah.

In the second scene: Rehoboam sends Adoniram, the man in charge of forcing the people to build buildings. The people kill Adoniram with stones. Rehoboam escapes and flees in his chariot to Jerusalem.

In the third scene: The storyteller reminds us that at the time he tells this story, the northern tribes of Israel are still rebelling against the family of David.

In the fourth scene: The Israelites have an assembly, and they make Jeroboam their new king. Only the tribe of Judah remains loyal to Rehoboam, the descendant of David.

In the fifth scene: Rehoboam chooses 180,000 fighting men from the tribes of Judah and Benjamin. Rehoboam prepares for war against the northern tribes of Israel.

In the sixth scene: Yahweh sends a message to Shemaiah, the man of God, to tell Rehoboam and the people of Judah and Benjamin that they must not fight against the other Israelites. All of the people go home, and they do not fight against the other Israelites.

The characters in this passage are:

- The people of the northern tribes of Israel who live in the north of Israel
- King Rehoboam
- People from the northern tribes of Israel who live in the cities of Judah
- Adoniram
- Jeroboam
- Tribe of Judah
- Tribe of Benjamin
- 180,000 fighting men from the tribes of Judah and Benjamin
- Shemaiah, the man of God
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in the previous passage, King Rehoboam refused to listen to the people's request to lessen their heavy load of work. Remember also that this passage is very similar to the passages in 2 Chronicles 10:8–19 and 2 Chronicles 11:1–12.

Stop here and listen again to your translation of these similar passages if you have already translated those passages. Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, the northern tribes of Israel tell Rehoboam that they have no place in the kingdom of David. The people ask, "What part do we have in David, and what part do we have in the son of Jesse?" Remember that the people do not want Rehoboam to answer this question, but they want to show Rehoboam that they are not a part of David's family, so Rehoboam cannot rule over them.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Would it be best to translate this as a question or as a statement? Another way to translate this part of the passage is, "We have nothing to do with King David, and we have nothing to do with this grandson of Jesse." It is probably best to translate this in the same way that you did in the 2 Chronicles passage. Pause this audio here.

The people of Israel also say they should go back to their tents, which means their homes. Then, the people go home. Remember that the northern tribes of Israel do not accept a descendant of David as their king, but Rehoboam does rule over some of the people from the northern tribes who live in the land of the tribe of Judah in the south of Israel.

Stop here and look again as a group at a map that includes Judah, if needed. How will you talk about the tents that people want to go back to? Remember that this does not necessarily mean that the people lived in temporary cloth shelters. "Tents" was a way to say "their homes." Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Rehoboam sends Adoniram to the people. Remember that Adoniram was in charge of forcing people to build buildings for Israel. Adoniram supervises the workers who work hard for King Solomon. The people of Israel kill Adoniram by throwing stones at Adoniram. Rehoboam escapes and quickly rides away on his chariot to Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show that Rehoboam escapes quickly on his chariot? Other ways to translate this part of the passage could be:

- King Rehoboam quickly climbs into his chariot and rides away to Jerusalem.
- King Rehoboam jumps into his chariot. Then, King Rehoboam quickly drives to safety in Jerusalem.

Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller says that the northern tribes of Israel have been in rebellion against the house, or family, of David from that time until now. This information from the storyteller is not in the main action of the story. We know that events in this passage are very important for the rest of the story of the divided kingdom of Israel because this passage is when the kingdom of Israel splits into two kingdoms.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story that includes some background information from the storyteller that is not in the main action of the story. How will you include this background information in this passage? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the northern tribes of Israel hear that Jeroboam is back in Israel. Remember that Jeroboam had been in Egypt in exile. It may be helpful to include in your translation that Jeroboam returns to Israel from Egypt. The northern tribes of Israel send someone to bring Jeroboam to an “assembly” or meeting. The people make Jeroboam their new king over all of northern Israel. Some people think this part is hard to understand because it seems like Jeroboam is meeting the people for the first time. But in the last story, the storyteller said that Jeroboam and the people asked Rehoboam to make their hard work easier. Maybe Jeroboam only talked to some of the people before, and now Jeroboam is meeting with all of the people.

Remember that “Israel” means the northern tribes of Israel. Remember that this meeting happens in the north of Israel, where the northern tribes live, and the land of the tribe of Judah is in the south of Israel. The tribe of Judah is the only tribe that remains loyal to the family of David. Remember that Rehoboam is a descendant of King David.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and the land of the tribe of Judah. Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, Rehoboam arrives in Jerusalem. Rehoboam gathers together all the men of the tribes of Judah and Benjamin. In the original language, “gathers together” means that Rehoboam calls together the men to fight. Rehoboam chooses 180,000 fighting men to make war against the northern tribes.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate “fighting men” in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam wants to fight against the northern tribes of Israel to take back the northern land for his own kingdom. Remember that the kingdom of Israel was united under King Solomon, Rehoboam’s father, but now there are two separate kingdoms. King Rehoboam is the king of Judah in the south, and King Jeroboam is the king of Israel in the north. Remember that now “Israel” means the northern tribes of Israel, and not the united kingdom of Israel.

The sixth scene begins with a strong contrast between King Rehoboam’s plans to reunite the kingdom of Israel and Yahweh’s plans to divide the kingdom of Israel. Yahweh sends a message to a prophet to tell King Rehoboam not to attack the northern kingdom.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show the contrast between Rehoboam’s plans and the message that Yahweh sent to the prophet, Shemaiah? Pause this audio here.

In the sixth scene, Shemaiah, the man of God, hears a word from God. In other words, God speaks to Shemaiah, the man of God. First, the storyteller says who Shemaiah should tell the message to. Yahweh tells Shemaiah to deliver this message to Rehoboam, to the people of Judah and Benjamin, and to all the other people. Then, the storyteller says the message that Shemaiah should say. Shemaiah says, “This is what Yahweh says to do. Do not go fight against your brothers, the Israelites. Go home, all of you, because I caused all of this to happen.” You can translate brothers as “relatives” or “your own people.”

In the final part of this passage, the people of the northern tribes of Israel listen to the message from Yahweh that Shemaiah tells them. The people all obey Yahweh and return to their homes.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

1 Kings 12:16–24

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has six scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The people of the northern tribes of Israel who live in the north of Israel
- King Rehoboam
- People from the northern tribes of Israel who live in the cities of Judah
- Adoniram
- Jeroboam
- Tribe of Judah
- Tribe of Benjamin
- 180,000 fighting men from the tribes of Judah and Benjamin
- Shemaiah, the man of God
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The people from the northern tribes of Israel see that King Rehoboam will not listen to them and will not make their work easier. The people tell the king, “We have nothing to do with King David, and we have nothing to do with this grandson of Jesse. We should all go home to our tents. David’s descendant, Rehoboam, can take care of David’s family.” So the northern tribes of Israel go to their homes. But Rehoboam still rules over the Israelites from the northern tribes who now live in the land of the tribe of Judah.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the northern tribes of Israel who live in the north of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are frustrated that Rehoboam refused to listen to us. We were not asking for too much. Rehoboam should have listened to us! or
- Now, Rehoboam will see that he is not our king, and we will not follow him. Rehoboam can take care of his own people, and we are not a part of those people; or
- Rehoboam will regret his choice not to make our work easier. Rehoboam will see that we have a plan to get a new king.

Also, ask the people playing the northern tribes of Israel who live in the cities of Judah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We do not like Rehoboam, but we live here in the cities of Judah, so he is our king; or
- We have homes and families here in Judah, so it would be difficult to move back to the north of Israel, where we are from; or
- We wish that we lived in the north of Israel, so we did not have to follow Rehoboam as our king. Rehoboam did not listen to our people in the north, and we are angry.

Also, ask the person playing Rehoboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- These northern tribes are a problem. These people need to learn to listen to me; or
- I am happy that at least everyone left and went back to their homes. Maybe they are ready to do the hard work for me; or
- I am worried that the northern tribes think I am not their king. Maybe I should have listened to the advice of the older advisers and agreed to make the people’s work easier?

Continue the drama.

King Rehoboam sends Adoniram to the people. Adoniram is the manager of the laborers. The people kill Adoniram by throwing stones at Adoniram. King Rehoboam quickly climbs into his chariot and flees to Jerusalem. Israel has been rebelling against the family of David ever since this story happened.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the northern tribes of Israel who live in the north of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We killed Adoniram to show Rehoboam that we refuse to do any more work for Rehoboam! or
- We are ready to go to war against Rehoboam because we refuse to follow Rehoboam as our king; or
- We are happy that Rehoboam is afraid of us now. Rehoboam had a chance to listen to our requests, but Rehoboam did not listen to us.

Also, ask the person playing Rehoboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am afraid that the people will kill me in the same way that they just killed Adoniram. I hope that the people do not catch me on my way back to Jerusalem; or
- I am shocked that the people killed Adoniram! The people should be afraid of me and be willing to build buildings for me, their king; or
- I need to gather some warriors to fight these terrible people in the north! These people will be sorry for killing Adoniram and for not respecting me as their king!

Continue the drama.

The northern tribes of Israel hear that Jeroboam is back in Israel. The northern tribes of Israel invite Jeroboam to a meeting of the people of Israel. The people of Israel make Jeroboam the king of Israel. The only tribe that is loyal to the family of David is the tribe of Judah.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to be the new king for the people of Israel; or
- This is happening just like the prophet Ahijah told me it would happen; or
- My kingdom has many more people than Rehoboam’s kingdom. Rehoboam should have listened to our request to make our work easier.

Also, ask the person playing Rehoboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I cannot believe that the people want to have Jeroboam as their king and not me; or
- I am glad that at least the tribe of Judah is still loyal to me as their king; or
- Now I am angry, and I will punish the northern tribes of Israel for their betrayal.

Continue the drama.

Rehoboam arrives in Jerusalem. Rehoboam gathers together all the men of Judah and Benjamin. Rehoboam chooses 180,000 fighting men to go to war with him against the northern tribes of Israel. Rehoboam, the son of Solomon, wants to restore the kingdom to himself so that Rehoboam will rule over all the tribes of Israel again.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the 180,000 fighting men, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are ready to fight for the true king of Israel, King Rehoboam; or
- We are angry at the northern tribes of Israel because they are rebelling against King Rehoboam; or

1 Kings 12:16–24

- We are glad that we are loyal to King Rehoboam, the son of King Solomon, who was the son of King David. We hope that King Rehoboam wins the fight against the northern tribes of Israel.

Continue the drama.

Shemaiah, a man of God, hears a message from God. God says to Shemaiah, "Tell this to Rehoboam, the son of Solomon, the king of Judah. Say this also to all the people of Judah and Benjamin, and to all the other men there. This is what Yahweh says to do: 'Do not go fight against your brothers, the Israelites. Go home, all of you, because I caused all of this to happen.'" The people obey the words of Yahweh. The people return to their homes as Yahweh told them to do.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Rehoboam and the men of the tribes of Judah and Benjamin, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are surprised that Yahweh told us to go home and not to fight to restore the kingdom of Israel; or
- We are confused about why Yahweh wants us not to fight against Jeroboam, but we are ready to obey Yahweh's commands; or
- We do not understand why Yahweh said that Yahweh caused these things to happen.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Israel** and **Israelites** refer to the northern tribes of Israel. Translate Israel and Israelites the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Israel and Israelites, refer to Israel and Israelites in the Master Glossary.

The people of the northern tribes of Israel realize that **King** Rehoboam will not listen to them. Translate king the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

The people of Israel say that they have nothing to do with David, the son of Jesse. The people also say that David should take care of his own house. David was the first king of Israel. The **house of David** means the descendants of David and the dynasty of kings that descend from David. Translate "house of David" the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on "house of David," refer to the Master Glossary.

Rehoboam rules over the people from the northern tribes of Israel who now live in the cities of **Judah**. A **city** is a settlement of people with a wall around it. Judah is one of the tribes of Israel, and people often called the two tribes in the south that still followed Rehoboam as their king "Judah." Translate city and Judah the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Judah, refer to the Master Glossary.

Rehoboam escaped in his **chariot** to **Jerusalem**. A chariot is a two-wheeled cart that horses pull. Jerusalem is the capital city of Israel, and now the capital city of the land of Judah, where Rehoboam is the king. Translate chariot and Jerusalem the same as you have in previous passages.

The people of northern Israel called Jeroboam to an **assembly**, or a special gathering of people that made decisions. Translate "assembly" the same as you have in previous passages.

Rehoboam calls together the whole **house**, or family, of the tribes of Judah and **Benjamin**. Benjamin was another tribe of Israel. Translate Benjamin the same as you have in previous passages. A "house" in this case means the descendants or family line of a person. The "house of Judah" is the descendants and tribe of Judah. Translate house in the same way you have before, when it means the descendants of someone. Refer to household in the Master Glossary for more information.

Rehoboam gathers together 180,000 fighting men to fight against the northern tribes of Israel. Rehoboam wants to reunite the divided **kingdom**. A "kingdom" is the territory or the people that a king rules. Translate kingdom the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on kingdom, refer to the Master Glossary.

The man of God, Shemaiah, hears a word of God to give to Rehoboam and the people. In the Old Testament, sometimes God spoke through his prophets, or people who received messages from God. In this passage, the storyteller calls the person who receives a message from God a "man of God."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate "**word of God**" and "**man of God**" in this passage? Check how you translated this in the 2 Chronicles 11:1–12 passage. Remember that in the 2 Chronicles passage, the storyteller says "word of Yahweh" instead of "word of God," but they mean the same thing. For more information on "word of God," refer to "word" in the Master Glossary. For more information on "man of God," refer to "prophet" in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Shemaiah says to Rehoboam and the people that **Yahweh** does not want the people to attack their brothers, the other Israelites. Yahweh is the personal name of God. Translate Yahweh the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 12:16–24

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (897 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (7.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Kings 12:25–33

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 12:25–33 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:25–33 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the people of the northern tribes of Israel chose Jeroboam as their new king of the northern kingdom of Israel. Now, Jeroboam strengthens Israel's military power when he builds up some cities in Israel to defend Israel from any enemies. Jeroboam also creates a new way to worship in Israel when he makes two places for people to worship in the kingdom of Israel: one place at Bethel in the south and one place at Dan in the north.

In the first part of the story, Jeroboam builds up the cities of Shechem and Peniel to protect his new kingdom from enemy attacks. Jeroboam makes the city of Shechem more secure, probably by building strong walls around the city. Remember that the northern tribes of Israel first made Jeroboam their king at Shechem. Jeroboam lives and rules from Shechem, his new capital city. Shechem is in the hill country of Ephraim, one of the 12 tribes of Israel. Hill country is a place with a lot of hills or raised areas of land.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map that includes the city of Shechem and the land of the tribe of Ephraim. Also, look at a picture of hill country as a group. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam also builds up the city of Peniel, a city on the east side of the Jordan River. It is possible that Jeroboam builds up Peniel in order to protect the area on the east side of the Jordan River from the enemies in that area.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the city of Peniel as a group. Pause this audio here.

In the second part of the story, Jeroboam decides that he should make an easier, more convenient way for the people to worship Yahweh. In the law of Moses, Yahweh said the people must travel to Jerusalem three times a year to offer sacrifices at the temple, or "house," of Yahweh. Jeroboam worries that if the people keep going to Jerusalem to worship Yahweh, the people will become loyal again to their former lord, or master, King Rehoboam of Judah. Remember that King Rehoboam is from the house, or family, of David. Jeroboam also worries that the people will kill Jeroboam. Jeroboam wants to protect his new kingdom.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when you had a new leader in your village, town, city, community, or country. What new plans or practices did your new leader start? Why do you think your new leader started these new practices? Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam asks for advice, probably from wise men who helped Jeroboam make important decisions. Then, Jeroboam makes two golden calves. A calf is a young, male bull or ox. A bull represented strength and fertility. Many people in the region made images of bulls to represent their gods.

Stop here and look at a picture of a golden calf as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you saw someone worshipping an idol. What did the people who worshipped the idol do? What did the idol look like? How did people make the idol? Pause this audio here.

People have different opinions about the purpose of the golden calves. Some people think that Jeroboam wants the people of Israel to worship the golden calves as their new gods instead of worshipping Yahweh. People who worshipped other gods had idols to help them visualize and worship those gods, and it was unusual that the Israelites had no idols to worship. Other people believe that Jeroboam still wants the people of Israel to worship

Yahweh, but closer to their homes, so they will remain loyal to Jeroboam. These people think that the two golden calves in Bethel and Dan might be like a footstool for Yahweh to stand on. Maybe Jeroboam wants Yahweh to leave the resting place of the ark of the covenant in the temple of Yahweh in Jerusalem to come to Bethel and Dan for a new resting place.

Jeroboam tells the people of the northern tribes of Israel that it is too difficult for them to travel to Jerusalem to worship. Jeroboam gives the people the two golden calves and says that these are the gods who brought the Israelites out of Egypt. You will remember that the Israelites were slaves in Egypt for 400 years. After Yahweh brought the Israelites out of Egypt, Aaron made a golden calf for the Israelites. Jeroboam even says the same thing that Aaron told the people: “These are the gods that brought you out of Egypt!”

Stop here and look at a map of Egypt and Israel as a group. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam puts one golden calf in Bethel, and Jeroboam puts the other golden calf in Dan. Bethel and Dan are both cities in the northern kingdom of Israel. Jeroboam wants the people of the northern kingdom of Israel to go to Bethel or Dan to worship instead of traveling all the way to Jerusalem to worship Yahweh in his temple, or house. Jeroboam does not trust Yahweh to keep Jeroboam in power as the king. You will remember that Yahweh promised Jeroboam a lasting kingdom if Jeroboam followed Yahweh.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Bethel, Dan, and Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

You will remember that the people of Israel sinned against Yahweh when they worshiped the golden calf that Aaron made in the past. Now, in this passage, the people also sin against Yahweh when they worship the golden calves that Jeroboam makes. We do not know exactly why Jeroboam makes the golden calves, but we do know that the golden calves cause the Israelites to sin. Sin means that the people disobey Yahweh because Yahweh said the people of Israel should not worship any idols.

Jeroboam also builds houses of worship on high places, which probably means Jeroboam builds walls around the altars on the high places. High places are often on hills. Yahweh’s presence was not in these houses on high places because Yahweh’s presence was only in the temple in Jerusalem. Jeroboam also chooses priests to serve in these houses of worship. Jeroboam chooses priests from all sorts of people, and not from the Levites. Levites are from the tribe of Levi, and in the law of Moses, Yahweh said that only Levites could be priests for Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Where do people in your community go to worship your god or gods? Describe the place or the building where you go to worship. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe the leaders in your place of worship. How do you choose these leaders? Think about what would happen if a different person started leading your religious meetings in your community, and not the person or people that your community normally chooses. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam also changes the day for the “festival” or feast. In the law of Moses, Yahweh said that the Israelites should celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles on the fifteenth day of the seventh month, but Jeroboam changes the festival to the fifteenth day of the eighth month. This festival is one of three festivals the Israelites celebrate each year. During the Festival of Tabernacles, the Israelites live in temporary shelters in Jerusalem to remember the time when the Israelites wandered in the desert after they left Egypt. The Festival of Tabernacles is during the time of the harvest in Israel. Some people think that the harvest happens a month later in the northern part of Israel than in the southern part of Israel, and these people think that is the reason why Jeroboam changes the day for the festival to the eighth month.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss some important religious days in your community. What do you do to celebrate each important religious day in your community? Why are those the days for your religious celebrations? Pause this audio here.

Finally, to start his new festival on the fifteenth day of the eighth month, Jeroboam himself offers sacrifices on the altar that Jeroboam had made in Bethel. An altar is a platform where a person makes a sacrifice. Remember that according to the law of Moses, only priests can offer sacrifices.

Stop here and look at a picture of an altar as a group.

1 Kings 12:25–33

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Jeroboam builds up Shechem and Peniel.

In the second scene: Jeroboam makes two golden calves for the people to worship because Jeroboam is worried the people will return to follow King Rehoboam. Jeroboam puts one golden calf in Bethel, and Jeroboam puts the other golden calf in Dan.

In the third scene: Jeroboam makes new places to worship, and Jeroboam chooses new priests who are not Levites. Jeroboam also chooses a new day of worship, and Jeroboam makes the first sacrifices himself on this new day of worship.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Jeroboam
- People of the northern tribes of Israel
- King Rehoboam of Judah
- King Jeroboam's advisers
- And the new priests whom King Jeroboam chooses

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the previous story, the storyteller talked a lot about Rehoboam and the southern kingdom of Judah. Rehoboam prepared to attack the northern kingdom of Israel, but a man of God, Shemaiah, told Rehoboam and all the people of Judah and Benjamin to go home. Remember that the people all listened to the man of God, and they all went home.

Now, the storyteller talks about the northern kingdom of Israel. Remember that the people made Jeroboam their new king in Shechem. In this passage, Jeroboam strengthens two of his cities to defend his new kingdom of Israel. Jeroboam also makes new religious rules for the people of the northern kingdom of Israel.

As the first scene begins, Jeroboam builds up the city of Shechem. Shechem is 65 kilometers north of Jerusalem. Shechem is in the hill country of the tribe of Ephraim. Remember that "hill country" is an area of land with a lot of hills. People had already built Shechem, but Rehoboam makes Shechem stronger to protect against enemy attacks. Jeroboam does this by building walls around the city. Jeroboam does not build up the city himself because Jeroboam is the king. Jeroboam tells other people to build up the city.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map that includes the city of Shechem and the land of the tribe of Ephraim, if needed. Also, look at a picture of hill country as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about ways that you protect your cities and villages from an enemy attack. In this case, Jeroboam wants to build strong walls around the city of Shechem. How will you describe the way that the people build up or protect their cities from an enemy? Remember that the storyteller in 2 Chronicles says that Rehoboam builds up some cities in the southern kingdom of Judah. Translate "build up" in the same way in this passage as you did in 2 Chronicles 11:1–12. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam also lives in Shechem, which means that Jeroboam rules from the city of Shechem. Jeroboam probably chooses Shechem as his new capital city of the northern kingdom of Israel because Shechem is between two mountains, Mount Ebal and Mount Gerizim. Jeroboam probably thinks that Jeroboam will be able to more easily defend Shechem from enemies because Shechem is in the mountains.

Jeroboam also builds up, or strengthens, the city of Peniel. Peniel is a city 8 kilometers east of the Jordan River. Another way to say Peniel is "Penuel." Jeroboam might travel to visit Peniel, or it is more likely that Jeroboam moves from Shechem to live in Peniel. Shechem remains the capital city of Israel. Peniel is in a good location to

defend Jeroboam's new kingdom against Jeroboam's enemies. People often traveled from the east to the west, or west to east, along the road near Peniel.

In the second and third scenes, the storyteller talks about the new religious practices that Jeroboam starts in the northern kingdom of Israel. Jeroboam chooses new places to worship. Jeroboam also chooses different priests and a new day to worship. You will remember from the law of Moses that Yahweh had very specific rules for where to worship Yahweh, who could serve as a priest, and on which days the people of Israel should have special festivals to worship Yahweh. Jeroboam changes all of these things in Jeroboam's new kingdom.

In the second scene, Jeroboam changes where the people of the northern kingdom of Israel should go to worship. Jeroboam thinks to himself that the people might become loyal to King Rehoboam again if the people keep going up to Jerusalem to worship Yahweh. Jerusalem was on higher ground than the other areas in Israel, so people often said they traveled "up" to Jerusalem. In the original language, the storyteller says that Jeroboam "says this in his heart." This probably means that Jeroboam thinks these things, but Jeroboam does not say these things out loud. Jeroboam is worried the people of his new kingdom will stop being loyal to him. In the original language, the storyteller says that Jeroboam thinks the heart of the people will return to King Rehoboam. "Heart of the people" means the loyalty of the people, or who the people follow as their king. Jeroboam is also worried that the people will kill him.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Jerusalem and the northern kingdom of Israel. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story where one of the characters in the story has a problem, and this character says something to themselves or thinks something about the problem that they have. How will you translate this part of the passage that Jeroboam thinks something to himself? Pause this audio here.

King Jeroboam asks for advice about what to do. King Jeroboam makes two male calves out of gold. Jeroboam probably does not make the golden calves himself. Maybe Jeroboam had workers pour liquid metal into molds to make the calves, or maybe Jeroboam had workers make wooden statues and then cover those statues with a thin layer of gold. Remember that Jeroboam tells the people that it is too much for them to travel up to Jerusalem. Jeroboam tells the people, "These are your gods, people of Israel, that brought you up from Egypt!" Jeroboam probably says "up from Egypt" because the land of Egypt was on lower ground than the highlands of Israel. Remember that Aaron told the people of Israel the same thing when Aaron made the golden calf after Yahweh brought the Israelites out of Egypt.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Egypt and Israel again if needed. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam puts one golden calf in Bethel at the southern end of his kingdom, and Jeroboam puts the other golden calf in Dan at the northern end of his kingdom. Bethel is 16 kilometers north of Jerusalem, and Bethel is where Jacob saw Yahweh many years before this. Bethel is in the land of the tribe of Benjamin. It is possible that Jeroboam hopes Yahweh will show himself to the people of the northern kingdom of Israel in the same way that Yahweh revealed himself to Jacob at Bethel. Dan is on the northern boundary of the northern kingdom of Israel. In the past, the people of the tribe of Dan made an altar in Dan. Dan is about 40 kilometers north of the Sea of Galilee.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Bethel, Dan, and Jerusalem again if needed. Pause this audio here.

In the final part of the second scene, the storyteller says what happened because of what Jeroboam did. The storyteller says that Jeroboam caused the people of the northern kingdom of Israel to sin because of the two golden calves in Bethel and Dan. Some people went to Bethel to worship the golden calf in Bethel, and some people went to Dan to worship the golden calf in Dan.

In the third scene, Jeroboam builds new shrines, or houses of worship, on high places. This probably means that Jeroboam builds walls around the altars already on the high places in the kingdom of northern Israel. These are not houses where people live, but places for people to come worship. High places are often on hills, but not all high places are on hills. High places are places where people built altars or shrines to worship their gods. Remember that Yahweh said only to worship Yahweh in the temple in Jerusalem, and not in any other place. It is likely that Jeroboam also put a house or shrine in Bethel and Dan. Jeroboam probably put a golden calf and an altar inside each house of worship in Bethel and in Dan.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember your discussion from the previous step about your place of worship. How will you translate “high places” in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam also chooses new priests from among all the people. “From among all the people” means that Jeroboam chose priests from all different tribes of Israel, and not just from among the Levites. Remember that Yahweh said that only Levites can be priests for Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the passage to show that Jeroboam chooses priests from all different kinds of people, and not just from the Levites? Pause this audio here.

We know from a similar passage in 2 Chronicles 11:13–17 that Jeroboam says the Levites cannot serve as priests in the northern kingdom, and so the priests and other Levites leave their homes and lands to go to Judah and Jerusalem. Some of these Levites lived in the northern kingdom of Israel in the past, but now they move to the southern kingdom of Judah so they can continue serving Yahweh.

Stop here and, as a group, listen to your translation of 2 Chronicles 11:13–17, if you have already translated this passage. Pause this audio here.

It is possible that Jeroboam does not trust the Levites anymore because they serve Yahweh in Jerusalem, and Jeroboam wants new priests who will be loyal to Jeroboam. It is also possible that the Levites do not want to help the Israelites worship the golden calves and other high places that Jeroboam sets up, so Jeroboam needs to find other priests who are willing to follow Jeroboam’s new religious changes.

Jeroboam makes a new day for the religious festival of shelters. Remember that Jeroboam changes the day of the festival from the fifteenth day of the seventh month to the fifteenth day of the eighth month. The festival was a time to celebrate that Yahweh provided for the Israelites in the desert after Yahweh brought the Israelites out of Egypt.

Jeroboam also sacrifices animals on the altar in Bethel on the fifteenth day of the eighth month. Remember that Yahweh said only priests can make sacrifices. The storyteller includes some information that shows the storyteller does not approve of Jeroboam’s choice. The storyteller says that Jeroboam chooses the month himself, and not because Yahweh told Jeroboam to choose this day for a new festival.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show that Jeroboam chooses this month by himself? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says three times that Jeroboam “goes up” to the altar. Sometimes people built an altar on a platform, so people had to go up on the platform to go to the altar. The storyteller probably repeats this because the storyteller wants to remind people how awful it is that Jeroboam himself offered sacrifices. All of the Israelites knew that only priests could offer sacrifices, so this is offensive and against Yahweh’s law.

In later passages, we will see that most of the later kings of the northern kingdom of Israel follow the example of Jeroboam, the first king of the northern kingdom of Israel. Most of the later kings turn the people of Israel away from Yahweh in the same way that Jeroboam does in this passage.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Jeroboam
- People of the northern tribes of Israel
- King Rehoboam of Judah
- King Jeroboam’s advisers

- And the new priests whom King Jeroboam chooses

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Jeroboam builds up the city of Shechem to make Shechem strong against enemy attacks. Shechem is in the hill country of the land of the tribe of Ephraim. Jeroboam lives in Shechem. Later, Jeroboam moves to the city of Peniel. Jeroboam also builds up the city of Peniel and makes Peniel strong against enemy attacks.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am worried that people from other nations around me will attack me and take my new kingdom from me. Then I could lose everything! or
- I hope that I can protect my kingdom from enemy attacks. I might need to build up more cities in my kingdom to protect my kingdom; or
- These new walls around Shechem and Peniel will protect me and my kingdom.

Continue the drama.

Jeroboam thinks the people of his kingdom might start to follow the family of David again. If the people go to Jerusalem to make sacrifices at the temple of Yahweh, then the people might decide to become loyal to King Rehoboam of Judah again. King Rehoboam was the master of the people in the past, and Jeroboam worries that the people of the northern kingdom will serve King Rehoboam again. Jeroboam also worries that the people of Jeroboam's northern kingdom will kill Jeroboam.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not trust Yahweh to help me keep my kingdom. I know that Yahweh promised me a kingdom that will not end, but I do not know if Yahweh will keep his promise; or
- I need to do anything I can to keep the loyalty of the people of the northern kingdom of Israel. I need to think creatively and make a plan so that I preserve my kingdom; or
- I am nervous that the people will kill me just like they killed Adoniram, King Rehoboam's representative. I need to please people so that they will not want to kill me.

Also, ask the people playing the people of the northern tribes of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We like King Jeroboam more than King Rehoboam because King Jeroboam will help us more than King Rehoboam. We do not want to build any more buildings for King Rehoboam; or
- We like the idea that we do not need to travel all the way to Jerusalem to make sacrifices to Yahweh. King Jeroboam seems like a wise king; or
- We do not think that King Jeroboam is right about what would happen if we went to Jerusalem to make sacrifices to Yahweh. We do not like King Rehoboam, and we will not change our minds about King Rehoboam; or
- I am nervous about what will happen if we do not go to Jerusalem to worship Yahweh.

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Continue the drama.

King Jeroboam asks for advice on what to do. Then, King Jeroboam makes two golden calves. King Jeroboam tells the people of the northern tribes of Israel, “It is too far for you to travel to Jerusalem. People of Israel, these two golden calves are your gods who brought you out of Egypt.” Jeroboam puts one golden calf in Bethel, and Jeroboam puts the other golden calf in Dan. But the people of the northern tribes of Israel sin, and they worship the golden calves. The people even go to Dan to worship the golden calf in Dan.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I do not think there is a problem with these two golden calves. All of the other nations around Israel have idols, and Israel should have some idols to worship, too; or
- I want the people to continue to worship Yahweh, but I do not want the people to travel to Jerusalem to worship Yahweh. These two golden calves will help me keep the loyalty of the people of the northern tribes of Israel because now the people can worship Yahweh in Bethel and in Dan; or
- Maybe Yahweh will see these two golden calves, and Yahweh will come to stand on these two golden calves. Yahweh showed himself to Jacob in Bethel, so maybe Yahweh will come to live in Bethel and Dan now; or
- Aaron made a golden calf for the people after the people came out of Egypt, and I am doing the same thing now.

Also, ask the people playing the people of the northern tribes of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are shocked that King Jeroboam made these two golden calves for us to worship! We know that the law of Moses says we should only worship Yahweh, and we should not worship any idols; or
- These idols seem so beautiful, and it is much easier to go to Bethel or Dan than to travel to Jerusalem to worship Yahweh. It is easier to worship these idols; or
- We trust King Jeroboam. King Jeroboam told us to worship these idols, and King Jeroboam takes good care of us. We will worship these idols because we do not want to go to Jerusalem to see King Rehoboam. King Rehoboam does not care about us.

Continue the drama.

Jeroboam also builds houses of worship on high places in the northern kingdom of Israel. Jeroboam chooses priests from among all the ordinary people, and Jeroboam does not choose priests from the tribe of Levi. Jeroboam makes a festival on the fifteenth day of the eighth month. This festival is similar to the festival in Judah. Jeroboam offers sacrifices on the altar in Bethel to the golden calf. Jeroboam also chooses priests at Bethel for the high places of worship. Jeroboam himself starts the new festival on the fifteenth day of the eighth month when Jeroboam offers sacrifices on the altar that Jeroboam built at Bethel. Jeroboam chooses this day himself.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want my new kingdom to have new ways of doing things. We have a new day for our own festival, new priests that I chose myself, and new places to worship; or
- I think that anyone should be able to be a priest now. I know that in the law of Moses, Yahweh says that a priest must be a Levite, but it does not matter if a person is a Levite or not; or
- I am the king, so I can make the sacrifices myself if I want to. All of the Levites who would tell me that I am not allowed to do this are already gone, so I can do whatever I want to do in my own kingdom.

Also, ask the people playing the people of the northern tribes of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are happy that King Jeroboam has made some changes to the difficult religion that Yahweh gave to us. It is easier to worship here in Bethel and Dan and in the houses of worship on high places. Now we are more like the other nations around Israel; or

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- Our new festival is similar to the festival of tabernacles in Judah. We have our festival a month later because our harvest happens a month later than the harvest in Judah; or
- We do not mind that King Jeroboam chose new priests for us. These priests are less strict about how we follow the law of Yahweh, and we prefer to worship however and wherever we want.

Also, ask the people playing the new priests that King Jeroboam chooses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are glad that King Jeroboam chose us as new priests, even though we are not Levites. It is an honor to be a priest; or
- We will do anything that King Jeroboam wants us to do, even if it means letting the people worship idols; or
- We like the two golden calves that King Jeroboam made for us. King Jeroboam had a good idea to keep the people of the northern tribes here in the northern kingdom of Israel. Now King Jeroboam will not lose the loyalty of the people.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 12:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King Jeroboam builds up the **city** of Shechem. Shechem is in the **hill country** of the land of the tribe of **Ephraim**. Ephraim and Manasseh were both sons of Joseph, and Ephraim is one of the half-tribes of the tribe of Joseph. The land of the tribe of Ephraim is in the northern kingdom of Israel. Hill country is land that has many hills or raised areas of land. Translate Ephraim, city, and hill country the same as you have in previous passages.

King Jeroboam thinks to himself that Jeroboam's northern **kingdom** might go back to the house, or family, of David. David was the second king of Israel, and King Rehoboam is David's grandson. Jeroboam thinks the people might return to serve their former **lord**, or master, **King** Rehoboam of **Judah**. A lord is someone who has authority over other people, and a king is someone who rules over a city or a territory. A kingdom is the people or the territory that a king rules. In this passage, "kingdom" means the people of the northern kingdom. Judah is the name of the southern kingdom of the tribes of Judah and Benjamin. Translate kingdom, house of David, lord, king, and Judah the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on kingdom, "**house of David**," lord, king, and Judah, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Jeroboam is worried that if the people of the northern kingdom of Israel continue to go up to **Jerusalem** to offer **sacrifices** in the **temple** of **Yahweh**, the people will not be loyal to King Jeroboam anymore. Jerusalem was the capital city of the unified nation of Israel, and now, in this passage, Jerusalem is the capital city of the southern kingdom of Judah. King Rehoboam lives and rules in Jerusalem. Yahweh told the priests of Israel to offer animal sacrifices in the temple, or house, of Yahweh. The sacrifices are gifts to Yahweh. Yahweh is God's personal name. Translate Jerusalem, sacrifices, temple, and Yahweh the same as you have in previous passages. For more information about sacrifices, temple, and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Jeroboam makes two golden calves. King Jeroboam tells the people of **Israel** that these golden calves are the **gods** of the people of Israel. King Jeroboam also tells the people that these gods brought the people out of **Egypt**. People often made statues or idols to represent their gods. Translate gods, Israel, and Egypt the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on gods and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

The people **sin** when the people **worship** the two golden calves that King Jeroboam puts in Bethel and in Dan. To "sin" means to disobey Yahweh. In Yahweh's laws, Yahweh said not to worship any idols. But in this passage, the people of Israel worship two golden calves. "Worship" means that the people of Israel honor these two golden calves and thank the golden calves for rescuing the people of Israel from slavery in the land of Egypt. Translate sin and worship the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on sin and worship, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Jeroboam also makes houses of worship on **high places**. High places are often on hills, or raised areas of land, but not all "high places" are in the hills. King Jeroboam puts altars in the houses of worship on high places. Translate high places the same as you have in previous passages.

King Jeroboam also chooses **priests** from all different kinds of people, and not just from among the **Levites**. Priests are people who serve in the temple of Yahweh. Levites are people who belong to the tribe of Levi, one of the 12 tribes of Israel. In the law of Moses, Yahweh said that only Levites could become priests for Yahweh. Translate priests and Levites the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on priests and Levites, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Jeroboam also chooses a new day for the festival. We know that this festival is called the **Festival of Tabernacles**. In the law of Moses, Yahweh tells the Israelites to celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles at the end of the harvest season, which was on the fifteenth day of the seventh month. The people live in temporary shelters for eight days during the Festival of Tabernacles. Yahweh also told the people they must come to Jerusalem for this festival. Earlier in the book of 1 Kings, King Solomon dedicated the temple in Jerusalem during the Festival of Tabernacles. Your team may choose to say the name of this festival, the "Festival of Tabernacles." If you do call it the Festival of Tabernacles, translate it the same as you have in previous passages, and you can refer to "Festival of Tabernacles" in the Master Glossary. Your team may choose to translate the festival as a more general word, like "festival."

King Jeroboam offers sacrifices himself on the **altar** that King Jeroboam had built in Bethel. An altar is a place where people burn sacrifices to God. Translate altar the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 12:25–33

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (936 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (11.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (8.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Kings 13:1–10

1 Kings 13:1–10

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 13:1–10 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:1–10 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, we learned how King Jeroboam strengthened his military power and his religious power. King Jeroboam made golden calves, started a new festival, chose new priests for his new high places, and offered sacrifices on the altar in Bethel. Now, in this passage, as King Jeroboam stands near the altar in Bethel to make a sacrifice, a man of God speaks against the altar that King Jeroboam made in Bethel. The man of God also makes a prophecy about the altar, and the man of God gives a sign that the prophecy will happen.

As the story begins, a man of God, or prophet, leaves Judah to come to Bethel. Judah is the southern kingdom, and Bethel is a city in the northern kingdom of Israel.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of both Judah and Israel. Find the city of Bethel on the map. Pause this audio here.

King Jeroboam stands by the altar in Bethel, which is where King Jeroboam put one of the golden calves that he made. King Jeroboam is ready to make a sacrifice on the altar at the start of the new festival that King Jeroboam made. Remember that only priests of Yahweh, who are Levites, should make sacrifices to Yahweh, and they should only make sacrifices in Jerusalem and not in any other place. Yahweh had also told people to celebrate this festival on a certain day each year, but King Jeroboam picked a different day to celebrate.

Suddenly, the man of God, or prophet, arrives in Bethel. Yahweh had sent the man of God from the southern kingdom of Judah to Bethel in the northern kingdom to share a message with King Jeroboam. It is important to remember that Yahweh is still the God of all the people of Israel, including the people of the northern kingdom of Israel.

The man of God loudly speaks out against the altar at Bethel with the authority of Yahweh. An altar is a platform where a person makes a sacrifice. The man of God speaks against the altar because Yahweh does not want the people of Israel to sacrifice at a different altar than the altar in the temple in Jerusalem.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an altar. Pause this audio here.

The man of God says that the “house,” or family, of David will have a son named Josiah. We know from later stories in the book of 2 Kings that King Josiah would rule the southern kingdom of Judah about 300 years after the time of King Jeroboam. The man of God says that Josiah will sacrifice priests of the high places on this altar. This is shocking! Also, people will burn human bones on the altar, which is also shocking. If people burn human bones on an altar, the altar becomes unclean, and no one can use the altar to make sacrifices again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What does it mean when people in your culture burn human bones? What happens to the bones after people burn the bones? Pause this audio here.

That same day, the man of God also gives a sign, or proof, that what he said about Josiah and the altar is true. Prophets often did a special sign to help people believe what they said about the future. The sign is that the altar will split apart, and the fatty ashes from the altar will pour out. It is not clear if people will break apart the altar or if an earthquake will break apart the altar. The fatty ashes are the burnt wood mixed with the fat of the animals that people sacrificed on the altar. In the law of Moses, Yahweh says the people should take these fatty ashes and put them in a ritually clean place. When the altar splits and the fatty ashes spill out, this shows that Yahweh does not like the sacrifices that the people make on this altar.

When King Jeroboam hears what the man of God says against the altar, King Jeroboam points with his hand at the man and tells some people to capture the man. Then, suddenly, King Jeroboam's hand becomes stiff so that King Jeroboam cannot pull it back. This shows that Yahweh is not happy with King Jeroboam.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe a person you know or someone you have seen who has a paralyzed arm or leg. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: What gesture do you make in your culture if you want to tell someone else to do an action? Pause this audio here.

Then, the altar splits apart, and the fatty ashes pour out. It is not clear when this sign happens, but it does happen exactly how the man of God said it would happen. Many people believe the altar splits apart and the fatty ashes pour out on the same day that the man of God speaks with King Jeroboam. Other people think this part of the passage tells about the time 300 years in the future, when King Josiah tears down the altar. Either way, when the storyteller tells this story in 1 Kings, there was no longer any altar at Bethel because King Josiah had already torn down the altar.

King Jeroboam asks the man of God to pray to Yahweh so that Yahweh will heal King Jeroboam's hand. The man of God prays to Yahweh, and Yahweh heals King Jeroboam's hand so that King Jeroboam can use his hand again. When Yahweh restores Jeroboam's hand, this shows that the man of God speaks with the authority of Yahweh because Yahweh listens to the man of God's prayers. This also shows that the prophecy that the man of God made about King Josiah and the altar is true.

Then, King Jeroboam asks the man of God to come and eat a meal with King Jeroboam. King Jeroboam also wants to give the man of God a reward, which is probably to thank the man of God for healing King Jeroboam's arm. Some people think that King Jeroboam invites the man of God to eat with King Jeroboam in order to take away the judgment that the man of God had made about King Jeroboam's altar at Bethel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when you gave a reward to someone you know. What reward did you give them? How did you choose the reward? Why did you give that person a reward? Pause this audio here.

But the man of God strongly refuses to go eat with King Jeroboam. King Jeroboam was probably very surprised. To eat with someone honored that person, and it may have also shown other people that you agreed with that person. The man of God says that even if King Jeroboam gives the man of God half of King Jeroboam's house, or kingdom, the man of God will not even eat bread with King Jeroboam. During the time of King Jeroboam, people said bread to mean any kind of food. The man of God also says he will not even drink water with King Jeroboam. The man of God says that Yahweh commanded him not to eat bread or drink water, and also not to return by the same way that the man of God came to Bethel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when someone refused to eat a meal with you or someone you know. How did you feel when the person refused the invitation to eat with you? Pause this audio here.

If the man of God eats with King Jeroboam, people in the northern kingdom of Israel may think that Yahweh and the man of God approve of all the religious changes that King Jeroboam made in the northern kingdom of Israel. But we know that the man of God spoke against the altar, and that Yahweh does not approve of the altar and the things that King Jeroboam is doing in the northern kingdom. It is important that the man of God obeys what Yahweh tells him to do.

The man of God obeys Yahweh. The man of God does not eat and drink with King Jeroboam. The man of God also goes back to Judah on a different road than the way the man of God came to Bethel at the beginning of this passage. It is likely that the man of God traveled on the main road on his way from Jerusalem to Bethel, and now the man of God probably travels through fields and on smaller paths from Bethel back to Jerusalem.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh sends the man of God from Judah to Bethel. The man of God speaks against the altar at Bethel. The man of God makes a prophecy about King Josiah, and that people will destroy the altar in the future.

In the second scene: King Jeroboam reaches out his hand and tells his men to arrest the man of God. King Jeroboam's hand becomes paralyzed. The altar breaks open, and the ashes spill out, just as the man of God said they would.

In the third scene: King Jeroboam asks the man of God to pray to Yahweh to heal King Jeroboam's paralyzed hand. The man of God prays to Yahweh, and Yahweh heals King Jeroboam's hand.

In the fourth scene: King Jeroboam asks the man of God to stay and eat with King Jeroboam. The man of God refuses to stay and eat with King Jeroboam. The man of God leaves Bethel and returns to Jerusalem in a different way than the man of God came to Bethel.

The characters in this passage are:

- The man of God
- King Jeroboam
- King Josiah
- Priests of the altar of Bethel
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that this current story continues the action from the previous story. In the previous story, King Jeroboam made changes to the religious practices of the northern kingdom of Israel. Remember that King Jeroboam made two golden calves and put them at Bethel and Dan, chose new priests, chose a new day for a festival, and made sacrifices on the new altar in Bethel.

As the first scene of this story begins, the man of God leaves Judah to come to Bethel. King Jeroboam is standing next to the altar at Bethel. King Jeroboam is ready to make a sacrifice on the altar at Bethel. Then, suddenly, a man of God comes to the altar at Bethel. A man of God is someone who speaks a message from Yahweh. Yahweh sends this man of God from the southern kingdom of Judah to the city of Bethel in the northern kingdom. The city of Jerusalem in Judah in the south, and the city of Bethel in the north, are connected by a main road.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Bethel and Judah again, if needed. Pause this audio here.

The man of God suddenly comes to Bethel, while Jeroboam is standing next to the altar in Bethel. Remember that an altar is a platform where a person makes a sacrifice. It may be better to change the order of this part of the passage. For example: "While Jeroboam was standing by the altar in Bethel to make a sacrifice, suddenly a man of God came up to Jeroboam. Yahweh had sent this man from Judah to talk to Jeroboam."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate this part of the first scene to show that the man of God comes unexpectedly and suddenly to Bethel with a message from Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

The man of God "cries out" in a loud voice by the word or authority of Yahweh. This does not mean that he wept. Rather, it means that Yahweh commanded or told the man of God to speak this message to King Jeroboam. When we hear that the man of God spoke by the "word" of Yahweh, we know that means that he speaks with the authority of Yahweh. The man of God also says, "This is what Yahweh says," when the man of God gives the message from Yahweh to King Jeroboam.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the story that the man of God is telling King Jeroboam a message from Yahweh, with the authority of Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

There are three parts to the message that the man of God speaks from Yahweh. First, the man of God speaks against the altar at Bethel. It is unusual to hear someone speak to an altar, but the man of God speaks against this altar to show that Yahweh does not approve of this altar. Some people think that when the man of God speaks against the altar, the man of God is also speaking against the golden calf and the new date for the festival that King Jeroboam chose. Other people think that the man of God only speaks against the altar because this shows that Yahweh's main concern is that the altar exists at all.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story where someone speaks against an object. How will you translate the part where the man of God speaks against the altar? Pause this audio here.

Next, the man of God also makes a prediction, or prophecy, about the future. Before his prediction, the man of God says something in the original language to focus the attention of King Jeroboam and all the people listening to the man of God. The man of God says David's family, or David's "house," will have a son whom people will name Josiah. The man of God says that right now, priests make sacrifices on this altar, but in the future, Josiah will sacrifice priests on the high places of this same altar in Bethel! People will also burn human bones on this same altar!

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about how you get people's attention when you speak to a crowd. How will you translate this part of the man of God's prophecy to show that the man of God wants to focus the attention of King Jeroboam and the others listening to the man of God's message from Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

The final thing the man of God says is a sign, or proof, that what the man of God says is true. The man of God says this sign from Yahweh on the same day as the first part of the message. The sign is that the altar will break apart, and the fatty ashes will pour out. Remember that it is not clear if the man of God means that the altar will break apart and the fatty ashes will pour out on the same day that the man of God is speaking with King Jeroboam, or if this sign will happen sometime in the future.

In the second scene, King Jeroboam hears what the man of God says against the altar, and King Jeroboam stretches out his hand, or arm, from the altar, probably to point at the man of God. It is possible that King Jeroboam points with his hand across the altar to the man of God. King Jeroboam tells his men to capture the man of God. Then, King Jeroboam's hand becomes paralyzed, stiff, and rigid, and King Jeroboam cannot pull back his hand.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the scene where King Jeroboam tells the men to capture the man of God, and then King Jeroboam's hand becomes paralyzed? Some ideas include:

- King Jeroboam stretches his hand over the altar and points at the man of God. King Jeroboam tells his men, "Capture that man!" But the hand King Jeroboam uses to point at the man of God becomes stiff and dry, and King Jeroboam cannot move his hand; or
- King Jeroboam raises his arm from the altar, and King Jeroboam tells his men to take the man of God captive. But King Jeroboam's arm becomes dry, and King Jeroboam cannot put his arm back at his side.

Pause this audio here.

It is difficult to know when the next part of the second scene happens. Remember that some people think that the same day that the man of God speaks with King Jeroboam, the altar also breaks apart, and the fatty ashes pour out. Other people think this part of the scene happens 300 years in the future, when King Josiah breaks apart the altar and pours out the fatty ashes. Remember that in the previous story, King Jeroboam built this altar in Bethel and made the golden calf for this altar, but the storyteller might be showing what happens when

someone destroys the altar many years later. Remember that regardless of when this happens, it does happen before the original listeners to this story heard the storyteller tell this story. It also happens exactly as the man of God says that the sign would happen.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the second scene where the sign happens? Will you make it clear that it happens on the same day that King Jeroboam is speaking with the man of God, or will you translate it to mean that the sign happens much later when King Josiah destroys the altar? Here are some example translations:

- Also, the altar split apart, and the fatty ashes poured out. This sign happened just as the man of God said, when the man of God told the sign with the authority of Yahweh; or
- Much later, people tore down the altar, and the fatty ashes spilled out. This happened just as the man of God had said with Yahweh's authority.

Pause this audio here.

In both the third and fourth scenes, King Jeroboam asks the man of God something. In the third scene, the man of God does what King Jeroboam asks the man of God to do. In the fourth scene, the man of God refuses to do what King Jeroboam asks the man of God to do.

In the third scene, King Jeroboam asks the man of God to pray to Yahweh to heal King Jeroboam's hand. In the original language, King Jeroboam asks the man of God to "plead with the face of Yahweh." This might mean that King Jeroboam wants the man of God to try and smooth out Yahweh's angry face for what happened to King Jeroboam's hand.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Act out how a person's face looks when they are angry. Describe how the person's face looks crinkled and not smooth. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when a friend of yours was angry with you for some reason, and you asked another person to talk with your friend on your behalf. How will you translate this part of the scene where King Jeroboam asks the man of God to pray to Yahweh to heal King Jeroboam's hand? Pause this audio here.

The man of God prays to Yahweh. In the original language, the storyteller says again that the man of God pleads with the face of Yahweh. Translate "plead with the face of Yahweh" the same as you did earlier in this scene. After the man of God prays to Yahweh, Yahweh heals King Jeroboam's hand. King Jeroboam can use his hand again! In the original language, the storyteller says that King Jeroboam's hand is restored to him, and King Jeroboam's hand becomes like it was before his hand was paralyzed.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what is the best way to clearly translate this part of the scene when Yahweh heals King Jeroboam's hand? It may be better to simply say, "Yahweh heals King Jeroboam's hand," and not also say that King Jeroboam's hand becomes like it was before. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, King Jeroboam asks the man of God to come and eat a meal with King Jeroboam. King Jeroboam also wants to give the man of God a reward, probably to thank the man of God for praying to heal King Jeroboam's paralyzed hand. We are not sure what this reward was, but it might have been money or some other valuable thing.

However, the man of God does not agree to go eat a meal with King Jeroboam. In the original language, the storyteller says, "But the man of God says no to King Jeroboam." Remember that King Jeroboam does not expect the man of God to refuse this invitation to eat with King Jeroboam. The original listeners of the story also probably would not expect the man of God to refuse the invitation to eat a meal with King Jeroboam.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the man of God's response to show that his response surprises people? Pause this audio here.

Instead, the man of God tells King Jeroboam that the man of God will not go with King Jeroboam, even if King Jeroboam offers the man of God half of King Jeroboam's house. Half of King Jeroboam's house means half of King Jeroboam's kingdom, wealth, or possessions. The man of God also says that he will not even eat simple bread or drink water with King Jeroboam.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best order to translate the man of God's response to King Jeroboam? Here are some translation ideas:

- Even if you offer me half of your wealth, I will not go with you. I also will not eat or drink anything here; or
- I will not go eat bread or drink water with you, even if you give me half of everything in your house.

Pause this audio here.

The man of God says the reason that the man of God cannot eat with King Jeroboam is because of Yahweh's command. In the original language, the storyteller says that "Yahweh commanded the man of God by the word of Yahweh." This means that Yahweh told the man of God what to do with Yahweh's authority. The man of God should obey the commands of Yahweh. Yahweh told the man of God not to eat bread or drink water, and not to return in the same way that the man of God came to Bethel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Would it be best to translate the exact words that Yahweh said to the man of God, or to describe what Yahweh said to the man of God? For example:

- Yahweh gave me this order: "Do not eat bread, do not drink water, and do not return the same way that you came"; or
- Yahweh commanded me not to eat any food or drink anything, and to go home by a different way.

Pause this audio here.

In the final part of this scene, the man of God does exactly what Yahweh told the man of God to do. Even though the storyteller does not say anything in this last part of the passage about whether or not the man of God eats with King Jeroboam, we know from earlier in the scene that the man of God already refused to eat with King Jeroboam. So, the man of God obeys Yahweh's command not to eat bread or drink water in that place, which is Bethel.

The man of God also obeys Yahweh's command to return to Judah by a different road than the road the man of God came to Bethel. It is not clear why Yahweh tells the man of God to go home a different way than the way he came, but it is possible that Yahweh wants the man of God not to be near the people of the northern kingdom of Israel. The storyteller says the same information in two different ways, probably to emphasize that the man of God obeyed Yahweh's command and did not return the same way he had come to Bethel. First, the storyteller says that the man of God went another way. Then the storyteller says that the man of God did not go back the same way he had come to Bethel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Would it be better to say first that the man of God went another way, or to say first that the man of God did not go back the same way that he had come to Bethel? For example:

- The man of God went another way. The man of God did not go back the same way that he had come to Bethel; or
- The man of God did not travel back on the same road that he had taken to Bethel. The man of God went home a different way.

Pause this audio here.

The man of God obeys Yahweh's commands, which is in contrast to the way King Jeroboam does not obey Yahweh. Remember that in the previous story, King Jeroboam made new ways to worship Yahweh that are not according to Yahweh's commands. It is important to notice that the man of God is obedient to all of Yahweh's commands.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The man of God
- King Jeroboam
- King Josiah
- Priests of the altar of Bethel
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh sends the man of God from Judah to the city of Bethel to talk to Jeroboam. While Jeroboam is standing by the altar in Bethel to make a sacrifice, the man of God comes to Jeroboam. The man of God speaks in a loud voice against the altar at Bethel. The man of God speaks with the authority of Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the man of God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am shocked to see King Jeroboam next to this altar in Bethel! King Jeroboam knows he is not a priest and cannot offer sacrifices! King Jeroboam also knows that priests should only make sacrifices at the temple in Jerusalem; or
- I am prepared to obey the commands of Yahweh. I came here to Bethel to share the message that Yahweh told me to say to King Jeroboam; or
- I know that Yahweh will protect me from King Jeroboam, so I can speak confidently to King Jeroboam with the message that Yahweh gave to me. Yahweh himself gave me the authority to say these things, so I am not afraid of King Jeroboam.

Also, ask the person playing King Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am angry that this man is interrupting my new festival! I am preparing to offer a sacrifice. This man came here uninvited. This man is causing a problem! or
- I hope that the people of the northern tribes of Israel do not listen to anything this man says. I want the people in the northern kingdom to come to this altar at Bethel to worship, and I do not want this man to change their minds about that; or
- I do not care what this man says to me or who he is. I will send this man away because I am the king here!

Continue the drama.

The man of God says, "Altar, listen to Yahweh! Yahweh says to you that David's family will have a son. People will name this son Josiah. Priests offer sacrifices on you, altar, but one day, Josiah will sacrifice these priests on you! On this altar, people will burn the bones of people!" The man of God also gives a sign from Yahweh that same day. The altar will break apart, and the fatty ashes will pour out.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This man does not know what he is talking about. Why is this man talking to an altar? Why does this man think he is speaking with the authority of Yahweh? or
- I am offended that this man thinks that one day someone named Josiah will sacrifice the priests of this altar on this same altar! That will never happen! or

- This altar is good, and I am angry that this man thinks one day people will burn human bones on this altar. If that happened, no one would be able to use this altar again. That will never happen! or
- I have no idea what this man is saying about a sign from Yahweh. No one will break this altar, and the ashes from the sacrifices will not pour out.

Also, ask the person playing the man of God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that someday, Josiah will break this altar apart. Yahweh does not approve of this altar or the sacrifices that people make on this altar; or
- I am happy to give this message to King Jeroboam. Jeroboam is not following Yahweh, and Jeroboam needs to know that someday, Yahweh will judge him for not obeying Yahweh; or
- I wish that Yahweh would come and break this altar apart today. It is terrible that King Jeroboam is making sacrifices here!

Continue the drama.

King Jeroboam hears what the man of God cries out against the altar in Bethel. King Jeroboam stretches his hand over the altar and points at the man of God. King Jeroboam tells his men, "Capture that man!" But his hand that he pointed at the man of God becomes stiff and dry, and King Jeroboam cannot move his hand. Also, the altar split apart, and the fatty ashes poured out. This sign happened just as the man of God said, when the man of God told the sign with the authority of Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am angry that this man dares to speak boldly at my new altar. I want to punish this man! or
- I am shocked that my hand will not move! Why did this happen to me? or
- I wonder if Yahweh punished me by paralyzing my hand. I am worried that Yahweh might not approve of my new altar here in Bethel.

Continue the drama.

King Jeroboam asks the man of God, "Please pray to Yahweh your God so that I can use my hand again." So, the man of God prays to Yahweh, and Yahweh heals King Jeroboam's hand. The king's hand is healthy again!

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know that Yahweh will listen to this man more than Yahweh will listen to me, so I want this man to pray to Yahweh to heal my hand; or
- I hope that Yahweh can heal my hand. I need to be able to use my hand! or
- Maybe if this man can pray to Yahweh and my hand becomes better, I will listen more closely to what this man is saying to me.

Continue the drama.

King Jeroboam also asks the man of God, "Come home with me to eat a meal with me. I will also give you a reward." But the man of God tells King Jeroboam, "Even if you offer me half of your wealth, I will not go with you. I also will not eat or drink anything here. Yahweh gave me this order, 'Do not eat bread, do not drink water, and do not return the same way that you came.'" The man of God did not travel back on the same road that he had taken to Bethel. The man of God went home a different way.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am deeply offended that this man refused to come eat with me! I wanted to reward this man for healing my hand, and now this man refuses to eat with me! or
- I wanted this man to eat a meal with me because then I would feel that Yahweh is not so angry with me anymore. I want all of the people of the northern kingdom to think that Yahweh actually approves of this new altar at Bethel; or

1 Kings 13:1–10

- I am embarrassed that this man refused my invitation. What will the people in the northern kingdom of Israel think when they hear that someone refused the king's invitation to eat with the king?

Also, ask the person playing the man of God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh gave me strict commands not to eat or drink at all here, and not to go home the same way that I came to Bethel. I am going to obey all of Yahweh's commands; or
- I do not want to eat with King Jeroboam! King Jeroboam does not follow Yahweh, and I do not want King Jeroboam to think that I approve of him and his new practices; or
- I wish Yahweh had not healed King Jeroboam's hand. I think that King Jeroboam deserves punishment from Yahweh; or
- I want to leave Bethel as soon as possible. I delivered the message from Yahweh, and now I want to return home.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

A **man of God** comes from **Judah** to Bethel by the **word** of **Yahweh**. In the Old Testament, people sometimes call a prophet a "man of God." Yahweh sends prophets with messages for the people. Judah is the southern kingdom of the nation of Israel that includes the land of the tribes of Benjamin and Judah. "By the word of Yahweh" means that this man of God comes with the authority of Yahweh with a message from Yahweh. Yahweh is God's personal name. Translate "man of God," Judah, word, Yahweh, and God the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on "man of God," refer to prophet in the Master Glossary. For more information on Judah, word, Yahweh, and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Jeroboam is standing by the **altar** to make an **offering**. An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to God. An offering is a gift people give to God. Translate altar and offering the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on altar and offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The man of God says that the **house of David** will have a **son**, or a male child. The house of David means the descendants of David, the second king of Israel. One day in the future, one of David's **descendants** will have a son whom people will name Josiah. Translate son, which really means descendant, and "house of David," the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on son, descendant, and "house of David," refer to the Master Glossary.

Josiah will **sacrifice** the **priests** of the **high places** on the altar in Bethel. In the law of Moses, Yahweh told the Israelites how to sacrifice animals, food, oil, and grain. Priests are the only people who should make sacrifices. High places are places where people made sacrifices to idols or other gods. High places are often on hills, or raised areas of land, but not all "high places" are in the hills. Translate sacrifice, priests, and high places the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on sacrifice and priests, refer to the Master Glossary.

The man of God also says that Yahweh gives a sign, or proof, that what the man of God says is true. The sign is that the altar will break apart, and the fatty ashes will pour out.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate "**sign**" in this passage? Translate sign the same as you have in other parts of the Old Testament. For more information on sign, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

King Jeroboam hears what the man of God says against the altar. Translate king the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Jeroboam asks the man of God to **pray** for King Jeroboam. King Jeroboam asks the man of God to pray a special kind of prayer to Yahweh, where a person prays earnestly to Yahweh for something. Use the same word or phrase for pray as you have used previously, and refer to pray in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the idea that King Jeroboam wants the man of God to plead with Yahweh to heal King Jeroboam's hand? Pause this audio here.

The man of God prays to Yahweh, and Yahweh heals King Jeroboam's paralyzed hand. Then King Jeroboam asks the man of God to come eat a meal with King Jeroboam. King Jeroboam also says he will give a reward to the man of God. Remember that we are not sure what this reward was, but it could have been money or some other valuable thing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate "**reward**" in this passage? Remember that King Jeroboam probably wants to thank the man of God with this reward because the man of God prayed to heal King Jeroboam's paralyzed hand. Translate reward the same as you have in other parts of the Old Testament.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 13:1–10

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (674 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (15.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Kings 13:11–22

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 13:11–22 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:11–22 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1 Kings 13:11–22

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:11–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, a man of God spoke against the altar in Bethel. The man of God refused to eat with King Jeroboam because Yahweh told the man of God not to eat. The story ended when the man of God left by a different road than the way he came to Bethel. Now, an old prophet hears about what the man of God did in Bethel, and the old prophet follows the man of God. The old prophet invites the man of God to come eat and drink with the old prophet. We will see if the man of God continues to obey the commands of Yahweh. This is the first part of a two-part story.

As the story begins, an old prophet lives in Bethel. We do not know the name of this old prophet. Remember that Bethel is a city near the southern border of the kingdom of Israel. King Jeroboam had made an altar and put a golden calf in Bethel for the people of Israel to go and worship at Bethel. It is possible that the old prophet is loyal to King Jeroboam's new religious practices.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Bethel, the northern kingdom of Israel, and the southern kingdom of Judah. Pause this audio here.

The sons of the old prophet come to their father to tell their father some important news about what happened in Bethel that day. It is possible that the old prophet stayed home and did not go to the altar in Bethel because he was an old man. The sons tell their father everything that the man of God from Judah did that day, and everything the man of God said to King Jeroboam. Remember that the man of God spoke about the destruction of the altar, prayed to Yahweh to heal King Jeroboam's hand, and then refused to stay and eat a meal with King Jeroboam because Yahweh had commanded the man of God not to eat or drink anything.

After the old prophet hears about what happened in Bethel that day, the old prophet decides he wants to follow the man of God. The old prophet asks his sons which road the man of God took from Bethel back to Judah, and the sons of the old prophet show their father the right road. The old prophet tells his sons to put a saddle on his donkey. A donkey is a common animal that people rode on during the time of the Old Testament. A saddle is a seat or cloth that people put on an animal to make it more comfortable to ride on that animal. The sons put the saddle on the donkey, and the old prophet gets on the donkey and follows after the man of God.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a donkey and a saddle. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: What animals do people ride in your community, if any? Do you use a saddle or a seat, or something else to ride on them? Pause this audio here.

The old prophet finds the man of God sitting under an oak or terebinth tree. Maybe the man of God is resting under the shade of this tree. Oak trees and terebinth trees can grow as tall as 9 meters high.

Stop here and look at a picture of an oak tree and a terebinth tree as a group. Pause this audio here.

The old prophet asks the man of God if he truly is the man of God from Judah, and the man of God says that he is. The old prophet invites the man of God to come to the old prophet's home to eat together. The man of God refuses the invitation to eat anything in Bethel because of Yahweh's commands not to eat or drink in Bethel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember your discussion in the previous passage about a time when someone refused an invitation to come eat with you. Talk about how you feel when someone refuses an invitation to eat with you. Pause this audio here.

The old prophet invites the man of God to come to his house again, but this time, the old prophet lies to the man of God. The old prophet says he is also a prophet and that an angel, or messenger, of Yahweh told the old

prophet to bring the man of God back to his house to eat with the old prophet. Remember that an angel is a supernatural being and not a person. The old prophet is not telling the truth because no angel of Yahweh told the old prophet to bring the man of God back with him. It is not clear why the old prophet lies to the man of God, but maybe the old prophet wants to be close to someone who heard from Yahweh, or maybe the old prophet wants to learn more about the man of God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time that someone lied to you, and at first you believed the lie, and then later you learned it was a lie. How did you feel when you found out it was a lie? Why do you think you believed the lie? Pause this audio here.

The man of God believes the old prophet's lie. The man of God goes back to Bethel with the old prophet. The man of God eats and drinks with the old prophet in the old prophet's house. Remember that Yahweh commanded the man of God not to eat or drink anything in Bethel, but the man of God disobeys Yahweh's command.

While the old prophet and the man of God are eating together at a table, Yahweh speaks to the old prophet. This time, the word from Yahweh is true and not a lie. People put food on the table, and then they sat next to the table to eat the food.

Stop here and look at a picture of a table as a group. Pause this audio here.

The old prophet tells Yahweh's message to the man of God. Yahweh says that the man of God did not obey Yahweh's command because the man of God ate food and drank water in Bethel, and Yahweh had told the man of God not to do this. If a person disobeys Yahweh's commands, Yahweh can punish that person. The punishment for the man of God is that people will not bury the body of the man of God in the tomb of his fathers, or ancestors. Israelites cut tombs for their families into the rocky hillsides, and they put dead bodies in these tombs. It was shameful and humiliating if a family did not bury their dead relative in their family tomb.

Stop here and look at a photo of a tomb. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: After someone dies, where do you put that person's body? What happens if someone dies when they are far from their home?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:11–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The sons of an old prophet tell the old prophet about what the man of God did in Bethel. The old prophet follows after the man of God.

In the second scene: The old prophet finds the man of God sitting under an oak tree. The old prophet invites the man of God to the old prophet's house to eat and drink, but the man of God refuses to come.

In the third scene: The old prophet lies to the man of God and says that an angel from Yahweh told the old prophet to bring the man of God back to the old prophet's house to eat and drink. The man of God goes with the old prophet to eat and drink.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh speaks through the old prophet and tells the man of God that the man of God disobeyed Yahweh's commands. Yahweh's message also says that people will not bury the man of God in his family tomb.

The characters in this passage are:

- The old prophet
- The sons of the old prophet
- The man of God
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story continues the previous story. Remember that in the previous story, the man of God spoke against the altar in Bethel. Also, remember that King Jeroboam invited the man of God to eat with King Jeroboam. The man of God obeyed the commands of Yahweh not to eat or drink in Bethel, and also to return home to Judah by a different way. Now, in this story, an old prophet also invites the man of God to eat and drink with the old prophet. This is the first part of a two-part story.

As the first scene begins, the sons of an old prophet in Bethel come to talk to their father, the old prophet. In the original language, the storyteller says that one son comes to tell his father everything that the man of God did and said that day in Bethel. It is possible that one son first tells the old prophet about the man of God, and then the other son or sons also speak with their father.

The old prophet asks his sons, "Which road did the man of God take?" The old prophet wants to know if his sons can show him where to follow the man of God. Then, the sons show the old prophet the way that the man of God went. In the original language, the storyteller uses words that show that the sons had seen the way the man went or that the sons now show their father the way. Then, the old prophet tells his sons, "Put my saddle on my donkey for me." Remember that a saddle is a seat or cloth that people use on a donkey to make it more comfortable to ride the donkey. The sons prepare the donkey, and the old prophet gets on the donkey. The old prophet follows after the man of God.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a donkey and a saddle again, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Would it be better to translate the exact words that the old prophet says to his sons, or to summarize what the old prophet says? For example:

- The old prophet asks his sons which road the man of God took; or
- The old prophet asks his sons, "Which road did the man of God take?" or
- The old prophet tells his sons to put the saddle on the donkey for the old prophet; or
- The old prophet tells his sons, "Put my saddle on my donkey for me."

Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the old prophet finds the man of God sitting under an oak tree. Remember that oak trees are often very tall, and it is likely the man of God was resting under the oak tree. It is possible to translate oak tree as "a big tree."

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an oak tree and a terebinth tree again, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the name for this tree in this passage? Pause this audio here.

The old prophet talks with the man of God. In this scene, the old prophet asks the man of God two questions, and the man of God answers both of the questions. It might be better to translate the exact questions that the old prophet asks the man of God, and the exact responses that the man of God gives. Or it may be more natural to translate a summary of the conversation. First, the old prophet wants to know if the man he is speaking with really is the man of God from Judah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate the conversation between the old prophet and the man of God? Here are some ideas for translation:

- The old prophet asks the man of God if he is the prophet from Judah. The man of God says that he is the prophet from Judah; or
- The old prophet asks the man of God, "Are you the man of God who came from Judah?"

The man of God says, "I am."

Pause this audio here.

Next, the old prophet asks the man of God to come to the old prophet's house to eat and drink together. Again, it may be better to translate the exact words that the old prophet says to the man of God, or to translate a summary of what the old prophet says.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate the old prophet's invitation to the man of God? Here are some ideas for translation:

- The old prophet invites the man of God to come to the old prophet's house to eat together; or
- The old prophet says to the man of God, "Please come to my house and eat with me."

Pause this audio here.

The old prophet's invitation is similar to the invitation that King Jeroboam made to the man of God in the previous passage. Similar to the previous passage, the man of God again refuses the invitation to eat anything in Bethel because the word of Yahweh commanded the man of God not to eat food, drink water, or return by the same way that he came to Bethel.

In the third scene, the old prophet again invites the man of God to his house to eat together. The old prophet says that an angel of Yahweh told the old prophet to bring the man of God back to eat at the old prophet's house. It is important to notice that the old prophet's message does not include the words "this is what Yahweh says," which is usually in a message from Yahweh. The storyteller includes the information that the old prophet lies to the man of God. The man of God does not know that the old prophet is lying.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show that the old prophet lies to the man of God? It might sound more natural to say, "But the old prophet is lying to the man of God," or that the man of God does not expect that the old prophet would lie to him. Pause this audio here.

The man of God believes what the old prophet says to him, so the man of God goes back to Bethel to eat and drink at the old prophet's house. Remember that the man of God knows Yahweh told him not to eat or drink anything in Bethel.

In the fourth scene, while the old prophet and the man of God are sitting at the table and eating together, the old prophet hears a real message from Yahweh. This time, the old prophet says, "This is what Yahweh says." The old prophet says that the man of God disobeyed the word of Yahweh. Then, the old prophet says the same message from Yahweh in a negative way, that the man of God did not keep the command that Yahweh gave to the man of God. Then, the old prophet says what the man of God did: that the man of God ate and drank in Bethel, even though Yahweh said not to eat and drink in Bethel. The actions of the man of God are in contrast to the command of the word of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the message from Yahweh to the man of God to show it is a real message from Yahweh? Would it be better to say the message in a negative way first or second? How will you show that the man of God disobeyed the command of Yahweh when the man of God ate and drank in Bethel? Pause this audio here.

The final part of the message is the punishment that Yahweh gives the man of God for disobeying Yahweh's command. The punishment is that people will not bury the dead body of the man of God in the tomb of the man of God's family. People dug a hole in a hillside to make a tomb. Then, the people put the bodies on stone shelves inside the tomb.

Stop here and look at a photo of a tomb. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the ideas of dead body, bury, and family tomb? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:11–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The old prophet
- The sons of the old prophet
- The man of God
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

An old prophet lives in Bethel. The sons of the old prophet come to the old prophet. The sons tell their father about what the man of God did in Bethel, and everything that the man of God said to King Jeroboam. The old prophet asks his sons, "Which way did the man of God go?" The sons show their father the way the man of God from Judah went. Then, the old prophet asks the sons to saddle his donkey for him to ride. The sons saddle the donkey, and the old prophet gets on the donkey. The old prophet rides the donkey to follow after the man of God.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the old prophet, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wish I were there in Bethel to see what the man of God did, and to hear what the man of God said to King Jeroboam; or
- I am shocked that the man of God said those things to King Jeroboam! I wonder if the man of God really had a true message from Yahweh; or
- I want to follow this man of God so I can speak with him. I need to tell this man of God that he cannot speak to King Jeroboam this way because it is King Jeroboam's choice to make these changes to the altar and priests in Bethel; or
- I want to talk to the man of God because I want to learn from him. If this man of God has a real message from Yahweh, then I want to be around him!

Also, ask the people playing the sons of the old prophet, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are shocked by what this man of God did and said today at the altar in Bethel! or
- We know that our father will want to know about what happened today at the altar in Bethel. We are excited to share this important news with him; or
- We wish that we could go with our father to meet this man of God. We want to hear from the man of God, too.

Continue the drama.

The old prophet finds the man of God sitting under an oak or terebinth tree. The old prophet asks the man of God, "Are you the man of God from Judah?" The man of God says, "Yes, I am." The old prophet says, "Come home to eat with me." But the man of God says, "I cannot go back to Bethel with you, and I cannot eat or drink in Bethel because Yahweh commanded me not to eat or drink here, and not to return by the same way that I came here."

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the man of God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- I am tired from my journey, so I am resting under this oak tree in the shade; or
- I am hungry and thirsty. I would like to go eat a meal with this man, but I must obey the commands of Yahweh; or
- I am ready to go home to Judah. This was a difficult message to give to King Jeroboam in Bethel, and I am trying to have enough strength to make the journey home; or
- I do not understand why Yahweh commanded me not to eat or drink in Bethel, but I must obey Yahweh's commands.

Also, ask the person playing the old prophet, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am offended that this man of God will not come with me to eat and drink! or
- I am surprised that this man of God refused King Jeroboam's invitation and also my invitation. Surely this man of God is hungry and thirsty from his journey; or
- I wonder how I might convince the man of God to come to my house. I want to speak with him and learn more about him.

Continue the drama.

The old prophet tells the man of God, "I am also a prophet like you are. An angel gave me this message from Yahweh that I should bring you back to my house so you can eat and drink." But the old prophet is lying to the man of God. Then, the man of God returns to Bethel to eat and drink with the old prophet.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the old prophet, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This command of Yahweh not to eat or drink in Bethel seems unfair. I think the man of God should be able to eat and drink here with me if he is hungry and thirsty! or
- I hope that the man of God will come back to eat with me in my house. I want the man of God to say that the new practices of King Jeroboam are okay to do; or
- I want to follow Yahweh in the right way, and I feel bad that I did not say anything against the new practices that King Jeroboam made in the northern kingdom of Israel. I want to talk to this man of God about these new practices of King Jeroboam.

Also, ask the person playing the man of God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know that Yahweh commanded me not to eat or drink here in Bethel, but I think Yahweh will be gracious to me if I go with this old prophet to eat and drink; or
- I am very tired, hungry, and thirsty, and it would be so good to rest and eat with this kind old prophet; or
- I do not think I am disobeying Yahweh's commands because this old prophet seems to have a new command from Yahweh that says I can eat and drink here.

Continue the drama.

While the old prophet and the man of God are eating together, Yahweh sends a message to the old prophet who brought the man of God back to Bethel. The old prophet tells the man of God this message. The old prophet says, "This is Yahweh's message for you. You disobeyed what Yahweh told you to do! You did not obey the command that Yahweh your God gave to you. You came back to Bethel to eat and drink, and I told you not to eat and drink here in Bethel. Your punishment is that people will not put your body in your family tomb."

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the old prophet, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am surprised that Yahweh chose to send a message through me! or
- I feel guilty because I brought this man of God back to Bethel by lying to him, and now there is a terrible message from Yahweh for this man of God; or
- I hope that these things in Yahweh's message do not happen anytime soon.

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Also, ask the person playing the man of God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I regret that I came back here to Bethel to eat and drink with this old prophet; or
- I feel very sad that I broke Yahweh's command not to eat and drink in Bethel; or
- I feel betrayed by this old prophet because now I do not think he had a special message from an angel of Yahweh who told him I could go back to Bethel with him; or
- I hope that I do not die for a long time. It is very painful not to be buried in my family's tomb. I hope that I can make this journey back to Judah safely, but I know this punishment might happen on my journey back to Judah.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:11–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

An old **prophet** lives in Bethel. A prophet is a person who gives messages from Yahweh to the people. The **sons** of the prophet tell the prophet what the **man of God** did in Bethel. Sons are the male children of their father. In the Old Testament, people also called a prophet a "man of God." The sons also tell their father what the man of God said to the **king**. A king is someone who rules over a city or a territory. Translate prophet, son, man of God, and king the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on prophet, son, and king, refer to the Master Glossary. For more information on "man of God," refer to prophet in the Master Glossary.

The man of God is from **Judah**. Judah is the southern kingdom of the nation of Israel that includes the land of the tribes of Benjamin and Judah. Translate Judah the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Judah, refer to the Master Glossary.

The old prophet tells his sons to saddle his **donkey** for him. A donkey is an animal that is big enough to carry heavy loads or people. A saddle is a seat or cloth that people use on a donkey to make it more comfortable to ride the donkey. Translate donkey the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on donkeys, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and look at a picture of a donkey and a saddle again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate "**saddle my donkey**" in this passage? It may be best to translate that the old prophet tells his sons to prepare his donkey so he can ride it, and not include the word "saddle" if this is a difficult idea to translate. Pause this audio here.

The man of God tells the old prophet that the man of God cannot eat or drink with the old prophet because the **word of Yahweh** told the man of God not to eat or drink anything.

"The word of Yahweh" means a message from Yahweh to the man of God not to eat or drink anything in Bethel. Yahweh is God's personal name. Translate "word of Yahweh" the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on "word of Yahweh," refer to word and Yahweh in the Master Glossary. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

The old prophet tells the man of God that an **angel** gave a message to the old prophet by the word of Yahweh. The old prophet wants the man of God to think that the old prophet has a message with the authority of Yahweh. An angel is a messenger from Yahweh. Be careful not to confuse angel with prophet. A prophet is a human, but an angel is a supernatural being.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate "**angel**" in this passage? For more information on angels, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The old prophet receives a message from Yahweh for the man of God. The old prophet says that people will not bury the body of the man of God in the tomb of his fathers, or ancestors. A tomb is a place where people bury dead bodies. For more information on tomb, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and look at a photo of a tomb. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate "**tomb**" in this passage?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 13:11–22

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (989 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (8.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (7.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Kings 13:23–34

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 13:23–34 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:23–34 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

1 Kings 13:23–34

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the man of God went to the house of the old prophet to eat with the old prophet, even though Yahweh had commanded the man of God not to eat in the city of Bethel. Then, the old prophet heard a message from Yahweh for the man of God. The message from Yahweh said that people will not bury the man of God in his family tomb because the man of God disobeyed Yahweh's command. Now, the man of God leaves the house of the old prophet to travel from Bethel back to Judah. This is the second part of a two-part story.

The man of God finishes his meal, and then the old prophet puts a saddle on a donkey for the man of God to ride on from the city of Bethel to Judah. It is unclear if the donkey belongs to the man of God or to the old prophet, but it is possible that the old prophet lends one of his own donkeys for the man of God to use. Remember that a donkey was a common animal that people rode on during the time of the Old Testament. A saddle is a seat or cloth that people put on an animal to make it more comfortable to ride. Bethel is the city where the old prophet lives in the northern kingdom of Israel, and Judah is the southern kingdom.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a donkey and a saddle. Also, look at a map of Bethel, the northern kingdom of Israel, and the southern kingdom of Judah as a group, if needed. Pause this audio here.

While the man of God is traveling on the donkey, a lion attacks the man of God and kills him. A lion is a dangerous wild animal. The body of the man of God lies on the road, and it is very surprising that the lion does not eat the body of the man of God or attack the donkey, and that the donkey does not run away from the lion. It is clear that Yahweh caused the lion to attack the man of God, and that the man of God did not die by accident!

Stop here and look at a picture of a lion as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: What dangerous animals do you have in your community? What do those animals do to the body of a person that they kill? Tell a story about a time when a dangerous animal injured you or someone you know. Pause this audio here.

Some people are also traveling on the same road and pass by the body of the man of God, with the lion standing next to the body. This is very surprising to these people! These people go to the city of Bethel, and they tell people in Bethel about the lion and the dead body.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time you heard surprising news about an event in your town, city, or community. Who told you the news? How fast did you hear the news after the event happened? Pause this audio here.

The old prophet also hears about the lion and the dead body, and the old prophet knows that the dead person is the man of God. The old prophet says that Yahweh gave the man of God to the lion, exactly how Yahweh warned the man of God. During the time of the man of God, if someone did not keep their promise or "oath," people believed that the person's god or gods would send a lion to eat that person. The old prophet knows that Yahweh punished the man of God for disobeying Yahweh's commands.

The old prophet tells his sons to put a saddle on his donkey for him, and the sons prepare the donkey. The old prophet rides the donkey to the place where the body of the man of God is lying on the road and where the lion and the donkey are standing next to the body. The old prophet sees that the lion did not eat the dead body or attack the donkey. Yahweh prevented the lion from eating the donkey or the dead body of the man of God. Yahweh also prevented the donkey from running away. This shows that Yahweh controlled both the lion and the donkey, and Yahweh is the one who punished the man of God.

The old prophet puts the dead body of the man of God on the donkey, and the old prophet brings the dead body back to Bethel. The old prophet mourns for the man of God, and he puts the body of the man of God into his own family tomb. It is possible that the sons of the old prophet or other people also mourned the man of God. In the time of the old prophet, to "mourn" meant to show grief by weeping and crying loudly. The old prophet says, "Oh my brother! How sad!" because the old prophet feels very sad that the man of God died.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you mourn when someone dies in your community? Pause this audio here.

The old prophet tells his sons, "When I die, bury me in the same tomb as this man of God from Judah." When people buried bodies during the time of the old prophet, they put the bodies on stone shelves inside a tomb they dug out of the hillside. Then, later, the people put the bones in a pit under the shelves and reused the tomb. Bones from different bodies would mix together so that it would be impossible to tell the bones apart from the different bodies. It is possible that the old prophet wants his own body to be close to the bones of the man of God in order to honor the man of God, or so that the old prophet's bones are close to someone who heard a true word from Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember your discussion from the previous passage about how and where you bury someone's body when they die. Where do you bury the dead bodies of people from the same family? Pause this audio here.

The old prophet also honors the man of God when he says that he knows the prophecy, or "word from Yahweh," that the man of God spoke will come true. The man of God spoke against the altar in Bethel and against the temples in the high places of the towns of Samaria. In this story, Samaria means the area of the 10 northern tribes of Israel. Yahweh will definitely keep his promise to destroy the altar in Bethel someday because Yahweh punished the man of God for not obeying the command of Yahweh. This is probably the most important message of this story because the storyteller shows that even if Yahweh's prophet fails to obey Yahweh, Yahweh's word will never fail.

In the final part of the story, the storyteller tells us King Jeroboam's reaction to all of the things in this story and in the previous stories. People might think that King Jeroboam will change his mind after the man of God warns him, and after a lion kills that same man of God for not obeying the command of Yahweh. But King Jeroboam continues to do evil.

King Jeroboam continues to choose anyone he wants to be priests for the high places that King Jeroboam makes. Remember that Yahweh said in the law of Moses that only Levites should be priests. This is the sin of the house, or family, of Jeroboam. The storyteller says that because of Jeroboam's sin, Yahweh will later destroy Jeroboam's family.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The man of God leaves on a donkey. A lion attacks and kills the man of God. The lion does not eat the body of the man of God or the donkey.

In the second scene: Some people see the body of the man of God lying in the road, and the lion and donkey standing next to the body. The old prophet hears about the death of the man of God, and the old prophet knows that Yahweh caused the man of God to die.

In the third scene: The old prophet goes to get the body of the man of God. The old prophet brings the body back to Bethel to bury the body. The old prophet mourns the man of God.

In the fourth scene: The old prophet tells his sons that he wants his sons to bury his own body with the man of God. The old prophet says that the message the man of God spoke against the altar at Bethel will happen exactly as the man of God says it will happen.

In the fifth scene: Jeroboam still did not change his evil ways. Jeroboam still chose priests from among the people, which became a great sin. In the future, Yahweh will destroy Jeroboam's family because of Jeroboam's sin.

The characters in this passage are:

- The old prophet
- The sons of the old prophet
- The man of God
- Yahweh
- People who pass by on the road
- King Jeroboam
- And the priests whom King Jeroboam chooses

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that this is the second part of a two-part story. In the previous story, the old prophet invited the man of God to eat with the old prophet in Bethel. The old prophet lied to the man of God, and the man of God went to eat with the old prophet. At the end of the story, the old prophet hears a message from Yahweh that people will not bury the man of God in the tomb of his family. Now, the man of God leaves the old prophet's house, and the man of God starts to travel back to Judah.

In the first scene, the man of God finishes eating and drinking with the old prophet. Then, the old prophet, who had brought the man of God back to Bethel, saddles a donkey for the man of God to ride. We do not know if the donkey belongs to the old prophet or to the man of God. It may be best to be unclear in your language about whether the donkey belongs to the man of God or to the old prophet.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a donkey and a saddle again, if needed. Pause this audio here.

The man of God travels on the donkey. Then, a lion attacks and kills the man of God, and the body of the man of God lies in the road. Remember that the lion does not eat the body of the man of God, which is surprising. The lion also does not attack or eat the donkey. Remember that this shows that Yahweh is the one who sent the lion to attack the man of God, and Yahweh prevented the lion from attacking the donkey or eating the body of the man of God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show that the lion unexpectedly attacked the man of God? How will you show that it was surprising that the lion did not eat the body of the man of God or attack the donkey? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, some people pass by the body of the man of God with the lion standing next to the body. In the original language, the storyteller shows that the people are surprised that the lion does not eat the dead body on the road. The donkey is probably also there, but the storyteller does not say that the people see the donkey in this part of the passage.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show that the people are surprised that the lion is standing next to the dead body, and the lion is not eating the dead body? Pause this audio here.

The people go back to the city of Bethel and tell people in Bethel about what they saw on the road. The old prophet also hears about the dead body and the lion, and the old prophet says the dead person must be the man of God who disobeyed Yahweh. In the original language, the old prophet says that "the man of God rebelled against the mouth of Yahweh," which means the man of God did not do what Yahweh said to do. The old prophet also says that Yahweh gave the man of God to the lion, and the lion tore the body of the man of God, or broke the bones of the body of the man of God. Remember that this happened exactly as Yahweh warned the man of God in the message in the first part of this story.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the idea that Yahweh gave the man of God to the lion? Other translation ideas include, "Yahweh caused the lion to attack the man of God," or "Yahweh sent a lion to attack the man of God." Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the old prophet tells his sons to saddle a donkey for him. The sons prepare the donkey, and the old prophet rides the donkey to see the dead body of the man of God. The old prophet also sees the lion and the donkey standing next to the body. Then, the old prophet puts the body on the donkey. We do not know if the old prophet puts the body on the donkey that the man of God had been riding, or if the old prophet puts the body on his own donkey that is with the old prophet. Then, the old prophet goes back to Bethel to bury the body

in the old prophet's own family tomb. Remember that this fulfills the message from Yahweh that people will not bury the man of God in his own family tomb.

The old prophet mourns for the man of God, which probably includes weeping and crying. The old prophet says, "Oh my brother! How sad!" This does not mean that the old prophet is literally the brother of the man of God. "Brother" is a term of affection and respect that one Israelite would often use to address another Israelite.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show the grief and sadness of the old prophet? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the old prophet tells his sons to bury him in the same tomb as the man of God from Judah. Remember that people buried several bodies in the same family tomb. The old prophet says the reason he wants people to bury his body in the same tomb as the man of God is that the old prophet knows that the prophecy of the man of God will come true. Remember the prophecy that the man of God spoke against the altar in a previous story. The old prophet now knows that prophecy is true, or came from Yahweh, because Yahweh has punished the man of God for not following Yahweh's instructions. However, we are not sure whether the altar of Bethel broke apart on that same day or whether the prophecy came true later, when King Josiah became king. The old prophet also says that the man of God spoke against the high places in the towns of Samaria. Samaria probably means the area of the 10 northern tribes of Israel, and not the city of Samaria, because people had not built Samaria yet when the storyteller is telling this story.

In the fifth scene, the storyteller tells the reaction of King Jeroboam. King Jeroboam was not in this story, but King Jeroboam was in the previous passage when the man of God came to speak against the altar in Bethel. Remember that people might expect that King Jeroboam would stop doing evil things after Yahweh sent a man of God to warn King Jeroboam, and even after Yahweh sent a lion to kill the same man of God for disobeying Yahweh's commands. But King Jeroboam still continues to do evil things.

The main way King Jeroboam does evil things is by choosing priests for the high places himself, without asking Yahweh. King Jeroboam chooses anyone he wants to be a priest. In the original language, the storyteller says that King Jeroboam "fills the hand of anyone who wants to become a priest." This could mean that King Jeroboam puts gifts in the hands of new priests, but it is not clear.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate the idea that King Jeroboam chooses or appoints anyone he wants to be a priest? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also says that King Jeroboam sins when he chooses priests according to his own ideas. When King Jeroboam sins, he causes Yahweh to destroy his "house," or descendants. In the original language, the storyteller says that someone, probably Yahweh, will cut off Jeroboam's family from the face of the earth. This means that no descendants of Jeroboam will live on the earth anymore. Yahweh will punish Jeroboam because Yahweh does not want anyone to change the way people worship Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the idea that someone, probably Yahweh, will completely destroy King Jeroboam's family in the future? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The old prophet
- The sons of the old prophet
- The man of God
- Yahweh

- People who pass by on the road
- King Jeroboam
- And the priests whom King Jeroboam chooses

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

After the man of God finishes eating and drinking, the old prophet saddles a donkey for the man of God to ride. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the old prophet, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel guilty that I lied to the man of God; or
- I want to honor the man of God by saddling this donkey myself. I do not want to ask my sons to saddle the donkey for my visitor; or
- I will give the man of God my own donkey so that the man of God will have an easier journey back to Judah. Maybe Yahweh will be merciful to me, and to the man of God. I feel responsible that the man of God disobeyed the command of Yahweh because the man of God believed my lie to come and eat with me at my house; or
- I hope that the man of God arrives home safely in Judah.

Continue the drama. The man of God continues on his journey back to Judah. Then suddenly, a lion comes and attacks the man of God. The lion kills the man of God, and the man of God falls off his donkey. The body of the man of God lies in the road, and the lion and the donkey stand next to the body. The lion does not attack the donkey, and the lion does not eat the body of the man of God. Some people pass by the body in the road, with the lion next to the body. These people go to Bethel and tell other people about the body and the lion. Bethel is where the old prophet also lives. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people who pass by on the road, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are shocked that this dead body is lying in the road, and the lion is not eating it! This is another miracle! or
- We wonder who this dead person is lying on the road; or
- We do not want to touch this dead body, but if we tell everyone in Bethel about this dead body, maybe the relatives of this dead person will come and get the body.

Continue the drama. The old prophet hears the news that there is a dead body in the road, and a lion standing next to the dead body. The old prophet says, "This dead man is the man of God who disobeyed Yahweh's command. Yahweh gave this man of God to the lion, and the lion attacked him and killed him. This happened just as Yahweh said it would happen." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the old prophet, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know that this dead man is the man of God that I saw recently; or
- I feel guilty that I caused the death of the man of God; or
- I am disappointed that the man of God did not arrive home safely.

Continue the drama. The old prophet tells his sons to saddle a donkey for him, and the sons saddle a donkey for the old prophet. Then the old prophet rides the donkey to the place where the dead body of the man of God is. The donkey and the lion are standing next to the dead body, and the lion has not eaten the body of the man of God or attacked the donkey. The old prophet picks up the dead body and puts it on a donkey. Then the old prophet goes back to Bethel. The old prophet puts the dead body of the man of God in his tomb, and the old

prophet mourns for the man of God. The old prophet says, “Oh my brother, my brother!” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the old prophet, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am really sad that the man of God died; or
- I feel ashamed because I lied to the man of God to convince him to come back to Bethel with me; or
- I am honored to bury this man of God in my own grave.

Continue the drama. After the old prophet buries the body of the man of God, the old prophet tells his sons, “After I die, bury me in this same tomb with the dead body of the man of God. Put my bones next to his bones. Everything that Yahweh told this man of God to say against the altar in Bethel will come true. Also, everything that Yahweh told this man of God to say against the high places in the towns of Samaria will come true.” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the old prophet, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want my body to be near the body of the man of God because I want to honor the man of God; or
- This man of God spoke the truth about the altar in Bethel, and I want my bones to be with a true prophet of Yahweh after I die; or
- I am old, and I know that I will die soon. I want my sons to know that I want to be buried near this man of God.

Also, ask the people playing the sons of the old prophet, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We feel guilty that we told our father about the man of God. Maybe the man of God would not have died if we had not told our father what happened in Bethel; or
- We are confused about what happened. Why did our father lie to the man of God to get the man of God to come back to Bethel to eat and drink with him? or
- We know that to obey Yahweh is very important. We need to listen to what Yahweh says to do and not listen to messages from anyone else.

Continue the drama. After all this happens, King Jeroboam still does not stop doing evil things. King Jeroboam continues to choose priests from the common people to serve at the high places. This is the sin of the family of Jeroboam. Eventually, Yahweh destroys Jeroboam’s family. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Jeroboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I do not care what this man of God did or what he said to me. I want to choose my own priests and make my own way to worship Yahweh; or
- I am surprised to hear that the man of God died on the way back to Judah. Maybe that means that the message from the man of God was not important for me; or
- I think that Yahweh should let anyone be a priest who wants to be a priest.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 13:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The old prophet and the man of God finish eating bread together. Remember that in this story, bread means food in general.

Stop here and decide how you will talk about food, or **bread**, in this story. Pause this audio here.

The old **prophet saddles** a **donkey** for the **man of God**. The man of God is also a prophet. A prophet is a person who gives messages from Yahweh to the people. A donkey is an animal that is big enough to carry heavy loads or people. A saddle is a seat or cloth that people use on a donkey to make it more comfortable to ride the donkey. Translate man of God, prophet, and donkey the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on prophet and donkey, refer to the Master Glossary. Also, be sure to translate “saddle the donkey” the same as you did in the previous passage.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a donkey and a saddle again, if needed. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 13:23–34

The man of God continues on his way back to Judah. Then, a **lion** attacks and kills the man of God. A lion is a dangerous wild animal. Translate lion the same as you have in previous passages.

Some people see the dead body of the man of God in the road, and the lion and the donkey standing next to the dead body. These people go back to the **city** of Bethel to tell other people about what they saw on the road. A city is larger than a village, and it has walls around it. Translate "city" the same as you have in previous passages.

The old prophet says that the message that the man of God spoke against the **altar** in Bethel will come true. The man of God spoke this message **by the word of Yahweh**, which means the man of God spoke with the authority of Yahweh. Yahweh is the personal name of God. An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to God. Translate "by the word of Yahweh" and "altar" the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on word, Yahweh, and altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

The man of God also spoke against the **high places** of **Samaria**. At high places, people made sacrifices to idols or other gods. People also made shrines, or houses for the idols. High places were often on hills, or raised areas of land, but not all "high places" were in the hills. Samaria is a city in the north of Israel. In this passage, Samaria probably means the area of the 10 northern tribes of Israel, and not the city of Samaria, because people had not built the city of Samaria yet when the storyteller is telling this story. Translate high places the same as you have in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate "**Samaria**" in this passage? For more information on Samaria, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The old prophet puts the body of the man of God in the old prophet's family "**grave**," or tomb. Translate tomb the same as you did in the previous passage, and refer to tomb in the Master Glossary for more information.

King Jeroboam does not change his **evil** ways. Evil is the opposite of good. Jeroboam does evil when he chooses **priests** in his own way for his high places. Priests make sacrifices to Yahweh, and only Levites should become priests for Yahweh. This is the **sin** of the house, or family, of Jeroboam. Sin is when people disobey Yahweh's laws. In this passage, Jeroboam sins when he does not obey Yahweh's laws about who can become a priest for Yahweh. Translate evil, priests, and sin the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on evil, priests, and sin, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 13:23–34

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (832 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Kings 14:1–11

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 14:1–11 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:1–11 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, the storyteller told how King Jeroboam of Israel continued to disobey Yahweh even after Yahweh sent a prophet to warn Jeroboam. Instead of worshiping Yahweh in the way Yahweh commanded, Jeroboam chose common people to serve the false gods as priests at the shrines. So the storyteller said that because of Jeroboam's great sin, Yahweh would destroy Jeroboam and take the kingdom away from Jeroboam.

The storyteller begins this story when he says that Jeroboam's son Abijah becomes very sick. We do not know exactly when this story happens, but the storyteller says in this story that the prophet Ahijah is now a blind old man. You will remember from an earlier story that Ahijah was the prophet who prophesied that Jeroboam would become king over 10 of the tribes of Israel, so a number of years have probably passed since the last story happened.

King Jeroboam gives his wife some instructions. First, Jeroboam tells his wife to disguise herself. This may mean to make herself look like someone other than the king's wife, or perhaps to cover her face so no one will recognize her. Then Jeroboam tells his wife to travel to see the prophet Ahijah at Shiloh. We know that King Jeroboam lived at Tirzah, which was a city about 10 kilometers northeast of the city of Shechem. We also know that Shiloh was north of Bethel, along the road that people would travel between Shechem in the north and Jerusalem in the south.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Israel. Find Tirzah and Shiloh on the map. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam also tells his wife to take with her 10 loaves of bread, some cakes, which are a type of food that people press flat, and a jar of honey. In Israel at this time, people who went to see a prophet would usually take a gift to give to that prophet. This gift that Jeroboam's wife will take is a small gift, like a common person in Israel

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could afford, so no one will guess because of the gift that she is a king's wife. Finally, Jeroboam tells his wife that when she arrives in Shiloh, she must ask Ahijah what will happen to her son.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who do people talk to if they need spiritual advice or want to know what might happen in the future? How do people pay for this kind of advice? Pause this audio here.

So Jeroboam's wife travels to Ahijah's home in Shiloh just as Jeroboam told her to do. The storyteller says that Ahijah is now an old man, and Ahijah can no longer see. Although the storyteller does not say this, it should be easy for Jeroboam's wife to deceive Ahijah since Ahijah is blind. But before Jeroboam's wife arrives, Yahweh tells Ahijah that Jeroboam's wife is coming and that she will pretend to be someone else. Yahweh also tells Ahijah that Jeroboam's wife will ask Ahijah about her son, because her son is very sick. And Yahweh tells Ahijah that Ahijah must tell Jeroboam's wife all that Yahweh tells Ahijah to say.

When Jeroboam's wife arrives, she pretends to be someone other than the king's wife. But as soon as Ahijah hears Jeroboam's wife walk into the house, Ahijah speaks and says, "Come in, Jeroboam's wife. Why do you pretend to be someone else?" Then Ahijah tells Jeroboam's wife that Ahijah has bad news to tell her and that she must tell Jeroboam this message from Yahweh, the God of Israel: First, Ahijah says Yahweh reminds Jeroboam that Jeroboam was a common person like everybody else, but that it was Yahweh who made Jeroboam king. Yahweh reminds Jeroboam how Yahweh took the kingdom away from the ancestors of David and gave it to Jeroboam. Although Ahijah does not say this, you will remember that Yahweh took the kingdom away from David's ancestors because those ancestors did not obey Yahweh as David did. However, instead of obeying Yahweh's commands and serving Yahweh as David did, Jeroboam did even more evil than the other kings who lived before Jeroboam. Jeroboam has made idols out of metal and has served false gods instead of Yahweh. This has made Yahweh very angry, because Jeroboam has rejected Yahweh and treated Yahweh like Yahweh is worthless.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a new leader who replaced a leader whom people did not like. How was the new leader? Was he or she better or worse than the old leader, and how did people feel about the new leader? Pause this audio here.

Because of the evil things that Jeroboam has done, Yahweh says he will destroy Jeroboam's family. Yahweh will kill every man and boy in Jeroboam's family. Just like people burn up animal manure in the fire so that nothing is left, Yahweh will completely destroy Jeroboam's family so that nothing is left. Dogs will eat the bodies of Jeroboam's family members who die in cities or towns, and birds will eat the bodies of the family members who die in the countryside or places outside the towns and cities. This is the message that Yahweh sends to Jeroboam.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: King Jeroboam's son becomes sick, so Jeroboam tells his wife to go ask the prophet Ahijah what will happen to the boy. Jeroboam tells his wife to pretend she is someone else so Ahijah will not know she is the king's wife.

In the second scene: God tells Ahijah that Jeroboam's wife is coming to see Ahijah. Yahweh also tells Ahijah what Ahijah must say to Jeroboam's wife so that she can then go tell Jeroboam.

In the third scene: Ahijah tells Jeroboam's wife that Yahweh is very angry with Jeroboam. Yahweh made Jeroboam king, but instead of worshiping Yahweh, Jeroboam has done evil and made the people of Israel turn away from Yahweh. So, all of Jeroboam's male descendants will die, and Jeroboam's family will no longer lead the kingdom.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jeroboam
- Jeroboam's son, Abijah
- Jeroboam's wife
- Ahijah the prophet
- Yahweh
- People of Israel
- Jeroboam's male descendants
- Dogs
- And birds of the air

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller begins and says, "At that time Jeroboam's son Abijah became very sick." We are not sure exactly what time the storyteller means. However, it may be that a few years have passed since the stories in the last passage, because the storyteller is about to mention that the prophet Ahijah, whom we learned about in an earlier story, is now old and blind.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you talk about the way time passes over many, many years? When you tell a story that happened a long time ago, how do you tell people approximately when that story happened without being specific? Pause this audio here.

Although the storyteller does not use the word "king," we know this is the same King Jeroboam from the last story. Jeroboam gives his wife several instructions. First, Jeroboam says, "Arise." This does not necessarily mean that Jeroboam's wife is sitting down, but just that she should get ready to take action. Next, Jeroboam tells his wife to disguise herself so that no one will know that she is Jeroboam's wife. Jeroboam probably means that his wife should put on clothing that common people wear instead of the rich clothing that Jeroboam's wife would normally wear as a queen. Jeroboam may also mean that Jeroboam's wife should cover her head and part of her face with a cloth, since women often dressed this way in this time.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a woman who has covered her head and part of her face with a cloth, like a woman might have done in ancient Israel. Pause this audio here.

Next, Jeroboam tells his wife to go to Shiloh, where Ahijah the prophet is. Jeroboam says this is the same Ahijah who once told Jeroboam that Jeroboam would become the next king. Jeroboam also tells his wife to take some specific things with her. First, Jeroboam's wife must take 10 loaves, which means the kind of bread that rises and becomes soft when people cook it. Second, Jeroboam's wife must take some cakes. Jeroboam does not say which type of cakes Jeroboam means. In Jeroboam's time, although cakes could refer to a type of flat or non-rising bread that people cooked with oil or honey, cakes could also mean dried fruit like raisins or dates that people would mash together into small flat disks. Third, Jeroboam says to take a jar full of honey or a similar sweet liquid. The storyteller does not say that Jeroboam tells his wife what to do with these items, but we know that at this time, people always took a gift with them when they visited a prophet or spiritual leader like Ahijah.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of loaves of bread, flat cakes of raisins and dates, and a jar with honey. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Jeroboam tells his wife to go to Ahijah and ask what will happen to Abijah, the child. In the original language, the word that people translate as "child" could refer to either a young man or to a baby only a few months old. So we are not sure how old Abijah was at the time of this story.

Jeroboam's wife follows Jeroboam's instructions and goes to Shiloh. However, before Jeroboam's wife arrives, the storyteller tells us about Ahijah. First, the storyteller gives some background information that Ahijah cannot see because Ahijah's eyes are dim from age. In the original language, this may mean not only that Ahijah is blind and unable to see, but also that Ahijah's eyes do not move and that he stares straight ahead.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about someone who is old and blind. How do you describe how this person looks or behaves? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that Yahweh speaks to Ahijah and says that Jeroboam's wife is coming and will ask about her son, who is sick. Yahweh also tells Ahijah what Ahijah must say to Jeroboam's wife. However, instead of

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repeating Yahweh's actual words, the storyteller says that Yahweh says, "Thus and thus you shall say to her." "Thus and thus" is special storyteller language. This is a way to quote someone or show that the person spoke without saying that person's actual words.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you tell a story in your language, how do you show that someone said something without saying that person's actual words? Why might you do this? Pause this audio here.

When Jeroboam's wife arrives, Ahijah hears the sound of her feet coming in at the door. The sound of someone's feet is the sound we hear when someone's feet hit or scrape against the ground when that person walks. Ahijah says, "Come in, wife of Jeroboam. Why do you try to look like someone else?" This is not a question Ahijah expects Jeroboam's wife to answer. Instead, Ahijah asks this question to show that Ahijah already knows who Jeroboam's wife is. Then Ahijah says that Yahweh has "sent" Ahijah to Jeroboam's wife with very bad news. Ahijah has not left his house, but Ahijah means that Yahweh himself gave Ahijah this bad news.

Now Ahijah quotes the exact words that Yahweh told Ahijah to say. First, Ahijah says, "I, Yahweh, exalted you from among the people and appointed you ruler over my people Israel." To exalt means to raise or lift up, so here Yahweh is saying that Jeroboam did not become a king because Jeroboam was special or powerful, but because Yahweh chose Jeroboam.

Next, Ahijah quotes, "I tore the kingdom of Israel away from the family of David and let you rule instead." To tear away means to remove something by force in a way that damages that thing, like a person who tears a piece of fabric.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Remind each other of how you talk about what happens when a person tears a piece of fabric. If possible, have someone in the group tear some fabric while the group watches. Then talk about what you saw, felt, or heard. Pause this audio here.

Ahijah continues and says, "But you are not like my servant David, who kept my commands and followed me with all his heart. David only did what pleased me." You will remember that for the Israelites, the heart represented the place where a person's thoughts, feelings, and decisions happen. So Yahweh is saying that David thought about Yahweh and wanted to do what Yahweh said was right, but Jeroboam has ignored Yahweh and instead does what is evil. In fact, Ahijah quotes, "You have done more evil than all who lived before you. You have made for yourself other gods from metal, and you have provoked me to anger by rejecting me." To provoke means to cause someone to have a strong feeling of grief, anger, or wrath.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about someone who did or said something that caused another person to feel very angry. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also says that Jeroboam has cast Yahweh behind Jeroboam's back. This is special language that shows how Jeroboam has totally abandoned or rejected Yahweh.

Ahijah continues to quote Yahweh and says, "Because of this, I am going to bring disaster on the house of Jeroboam." Here, Yahweh begins to talk about Jeroboam as if Jeroboam were another person, but Yahweh is still speaking to Jeroboam. In ancient Israel, people commonly talked in this formal way when they made an important promise. "I will cut off from Jeroboam every last male in Israel—slave or free." Here, to cut off means to kill, and the word "slave" probably does not refer to actual slaves, but rather to young men or boys who were still under their father's authority. Some people think these words mean that literally every male in Israel will die, but we know this does not happen. Instead, it seems more likely that it only means that every male in Jeroboam's household will die.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a man's two sons—one young son who is not yet old enough to get married and who still lives in his father's house, and one older son who is married and lives in his own house with his own family. Pay attention to the words you use to describe each son. Pause this audio here.

Ahijah quotes: "I will burn the house of Jeroboam as people burn manure. It will all be gone." In that culture, people often mixed animal manure with straw and allowed it to dry so that people could then use it as a slow-burning fuel for cooking. So this may be what Yahweh means. However, in the original language, these words

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could also mean to sweep away dung. Either way, Yahweh shows how offensive Jeroboam and Jeroboam's family are to Yahweh by comparing them to animal dung. "Dogs will eat the people of Jeroboam's family who die in a city, and the birds of the air will eat those who die in the country." In that culture, it was common for dogs to roam the streets without owners. These dogs would be very wild and hungry and would often eat dead things. Also, in the original language, "birds of the air" refers to the kind of birds that eat meat or dead things. These things would be very shameful to the Israelites, because in Israelite culture, people honored someone when they buried them. So this was one of the worst punishments people could imagine.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about someone who received a very shameful punishment for something that person did wrong. Pay attention to the words you use to describe this shame. Also, pay attention to the way your audience responds when you talk about this shame. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Ahijah quotes, "Yahweh has spoken!" With these final words, Yahweh shows that Yahweh will do exactly what Yahweh has just promised, and this is certain because Yahweh always does what Yahweh says.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jeroboam
- Jeroboam's son, Abijah
- Jeroboam's wife
- Ahijah the prophet
- Yahweh
- People of Israel
- Jeroboam's male descendants
- Dogs
- And birds of the air

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

At a certain time, Jeroboam's son Abijah gets very sick. So Jeroboam says to his wife, "Go and change clothes so that no one will see that you are the wife of King Jeroboam. Then go to the city of Shiloh, where you will find Ahijah the prophet, who told me that I would become king over Israel. Take 10 loaves of bread, and also some cakes and a jar of honey, and go see Ahijah. Ask Ahijah if your child will get well again. Ahijah will be able to tell you."

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- I am worried about our son Abijah, but I hope Ahijah will say our son will get well. Then I will not feel worried anymore; or
- The gods and idols I serve cannot tell me if my son will get well, but I remember that Yahweh can tell Ahijah things like that; or
- I need Ahijah's help, but because I have disobeyed Yahweh, I am afraid Ahijah will get angry if I ask. Maybe Ahijah will not know it is my son if my wife pretends to be someone else.

Continue the drama.

But before Jeroboam's wife arrives, Yahweh speaks and tells Ahijah that Jeroboam's wife is coming and that she will pretend to be someone else. Then Yahweh tells Ahijah a message that Ahijah must speak to Jeroboam's wife from Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very angry! I made Jeroboam king so that Israel would worship me, but instead, Jeroboam worships false gods and metal idols; or
- Jeroboam cannot trick Yahweh, the God of Israel. I know all of the evil things Jeroboam is thinking and doing.

Ask the person playing Ahijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Jeroboam's wife will probably be surprised and afraid when I say I know who she is and why she came. But she will be even more afraid when I tell her what Yahweh said; or
- Jeroboam probably thinks he is very clever and can easily trick an old, blind man like me. But Jeroboam forgets that I serve Yahweh, and Yahweh sees everything.

Continue the drama.

When Jeroboam's wife arrives, and Ahijah hears her coming, Ahijah says, "Come in, wife of Jeroboam. Why are you trying to hide who you are?" Then Ahijah tells Jeroboam's wife that Ahijah has a terrible message from Yahweh that she must tell Jeroboam. "I, Yahweh, raised you up from among the ordinary people to be the king of my people Israel. I even took David's kingdom away from David's descendants and gave it to you. But you are not like David, who served me, Yahweh. David obeyed my commands and lived to serve me and do what pleases me. The rulers of Israel before you did some evil things, but you have done much worse. You have made me furious by making metal images of false gods and abandoning me, Yahweh. So listen, Jeroboam! I am about to destroy your family! I will make sure that every single man and boy in your family dies. I will throw them all away as if they were dung. Dogs will eat the dead bodies of your relatives in the towns, and birds will eat the bodies of your relatives in the field. I, Yahweh, have declared this will happen!"

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam's wife, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am terrified! When I came, I was only afraid for our son Abijah. But now this prophet says that every one of our male family members will die too! or
- I do not know much about Yahweh because we worship other gods. But Yahweh must be very powerful to tell Ahijah all of these things, even before I came.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am usually very patient and give the Israelites many chances to change and obey me. But Jeroboam has gone too far!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

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In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

When Jeroboam's son Abijah becomes sick, Jeroboam tells Jeroboam's wife to disguise herself and go to Shiloh. To disguise yourself means to change your normal appearance or cover yourself so that people will not recognize you.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **disguise**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

You will remember that **Shiloh** was once a very important city for the Israelites. Before King David moved the ark of the covenant to Jerusalem, and Solomon later built the temple, people went to Shiloh, where the tabernacle was, to worship Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for Shiloh as you used in previous passages.

Jeroboam tells his wife that in Shiloh, she must go to see the **prophet** Ahijah. A prophet is a person who gives messages from God to the people. This message can be an instruction from God about something that needs to be done, or it can be a message that tells about something that is going to happen in the future. But most of the time, these messages were warnings to people to stop disobeying God. Use the same word or phrase for prophet as you used in previous passages. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells Ahijah that Jeroboam's wife is coming to see Ahijah. **God** is the general name people use to talk about the most powerful spiritual being who created everything, but Yahweh is a name that God gives himself. When people hear the name Yahweh, they are reminded especially of the covenant, the special promise that God had made with the Israelites at the time of Moses. In this passage, Yahweh reminds Jeroboam's wife that Yahweh is the God of Israel. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ahijah begins to give Yahweh's message to Jeroboam's wife so that she can later tell it to Jeroboam. First, Yahweh says that Yahweh exalted Jeroboam among the people. To exalt means to put someone in a place of high honor or to raise that person above others in power or position.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about Yahweh **exalting**, or **raising up**, Jeroboam to be king. Pause this audio here.

A **kingdom** is the territory or the people that a king rules. Use the same word for kingdom as you used in previous passages. For more information on kingdom, refer to the Master Glossary.

The **house of David** refers not to a building, but to the people who belong to David. You will remember that David was an important king in Israel's history. Here, "house of David" refers specifically to the descendants of King David. Use the same word for "house of David" as you used in previous passages. For more information on "house of David," refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that David was Yahweh's **servant** who kept Yahweh's **commandments**. A servant is a person who does work for someone else, and a commandment is a law, a rule, or an instruction. David was Yahweh's servant because he did the things Yahweh told him to do. God gives commandments to people to show people how to live well, in a good relationship with God and with others. Use the same words for servant and commandment as you used in previous passages. For more information on servant and commandment, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that David followed Yahweh with all of David's **heart** and did what was right in Yahweh's **eyes**. You will remember that in the Bible, the heart is special language that means the place where a person's thoughts, feelings, and decisions happen. And to do right in someone's eyes is special language that means to do what pleases that person. Use the same words or phrases for heart and doing what is right in the eyes of Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on heart, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that Jeroboam has done evil. Evil is the opposite of good. A person who is evil willingly does bad things that hurt other people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **evil**. Look up evil in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 14:1–11

Yahweh says that Jeroboam has made **gods** and metal images. These are not the true God, Yahweh, the most powerful spiritual being. Instead, these are other spirit beings or false gods that people worship as if they have power. Use the same word or phrase for god as you used in previous passages. For more information on god, refer to the Master Glossary.

Sometimes people make statues or metal images to represent these false gods. Here, Jeroboam probably did not make these gold or silver idols himself but instead ordered craftsmen to make the images.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **metal images**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. For more information, look up idols in the Master Glossary. Although this is a slightly different word in the original language, some translations use the same word for idols here, so you may choose to do the same. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says he will destroy, or bring disaster to, Jeroboam's **household**. For more information, look up household in the Master Glossary. This is the same concept as "house of David" earlier in this passage. Use the same word or phrase for house or household when it means someone's descendants as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 14:1–11

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (868 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (9.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 14:12–20

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 14:12–20 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:12–20 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, King Jeroboam's son got sick, so Jeroboam sent his wife to the prophet Ahijah to find out what would happen to the child. Even though Jeroboam's wife pretended to be someone else, Yahweh had already told Ahijah who she was and what to say. So Ahijah spoke Yahweh's message to Jeroboam's wife so she could take the message to Jeroboam. In that message, Yahweh said he was very angry with Jeroboam because Jeroboam had led Israel to worship idols instead of Yahweh. Yahweh also said he would kill Jeroboam's male descendants, and that wild animals would eat the bodies. Then Jeroboam's family would no longer lead Israel. This was Yahweh's message to Jeroboam.

Now, in this story, Ahijah continues to speak to Jeroboam's wife, but instead of speaking Yahweh's words, Ahijah now speaks Ahijah's own words. First, Ahijah tells Jeroboam's wife that she must go back to her home. You will remember that Ahijah's home is in the city of Shiloh, but Jeroboam and Jeroboam's wife live in the city of Tirzah, which is north of Shiloh.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Israel. Find Shiloh and Tirzah on the map. Pause this audio here.

Before Jeroboam's wife goes back home, Ahijah tells Jeroboam's wife what will happen. As soon as Jeroboam's wife enters the city, the child Abijah will die. Then all the people of Israel will mourn, or weep and cry, because Abijah has died, and people will bury Abijah's body. But Abijah is the only one in Jeroboam's family who people will bury in this respectful way. This is because Abijah is the only person in Jeroboam's family who has done anything to make Yahweh happy. You will remember from the last story that Yahweh said all the males in Jeroboam's family would die, and that no one would bury their bodies. Instead, wild animals would eat their bodies. So Abijah is the only one in Jeroboam's family who will not suffer that great shame.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When someone in your community dies, what do you do with that person's body? How do you show honor and respect for that person? How do you show your sadness? Pause this audio here.

Abijah says that after that, Yahweh will raise up another king who will replace the family of Jeroboam as ruler over Israel. We will not hear more about this king until a later story, but we know that Ahijah is talking about Baasha, the man who will later kill King Nadab, Jeroboam's son. Then Baasha will make himself the new king of Israel. You will remember that at this time, the land was divided into two kingdoms: the kingdom of Israel in the north and the kingdom of Judah in the south. And so another person will replace Jeroboam's family as the king of the northern kingdom of Israel, just as Yahweh promised.

Now Ahijah uses special language to describe how Yahweh will punish Israel. First, Ahijah says that Yahweh will strike Israel like a person shakes a reed or a special type of long, thick grass that grows in the water. Yahweh will uproot Israel from the land Yahweh gave their ancestors. This means that Yahweh will force the people to

go somewhere else. And finally, Ahijah says that Yahweh will scatter the people of Israel beyond the Euphrates. This means that Yahweh will force the people to go to a land east of Israel, across the Euphrates River. Although Ahijah does not give any more details in this story, this probably refers to the story we find in 2 Kings chapter 17, where the Assyrians will conquer the northern kingdom of Israel and take the people to Assyria.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Israel and the countries that surround Israel. Find the Euphrates River and the land east of it. Pause this audio here.

Ahijah says that Yahweh will do these things to Israel because the people made Yahweh very angry when they made idols of the goddess Asherah. Asherah was the goddess of fertility whom the Canaanite people who lived in the land before the Israelites worshiped. And so Yahweh will give up or abandon the people of Israel because Jeroboam sinned and caused the people to sin.

So Jeroboam's wife left Ahijah and traveled back to Tirzah. And as soon as Jeroboam's wife entered the house, the boy Abijah died. And people buried Abijah, and all the people of Israel mourned and cried, just like Yahweh said would happen.

The storyteller says we can learn more about everything else Jeroboam did, including the battles Jeroboam fought and how Jeroboam ruled as king, in the book called "The History of the Kings of Israel." However, we know that this book no longer exists.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you remember and share stories or information about things that happened long ago? What happens if people lose or forget this information? Pause this audio here.

Finally, the storyteller says that Jeroboam ruled as king for 22 years. Then Jeroboam died, and Jeroboam's son Nadab became the next king.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Ahijah tells Jeroboam's wife to go home. Then Abijah will die, and people will bury Abijah's body. But people will not bury anyone else from Jeroboam's family when they die. Abijah is the only person in Jeroboam's family who pleases Yahweh, and so only Abijah will receive a proper burial.

In the second scene: Ahijah says that Yahweh will raise up another person as king. Then Yahweh will punish the people of Israel for the sins Jeroboam caused them to commit. Yahweh will do this by forcing the Israelites to live in a foreign land.

In the third scene: Jeroboam's wife goes home, and as soon as she gets there, Abijah dies. Then people mourn for Abijah and bury his body, just as Ahijah said.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller says Jeroboam reigned for 22 years before he died, and then Nadab, Jeroboam's son, became king.

The characters in this passage are:

- Ahijah
- Jeroboam's wife
- Abijah, Jeroboam's son
- All of Israel
- Jeroboam
- Yahweh, the God of Israel
- Jeroboam's "house" or family
- Israel's fathers, or ancestors

1 Kings 14:12–20

- Asherah
- And Nadab

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Ahijah tells Jeroboam's wife to get up and go to her house. In the original language, "get up" often means to begin some action, especially the action of traveling. It does not mean that Jeroboam's wife was sitting or lying down. You will remember that Jeroboam's house is in another city, Tirzah, so Jeroboam's wife will have to travel on the road to get home. However, before Jeroboam's wife leaves, Ahijah tells her what will happen.

Ahijah says that as soon as Jeroboam's wife sets foot in the city, the child will die. To set foot in a place means to walk into that place. Then all of Israel, or all of the people who live in the northern kingdom of Israel, where Jeroboam is king, will mourn for Abijah and bury Abijah's body. To mourn means to cry and show great sadness, and to bury someone's body. In ancient Israel, people often buried a body in a mountain cave or in a special "tomb" or room that people had carved into a large rock.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you talk about the way a person walks into a place? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss how you will talk about the way many people will mourn and bury Abijah's body in your translation. Can you think of a time in your community where a large number of people mourned someone's death? If so, what was it like? What words do you use to describe the way people felt and acted? Pause this audio here.

Ahijah says that Abijah is the only person who "belongs to Jeroboam" whom people will bury. To belong to Jeroboam means to be a family member or descendant of Jeroboam. Ahijah says that Abijah will receive burial because Abijah is the only one in Jeroboam's family in whom Yahweh, the God of Israel, has found anything good. This means that Abijah has done something to make Yahweh happy, although Ahijah does not say what Abijah did.

Next, Ahijah says that Yahweh will raise up a king over Israel who will cut off the house of Jeroboam, and that this is already beginning to happen today. To raise up a king means that Yahweh will choose someone who is not yet powerful or important and make that person king. This person will cut off the house of Jeroboam, which means he will destroy Jeroboam's family and take away their power to rule Israel. This is the same violent destruction that Yahweh promised Jeroboam's family would experience in the previous story. When Abijah says this is already beginning to happen today, Abijah means that it will happen very soon.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story to warn people about something that will happen very soon, but do not say exactly when that thing will happen. Pay attention to the words you use to describe when that thing will happen. Pause this audio here.

Ahijah now uses special language to describe how Yahweh will punish Israel. First, Ahijah says that Yahweh will strike Israel. This means that Yahweh will attack or punish Israel in a violent way. Second, Ahijah says that when Yahweh does this, Israel will shake as a reed sways in the water. A reed is a type of large grass that grows in a river. As water flows in a river, it pushes against these reeds and makes them sway back and forth. Ahijah also says that Yahweh will uproot Israel from this good land that Yahweh gave to their fathers or ancestors. To uproot a plant means to pull the plant out of the ground by force or in a violent way. So in that same way, Yahweh will violently force the Israelites to leave their homeland. Then Yahweh will scatter the Israelites beyond the Euphrates River. To scatter means to throw things in different directions so that those things are apart from each other in different places. In the same way, Yahweh will force the Israelites to leave their land and go east, over the Euphrates River, to a foreign country where they will live among people from another country instead of just with other Israelites.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a reed swaying in the water. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a person who does a certain task. For example, the person might build a house, plant a garden, or cook a meal. As you talk about the way the person does that

task, use special language to describe how that action is like another thing or action, like Ahijah does in this story. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will punish the Israelites in this way because they made Yahweh feel very angry when they made Asherah poles. What Yahweh feels here is the same feeling you discussed in the last story when people made gods for themselves out of metal. Asherah was a Canaanite goddess, and Asherah poles were wooden statues or idols that people made to worship Asherah. So the people made Yahweh very angry when they made idols and worshipped false gods. Yahweh will give Israel up because Jeroboam committed these sins and because Jeroboam caused Israel to also commit these sins. To give Israel up means that Yahweh will abandon or leave Israel. Yahweh will no longer be with the Israelites and protect the Israelites from their enemies.

Then Jeroboam's wife stood up, left Ahijah's house, and went back to the town of Tirzah, where she lived. And as soon as Jeroboam's wife stepped over the threshold of her house, the boy, Abijah, died. A threshold is the bottom part of a doorway. Then people buried Abijah, and all of the people of Israel mourned, or cried and acted very sad, for Abijah, just as Yahweh had said through Yahweh's servant Ahijah.

Now, the storyteller says that people wrote about the rest of Jeroboam's acts, or the things Jeroboam did, including the wars Jeroboam fought and how Jeroboam reigned or made decisions as king, in the book called "The History of the Kings of Israel." This means that people wrote down these stories and information in a book about the different kings of Israel so people would not forget the history.

Jeroboam reigned as king of Israel for 22 years, and then Jeroboam rested with his fathers or ancestors. This does not mean that Jeroboam went to sleep or took a nap. Instead, this is a nice way to say that Jeroboam died. And then Nadab, Jeroboam's son, reigned in Jeroboam's place. This means that Nadab became the next king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what is a nice way to say that a person dies? How will you translate that Jeroboam "rested with his fathers" so that people will understand it means Jeroboam died? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Ahijah
- Jeroboam's wife
- Abijah, Jeroboam's son
- All of Israel
- Jeroboam
- Yahweh, the God of Israel
- Jeroboam's "house" or family
- Israel's fathers, or ancestors
- Asherah
- And Nadab

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

1 Kings 14:12–20

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Ahijah says to Jeroboam’s wife, “Now, Jeroboam’s wife, you must go home. And when you step into your town, your son will die. All the people of Israel will mourn, and the people will bury Abijah’s body with honor. Abijah will be the only person in Jeroboam’s family to receive burial like this because Abijah is the only one in Jeroboam’s family who has done anything to please Yahweh, the God of Israel.”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam’s wife, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I do not want to go home now, because I do not want Abijah to die! or
- I feel sad and hopeless, but I am grateful that at least Abijah will not die in a shameful way.

Ask the person playing Ahijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I know this news must be very sad and painful to Abijah’s mother; or
- I do not like to give people bad news like this, but I serve Yahweh, and this is what Yahweh told me to say; or
- This is very sad and difficult news, but Jeroboam and the Israelites caused this to happen.

Continue the drama.

Ahijah says, “Yahweh will choose a new king of Israel. That king will destroy Jeroboam’s family. This is starting today and will keep happening! Yahweh will attack Israel until they shake like grass in a river. Yahweh will pull up the people of Israel out of this good land that Yahweh gave to their ancestors long ago. And Yahweh will scatter the Israelites in different directions and make the Israelites live in the land on the other side of the Euphrates River to the east of Israel. Yahweh will abandon Israel because Jeroboam sinned and caused the Israelites to sin too.”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- The Israelites have made me furious by worshiping these idols instead of worshiping me! or
- I rescued the Israelites from being slaves in Egypt so that they could worship me, but now the Israelites are acting like slaves to the false gods and idols; or
- The Israelites are not sorry for the evil way they act, but they will be sorry when I punish them. Then maybe the Israelites will finally choose to do what is right.

Continue the drama.

Then Jeroboam’s wife leaves Ahijah’s house and travels back to her own house in Tirzah. And as soon as Jeroboam’s wife enters the house, Abijah dies. Then, people bury Abijah’s body, and they cry loudly and act very sad that Abijah has died. These things happen just as Yahweh told Ahijah, who told Jeroboam’s wife.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam’s wife, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I hoped that Ahijah was wrong and that my son would not really die; or
- I feel devastated that Abijah has died, but now I am even more afraid, because that must mean that everything else Ahijah said will also be true.

Ask the person playing Jeroboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- When my wife told me the message Ahijah gave from Yahweh, I felt afraid; or
- I am not sure that what Ahijah said is really true. Ahijah is very old, so maybe Ahijah is confused; or
- I know Abijah died just like Ahijah said, but Abijah was very sick, so that does not prove that Yahweh did it; or

- Maybe if I keep worshiping these idols, the idols can protect me from the bad things Ahijah said.

Continue the drama.

Now the storyteller says, “Everything else King Jeroboam did, including the battles Jeroboam fought and the details of how Jeroboam ruled the people, is all recorded in the book called The History of the Kings of Israel. And Jeroboam ruled for 22 years, and then Jeroboam died, and people buried him close by the bodies of his ancestors. And Jeroboam’s son Nadab became the next king.”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Nadab, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- My father ruled over Israel for a long time, so he must have been a good king. I want to be just like my father; or
- I remember how the prophet Ahijah said Israel’s old God, Yahweh, would punish my father. But my father was king for a long time, so maybe Ahijah was wrong; or
- The gods my father worshiped seemed to help my father be king for a long time, so I will worship them too.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The **prophet** Ahijah is a **servant** of Yahweh. You will remember that a prophet is a person who gives messages from God to the people, and a servant is a person who does work for someone else. In this case, Ahijah is a servant of Yahweh because he does the things Yahweh tells him to do. Use the same words or phrases for prophet and servant when they are used in similar situations as you used in previous passages. Prophet and servant are in the Master Glossary.

Ahijah refers to Abijah as the **child**. In the original language, this word can refer to either a young man or a baby only a few months old, so we are not sure how old Abijah was at the time of this story. In your translation, if possible, translate this in a way that also does not say how old Abijah is in this story. If you do not have a general word for this in your language, you could just say “your son.”

Abijah will die. Then people will **mourn** and **bury** Abijah. To mourn means to wail or cry loudly. In ancient Israel, people usually buried the body of someone important, like a king’s son, in a tomb, which is a special cave or room that people had carved into a large rock. Use the same words or phrases for mourn and bury as you used in previous passages.

Abijah is the only person in the **house of Jeroboam** who has done anything to please Yahweh, the God of Israel. In the Bible, people talked about everyone who lived in the same house as a “household” or “house.” So the house of Jeroboam meant all of the people who lived in Jeroboam’s house. But people could also use the word household, or house, to mean a larger group of related people. So here, the house of Jeroboam meant all of Jeroboam’s ancestors or family who came from Jeroboam. Use the same word or phrase for “house of Jeroboam” as you used in previous passages. For more information on household, see the Master Glossary.

Ahijah uses the special phrase “Yahweh, the God of Israel” to talk about God. **God** is the general name people use to talk about the most powerful spiritual being who created everything, and **Yahweh** is a name God gives himself. When people hear the name Yahweh, they are reminded especially of the covenant, the special promise that God had made with the Israelites at the time of Moses. The name **Israel** comes from Abraham’s grandson, Israel. Abraham was the first ancestor of the Israelites. Abraham’s grandson was named Jacob, but God later gave Jacob the name “Israel.” People call all of Jacob’s descendants “Israelites.” Use the same words or phrases for God, Yahweh, and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, Yahweh, and Israel, see the Master Glossary.

Yahweh will raise up a new **king** over Israel. Use the same word or phrase for king as you have previously, and refer to king in the Master Glossary for more information.

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Ahijah says Yahweh will uproot the Israelites from this good land that Yahweh gave their fathers. This is special language that means God will take the people away from this good and prosperous land, or force the people to leave the land.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **uproot**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gave this land to the Israelites' **fathers**. This does not mean these people's literal fathers, but rather their ancestors or forefathers. Use the same word or phrase for fathers as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh will make the Israelites live on the other side of the **Euphrates**. In the original language, this word simply means "river," but we know this refers to the Euphrates River. The Euphrates is a very large river to the east of Israel that was an important source of water for Babylon, a powerful enemy of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for Euphrates as you used in previous passages.

The people of Israel made Asherah poles. Asherah is the name for the female goddess that many people of the nations surrounding Judah worshiped. The male god's name is Baal.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Asherah poles**. For more information about Asherah, refer to Baal in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will give up Israel because of the **sins** that Jeroboam did. When someone sins, they disobey God. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you have used previously, and refer to sin in the Master Glossary for more information.

When Jeroboam's wife went home, as soon as she came to the threshold of the house, Abijah died. A threshold is the bottom part of a doorway or opening in the wall of the house where people enter.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **threshold**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Jeroboam **reigned** for 22 years before he died. To reign means to be the king and to have the authority and power to rule the country. Use the same word or phrase for reigned as you used in previous passages.

Someone wrote down everything that Jeroboam did in the "Book of the History of the Kings of Israel." We do not have this book anymore. In that time, people wrote histories on long sheets of parchment or animal skin that they called scrolls. Use the same word or phrase for scroll, or book, as you have used previously, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about scroll.

Stop here and, if needed, look at a picture of a scroll.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 14:12–20

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (904 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 14:21–31

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 14:21–31 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:21–31 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:21–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, we heard about Jeroboam, who was king over the northern kingdom of Israel. And now, in this story, we will hear about Rehoboam, who was king over the southern kingdom of Judah at the same time.

Stop here and listen: If you have already translated 2 Chronicles 12:1–16, which contains the same information as this story, listen to your translation of that passage as a group. Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam was Solomon's son. You will remember that King Solomon was the second king of Israel before Israel divided into two kingdoms. Rehoboam was 41 years old when he became king of the southern kingdom of Judah, and Rehoboam continued to be the king for 17 years. Rehoboam lived in Jerusalem, where Rehoboam's grandfather, King David, had built King David's palace and where King Solomon had built Yahweh's temple. The storyteller reminds us that Yahweh specifically chose the city of Jerusalem out of all the tribes of Israel as the place where people would come to worship Yahweh.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Israel. Find the northern kingdom of Israel and the southern kingdom of Judah. Also, find the city of Jerusalem in Judah. Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam's mother was Naamah. You will remember that King Solomon had a great number of wives, and many of those wives were not Israelites. Naamah was from the Ammonite people. The Ammonites were the descendants of Lot, Abraham's nephew. The Ammonites lived in the land east of Judah.

1 Kings 14:21–31

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Israel again. Find the land of Ammon, east of Judah. Pause this audio here.

When Rehoboam was king, the people of Judah did very bad things that Yahweh had said not to do. This made Yahweh feel very jealous. The storyteller says that during Rehoboam's reign, the people of Judah sinned even more than their ancestors had sinned.

The people of Judah made high places, or shrines, in different places throughout the kingdom where people could worship other gods. The people also set up pillars, or stones, to worship the god Baal, and the people also set up idols to worship the goddess Asherah. Baal and Asherah were gods that people worshiped in other countries where people were enemies of Israel and Yahweh. The storyteller says the people of Judah set up these idols on every high hill and under every green tree. These are the kind of places where the Israelites' enemies worshiped idols, and so the Israelites did the same.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are some gods or spirits that people worship? What kinds of things do people do to worship, and where do people do those things? Pause this audio here.

Male cult prostitutes were also in Judah during this time. Cult prostitutes were people who would do shameful sexual acts to honor or worship these pagan gods. These prostitutes may have included both men and women. The storyteller reminds us that the people who lived in this land before the Israelites had done all of these evil things. And now the Israelites are acting just like those people.

Now the storyteller tells a specific story about what happened because of the evil things people did in Judah. In the fifth year that Rehoboam was king, Shishak, the king of Egypt, came up from Egypt to attack Jerusalem. We hear this same story in 2 Chronicles 12:1–16, where we learn that when Shishak came, Yahweh sent a message to Rehoboam to say that because Judah rejected Yahweh, Yahweh would now reject Judah and allow Shishak to destroy Jerusalem. However, when Rehoboam and the other leaders of Judah heard this, they were very humble and sorry, so Yahweh said he would not allow Shishak to destroy Jerusalem. Instead, Shishak took all of the treasures, or valuable things, from Yahweh's temple and from the king's palace. These things even included the gold shields that Solomon had made. And so King Rehoboam had people make new shields of bronze, which is far less expensive than gold. Then Rehoboam gave these shields to the officers of the guard, who guarded the door of the king's house. And whenever the king went to the house of Yahweh, the temple, the guards carried the shields with them and then brought the shields back to the guardroom.

Stop here and look at a map that shows both Egypt and Israel. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that all of the things that Rehoboam did when Rehoboam was king are in the "Book of the History of the Kings of Judah." This means that someone wrote all of this information down so people would not forget. However, we know that unfortunately, these writings no longer exist, so we cannot read these things to learn more about Rehoboam. However, the storyteller does remind us that Rehoboam was always at war with Jeroboam, king of the northern kingdom of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about some people who are enemies and always seem to be fighting with each other over a long period of time. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Rehoboam died, and people buried Rehoboam's body near Rehoboam's ancestors in the old part of Jerusalem that people called the City of David. Once again, the storyteller reminds us that Rehoboam's mother was Naamah the Ammonite. And then Reboboam's son Abijah became the next king of Judah.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:21–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller introduces King Rehoboam. We learn who Rehoboam's parents were, and how long Rehoboam reigned in Jerusalem.

In the second scene: We learn about the evil things that the people of Judah did while Reboam was king, including how the people worshiped idols and practiced prostitution, just like the people groups Yahweh forced out of the land when the Israelites came here.

In the third scene: King Shishak of Egypt attacked Jerusalem and took all of the treasures from Yahweh's temple and the king's palace, including the gold shields Solomon had made. So King Rehoboam made bronze shields instead.

In the fourth scene: King Rehoboam and King Jeroboam were always at war while Rehoboam was king. Then Rehoboam died, and Abijah became the next king.

The characters in this passage are:

- Rehoboam, the king of Judah
- Solomon, Rehoboam's father
- Yahweh
- The tribes of Israel
- Naamah, Rehoboam's mother, who is an Ammonite
- The people of Judah
- The nations, or people groups, who lived in this land before Yahweh forced them out
- Shishak, the king of Egypt
- Jeroboam, the king of the northern kingdom of Israel
- And Abijah, Rehoboam's son

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

You will remember that in the last story, the storyteller told about Jeroboam's reign as king of the northern kingdom of Israel. In the first scene of this story, the storyteller uses a special word in the original language to show that he will now talk about a different place where things happened at the same time as the last story.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story where people do things at the same time but in different places. Tell what happens in one place, and then tell what happens in the other place. Pay attention to the words you use to show where and when these things happen. Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam was Solomon's son. Sometimes in the Bible, the word son can mean a more distant descendant from many generations before, but here it means that Rehoboam was literally one of King Solomon's sons. Rehoboam became the king of Judah when Rehoboam was 41 years old, and Rehoboam reigned, or acted as the king, in Jerusalem for 17 years. The storyteller says that Yahweh chose Jerusalem out of all the cities in all the tribes of Israel as the place to put Yahweh's name. You will remember that in that culture, a person's name represented their character or their self. So when Yahweh chose this as the place to put Yahweh's name, it means that this was the place where Yahweh's house, or temple, was and where people would come to worship Yahweh. Rehoboam's mother's name was Naamah the Ammonite. This means that Naamah came from the country of Ammon, where people were not Israelites.

Stop here as a group and discuss how you will talk in your translation about the way Yahweh chose Jerusalem as the place to "put his name." Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a person whose parent comes from another people group or place. How do you talk about that person and the place where their parent comes from? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller explains how "Judah," or the people of Judah, did evil in the sight of Yahweh when Rehoboam was king. This is special language that means Yahweh saw or knew what the people did, and that Yahweh judged those actions and said the actions were evil. The people did such great sins that it made Yahweh feel very jealous, much like a husband feels jealous if his wife is unfaithful to him with another man. The storyteller says that the people did more sinful things than all of their "fathers," or ancestors, before them. In fact, the people behaved just like the people of the northern kingdom of Israel, which we heard about in the last story.

Stop here as a group and discuss how you will talk in your translation about the way people "did evil in the sight of Yahweh." Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a person who became very jealous because of how their husband or wife acted unfaithfully toward that person. Pay attention to the words you use to describe how that person feels. Pause this audio here.

The people of Judah made high places, or shrines. These were places where people would worship other gods. The people also set up pillars and "Asherah." Pillars refer to stones that people would stand upright, like a monument or special marker. Sometimes in Israel, people would use stones in this way to mark where they buried a person's body or to remind people of an important event that happened at that place. But here, people used these stones to worship Baal, a foreign god. People also set up Asherah. Asherah is a foreign goddess, and people would often set up wooden poles to represent this goddess. The people set up these pillars and Asherah on every high hill and under every green tree. The other people groups around Israel who worshipped these gods believed that high mountains and trees were sacred places for their gods.

There were also male shrine prostitutes in the land of Judah. In the original language, we are not sure if these were only men or if both men and women were shrine prostitutes. Either way, these shrine prostitutes were people who did sexual acts as part of the people's worship of these gods. So people who lived in Judah did the same "detestable," or disgusting, things as the people Yahweh forced out of the land long ago when the Israelites arrived.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is a culturally appropriate way you can talk about the evil sexual things people did at these shrines as part of their worship of these gods? What words will you use to describe this in your translation? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller tells a specific story of an event that happened when Rehoboam was king. We hear this same story in 2 Chronicles 12:1–16. This story happened in the fifth year after Rehoboam first became king. In that year, Shishak, the king of Egypt at that time, came up to attack Israel. You will remember that Shishak's army came from Egypt in the south, all the way up to Judah in the north, to attack the city of Jerusalem. So this is why the storyteller says they "came up." Then Shishak took away the treasures of the temple, or "house" of Yahweh, and the king's house. This means that Shishak's army stole all of the expensive things from the temple and the palace in Jerusalem. The storyteller says Shishak took away every valuable thing, including all the gold shields that Solomon had made. You will remember that this does not mean Solomon made these shields himself, but probably that Solomon commanded craftsmen to make these shields. So Rehoboam made, or had other people make, a new set of shields from bronze to replace the gold shields. Then Rehoboam assigned, or gave, these shields to the captains of the men who guarded the door of the king's palace. And whenever the king went to Yahweh's temple, the guards also went and carried the shields. And when the king left the temple, the guards took the shields back to the room where the guards stored the shields.

In the last scene, the storyteller asks a question he does not expect anyone to answer. The storyteller says, "Now the rest of the acts of Rehoboam, and all that Rehoboam did, are they not written in the Book of the History of the Kings of Judah?" The storyteller uses this question to tell us that we can read more about Rehoboam and what people did in Judah during Rehoboam's reign. You will remember that the storyteller has mentioned similar history books in previous stories in 1 Kings. However, these books are not part of the Bible, and unfortunately, they no longer exist.

The storyteller reminds us that Rehoboam and Jeroboam were continually fighting. This means that King Rehoboam's armies and King Jeroboam's armies fought many wars while Rehoboam was king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, how will you describe how Rehoboam and Jeroboam were always fighting? If needed, refer back to the story you told in step two to see how you talked about this. Pause this audio here.

Then Rehoboam slept with his fathers, which means Rehoboam died, and people buried Rehoboam in the City of David. To bury a dead body means to put that person's body into a place in the ground where no one can see it. In ancient Israel, people usually buried the body of a king in a tomb, which is a special cave or room that people carved into a large rock. The storyteller reminds us once again that Rehoboam's mother's name was Naamah the Ammonite. And finally, Abijah reigned as king after Rehoboam.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

1 Kings 14:21–31

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:21–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Rehoboam, the king of Judah
- Solomon, Rehoboam's father
- Yahweh
- The tribes of Israel
- Naamah, Rehoboam's mother, who is an Ammonite
- The people of Judah
- The nations, or people groups, who lived in this land before Yahweh forced them out
- Shishak, the king of Egypt
- Jeroboam, the king of the northern kingdom of Israel
- And Abijah, Rehoboam's son

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Meanwhile, in Judah, Solomon's son Rehoboam was king. Rehoboam was 41 years old when he started to rule, and Rehoboam was king for 17 years in Jerusalem. Jerusalem was the city that Yahweh had chosen from all the cities in all of the tribes of Israel to be a place where people would worship Yahweh's name. Rehoboam's mother's name was Naamah, and Naamah was from the people of Ammon.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I married women from other countries and worshiped other gods besides Yahweh. But my father David always served Yahweh, and I built Yahweh's temple, so I hope my son will worship Yahweh too.

Ask the person playing Naamah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Even though I live in Israel now, I still love my family and the place I was born, so I serve the gods of my people; or
- I love my husband, but I am not an Israelite, and I do not know the Israelites' God. So I will teach my son about the gods of my people and how to serve them, instead.

Continue the drama.

The people of Judah did things that Yahweh said were evil. The people committed such great sins that they caused Yahweh to become even more jealous than Yahweh was when their ancestors had sinned. The people of Judah made for themselves various local places of worship. On every high hill and under every green tree, the people set up stones to worship Baal and poles to worship Asherah. And some people in Judah even did very

shameful sexual things to worship these idols. The people who lived in this land before the Israelites came had done these evil things, and God had taken the land away from them. But now the people of Judah were doing these same evil things.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Judah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We still have Yahweh's temple in Jerusalem, but we want to have other gods too; or
- All of the other nations around us have more than one god, and we want to be like other people. Besides, maybe if Yahweh does not give us what we want, we can ask another god; or
- Yahweh has a bunch of rules about the right way to worship, and only special people can serve in the temple. But anyone can worship Baal and Asherah, and we can worship however we want.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very upset that people are worshiping Baal and Asherah instead of me! or
- I am disgusted by the way people mistreat each other and even their own bodies when they worship these idols; or
- I feel as jealous as a husband whose wife is unfaithful with another man!

Continue the drama.

After Rehoboam had been king for almost five years, the Egyptian king Shishak and his army fought against Jerusalem. Shishak's men stole all the valuable things from the house of Yahweh in Jerusalem. The men also took all of the valuable things from the king's house. Shishak took everything away, including the shields that Solomon had made from gold. So, King Rehoboam had people make shields out of bronze instead. Rehoboam gave these shields to the captains of the royal guards. When the king went to the temple of Yahweh, the guards went with the king and held the shields, and when the king left the temple, the guards took the shields back to the room where they stored the shields.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shishak, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have a huge army, so I could have killed everyone in Jerusalem. But instead, I will just take all of their valuable things; or
- I remember hearing how the Israelites' God killed many people in Egypt and helped the Israelites to escape. But the Israelites' God does not seem to be helping them now.

Ask the person playing Rehoboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Shishak took a lot of very valuable and important things, but at least Shishak did not kill us; or
- These bronze shields are not as impressive as the gold shields my father made, but hopefully, people will still be impressed when they see all of these guards who protect me.

Continue the drama.

All of the things that happened during Rehoboam's reign, and all that Rehoboam did, are written in the records of the kings who ruled in Judah. The armies of Rehoboam and Jeroboam were always fighting with each other. Then Rehoboam died, and people buried Rehoboam beside his ancestors in the City of David. Rehoboam's mother's name was Naamah, who was from the people of Ammon. And Rehoboam's son Abijah became the next king.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Rehoboam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I did a lot of fighting while I was king. I feel very tired; or
- I feel discouraged because I was never able to take back the northern kingdom of Israel that Jeroboam stole from me; or

1 Kings 14:21–31

- Although I was born in Israel, my mother came from Ammon, so I wanted to honor my mother's gods as well as Yahweh.

Ask the person playing Abijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- My father was king for a long time, and I hope I can be king for a long time too; or
- I know my father worshiped idols of the gods from other people groups, so I will worship those idols too; or
- My father always fought with King Jeroboam, so I will fight Jeroboam too.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 14:21–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Rehoboam **reigned** in **Judah** for 17 years. To reign means to rule or act as the king. Judah was the southern kingdom in the land of Israel during this time. Use the same words or phrases for reigned and for Judah as you used in previous passages. For more information about Judah, refer to the Master Glossary.

Out of all the **tribes of Israel**, Yahweh chose the city of Jerusalem to put his name there. You will remember that Abraham's grandson was Jacob, and God later gave Jacob the name Israel. From that time onwards, all Jacob's descendants are called Israelites. Jacob had 12 sons, and therefore the Israelites were divided into 12 tribes. Each of the tribes had its own land in Israel, and Judah was one of these tribes. Use the same word or phrase for "tribes of Israel" as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh is God's personal name. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Jerusalem is the most important city for the Jews, or Israelites, and Jerusalem is in the land where Judah's tribe lived. Jerusalem was where Yahweh's temple was and also where the king's palace, or special house, was located. Use the same word or phrase for Jerusalem as you used in previous passages. For more information on Jerusalem, refer to the Master Glossary.

The people of Judah did what was **evil** in the sight of Yahweh. Evil is the opposite of good. A person who is evil willingly does bad things that hurt other people. When people stop obeying God, those people begin to do evil actions. Use the same word or phrase for "evil" as you used in previous passages. For more information on evil, refer to the Master Glossary.

The people of Judah committed even more **sins** than their **fathers** had done. In the Bible, sometimes "father" means a person's literal father, but other times it can mean a male ancestor. Here, the storyteller is saying that Judah sinned even more than their ancestors sinned. Use the same word or phrase for fathers, when you are talking about ancestors, as you used in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you have used previously, and refer to sin in the Master Glossary for more information.

The people of Judah set up **high places** on every hill and under every tree. You will remember that high places are local places of worship. People often made these altars and shrines on hills or high places, but not always. Use the same word or phrase for high places as you have used in previous passages.

The people set up **Asherah** poles. Asherah is the name for the female goddess that many people of the nations that surrounded Judah worshiped. The male god's name is **Baal**. For more information about Asherah, refer to Baal in the Master Glossary. Use the same word for Asherah as you did in the previous story.

The people of Judah did all the same abominable things as the people of the other nations that Yahweh had driven out of the land. Abominable means disgusting, horrible, or shocking. These are things that God hates, or very strongly dislikes, and people should strongly dislike these things too.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **abominable**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

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Nations means the other countries or people groups who are separate from the Israelites and who do not worship Yahweh. For more information about nations, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for nations as you used in previous passages.

Shishak, the **king** of Egypt, attacked Jerusalem. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a region or a country. People called the kings of Egypt "pharaohs." Use the same word or phrase for kings as you used in previous passages.

Shishak took treasures from the **temple** and the **palace**. Translate temple and king's house, or palace, the same way you have in previous passages. Remember that sometimes people translate the temple as "house of Yahweh." Refer to "temple" in the Master Glossary for more information.

Shishak took the **shields** of **gold**, so Rehoboam made shields of **bronze** to replace those shields. A shield is something that soldiers use to protect themselves from an enemy's attack. People usually made shields with a wooden frame and covered that frame with animal hide or leather. Shields covered with metal were not common because, although this kind of shield provided better protection, it was also heavier and difficult to carry. Gold is a very expensive metal that is yellow in color and does not tarnish. Bronze is also a yellow metal, but it is less expensive and does tarnish. Use the same words or phrases for shields, gold, and bronze as you used in previous passages, and for more information about bronze, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a shield that people have covered in metal. Pause this audio here.

Everything else that happened while Rehoboam was king is in the "**Book** of the History of the Kings of Israel." In Bible times, people did not make books the same way we make them today. Instead, this was probably a scroll, which is a type of ancient book where people wrote everything on one very long piece of paper or animal skin and then rolled that paper or skin around a stick so it was easy to carry and store away. Use the same word for book or scroll as you used in previous passages, and refer to scroll in the Master Glossary for more information.

At the end of the story, the storyteller says that Rehoboam slept with his fathers and they buried Rehoboam in the **City of David**. You will remember that the City of David was the older part of the city of Jerusalem that existed when David was king. Use the same words or phrases for "buried" and for "City of David" as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 14:21–31

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (840 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 15:1–8

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 15:1–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:1–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, we heard about Rehoboam, king of Judah, Solomon's son. The people of Judah did many evil things while Rehoboam was king. People built shrines, worshiped other gods, and did shameful sexual acts as part of that worship, just like pagan people. Then the king of Egypt attacked Jerusalem and took the treasures from Yahweh's temple and from King Rehoboam's house, including the gold shields. So Rehoboam replaced those shields with shields that people made from bronze, a less expensive metal. The storyteller also said that King Rehoboam fought constantly with King Jeroboam of Israel while Rehoboam was king. Then Rehoboam died, and Rehoboam's son Abijah became the new king of Judah.

You will remember that during this time, the Promised Land that God had given the Israelites was divided into two kingdoms: the kingdom of Israel in the north and the kingdom of Judah in the south. Each of these kingdoms had its own king. So, whenever the storyteller introduces a new king, the storyteller always tells us how many years it has been since the king of the other kingdom became king. This way, we can figure out when each king ruled. So the storyteller begins by telling us that Abijah became king of Judah, the southern kingdom, in the same year that Jeroboam had already been king of the northern kingdom of Israel for 18 years. Many people think this was about the year 913 B.C. The storyteller says that Abijah reigned in Jerusalem, the capital city of Judah, for three years. The storyteller also says Abijah's mother was Maacah, the daughter of Abishalom. We are not sure, but Maacah's father may be the same person as King David's son Absalom.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about an important leader who lived a long time ago. Tell when the person became the leader, how long the person was a leader, who the person's family was, or any other important information. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that Abijah sinned just like Abijah's father, Rehoboam, had sinned. Although Abijah's ancestor, King David, had been fully loyal to Yahweh, Abijah was not like David. In an earlier story, in 1 Kings 11:36, we

heard how Yahweh used the idea of a lamp to show how David would always have a descendant on the throne after David. Now, in this story, the storyteller returns to this idea of a lamp to give Judah hope that Yahweh will give Abijah a son who will once again make Jerusalem strong.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a lamp like people who lived at this time might have used. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller reminds us that Yahweh did this because David had always done what pleased Yahweh, except in the matter of Uriah the Hittite. You will remember this story from 2 Samuel 11, where King David secretly had sex with a married woman named Bathsheba, whose husband was Uriah. Then, when Bathsheba became pregnant, David was afraid of what would happen when Uriah found out, so David sent Uriah into battle so that Uriah would die while fighting. Later, David felt very sorry that David had done these sins. Yahweh forgave David, but Yahweh also punished David by causing David and Bathsheba's baby to die.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a very good leader who did a very bad thing one time. What were the consequences of the one bad thing the leader did? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller again reminds us that Rehoboam and Jeroboam constantly fought battles, so this means that Judah was at war with Israel all of Abijah's lifetime. The storyteller also says that we can learn more about all the things Abijah did when Abijah was king if we find the book called "The History of the Kings of Judah." We know, however, that this book unfortunately no longer exists. The storyteller also says that when Abijah became king, Abijah continued to fight with Jeroboam, just like Rehoboam had.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about two countries, people groups, or families that continued to fight with each other for a very long time. Tell how that fighting continued from one generation to the next generation. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Abijah died, and people buried Abijah in the old part of Jerusalem that people call the City of David. And Abijah's son Asa became the next king.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Abijah was king of Judah for three years during the time that Jeroboam was king of Israel. Abijah sinned like Abijah's father had sinned and was not true to Yahweh. But because Abijah's ancestor, King David, had obeyed Yahweh, except in the case of Uriah the Hittite, Yahweh gave Abijah a son to rule as king after Abijah.

In the second scene: During Abijah's lifetime, the army of Judah continued to fight with the army of Israel. People wrote down all the important things that Abijah did in The Book of the History of the Kings of Judah.

In the third scene: Abijah died, and Abijah's son Asa became the next king.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Jeroboam of Israel
- Nebat, Jeroboam's father
- King Abijah of Judah
- Abijah's mother, Maacah, the daughter of Abishalom
- Yahweh, Abijah's God
- King David
- Uriah the Hittite
- Rehoboam
- And King Asa

1 Kings 15:1–8

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, we learn that Jeroboam, who was the son of Nebat, had ruled Israel for 18 years as king when Abijah became king of Judah. In the original language, this story uses the name "Abijam," but this is the same king as "Abijah" that we hear about in 1 Chronicles and 2 Chronicles. So you can use the same name here if you would like.

Abijah reigned for three years in Jerusalem. To reign means to be the king and to have the authority and power to rule the kingdom. You will remember that Jerusalem was not only the capital city of Judah but also the city where King Solomon had built the temple for Yahweh. So Jerusalem was a very important city for all of the Israelites.

The storyteller says that Abijah's mother was Maacah, Abishalom's daughter. However, we hear in 2 Chronicles 11 that Maacah is Absalom's daughter. Although we are not sure, it may be that Abishalom is the same person as Absalom, and if this is the same Absalom as King David's son, then Maacah would be King David's granddaughter. You will remember that King Abijah was King David's great-grandson. Sometimes in the Bible, storytellers use the word "mother" to mean grandmother and "daughter" to mean granddaughter. However, we also hear in 2 Chronicles 13:2 that Abijah's mother was "Micaiah, the daughter of Uriel." Although we are not sure exactly why these passages are different, you should translate this passage exactly as the storyteller told it here and say that Abijah's mother was Maacah, Abishalom's daughter.

Abijah walked in all the sins that Abijah's father did before him. This means that Abijah imitated his father, or did the same sinful actions that Abijah saw his father, Rehoboam, do. Abijah's heart was not fully devoted to Yahweh like the heart of David, Abijah's father. You will remember that for the Israelites, the heart was the place where a person's thoughts, feelings, and desires lived, so the storyteller means that Abijah did not love Yahweh, did not want to listen to Yahweh, and did not want to obey Yahweh like David did. You will also remember that Rehoboam was Abijah's literal father, so when the storyteller refers to David as Abijah's "father," this means ancestor or forefather.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a person who behaves in the same bad way that their father or ancestors behaved. Now tell a story about a person who behaves in the same good way that their father behaved. Pay attention to the words you use to describe this person. Pause this audio here.

Even though Abijah acted like Rehoboam and not like David, the storyteller says that for David's sake, Yahweh gave Abijah a lamp in Jerusalem, and Yahweh did this by raising up a son after Abijah to make Jerusalem strong. Here, the storyteller uses the special language of a lamp to show how people continue to remember David because of David's family, just like the fire in a lamp continues to burn and does not go out.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about the way people continue to remember a person who has died because of how that person's family continues. What happens if that person's family does not continue? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that Yahweh gave Abijah a lamp in Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh did these things for Abijah because David did what was right in the eyes of Yahweh and did not turn aside from anything that Yahweh commanded all the days of his life, except in the case of Uriah, the Hittite. You will remember that to do what is right in someone's eyes is special language that means to do what pleases that person. To not "turn aside" means not to disobey or to do things that are different from what Yahweh says to do or not do. A person who turns aside is like a person who begins to walk in a different direction from the direction someone has told them to walk. And "all the days of his life" means every day that David was alive. So King David always pleased Yahweh except for what David did to Uriah.

Stop here as a group and discuss how you will say that David did what was right in Yahweh's eyes and did not turn aside from Yahweh's commands all the days of David's life. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that there was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam all the days of Abijah's life. This means that even when Abijah was a small child, the kingdoms of Judah and Israel were constantly having battles. The storyteller also says that the things that happened when Abijah reigned, or when Abijah grew older and became

king himself, are in the book called "The History of the Kings of Judah." This is the same book where people recorded the reigns of the other kings of Judah. And the armies of Abijah and Jeroboam continued to fight one another.

Finally, the storyteller says that Abijah slept with his fathers and that people buried Abijah in the City of David. "Slept with his fathers" is special language that is a nice way to say that Abijah died and that people buried Abijah's body in the same way they buried kings in previous passages. Then Asa, Abijah's son, reigned in Abijah's place. This means that Asa became the next king of Judah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about how someone died and what people did with that person's body. Pay attention to the words you use to talk about these things. Then, as a group, talk about how you will translate this part of the story so people will understand. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Jeroboam of Israel
- Nebat, Jeroboam's father
- King Abijah of Judah
- Abijah's mother, Maacah, the daughter of Abishalom
- Yahweh, Abijah's God
- King David
- Uriah the Hittite
- Rehoboam
- And King Asa

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, ruled Israel for 18 years. Then Abijah started to rule over Judah. Abijah ruled in Jerusalem for three years. Abijah's mother was Maacah, Abishalom's daughter. Abijah sinned just as Abijah's father had sinned. Abijah's heart was not true to Yahweh, his God, like Abijah's ancestor David. However, because of the promise Yahweh made to Abijah's ancestor David, Yahweh let Abijah's son continue to reign in Jerusalem.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am ashamed that people still think about the terrible sin I committed against Yahweh and Uriah; or
- I am grateful that Yahweh continues to keep Yahweh's promise to me; or
- I am ashamed that my descendants do not worship and obey Yahweh as I did.

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Ask the person playing Abijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I remember that my ancestor, King David, served Yahweh, but my father served other gods; or
- I want to be like my father, so I will keep serving these gods instead of Yahweh; or
- Things seem to be working out okay for me as king, so I guess these gods that I worship are happy with me.

Continue the drama.

During Abijah’s lifetime, the armies of Judah and the armies of Israel continued to fight each other. People wrote down all the things that happened while Abijah ruled and all Abijah did in the book people called The History of the Kings of Judah. And the war between Abijah and Jeroboam continued.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroboam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I have fought with Rehoboam for many years, and I will fight with Abijah now; or
- I am tired of fighting, but I refuse to let Judah have control.

Ask the person playing Abijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I must be an important king for people to write all of those stories about me. I hope people will always remember me as a strong king; or
- For all of those years, my father never let Jeroboam take control of Judah. Maybe I can finally beat Jeroboam; or
- I hope I will be king for at least as many years as my father.

Continue the drama.

And Abijah died, and people placed Abijah’s body in a tomb in Jerusalem, in the City of David. And Abijah’s son Asa became the next king of Judah.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Abijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- My father was king for many years, so I am surprised I was king for only three! or
- I thought the gods my father served would help me, but I did not stay king for long; or
- I hope my son will be a strong king and rule for many years.

Ask the person playing Asa, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- My father did not live very long as king, so I hope I live a lot longer! or
- My father said these gods would help him be a strong king, but that did not seem to work; or
- Maybe I should serve Israel’s first God, Yahweh, instead of these other gods. People say that Yahweh is a strong God and that Yahweh always protected the Israelites in the past.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller says that it was in the 18th year of **King** Jeroboam that Abijah began to **reign** over Judah. You will remember that Jeroboam was king of the northern kingdom of Israel, and Abijah was king of the southern kingdom of Judah. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a region or a country, and to reign means to be the king and to have the authority and power to rule the country. Use the same words or phrases for king and for reign as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Abijah’s **mother** was Maacah, the **daughter** of Abishalom. Use the same words or phrases for mother and for daughter as you used in previous passages.

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Abijah sinned just like Abijah's father had sinned. **Sin** is an act of rebellion against God. Anytime a person disobeys God's laws, that person sins. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary.

Because of the promise **Yahweh** made to David, Yahweh, David's **God**, gave Abijah **a lamp** in Jerusalem by raising up a son after Abijah and establishing Jerusalem, or making Jerusalem strong. Use the same words for Yahweh and God as you have used in previous passages, and refer to Yahweh and God in the Master Glossary for more information. A lamp is special language that refers to the way a person's descendants remind people of that person's life and the good things that person did, even after the person dies. Use the same word or phrase for "a lamp" as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group, if needed, and look again at a picture of a lamp like people who lived at this time might have used. Pause this audio here.

"Raising up a son" means that God allowed Abijah's family line to continue by giving Abijah a son who would become the next king. This would help Jerusalem to remain secure and stable, or established, even after Abijah died.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **raising up a son** and **establishing** Jerusalem. For more information about "son," refer to the Master Glossary. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David had done what was right in the "**eyes of Yahweh**." Use the same words or phrases for doing what is right "in the eyes of Yahweh" as you have used in previous passages.

Someone wrote down what Abijah did in the scroll or "**Book of the History of the Kings of Judah**." Use the same title for this book as you used in the previous passage. For more information about scroll, refer to the Master Glossary.

Finally, Abijah **slept with his fathers**, and they **buried** Abijah in the **City of David**. Use the same words or phrases for "slept with his fathers," "buried," and "City of David" as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (860 KB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Kings 15:9–24

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 15:9–24 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:9–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:9–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, Abijah became king of the southern kingdom of Judah and ruled for three years in Jerusalem. Abijah followed the sins of his father and did not obey Yahweh his God with his whole heart as King David did. Still, Yahweh allowed Abijah to keep the kingdom because of Yahweh's promise to David. Abijah fought against Jeroboam, the king of the northern kingdom of Israel. Then Abijah died, and his son Asa became king.

The storyteller introduces the rule of King Asa of Judah. When Jeroboam has been king over Israel for 20 years, Asa becomes king over Judah. Asa rules in Jerusalem for 41 years, from around the year 911 to 870 before Jesus. Jerusalem was the capital of Judah, from where the kings of Judah ruled. The storyteller says that Asa's mother's name is Maacah. Maacah's father is Abishalom. However, we learn from the previous passage that Maacah is the mother of Abijah, Asa's father. Therefore, Maacah must be Asa's grandmother. We are not sure, but Maacah's father may be the same person as King David's son Absalom. Therefore, it is likely that Abishalom and Absalom are the same person.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and Judah. Find Jerusalem, the capital of Judah. Pause this audio here.

King Asa does what Yahweh thinks is right, just like his ancestor King David does. Bible storytellers often judge the kings of Judah and Israel by comparing them to King David's reign. Asa is one of the few kings of Judah who gets a good report when the storyteller compares him to David.

King Asa chases away all the male cult prostitutes who live in the land of Judah. Cult prostitutes are men or women who work in temples where people worship false gods. Cult prostitutes have sex as part of pagan religious ceremonies. King Asa also removes all the horrible idols that the kings of Judah made before King Asa ruled. People use the idols to worship false gods like Baal and Asherah, just as many surrounding nations do. King Asa destroys these objects because King Asa wants the people of Judah to worship only Yahweh.

1 Kings 15:9–24

King Asa removes his grandmother Maacah from being queen mother because Maacah made a horrible idol to worship the false goddess Asherah. We do not know for sure if being queen mother was a real job with duties or if it was just a title. But queen mothers were often important and had a lot of power in Judah's religion and politics. Maacah probably helped rule when Asa was a young king. Asherah was a goddess of fertility. King Asa cuts down the idol Maacah made and burns the pieces at the Kidron Brook in the Kidron Valley.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and Judah. Find the Kidron Brook near Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What role does the queen mother or the mother of the leaders have to help rule your people group, especially if the leader is young? Talk about the role other family members of the leader may have and how those people can influence the leader's reign. Pause this audio here.

However, King Asa does not remove all the shrines on the hilltops where people worship other gods. The people of Judah often worship Yahweh at shrines on hilltops, but this kind of worship is wrong. Yahweh wants the people of Judah to worship only Yahweh and to worship Yahweh only at the temple in Jerusalem. Even so, King Asa remains completely faithful to Yahweh all the days of King Asa's life. This does not mean that King Asa never does anything wrong. This means that King Asa worships Yahweh only and does not worship idols.

King Asa puts holy gifts into Yahweh's temple. These gifts were silver, gold, and other treasures that King Asa and his father Abijah had promised to give to Yahweh. People gave holy gifts when they made a promise to God or when God answered their prayers. King Asa and King Abijah likely gave treasures from the wars they fought.

The armies of Asa, king of Judah, and Baasha, king of Israel, are at war throughout their reigns. King Asa of Judah and King Baasha of Israel are enemies, and people have been fighting between the two kingdoms for a long time. The wars between the northern and southern kingdoms are border conflicts in which one or the other king tries to make the border, and therefore his kingdom, larger.

One day, King Baasha of Israel goes against Judah. Baasha captures the city of Ramah, about 8 kilometres north of Jerusalem. Ramah city is on the main road that connects Jerusalem to Shechem and other places. Baasha makes the walls of Ramah stronger and puts many soldiers there. Baasha does this to stop people from going in and out of Judah, where King Asa rules. By controlling Ramah, Baasha can affect Judah's communication, trade, and security, since Baasha now controls the key road into Judah. The storyteller tells the same story in 2 Chronicles 16.

Stop here and, as a group, find the city of Ramah on the map. What kinds of cities do you have that are important for your trade, communication, and security? Pause this audio here.

Then King Asa responds to Baasha's capture of Ramah city. Asa takes the silver and gold that remain in the treasuries in Yahweh's temple and in King Asa's palace. King Asa gives the silver and gold to some of his men and sends it to Ben-Hadad. Ben-Hadad is the son of Tabrimmon, who is the son of Hezion. Ben-Hadad is the king of Syria and rules from Damascus, the capital city of Syria. King Asa tells Ben-Hadad that they should make a covenant, or a serious agreement to help each other in wars, just like the covenant that the father of Asa made with the father of Ben-Hadad. Asa mentions the generous gift of silver and gold that Asa is sending to Ben-Hadad. King Asa asks Ben-Hadad to break his covenant or serious agreement with Baasha, the king of Israel, and to fight against Baasha so that Baasha will leave King Asa's land. To break an agreement means to cancel it or to ignore it.

Stop here and, as a group, locate Syria and the city of Damascus on the map. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, talk about a war your people group was involved in some time ago. Who started the war, and why did they start it? What happened during the war? How did the war end? Pause this audio here.

King Ben-Hadad agrees to King Asa's plan and does more than King Asa asks. King Ben-Hadad sends commanders and soldiers to attack towns in the northern kingdom of Israel. The army captures the cities of Ijon, Dan, and Abel Beth Maacah. The army also captures the land of Kinnereth, including the city of Kinnereth, the lake of Kinnereth, and the land south of the city. These cities stand on an important international road that King Baasha needs for trade, travel, and defence. King Ben-Hadad's army also captures the land of the tribe of Naphtali.

Stop here and, as a group, find the cities of Ijon, Dan, Abel Beth Maacah, the land of Kinnereth, and the land of the tribe of Naphtali on the map. Pause this audio here.

As soon as King Baasha of Israel hears this news, he stops making the city of Ramah stronger, abandons his work there, and goes back to live in the city of Tirzah. Tirzah was the capital of the northern kingdom of Israel at that time. Baasha rules Israel from there. Then King Asa sends a message to all Judah. King Asa requires everyone to carry away from Ramah the stones and wood that Baasha had been using there to make it stronger. The men of Judah use these materials to make the cities of Geba and Mizpah stronger. Both cities are in important places in the territory of Benjamin, on the northern border of Judah.

Stop here and, as a group, find the cities of Tirzah, Geba, and Mizpah on the map. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller sums up and judges the rule of King Asa. The storyteller says that people record the other events of Asa's reign in the book called "History of the Kings of Judah." The people write about the good things Asa did and about how Asa made several cities in his land stronger. This book records the actions of the kings of Judah during their reigns. However, when Asa grows old, Asa develops a disease in his feet. Asa's foot disease shows Yahweh disapproves of Asa and contrasts with the earlier time when Yahweh blessed Asa. We do not know for sure why Yahweh was not pleased with Asa.

Then Asa dies and goes to be with his ancestors. People bury Asa in the city of his ancestor David, where people buried Asa's other ancestors. The City of David is part of Jerusalem and becomes the burial place for the kings of Judah. And Asa's son Jehoshaphat becomes king of Judah in Asa's place.

Stop here and, as a group, locate the City of David on a map of Jerusalem.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:9–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has 11 scenes.

In the first scene: When Jeroboam has been king over Israel for 20 years, Asa becomes king over Judah. Asa rules in Jerusalem for 41 years.

In the second scene: King Asa does what Yahweh thinks is right, just like his ancestor King David did. King Asa chases away all the male cult prostitutes who live in the land of Judah. King Asa also removes all the horrible idols that the kings of Judah had made before King Asa.

In the third scene: King Asa removes his grandmother Maacah from being queen mother because Maacah made a horrible idol to worship the false goddess Asherah. King Asa cuts down the idol Maacah made and burns the pieces at the Kidron Brook in the Kidron Valley.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller says that despite the good things that Asa does, King Asa does not remove all the shrines on the hilltops where people worship other gods. Even so, King Asa remains completely faithful to Yahweh all the days of King Asa's life.

In the fifth scene: King Asa puts holy gifts into Yahweh's temple. These gifts are silver, gold, and other treasures that King Asa and his father Abijah had promised to give to Yahweh.

In the sixth scene: The armies of Asa, king of Judah, and Baasha, king of Israel, are at war throughout their reigns. Baasha captures Ramah city and makes it stronger to stop people from going in and out of Judah, where King Asa rules.

In the seventh scene: Then King Asa takes the silver and gold that remain in the treasuries in Yahweh's temple and in King Asa's palace. King Asa sends some of his men with the silver and gold to Ben-Hadad, the king of Syria, who rules from Damascus. King Asa sends a message to Ben-Hadad. Asa suggests that Asa and Ben-Hadad make a covenant, or a serious agreement, to help each other in wars, just like the agreement the father of Asa made

with the father of Ben-Hadad. King Asa also asks Ben-Hadad to break, or cancel, his agreement with King Baasha of Israel. Asa wants Ben-Hadad to fight against King Baasha so that Baasha will leave the land of King Asa.

In the eighth scene: King Ben-Hadad agrees to King Asa's plan, and King Ben-Hadad sends commanders and soldiers to attack towns in the northern kingdom of Israel. The army captures the cities of Ijon, Dan, and Abel Beth Maacah. The army also captures the land of Kinnereth, including the city of Kinnereth, the lake of Kinnereth, and the land south of the city. King Ben-Hadad's army also captures the land of the tribe of Naphtali.

In the ninth scene: King Baasha of Israel hears the news that Ben-Hadad has captured cities in northern Israel. King Baasha stops making Ramah stronger and abandons the work there. King Baasha goes back to live in the city of Tirzah. Then King Asa sends a message to all Judah. King Asa requires everyone to carry away from Ramah the stones and the wood that King Baasha used to make Ramah stronger. The men of Judah use these materials to make the cities of Geba and Mizpah stronger.

In the tenth scene: Now the storyteller sums up and judges the reign of King Jehoshaphat. The storyteller says that people record the other events during Asa's reign in the book called "History of the Kings of Judah." The people write about Asa's successes and accomplishments and about how Asa strengthens several cities in his land. However, when Asa is old, Asa develops a disease in his feet.

In the eleventh scene: Then Asa dies and goes to be with his ancestors. People bury Asa in the city of his ancestor, David, where people buried Asa's other ancestors. And Asa's son Jehoshaphat becomes king of Judah in his place.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jeroboam, king of Israel
- Asa, king of Judah
- Maacah, Asa's grandmother
- Yahweh
- Male cult prostitutes
- Asa's servants, or men
- Ben-Hadad, king of Syria
- Ben-Hadad's commanders and soldiers
- All the men and women of Judah
- And Jehoshaphat, son of Asa

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller introduces the rule of King Asa of Judah. The storyteller follows the normal way to talk about a king's rule and says how long King Asa ruled and gives the name of Asa's mother. When Jeroboam has been king over Israel for 20 years, Asa becomes king over Judah. Asa rules in Jerusalem for 41 years. The storyteller says that Asa's mother's name is Maacah, and she is the daughter of Abishalom. However, we know from the previous passage that Maacah is the mother of Abijah, Asa's father. Therefore, Maacah must be Asa's grandmother. Some Bible translators refer to Maacah as Asa's mother and some as Asa's grandmother in this passage. We are not sure, but Maacah's father may be the same person as King David's son Absalom. Therefore, Abishalom and Absalom are likely the same person.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and Judah. Find Jerusalem, the capital of Judah. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, decide whether you are going to say that Maacah was Asa's mother or grandmother. You should translate the name of Maacah's father, Abishalom, exactly as the storyteller told it. Pause this audio here.

King Asa does what is right in the sight of Yahweh. This means Asa does what Yahweh considers right, just like David, Asa's father, did. "Father" means ancestor here, not biological father.

King Asa drives out all the male cult prostitutes who live in the land of Judah. Cult prostitutes may be male or female. King Asa also removes all the idols that his "fathers," or ancestors, made. These idols include stones, poles, and altars that the people use to worship Canaanite false gods, mainly Baal and Asherah. Asa does not do these actions himself, but commands his officials, priests, and military officers to remove the male cult

prostitutes and tear down the idols. The storyteller uses a word for idols that, in the original language, has a strong negative meaning and can also mean “dung.” Some translators call these idols “very dirty idols.” The word fathers here means ancestors—the kings of Judah before King Asa.

Stop here and, as a group, talk about the words in your language that mean “an idol.” How do these words differ? Which one will suit this passage best? Pause this audio here.

King Asa removes his grandmother Maacah from being queen mother because Maacah makes a horrible image to worship the false goddess Asherah. The word “removes” in the original language means something very strong, like when people remove a ruler from power. The storyteller uses a special word for “image” that appears only one other time in the Bible, in 2 Chronicles 15:16. People do not know the exact meaning of this word, but many think it means something like a “horror.” Some translators call it an “obscene image.” The image of Asherah is a wooden pole. King Asa cuts down the idol that Maacah makes and burns the pieces in the Kidron Valley. King Asa likely gives the order, and his workers destroy the idol.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and Judah. Find the Kidron Brook near Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller now uses contrast language to show that Asa did do one thing that was bad: King Asa did not remove all the shrines on the hilltops where people worship other gods. Even so, King Asa fully commits his heart to Yahweh. This means that King Asa remains completely faithful to Yahweh all the days of King Asa’s life.

King Asa puts holy gifts into Yahweh’s temple. These gifts were silver, gold, and other treasures that King Asa and his father Abijah had promised to give to Yahweh.

The armies of Asa, king of Judah, and Baasha, king of Israel, are at war throughout their reigns. People have been fighting between the kingdom of Judah and the kingdom of Israel for a long time.

Stop here and, as a group, discuss the different words for “war” in your language. Which word for war would work best here? Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller introduces one specific battle to show the nature of the fight between Israel and Judah. Baasha builds up the city of Ramah, which is about 8 kilometres north of Jerusalem. The city of Ramah already exists. Baasha captures Ramah and makes it stronger. Baasha strengthens the city walls and places many soldiers in Ramah. Now the storyteller explains why Baasha makes Ramah city stronger. Baasha does this to stop people from going in and out of Judah, where King Asa rules.

Stop here and, as a group, find the city of Ramah on the map. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller starts the next sentence with a word that shows these events happen next or happen because of what Baasha did. Then King Asa takes the silver and gold that remain in the treasuries in Yahweh’s temple and in King Asa’s palace. Asa likely does not take the gold himself but asks his officials to do that. King Asa gives the silver and gold to some of his servants and sends it to Ben-Hadad. Ben-Hadad is the son of Tabrimmon, who is the son of Hezion. Ben-Hadad is the king of Syria and rules from Damascus, the capital city of Syria. The silver and gold are not coins, but lumps of metal or sacred objects from the temple, such as bowls, cups, or decorations. People did not use coins at that time. King Asa tells his men to tell Ben-Hadad to make a covenant, or a serious agreement to help each other in wars, just like the agreement the father of Asa made with the father of Ben-Hadad. The storyteller uses a word to draw Ben-Hadad’s attention to the generous gift of silver and gold that Asa is sending to Ben-Hadad. King Asa also asks Ben-Hadad to break, or cancel, his agreement with King Baasha of Israel and fight against King Baasha so that Baasha will leave the land of King Asa.

Stop here and, as a group, locate Syria and the city of Damascus on the map. Pause this audio here.

King Ben-Hadad agrees to King Asa’s plan and does more than King Asa asks. King Ben-Hadad sends commanders and soldiers to attack towns in the northern kingdom of Israel. The army captures the cities of Ijon, Dan, and Abel Beth Maacah. People called the city of Abel Beth Maacah “Abel Maim” and “Abel” in other parts of the Bible. The army also captures the land of Kinnereth, including the city of Kinnereth, the lake of Kinnereth, and the land south of the city. Lake Kinnereth is another name for the Lake of Galilee. The cities of Ijon, Dan, Abel Beth Maacah, and Kinnereth are on an important international road that King Baasha needs for trade, travel, and defence. King Ben-Hadad’s army also captures the land of the tribe of Naphtali.

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Stop here and, as a group, find the cities of Ijon, Dan, Abel Beth Maacah, the land of Kinnereth, and the land of the tribe of Naphtali on the map. Pause this audio here.

As soon as King Baasha of Israel hears this news, King Baasha stops making Ramah stronger and abandons the work there. King Baasha goes back to live in the city of Tirzah. Then King Asa sends a message to all Judah. The words for "sends a message" in the original language mean that King Asa causes everyone to hear him. King Asa requires everyone to carry away from Ramah the stones and the wood that King Baasha used to fortify Ramah. The men of Judah use these materials to make the cities of Geba and Mizpah stronger.

Stop here and, as a group, find the cities of Tirzah, Geba, and Mizpah on the map. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller sums up and judges the reign of King Asa. The storyteller says that people record the other events during Asa's reign in the book called "History of the Kings of Judah." The people write about the good things that Asa does and about how Asa strengthens several cities in his land. This book records the actions of the kings of Judah during their reigns. Everything the storyteller mentions so far about Asa's reign shows that Yahweh is pleased with Asa. Now the storyteller talks about something that shows Yahweh's disapproval of Asa. The storyteller uses words that contrast the earlier time of blessing with the new time of disapproval. However, when Asa is old, Asa develops a disease in his feet.

Then Asa dies and sleeps with his fathers, which means Asa goes to be with his ancestors. People bury Asa in the City of David, Asa's father, where people bury Asa's other fathers. In all these cases, the word "father" means ancestor. Then Asa's son Jehoshaphat becomes king of Judah in his place.

Stop here and, as a group, locate the City of David on a map of Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:9–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has 11 scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jeroboam, king of Israel
- Asa, king of Judah
- Maacah, Asa's grandmother
- Yahweh
- Male cult prostitutes
- Asa's servants, or men
- Ben-Hadad, king of Syria
- Ben-Hadad's commanders and soldiers
- All the men and women of Judah
- And Jehoshaphat, son of Asa

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

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The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

When Jeroboam has been king over Israel for 20 years, Asa becomes king over Judah. Asa rules in Jerusalem for 41 years. Asa's mother's name is Maacah. Maacah's father's name is Abishalom.

King Asa does what Yahweh thinks is right, just like his ancestor King David did. King Asa drives out all the male cult prostitutes who live in the land of Judah. King Asa also removes all the filthy idols that the kings of Judah had made before King Asa.

King Asa removes his grandmother Maacah from being queen mother because Maacah made a horrible idol to worship the false goddess Asherah. King Asa cuts down the idol Maacah made and burns the pieces at the Kidron Brook in the Kidron Valley.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Asa, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am trying my best to act in a way that pleases Yahweh, my God; or
- I feel angry that the cult prostitutes and idols are still in Judah. I will get rid of them all; or
- I feel shame that my own grandmother, the queen mother, made a horrible idol to worship the false goddess Asherah. My grandmother will no longer be queen mother.

Continue the drama.

However, King Asa does not remove all the shrines on the hilltops where people worship other gods. Even so, King Asa remains completely faithful to Yahweh all the days of King Asa's life.

King Asa puts holy gifts into Yahweh's temple. These gifts are silver, gold, and other treasures that King Asa and his father Abijah had promised to give to Yahweh.

The armies of Asa, king of Judah, and Baasha, king of Israel, are at war throughout their reigns. Baasha captures Ramah city and makes it stronger to stop people from going in and out of Judah, where King Asa rules.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Baasha, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel threatened. I am worried that Judah is becoming a powerful country because Yahweh is blessing them; or
- I feel angry at Judah. We are enemies, and I want to keep control over the border between our countries; or
- I feel confident and powerful. Because we captured and strengthened Rama, people will not be able to travel in and out of Judah. This will weaken Judah and protect my kingdom.

Continue the drama.

Then King Asa takes the silver and gold that remain in the treasuries in Yahweh's temple and in King Asa's palace. King Asa sends some of his men with the silver and gold to Ben-Hadad, the king of Syria, who rules from Damascus. King Asa sends a message to Ben-Hadad. Asa suggests that Asa and Ben-Hadad make a covenant, or a serious agreement to help each other in wars, just like the agreement the father of Asa made with the father of Ben-Hadad. Asa draws Ben-Hadad's attention to the generous gift of silver and gold that Asa is sending to Ben-Hadad. King Asa asks Ben-Hadad to break, or cancel, his agreement with King Baasha of Israel. Asa wants Ben-Hadad to fight against King Baasha so that Baasha will leave the land of King Asa.

King Ben-Hadad agrees to King Asa's plan, and King Ben-Hadad sends commanders and soldiers to attack towns in the northern kingdom of Israel. The army captures the cities of Ijon, Dan, and Abel Beth Maacah. The army also captures the land of Kinnereth, including the city of Kinnereth, the lake of Kinnereth, and the land south of the city. King Ben-Hadad's army also captures the land of the tribe of Naphtali.

King Baasha of Israel hears the news that Ben-Hadad has captured cities in northern Israel. King Baasha stops fortifying Ramah and abandons the work there. King Baasha goes back to live in the city of Tirzah. Then King Asa sends a message to all Judah. King Asa requires everyone, without exception, to carry away from Ramah the stones and the wood that King Baasha used to fortify Ramah. The men of Judah use these materials to make the cities of Geba and Mizpah stronger.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Ben-Hadad of Syria, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy because King Asa of Judah came to me to ask for help. Asa gave me silver and gold; or
- I feel strong because I am going to attack Israel. This shows how powerful Syria is; or
- I feel in control. I captured important cities in northern Israel, and as a result, King Baasha abandoned Ramah city. King Asa is pleased.

Continue the drama.

Now the storyteller sums up and evaluates the reign of King Asa. The storyteller says that people record the other events during Asa's reign in the book called "History of the Kings of Judah." The people write about Asa's successes and accomplishments and about how Asa strengthens several cities in his land. However, when Asa is old, Asa develops a disease in his feet.

Then Asa dies and goes to be with his ancestors. People bury Asa in the city of his ancestor, David, where people buried Asa's other ancestors. And Asa's son Jehoshaphat becomes king of Judah in his place.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy with King Asa because he did what is right, and Asa obeyed me; or
- I feel sad about King Baasha because he did evil and did not obey me; or
- I feel disappointed that Asa did not ask me for help to defeat Baasha. Asa made an agreement with the foreign king Ben-Hadad instead.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:9–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

When Jeroboam has been **king** over **Israel** for 20 years, Asa becomes king over **Judah**. Use the same words or phrases for king, Israel, and Judah as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, Israel, and Judah, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Asa does what is right in the sight of Yahweh. This means Asa does what Yahweh considers right, just like David, Asa's father, did. Translate "does what is right in the sight of Yahweh" like you did in previous passages.

Yahweh is God's personal name. Use the same name for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Father means ancestor here, not biological father. Use the same word for "father" when it means ancestor as you used in previous passages.

King Asa chases away all the **male cult prostitutes** who live in the land of Judah. King Asa also removes all the horrible **idols** that the kings of Judah had made before King Asa. Use the same words or phrases for male cult prostitute and idol as you used in previous passages. For more information on idol, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and, as a group, discuss whether you will describe the idol as **horrible** or **dirty**. Pause this audio here.

King Asa removes his grandmother Maacah from being queen mother because Maacah makes a horrible image to worship the false goddess Asherah.

Stop here and, as a group, discuss how you will translate **horrible image**. If you already translated 2 Chronicles 15:16, check how you translated "horrible image" there. Pause this audio here.

However, King Asa does not remove all the **shrines** on the **hilltops** where people worship other gods. Use the same words or phrases for shrines on hilltops as you used in previous passages.

Even so, King Asa fully commits his **heart** to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for heart as you used in previous passages. For more information on heart, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Asa responds to Baasha's capture of Ramah city. Asa takes the silver and gold that remain in the treasuries in Yahweh's **temple** and in King Asa's palace. King Asa gives the silver and gold to some of his **servants** and sends it to Ben-Hadad, King of Syria. King Asa tells Ben-Hadad that they should make a **covenant**, or a serious agreement to help each other in wars, just like the covenant that the father of Asa made with the father of Ben-Hadad. Use the same words or phrases for temple, servants, and covenant as you used in previous passages. For more information on temple, servants, and covenant, refer to the Master Glossary.

People record the other events of Asa's reign in the **book** called "**History of the Kings of Judah**."

Translate "book, or **scroll**, called the History of the Kings of Judah" as you did before. Scroll is in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 15:9–24

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (981 KB)
- Setting the Stage (8.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (12.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 15:25–32

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 15:25–31 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:25–31 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 15:25–32

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:25–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The last few stories have been about the kings of Judah. The storyteller now begins a section about the kings of Israel. This is an unstable time in Israel. While King Asa rules in Judah, five men will replace each other as king in Israel, and most of these men will die in a violent way. The first king is Nadab. While Nadab is king, Baasha kills Nadab in order to take Nadab's place as king.

Remember that Jeroboam was the first king of Israel after Israel and Judah became two kingdoms. When Jeroboam died, Jeroboam's son, Nadab, became the next king of Israel. At this time, Asa is in his second year as king of Judah. Nadab rules Israel for two years, and Nadab acts in a way that displeases Yahweh. Nadab sins as Jeroboam had sinned. Jeroboam had led the Israelites in such a way that the Israelites willingly chose to sin as well. One way Jeroboam sinned was that he worshiped a golden statue of a calf.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: As an activity, tell a story about something that happened in your people group's history. Then tell a story about something that happened at the same time with another people group or in another area. Pay attention to the way you show that these two stories happen at similar times. Pause this audio here.

In his second year as king, Nadab attempts to capture the Philistine city of Gibbethon. However, Baasha, an Israelite man who is the son of a man named Ahijah, plans to kill Nadab. So while Nadab and the Israelite army surround Gibbethon, Baasha kills Nadab.

Baasha kills Nadab and becomes the next king of Israel while Asa is still king of Judah. Once Baasha is king, Baasha immediately kills all of Jeroboam's family. Baasha probably kills Jeroboam's family to make sure that no one will try to take revenge on Baasha or try to take the throne from Baasha. This happens just as Yahweh said it would happen. Remember that Yahweh had told Ahijah, the prophet from Shiloh, to tell Jeroboam that Jeroboam's family would die because of how Jeroboam sinned. Yahweh, Israel's God, was angry because of the way Jeroboam had sinned. Not only had Jeroboam sinned, but Jeroboam had also caused the Israelites to sin as well.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time in your history or in the history of a nearby country when someone violently took over as leader. How did the new leader make sure that no one would try to stop the new leader? What do people think about a leader who takes over and rules like this? Pause this audio here.

Everything else Nadab did as king is in the book or scroll that has the history of the kings of Israel. This story shows that Yahweh does what Yahweh says he will do. If people sin, Yahweh will punish those people.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:25–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller formally introduces Nadab and how Nadab rules.

1 Kings 15:25–32

In the second scene: Baasha kills Nadab and becomes king.

In the third scene: Baasha kills Jeroboam's family, just like Yahweh said would happen.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller formally ends Nadab's story.

The characters in this passage are:

- Nadab
- Jeroboam
- Asa, king of Judah
- Yahweh
- The people of Israel, including the army
- Baasha, Ahijah's son
- Jeroboam's family
- And Yahweh's prophet, Ahijah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller uses the same formal language to introduce Nadab, the king of Israel, as the storyteller did for Asa, Abijah, and Rehoboam. The storyteller explains who Nadab's father is, who rules in Judah when Nadab becomes king, how long Nadab rules, and how Nadab rules.

Stop here and review how you translated the introduction to the kings of Judah. Pause this audio here.

When the storyteller says that Nadab rules for two years, the storyteller means that Nadab rules during two different years. Nadab becomes king in the second year that Asa is king in Judah, and dies in the third year that Asa is king of Judah. In this time, people would often count parts of years as whole years. It is possible that Nadab became king at the very beginning of one year and died at the very end of the next year, and so may have ruled for almost two years. It is also possible that Nadab reigned for fewer than two full years.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Imagine that something begins during one year and ends during the next year, but you are not sure exactly when during the year it began or ended. In your language, how would you talk about that amount of time? Pause this audio here.

Nadab does evil in the eyes of Yahweh, which means that Nadab does what Yahweh says is evil. The storyteller has used this phrase before when he told the stories of Rehoboam and Solomon. The storyteller will continue to use this phrase for each of the next few kings, so you will want to translate this phrase in the same way throughout all of the stories.

Stop here and review how you translated the phrase "did evil in Yahweh's eyes" or "acted in an evil way." Pause this audio here.

Nadab follows his father Jeroboam's example and sins, like someone follows another person on a path.

The second scene is about how Baasha kills Nadab. In Nadab's second year as king, Nadab tries to take over the Philistine town of Gibbethon. All Israel, which is all of Nadab's army, goes with Nadab and besieges Gibbethon. This is the way an army surrounds a town in order to defeat the people in the town and take control of the town. Gibbethon is probably about 20 kilometers east of the Mediterranean Sea on the western edge of the Judean hills. One of the Israelite tribes did not conquer this town like they should have when the Israelites first arrived in this land.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and Philistia. Find the town of Gibbethon. Pause this audio here.

Baasha plots against or makes plans to harm Nadab. Baasha's father is Ahijah, who is a different man from Ahijah the prophet. Baasha is from the house or tribe of Issachar. While Nadab is outside Gibbethon, Baasha strikes Nadab down. To strike someone down means to kill that person, since a person who stands will fall to the ground if someone kills him. The storyteller then explains that Baasha killed Nadab and became king in place of Nadab during Asa's third year as king of Judah.

The third scene happens right after Baasha becomes king. Baasha immediately kills Jeroboam's family. Baasha probably does not do this all himself, but instead has other men help Baasha do this. The storyteller says

three times, in three different ways, that Baasha kills Jeroboam's family. The storyteller says that Baasha kills Jeroboam's family and destroys Jeroboam's family. The storyteller also says that there is no one left in Jeroboam's family who breathes. No one in Jeroboam's family breathes because all of Jeroboam's family is dead. The storyteller talks about what Baasha does three times to emphasize that Baasha definitely kills everyone in Jeroboam's family. Yahweh had given Ahijah the prophet a word or message about how this would happen, and it did happen just like Yahweh said it would happen. The way Jeroboam acted had angered Yahweh. The storyteller reminds us that Yahweh is Israel's God, whom the Israelites should have worshiped. But the Israelites did not worship Yahweh during Jeroboam's time as king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you emphasize that something really happened, especially something terrible? What different phrases do you have for the way that someone kills someone else? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller again uses the same formal language to finish Nadab's story as the storyteller used for Abijah and Rehoboam's stories. The storyteller has just included some parts of Nadab's story here, but everything else Nadab did as king is in another book. In the original language, this statement is a question, but the storyteller just means to emphasize that this is really true.

Stop here and review how you translated the end of the stories about the kings of Judah. The storyteller tells the end of stories about the kings of Israel in the same way. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:25–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Nadab
- Jeroboam
- Asa, king of Judah
- Yahweh
- The people of Israel, including the army
- Baasha, Ahijah's son
- Jeroboam's family
- And Yahweh's prophet, Ahijah

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Jeroboam's son Nadab began to rule over Israel during Asa's second year as king of Judah. Nadab was king of Israel for two years. Nadab acted in an evil way that did not please Yahweh. Nadab sinned just like his father, Jeroboam, had sinned. Jeroboam had caused the people of Israel to sin, and Nadab sinned in the same way.

1 Kings 15:25–32

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Nadab, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I respect my father and act in the same way that he lived; or
- I did not learn about Yahweh as I grew up, and I do not care about Yahweh enough to learn about him now; or
- I love that I am king and I can do anything I want!

Continue the drama.

Baasha, the son of Ahijah from the tribe of Issachar, made plans to get rid of Nadab. Baasha killed Nadab at Gibbethon, which is a Philistine town. At that time, Nadab and his army had surrounded the town of Gibbethon in order to capture it. Baasha killed Nadab in the third year of Asa, king of Judah. Then Baasha ruled as king.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Baasha, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I do not like Nadab and how Nadab rules. I would be a better king than Nadab; or
- Our king does not have to come from a special family. I remember that Jeroboam became king of Israel even though he was not from Solomon’s family; or
- I am happy that my plan worked and that I am king. Now I can do whatever I want.

Continue the drama.

As soon as Baasha began to rule, Baasha killed everyone in Jeroboam’s family. No one in Jeroboam’s family survived. Baasha killed them all. This is exactly what Yahweh had said would happen through his servant Ahijah of Shiloh. This happened because Jeroboam sinned and because Jeroboam caused Israel to sin. Jeroboam had angered Yahweh, the God of Israel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I know what will happen because Jeroboam sinned. Because Jeroboam did not lead the Israelites to honor me and live in a good way, the Israelites will act in evil ways. Baasha will act in an evil way and kill Jeroboam’s family. I am sad that the Israelites hurt each other when they sin; or
- I still care for the Israelites, even when they act in an evil way. I will warn Jeroboam about what will happen; or
- I told the Israelites that the way they sin will affect their children and grandchildren.

Continue the drama.

The other things that happened while Nadab was king, and all that Nadab did, are in the book that has the history of the kings of Israel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel nervous that our new king killed our old king. I am worried that our new king will continue to act in a violent way; or
- I was surprised when I heard that Baasha killed Nadab and all of Jeroboam’s family. ; or
- My parents followed the example of Jeroboam and acted as he did. Our king is our leader, so I will act as he does.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:25–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

1 Kings 15:25–32

Nadab, the **son** of Jeroboam, becomes **king** of Israel. For more information on son and king, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for son and king as you used in previous passages.

Here, **Israel** means the northern kingdom. When the storyteller says that all Israel is at Gibbethon, the storyteller means the whole army of people who live in the northern kingdom of Israel. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

Asa is king of **Judah** while Nadab rules in Israel. Judah is the southern kingdom. Use the same word or phrase for Judah as you used in previous passages, and refer to Judah in the Master Glossary if needed.

Nadab acts in an **evil** way in the eyes of Yahweh. Evil is the opposite of good. For more information on evil, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for evil and acting "in the eyes of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages.

The name **Yahweh** is a very personal name for God that shows the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Nadab **sins** like Jeroboam sinned. Sin is an act of rebellion against God. Anytime that a person disobeys God's laws, that person sins. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages.

Nadab "besieges" or attacks Gibbethon with a **siege**. A city usually had thick walls to keep attackers out of the city. The attackers would surround the city so that the people inside could not come out to get food, water, and other supplies. The people inside the city would have to either starve, surrender, or fight the enemy to escape. For more information on siege, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for siege as you used in previous passages.

Baasha, who is from the **house** of Issachar, kills everyone in the **house** of Jeroboam. People sometimes used the word household, or house, to mean a large group of people who did not live in the same house, but who had something in common. So the house of Jeroboam refers not to a building but to the people who are in Jeroboam's family. This includes all of Jeroboam's descendants and probably most of his relatives as well. The house of Issachar is the tribe of Issachar, who are all Issachar's descendants. For more information on house, refer to "household" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for house when the storyteller uses it to mean a large family group as you used in previous passages.

Ahijah the prophet received the **word of Yahweh** about what would happen to Jeroboam's family. The word of Yahweh means what Yahweh tells people. For more information on the word of Yahweh, refer to "word" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the "word of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages.

Ahijah is Yahweh's **servant** or **prophet**. A servant is a person who serves someone else. People would often call prophets Yahweh's servants, and the storyteller calls Ahijah Yahweh's servant here. A prophet is a person who gives messages from God to the people. For more information on servant or prophet, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for servant as you used in previous passages.

Jeroboam had **provoked**, or caused, Yahweh to be angry. Use the same word or phrase for provoked as you have in previous passages. Yahweh is Israel's **God**. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Nadab's story is also in the book or **scroll** that tells the history of the kings of Israel. A scroll is a long strip of material on which people would write down stories. Because those sheets were very long, people rolled them up around a stick. For more information on scroll, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for scroll or book as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a scroll again as a group as needed.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 15:25–32

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (834 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 15:33–16:7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 15:32–16:7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:32–16:7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:32–16:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Baasha killed King Nadab, and Baasha became king. This story is about how Baasha rules as king. Baasha sins, just like Nadab and Jeroboam had sinned. So Yahweh gives a prophet a message for Baasha.

Because of how Baasha has acted, Yahweh will punish Baasha like Yahweh punished Jeroboam. All of Baasha's family will die.

Baasha, son of Ahijah, becomes king while Asa is in his third year as king of Judah. The whole time Baasha rules Israel, the Israelites fight with the people of Judah. Baasha rules for 24 years from the city of Tirzah. Remember that Jeroboam had chosen Shechem as his capital city, but now Baasha rules from Tirzah. Tirzah is about 11 kilometres northeast of Shechem. Baasha acts in a way that displeases Yahweh. Like Jeroboam, Baasha sins and leads the Israelites in such a way that the Israelites willingly choose to sin as well.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the towns of Shechem and Tirzah. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh speaks to a prophet named Jehu, who is Hanani's son. Yahweh's message is for Baasha, and it is very similar to Yahweh's message for Jeroboam. Yahweh says that Baasha used to be a man without power or influence, but Yahweh chose Baasha to lead Israel. However, Baasha has not led well. Baasha has followed the example of Jeroboam and has caused the Israelites to sin. This has made Yahweh angry. Yahweh will completely destroy Baasha and Baasha's family. Someone will kill Baasha's family, just like Baasha killed Jeroboam's family. No matter where someone from Baasha's family dies, no one will bury that person's body. If someone from Baasha's family dies in a city, dogs will eat that person's dead body. If someone from Baasha's family dies outside the cities, birds that eat meat will eat that person's dead body.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your area, what are some animals that eat dead things? How do people feel about these animals? Pause this audio here.

It was very important during this time for someone to bury a dead person's body. It was very shameful for the dead person if no one buried that person's body. People often believed that if no one buried a dead person's body, this was a sign that God was unhappy with that person and wanted to punish that person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what is a respectful way to treat a dead body? What do people think about a body that no one buries? How would you feel if someone did not bury the body of someone you know? Pause this audio here.

Everything else Baasha did as king, including his actions as a military leader, is in the book or scroll that tells the history of the kings of Israel. Baasha dies, and people bury him in a place that is close to where they buried Baasha's ancestors in Tirzah. Baasha's son Elah then becomes king.

Yahweh spoke to Jehu, Yahweh's prophet, about Baasha because of the evil things Baasha had done. Like Jeroboam, Yahweh chose Baasha to lead Israel. Like Jeroboam, Yahweh gave Baasha the opportunity to honor Yahweh as Israel's true king when Baasha killed the previous king and began to rule in that king's place. Remember that Yahweh said that all of Jeroboam's male descendants will die. You will remember from the previous story that Baasha chose to kill Nadab and all of Jeroboam's descendants, both male and female. But then Baasha does not act any better than Nadab and Jeroboam. Baasha sins and does not honor Yahweh as Israel's true king. Yahweh still punished Jeroboam and caused Jeroboam's male descendants to die, just as Yahweh planned, despite the way that Baasha sinned. But because Baasha sinned, Yahweh will punish Baasha too.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you saw how God did amazing things, even through people who did not worship or honor God.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:32–16:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller formally introduces Baasha and how Baasha rules.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives Jehu a message to tell Baasha. Yahweh says that because Baasha has sinned, Baasha and his entire family will die.

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In the third scene: The storyteller formally ends Baasha's story.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller repeats that Yahweh gave Jehu this message because of the evil way Baasha acted.

The characters in this passage are:

- Baasha, Ahijah's son
- Asa, king of Judah
- The people of Israel, the northern kingdom
- Yahweh
- Jeroboam, Nebat's son
- Jeroboam's family
- Jehu, Hanani's son
- Baasha's family
- And Elah, Baasha's son

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller tells us that Baasha and the Israelites are at war with Asa and the people of Judah while both Baasha and Asa reign.

Though the storyteller has already talked about Baasha, the storyteller still uses the same formal language to introduce Baasha as the storyteller used for Nadab's story. In the first scene, the storyteller explains who Baasha's father is, who rules in Judah when Baasha becomes king, how long Baasha rules, and how Baasha rules. Remember that Baasha's father Ahijah is a different man from the prophet Ahijah in the last story.

Stop here and review how you translated the introduction to Nadab's story. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller has already told how Baasha fought with Asa in Asa's story and how Baasha became king during Nadab's story. The storyteller does not repeat those parts of Baasha's story. Here, the storyteller focuses on how Baasha sins and how Yahweh responds to Baasha.

Baasha becomes king of all Israel, which means all of the northern kingdom of Israel. Baasha rules from the city of Tirzah for 24 years.

Baasha does evil in the eyes of Yahweh, which means that Baasha does what Yahweh says is evil. The storyteller uses the same phrase that he used for Nadab. Baasha also follows Jeroboam's example and sins, like someone follows another person on a path.

Stop here and review how you translated the phrase "did evil in Yahweh's eyes" or "acted in an evil way." Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh talks to Jehu, Yahweh's prophet. Once Yahweh finishes speaking, Jehu goes and repeats the message to Baasha. Sometimes Yahweh talks about "Baasha's family," and sometimes Yahweh speaks about "your family." But the whole time, Yahweh speaks to Baasha in this message.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, when are some times when you might change how you talk to a person, like Yahweh talks to Baasha here? If you do not talk like this in your language, you can follow the example of some translations that show Yahweh talking in just one way to Baasha. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh "exalted" or lifted Baasha out of the dust. This is a poetic way to say that Baasha was not an important person until Yahweh made Baasha the ruler of Israel. Notice that Yahweh uses a different word for ruler than the word for king. Yahweh would often use this word for ruler or leader to mean someone Yahweh chooses to lead. This kind of ruler should understand that Yahweh is Israel's true king.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about how Yahweh lifts Baasha out of the dust and how Yahweh chooses Baasha to be ruler. Pause this audio here.

Notice how Yahweh calls Israel his people even though the Israelites sin. However, Yahweh is angry that his people sin, so Yahweh says Yahweh will burn or utterly sweep away Baasha and his house. This means Yahweh

will completely destroy Baasha's household in the way that a fire or a flood completely destroys something. Baasha's family will die as Jeroboam's family did. Yahweh describes the way that no one will bury the dead bodies in the same way that Yahweh did in Yahweh's message to Jeroboam.

Stop here and review how you translated Yahweh's message to Jeroboam in 1 Kings 14:11, when Yahweh talked about how animals would eat the dead bodies. You should translate how Yahweh talks to Baasha in the same way here. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller uses formal language to finish Baasha's story. The storyteller has just included some parts of Baasha's story here, but everything else Baasha did as king is in another book. Notice this time that the storyteller says here that Baasha's achievements or mighty deeds are also in that other book. These mighty deeds are probably how Baasha fought and led during battles.

Stop here and review how you translated the end of Nadab's story. You will want to use the same phrases here, but include the storyteller's comment about Baasha's military achievements. In your language, how do you talk about a king's military achievements? Pause this audio here.

Baasha sleeps with his ancestors, which is a common polite phrase that means Baasha dies. People bury Baasha's body in Tirzah. Then Baasha's son, Elah, becomes king. These phrases are like the ones the storyteller used for the end of Asa's story, so you can translate this part in the same way you did earlier.

Stop here and review how you translated the end of Asa's story in 1 Kings 15:24. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller repeats why Yahweh sent this message to Jehu to emphasize how important the message was. The storyteller also gives some more information about one way Baasha sinned. Baasha made Yahweh angry not only because Baasha acted like Jeroboam but because Baasha killed Jeroboam's family. This seems surprising, since Yahweh said that Yahweh would punish Jeroboam's family in this way. However, Baasha killed not just the men, but the women as well. And Baasha did not kill Jeroboam's family in order to honor Yahweh. We can see this because Baasha sins as Jeroboam did. Baasha just killed Jeroboam's family because Baasha wanted to become king and continue to sin.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:32–16:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Baasha, Ahijah's son
- Asa, king of Judah
- The people of Israel, the northern kingdom
- Yahweh
- Jeroboam, Nebat's son
- Jeroboam's family
- Jehu, Hanani's son
- Baasha's family
- And Elah, Baasha's son

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

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The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

All the time that Asa ruled Judah and Baasha ruled Israel, their armies continued to fight each other. Ahijah's son Baasha began to rule over Israel during Asa's third year as king of Judah. Baasha ruled from Tirzah and was king of Israel for 24 years. Baasha acted in an evil way that did not please Yahweh. Baasha sinned just like Jeroboam had sinned. Jeroboam had caused the people of Israel to sin, and Baasha sinned in the same way.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Baasha, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Now that I am king, I can do whatever I want; or
- I think that I act in the right way, so I will lead the Israelites to act in the same way; or
- I am a better king than Nadab. Look how long I have been able to rule!

Continue the drama.

Then Yahweh gave this message to Jehu, son of Hanani, to give to Baasha: "I made you the leader of my people, the people of Israel, although you were nobody important. But you have lived in the same evil way as Jeroboam. You have caused my people Israel to sin. This has made me very angry! So I am going to destroy you, Baasha, and your family line. I brought to an end the family of Nebat's son Jeroboam. Now I will do the same to your family! If your family members die in the city, dogs will eat their bodies. If your family members die in the open fields, birds will eat their bodies."

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jehu, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I felt angry when I saw how Baasha sinned and led the Israelites to sin. I wanted Baasha to stop! or
- I am thankful that Yahweh will act in a just way and punish Baasha; or
- I am nervous to give this message to the king. The king may be very angry when he hears this!

Continue the drama.

The other things that happened while Baasha was king, and all that Baasha did and all Baasha's mighty deeds, are in the book that tells the history of the kings of Israel. Baasha died, and people buried his body in Tirzah. Then Baasha's son Elah became king in Baasha's place.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad my father is dead; or
- I heard the message that the prophet gave to my father. I am worried about what will happen while I am king; or
- I am excited to be king and rule. Perhaps I will rule like my father did!

Continue the drama.

Yahweh gave this message to Baasha and Baasha's family through the prophet Jehu, son of Hanani, because Baasha acted in an evil way that did not please Yahweh. Baasha had made Yahweh very angry by the way Baasha acted. Baasha killed all of Jeroboam's family and then became just like Jeroboam!

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- I am sad and angry that Baasha chose to sin. I will punish Baasha for the bad way he has led Israel; or
- Sometimes I work through one person to punish another person. However, the person who does my work must do it in the right way and for the right reason; or
- I am sad that my people continue to sin. Yet I love my people and will not immediately punish them all. I will continue to give my people more opportunities to obey me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 15:32–16:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Baasha becomes **king** of Israel. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages.

Here, **Israel** means the northern kingdom. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

Asa is the king of **Judah**, while Baasha rules in Israel. Judah is the southern kingdom. Use the same word or phrase for Judah as you used in previous passages.

Baasha acts in an **evil** way in the eyes of Yahweh. Evil is the opposite of good. For more information on evil, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for evil and "in the eyes of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages.

The name **Yahweh** is a very personal name for God that shows the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Baasha **sins** like Jeroboam sinned. Sin is an act of rebellion against God. Anytime that a person disobeys God's laws, that person sins. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages.

Jehu received the **word of Yahweh** about what would happen to Baasha's family. The word of Yahweh means what Yahweh tells people. For more information on the word of Yahweh, refer to "word" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the "word of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh **appointed** Baasha as a ruler over Israel. To appoint means to assign a job or role to someone and give them authority to act in a certain way.

Yahweh appointed Baasha a **ruler**, or **chosen leader**. In the original language, this is not the same word as king. This means that Yahweh will still be the highest ruler, and this man will be second to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for ruler or chosen leader as you used in previous passages.

Everyone in the **house** of Baasha will die. People sometimes used the word household or house to mean a large group of people who did not live in the same house but who had something in common. So the house of Baasha is the people who are in Baasha's family. For more information on house, refer to "household" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for house as you used in previous passages.

Birds of the air or of the **heavens** will eat the dead bodies. Here, heaven means the visible sky, where birds fly. Some translations do not include this word since "birds of the heavens" is just another way to say "birds." For more information on heaven, refer to the Master Glossary. If you chose to use the word heavens in your translation, use the same word or phrase for heaven as you used in Yahweh's message to Jeroboam.

Baasha's story is also in the book or **scroll** that tells the history of the kings of Israel. A scroll is a long strip of material on which people would write down stories. Because those sheets were very long, people rolled them up around a stick. For more information, refer to "scroll" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for scroll or book as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a scroll again as a group as needed. Pause this audio here.

Jehu is a **prophet**. A prophet is a person who gives messages from God to the people. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for prophet as you used in previous passages.

Baasha's actions also **provoked**, or caused, Yahweh to be angry. Use the same word or phrase for provoked as you have in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 15:33–16:7

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (885 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 16:8–14

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 16:8–14 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:8–14 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 16:8–14

5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:8–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The last story was about how Baasha ruled as king of Israel. Because of how Baasha sinned, Yahweh said that all of Baasha's family would die. This story is about King Elah, Baasha's son. While Elah is king, a man named Zimri kills Elah in order to take Elah's place as king. Then Zimri kills all of Baasha's family, just like Yahweh said would happen.

Elah, son of Baasha, becomes king of Israel while Asa is in his 26th year as king of Judah. Elah rules for two years from the city of Tirzah. Remember that Tirzah is the capital city, or the city where the kings of Israel live and rule from.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel that shows the city of Tirzah, as needed. Pause this audio here.

Elah has a military officer whose name is Zimri. Zimri is in charge of half of Elah's chariots. Chariots were wagon-like vehicles with two wheels. Horses pulled the chariots and two men rode in each chariot. One of these men drove the chariot while the other man fought as a warrior.

Stop here and look at a picture of a chariot as a group. Pause this audio here.

Zimri plans to kill King Elah. One day, Elah is in Tirzah at the house of Arza. Arza is in charge of Elah's palace, which is the house where the king lives. Arza probably takes care of the palace building, the people in the palace, and the king's property. Elah drinks alcohol with Arza and Elah becomes drunk.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of alcoholic drinks do people drink? At what times or in what ways is it appropriate to drink alcohol, and when is it not appropriate? What would people in your culture think about a leader who drinks alcohol until they are drunk? Pause this audio here.

Zimri comes into Arza's house and kills Elah. Then Zimri becomes king. Zimri does this in Asa's 27th year as king of Judah.

Zimri sits on the throne, or the special seat for a king. This is another way to say Zimri makes himself king. And once Zimri is king, Zimri then kills Baasha's family. Zimri does not kill the female members of Baasha's family, but Zimri does kill all of the male relatives. In this time, if someone killed another person, people expected the relatives of the dead person to take revenge on the killer. So in this way, Zimri makes sure that no one in Baasha's family can take revenge. Zimri also kills the old king's friends who might rebel against Zimri. Zimri kills everyone who might try to kill Zimri.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what is the special seat or place where a king sits? What are some things that a man does to show that he has become king, such as wear certain clothes or live in a certain place? Pause this audio here.

This is exactly what Yahweh had said would happen because Baasha and his son Elah had both sinned. Baasha and Elah also caused Israel to sin and led the Israelites to worship idols or false gods. This made Yahweh very angry.

Everything else Elah did as king is in the book or scroll that has the history of the kings of Israel.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:8–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

1 Kings 16:8–14

In the first scene: The storyteller formally introduces Elah.

In the second scene: Zimri kills Elah and becomes king.

In the third scene: Zimri kills Baasha's family and close friends, just like Yahweh said would happen.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller formally ends Elah's story.

The characters in this passage are:

- Asa, king of Judah
- Elah, Baasha's son
- Zimri
- Arza
- Baasha
- Baasha's male family members
- Yahweh
- Baasha's male friends
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Notice how Elah's story is very similar to Nadab's story earlier in the book of 1 Kings! Other men kill both Nadab and Elah in order to become king. Then the new king kills the old king's family, just like Yahweh said would happen. Notice how the storyteller tells Elah's story with some of the same statements as the storyteller used in Nadab's story. The storyteller also begins and ends with statements similar to those in the other kings' stories.

Stop here and, as a group, review the beginning and ending phrases from the other kings' stories, as needed. Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces Elah's time as king. When the storyteller says that Elah rules for two years, the storyteller means that Elah rules during two different years. Elah becomes king of Israel in the 26th year that Asa is king of Judah, and Elah dies in the 27th year that Asa is king of Judah. In this time, people would often count parts of years as whole years. Elah must have ruled for less than two complete years.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember that the storyteller counted parts of a year in the same way in Nadab's story. You will want to translate Elah's two years as king in the same way as you translated Nadab's time as king. Pause this audio here.

The second scene is about how Zimri kills Elah. Zimri is in charge of Elah's chariots. Zimri plots against or makes plans to harm Elah. In Elah's second year as king, Elah is with Arza, in Arza's house. Arza's house is in Tirzah, the capital city of Israel. Arza is in charge of the king's house.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what do you call the place where a king lives and rules from? What do you call a person who takes care of the king's house and the people inside the king's house? Pause this audio here.

Elah drinks alcohol and becomes drunk, which makes it harder for Elah to defend himself. Zimri enters Arza's house, then strikes and kills Elah. To strike and to kill are two ways to say the same thing. This means Zimri hit Elah in order to kill Elah. It is not clear if Arza knew Zimri would do this. The storyteller explains that Zimri kills Elah and becomes king in place of Elah during Asa's 27th year as king of Judah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you say that someone hits another person in order to kill that person? Pause this audio here.

The third scene happens right after Zimri becomes king. Zimri immediately kills Baasha's "house," which is Baasha's family. The storyteller says Zimri kills Baasha's family as soon as Zimri sits on the throne. This phrase emphasizes two things. First, this shows Zimri chose to make himself king, just like Zimri chooses to sit on the throne. This phrase also emphasizes how quickly Zimri begins to kill Baasha's family. Zimri probably does not kill Baasha's family by himself, but instead has other men help Zimri do this.

1 Kings 16:8–14

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you emphasize that something happens very soon after another event? Pause this audio here.

Unlike Baasha, who killed both male and female members of Jeroboam's family, Zimri kills only the male members and relatives of Baasha's family. These relatives are kinsmen redeemers. Kinsmen is another word for relatives. In this time, people expected relatives to buy back or redeem land that another family member had sold. People also expected a relative, or "kinsman redeemer," to take revenge on someone who killed another family member. This is why Zimri kills these relatives, so that they will not kill Zimri. Zimri also kills any men who are friends of Baasha's family.

Stop here and discuss as a group what you want to call the kinsmen redeemers, or relatives that help or take revenge for their relative when someone kills their relative. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh had given Jehu the prophet a "word" or message about how this would happen to Baasha, and it did happen just as Yahweh said it would happen. The way Baasha and Elah acted had made Yahweh angry. The storyteller reminds us that Yahweh is Israel's God, whom the Israelites should have worshiped during Baasha and Elah's time as king. Instead, however, Baasha and Elah led the Israelites to worship idols or statues of false gods. These idols are worthless because these idols cannot do anything or help the Israelites.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller again uses the same formal language to finish Elah's story as the storyteller used for Nadab's story. The storyteller has just included some parts of Elah's story here, but everything else Elah did as king is in another book.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:8–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Asa, king of Judah
- Elah, Baasha's son
- Zimri
- Arza
- Baasha
- Baasha's male family members
- Yahweh
- Baasha's male friends
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

1 Kings 16:8–14

When Asa had been king of Judah for about 26 years, Baasha's son Elah became king of Israel. Elah ruled in the capital city of Tirzah for two years. Zimri was one of Elah's army officials who commanded half of Elah's chariots. Zimri made secret plans to kill Elah. Elah was in Tirzah at that time in Arza's house. Arza was in charge of Elah's palace. Elah had drunk a lot of alcohol. Zimri went into Arza's house and hit Elah so that Elah fell down and died. Then Zimri became king of Israel instead of Elah. At this time, Asa had been king in Judah for about 27 years.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Arza, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I like the king and want to spend time with the king. We will relax at my house and drink alcohol together; or
- I was so surprised when Zimri came in and killed the king; or
- I am nervous that Zimri might kill me, too, if I do not help Zimri.

Ask the person playing Elah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Since I am king, I can relax and do whatever I want to do. I want to drink alcohol and visit my friends; or
- I am not worried about my army or my commanders. My men will surely obey me.

Continue the drama.

As soon as Zimri began to rule and sat on the throne, Zimri killed everybody in Baasha's family. Zimri did not allow a single male relative or friend to live. So Zimri destroyed the whole family of Baasha. All of this happened exactly as Yahweh had told Jehu the prophet.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Zimri, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad my plan worked; or
- I am worried that one of the men from Baasha's family might attack me and become king in my place. I will kill Baasha's family so that no one will try to do that; or
- I heard that King Baasha received a message that all of Baasha's family would die. I should kill Elah and Baasha's family because Baasha's son, Elah, is supposed to die anyway.

Continue the drama.

Yahweh said this because of all the ways that Baasha and his son Elah had sinned. Baasha and Elah led the Israelites to sin. Baasha, Elah, and the Israelites worshiped useless statues and so made Yahweh, the God of Israel, very angry. The other things that happened while Elah was king, and all that he did, are in the book that has the history of the kings of Israel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that the Israelites continue to sin; or
- I am angry that the kings continue to lead the Israelites to sin. The kings hurt the Israelites and themselves when they worship idols that cannot help them; or
- I love the Israelites and will continue to give them more opportunities to obey me. However, when the Israelites sin, I will punish them.

Ask the person playing Asa, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hear about the kings in Israel. I can see how the kings do not obey Yahweh, and Yahweh punishes them. I really should continue to honor and obey Yahweh; or
- I feel sad for the Israelites in the northern kingdom. Those people do not have good kings to lead them; or
- I am nervous when I see bad kings rule Israel. I am worried that those kings may attack us instead of live peacefully with us.

1 Kings 16:8–14

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:8–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Elah becomes **king** of Israel. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages.

Here, **Israel** means the northern kingdom. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

Asa is the king of **Judah**, while Elah rules in Israel. Judah is the southern kingdom. Use the same word or phrase for Judah as you used in previous passages.

Zimri is Elah's **servant** or official who is in charge of half the chariots. A servant is someone who does work for someone else. Here, the storyteller uses the word servant to mean an official or military leader. Use the same word or phrase for a servant who is really an official as you used in previous passages. If you use the word for servant, you can refer to the Master Glossary for more information about the word servant.

Chariots were wagon-like vehicles with two wheels. Horses pulled the chariots, and two men, one driver and one warrior, rode the chariot into battle. The warrior would fight the enemy while standing in the chariot. Use the same word or phrase for chariot as you used in previous passages.

Azra was in charge of Elah's **palace**, which is the special place where a king lived. Use the same word or phrase for palace as you have used in previous passages.

Zimri sits on the **throne**. A throne is a special seat where a king sits. People would often make this special seat from precious materials and decorate the seat. Only a king would sit on a throne. Use the same word or phrase for throne as you used in previous passages.

Zimri kills everyone in the **house** of Baasha. The house of Baasha refers not to a building, but to the people who are in Baasha's family. Remember that here, this just means the male members of Baasha's family. For more information on house, refer to "household" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for house as you used in previous passages.

Zimri kills the male relatives and friends of Baasha. The storyteller uses a word for relatives that really means a kinsman redeemer. In this time, people expected relatives to buy back or redeem land that another family member had sold. People also expected a relative, or "kinsman redeemer," to take revenge on someone who killed another family member. Zimri wants to kill these "kinsmen redeemers" so that none of them will kill Zimri!

Stop here and discuss as a group what you will call these relatives who are really "**redeemers**," or "avengers" of Elah's death. For more information about this idea of redeeming something, refer to "redeem" in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Jehu the prophet received the **word of Yahweh** about what would happen to Baasha's family. The word of Yahweh means what Yahweh tells people. For more information on the word of Yahweh, refer to "word" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the "word of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages.

The name **Yahweh** is a very personal name for God that shows the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Jehu is Yahweh's **prophet**. A prophet is a person who gives messages from God to the people. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for prophet as you used in previous passages.

Baasha and Elah had **sinned**. Sin is an act of rebellion against God. Anytime that a person disobeys God's laws, that person sins. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages.

1 Kings 16:8–14

Yahweh is Israel's **God**. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Baasha and Elah led the Israelites to worship **idols**. An idol is an object that people make in order to worship a god. The object reminds the people about some characteristics of this god. For more information on idol, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for idol as you used in previous passages.

Baasha and Elah **provoked**, or caused, Yahweh to be angry. Use the same word or phrase for provoking Yahweh as you have in previous passages.

Elah's story is also in the book or **scroll** that tells the history of the kings of Israel. A scroll is a long strip of material on which people would write down stories. Because those sheets were very long, people rolled them up around a stick. For more information on scroll, refer to "scriptures" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for scroll or book, and for the name of this book, as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a scroll again as a group as needed.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 16:8–14

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (811 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 16:15–20

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 16:15–20 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:15–20 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:15–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Zimri killed King Elah, and Zimri became king. This story is about Zimri's short time as king. The Israelite army does not accept Zimri as king and chooses another man, Omri, to be king. When Omri and the army attack the city of Tirzah, where the king lives, Zimri kills himself.

Zimri becomes king while Asa is in his 27th year as king of Judah. Zimri rules from the city of Tirzah for only seven days. When Zimri becomes king, the Israelite army is not at Tirzah. The Israelite army is at the Philistine city of Gibbethon. Remember that in Nadab's story, King Nadab and the Israelite army tried to capture Gibbethon. Nadab failed to capture Gibbethon, probably because Baasha killed Nadab during that time.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and Philistia. Find Gibbethon and Tirzah. Pause this audio here.

Someone tells the Israelite army that Zimri secretly planned against Elah and killed Elah. All the Israelites in the army decide they do not want Zimri to be their king. Instead, the Israelites in the army immediately declare that Omri will be their king. Omri is the commander of the whole Israelite army. Remember that Zimri was in charge of half of the chariots in Elah's army before Zimri became king. But Omri was a more important military leader than Zimri.

Then Omri leads the army of Israel away from Gibbethon and to Tirzah, where Zimri is. Omri and the Israelite army surround Tirzah and attack. When Zimri sees that Zimri's enemies have captured Tirzah, Zimri goes into the stronghold of the palace. In this time, a palace or a king's house would have many rooms and parts, like places to keep animals or places for servants to live. The stronghold was probably the strongest and most safe part of the king's house, where the king himself lived.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of rooms or sections does a king's house have? What part of the king's house would the king sleep in? Pause this audio here.

Zimri lights the stronghold rooms on fire while Zimri is in the stronghold, so that Zimri dies in the fire. This is not an honorable way to die in the Israelite culture. Zimri may have been scared of the way the Israelite army might hurt or dishonor Zimri when the Israelite army found Zimri. Zimri dies because Zimri had sinned and acted in a way that displeased Yahweh. Zimri followed Jeroboam's example and led the Israelites to sin. Zimri was a military leader before Zimri became king, so this probably means that Zimri sinned throughout his life and time as a military leader, not just during Zimri's short time as king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people expect a king to act when a king loses a battle? What do people think about a king who kills himself? Pause this audio here.

Everything else Zimri did as king, including the way Zimri planned to kill King Elah, is in the book or scroll that tells the history of the kings of Israel.

1 Kings 16:15–20

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:15–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller formally introduces Zimri.

In the second scene: The Israelite army hears that Zimri is king, but the Israelite army declares that Omri will be king instead.

In the third scene: Omri and the Israelite army attack Tizrah. When the Israelite army captures the city, Zimri goes into the citadel and lights the building on fire to kill himself.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller formally ends Zimri's story.

The characters in this passage are:

- Asa, king of Judah
- Zimri
- The Israelite army
- Omri
- Yahweh
- Jeroboam
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Though the storyteller has already talked about Zimri in the last story, the storyteller still uses formal language to introduce Zimri as king. In the first scene, the storyteller explains who rules in Judah when Zimri becomes king and how long Zimri rules. Notice that the storyteller does not tell us who Zimri's father was, nor whether Zimri acted in a good or evil way here at the beginning of this passage.

The second scene tells how the Israelite army responds when the soldiers hear that Zimri has made himself king. While Elah was king, Elah had apparently sent the army to besiege the Philistine town of Gibbethon. Remember that this is the way an army surrounds a town in order to defeat the people in the town and take control of the town. Gibbethon is probably about 60 kilometers southwest of Tirzah. This is the same town that King Nadab tried to take over in an earlier story.

Once Zimri makes himself king, someone travels to the Israelite army. This person tells the Israelite army that Zimri has planned against and killed King Elah. The Israelite army does not want Zimri as their king, so these Israelites immediately declare that Omri is their king. Omri accepts the Israelite soldiers' decision. The storyteller says the Israelite soldiers chose Omri the same day the Israelites heard the news about Zimri. The storyteller says this to emphasize how quickly the Israelites chose Omri. Remember that in the previous story, the storyteller also emphasized how quickly Zimri killed Baasha's family. The storyteller wants us to understand how quickly everything happens during Zimri's very short time as king!

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: As an activity, tell a story about a time when you received some news and immediately began to do something because of that news. How do you emphasize how quickly you acted after you heard the news? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Omri leads the Israelites to Tirzah. Once Omri and the army arrive at Tirzah, the army surrounds Tirzah and attacks the city. There are probably some Israelites in the city of Tirzah who are loyal to Zimri and who try to defend Tirzah. However, the Israelites who fight for Omri win. When Zimri learns that the Israelites with Omri have captured the city, Zimri enters the palace fortress.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what do you call the strongest, safest part of a palace? Pause this audio here.

Zimri then lights the palace on fire. People probably made parts of the palace, like the roof, with a material that burned, like wood. There were probably many other things in the palace that would burn well, like clothes, window coverings, and furniture. Zimri lights the palace on fire in order to kill himself. Zimri dies because Zimri had sinned. Zimri had done evil in the eyes of Yahweh, which means that Zimri did what Yahweh says is evil. Zimri also followed Jeroboam's example when Zimri sinned and caused Israel to sin.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what is an appropriate way to say that a man killed himself? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller uses the same formal language as he has used before to finish Zimri's story. The storyteller has just included some parts of Zimri's story here, but everything else Zimri did as king, as well as how Zimri rebelled against the king, is in another book that has the kings' histories. Someone rebels when they resist and fight the government or a ruler.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when a person or a group of people rebelled and fought against a government or a ruler. In your language, what words or phrases do you have for the way people rebel against a ruler? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:15–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Asa, king of Judah
- Zimri
- The Israelite army
- Omri
- Yahweh
- Jeroboam
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

When King Asa had ruled Judah for about 27 years, Zimri became king of Israel. Zimri ruled in the city of Tirzah for only seven days. At that time, the Israelite army was camped around the Philistine town of Gibbethon. The Israelite soldiers in the camp heard that Zimri had secretly planned against and killed King Elah. At once, there in the camp, the Israelites in the army announced that, instead of Zimri, their leader, Omri, was the new king of Israel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite army, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not like Zimri. I would rather have Omri as our king. I trust Omri; or
- I am angry that Zimri killed King Elah! I do not want a murderer to be our king! or
- I was surprised and sad to hear that someone killed our king!

Ask the person playing Omri, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- If the Israelites want me to be their king, I should become king; or
- I am surprised at how quickly things have changed! or
- I have led the army well. I think I would be a good king and lead the Israelites well.

Continue the drama.

Then Omri led the army of Israel away from Gibbethon. The army went to Tirzah and began to attack it. When Zimri realized that his enemies had captured the city, Zimri went into the most safe area of the palace. Then Zimri set fire to the palace with Zimri inside. Zimri died in the fire. Zimri died because Zimri had sinned. Zimri had done what Yahweh said was evil. Zimri followed Jeroboam's example. Zimri led the Israelites to sin, like Jeroboam had done.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Zimri, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am surprised that the Israelite army attacked Tirzah! I thought I had made a good plan! I thought the Israelites would follow me! or
- I am scared of what the Israelite army will do to me if they capture me. It is shameful to kill myself, but the Israelites may treat me in a worse way.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that the Israelites fight against each other and kill each other; or
- I am angry that the Israelites disobey me. The Israelites make their lives more difficult when they do not obey me! or
- I have warned the Israelites what will happen if they continue to live in this violent and sinful way.

Continue the drama.

The other things that happened while Zimri was king, like how Zimri planned to kill King Elah, are in the book that tells the history of the kings of Israel.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:15–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Zimri becomes **king** of Israel. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages.

Israel is the northern kingdom. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

Zimri rules while Asa is king of **Judah**. Judah is the southern kingdom. Use the same word or phrase for Judah as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites attack the **city** of Tirzah with a **siege**. A city was a bigger settlement that usually had walls around it. A city usually had thick walls to keep attackers out of the city. The attackers would surround the city so that the people inside could not come out to get food, water, and other supplies. For more information on siege, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for siege and city as you used in previous passages.

Omri is the **commander** of the Israelite army. Here, this means that Omri is the military leader who leads the whole army. Use the same word or phrase for “military commander” as you used in previous passages.

Zimri goes into the “stronghold” of the **palace**. A stronghold, in this case, is a safe place that people have built to make it difficult for enemies to capture. Palaces often had an especially strong area inside that made it difficult for enemies to attack. Use the same word or phrase for palace as you have used previously.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a man-made **stronghold**. For more information, refer to stronghold in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Zimri had **sinned**. Sin is an act of rebellion against God. Anytime that a person disobeys God’s laws, that person sins. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages.

Zimri acted in an **evil** way in the eyes of Yahweh. Evil is the opposite of good. For more information on evil, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for evil and doing evil in the eyes of Yahweh, as you used in previous passages.

The name **Yahweh** is a very personal name for God that showed the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Zimri’s story is also in the book or **scroll** that tells the history of the kings of Israel. For more information, refer to scroll in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for scroll or book, and for the name of this book, as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a scroll again as needed.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 16:15–20

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (835 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.8 MB)

- Defining the Scenes (4.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 16:21–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 16:21–28 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:21–28 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:21–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, the army declared that Omri should be king, and Zimri killed himself. This story is about what happens after Zimri dies. Some Israelites want another man, Tibni, to be king. However, Omri's supporters defeat Tibni's supporters and Omri rules as king. While Omri is king, Omri sins even more than the other Israelite kings did.

This story begins right after Zimri dies. When Omri defeats Zimri, the Israelites do not all immediately support Omri. One group supports Omri while another group supports a man named Tibni, son of Ginath. Ginath could be Tibni's father's name or the place Tibni is from. The two groups of Israelites probably fight each other in battles for about four years. Omri's supporters are stronger than Tibni's and probably kill Tibni in a battle.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when your people group or a people group near you disagreed about who should rule next. How did the people who disagreed treat each other? When one person finally led the group, how did the group treat the other person who had tried to rule? Pause this audio here.

Omri becomes king of all the Israelites, including Tibni's supporters, while Asa is in his 31st year as king of Judah. Omri rules for a total of 12 years, including the 4 years when Omri and Tibni fought each other. For half of those 12 years, Omri lives and rules in the city of Tirzah. While Omri lives in Tirzah, Omri buys a hill from a person named Shemer for two talents of silver. A talent is a unit of measurement of about 34 kilograms.

Omri builds a town on this hill. This hill is a good place to build a city. This hill is easy to defend, and it is on a trading route. Omri names this town Samaria after Shemer, the name of the former owner of the hill. Omri moves to Samaria in Omri's seventh year as king and makes Samaria the new capital of Israel.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find Tirzah and Samaria. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does a leader choose the capital city or the city the leader will rule from? Tell a story about a time when a leader picked a new capital city. What things or people did the leader have to move to the new city? What did people think about this change? Pause this audio here.

However, the whole time Omri is king, Omri acts in a way that displeases Yahweh. Omri sins even more than the kings who ruled before Omri. Omri follows Jeroboam's example and sins exactly like Jeroboam sinned. Omri leads the Israelites in such a way that the Israelites willingly choose to sin as well. Omri and the Israelites worship idols, which makes Yahweh very angry.

Everything else Omri did as king, including Omri's actions as a military leader, is in the book or scroll that has the history of the kings of Israel. Omri rests with his ancestors, which is a polite way to say Omri dies. This probably does not mean that people bury Omri near his ancestors because people bury Omri in Samaria. Since Samaria is a new town, people probably did not bury Omri's ancestors in Samaria in the past. Omri's son Ahab then becomes king.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:21–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The Israelites divide into two groups. One group supports Tibni. The other group supports Omri. Omri's supporters defeat Tibni's supporters and kill Tibni. Omri becomes king.

In the second scene: The storyteller formally introduces Omri's time as king.

In the third scene: Omri buys a hill and builds the city of Samaria.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller talks about how Omri ruled as king.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller formally ends Omri's story.

The characters in this passage are:

- The people of Israel, who divide into two groups
- Tibni, son of Ginath
- Omri
- Shemer
- Asa, king of Judah
- Yahweh
- Jeroboam, Nebat's son
- And Ahab, Omri's son

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the Israelites divide into two groups. It is not clear how many Israelites are in each group. The people who support Omri defeat the people who support Tibni and probably kill Tibni in a battle. Then Omri becomes king. Remember that Zimri died in the 27th year that Asa ruled in Judah, and that is when the Israelites began to fight. Omri becomes king in Asa's 31st year as king, so the Israelites probably fought for about 4 years.

In the second scene, though the storyteller has already said that Omri becomes king, the storyteller still uses formal language to introduce Omri's time as king. The storyteller explains who rules in Judah when Omri becomes king and how long Omri rules.

The storyteller says Omri rules for 12 years. This means that the army declares that Omri is king in Asa's 27th year, right after Zimri murdered Elah. Then Omri and Omri's group fight Tibni and Tibni's group until Asa's 31st year as king. This is when Tibni dies and Omri officially rules over all the Israelites. Then Omri dies in Asa's 38th year as king. These are the 12 years that the storyteller says Omri rules. For 6 of those 12 years, Omri lives in Tirzah, including the 4 years when Omri and Tibni fight each other. Then, for the other six years that Omri is king, Omri lives in Samaria.

1 Kings 16:21–28

Stop here and discuss as a group how you want to translate how long Omri ruled. You can draw or act out what Omri did during the 12 years between when Zimri died and when Omri died. Pause this audio here.

The third scene probably happens sometime during the last two years Omri lives in Tirzah. Omri buys a hill from a person named Shemer and builds a town on the hill. Omri probably orders other people to build the town. Omri names the town Samaria and moves to Samaria six years after Zimri died. Samaria is about 15 kilometers from Tirzah. Omri then rules for six more years in Samaria.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller describes how Omri rules as king. Omri does evil in the eyes of Yahweh, which means that Omri does what Yahweh says is evil. Omri sins even more than the previous kings did. Omri follows Jeroboam's example and sins. Omri leads the Israelites to worship idols or statues of false gods. These idols are worthless because these idols cannot do anything or help the Israelites. This idol worship makes Yahweh very angry. The storyteller reminds us that Yahweh is Israel's God, whom the Israelites should have worshiped.

In the fifth scene, the storyteller uses formal language to finish Omri's story. The storyteller has just included some parts of Omri's story here, but everything else Omri did as king is in another book. This is similar to what the storyteller said about other kings in past stories, but notice that this time the storyteller says here that Omri's achievements or mighty deeds are also in that other book. These mighty deeds are probably how Omri fought and led during battles.

Omri sleeps with his ancestors, which is a common polite phrase that means Omri dies. People bury Omri's body in Samaria. Then Omri's son, Ahab, becomes king. The storyteller ends Omri's story in the same way the storyteller ended Baasha's story.

Stop here and review how you translated the end of Baasha's story. You will probably want to translate the end of Omri's story in a similar way to how you translated the end of Baasha's story. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:21–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The people of Israel, who divide into two groups
- Tibni, son of Ginath
- Omri
- Shemer
- Asa, king of Judah
- Yahweh
- Jeroboam, Nebat's son
- And Ahab, Omri's son

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

After Zimri died, the people of Israel split into two groups. One group wanted Tibni, son of Ginath, to be their king. The other group wanted Omri to become king. But Omri's supporters defeated the supporters of Tibni. Omri's supporters probably killed Tibni, and then Omri became the king of Israel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites who supported Tibni, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not like Omri. I think Tibni will be a better king; or
- I am so surprised that Omri's group defeated us and killed Tibni! or
- I am worried about how Omri will treat us now that Omri rules us all as king.

Ask the person playing the Israelites who supported Omri, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that we defeated Tibni and his group; or
- Omri won this fight against Tibni and the other Israelites. This shows that Omri is strong and should be king! or
- I am glad that we have won and can go home now.

Continue the drama.

When Asa had been king of Judah for about 31 years, Omri became king of Israel. Omri ruled for 12 years. For the first six years, Omri ruled in Tirzah. During that time, Omri bought the hill of Samaria from a person named Shemer. Omri paid two talents of silver for the hill. When Omri built a city on the hill, Omri named the city Samaria after Shemer, who used to own the hill.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Omri, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I will build a new city so that whenever people enter the city, they will remember that I built the city. Then people will remember me as a great king! or
- Since I am king, I am rich and can buy land to build a new city; or
- This new city will be better than Tirzah. Zimri burned the old king's house, and I want to build a new one in this new city.

Continue the drama.

Omri did evil things that displeased Yahweh. Omri sinned more than any of the kings of Israel before him. Omri did all the bad things that Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, had done. Omri sinned in the same way that Jeroboam had caused the people of Israel to sin. The Israelites made Yahweh, the God of Israel, angry because they worshiped useless statues.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I give each new king a chance to honor me, and each time they do not. I knew this would happen, but this still makes me sad; or
- I am angry that the Israelites dishonor me when they ignore me and worship idols; or
- The Israelites fight each other and die because they do not live in the way I say they should.

Continue the drama.

Now, the rest of what took place during Omri's time as king, what Omri did and the power Omri showed, are in the book that has the history of the kings of Israel. Omri died, and people buried Omri's body in the city of Samaria. Omri's son Ahab then ruled as king.

1 Kings 16:21–28

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:21–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The people of **Israel** split into two factions or groups. Here, Israel means the northern kingdom. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

Omri becomes **king** of Israel. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages.

Asa is king of **Judah** while Omri rules in Israel. Judah is the southern kingdom. Use the same word or phrase for Judah as you used in previous passages.

Omri pays two **talents** of silver to Shemer to buy a hill. A talent is a unit of measurement. One talent is about 34 kilograms, so Omri probably pays around 68 kilograms of silver to Shemer. Use the same word or phrase for talent as you used in previous passages, and refer to talent in the Master Glossary for more information.

Omri acts in an **evil** way in the eyes of Yahweh. Evil is the opposite of good. For more information on evil, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for evil and acting in an evil way in the eyes of Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Omri makes Samaria the new capital **city** of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for city as you used in previous passages.

The name **Yahweh** is a very personal name for God that showed the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Omri **sins** more than the other kings had sinned. Sin is an act of rebellion against God. Anytime that a person disobeys God's laws, that person sins. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh is Israel's **God**. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Omri led the Israelites to worship **idols** and provoked, or caused, Yahweh to become angry. An idol is an object that people make in order to worship a god. For more information on idol, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for idol and provoked Yahweh to be angry as you used in previous passages.

Omri's story is also in the book or **scroll** that tells the history of the kings of Israel. A scroll is a long strip of material on which people would write down stories. For more information, refer to scroll in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for scroll or book, and the name of the book, as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a scroll again as a group as needed.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 16:21–28

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (643 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1012 KB)

1 Kings 16:29–34

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 16:29–34 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:29–34 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The last story was about how Omri ruled as king. This story is about King Ahab, Omri's son. Ahab becomes king while Asa is in his 38th year as king of Judah. Ahab rules for 22 years from the city of Samaria. Remember that Samaria is Israel's new capital city, which is the city where the kings rule from.

Ahab is even more evil than the kings who ruled before Ahab. Ahab does not think that it is a serious sin to act in the same evil way as Jeroboam. So Ahab sins like Jeroboam did, and then Ahab sins even more!

Ahab marries a woman named Jezebel, who is not an Israelite. Jezebel is the daughter of King Ethbaal, who ruled over the city of Sidon. Sidon was a city on the coast of the Mediterranean Sea, where the Phoenician people lived.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and Phoenicia as a group. Find the cities of Sidon and Samaria. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 16:29–34

Yahweh warned the Israelites not to marry people who were from other people groups. Those people from other people groups will try to convince the Israelites to worship other gods, like Baal. Baal was a male false god that the Canaanites worshiped. The Canaanites believed that Baal controlled the wind and rain and caused plants to grow.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what would people think if someone from your people group married someone from another people group, who had different traditions and worshiped different gods? What would people think if a king or leader married someone from a different people group? Why might a king do this? Pause this audio here.

The people of Sidon probably worshiped Baal, and now Ahab does too. Ahab builds a temple with an altar for Baal in Samaria. Ahab also makes an Asherah pole. Asherah was a false goddess that the Canaanites worshiped. Asherah was also Baal's partner. Sometimes people would make a wooden pole to represent their Asherah goddess. The Israelites probably follow Ahab's example and worship these false gods too. All this makes Yahweh very angry. Ahab does more to make Yahweh angry than any of the previous kings of Israel had done.

Stop here and look at a picture of an altar and an Asherah pole as a group. Describe the items that people use to worship other gods in your area. How do those items look similar to or different from the altar and pole in this picture? Pause this audio here.

While Ahab is king, a man rebuilds the city of Jericho. Many years ago, when the Israelites first came to the land of Canaan, Yahweh helped the Israelites defeat the people of Jericho in an amazing way. Yahweh knocked down the walls of Jericho. The Israelite leader at that time was Joshua. Joshua warned the people of Israel never to rebuild the city of Jericho. Joshua said that Yahweh will place a curse on anyone who tries to rebuild Jericho, which means to build the walls of Jericho so that people can build houses inside. Joshua said that when someone starts to build the city, their oldest son will die. And when that person finishes building the city, their youngest child will die. This may mean that whoever rebuilds the city of Jericho will lose all of his children, from the oldest to the youngest.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people believe about curses? When would be some times when a god might curse someone? When would someone curse whoever does a certain action? Pause this audio here.

The ruins of Jericho would remind the Israelites that Yahweh defeated the Canaanites and gave the land of Canaan to the Israelites. So, since Joshua's time, no one had rebuilt the city. Since Jericho was in Israel, people still lived in the area of Jericho, as we see in other books of the Bible. But until Ahab's time, no one rebuilt the walls of Jericho to make it a strong city again.

So now, while Ahab rules as king, a man from Bethel named Hiel wants to rebuild Jericho. Since Ahab is king, Ahab probably has to allow Hiel to do this. So this part of the story may show an example of how Ahab sins, because Ahab allows the Israelites to build the city that Yahweh said no one should rebuild.

To begin to build the walls, Hiel would first build the foundation, or the strong stones at the bottom of the wall that people put firmly in the ground. When Hiel sets up those stones, Hiel's oldest son, Abiram, dies. To finish the wall, Hiel would put gates or large doors in the wall. This would show that the city is finished and ready for people to live in. When Hiel puts the gates in the wall, Hiel's youngest son, Segub, dies. This happens exactly like Yahweh's curse, which Joshua spoke to the Israelites. This part of the story shows that even though the Israelites worship other gods during this time, Yahweh still rules over the Israelites, and that everything Yahweh says will happen, happens.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of the foundation stones of a wall and a gate in a city wall. How do people build walls in your area? When someone builds a new town, what does that person build first? What is the last thing the person would build, which would show the town is ready for people to live in?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller formally introduces Ahab's time as king.

In the second scene: Ahab marries Jezebel and sets up places to worship false gods.

In the third scene: Hiel rebuilds Jericho. When Hiel starts to build Jericho, his firstborn son dies. As Hiel finishes the gates of Jericho, his youngest son dies.

The characters in this passage are:

- Ahab, Omri's son
- Asa, king of Judah
- The people of the kingdom of Israel
- Yahweh
- Jeroboam, Nebat's son
- Jezebel, King Ethbaal's daughter
- Hiel
- Hiel's son Abiram
- Hiel's son Segub
- And Joshua, Nun's son

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller uses formal phrases to introduce Ahab's time as king. The storyteller explains who rules in Judah when Ahab becomes king, how long Ahab rules, and how Ahab rules. Ahab does evil in the eyes of Yahweh, which means that Ahab does what Yahweh says is evil. Ahab does even more evil than the previous kings did. Ahab follows Jeroboam's example and sins.

Stop here and review the way you have translated the formal introduction to the kings of Israel in previous passages as needed. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Ahab marries Jezebel and worships false gods. The storyteller says that it was not enough for Ahab to sin like Jeroboam, so Ahab sins even more. Ahab thinks that it is not serious to sin like Jeroboam. The storyteller is emphasizing that Ahab wants to act in a sinful way, so Ahab chooses to sin even more than Jeroboam did. Ahab disobeys Yahweh when Ahab marries Jezebel, a woman who is not an Israelite, and when Ahab worships false gods.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you emphasize that someone acts not only in a bad way like someone else, but also in another bad way? How would you talk about the way that someone thinks that the way they sin is not serious? Pause this audio here.

Jezebel's father rules over the people in the city of Sidon. Ahab builds a temple and altar to Baal in the city of Samaria. Ahab also makes an Asherah pole. Ahab probably has other people build these things.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the cities of Sidon and Samaria. Pause this audio here.

Again, the storyteller says that Ahab did more to make Yahweh angry than the previous kings of Israel did. The storyteller shows how each king of Israel is worse than the one before him! The storyteller also emphasizes that Yahweh is Israel's God, whom Ahab and the Israelites should have worshiped.

In the third scene, Hiel of Bethel rebuilds Jericho. When Hiel starts to build and puts down the strong stones at the bottom of the walls, Hiel's oldest son, Abiram, dies. When Hiel finishes the city and puts on the gates, Hiel's youngest son, Segub, dies. The storyteller does not tell us how Hiel's sons die, but Hiel's sons die because of Yahweh's curse, which Joshua had told the Israelites about. The storyteller does not tell the story of how Joshua shared Yahweh's word or message with the Israelites because the Israelites would probably know this story already.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the cities of Jericho and Bethel. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller does not give the formal ending to Ahab's story because in the next passages, the storyteller will tell stories about what happened while Ahab ruled as king.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Ahab, Omri's son
- Asa, king of Judah
- The people of the kingdom of Israel
- Yahweh
- Jeroboam, Nebat's son
- Jezebel, King Ethbaal's daughter
- Hiel
- Hiel's son Abiram
- Hiel's son Segub
- And Joshua, Nun's son

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Ahab became king of Israel when Asa had ruled Judah for about 38 years. Ahab ruled Israel from the city of Samaria for about 22 years. Ahab, the son of Omri, did evil that displeased Yahweh more than any of the kings who ruled before Ahab.

Ahab did not think that it was a serious sin to act in the same evil way as Nebat's son Jeroboam. Ahab sinned even more than Jeroboam sinned and married Jezebel, who was the daughter of Ethbaal, king of the Sidonians. Then Ahab began to serve and worship the false god Baal. Ahab built a temple in Samaria to worship Baal and put an altar there to honor Baal. Ahab also made an Asherah pole. Ahab did more things to make Yahweh the God of Israel angry than any of the previous kings of Israel had done.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jezebel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Israel is not like the land where I grew up. The people here live differently than how I live. I will ask my husband to do some of my people's traditions and build a temple like the ones in Sidon. Then this new land will not be so strange for me; or
- I want my new husband to worship the same gods as I do. I do not want Ahab's God to tell Ahab to do something different than what my gods want me to do! or

1 Kings 16:29–34

- I do not like the God of the Israelites. I did not learn about this God when I was young. I would rather worship the gods of my people.

Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is a good marriage for our two people groups. Now our people will live in peace and trade with each other. I made a good decision to marry Jezebel; or
- I want my wife to be comfortable. I will do some of the things that her people do, like worship these gods; or
- I do not care about Yahweh and Yahweh's rules. I will live however I want to live.

Continue the drama.

While Ahab was king of Israel, a man from Bethel named Hiel rebuilt the city of Jericho. But when Hiel put the bottom stones for the wall in place, Hiel's oldest son, Abiram, died. And when Hiel finished the gates to the city, Hiel's youngest son, Segub, died. Many years earlier, Yahweh had told Joshua, the son of Nun, that this would happen.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hiel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so sad my sons are dead! or
- When my oldest son died, I thought it was an accident or a coincidence. So I continued to build Jericho. But now my youngest son has died! This must have happened because of a curse! or
- I wish I had not built Jericho.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I told the Israelites what would happen! I want the Israelites to listen to me! or
- I am angry that Ahab does not honor me; or
- I am sad that the Israelites hurt themselves and others when they sin.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 16:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Ahab becomes **king** of Israel. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages.

Here, **Israel** means the northern kingdom. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

Asa is king of **Judah** when Ahab becomes king in Israel. Judah is the southern kingdom. Use the same word or phrase for Judah as you used in previous passages.

Ahab acts in an **evil** way in the eyes of Yahweh. Evil is the opposite of good. For more information on evil, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for evil and acting in an evil way in the eyes of Yahweh, as you used in previous passages.

The name **Yahweh** was a very personal name for God. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Ahab **sins** even more than Jeroboam sinned. Sin is an act of rebellion against God. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages.

Ahab **worships** Baal. Baal was a male false god that the Canaanites worshiped. The Canaanites believed that Baal controlled the wind and the rain, and that Baal caused plants to grow. For more information on worship, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for worship as you used in previous passages.

1 Kings 16:29–34

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Baal**. Look up Baal in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Ahab builds an **altar** for Baal. An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to a god. An altar is like a table or a platform that people make of earth or large stones. For more information on altar, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for altar as you used in previous passages.

This altar is in the temple for Baal. This temple is a building where people worship Baal, not the temple that Yahweh asked the Israelites to build for Yahweh. In the original language, people would call this building "Baal's house."

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **temple**, or **house**, of Baal. If you use a general word for a temple, refer to temple in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Ahab also makes an Asherah pole. Asherah, the partner of Baal, was the female false god that the Canaanites worshiped. Sometimes people would make a wooden pole to represent the Asherah goddess.

Stop here and, as a group, look at an Asherah pole again as needed. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**Asherah pole**." Use the same word or phrase for "Asherah pole" as you used in earlier stories in 1 Kings. Pause this audio here.

Ahab **provokes**, or causes, Yahweh, Israel's **God**, to become angry. Use the same word or phrase for provoke or cause as you have in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Hiel builds the "foundation" of Jericho, which is the strong stones at the bottom of a wall. People would often dig holes and put these stones into the holes. These stones would make a very stable place for people to build a wall on top. Use the same word or phrase for foundation as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look again at the picture of a foundation. Pause this audio here.

Joshua received the **word of Yahweh** about what would happen to the person who rebuilt Jericho. The "word of Yahweh" means what Yahweh tells people. For more information on the word of Yahweh, refer to word in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the word of Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 16:29–34

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (659 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1022 KB)

1 Kings 17:1–7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 17:1–7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:1–7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Here we meet Elijah the prophet for the first time. The name “Elijah” means “Yahweh is my God.” Elijah is a Tishbite, from the village of Tishbe in Gilead, east of the Jordan River. King Ahab is the king of the Northern Kingdom of Israel and rules from the capital city, Samaria. Samaria is west of the Jordan River. It is likely that Elijah travelled from Gilead to Samaria to share Yahweh’s words with King Ahab.

Stop here and look at a map of the regions of Gilead and Samaria. Find Gilead on the map, and then find the village of Tishbe, east of the Jordan River. Next, locate the city of Samaria, west of the Jordan River. Pause this audio here.

We know that Elijah must be a prophet because Yahweh has given a message to Elijah to share with King Ahab. First, Elijah identifies clearly who Elijah serves. Elijah is not serving King Ahab or King Ahab’s “god,” Baal. Elijah tells King Ahab that Yahweh, not Baal, is the God of Israel. Remember, you heard before that King Ahab built a temple and an altar for Baal in Samaria.

Elijah also tells King Ahab that Yahweh, the God of Israel, is a living God. By saying this, Elijah contrasts the living Yahweh with Baal, a god who is not alive. Finally, Elijah tells King Ahab that Yahweh has decided that there will be no dew or rain for several years. In Israel, the rainy season usually happens between October and March. During the dry season, the moisture in the air from the sea provides water for the land and the people in the form of heavy morning dew.

Stop here and look at a picture of morning dew. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 17:1–7

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What does “rainy season” look like in your country? How long does the rainy season last? Where do you get water if there is no rain? Pause this audio here.

[Yahweh gave Elijah the power to stop the dew and the rain because Elijah is a prophet of Yahweh. Yahweh wants to show that Yahweh is the true God of Israel, not Baal.]{.mark} Baal is a storm god and a fertility god, but Baal actually has no power to control the dew or the rain that helps the crops grow.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do we know our God is alive, powerful, and the only true God? How are the true God’s actions the same or different from Baal’s actions? Pause this audio here.

Notice that Elijah never mentions the name “Baal” when he shares Yahweh’s words with King Ahab.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you show someone that their actions are sinful or wrong? Do you tell that person directly, or do you simply share God’s word with them, as Elijah does in this story? Pause this audio here.

After Elijah gives Yahweh’s message to King Ahab, Yahweh warns Elijah to leave and hide in the Kerith Valley. We do not know where Elijah is leaving from, but we do know that Yahweh tells Elijah to go to the east side of the Jordan River.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of the Kerith Valley. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Elijah to hide in the Kerith Valley. This area is a streambed or riverbed that is dry when there is no rain. However, the streambed or riverbed fills up with water during the rainy season.

Stop here and look at a picture of an area that is only full of water during the rainy season. Look at a picture of the area when there is water and another when there is no water. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: What are some areas in your country that are sometimes dry and sometimes full of water? What does it look like when it is dry, and what does it look like when it has water? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of a brook or a stream. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call flowing water that is smaller than a river in your language? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Elijah that he can drink water from the brook and that ravens will bring Elijah bread and meat. A raven is a type of crow, a large black bird that people know for eating dead animals.

Stop here and look at a picture of a raven. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call this type of bird in your language? Do any types of birds have special meaning in your culture? Pause this audio here.

We do not know what type of meat the ravens bring to Elijah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story from your culture about a time when God provided food for someone in a miraculous way. Pause this audio here.

After a while, the brook dries up, and Elijah can no longer drink water from the brook. Yahweh did not promise Elijah that the brook would miraculously provide water forever. However, Yahweh shows that he clearly has power over the natural world. In later passages, Yahweh gives Elijah power to perform other miraculous events.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember that Yahweh has given Elijah the power to command the dew and the rain to come. Why do you think Elijah does not use that power at this time? Discuss a time when you did not go ahead and act or do something, even though you had the ability to do it. Why did you choose not to act?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 17:1–7

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Elijah tells King Ahab that Yahweh has told him there will be no dew or rain in the land for a few years. There will only be dew or rain if Elijah asks for it.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Elijah to leave, go east of the Jordan River, and hide in an area near Kerith Brook. Yahweh promises to take care of Elijah. Yahweh tells Elijah that Elijah will be able to drink water from the brook and that ravens will bring him food.

In the third scene: Elijah obeys Yahweh and goes to Kerith Brook. Every morning and night, the ravens bring bread and meat to Elijah. Elijah drinks water from the brook.

In the fourth scene: After some time passes, the brook dries up because there has not been dew or rain for so long.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah the Tishbite, a prophet from the village of Tishbe, in Gilead
- Ahab, king of Israel, son of Omri
- Yahweh, the God of Israel
- And ravens

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember, in the first scene, Elijah is speaking with King Ahab, maybe for the first time. King Ahab is one of the most wicked kings in Israel's history. Elijah emphasizes three things: one, that Elijah serves Yahweh; two, that Yahweh is a living God; and three, that Yahweh is the true God of Israel. Elijah says these things to make a strong promise that what Elijah says will happen, will actually happen.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you make a strong promise or oath in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Elijah tells King Ahab that there will be no dew or rain for a few years, "except by my word." "Except by my word" means "only if I say it." Elijah is telling King Ahab that the only way it will rain is if Elijah says it will rain.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use to explain that Elijah tells King Ahab that it is Elijah who will say when the rain can come again. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, God tells Elijah to hide from King Ahab. King Ahab is probably very angry about not having rain. Remember, we do not know where Elijah is leaving from, but we know that "the Word of Yahweh" came to Elijah again. This time God commands Elijah to go east of the Jordan, to the Kerith Valley, a dry river valley where there is a brook, or small river, of water when it rains. God also gives Elijah a message about the food and water that Yahweh will provide for Elijah.

Stop here and look at a map of the Kerith Valley area. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, every morning and night, the ravens bring both bread and meat to Elijah. Some translations say the ravens brought bread and meat every morning and every night, and other translations say the ravens brought bread and meat every morning and bread and meat every night.

Stop here and discuss this question together as a group: What would be the most natural way in your language to explain that the ravens brought food at the same two times every day? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss another question together as a group: What do you think it looked like for the ravens to bring bread and meat to Elijah? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, we see that after some time passes, the brook has dried up and Elijah can no longer drink from it. We do not know exactly how much time passes before the brook dries up, but we know it is dry because there has been no rain for a while. Most likely, the period of time is more than a few days but less than one year.

1 Kings 17:1–7

Stop here and discuss this question together as a group: How does your language describe a period of time that is longer than a few days but less than a year? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah the Tishbite, a prophet from the village of Tishbe, in Gilead
- Ahab, king of Israel, son of Omri
- Yahweh, the God of Israel
- And ravens

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out Elijah introducing himself to King Ahab. Remember, Elijah emphasizes three things: one, that Elijah serves Yahweh; two, that Yahweh is a living God; and three, that Yahweh is the true God of Israel. Elijah warns King Ahab that Yahweh has said that the dew and the rain will stop for a long time. Elijah also tells King Ahab that Yahweh has given Elijah the power to command the dew and the rain to come again. Act out this scene now.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer something like:

- King Ahab is such a wicked king. How can King Ahab deny that Yahweh is the God of Israel?

Ask the person playing King Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Who does this Elijah think he is? My god, Baal, is all-powerful. But what if Elijah is right? or
- Elijah says he can command the dew or rain to come. Fine, I will just arrest Elijah and order him to make it happen!

Continue the drama.

Act out Yahweh speaking with Elijah. Yahweh instructs Elijah to leave and go to the brook in the Kerith Valley. Yahweh also explains how he will take care of Elijah, that Yahweh will send ravens to bring food to Elijah and that the brook will have water. Act out this scene now.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Elijah, you are truly my servant. I will protect you and take care of you; or
- I know Elijah will have some tough times ahead, but I will always be with him.

1 Kings 17:1–7

Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so thankful that Yahweh has a plan to keep me safe; or
- I hope this will be a good hiding place. King Ahab looked really mad.

Continue the drama.

Act out Elijah travelling to Kerith Ravine, drinking from the brook in the ravine, and the ravens feeding him every morning and night.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh is so good to provide food for me; or
- It is very strange for wild birds to bring food to me.

Continue the drama.

Act out the brook drying up and Elijah not having water anymore.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I wonder why Yahweh let the brook dry up? Maybe Yahweh wants me to move on; or
- I am feeling a little worried, but I trust that Yahweh will take care of me.

Continue the drama.

Now practice all four scenes as a group and perform the scenes two times—the first time with no interruption and the second time with pauses to ask the characters questions.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

You have heard the words **Yahweh**, **God**, and **Israel** many times in 1 Kings. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh, God, and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, God, or Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

This is the first time that the storyteller mentions Elijah. Elijah is a prophet that God sent to warn Ahab about the consequences of Ahab’s evil acts. A prophet is a person who gives messages from God to the people. The name “Elijah” means “Yahweh is my God.”

Stop here and discuss as a group what name you will use for **Elijah**. Look up Elijah in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already used this name in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Elijah is called “the Tishbite from Tishbe in Gilead.” A Tishbite is a person from the village of Tishbe. Gilead is a region that is on the east side of the Jordan River. You will need to decide if it is appropriate in your language to call Elijah “the Tishbite from Tishbe in Gilead,” or if there is a more natural way to say this.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for “**the Tishbite from Tishbe in Gilead**.” Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 17:1–7

Elijah travels **east** towards the Jordan River and crosses the Jordan River to get to the Kerith Valley. Remember that the sun rises in the direction of the east. Use the same word or phrase for east as you have used in previous passages in 1 Kings.

Use the same word for the **Jordan River** as you used in previous passages. For more information about the Jordan River, refer to the Master Glossary.

Remember, you learned that during Israel's dry season, the moisture in the air from the sea appears as a heavy morning dew. This dew provides water for the land and the people when there is no rain.

Stop here and look again at the photo of heavy morning dew, if needed. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**dew**." Pause this audio here.

God instructs Elijah to go east of the Jordan to a brook in the **Kerith Valley**. The name "Kerith" means "to cut" or "to cut off." The meaning of this name gives a hint about the future and some of the terrible things Ahab and his queen will do to the prophets of Israel. When it rains, there is a brook, or a small river, that flows through the valley.

Stop here and look again at the photos of the dry river valley and the brook that flows through it. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the brook, or small river, that flows in the Kerith Valley when it rains. Use the same word for wadi, or dry river valley, that you used in 1 Kings 8:65. Pause this audio here.

The word of Yahweh comes to Elijah. Use the same word or phrase you used for "the word of Yahweh" in previous passages, and refer to word in the Master Glossary for more information.

Ravens feed Elijah, and they bring him both bread and meat every morning and every night.

Stop here and look at a photo of ravens again, if needed. Discuss as a group what word you will use for **ravens**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Also, discuss what word or phrase you will use for "**meat**." We do not know what kind of meat this was.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 17:1–7

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (631 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1002 KB)

1 Kings 17:8–16

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 17:8–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:8–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:8–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, we heard how Elijah, Yahweh's prophet, told King Ahab that there would be a long time of no rain or dew in Israel or Samaria. King Ahab was one of the most wicked kings in Israel's history. King Ahab did not obey Yahweh, but instead worshipped a false god named Baal. King Ahab believed in Baal as the god of fertility and rain. Yahweh protected Elijah from King Ahab and led Elijah to the Kerith Valley, which had a small brook, so that Elijah could have fresh water. Yahweh also sent ravens to bring food to Elijah every day. But then, the brook that Elijah had been drinking from dried up.

In this story, Yahweh commands Elijah to get up and go right away to Zarephath. Zarephath is a town between the two areas of Sidon and Tyre, near the Mediterranean Sea. Zarephath is located about 15 kilometers south of Sidon, and 14 kilometers north of Tyre, in the country of Phoenicia. Zarephath, just like Israel, has had no rain for a long time. It is interesting to note that Baal is a Phoenician false god. Yahweh makes it clear that Baal has no power, since Baal obviously cannot even make it rain in Baal's own home country.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map that shows the town of Zarephath and where it is located between Sidon and Tyre, near the Mediterranean Sea. Trace Elijah's journey from Kerith Valley to Zarephath. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh sends Elijah to Zarephath and promises that a widow, or a woman whose husband has died, will provide food for Elijah.

Stop here and answer this question as a group: What is life like for a widow in your community? How do people recognize if a woman is a widow? Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 17:8–16

Elijah arrives at the town's entrance, a gate. In Elijah's time, many cities were surrounded by a wall to protect the city from attackers. There was usually one main way to enter and leave the city, through a gate. The gate was often a public gathering place.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Where do people in your community regularly gather to see each other and talk? Pause this audio here.

Elijah calls out to the woman from a distance and asks her to bring him some water to drink in a jar or a cup. This probably means that there was a shared, public source of water nearby. While the woman is on her way to get Elijah the cup of water, Elijah calls out to her again and asks her to please bring him a piece of bread. Elijah is not asking her for a lot of bread, just a piece.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a jar or a cup that people use to carry drinking water. Pause this audio here.

The woman responds to Elijah's request by declaring a strong oath, "As surely as Yahweh your God lives," and says that she does not have any bread to share with Elijah. When the woman says, "Yahweh your God," this shows that she recognizes that Elijah is from Israel and that she knows the God of Israel's name: Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: Why do you think the woman uses an oath here? What are some situations in your culture in which you would use an oath? How would you say that oath? Pause this audio here.

The woman explains to Elijah that all she has left for food is a handful of flour and a small amount of olive oil. Flour and olive oil are the main ingredients to make a flat, round type of bread. People make flour by grinding grain into a fine powder. People at this time stored flour in jars. People made the jars from clay. These jars were large enough to hold about two kilograms of flour.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a handful of flour and the container that people used to store the flour. What do you use to store flour? Pause this audio here.

The woman also says that she has olive oil in a jug. Olive oil is from the fruit of the olive tree, which people press and process to extract its oil. People would store olive oil in a jug, most likely a narrow container that they made of clay. The container was a special shape for pouring liquids, and was about 7.5 to 15 centimeters tall.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of olive oil and a container that people used to store the oil. What do you use to store oil or liquids? Pause this audio here.

The woman explains to Elijah that she is gathering sticks to bring home and make a fire to cook a last meal for herself and her son. By saying, "that we may eat it and die," the woman shows that she does not expect to have any food left after this last meal. The woman has lost hope for survival and believes that she and her son will starve to death.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Share a story you know about a time when someone had lost all hope. How did this person speak and behave to show that they no longer hoped that good things would happen? Pause this audio here.

Elijah sees that the woman has lost all hope of survival for herself and her son. Elijah knows that Yahweh has sent Elijah to this particular woman so that she can provide him with food, and Elijah knows that Yahweh always keeps his promises. Knowing this, Elijah is able to give clear instructions to the woman, telling her what Yahweh has told Elijah. Elijah tells the woman to go ahead and make bread for Elijah first, and then she will be able to make more bread for herself and her son. How is this possible? Elijah explains that Yahweh has promised that the woman will not use up all the flour and the oil will not run dry until the next time it rains.

The woman obeys and finds that the word of Yahweh that Elijah has spoken to her is true! The jars of flour and oil miraculously fill up again every day, and the woman is able to continue to make bread for herself, her son, and Elijah every day.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: Share a story you know about a time when God provided for someone's needs in a miraculous way. How does that experience change the way you think about God? Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 17:8–16

This passage is important because Yahweh shows his power to meet the human need for food. Yahweh provides food in a miraculous way that is completely outside of the usual ways people grow and get food. Yahweh does not need to wait for rain or for grain to grow to make flour. Yahweh does not need to wait for olive trees to produce olives to make olive oil. The false gods like Baal have no power to do anything.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:8–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The brook dries up, and Yahweh speaks to Elijah and instructs him to go to the city of Zarephath. Yahweh promises Elijah that in Zarephath, Elijah will meet a widow, or a woman whose husband has died. This woman will provide food for Elijah.

In the second scene: Elijah meets the widow at the town gate and asks her for water. As the woman goes away to get water for Elijah, he also asks for a piece of bread. The woman explains that she is almost out of food and will soon prepare her last meal for herself and her son. Elijah gives the woman instructions to go home and make bread for Elijah, and then make bread for herself and her son.

In the third scene: The woman follows Elijah's instructions and goes home to make bread for Elijah and also for herself and her son, and brings Elijah's bread back to him.

In the fourth scene: The woman goes home and continues to make bread for herself, her son, her household, and Elijah for many days, even though there is still no rain.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Elijah
- The "widow," or the woman whose husband has died
- And the widow's son and household

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember, before the first scene, Elijah was staying in the Kerith Valley near a brook and drinking water from it. Now, in the first scene, the brook dries up, so Yahweh tells Elijah where to go next. Yahweh tells Elijah to get up and go right away to Zarephath, northeast of where Elijah is. When Yahweh says, "get up," it does not mean that Elijah is sitting down and needs to stand up. This is a way to tell someone that they must go somewhere right away. Zarephath is a town in the region of Sidon, very close to the Mediterranean Sea. Yahweh tells Elijah that Elijah will meet a woman there, and she will give Elijah food. The woman is a widow, which means her husband is dead.

Stop here and, if needed, look again at the map that shows how Elijah might travel from the Kerith Valley to Zarephath. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Elijah comes to the town gate at Zarephath and perhaps stops to rest there. Elijah sees a woman picking up sticks and calls out to her to bring Elijah some water.

Stop here and answer this question as a group: Elijah "calls out" to the woman, which lets us know that she is a short distance away from Elijah. What words do you use in your language to show that someone is near enough to hear but not close enough to have a conversation? Pause this audio here.

Elijah may recognize this woman as a widow based on her clothing, because in those days it was common for widows to wear certain colors to show their status as widows. Sometimes life could be very difficult for a widow because people often did not allow widows to work to support themselves. Widows might be dependent on family members and the community to support them.

Remember, when Elijah sees the woman at the gate, she is gathering small sticks of wood. The woman is gathering wood to bring home to make a cooking fire, and will cook a last meal for herself and her son to eat.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you use to build a fire? What different types of fires for different purposes do people make in your area? How do people make different types of fires? Pause this audio here.

In addition to carrying the sticks, the woman may also be carrying a small clay jar for water. This jar is what she uses to bring Elijah some water. Elijah's instructions to the woman are to "make a small loaf of bread for me from what you have and bring it to me, and then make something for yourself and your son."

Stop here and look at a picture of bread that people made from flour and olive oil. Discuss these questions as a group: What ingredients do you use to make bread in your community? What does the bread look like? How is the bread the same or different from the picture of bread you see? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the woman goes away from Elijah back to her home and makes the bread for Elijah using the flour in her jar and the olive oil in her jug. Then the woman finds she is able to make a second loaf of bread because the jar fills up with more flour and the jug fills up with more olive oil! We do not know if the woman brings the bread to Elijah and then goes home again and makes the second bread for herself and her son.

In the fourth scene, we see that the woman is able to continue to make bread for Elijah, herself, and her household every day. We do not know if anyone lived in the house with the woman besides her son. If there were other people in the house, we know there was enough flour and oil to make bread for all of them. We do not know how many days the miracle of the flour and oil continued, but we do know that this miracle lasted until the rain came again. The dry time lasted for several years. Yahweh's promise to the widow came true: Yahweh had said that the widow would not use up all of her flour and that the olive oil would not run dry, and that is indeed what happened. The widow never used up all the flour, and the jar of olive oil continued to fill up. The storyteller emphasizes that Yahweh's promise to the widow came true when the storyteller summarizes the story with the same words as the promise from Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you show that the same thing continues to happen again and again for many days? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:8–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has 4 scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Elijah
- The "widow," or the woman whose husband has died
- And the widow's son and household

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

1 Kings 17:8–16

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

For the first scene, act out Yahweh giving instructions to Elijah to go to Zarephath. Yahweh tells Elijah to "go at once," as soon as possible. Yahweh also describes how Yahweh will take care of Elijah through the widow. Act out this scene now.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad Yahweh has a plan to take care of me; or
- How will I know which woman to talk to in Zarephath?

Continue the drama.

For the second scene, act out the woman picking up sticks at Zarephath's town gate, and Elijah asking the woman first for water and then for bread. Remember, first Elijah calls out to the woman from a distance to ask for water. Then, while the woman is going away to get the water, Elijah calls out to her again and asks for a piece of bread. The woman swears an oath and says, "As surely as Yahweh your God lives," and explains that what Elijah is asking for is too much, because she only has enough to feed herself and her son one last meal. Then Elijah tells the woman that Yahweh told Elijah that her flour and oil will not run out until it rains again. Act out this scene now.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the woman in Zarephath whose husband has died, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very sad because I know my son and I will die soon; or
- Why does this man keep bothering me? Does he not see that I am poor and starving? or
- I really hope what this man says will happen is true.

Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am excited to show this Phoenician woman, who does not know Yahweh, how powerful Yahweh is; or
- I hope this woman follows my instructions and comes back with the bread.

Continue the drama.

For the third scene, act out the woman returning to her home and following Elijah's instructions. First, act out the woman making bread for Elijah, then making bread for herself and her son. Also, act out the woman bringing the bread back to Elijah. Act out this scene now

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the woman, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I really hope this man is not tricking me. This may be the only bread I can make; or
- This is amazing! I know I used up all of the flour, but here is more! or
- Elijah, your god, Yahweh, is very powerful! I have never seen Baal do anything like this!

Continue the drama.

For the fourth scene, act out the woman making bread again and again for herself, her son, and Elijah, while there is still no rain. Act out this scene now.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the woman, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- There was flour and oil yesterday, but will there still be flour and oil again today? or
- Who is this god who can bring flour and oil out of nothing? or
- I am so happy that my son is still alive and healthy because of how Yahweh provides for us.

Ask the person playing the son, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- My mother was so worried about having food before, and now she is not! or

- I am so happy because my stomach is never empty!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:8–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Use the same word or phrase for "**word of Yahweh**" that you have used in previous passages. For more information, refer to word in the Master Glossary.

You have heard the words **Yahweh**, **God**, and **Israel** many times in 1 Kings. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh, God, and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, God, or Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same name for **Elijah** as you used in previous passages.

Elijah meets a **widow** in Zarephath. This means a woman whose husband is dead. We do not know if the widow's husband died a long time ago or recently died. Use the same word or phrase for widow that you used in previous passages.

Use the same name for the region of **Sidon** as you used in previous passages. Sidon is a part of the country of Phoenicia, on the coast of the Mediterranean Sea.

Zarephath is a **city** located south of Sidon, in the country of Phoenicia, near the Mediterranean Sea. A city is a settlement that usually has a wall around it for protection. Use the same word for city here as you have used previously.

Stop here and discuss as a group what name you will use for **Zarephath**. If needed, look at the map again to see where Zarephath is located. Pause this audio here.

Elijah asks the woman for a piece of bread. Most likely, Elijah means a chunk of bread that someone pulled by hand from a full loaf of bread.

Stop here and look at a photo of bread again if needed. Discuss as a group what words you use for a full **loaf of bread** and for just a **piece of bread** torn off by hand. Pause this audio here.

Remember that a **jar** refers to a larger clay container that people used to store flour. A **jug** refers to a smaller container people used to store oil. Use the same word for jar and jug as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a photo of a jar and a large clay container again, if needed. Pause this audio here.

The woman tells Elijah that she only has a handful of flour and a little olive oil left. We do not know the exact amount.

Stop here and look at photos of flour and olive oil again if needed. Discuss as a group what words you will use for a **handful** of flour and a **little** olive oil. Pause this audio here.

Elijah tells the woman that the jar of flour will not be used up and the jug of oil will not run dry. This means that the woman will continue to find flour and oil in the containers every time she goes to get flour and oil out of them!

Stop here and discuss as a group what words you will use to describe how the flour is not **used up** and how the oil does not **run dry**. Pause this audio here.

The woman makes bread for herself and her **household** or her family. If you decide you want to use a word that means something like household, continue to use the same word you used previously. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about household.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 17:8–16

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (660 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1014 KB)

1 Kings 17:17–24

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 17:17–24 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:17–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:17–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the story before this one, we heard about the widow in the city of Zarephath. The woman is able to keep feeding herself, her son, her household, and Elijah from a jar of flour and a jug of olive oil that never runs out.

1 Kings 17:17–24

There has been no rain in the land for a long time, but Yahweh continues to miraculously provide for Elijah's and the widow's needs. The widow is not from Israel but from the country of Phoenicia. The people in Phoenicia do not yet know Yahweh. They worship the false god, Baal.

Some time has passed, and we learn that Elijah is living in the upper room of the widow's house in Zarephath. The widow owns this house. The house has two levels or floors. The first floor is the main part of the house, and this is where the widow and her son eat and sleep. The second level of the house, the upper room, is where Elijah sleeps. We do not know for sure, but most likely there were stairs on the outside of the house that went up to the roof of the first level. There was a roof, but there may or may not have been walls.

Stop here and look at a picture of a house with two levels: a first level or floor and an upper room. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do houses look like in your area? What did houses look like a long time ago in your area? How are they the same as or different from the house you see in the picture? Pause this audio here.

Now something very tragic happens: the widow's son becomes very sick and keeps getting more and more sick until finally he dies. Of course, the boy's mother is very sad, confused, and maybe even angry. The woman questions Elijah about why her son is dead. The woman asks Elijah if Yahweh is punishing her because of her past sins. We do not know what sin the woman is talking about.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: What stories do you know about someone who experiences a great loss or tragedy? What kinds of questions do you think that person might ask after this very sad thing happens? How might the questions be different for a person who believes in God and a person who does not believe in God? Pause this audio here.

After the woman questions Elijah and shares her grief, Elijah takes the boy up to the upper room and lays him on the bed there. Now Elijah shares his own grief and confusion with Yahweh. When Elijah says that he is the woman's guest, Elijah is reminding Yahweh that the woman herself is not an Israelite. The woman does not know Yahweh the same way the people of Israel should know Yahweh. With faith, Elijah begs Yahweh to bring life back to the dead boy. Yahweh responds to Elijah's faith, and Yahweh hears Elijah and does indeed bring life back to the boy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Imagine you are a guest in someone's home, and while you are staying there, something awful happens. Your host does not know God. What would you say to your host? What would you say to God?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:17–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The woman's son becomes sick and dies. The woman asks Elijah if Yahweh is punishing her for her past sin. Elijah does not answer the woman's question—Elijah only asks her to give the boy's body to him.

In the second scene: Elijah takes the dead boy to the upper room of the house and lays the boy down on the bed. Elijah calls out to Yahweh his God, and asks why this tragedy happened. Elijah stretches himself out over the boy three times and prays to Yahweh to return the boy to life. Yahweh hears Elijah's prayer and gives life to the boy again.

In the third scene: Elijah brings the boy back down the stairs and gives the boy to his mother, the woman. The woman tells Elijah that now she sees that Elijah is truly a man of God and that the word of Yahweh is truth.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah

1 Kings 17:17–24

- The woman who owns the house—the widow
- The woman's son, a young boy
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember, Elijah has been staying in the woman's house, where he sleeps on the second floor, in the upper room. We know that there is at least a bed in this room. The woman and her son sleep on the first or main floor of the house.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at a picture of what the woman's house probably looked like. Pause this audio here.

This first or main floor part of the house is where the boy gets sick and dies. The storyteller tells us that the boy stopped breathing. This is another way to say that the boy died.

Stop here and discuss this question: What are some ways that your culture talks about how someone dies, especially after an illness? How will you say that the boy was sick and finally stopped breathing? Pause this audio here.

The woman calls Elijah "Man of God," and she asks Elijah if the boy is dead because Yahweh is punishing her for her sin. The woman calls Elijah "Man of God" and asks, "What do you have against me?" in a way that shows that she blames Elijah for bringing this tragedy into her home. The woman is not really asking Elijah for an answer. The woman asks this question to show that she blames Elijah and his God for her son's death.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for "What do you have against me?"

If someone you helped does something wrong to you, what do you say to them or ask them? Pause this audio here.

Elijah only answers the woman with a command: "Give me your son." Elijah takes the boy up to the upper room of the house and lays him on the bed.

Stop here and look as a group at a picture of what a bed in Elijah's time probably looked like. Pause this audio here.

Elijah cries out to Yahweh with strong emotions and asks why Yahweh let this awful thing happen to the woman who helped Elijah. Even though Elijah is a visitor from another country, the woman has been kind and generous to let Elijah stay in her house and to feed him. "Cries out" here does not mean that Elijah was only weeping. "Cries out" means that Elijah cried loudly to or called out to Yahweh.

Then Elijah "stretches himself out" over the boy's body where it lies on the bed. We do not know exactly what this looks like. Maybe Elijah is showing his grief, or maybe Elijah thinks that putting his warm body close to the boy's lifeless body will help bring the boy to life again. While Elijah is stretching himself out over the dead boy, Elijah begs Yahweh to "let this boy's life return to him." It seems like the boy comes to life again pretty quickly, because we know Elijah stretches out on the body only three times.

Stop here and have two people in your group act like Elijah and the dead boy. Show what it might look like for Elijah to "stretch out" on the boy's body. After you act this out, discuss what words you will use to describe this action of stretching out on the body. Note that this should be two women or two men acting this out together. Pause this audio here.

When the boy comes alive again, Elijah picks the boy up, brings him down the stairs, and gives him to his mother. This is how we know that the boy must be young, maybe a child. As the woman receives her son back from Elijah, she says she does believe that Elijah is a man of God and that the word of Yahweh, or God's promises, that Elijah speaks are true.

The woman calls Elijah a "man of God" two times in this story. The first time the woman says "man of God" is in the first scene, right after her son dies. The woman questions Elijah about why her son is dead. The woman seems to blame Elijah, as God's representative, for her son's death. The second time the woman says "man of God" is right after Elijah gives her son back to her, alive.

1 Kings 17:17–24

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: What is the difference between the first time the woman says "man of God" and the second time she says it? How do you think the woman's voice sounded when she said "man of God" each time? Pause this audio here.

The woman says to Elijah, "The word of Yahweh from your mouth is the truth." Now the woman understands clearly that Elijah speaks the words of the powerful and life-giving God of Israel. Nothing can stop God from doing what God wants to do: not even a lack of rain, sickness, or death. Yahweh's words are powerful and true.

Stop here and discuss how you will describe the truth of the "word of Yahweh" coming from Elijah's mouth. What is different about saying that Yahweh's words are true, rather than just saying that someone keeps a promise or tells the truth? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:17–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah
- The woman who owns the house—the widow
- The woman's son, a young boy
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the woman's son becomes very sick and keeps getting more sick until he dies. The woman questions Elijah about why this terrible thing has happened to her. The woman asks Elijah if it is because of her sins and if she is being punished. Remember, the woman calls Elijah a "man of God" here.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the woman, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have been helping this "man of God" by letting him live with me and feeding him, and now this man's God is punishing me for my sin by killing my son? or
- I should never have let this "man of God" stay with us. Look at what happened! or
- I am so sad because my child is dead. I want to understand why!

Continue the drama.

In the second scene, Elijah takes the woman's son upstairs to his bed in the upper room. Elijah lays the boy down on the bed. Then Elijah cries out to Yahweh God, asking why God allowed the boy to die. Next, Elijah "stretches himself out" over the boy three times and begs Yahweh to let life return to the dead boy.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I do not understand why Yahweh would give this woman flour and oil that never runs out, save us from starving, and then let her son become sick and die; or
- Can I still trust Yahweh to do another miracle?

Continue the drama.

Yahweh hears Elijah, and the boy becomes alive again.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I love to answer the prayers from the people who have faith in me.

Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Praise you, Yahweh! You are amazing, and only you can bring a dead person back to life! or
- Thank you for answering my prayer!

Ask the person playing the son, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer:

- Wow, I feel great! I wonder why Elijah looks so happy to see me?

Continue the drama.

In the third scene, Elijah picks up the boy from the bed and brings him downstairs to his mother. The woman says again to Elijah that he is a “man of God” and that now she knows and believes that the word of Yahweh that Elijah speaks is the truth.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the woman, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Can I believe what I am seeing?! Is my child really alive again? or
- I have never seen anyone dead come back to life. The words of Elijah’s god are very powerful! or
- How could I forget that this is the same Yahweh who keeps giving us flour and oil that never runs out?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 17:17–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

When the woman’s son dies, she addresses Elijah as “**man of God**.” Earlier, the woman heard the word of Yahweh from Elijah, and she saw that her supply of flour and oil never ended. The woman clearly understands that Elijah has a relationship with a powerful god. Use the same phrase for “man of God” that you used in previous passages. People sometimes called prophets “men of God.” For more information on “man of God,” refer to prophet in the Master Glossary.

The woman asks Elijah why Yahweh is punishing her for her **sin**. When someone sins, they disobey God. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you have used in previous passages. For more information, refer to sin in the Master Glossary.

Remember, the **upper room** is a room on top of the main room of a house, and a person climbs up stairs to enter the upper room. Often, the stairs were on the outside of the house.

If necessary, stop here and look again as a group at a picture of an upper room. What word or phrase will you use to describe this upper part of a house? Pause this audio here.

Elijah calls Yahweh “**Yahweh my God**.” Use the same phrase for “Yahweh my God” as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and God, see the Master Glossary.

Elijah calls out to God and asks why God brought this tragedy on the **widow**. “Tragedy” means the awful thing that happened, that the woman’s beloved son died. Use the same word for “widow,” or a woman whose husband is dead, as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **tragedy**. Remember the story that you told in step two about someone who experienced an awful thing in their life. What word or phrase does your community use to describe when something awful happens to a person they love? Pause this audio here.

Elijah says that he **prays** to Yahweh and asks Yahweh to let life return to the boy. Use the same word or phrase for pray as you have used previously. For more information about pray, refer to the Master Glossary.

The widow says that now she knows that the **word of Yahweh** is true. Use the same phrase for “word of Yahweh” as you used in previous passages. For more information, see “Word” in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 17:17–24

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (656 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1011 KB)

1 Kings 18:1–15

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 18:1–15 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:1–15 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

1 Kings 18:1–15

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This story is about the prophet Elijah meeting King Ahab after a long famine. A famine is when there is no rain for a long time, and it hurts crops and animals. Yahweh sent this famine as a punishment because King Ahab and Queen Jezebel led the people of Israel to worship false gods and hurt Yahweh's prophets.

In the last story, you will remember that Elijah was hiding in another country because Yahweh had told Elijah to hide during the famine. Yahweh took care of Elijah during the famine. Now, Yahweh tells Elijah that Yahweh will end the famine. Elijah must go tell King Ahab so that Ahab knows that Yahweh caused the famine and that Yahweh will also end it.

Elijah leaves the town of Zarephath to go to Samaria. Samaria was the capital city of Israel at that time. Sometimes people called the whole land of Israel "Samaria."

Stop here and look at the map that includes Zarephath and Samaria. Pause this audio here.

You will remember that Yahweh had promised there would be a famine. The famine had now lasted three years.

During the famine, there was little grass and water. Grass and water were both important for the king's horses and mules. So now, King Ahab and his palace manager, a man named Obadiah, go in different directions to search for grass near any streams for the animals. As palace manager, Obadiah helped take care of the king's house, land, and possessions.

Ahab and Obadiah hoped to find grass or water in springs or hidden valleys. These dry river valleys are small valleys that fill with water when it rains but stay dry during a drought.

Stop here and look at photos of a spring and a dry river valley. Discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when there was no rain, and the plants died. Imagine what it would be like if there were no rain for three years. Pause this audio here.

Obadiah sees Elijah and bows down to show respect. When Elijah tells Obadiah to tell Ahab that Elijah is there, Obadiah says, "What have I done wrong? Are you trying to get me killed?"

You remember that during the famine, Ahab had searched for Elijah everywhere—even in other countries. Ahab made people promise they were not hiding Elijah. Obadiah was afraid that if he went to tell Ahab that Elijah was there, Yahweh might move Elijah somewhere else. Then Ahab would be angry and kill Obadiah.

Obadiah wanted Elijah to know he loved and followed Yahweh. Obadiah reminded Elijah that when Queen Jezebel tried to kill Yahweh's prophets, Obadiah hid 100 of them in two caves—50 prophets in each cave. Obadiah gave the prophets food and water to help them stay safe. Just like Yahweh sent ravens and a widow to care for Elijah, Obadiah cared for the prophets.

Stop here and look at a picture of a cave as a group. Pause this audio here.

We know Obadiah told the truth because other parts of the Bible say the same thing. The Bible says Obadiah truly believed in Yahweh.

Elijah made a promise to Obadiah. Elijah said, "As surely as Yahweh of Heaven's Armies lives, whom I serve, I will go to Ahab today."

1 Kings 18:1–15

“Yahweh of heaven’s armies “ means Yahweh is powerful and rules over many angels in heaven. Elijah says he stands in Yahweh’s presence, meaning he is truly Yahweh’s prophet. By making this strong promise, Elijah is saying he trusts Yahweh to take care of everything.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Elijah, “Go and show yourself to Ahab, and I will send rain on the land.” It is the third year of the famine. Yahweh is ready to end the famine, and Elijah must deliver the message.

In the second scene: King Ahab and his palace administrator, Obadiah, are looking for any grass or water left in the land. Ahab and Obadiah hope to save the animals—the horses, mules, and other livestock. In this scene, the Bible also tells us something important about Obadiah: he truly followed Yahweh. Earlier in Obadiah’s life, he had hidden 100 of Yahweh’s prophets in caves when Queen Jezebel was trying to kill them.

In the third scene: Elijah appears before Obadiah. Obadiah is respectful but frightened. Obadiah is nervous that his own life will be in danger if Elijah disappears again, so Obadiah describes how he saved Yahweh’s prophets. Elijah swears that he will show himself to Ahab.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah
- Yahweh
- King Ahab
- Obadiah
- Jezebel
- And the prophets of Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage’s setting:

Long before this story happens, Jezebel, the queen, tried to kill all the prophets of Yahweh so that she could establish the prophets of her false gods in Israel.

In scene one, this happens after three years of no rain.

Stop and discuss with the team how you will start this passage so that it is clear that a long time has passed from the previous story. Pause the audio here.

Elijah is still in a foreign land, but Yahweh tells Elijah to return. We do not know how Yahweh spoke to Elijah, but it is clear that it was Yahweh who told Elijah to return.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will send rain and that Elijah must go and present himself to Ahab.

Stop and discuss how you will make it clear that Elijah is not just waiting around for Ahab to see him. Elijah is supposed to go to Ahab and talk with him. Pause the audio here.

Stop and show a picture of the landscape of Samaria. Pause the audio here.

Scene two takes place in Samaria. Ahab calls Obadiah to meet with him.

The storyteller gives us background about Obadiah. Obadiah fears, or respects and honors, Yahweh greatly. In the past, Obadiah hid 100 of Yahweh’s prophets in caves and gave them bread and water. In this case, bread really means food in general.

Stop and discuss what word you will use for bread to make it clear that it is food. Pause the audio here.

Stop and discuss how to make it clear that when Obadiah hid the 100 prophets, this occurred long before Ahab and Obadiah are talking in this scene. Pause the audio here.

After that background, the storyteller tells us Ahab's plan. Ahab and Obadiah will split up and search the land for springs and valleys that have grass. Springs are streams of water that flow out of the ground. Valleys are low areas that are often dry when it has not rained, but during times of rain, there are streams of water. People are more likely to find grass near these water sources. Ahab goes one way to look for grass, and Obadiah goes the other.

In the third scene, Obadiah is walking and suddenly sees Elijah. Obadiah bows down, not to worship Elijah, but to show respect because Elijah is a prophet. Obadiah is not sure if it is really Elijah. In fact, Obadiah asks Elijah, "Is it you, my lord, or master, Elijah?" No one in Israel has seen Elijah for years. Elijah confirms that he is indeed Elijah. Elijah tells Obadiah to tell his lord, or master, the king, "Look! Elijah is here." Elijah's words mean, "I have found Elijah!" or "I have seen Elijah!" Obadiah gets worried that Yahweh's Spirit will take Elijah away while Obadiah is going to get Ahab. If Obadiah tells Ahab about Elijah and then Elijah disappears again, Ahab might kill Obadiah.

Obadiah says Ahab sent people to search for Elijah absolutely everywhere. Obadiah greatly emphasizes the certainty of the search by swearing, "as surely as Yahweh your God lives." Obadiah greatly emphasizes the wide scope of the search by saying, "There is not a nation or kingdom where Ahab has not sent someone to search for Elijah." King Ahab even made people in other nations swear oaths that Elijah was not in their land. Obadiah is telling what great effort the king has gone to in order to find Elijah so that Elijah will understand how angry Ahab would be if Obadiah said he found Eljiiah and then Elijah disappeared. Obadiah tells Elijah what the storyteller already told us: how Obadiah had risked his life to hide 100 prophets of Yahweh in caves and give them food and water to protect them from Jezebel. Obadiah wants Elijah to understand that Obadiah is faithful to Yahweh.

Elijah promises that he will not disappear. Elijah makes an oath that, as surely as Yahweh lives, Elijah will meet with Ahab today. Elijah is saying that just as it is true that Yahweh lives, it is true that Elijah will appear before Ahab today.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah
- Yahweh
- King Ahab
- Obadiah
- Jezebel
- And the prophets of Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or t hinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

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The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, it has been three years since the famine began. Yahweh tells Elijah to go to Ahab and that Yahweh will send rain on the land.

Stop the action. Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am ready to go back home to Israel, but I am afraid for my life; or
- I am happy to hear this horrible famine will end.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am ready to bring rain, but the people are not ready to turn back to me.

Continue the drama.

Elijah responds to Yahweh by going to present himself to Ahab.

In scene two, the famine has been very severe in the capital of Samaria, so Ahab calls for his palace manager, Obadiah, to come to him. Obadiah is a devout follower of Yahweh. In the past, King Ahab's wife Jezebel put plans in place to kill off all of the prophets of Yahweh, but Obadiah took 100 of the prophets and hid them in two caves. Obadiah provided for the prophets by supplying them with food and water.

Stop the action. Ask the person playing Obadiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer with things like:

- I am afraid Jezebel may try to kill me, but I know that no one else has the resources to protect these prophets of Yahweh; or
- At any moment, Jezebel could catch me and kill me.

Continue the drama.

Back to the present, Ahab tells Obadiah that Ahab and Obadiah will search all the land for grass to keep the horses and mules alive.

Stop the action. Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer with things like:

- I am a king over the land, but I cannot even keep my horses alive; or
- I am so angry at that bad prophet, Elijah. I am a king, but instead of building a strong kingdom, I must go through all the land just looking for grass for animals.

Continue the drama.

So Ahab and Obadiah divide up where they will search and go in two different directions.

In scene three, Elijah walks up to Obadiah, who is walking alone. Obadiah recognizes Elijah, bows to the ground, and asks him if he is really Elijah. Elijah replies, "Yes. Go tell your master that Elijah is here." Then Obadiah asks, "What have I done wrong that you are handing me over to Ahab to be put to death?" Obadiah tells Elijah how the king searched throughout the land for Elijah and even forced kings from other nations to swear oaths that Elijah was not in their lands. Now, Elijah tells Obadiah to go to Ahab and say, "Elijah is here." Obadiah does not know if the Spirit of the Lord might carry off Elijah to protect Elijah while Obadiah would be left to face the anger of King Ahab, who would surely kill Obadiah if that happened. Obadiah tells Elijah that Obadiah has worshipped Yahweh ever since he was a youth. When Jezebel was killing all the prophets of Yahweh, Obadiah risked his life to hide and care for 100 prophets in two caves. Now, Elijah is telling Obadiah to go to the king and say, "Elijah is here." Ahab will surely kill Obadiah.

Stop the action. Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer with things like:

- Obadiah has been faithful. I understand Obadiah's fear; or
- Yahweh is at work in more people than I realized.

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Ask the person playing Obadiah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer with things like:

- I feel extreme fear; or
- I feel frustrated. I have already risked everything. Will this cost me my life?

Continue the drama.

Elijah reassures Obadiah with an oath: “As Yahweh of Heaven’s Armies lives, whom I serve, I will surely present myself to Ahab today.”

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

This story is about the prophet Elijah coming to see King Ahab after a long period of famine.

The “**word of Yahweh**” comes to Elijah during the third year of the famine. Translate “word of Yahweh” in the same way you have in previous passages. For more information on word and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh told Elijah to go and show himself to King Ahab in **Samaria**. You will remember that Samaria was a city in northern Israel. Translate Samaria in the same way you have in previous passages. For more information on Samaria, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Ahab had been searching for Elijah, the prophet who predicted the famine. A **famine** is a time of severe hunger, often caused by a lack of rain. This famine had lasted for three years. Ahab and his palace manager, Obadiah, were looking for grass and water to save their animals, especially horses and mules. Obadiah was a palace manager who managed the royal lands and possessions.

Stop and discuss with the team how you will translate the term **palace manager**. Use the same word for palace, or king’s house, that you have used in previous passages. Pause the audio here.

Even though he worked for an evil king, Obadiah followed Yahweh. Obadiah calls Elijah his “**lord**,” and Elijah calls Ahab Obadiah’s “lord.” A lord is someone who is a master over other people, who has full authority, and who deserves for people to give him respect. In the Bible, we hear people address their king as lord and slaves call their master lord. Use the same word or phrase for “lord” or master as you have used in previous passages, and for more information on lord, refer to the Master Glossary.

Obadiah had hidden 100 of Yahweh’s **prophets** in two caves while Jezebel was trying to kill them. Use the same word or phrase for prophets as you have used in previous passages. For more information about prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ahab had told Obadiah to go look in all the springs and **valleys** for water. A spring is a place where fresh water comes up directly from the ground. A valley here is the same dry river valley from previous passages. You will remember that these dry river valleys are dry when it does not rain, and full of water when there is enough rain. Use the same word or phrase for these kinds of “wadis,” or dry river valleys.

Stop here and look at a photo of a spring and a photo of a dry river valley. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **spring**. Pause this audio here.

Obadiah feared Yahweh, which means that Obadiah worshipped and respected Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use to say that Obadiah **feared** Yahweh. For more information about fear of Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

When Obadiah saw Elijah, he **bowed** to the ground because he respected Elijah. Use the same word or phrase for bow as you used in previous passages. For more information about bow, refer to the Master Glossary.

Obadiah calls himself a servant of Elijah and asks what sin he has committed. A **servant** is a person who does work for someone else. Obadiah is not a slave or a servant who works in Elijah’s household, but Obadiah respects

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Elijah's authority over him as a prophet of Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for servant when it means something similar, and for more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Some versions translate "what **sin** have I committed" as "what have I done wrong?" A sin is an act of rebellion against Yahweh. Obadiah asks what he has done wrong against Yahweh or Elijah that would be reason to put Obadiah's life in danger to tell Ahab that Elijah has come back. Use the same word or phrase for sin here as you have used in previous passages. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary.

Obadiah tells Elijah that as surely as Yahweh his **God** lives, King Ahab has searched every **nation** and **kingdom** for Elijah. A nation is a group of people who belong together, who live in the same country, and who have the same ruler. A kingdom is the territory that a king rules. Use the same words or phrases for God, nation, and kingdom as you have used in previous passages. For more information on God, nation, and kingdom, refer to the Master Glossary.

Obadiah says that he has **worshiped** Yahweh since he was young. Use the same word or phrase for worship as you have used in previous passages. For more information about worship, refer to the Master Glossary.

Obadiah is afraid that if he tells King Ahab that Elijah is there, the **Spirit of Yahweh** will take Elijah away and hide him. Then Ahab will be angry and might kill Obadiah for lying. In the Old Testament, the phrase "the Spirit of Yahweh" often means Yahweh's power and presence in action. It shows how Yahweh works in the world, like guiding people, giving them strength, or helping prophets speak Yahweh's message. In the New Testament, we hear about "the Spirit of Yahweh" or "the Holy Spirit." The Holy Spirit is one of the three persons of God—Father, Son (Jesus), and Holy Spirit. Although in this passage you should refer to God's Spirit as the Spirit of Yahweh, for more information, refer to the **Holy Spirit** in the Master Glossary.

When Obadiah meets Elijah, Elijah tells him to inform King Ahab that he is here. But Obadiah is afraid. Obadiah fears that if he tells Ahab and then Elijah disappears again, Ahab might kill Obadiah out of anger. Elijah promises with an **oath**, or strong promise, that he will surely meet Ahab that very day. The storyteller does not use the word for oath, but for more information about oath, you may refer to oath in the Master Glossary.

Elijah's oath uses a special name for Yahweh: "Yahweh of Heaven's Armies." Some versions translate this name for Yahweh as "Yahweh of Hosts" or "Yahweh Almighty." This name emphasizes that Yahweh is a mighty ruler who commands vast heavenly armies. Elijah is showing that he does not fear an earthly king like Ahab because Elijah serves the almighty Yahweh, who leads the armies of heaven. This title teaches us that Yahweh is powerful, sovereign, and able to act on behalf of Yahweh's people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for **Yahweh of Heaven's Armies**. For more information, refer to "Yahweh of Hosts" in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 18:1–15

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (656 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1008 KB)

1 Kings 18:16–29

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 18:16–29 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:16–29 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:16–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You will remember that King Ahab searched for Elijah during the three years of famine. After three years, Elijah came to King Ahab's palace manager, Obadiah, to tell him that Elijah was there to see him. At the beginning of this part of the story, Obadiah tells Ahab that he has found Elijah. Then Ahab goes to see Elijah.

Ahab calls Elijah a troublemaker of Israel. A troublemaker is someone who causes problems or ruin for someone else. Ahab is saying that Elijah has caused the great famine. But Elijah says Ahab and Ahab's father, Omri, who was king before Ahab, were the ones who caused the trouble for Israel. Ahab and Omri stopped following Yahweh's commands and turned instead to the false gods of Baal and Asherah.

You will remember that Ahab's wife, Queen Jezebel, was not an Israelite. Jezebel was a Canaanite. When Jezebel became queen, she brought the worship of Baal and Asherah to Israel and tried to kill all the prophets of Yahweh.

Baal was a false god that the Canaanite people had worshiped before the Israelites conquered the land and pushed out the Canaanites and their worship of Baal. Baal was the storm god whom the people thought had power over rain and fertility. Three years before this story, Elijah told Ahab that Yahweh would not allow it to rain and cause a great famine. The famine proved that the false god Baal had no power to bring rain.

Asherah was the female partner of Baal and another false god of the Canaanites. People set up wooden poles on which they may have carved images of Asherah in her honor.

Elijah called for King Ahab to invite all the people of Israel to Mount Carmel and bring the 450 prophets of Baal and the 400 prophets of Asherah. The story says the prophets ate at Jezebel's table. Jezebel probably did not have a table where the 850 false prophets ate. Jezebel supported the prophets of Baal and Asherah by providing them with food from the royal supplies.

Mount Carmel was a high mountain by the Mediterranean Sea in the northwest of Israel. Mount Carmel was near the border of the land where Jezebel grew up and worshiped Baal and Asherah.

Stop here and look at a map and a picture of Mount Carmel as a group. Pause this audio here.

Elijah, Ahab, the people of Israel, and the 850 prophets of Baal and Asherah gather on Mount Carmel. Elijah, the only prophet of Yahweh at Mount Carmel, confronts the people. Elijah asks how long the people will limp along with two different opinions, or jump between two different opinions. Elijah challenges the people to decide which one is the true God and follow that God. If Yahweh is the true God, follow him. If Baal is the true god, follow him. To follow God is to obey and worship him. But the people stay silent and do not answer Elijah.

Elijah proposes a contest between Baal and Yahweh to see who is the true god. Elijah and the prophets of Baal will prepare two different sacrifices of bulls. Elijah will let the prophets of Baal get the bulls for the sacrifice and let them choose which bull they want for the sacrifice. A bull is an adult male cattle and is one of the highest-quality animals for a sacrifice. Because the prophets of Baal will choose the animals, they will not be able to accuse Elijah of causing a problem so that Baal will not approve of the animal. Elijah and the group of prophets will each prepare the sacrifices in the same way. They cut the bulls into pieces and place them on wood, but will not set the wood on fire yet. The prophets of Baal will first call out to Baal to light the fire for the sacrifice. The story says that the prophets will call on the name of Baal. This is a way to say that they will pray to their god by name and ask him to answer. Then Elijah will get the opportunity to pray to Yahweh and ask Yahweh to light the other sacrifice. Since Baal is the storm god who has power over lightning and rain, the prophets of Baal must think it will be easy for Baal to use lightning to start the fire. The people agree that this is a good idea.

Stop and discuss how people make group decisions in your culture. The storyteller does not tell exactly how the people made the decision, but you should make clear that it was not just Elijah's decision. The people agreed that this was a good idea. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at photos of a bull and an altar of sacrifice. Discuss these questions: How do people offer sacrifices in your culture? If people in your culture do not make sacrifices, what are some things that people do to please or gain the attention of their god? Pause this audio here.

Baal's prophets try to get Baal's attention so that he will send down fire to light the sacrifice. Baal's prophets shout, but no one responds. Next, Baal's prophets dance or limp around the altar. No one responds to this ritual dance.

Elijah begins to taunt and mock Baal's prophets. Elijah suggests that Baal is busy or distracted in some way. Elijah gives at least four possibilities. Maybe Baal is meditating or deep in thought. Maybe Baal is busy. Maybe Baal is traveling somewhere. Maybe Baal is sleeping, and the prophets need to awaken him. Baal worshipers believed that Baal could go on a journey, fall asleep, or even die. But Elijah is simply taunting or mocking them by giving these suggestions.

The prophets of Baal are desperate. The prophets of Baal fear that they will lose their authority as prophets. To get Baal's attention, the prophets cut themselves using swords and lances. In some religions, people cut their skin with knives as an act of worship and mourning. [Yahweh forbade the Israelites from cutting their bodies in worship.]{.mark} The swords were probably small swords, like knives, that people used for stabbing. The lances were spears that had long shafts. People used lances in battle to thrust at the enemy rather than to throw like a spear or javelin. The prophets of Baal kept making marks on their bodies with the swords and lances until they began to bleed.

Stop here and look at photos of swords and lances like the prophets of Baal might have used in this ritual. Pause this audio here.

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Baal still did not answer. [At noontime, the prophets of Baal started to shout louder and act wild and excited, hoping their god would answer them.]{.mark} By the time of the normal evening sacrifice that happens each day, Baal was still silent. Baal could not light the fire for the sacrifice.

Stop here and do this activity: Have one group member name an activity that happens in your culture or community at the same time every day. Then have the other group members respond with the time that the activity happens. Then have another group member name another activity, and have the group guess the time.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:16–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Obadiah goes to tell Ahab that Obadiah found Elijah. Ahab goes to meet Elijah.

In the second scene: Ahab and Elijah accuse each other of causing the trouble of Israel. Elijah tells Ahab to gather all of Israel and the prophets of Baal to Mount Carmel.

In the third scene: Elijah rebukes the people of Israel for wavering between two gods. Elijah proposes a contest to see which is the true God—Yahweh or Baal.

In the fourth scene: All day, the prophets of Baal attempt to get Baal to light the fire for the sacrifice to prove that Baal is the true god. The prophets do many things, but Baal does not light the fire.

The characters in this passage are:

- The prophet Elijah
- Obadiah, the palace manager
- King Ahab
- 450 prophets of Baal and 400 prophets of Asherah
- And the people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

You will remember that in the last part of the story, just before this, Elijah promised Obadiah that he would present himself to Ahab. Now, in the first scene of this story, Obadiah leaves Elijah to find King Ahab to tell him about Elijah. Ahab then goes to meet Elijah. The story does not say exactly where this happens, but it seems that Elijah is in the same place that Obadiah had left him. Ahab had been looking for Elijah all over the place for several years.

In the second scene, King Ahab begins the conversation by asking a question that he does not expect Elijah to answer: "Is that you, you troubler of Israel?" Ahab already knows that it is Elijah. Ahab accuses Elijah of bringing trouble to Israel by announcing and causing the severe drought of no rain for several years.

Elijah replies that it is not Elijah who has brought trouble on Israel, but Ahab's father's family that has caused the trouble. Ahab's father was Omri, who was the king before Ahab. Elijah says that Omri's family has abandoned Yahweh's commands and followed the false god Baal. Ahab's wife, Jezebel, was supporting 450 prophets of Baal and 400 prophets of Asherah with the royal supplies. Elijah tells Ahab that it is both Ahab and Ahab's father's family who have abandoned Yahweh's commands and followed Baal.

Elijah calls for Ahab to summon all the people of Israel to meet Elijah on Mount Carmel, along with the 450 prophets of Baal and 400 prophets of Asherah.

In the third scene, Ahab sends "word," or a message, throughout all the people of Israel and gathers all the prophets to meet Elijah on Mount Carmel. The story does not tell us how many people gather there, but all of the people in the land know that they can come up on the mountain. The story is not clear whether all the prophets

of Baal and Asherah come, but it is clear that Elijah asks for them all to be there. Elijah tells the people that Elijah is the only prophet of Yahweh who has come, and Baal has 450 prophets.

Stop here and look at photos of Mount Carmel. Describe a time when you were with a large group of people. How many people were gathered there? How did you feel in such a large crowd of people? Try to picture thousands of people gathered here for this contest. Pause the audio here.

Elijah first confronts the people and asks them, “How long will you go on limping between two opinions? If Yahweh is God, follow him, but if Baal is God, follow him.” The question, “How long [will you go on limping between two opinions?” is special language to say, “How long will you try to follow both God and Baal at the same time?” This question means the people were not choosing one side, but were stuck in the middle, like someone who tries to walk on two different paths or uses crutches. Elijah is telling the people they need to make a clear choice and not keep switching back and forth.]{.mark}

Stop and discuss how groups in your culture try to decide between two different opinions when you are not sure. How do you talk about that? Pause this audio here.

However, the people do not answer Elijah’s questions. It seems that the people have not yet decided. The Israelites have been worshiping Baal, Asherah, and sometimes, Yahweh. Queen Jezebel has been supporting the prophets of the Canaanite gods and trying to kill the prophets of Yahweh.

When the people do not answer Elijah, Elijah proposes a contest to see which is the true god. The people will get two bulls for sacrifices. The 450 prophets of Baal will first select one bull and prepare it for sacrifice. Elijah will prepare the other bull for sacrifice. [When people prepare a sacrifice, they make sure that the altar is ready and they have wood to burn the offering. The person then takes the animal or other things to be offered and kills a bull, cuts it into pieces, and puts the pieces on the wood. The person will not light the fire themselves, but will wait for the true God to send fire to burn up the sacrifice. People will do all these steps to show honor to God and ask for his answer.]{.mark}

The prophets of Baal will first get an opportunity to pray to Baal and ask him to light the fire of the sacrifice. Then Elijah will get an opportunity to call on Yahweh to light the fire of Elijah’s sacrifice. Elijah says that the spiritual being who answers by fire is the true God. Then all the people say, “It is well spoken,” which means they agree that this is a good and fair plan.

Stop and remember how you discussed how your culture comes to an agreement on a group decision. Discuss how you will translate that the people all agreed. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the contest begins when Elijah tells the prophets of Baal to choose a bull, prepare the bull, call on the name of their god, but do not light the fire. The prophets make all the preparations for the sacrifice. The prophets cut up the bull and put those pieces on the wood. The prophets do not light the fire. The prophets begin to call on the name of Baal.

From morning to noon, the prophets of Baal call loudly for Baal to answer them. But Baal does not answer. The prophets dance around the altar in a special ritual while they call on Baal. Still, Baal does not answer.

At noon, Elijah begins to taunt the prophets to shout louder. Elijah is encouraging the prophets and almost sounds like he agrees with them, but Elijah is only taunting and mocking them. Elijah tells the prophets that surely Baal is a god, but the problem could be that Baal is distracted and thinking about other things. Or maybe Baal is busy, or traveling, or sleeping. Baal just needs someone to wake him up. The prophets of Baal shout louder. To get Baal’s attention, the prophets begin to cut themselves with swords and lances so that they bleed. The prophets receive no answer. As the hours continue to pass, the prophets begin to prophesy, or shout louder, and act in a wild and excited manner. When these prophets prophesy, it does not mean they are predicting the future or reminding people to keep the law of the covenant. When these prophets prophesy, or show that they speak to and hear from their god, it means they speak and move in a wild manner with much energy and move their hands.

By the time of the normal evening sacrifice, it has been all day, but Baal has not been able to light the fire of the sacrifice. According to Israel’s law, the priests offered to Yahweh half of one of the grain offerings in the morning

and the other half in the evening. Here, in this story, the reference to the time of the evening offering is simply a way to show the time of day, which was about three o'clock in the afternoon.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate the idea of the evening offering so that people will understand that the storyteller is referring to the time of day. Pause the audio here.

The storyteller emphasizes that Baal does not respond by saying almost the same thing three times: There was no response. No one answered. No one paid attention.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:16–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The prophet Elijah
- Obadiah, the palace manager
- King Ahab
- 450 prophets of Baal and 400 prophets of Asherah
- And the people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

After talking with the prophet Elijah, Ahab's palace manager, Obadiah, leaves Elijah to go tell king Ahab where he has found Elijah. When Ahab hears where Elijah is, Ahab goes to Elijah. When Ahab sees Elijah, Ahab asks, "Is that you, you troublemaker for Israel?"

Pause the drama. Ask the actor playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The actor might answer things like:

- I am afraid for my life because I have been hiding from Ahab. Jezebel has been trying to kill me because I am a prophet of Yahweh; or
- I am angry at Ahab because he is blaming me for causing the trouble.

Continue the drama.

Elijah replies, "It is not me that has been causing the trouble for Israel. It is you and your father's family that has been causing trouble. You have abandoned the commands of Yahweh and started following Baal. Call together the people of Israel and gather the 450 prophets of Baal and the 400 prophets of Asherah that eat at Jezebel's table. Have everyone meet me on Mount Carmel."

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Ahab notifies the people in all of Israel and gathers the prophets on top of Mount Carmel. Elijah addresses the people and asks them, “How long will you waver between two opinions? If Yahweh is God, follow him. But if Baal is God, follow him.” But the people say nothing.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- There is only one prophet of Yahweh left and hundreds of prophets of Baal. But this one prophet sounds like he has a lot of authority; or
- I feel guilty because Israelites have always worshipped Yahweh; or
- I do not know what to think.

Continue the drama.

Elijah then says to the people, “I am the only one of Yahweh’s prophets left, but Baal has 450 prophets. Here is what we will do. Get two bulls for sacrifices. Let the prophets of Baal choose one of the bulls for themselves and prepare the sacrifice by cutting the bull into pieces and putting it on the wood. I will prepare the other bull. No one will set fire to the sacrifices. The prophets of Baal will call on the name of Baal, and I will call on the name of Yahweh. The god who answers by setting fire to the sacrifices is the true God.”

Then all the people say, “Your plan is good.”

Elijah says to the prophets of Baal, “Since there are so many of you, you go first and prepare the bull for sacrifice. Call on the name of your god, but do not light the fire.” The prophets of Baal prepare the bull and call on the name of Baal for hours and hours. From morning until noon they shout, “O Baal, answer us!” But there is no response. No one answers. So the prophets begin to dance around the altar of sacrifice.

When noon comes, Elijah taunts and mocks the prophets of Baal. Elijah says, “Shout louder. Surely Baal is a god! Maybe Baal is just thinking about something else. Or maybe Baal is busy. Or maybe Baal is traveling. Or maybe Baal’s sleeping and someone needs to wake him up.”

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the prophets of Baal, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I am getting very nervous. All the other prophets of Baal think Baal will light the fire, but I am not so sure now; or
- That prophet Elijah is making me angry. Elijah is making fun of us; or
- What do I have to do so that Baal will light the fire and prove that he is the true god?

Continue the drama.

When Elijah taunts the prophets, the prophets of Baal shout louder. The prophets cut themselves with swords and spears, as part of their rituals, even to the point that they begin to bleed. Even after the middle of the day passes, the prophets begin to pray in a wild and excited manner all the way until the time for the evening sacrifice. But Baal does not respond. No one answers. No one pays attention.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I have never seen anything so crazy in my life; or
- I cannot believe the storm god could not bring fire to light the sacrifice; or
- I feel hopeless because there is still no rain. None of these gods can help.

Ask the person playing Ahab, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- This Elijah is causing all of these problems! or
- If it is not Elijah’s fault, then maybe it is my wife’s fault for bringing in all of these prophets.

Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Wow, it felt great to give these prophets such a hard time. These prophets are miserable; or

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- Now it is time for Yahweh. I am a little anxious, but I know Yahweh will come through.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:16–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Ahab met **Elijah** and said, "Are you the troublemaker of **Israel**?" Translate Elijah and Israel in the same way you have in previous passages. For more information on Elijah and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah tells Ahab that Ahab and his father's family have abandoned **Yahweh's commandments**. A commandment is a law, a rule, or an instruction. God gives commandments to people to show them how to live well, in a good relationship with God and with others. When the Bible talks about God's commandments in this passage, this means all the instructions that God has given his people. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and for command that you have previously used in other passages. For more information on Yahweh and commandment, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah tells Ahab to summon the people of Israel, the 450 **prophets** of **Baal**, and the 400 prophets of Asherah. A prophet is a person who claims to speak messages from a god. Baal is a false god whom many people in Canaan worshiped. Asherah, Baal's partner, is a false goddess whom people in Canaan worshiped in Canaan. Use the same words or phrases for prophet and Baal as you have used previously. For more information on prophet and Baal, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah says, "If Yahweh is **God**, follow him. If Baal is god, follow him." In the Bible, "God" means the Creator of everything and the one true God. Yahweh made a special promise to Abraham and his family, the Israelites. Yahweh said not to worship any other **gods**. But some people worship spirits or idols that people made from wood or metal. These are false gods, like Baal. Use the same word or phrase for God and gods, or false gods, as you have used previously. For more information on God and gods, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah proposed that people prepare two **sacrifices**, one to Baal and one to Yahweh. The true God would be the one who lights the fire of the sacrifice without the help of people. [A sacrifice is a gift that people offer to God, usually by placing an animal or other gift on an altar and then burning it. People gave sacrifices to thank, worship, or ask forgiveness from God. Use the same word or phrase for sacrifice as you have used previously. For more information on sacrifice, refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

Elijah tells the prophets to call on the name of their god, and then Elijah will call on the name of his God. To "call on the name of your God" is to talk to your God and trust that his name, or reputation, is good. The prophets of Baal cried out to Baal to reveal himself as true by answering them by lighting the fire of the sacrifice.

Stop here and discuss how to translate "**call on the name of their god**." Pause this audio here.

To get Baal's attention, the prophets of Baal cut themselves using **swords** and thrusting spears. Use the same word for swords as you have used in previous passages. In some ancient religions, it was the custom that people would cut their skin as a mark to mourn the dead and to worship idols. The swords were probably small swords, like knives, that people used for stabbing. The thrusting spears were long spears that had long shafts that people used in battle to thrust at the enemy rather than to throw like a spear or javelin. The prophets of Baal kept making marks with the swords and spears until they began to bleed.

Stop here and look at photos of swords and thrusting spears like the prophets of Baal might have used in this ritual. Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**thrusting spear**." If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

[The prophets of Baal tried to **prophesy** by calling on their god to answer with fire. The prophets shouted, danced, and even acted wildly or frenzily in hopes that their god would respond. The prophets kept this up for hours and got more and more excited, but Baal did not answer. Only Elijah, the prophet of the true God, gave a real message from Yahweh and saw God's power. So, to prophesy here means to speak or act as a messenger for

a god, sometimes with loud or wild behavior, to ask for a sign or answer. For more information on “prophesy,” refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

Speaking the Word
Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content
- Hear and Heart (692 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1009 KB)

1 Kings 18:30–40

Hear and Heart
In this step, hear 1 Kings 18:30–40 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:30–40 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

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Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:30–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You will remember that just before this story, Elijah told King Ahab to gather the people of Israel and the prophets of Baal at Mount Carmel. Elijah challenged the prophets of Baal to pray to Baal to reveal himself as the true God by lighting the fire of the bull sacrifice. The prophets prayed, shouted, danced, and cut themselves all day, but Baal did not answer them. Now it is Elijah's turn to pray to Yahweh.

Elijah tells the people, "Come to me." Elijah wants the people of Israel to pay close attention to how Elijah is preparing the sacrifice. First, Elijah repairs the altar of Yahweh. People used to make sacrifices to Yahweh on Mount Carmel. The altar was in bad condition because people had stopped making sacrifices to Yahweh. You will remember that Jezebel was trying to stop people from worshipping Yahweh in Israel so that the people would worship Baal instead.

Stop and look at a picture of an altar. Pause the audio here.

Elijah repairs the altar by using 12 stones, one for each of the 12 tribes of Israel. [The storyteller reminds us that many years before, Yahweh had changed Jacob's name to Israel. God spoke to Jacob and gave him the new name, "Israel." Jacob had 12 sons, and each son had many children. These families grew into the people we call the nation of Israel. Each family group from Jacob's sons became a tribe of Israel. So,]{.mark} Elijah took 12 stones to repair this altar to Yahweh, Israel's God.

Elijah did something unusual when Elijah dug a trench, or small ditch, around the altar. The trench was able to hold about two seahs of grain. A seah is an ancient measurement that held about 15 liters. Elijah did not put grain in the trenches. The measurement is to show how deep the ditch was around the altar. After Elijah dug the trench, Elijah prepared the bull by cutting the meat into pieces, just like the prophets of Baal had done for their sacrifice. Elijah put the meat on top of the wood, which was on top of the stone altar.

Then Elijah asked the people to prepare four large jars of water. Each of the jars probably had several liters of water. Elijah got the people to pour the water on top of the sacrifice so that the meat of the bull was very wet. The water made the wood and stones all very wet. A wet sacrifice would make it difficult for someone to light a fire on a wet surface.

Elijah told the people to pour four large jars of water on the sacrifice three times. [People had made these jars or pots from clay and shaped them to carry and store liquids. Each jar could hold a few liters of water, which is enough to fill a large bucket. People carried these jars by hand or on their shoulders. The jars were strong enough to hold heavy water, but not too big for a person to lift. People used jars like these every day for water, oil, or other liquids.]{.mark}

[Stop and look at a picture of a clay jar that can hold a few liters of liquid. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

[The people poured so much water that everything was soaked. Water even filled the trench around the altar as it flowed down from the top of the sacrifice.]{.mark}

Stop here and have a group member tell a story about what it is like to build a fire when the wood is wet. What is it like to light a fire with wet firewood? Pause this audio here.

When Elijah prayed to Yahweh, Elijah called Yahweh the God of Abraham, Isaac, and "Israel," or Jacob. Abraham was Israel's grandfather, and Isaac was Israel's father. Abraham, Isaac, and Israel had all worshipped Yahweh. These three men were the famous ancestors of Israel.

Elijah prayed that Yahweh would answer Elijah's prayer by lighting the fire of the soaking-wet sacrifice. Elijah prayed that Yahweh would do this so the people of Israel would know that Yahweh is the one true God and that Yahweh was turning the hearts of the people of Israel back again. When people turn their hearts back to Yahweh, they commit themselves to stop worshipping Baal and to start worshipping Yahweh again.

Stop and t[ell a story about a time when people turned back or returned to an old way or belief. Pause this audio here.]{.mark}

Yahweh sent his fire and burned the sacrifice. Yahweh answered Elijah's prayer and burned the wet meat, the wet wood, and even the wet stones. Only an extraordinarily intense fire could burn up the stones. In Scripture, fire often symbolizes the presence of Yahweh or the judgment of Yahweh. Yahweh answered the prayer by sending fire when the storm god, Baal, could not.

The fire even licked up all the water in the trench around the altar. Another way to say this is that the fire ate up the water. This means that the fire completely dried up the water in the ditch.

Stop here and tell about a time when someone experienced a strong and intense fire. How quickly did the fire burn wood and other things? Does that fire seem stronger or less intense than the fire that burned up Elijah's sacrifice? Pause this audio here.

When all the people witnessed the fire burn up the sacrifice, the people threw themselves down on the ground to show their humility. The people shouted, "Yahweh, he is God. Yahweh, he is God." The people realized that, just like Elijah had said, Yahweh is truly God!

Then Elijah commanded the people of Israel to "seize," or capture, the prophets of Baal. The people captured all the prophets of Baal. Then Elijah took them down to the valley next to the mountain to kill them. Elijah was doing what the Israelite law in Deuteronomy 13 said to do to people who lead others to worship idols: the leaders should kill these prophets of Baal.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:30–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Elijah repairs the altar, digs a trench around it, and prepares a sacrifice. Elijah tells some people to pour water on the altar and sacrifice.

In the second scene: Elijah prays to Yahweh, who answers by sending fire. The people of Israel praise Yahweh as God, and the people of Israel take the prophets of Baal down to the valley and kill them.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah
- The people of Israel
- Ahab, the king of Israel, who we know is there, but who does not do anything in this part of the story
- Yahweh
- And the prophets of Baal

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the previous passage, Elijah criticized King Ahab for abandoning Yahweh to worship false gods. Elijah instructed Ahab to gather the people of Israel and the prophets of Baal and Asherah on top of Mount Carmel to judge whether Yahweh or Baal is the true god. The prophets of Baal cried out all morning for the god Baal himself to light the fire of the sacrifice of the prophets of Baal.

The first scene overlaps a little with the end of the previous story about the prophets of Baal. The prophets of Baal cried out for Baal to answer them all the way until the time of the evening sacrifice to Yahweh, which took place around 3 p.m. Then, at the time of the evening sacrifice, around 3 in the afternoon, Elijah begins to pray to Yahweh.

Elijah takes a lot of time to repair an old altar with special stones, cut up the meat, dig a trench, and pour many jars of water onto the sacrifice, so Elijah has probably already started to prepare the altar before 3 in the afternoon. Here is how Elijah prepares the altar. Elijah prepares a separate altar of sacrifice from the ones for Baal. This includes the materials for the altar, the wood to burn the offering, and the bull for the sacrifice to Yahweh. Elijah begins by first asking the people of Israel to come closer to him. Elijah probably does not want

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the prophets of Baal to distract the people because the prophets are desperately crying out to Baal. Elijah wants the people to pay attention to the special way Elijah is preparing the sacrifice.

Elijah uses the same kind of young bull and wood that the prophets of Baal used for their sacrifice. But Elijah repairs an old, damaged altar to Yahweh. Elijah takes 12 stones to represent the 12 tribes of Israel to make the base of the altar. The storyteller interrupts the story about Elijah to tell the story about the 12 sons of Jacob and how Yahweh changed Jacob's name to Israel. The storyteller says that Yahweh's word came to Jacob. The word of Yahweh is what Yahweh said to Jacob. The word of Yahweh said that Jacob's new name was Israel.

Stop and tell a story from your culture that gives extra details from another story in the middle of the main story. Pay attention to how the storyteller changes from the main story to those extra details. Are there specific words or phrases that signal to the listener that this is extra information? Notice how the storyteller helps people understand what is happening. Pause this audio here.

Then, like the prophets of Baal, Elijah puts the wood on the altar and cuts up pieces of bull to place on top of the wood. Elijah digs a trench around the altar deep enough to hold many liters of water, but he does not put anything in the trench.

Elijah asks the people of Israel to prepare four large jars of water, which would each hold several liters of water. Then Elijah tells the people to pour the four large jars of water to soak the sacrifice and the wood. Then Elijah asks the people to do the same thing two more times. The storyteller repeats Elijah's command to pour the water, and then to do it again. This emphasizes that the people pour four jars of water three times. So altogether, this would be pouring 12 jars full of water on the sacrifice and wood. This was so much water that the water filled the trench.

Stop here and discuss how you will make it clear that while Elijah was preparing the altar, the prophets of Baal were continuing to cry out to Baal, but everything stopped at the time of the evening sacrifice when Elijah began his prayer. The easiest way to do this may be to emphasize the time of the evening sacrifice in both parts of the story. Pause the audio here.

The second scene starts at the time of the evening sacrifice, around 3 in the afternoon. The prophets of Baal had cried out to Baal all day until that time. Now it was Elijah's turn to pray to Yahweh. At this time, Elijah steps forward to the altar.

Elijah prays a short prayer. Elijah begins by calling on the name of Yahweh and calling Yahweh the God of the fathers, or ancestors, of Israel: Abraham, Isaac, and Israel. Then, as Elijah is asking Yahweh to light the fire, Elijah gives the reasons: Elijah wants people to know that Yahweh is the true God of the people of Israel, that Elijah is the servant of Yahweh, and that Elijah's actions are from Yahweh. Elijah twice asks Yahweh to answer Elijah's prayer. Then Elijah gives two more reasons: that the people of Israel will know that Yahweh is God and that Yahweh is turning the Israelites' hearts back from idols to Yahweh.

Stop and discuss how people in your community talk about turning back to something that was important or good. Remember the story in the previous step that you told about people turning back to an old belief. How did you talk about the people turning back and changing their hearts or minds? Pause the audio here.

The prophets of Baal have been praying all day with no answer, but Yahweh answers Elijah's prayer immediately. Yahweh sends a fire down that consumes, or burns up, the bull, the wood, and even the stones. Remember that all of these things are very wet. The fire even consumes, or dries up, all the water that had filled the ditch around the altar.

When the fire falls from heaven, the people immediately fall down on their faces to show humility. The people begin to repeat with loud voices, "Yahweh, he is God. Yahweh, he is God." Not only had Yahweh answered Elijah's prayer that Yahweh reveal himself as the true God, but Yahweh had also answered the prayer to turn the people away from Baal and back to Yahweh. [Make sure to say that Yahweh sent the fire; the fire was not an accident. The storyteller talks about fire falling and the people falling in the same way. This connection shows how both the fire and the people's response were powerful and immediate.]{.mark}

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[Stop here and discuss how you can talk about the fire falling and the people falling. This helps show the connection between God's action and the people's reaction.]{.mark} [How will you show the connection between Yahweh's action and the people's reaction?]{.mark} Pause the audio here.

The fire even licked up all the water in the trench around the altar like an animal licks up water. Another way to say this is that the fire ate up the water. The meaning is that the fire completely dried up the water in the ditch.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you talk about the fire eating up or burning the bull, the wood, and the stones, and licking up the water? Pause this audio here.

Elijah commands the people of Israel to seize all the 450 prophets of Baal. Then Elijah takes the prophets down Mount Carmel into the Kishon Valley, where he slaughters the prophets. The Kishon Valley was a small farming valley on the northeast edge of the base of Mount Carmel.

Stop and look at a map that shows the Kishon Valley at the base of Mount Carmel. Pause this audio here.

We do not know why Elijah takes the prophets to the valley. When Elijah takes the prophets to the valley and kills the prophets, this probably means Elijah orders people to help him take the prophets to the valley and kill the prophets, not that Elijah kills every prophet himself. The storyteller talks about killing these prophets in the same way that people talk about killing animals by slitting their throats.

[Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you talk about Elijah and others killing the prophets of Baal in the same way that people kill animals by slitting their throats? Pause this audio here.]{.mark}

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:30–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah
- The people of Israel
- Ahab, the king of Israel, who we know is there, but who does not do anything in this part of the story
- Yahweh
- And the prophets of Baal

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Elijah calls all the people to himself saying, "Come here to me." The Israelites come to Elijah and watch him repair an altar to Yahweh. To make the base of the altar, Elijah uses 12 stones to represent the 12 tribes of Israel. Yahweh had changed Jacob's name to Israel.

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Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- Yes, the God of our ancestors is Yahweh; or
- Yahweh is the God of our ancestors, but I feel uncertain if he is still our God. We have no rain; or
- Look! Elijah uses 12 stones, just like there are 12 tribes in Israel. I remember stories of how Moses and Joshua made altars with 12 stones.

Continue the drama.

Elijah digs a trench around the altar. The trench is big enough to hold two measures of grain, which is about 15 to 30 liters. Elijah arranges the wood for the fire on top of the stone. Elijah cuts the meat into pieces and puts it on top of the wood. Then Elijah tells the people to fill four large jars of water and pour it on the offering of meat and on the wood. When the people pour the four jars of water on the sacrifice, Elijah tells the people to do it again. When the people refill the jars and do it again, Elijah tells them to do it a third time. At this point, the water is running down over the meat and wood and stones and filling up the ditch with water.

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- This is not a normal sacrifice to Yahweh with all this water; or
- It will be impossible for this sacrifice to catch fire. Why is Elijah doing this?

Continue the drama.

Then, at the time of the evening sacrifice, the prophet Elijah steps forward and prays, “ Yahweh, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, let the people know that you are the God in Israel. Let the people know that I am your servant and have done all things at your command. Answer me, Yahweh, answer me, so these people will know that you, Yahweh, are God, and that you are turning their hearts back to you again.”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am confident that Yahweh is God; or
- I am a little confident but also nervous; or
- I am eager for the people of Israel to turn back to God.

Continue the drama.

Then fire from Yahweh falls down from the sky and burns the sacrifice, the wood, the stones, and the soil, and burns up all the water in the trench.

When the people of Israel see this happen, they fall down on their faces, lie on the ground, and cry, “Yahweh, he is God! Yahweh, he is God!”

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are amazed! or
- We feel afraid. We know that we have done wrong by allowing and participating in the worship of Baal.

Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed! I knew that Yahweh would reveal himself, but I could never imagine anything like this; or
- I feel justified because now it is clear that I am truly God’s servant, helping Israel. It was not me who caused the famine. It was Ahab’s family’s fault; or
- Praise Yahweh. Yahweh is God!

Ask the people playing the prophets of Baal, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are amazed! How could this happen? or
- Everything we have been doing as prophets of Baal must have been a lie; or

- Yahweh is the true God! or
- We are terrified. People will accuse us of being false prophets.

Continue the drama.

Then Elijah commands the people of Israel, “Seize these prophets of Baal. Do not let any of them escape!” The people of Israel seize all the 450 prophets of Baal. Elijah has the people of Israel take the prophets of Baal down the mountain into the Kishon Valley where Elijah slaughters all the prophets of Baal.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:30–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Elijah rebuilt an **altar** to **sacrifice** to **Yahweh**. Use the same words for Elijah, altar, sacrifice, and Yahweh that you have used in previous passages. For more information on altar, sacrifice, and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

[Elijah used 12 stones to build the altar, and each stone represented one of the sons of Jacob, or **Israel**. Yahweh gave Jacob a **word**, or a message, and told him that his name would be Israel.]{.mark} Use the same words for Israel and “word of Yahweh” that you have used in previous passages. For more information on word and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah dug a long hole, or trench, around the altar to Yahweh. The trench was able to hold about two seahs of grain. Normally, the altar did not have a trench like the one that Elijah dug around the altar. A trench is a long, narrow hole or ditch that people dig in the ground to drain water from land or bring water to crops. A seah is an ancient measurement of volume that may have held about 15 liters. Elijah did not put grain in the trench. The measurement is to show how deep the trench was around the altar.

Stop here and look at the photo of the altar with the trench around it again. Discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **trench** and **seah**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

At the time of the sacrifice for the evening **offering**, Elijah approached the altar. An offering or sacrifice was a gift that people offered in a ritual to God, usually in the temple or on a special altar. People can make offerings for many reasons, including to give thanks, to be purified, or to ask forgiveness for sin. [The evening offering or sacrifice happened every day in the late afternoon, usually around 3 p.m. This was a regular time for the people to bring a sacrifice to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for offering as you have used in previous passages. For more information about offering, refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

Elijah begins his prayer by talking to Yahweh, the **God** of **Abraham**, **Isaac**, and **Israel**. [The God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel is Yahweh, the one true God that the ancestors of the Israelites worshipped. This name shows that Yahweh made promises to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob—who is also called Israel—and is faithful to their family. Use the same words for]{.mark} God, Abraham, Isaac, and Israel [as you have used in previous passages. For more information about God and Abraham, refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

Elijah the **prophet prayed** that the people would know that Yahweh is God and that Yahweh is turning the people’s **hearts** back to himself. Translate pray, heart, and prophet as you have previously. For more information on pray, heart, and prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

After fire from **heaven** falls on Elijah’s sacrifice to Yahweh, Elijah tells the people to seize the prophets of **Baal**. [Heaven can mean sky or the place where Yahweh lives. The fire came down from above, from the sky that people can see. Here, heaven does not mean the place where Yahweh lives.]{.mark} Translate heaven, when it means sky, and Baal as you have previously. For more information on heaven and Baal, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 18:30–40

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (648 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1014 KB)

1 Kings 18:41–46

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 18:41–46 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:41–46 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:41–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Just before this story, King Ahab and [the people of Israel gathered on Mount Carmel. Elijah challenged the prophets of Baal to prove whose god was real. Elijah prayed, and Yahweh sent fire from heaven to consume the

sacrifice, which showed that Yahweh is the true God. Then Elijah killed all the prophets of Baal in the valley at the base of the mountain.]{.mark}

This story is about the end of the drought after three years of no rain.

At the beginning of this story, Elijah tells Ahab to go eat and drink. It had been a long day on Mount Carmel, and now Elijah says there is the sound of heavy rain. It is not raining on the mountain yet. Perhaps Elijah can hear thunder in the distance, but no clouds are in the sky.

Mount Carmel is in the northwest part of Israel on the coast of the Mediterranean Sea. Here, there is a great view of the sea from the top of the mountain. This is the perfect place to watch for rain coming from the west.

Stop and look at the map of Mount Carmel on the edge of the sea. Pause the audio here.

Elijah goes back up the mountain to kneel down and pray to Yahweh. Then Elijah tells his servant to look toward the sea for clouds. The servant says that there is nothing there. Elijah continues to ask the servant to go look. On the seventh time, the servant sees a cloud rising from the sea that looks like the size of a human hand. The servant probably does not mean that the cloud looks like a person's hand. The servant is probably saying that he thinks the cloud is about the same size as a person's hand. This shows the cloud is very far away. When the servant says, "rising from the sea," he does not mean that the cloud is coming out of the water. The servant is talking about how he sees the cloud coming out of the horizon in the west over the sea.

Stop and do this activity: Go outside and look at the sky. Have different people on your team take turns describing the clouds that you see. Pause this audio here.

Elijah tells the servant to go tell Ahab to hitch up his chariot. A chariot is a light, open, two-wheeled vehicle that one or more horses pull. People rode chariots in battle. Kings or leaders also used chariots to travel long distances. Ahab is not going off to war. It will take some time to get the horses ready and Ahab's chariot packed to leave for Jezreel. Elijah is telling Ahab to get ready to leave by hitching horses up to Ahab's chariot so Ahab can get to Jezreel before the rain stops Ahab.

Stop and look at a picture of a horse-drawn chariot. Pause the audio here.

The rain will make the road muddy. Ahab would have difficulty if Ahab had to drive the chariot along muddy roads. Elijah was not expecting a little rain, but a lot of rain.

Stop here and get someone to tell a story [or talk about a time when you knew a big storm was coming. Listen to how the storyteller describes the sky and the change of weather.]{.mark} Pause this audio here.

Ahab rides his chariot to Jezreel. Jezreel was a city located near Mount Gilboa, about 27 kilometers from Mount Carmel. Ahab's closest palace to Mount Carmel was in Jezreel. Ahab's winter home was in Jezreel when the capital of Samaria was too cold.

The phrase "Yahweh's hand was on Elijah" means that Yahweh's power helps Elijah. Elijah runs faster than Ahab's horse-driven chariot on the long 27-kilometer road to Jezreel. This is beyond a human's normal strength and speed, but Yahweh gives Elijah the strength.

Elijah tucks his cloak into his belt. Men in this culture usually wore long cloaks or robes that hung loose when they were not working. When a man needed to work or move quickly, he would tuck the robe under his belt. If Elijah did not do this, Elijah would probably trip and fall when he ran. It was a common phrase for people who wore robes in those days to speak of "tucking their robe in the belt" to get ready for a vigorous activity.

Stop and look at a picture of a cloak. Look at a picture of a man with his cloak tucked. Pause this audio here.

Stop and do this activity. [Have a team member take a big cloth or long robe and let it hang loose like a cloak. Try to run with it and see how hard it is. Then tuck the cloth into a belt and try running again. Talk about how much easier it is to move when the cloth is tucked in. This shows why Elijah tucked his robe before running.]{.mark}

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:41–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 18:41–46

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Elijah tells King Ahab to go get something to eat and drink because rain is coming.

In the second scene: Elijah climbs back to the top of the mountain. While Elijah is kneeling down, he keeps telling his servant to look out over the sea for rain.

In the third scene: It begins to rain, and Ahab leaves in his chariot for Jezreel.

In the fourth scene: The power of God comes upon Elijah, and Elijah runs faster than Ahab's chariot to Jezreel.

The characters in this passage are:

- The prophet Elijah
- King Ahab
- And Elijah's servant

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

When the first scene begins, Elijah and Ahab are at the bottom of Mount Carmel in the Kishon Valley. On top of the mountain, Yahweh had just sent fire from heaven, which proved that he was the true God. Elijah had also taken the prophets of Baal down the mountain to the Kishon Valley and slaughtered them. It is not clear whether the events in this new story take place on the same day or if it is the next day. Now, at the bottom of Mount Carmel, Elijah tells King Ahab to go and get something to eat and drink. [The king has just had a long day on the mountain. Like before, King Ahab just watches Elijah and follows what Elijah says to do.]{.mark} Elijah tells Ahab that heavy rain is about to come. It has not rained for three years, but Yahweh said that the rain would come again.

In the second scene, Elijah climbs back to the top of Mount Carmel to wait for the rain. When Elijah gets to the top, Elijah does not look for rain. Elijah kneels down and leans forward so that his head is between his knees. It is not clear why Elijah is kneeling, but it is possible that he is praying as he normally does or focusing very hard on praying to Yahweh. It is a position of humility.

[Stop and ask someone on the team to kneel like Elijah, with their head between their knees. This helps everyone see how Elijah showed humility and focus. While watching, talk about how people in your culture show deep thinking or respect with their bodies. This will help you find the right words for Elijah's actions in your translation.] {.mark} Pause the audio here.

Then Elijah tells his servant to go up to the part of the mountain where the servant can look out over the sea. Mount Carmel is on the edge of the Mediterranean Sea, where the rain clouds often move off the sea from the west over the land of Israel, east of the sea. The servant goes up and looks for rain clouds. Normally, the rain in Israel comes from rain clouds that form over the sea.

Stop here and look at a map of Mount Carmel and the Mediterranean Sea. Take a look at a photo of the sea as viewed from Mount Carmel. Pause the audio here.

The servant comes back and reports that there is nothing there. Elijah tells the servant to go back and look again. This happens seven times. The servant does not see anything until the seventh time, when the servant comes back and reports that he saw a cloud. The way the servant tells Elijah about the cloud shows that he is surprised, and the servant emphasizes that he sees something new he has not seen before. The servant says, "Look! I see a cloud as small as a man's hand rising from the sea." It is unclear whether the servant looked toward the sea seven times or whether Elijah told the servant to return and look seven times. If the servant went back seven times, then the servant looked toward the sea a total of eight times.

Elijah tells the servant to go tell Ahab to hitch the horses to his chariot. Elijah tells the servant to urge Ahab to go down to Jezreel before the rain stops Ahab. We are not sure whether Ahab is on the mountain at this point. So it is not clear whether Ahab is on the mountain and should go down the mountain or whether Ahab is at the base of the mountain and should go down to Jezreel. However, it is clear that Ahab should go to Jezreel before

the rain and mud make Ahab's journey too difficult. The chariot wheels are heavy, and they will get stuck in mud if the ground is wet.

The third scene starts a few minutes after Elijah gave instructions to Ahab's servant. The storyteller starts by saying "in a little while," or "meanwhile." In a few minutes, the sky begins to get very dark with clouds. A heavy wind begins to blow. And when it begins to rain, Ahab leaves in his chariot for Jezreel.

Stop and tell a story about a huge storm that happened quickly. Pay attention to the words the storyteller uses to describe the sky and the change in weather. What does it look like in your area before a heavy storm comes, like the storm in this story? Use these words to describe the sky getting dark, the heavy wind beginning to blow, and the rain starting. Pause the audio here.

In the fourth scene, the hand or power of Yahweh comes on Elijah. In other words, Yahweh gives Elijah strength that is more than people normally have. Elijah tucks his cloak under his belt so that he can run.

[Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you translate that the power of Yahweh came on Elijah? Pause this audio here.]{.mark}

[Stop again and discuss as a group: Think about the activity where you ran with the cloth wrapped around you. How will you translate the idea that Elijah tucked up his robe to run easily? Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

Then Elijah runs so fast that he runs ahead of Ahab's horse-drawn chariot. Elijah runs from Mount Carmel and arrives in Jezreel ahead of Ahab.

Stop and look at a map from Mount Carmel and the Kidron Valley to Jezreel. Pause the audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:41–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The prophet Elijah
- King Ahab
- And Elijah's servant

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The prophet Elijah says to King Ahab, "Go get something to eat and drink. There is a sound of heavy rain coming." So Ahab goes to eat and drink while Elijah climbs back up to the top of Mount Carmel.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am exhausted. What happened on this mountain was nothing like what I expected; or
- I am starving. This drought is long, and I have no energy after climbing up and down the mountain. I am just ready to eat; or
- I just have to do whatever this prophet of the Lord says.

Continue the drama.

When Elijah gets back to the top of the mountain, Elijah kneels down and leans over so that his head is between his knees. Elijah tells his servant to go look out over the sea for rain.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am exhausted from going up and down the mountain and killing all of the prophets of Baal. But my work is not yet finished. Yahweh said he would bring rain; or
- I am trying to pray, but I am so tired. I need Yahweh to give me strength to pray for rain.

Continue the drama.

Elijah's servant walks over to look for rain. The servant comes back and reports, "There is nothing there." Elijah tells the servant to go look again. This happens seven times.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah's servant, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Surely there will be rain, but I do not see anything at all. How many times will the prophet keep telling me to go back out and look? or
- Elijah is truly a man of God. Elijah has ridiculed Baal, who was powerless to bring rain. Elijah killed off all the prophets of Baal, and now he is praying for rain. Oh, how I hope that Yahweh brings rain back to our land.

Continue the drama.

On the seventh time, Elijah's servant reports that he sees a tiny rain cloud that looks as if it were the size of a human hand rising out of the sea. So Elijah tells the servant to go tell Ahab to hitch up his chariot with Ahab's horses to leave before the rain can stop Ahab. In a little while, the sky starts to grow very dark, and a strong wind begins to blow.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Rain is finally coming! or
- I am so relieved. After three long years, the rain is back; or
- Praise Yahweh for his power. Praise Yahweh for bringing rain.

Continue the drama.

Heavy rain pours down from the sky as Ahab rides in his chariot back to Jezreel. Then the power of Yahweh comes on Elijah so that Elijah tucks his cloak into his belt so that he can run. Elijah runs ahead of Ahab's chariot all the way to Jezreel.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 18:41–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause the audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Elijah tells **Ahab** to get something to eat and drink because rain will come soon. Elijah is the prophet of Yahweh. Ahab is the king of Israel. Translate Elijah and Ahab as you have previously.

Elijah urges Ahab to leave quickly in his chariot so that the strong rain does not stop Ahab from getting home. The word for rain is a general term for rainfall, but this is a heavy rainstorm that comes after three years of no rain.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a heavy **rain**. Pause this audio here.

From the top of the mountain, Elijah's servant sees a small **cloud**. Your language may have many words for cloud, but the term used in this story is for a thick, dark rain cloud.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a dark and heavy rain cloud. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Elijah tells his **servant** to go to the top of Mount Carmel and look out over the **sea** for rain. This sea is the Mediterranean Sea, which is a very large body of saltwater, much larger than a lake but not as big as the ocean. This sea is to the west of Israel, or the direction that the sun sets. Mount Carmel overlooks the sea. Translate servant and sea as you have in previous passages. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Ahab rides back to Jezreel in his **chariot**. [A chariot is a small, light cart that horses pull and that carries people—especially kings and soldiers—when they are fighting in battles.]{.mark} Translate chariot as you have in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a chariot if needed. Pause the audio here.

The power of **Yahweh** came on Elijah, and Elijah tucked in his **robe**, or "tucked in the lower part of his body," and ran. This means that Elijah tucked his robe into the belt, or the long piece of cloth that a person would wrap around their robe. Although the original story does not use the word for robe, you may want to say that Elijah tucked in his robe when he ran. If you use the word for robe, see the Master Glossary for robe and use the same word for robe that you have used previously. Yahweh is the name God gives himself. Translate Yahweh the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and, if needed, look again at a photo of a robe and of a man who tucks his robe into his belt. Discuss how you will talk about Elijah tucking in his robe so that he could run quickly.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 18:41–46

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (661 KB)

- Setting the Stage (3.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1022 KB)

1 Kings 19:1–8

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 19:1–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:1–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

[In the previous stories, Elijah called the people together on Mount Carmel and challenged them to choose between Yahweh and Baal. Baal could not send fire, but when Elijah prayed, Yahweh sent fire from heaven, which showed Yahweh is the true God. Elijah then killed all the prophets of Baal. After this, Elijah prayed again, and Yahweh sent rain to end the three years of drought in Israel. Elijah told King Ahab to go ahead to Jezreel. Elijah then prayed and, with Yahweh's strength, ran ahead of Ahab's chariot to Jezreel.]{.mark}

[At the beginning of this story, King Ahab has just arrived in Jezreel and tells Jezebel everything that Elijah did. Ahab tells Jezebel that Elijah put all the prophets of Baal to death by the sword. In that culture, "by the sword" means that people killed them in a violent way, but it does not mean Elijah killed each one himself or that he used a real sword.]{.mark}

[Jezebel is very angry because she supported the prophets of Baal and tried to kill the prophets of Yahweh, but now Elijah has killed all the prophets of Baal. Jezebel sends a message to Elijah to say she will kill Elijah. Jezebel swears by or makes an oath to her gods, not by Yahweh, because she worships many gods. Jezebel says she will do to Elijah what he did to the prophets, but Jezebel only sends a messenger, not soldiers. People in that culture used this kind of sentence to make a strong promise. The words, "May the gods do to me, and more also," show an oath. It means the person is calling on their gods to punish them if they do not keep their promise.]{.mark}

[Stop and discuss as a group what a strong promise means in your culture. Discuss how someone might swear an oath to do something important or threatening. How do people show they are very serious when they make a promise? Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

[Elijah becomes afraid and runs away from Jezreel. Elijah leaves Israel and travels through Judah all the way to Beersheba.]{.mark}

Stop and look at a map of Elijah's journey from Jezreel to Beersheba and the wilderness. Pause the audio here.

We do not know why Elijah's servant only goes with Elijah as far as Beersheba, but Elijah leaves the servant there. Beersheba is a city in the southern kingdom of Judah, which had a different king than Ahab.

1 Kings 19:1–8

Elijah then walks alone into the wilderness, which is a dry, desert area with few trees or people. Elijah probably walks about 25 kilometers, or a day's journey, and sits down to rest under a broom tree. A broom tree is a large bush or small tree that grows in the desert. Some broom trees can grow up to 3.5 meters tall.

Stop and look at a photo of a broom tree. Pause this audio here.

People often used the wilderness near Beersheba to graze animals in winter. Long before Elijah, both Abraham and Isaac built altars to Yahweh in this area. Hagar wandered with Ishmael in the wilderness of Beersheba when Abraham sent them away. Like Abraham, Isaac, and Hagar, Elijah talks to Yahweh in the wilderness of Beersheba.

Under the broom tree, Elijah prays to Yahweh and says he has had enough and wants to die because his problems feel too great. Elijah says, "I am no better than my fathers or ancestors," which means Elijah feels he is not better off than those who have already died or that Elijah has not done better than the prophets before him. Elijah then lies down and falls asleep.

After some time, an angel touches Elijah and tells him to get up and eat and drink. The story does not say if Elijah sees the angel, but it does not seem like Elijah is afraid or surprised. An angel is a spiritual being that Yahweh created who brings messages or help from Yahweh. Sometimes angels look like people, and sometimes they look bright or frightening, but the storyteller does not describe the angel.

Elijah is very tired and wants to die, but Yahweh gives Elijah a jar of water and bread to help Elijah recover. Elijah finds a jar of water and bread beside his head. The bread is a flat, round loaf that someone baked on hot stones. This bread is not a sweet cake.

[Stop and look at a picture of a round, flat bread that someone baked on hot stones. Think about the basic food people eat in your area, even if it is not bread. Consider how people in your community would describe a basic food that gives strength and energy.]{.mark} Pause the audio here.

A jug of water was a small clay bottle about 7.5 to 15 centimeters tall. This means it was about as tall as a finger or hand. People normally used jars like this to hold water or other liquids.

Stop here and look at a jug that people used to hold water. Pause the audio here.

The angel tells Elijah to eat because Elijah's journey will be long and hard. The trip from Beersheba to Horeb is about 400 kilometers, and Elijah travels for 40 days and nights with the strength from the food God gives him.

Elijah walks all the way to Mount Horeb. People also call Mount Horeb "Mount Sinai," or "the mountain of God." You will remember this is the place where God appeared to Moses in the burning bush and gave the covenant to Israel after they left Egypt.

Stop here and look at a photo of Mount Horeb. Also, look at the map again, and this time note Elijah's journey from Beersheba to Mount Horeb.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: King Ahab tells Queen Jezebel everything that happened on Mount Carmel. So Jezebel sends a message to Elijah to warn Elijah that she is about to kill him.

In the second scene: Elijah runs to Beersheba and then to a place in the wilderness. Elijah prays to God to take Elijah's life. Then Elijah falls asleep under a broom tree.

In the third scene: An angel awakens Elijah and tells him to get up to eat and drink. Someone has provided bread and water for Elijah, so Elijah eats and drinks and then goes back to sleep.

1 Kings 19:1–8

In the fourth scene: The angel wakes up Elijah again and tells him to eat for the long journey. Elijah eats and drinks and then walks for 40 days and 40 nights until he gets to Mount Horeb.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Ahab
- Queen Jezebel
- The prophet Elijah
- Elijah's servant
- And an angel of Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Just before the first scene, King Ahab has ridden his chariot through the rainstorm to his palace in Jezreel, a city in northern Israel. Now, in the first scene, as soon as Ahab arrives, he tells his wife Jezebel everything that happened with Elijah and the prophets of Baal. Yahweh had proven that the only true God was Yahweh and that Baal was a false god. Elijah and the people of Israel killed all the false prophets.

Elijah, who had run ahead of Ahab's chariot from Mount Carmel to Jezreel, is still in the city. Jezebel quickly sends a messenger to Elijah with a threat. Jezebel swears an oath that she will have her soldiers kill Elijah by the same time the next day, or within 24 hours. The way that people swore an oath was to say that their god should kill them if they did not do what they promised to do.

Stop and think about your discussion about making oaths. How will you translate the idea that Jezebel swore an oath? How will you translate this so people will understand that Jezebel is very serious about the promise she makes? Pau[se this audio here.]{.mark}

In the second scene, Elijah becomes afraid and immediately runs away to save his life. Elijah travels on foot from Jezreel, which is in the north of Israel, all the way south. Elijah crosses the entire land of Israel and then through Judah to Beersheba, a city on the southern border of Judah, about 160 kilometers from Jezreel. Elijah's servant is with Elijah during this long journey. When they reach Beersheba, Elijah leaves his servant there. Then Elijah walks alone for a whole day into the wilderness, a dry and empty area with very few trees or people.

Stop and look at a map of Elijah's journey from Jezreel to Beersheba and the wilderness. Notice where Elijah's servant was with him in the journey and where Elijah left the servant. Pause the audio here.

Elijah finally comes to rest at a broom tree there in the wilderness. Broom trees can be 3.5 meters tall, so this big shrub was probably taller than Elijah. Elijah sits down under the broom tree, which means Elijah sits down in the shade of the broom tree.

[Stop and look at a picture of a broom tree again, if needed. Talk with the team about how to say the name of this tree in your language. If your area does not have this kind of tree, you can describe the tree. Some ways to describe the tree are "tall desert shrub" or "bush that gives shade." Do not use a local tree name if it gives the wrong idea. Think about how the tree gave Elijah a place to rest and shade. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

Elijah tells Yahweh that Elijah cannot experience anything else so difficult and asks Yahweh to take his life. Elijah feels that he does not have a better life than his ancestors, who are dead. So Elijah wants to die, too.

[Stop and share a story about someone in your community who felt very tired and wanted to give up. How did you describe this person's feelings? Discuss how you talk about someone ready to give up. Use these ideas to explain Elijah's feelings under the broom tree, when Elijah felt overwhelmed and asked God to take his life. Pause this audio here.]{.mark}

In the third scene, after Elijah has been sleeping for a short time, all of a sudden, an angel of Yahweh touches Elijah and tells him to get up and eat. In the original language, the storyteller uses a word to emphasize that something new and sudden has happened.

[Stop and have a team member tell a story about a time when something surprising happened, like something suddenly waking you from sleep. Listen for the words the person uses to show surprise or get attention. Discuss which words in your language signal that something unexpected is happening in a story. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

Elijah looks around and is surprised to see flat bread and a jar of water by his head. Although you may have a different type of basic food in your culture, it is likely that this is really a flat bread that Elijah eats. After Elijah eats and drinks, and then Elijah lies down again and goes back to sleep.

Stop here and look again at the photo of the flat bread that someone has baked on hot stones. What will you call this in your translation? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the angel touches Elijah a second time and tells him to eat and drink more because Elijah has a long journey ahead. The angel wants Elijah to understand that Elijah will need to eat this food in order to have the strength he needs for the long journey. Elijah obeys, and the food and water give Elijah enough strength to walk for 40 days and 40 nights from the wilderness of Beersheba to Mount Horeb, about 400 kilometers away. The storyteller repeats that Elijah walks for both 40 days and 40 nights to show that this was a very long journey! Mount Horeb is also called Mount Sinai or the mountain of God. Many years before, when Yahweh had first rescued the Israelites from Egypt, God appeared to Moses at Mount Horeb and gave the Israelites his laws, which are the covenant agreement with his people.

Stop and look at a map of Israel with Beersheba and see where Elijah walked from Beersheba to Mount Horeb, or Mount Sinai. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Ahab
- Queen Jezebel
- The prophet Elijah
- Elijah's servant
- And an angel of Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Now, King Ahab tells his wife, Jezebel, everything that the prophet Elijah had done on Mount Carmel and how he had put all the prophets of Baal to death. So Jezebel sends a messenger to Elijah, who tells him, ["If I do not kill you in 24 hours like you killed the prophets of Baal, may the gods punish me severely."]{.mark}

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jezebel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am furious at this troublemaker, Elijah, who has killed all my prophets; or
- I am completely in shock. How could one prophet of Yahweh defeat 450 prophets of Baal? or

- I must put an end to Elijah, but after what happened, I am afraid of Yahweh and the people. I will send a messenger to frighten Elijah away.

Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Everyone has turned to Yahweh except this wicked woman, Jezebel. Now this wicked woman will kill me; or
- I am exhausted from everything that has been happening. Now, where is Yahweh to protect me?

Continue the drama.

Elijah is terrified and runs for his life all the way to Beersheba in the land of Judah. Elijah leaves his servant in the city of Beersheba and walks by himself all day into the wilderness. Elijah comes to a broom tree, sits down under it, and prays that he might die: "I have had enough of all of this, Yahweh. Take my life now. I am no better than my ancestors." Then Elijah lies down under the broom tree and falls asleep.

Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am done. I feel hopeless. I just want to die; or
- I have no emotional or physical strength to do anything else at all; or
- The life of a prophet is useless.

Continue the drama.

Suddenly, an angel of Yahweh awakens Elijah. The angel touches Elijah and says, "Get up and eat." Elijah looks around and sees that, by his head, there are some round cakes of bread that someone baked over hot coals. There is also a small jug of water. Elijah eats and drinks, and then lies down again.

Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- How did this hot bread and this jug of water get here in this desert place? or
- Was that really an angel of Yahweh who touched me, spoke to me, and gave me this food? or
- I do not know what happened, but I am starving and dying of thirst. Thanks be to Yahweh.

Continue the drama.

A second time, the angel of Yahweh touches Elijah to wake Elijah up. The angel says to Elijah, "Get up and eat, for the journey will be too much for you if you do not eat."

So Elijah gets up, eats the bread, and drinks the water. Elijah is strengthened by this food so that Elijah is able to walk 40 days and 40 nights.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The food the angel made for me was amazing; or
- I do not know what Yahweh has planned for me next. I will go to Mount Horeb if that is what Yahweh tells me to do; or
- Yahweh has again provided food for me in a very difficult time.

Continue the drama.

After 40 days and 40 nights, Elijah arrives at Mount Horeb, the mountain of God.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 19:1–8

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King Ahab told his wife Jezebel all that Elijah had done and how **Elijah** had killed the **prophets.** The storyteller does not say that these are the prophets of Baal, but we know that they are the prophets of Baal from the previous stories. Translate Elijah and prophets in the same way you have in previous passages. For more information on prophets, refer to the Master Glossary.

Jezebel swears an **oath** by the **gods**. [An oath is a serious promise that people make in front of others. When people make an oath, they often call on God or gods to witness that oath and punish them if they break the promise.]{.mark} Jezebel worshipped false gods, like Baal and Asherah, gods of the Canaanite peoples. These are the false gods that Jezebel is calling on in her oath. Use the same word for gods as you have used previously, and refer to gods in the Master Glossary for more information. If you use the word “oath” in your translation, use the same word for oath that you used previously. If you need more information about oath, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah left his **servant** in Beersheba in the southern part of **Judah**. Translate servant and Judah as you have previously. For more information on servant and Judah, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah rests under a broom tree in the wilderness of Beersheba. A broom tree is the name for a kind of desert shrub that can grow as tall as 3.5 meters. People think of the broom tree as a small tree or a large bush.

Stop and look again at the photo of the broom tree. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **broom tree**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

[**Wilderness** is a wild, natural area with few people, often with rough land, trees, or desert, where people might go to be alone or find safety. Translate wilderness as you have previously. For more information on wilderness, refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

[When Elijah is under the broom tree, he tells **Yahweh** that Elijah has had enough and wants to die. Yahweh is the name God gives himself. Elijah asks Yahweh to let him die. Elijah is talking to Yahweh and asking Yahweh for something, so some translations say that Elijah is **praying** here. If you use your word or phrase for praying in this story, translate “pray to ask Yahweh for something” in the same way you have previously, and refer to pray in the Master Glossary for more information. Translate Yahweh as you have previously. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

[Elijah says he is no better than his **fathers** or **ancestors**. Elijah is talking about the people in Elijah’s family who lived before him, like parents, grandparents, or even famous people from long ago, like Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Elijah just means he is no better than those who died before him. Use the same word for fathers or ancestors as you have used previously.]{.mark}

[An **angel** of Yahweh comes to strengthen Elijah two times. An angel is a special spirit being that Yahweh created. Angels bring messages from Yahweh to people. Sometimes angels look like regular people, but other times they look bright or even scary. Be careful not to confuse the word for “angel” with “prophet.” A prophet is a human who gives Yahweh’s messages, but an angel is a spirit being from heave]{.mark}n. Translate angel as you have in previous passages. For more information on angel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh provides bread and water for Elijah.

Stop here and look at the photo of the flat bread that someone baked on hot stones again as a group. Look also at the jar for water. Review what words or phrases you decided to use for the flat bread and the jar of water.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 19:1–8

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (629 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1002 KB)

1 Kings 19:9–21

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 19:9–21 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:9–21 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:9–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This story is about how Yahweh talks to the prophet Elijah on the mountain of God and tells him what to do next.

Earlier, Elijah ran away from Queen Jezebel because she wanted to kill Elijah for killing the prophets of the Canaanite god Baal. Elijah traveled across Israel and Judah into the wilderness, where he asked Yahweh to let him die. Instead, Yahweh let Elijah rest and sent an angel with bread and water, which gave Elijah strength for a 40-day journey to Mount Horeb. Mount Horeb is also called Mount Sinai, where Yahweh spoke to Moses many years before to give the covenant to the people of Israel.

1 Kings 19:9–21

Now, in this story, when Elijah gets to Mount Horeb, Elijah finds a cave to sleep in after his long trip. A cave is a natural hole in the mountain. People can use caves for protection from the weather or animals.

Stop and look at a photo of a cave. Pause the audio here.

Yahweh speaks his word to Elijah. Yahweh asks Elijah, “What are you doing here, Elijah?” Even though Yahweh already knows, Yahweh is starting a conversation so Elijah can share his thoughts and feelings.

Elijah answers that he has been very zealous for Yahweh, the God of heavenly armies. This name for God [means that Yahweh is the leader of a great army. “Yahweh” is God’s personal name, and “hosts” refers to the heavenly armies or angels. This title shows Yahweh’s power and authority over all spiritual and earthly forces.]{.mark}

Elijah has been very zealous by working hard and being very loyal to Yahweh. Elijah says he has done everything for Yahweh, but the people of Israel have broken their covenant with Yahweh, destroyed Yahweh’s altars, and killed Yahweh’s prophets. Elijah says that he himself is the only prophet left, and now people want to kill Elijah too. Elijah is telling Yahweh all of Elijah’s problems, and Elijah feels like all of Elijah’s hard work was for nothing.

Yahweh tells Elijah to go stand on the mountain because Yahweh is about to pass by. [This reminds us of when Yahweh showed Yahweh’s glory to Moses on Mount Sinai, but passed by in a different way.]{.mark} This time, a strong wind comes, and rocks fall from the mountain, but Elijah knows Yahweh is not in the wind. Then there is an earthquake, which is when the ground shakes, but Elijah knows Yahweh is not in the earthquake either.

[Stop and have each team member share if they or people in their community have ever experienced an earthquake or heard stories about one. Tell a story of a time when you experienced very strong wind or an earthquake. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

After the earthquake, a fire starts to burn. There are no details about the fire. Elijah knows that Yahweh is not in the fire. Then Elijah hears a gentle, quiet sound. Yahweh was not in the strong wind, the earthquake, or the fire. Instead, Elijah recognizes Yahweh’s presence in the gentle, quiet sound. This may have been simply silence.

[Elijah covers his face with his robe because no one could look directly at Yahweh and live. Long ago, when Moses asked to see Yahweh’s glory, Yahweh told Moses to hide in a crack of a rock. Yahweh covered Moses’ face as Yahweh passed by. Even when Yahweh spoke from Mount Sinai, the people were afraid to look. Now Elijah, like Moses, covers his face in the presence of Yahweh. A voice asks Elijah again, “What are you doing here, Elijah?” and Elijah gives the same answer as before.]{.mark}

Then Yahweh tells Elijah to leave the mountain, go back the way he came, and head toward the wilderness near Damascus, which is in the land of Aram, or Syria.

Stop here and look at a map that shows where Elijah is at Mount Horeb and where Yahweh tells Elijah to go, near Damascus. The wilderness is the area outside of Damascus where few people live. Pause the audio here.

[Now, Yahweh wants Elijah to anoint a new king for a foreign country, a new king for Israel, and a new prophet.]{.mark} To anoint someone means to pour oil or rub ointment on that person’s head to show that Yahweh has chosen them to do a special task.

Stop here and tell a story about a time when your community selected a new leader. How did you choose a new leader? How did people know that this was the new leader? Were there any kind of ceremonies? Pause the audio here.

Yahweh tells Elijah to anoint Hazael as the new king of Aram, which is also called Syria. Aram is a country next to Israel, and it is often Israel’s enemy. Hazael is an officer who serves under the king of Aram, or Syria.

Yahweh tells Elijah to anoint Jehu, son of Nimshi, as the new king of Israel. Jehu was actually the grandson of Nimshi. In Hebrew culture, a son can refer to any male descendant. This King Jehu is not the same person as the prophet Jehu the storyteller mentioned in earlier stories.

Yahweh also tells Elijah to anoint Elisha, son of Shaphat, to take Elijah’s place as prophet. Shaphat is Elisha’s father. Abel Meholah is Elisha’s hometown, but we do not know its exact location. Most scholars believe Abel Meholah was back in Israel, west of the Jordan River in the central Jordan Valley, about 60 kilometers south of Samaria.

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Yahweh tells Elijah that Hazael, Jehu, and Elisha will do important tasks for Yahweh. These tasks include punishing people who are leading Israel to worship the false idol of Baal. When Yahweh says some will escape the sword of Hazael, Jehu, or Elisha, it means some people will escape being killed by these leaders. Yahweh will use Hazael, Jehu, and Elisha to punish those who worship false gods. But Yahweh will protect 7,000 people who have not worshipped Baal. In that culture, people worshipped an idol by kneeling down and kissing the idol. Seven thousand people have not done this but have stayed faithful to Yahweh. This shows Elijah that he is not alone and that Yahweh always keeps a group of faithful people.

After this, Elijah finds Elisha in his hometown of Abel Meholah, where Elisha is plowing a field with 12 pairs of oxen. A plow is a tool for digging soil to prepare it for farmers to plant seeds, and oxen are large cattle that people use for farming. Hired workers are using the other 11 pairs of oxen while Elisha is plowing with the 12th pair. Having 12 pairs of oxen means Elisha's family was likely wealthy.

Stop here and look at a picture of two oxen yoked to a plow. Pause the audio here.

Elijah puts his robe on Elisha to show that Yahweh is choosing Elisha as the next prophet after Elijah. Elijah's robe was a special outer garment that showed that Elijah was a prophet.

Elisha asks to kiss his father and mother goodbye before he leaves. In that culture, kissing your parents goodbye was a normal, loving, and properly respectful way to say farewell.

Stop and discuss these questions about how your culture says goodbye to different people. How do children say goodbye to parents? How do people say goodbye when they leave for a long time? What special actions or words show respect when saying farewell? What is different about saying goodbye to others? Pause the audio here.

Elisha kills a pair of oxen and uses the yoke to build a fire to cook the meat of the oxen. By burning the yoke and cooking the oxen, Elisha shows that he is leaving his old life as a farmer completely behind. Elisha will not need these farming tools anymore because Elisha is becoming Elijah's helper.

Stop and discuss what tools are most valuable to farmers in your area.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:9–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh talks with Elijah inside the cave at Mount Horeb.

In the second scene: Yahweh talks with Elijah outside the cave at Mount Horeb.

In the third scene: Elijah goes to the town where Elisha is plowing in the fields. Elijah calls Elisha to be a prophet.

In the fourth scene: Elisha slaughters the oxen he has been using to plow the fields and serves their meat to the people there to eat. Then Elisha leaves to follow Elijah as his servant.

The characters in this passage are:

- The prophet Elijah
- Yahweh
- Elisha
- And the people of Elisha's village, including Elisha's father and mother

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Just before this story begins, an angel of Yahweh provided Elijah with bread and water. That meal gave Elijah strength to walk from the wilderness of Beersheba to Mount Horeb. The distance between these places is about 400 kilometers. Elijah walked for 40 days and 40 nights for this trip.

Stop and look at a map of Israel. Find Beersheba. Then find Mount Horeb. [Pause this audio here.]{.mark}

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In the first scene, when Elijah arrives at Mount Horeb, he spends the night in a cave for shelter. If people in your language do not know about caves, you can say “a hole in the rocks” or something similar. Mount Horeb is also called Mount Sinai. The Israelites knew Mount Horeb as the mountain of God because it was at Mount Horeb that God appeared to Moses in the burning bush and gave the law to Israel after they left Egypt.

Suddenly, the word of Yahweh, or a message from Yahweh, comes to Elijah, and Yahweh asks him, “What are you doing here, Elijah?” The storyteller uses a word to show that something new and unexpected is happening.

[Stop and ask two people to tell about a time when something surprised them. Listen to the special words they use to show surprise. Talk about which words in your language best show big surprises. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

Yahweh’s question is not to get new information. Yahweh already knows what Elijah is doing. Yahweh asks so that Elijah can think about his answer and talk about what is happening.

Elijah answers that he has been zealous for Yahweh, the God of heavenly armies. [Yahweh is the name for the one true God. God of heavenly armies, or hosts, is a title that people use for God to show that God is the leader of many angels and armies in heaven. God has great power. God rules over all. People are zealous when they have strong feelings about protecting what belongs to Yahweh. A zealous person works hard to help others worship only Yahweh and feels upset when people follow false gods.]{.mark} A zealous person is absolutely loyal.

Stop here and, as a group, tell a story about people who have strong feelings about protecting other people. How do you describe these people? How will you talk about people who are zealous for Yahweh, the God of hosts? Pause this audio here.

But the people of Israel have broken their covenant, or special agreement, with God. The people have destroyed Yahweh’s altars and killed all Yahweh’s prophets with a sword, or in a violent way. Elijah says he is the only prophet of Yahweh left.

Yahweh tells Elijah to go out and stand on the mountain in the presence of Yahweh, because Yahweh is about to pass by.

In scene two, outside the cave, the storyteller uses a word to speak of something sudden and important as Yahweh is passing by. Outside the cave, a strong wind blows and breaks rocks off the mountain before Yahweh, but Yahweh is not in the wind. [“Before Yahweh” means Yahweh is there. Yahweh’s power causes these things to happen. The rocks break because Yahweh is present. Everything happens in front of Yahweh.]{.mark} Then the ground shakes in an earthquake, but Yahweh is not in the earthquake. After that, a fire comes, but Yahweh is not in the fire either. [Yahweh’s power causes the wind, the earthquake, and the fire. But Yahweh does not show himself in the wind, the earthquake, or the fire. Yahweh is near, but Yahweh does not speak through these things. Yahweh is present, but Yahweh chooses to speak in a quiet, gentle voice after these things happen.]{.mark}

Elijah hears a gentle, quiet sound like a whisper, a gentle breeze, a very quiet voice, or perhaps just the sound of quiet silence. When Elijah hears it, he covers his face with his robe and stands at the cave entrance.

[Stop and make these sounds: a leaf moving in the wind, a mother whispering to her sleeping baby, someone breathing very softly. Listen to each sound. Talk about words in your language for the quietest sounds you know. Choose which words best show Yahweh’s quiet voice. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

The voice asks Elijah again, “What are you doing here, Elijah?” This voice must be Yahweh since it is the same question that Yahweh asked before.

[Stop and talk about different words for “voice” in your language. Think about words you use for a human voice, an animal sound, thunder, wind, and spirits. Now think carefully: which word shows this is not a human body speaking, but Yahweh, who is spirit? Choose a word that helps people understand this is Yahweh’s special voice speaking to Elijah. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

Elijah gives the same answer. This time, Yahweh gives Elijah instructions. Yahweh tells Elijah to go back the way he came and stop in the wilderness near Damascus, which is the capital city of Aram. Aram is also called Syria. The wilderness of Damascus is the desert area south and east of the city.

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Stop and look at a map that shows Israel, Judah, Aram, and Mount Horeb. Notice the route that Elijah would take from Mount Horeb to the wilderness outside Damascus in Aram. Pause the audio here.

When Elijah goes to the wilderness near Damascus, Elijah is to pour oil on Hazael's head to make Hazael the new king of Aram. Yahweh does not say where Elijah should anoint Jehu and Elisha, but those anointings happen somewhere else.

To anoint someone, a prophet would take special oil and pour it on the person's head. This oil would run down their head and show everyone that Yahweh chose this person for a special job. If your language has no special word for anointing, you can say "pour oil on the head" to show this special act.

Stop and do this activity: Show how someone would pour water, representing the oil, over a head. What words describe liquid flowing down on purpose? Pause the audio here.

Yahweh says he will use three people to punish those who worship Baal: Hazael, the new king of Syria, Jehu, the new king of Israel, and Elisha, the new prophet of Yahweh. Hazael will kill the idol worshipers. Jehu will kill the ones who escape the sword of Hazael. Elisha will kill the ones who escape the sword of Jehu. [The sword was a common weapon to destroy an enemy. To "escape the sword" means that you would escape so that your enemies would not kill you in battle. Yahweh is telling Elijah that Jehu, Hazael, and Elisha will kill the idol worshippers.]{.mark}

But Yahweh will protect 7,000 Israelites who have not bowed down to and kissed Baal. Bowing down to the idols of Baal and kissing the idols of Baal is to worship Baal and show allegiance and respect with your body.

[Stop and discuss as a team what actions people use to show deep respect to leaders in your area, such as bowing, kneeling, or other movements. Choose words that show how people gave their loyalty to Baal by bowing and kissing, while 7,000 people stayed faithful to Yahweh and refused to worship Baal with their bodies. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

In scene three, Elijah leaves [Mount Horeb and travels back through Israel to find Elisha. Elisha is in his hometown, Abel Meholah, which is located in the Jordan Valley, north of Jericho.]{.mark}

[Stop and look at a map of Israel during the divided kingdom that shows Mount Horeb and Abel Meholah. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

[Elisha is plowing a field with 12 pairs of oxen, which shows that Elisha's family is wealthy. Elijah walks up to Elisha in the field and throws his robe over him. Elijah's robe represents Elijah's role and authority as a prophet of Yahweh. This act means Elijah is choosing Elisha as the next prophet.]{.mark}

[Stop and talk about how leaders in your community choose someone for important work. What do the leaders do? What do the leaders give? Now, talk about how people will understand how Elijah puts his robe on Elisha. Choose words that show Elijah is picking Elisha as Yahweh's next prophet. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

[Elisha is busy guiding one pair of oxen, so when Elijah leaves, Elisha has to stop his work and run after Elijah to show he accepts the call.]{.mark}

In scene four, [Elisha wants to say a proper farewell to his parents. In this culture, people kissed family members to say goodbye. In your language, what words show a loving, respectful farewell between children and parents? If people in your area do not kiss when they say goodbye, what words or actions show the same meaning? Choose words that clearly show this was a farewell gesture.]{.mark}

[Stop here and discuss how to translate this farewell scene so that everyone understands it shows respect between child and parents.]{.mark} If your culture does not kiss at goodbyes, discuss how you will make sure you clearly communicate that this is a farewell gesture. Pause the audio here.

[Elijah says, "What have I done to you?" This question can mean two things. It can mean, "Go back home if you want. I am not stopping you." It can also mean, "Go, but remember what I have done is important. Come back to me." Elijah wants Elisha to think about the choice to follow Elijah.]{.mark}

[Stop and discuss how people in your culture speak when you ask someone to make an important choice. Share examples from your own language. Decide if Elijah's words should sound like he is letting Elisha go back or asking

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Elisha to go, but to come back. Work as a group to choose the best words for your language. Pause the audio here.]{.mark}

[Elisha does several things to show he is leaving his old life behind. Elisha kills one pair of oxen and uses the wooden parts of the yoke and plowing equipment as firewood to cook the meat. Elisha gives the meat to the people in his village for a farewell meal. After this, Elisha leaves his home and family to follow Elijah and becomes his servant. Elisha is also becoming Elijah's student as he prepares to take Elijah's place as a prophet of Yahweh.]{.mark}

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:9–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The prophet Elijah
- Yahweh
- Elisha
- And the people of Elisha's village, including his father and mother

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

When the prophet Elijah arrives at Mount Horeb, he goes into the cave and shelters there for the night. Suddenly, the word of Yahweh comes to Elijah: "What are you doing here, Elijah?"

Elijah replies to Yahweh, "I have been very zealous in my devotion to Yahweh, the God of Heavenly Armies. The people of Israel have rejected your covenant with them. The people have torn down the altars of sacrifice to you. And the people have put the prophets of Yahweh to death with the sword. I am the only one left who worships you, and now the people of Israel are trying to kill me, too."

Then Yahweh says to Elijah, "Go out of the cave and stand on the mountain in the presence of Yahweh."

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- What does this mean to stand in the presence of Yahweh? or
- I am too afraid of a holy God. There is no way I can stand in the presence of Yahweh; or
- I will do whatever Yahweh says, but I am afraid that I have walked all the way out here to die.

Continue the drama.

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Suddenly, a great wind blows. The wind is so powerful that it tears the rocks out of the mountain and shatters the rocks. But Yahweh is not in the wind. After the wind, there is an earthquake that shakes the ground, but Yahweh is not in the earthquake. After the earthquake, there is a fire, but Yahweh is not in the fire.

After the fire, there is a small, gentle whisper. When Elijah hears the whisper, Elijah pulls his robe over his face and goes out to stand at the entrance of the cave.

Then a voice says to Elijah, “What are you doing here, Elijah?”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am confused by all of these happenings; or
- I am now certain that this is Yahweh speaking; or
- Why is Yahweh asking me the same thing again? What does this mean?

Continue the drama.

Elijah replies to Yahweh, “I have been very zealous in my devotion to Yahweh, the God of Heavenly Armies. The people of Israel have rejected your covenant with them. The people have torn down the altars of sacrifice to you. And the people have put the prophets of Yahweh to death with the sword. I am the only one left who worships you, and now the people of Israel are trying to kill me, too.”

Then Yahweh responds to Elijah, “Go back the way you came and then go out to the wilderness of Damascus. When you get to the wilderness, anoint Hazael as the new king of Aram. Also, you are to go anoint Jehu, son of Nimshi, as the new king of Israel. And you are to anoint Elisha, son of Shaphat from Abel Meholah, to become the prophet of Yahweh in your place. Jehu will kill any who escapes the sword of Hazael. Elisha will kill any who escapes the sword of Jehu. However, I will protect 7,000 people in Israel. These 7,000 are the ones who have not bowed their knees down to worship Baal nor have their mouths kissed his idols.”

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elijah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- There are 7,000 people who are following Yahweh and have never turned to Baal. I can hardly imagine this, but I am so happy that it is true; or
- Yes! Finally, someone will take my place as prophet. Being a prophet is such a burden.

Continue the drama.

So Elijah leaves Mount Horeb to go find Elisha in his hometown. Elisha is plowing with 12 yokes of oxen. As Elisha is guiding the 12th pair of oxen, Elijah takes his robe and puts it on Elisha’s shoulders.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elisha, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Yes, this prophet Elijah is very strange to throw his robe on me while I am plowing. Does Elijah mean I am to be a prophet? or
- I am excited to be a prophet. I knew Yahweh was preparing me to do something great for Yahweh; or
- Elijah is leaving, but I am in the middle of plowing with all these oxen. What should I do? I had better act fast.

Continue the drama.

Elisha stops the oxen, runs up to Elijah, and says, “Let me go kiss my father and mother goodbye. Then I will come back to you.”

Elijah says, “Go on back. What have I done to you?”

So Elisha leaves Elijah and goes back. Elisha takes one pair of oxen and slaughters the oxen. Elisha uses the plow for firewood to cook the meat. Elisha gives the meat to the people of the village, and the people all eat.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Elisha’s village, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am enjoying this feast, but I am sad that Elisha is leaving; or

- Young Elisha is now growing up to be the next prophet Elijah. What strange times!

Continue the drama.

Then Elisha leaves to follow Elijah and become his servant.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 19:9–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

When Elijah spends the night in the cave at Mount Horeb, the **word of Yahweh**, or a message from **Yahweh**, comes to Elijah. Yahweh is the name God gives himself. Translate Yahweh in the same way you have in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and "word of Yahweh," refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah tells Yahweh that Elijah has been very **zealous** for **Yahweh, the God of Heavenly Armies**. When someone is zealous, they are so passionately devoted to someone or something that they are jealous for that relationship to stay pure. Elijah is zealous for Yahweh, the God of hosts, Heavenly Armies. [This name for Yahweh means that Yahweh is God and leads powerful angels and spiritual beings in heaven, like a great king or commander of a huge army. This name shows that Yahweh is very powerful and rules over everything in heaven and on earth. Translate]{.mark} Yahweh, the God of Hosts, or heavenly armies, as you have previously. For more information on Yahweh, God of Hosts, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss how you will say that Elijah was zealous. For more information on zealous, refer to zeal in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Elijah says that the people of **Israel**, or the **Israelites,** have broken the **covenant** with Yahweh. A covenant is a solemn promise that people cannot break. Centuries before this story, Yahweh made a covenant with Israel on Mount Horeb and gave them the laws. Yahweh said that he would be with his people, and the people said that they would obey Yahweh's laws. Elijah says that the people broke the covenant because they did not keep the laws, but worshipped Baal and other gods instead. Translate the covenant, Israelites, and Israel, the same way you have previously. For more information on Israel, Israelites, and covenant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah says the people of Israel tore down **altars** of worship to Yahweh. [An altar is a special table or platform that people make of earth or stones where people place and often burn gifts or sacrifices, like animals or food, to God. Translate altar as you have in previous passages. For more information on altar, refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

[Elijah tells Yahweh that the Israelites put the **prophets** of Yahweh to death and that Elijah is the only one left. Translate prophet as you have in previous passages. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

When Elijah hears the gentle whisper, Elijah puts his **robe** over his face. Translate robe in the same way you have in previous passages, and refer to robe in the Master Glossary for more information.

[Yahweh tells Elijah to **anoint** new leaders. To anoint means to pour oil on someone's head. To pour oil on someone showed that God chose that person for a special job. The oil was a sign that Yahweh gave that person authority and power to lead. Use the same word or phrase for anoint as you used in previous passages. For more information on anoint, refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

Yahweh says to anoint Jehu, the **son** of Nimshi, as the new king of Israel. A son is the male child of his parents, but in this case, Jehu was actually the grandson of Nimshi, so you may use the word for **descendant** if you would like. [For more information about son or descendant, refer to the Master Glossary.]{.mark}

Elisha leaves to follow Elijah and become his servant, or assistant. Elisha is Elijah's helper, but also a disciple who is learning to take on Elijah's role as prophet. It is both clearer and closer to the original language to say that Elisha set out to follow and serve, or assist, Elijah, rather than to say that Elisha is Elijah's servant.

Yahweh says he is protecting 7,000 people in Israel who have not **bowed** down to **Baal**. Baal is a false god of the Canaanite people. Translate Baal and bowed down as you have previously. For more information on Baal and bow, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells Elijah to go to the **wilderness** of Damascus and anoint Hazael as the new **king**. Translate wilderness and king as you have previously. For more information on wilderness and king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah finds Elisha plowing a field with a **yoke** of **oxen**. Translate yoke and oxen in the same way you have translated them in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 19:9–21

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (648 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1011 KB)

1 Kings 20:1–12

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 20:1–12 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:1–12 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1 Kings 20:1–12

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, Yahweh reminded the prophet Elijah that he was not alone. Yahweh told Elijah where to find Elisha. Elisha would become Elijah's assistant and eventually replace Elijah as Yahweh's prophet to Yahweh's people. Now, Israel's enemy Aram, or Syria, prepares once more to attack Israel.

Ben-Hadad, the king of Aram, or Syria, launches an attack against the capital city of Samaria in Israel. The things that happen in this story seem slightly different than the things that happened in history at that time. It is possible that the storyteller uses the two [kings' names as representatives of kings during this time. Because the storyteller does use the names Ahab and Ben-Hadad, it is best to keep the same names in your translation.]{.mark}

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Syria and the city of Samaria. Pause this audio here.

Ben-Hadad brought not only his entire army to Samaria but also 32 kings who were under his authority, along with their horses and chariots. A chariot is a vehicle with two wheels that horses pull, and soldiers often use chariots in battles.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of horses and Syrian chariots. Pause this audio here.

The Aramean army besieged the city of Samaria. When an army besieged a city, the soldiers surrounded the city in order to cut off its supplies of food, water, and weapons. The people inside the city would eventually have to fight their way out or surrender. Once the Aramean army surrounded the city of Samaria, Ben-Hadad sent messengers to Ahab, the king of Israel. During this time, kings did not meet face to face in case their enemy decided to use the meeting as an opportunity to kill them. Instead, kings sent men back and forth to give messages on their behalf.

As a forceful way to get Ahab to submit to his demands, Ben-Hadad tells King Ahab that King Ahab's gold and silver belong to Ben-Hadad. The Aramean king also demands that King Ahab give him the best of his wives and children. It is unclear if "best" refers to women and children who were the most beautiful or the most intelligent. Regardless, the women and children would have been captives of war.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do leaders defend their land from enemies where you live? How do opposing forces come to an agreement to stop fighting over land? Pause this audio here.

King Ahab agrees to Ben-Hadad's demands because he knows it is the price he must pay to get the Aramean king to stop attacking Samaria. Ahab sends a messenger to Ben-Hadad to say that Ahab formally agrees to give Ben-Hadad his gold, silver, women, and children. Ahab calls Ben-Hadad "my Lord, the King" as a way to show that he will submit to him. King Ahab says that all he has belongs to Ben-Hadad. However, Ben-Hadad wants more. The Aramean king further insults Ahab by sending messengers to say that he will send his servants the next day to raid Ahab's palace and the houses of Ahab's officials and take whatever they want.

Once King Ahab understands that Ben-Hadad's goal is to completely humiliate him, Ahab calls all the elders, or tribal and family leaders, of Israel together for a meeting. King Ahab explains to the elders that he previously accepted the Aramean king's demands. However, Ben-Hadad is now asking for too much because he wants to take everything of value that Ahab has. The Israelite elders advise Ahab not to accept Ben-Hadad's demands. So Ahab sends messengers back to Ben-Hadad to say that though Ahab had agreed to give gold, silver, women, and children, Ahab now refuses to meet Ben-Hadad's new demands.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Ben-Hadad used fear and threats to try to make King Ahab give in. Tell a story of when someone or something forced your people to give up what was theirs. Discuss when it is wise to resist and when it is wise to submit. Pause this audio here.

Once Ben-Hadad hears Ahab's response, Ben-Hadad makes an oath, or promise, and says that he will completely destroy Samaria and make it only a few handfuls of dust. If he fails, then Ben-Hadad will accept the gods' punishment.

Ahab quickly sends back a reply to Ben-Hadad and says, "One who puts on his armor should not boast like one who takes it off." Armor is what soldiers wear to protect themselves in battle. In other words, Ahab tells Ben-Hadad that he should not be so quick to assume victory when he has not yet won the battle.

Stop here and look at a picture of armor as a group. Pause this audio here.

The Aramean king receives Ahab's message as he is drinking and celebrating with the other kings in his tent. Upset by Ahab's refusal, Ben-Hadad immediately orders his soldiers to attack the city of Samaria once more.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has six scenes.

In the first scene: The Aramean king Ben-Hadad attacks Samaria with all of his army, horses, chariots, and 32 other kings at his command.

In the second scene: Ben-Hadad sends messengers to Ahab and tells him to give Ben-Hadad all of his gold, silver, and his best women and children. Ahab sends a messenger back to Ben-Hadad to agree to his demands and says, "All I have is yours, my Lord, the king."

In the third scene: Ben-Hadad sends messengers to Ahab to say that not only will Ben-Hadad take Ahab's silver, gold, women, and children, but at this time tomorrow, Ben-Hadad will send his servants to take whatever valuables they want from Ahab's palace as well as from the houses of Ahab's officials.

In the fourth scene: Ahab calls the elders of Israel to Samaria to a meeting and tells them what has happened. The elders agree that Ahab should not meet Ben-Hadad's humiliating demands. Ahab sends messengers to Ben-Hadad to say he will not allow Ben-Hadad to raid his palace and his officials' homes.

In the fifth scene: Ben-Hadad receives Ahab's message and makes a promise to say that the gods will punish Ben-Hadad if he does not completely destroy Samaria and turn it into handfuls of dust. Ahab sends messengers back to Ben-Hadad and says that Ben-Hadad should not speak as one who already has victory.

In the sixth scene: Ben-Hadad receives Ahab's message while he is drinking with the other kings in his tent. Ben-Hadad is so upset by the message that he orders his soldiers to attack Samaria once again.

The characters in this passage are:

- Ben-Hadad, the king of Syria
- The Aramean army
- 32 kings
- Ahab, the king of Israel
- Messengers
- And the elders of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Ben-Hadad gathers his army and 32 kings to go to Samaria, the capital of Israel, to surround and attack it. It is important to note that these kings were leaders or governors under Ben-Hadad's authority. Ben-Hadad was the king of Aram, otherwise known as Syria. Ben-Hadad's army included chariots, or war carts that horses pull.

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It is important to note that the distance between the capital of Aram to Samaria is between 140 to 160 kilometers. This means it would take an army around five to eight days to arrive in Samaria.

Ben-Hadad tells Ahab that he owns all of Ahab's silver, gold, and his best wives and children. It is also important to note that Ben-Hadad is not asking for these things but making a statement that they already belong to Ben-Hadad.

King Ahab sends messengers and agrees to meet Ben-Hadad's demands. Ahab calls Ben-Hadad "my Lord, or master, the king" to show that he is willing to obey Ben-Hadad. Ahab agrees to the demands and says all he has belongs to Ben-Hadad.

Some time passes, though we are not sure how long it took Ben-Hadad to respond. The messengers return with another message from Ben-Hadad. In it, Ben-Hadad repeats his earlier claim of ownership over the gold, silver, wives, and children of Israel. But now, Ben-Hadad adds that by this time tomorrow, Ben-Hadad's servants will go to Ahab's palace and the houses of Ahab's officials and take whatever valuable things they want. These servants are most likely Ben-Hadad's military officers.

It is important to note that the messengers are giving exact quotes from their kings to each rival king. In the message, Ben-Hadad reminds Ahab of what he has already demanded and then makes an extra demand. Remember that the storyteller directly quotes each king's message, but it is really the messengers who are going back and forth and giving the messages to each king.

Stop here and discuss with your group: How do you tell a story where one character quotes someone who is quoting himself? How can the storyteller make it less confusing? Make up some examples or act them out to find a natural and clear way to express a messenger giving direct messages to someone else. Pause this audio here.

Ahab calls together the elders of the land. The elders were leaders of the tribes and families throughout the land who helped make community decisions for Israel. The meeting happens while the enemy army is surrounding the city of Samaria. Somehow, the elders can still reach Samaria. This could mean that the army was not directly at the gates but in the area around the city. It is also possible that Ahab only called together the leaders who were already in the city of Samaria.

Ahab tells the elders to see for themselves the demands of Ben-Hadad. Ahab also admits that he already agreed to Ben-Hadad's first request. The elders advise Ahab not to accept anything else Ben-Hadad demands.

Ahab tells the messengers what to say to Ben-Hadad: "Tell the king that I will agree to everything from the first message, but I will not accept the latest demand."

Stop here and remember what you discussed about telling a story with messengers who tell direct messages to someone else. Use that to make this part as natural and easy to understand as possible. Pause this audio here.

It is important to note that the storyteller does not repeat the two demands, but the audience will remember the two things that Ben-Hadad asked for. The first demand was that Ben-Hadad said he already owned all the silver, gold, wives, and children. The second demand was that Ben-Hadad's officers would come inside the city and take all the valuable things from both Ahab and Ahab's officials.

Then Ben-Hadad sends a response to Ahab. Ben-Hadad makes an oath, or promise, and says that the gods should punish Ben-Hadad severely if anything remains of Samaria. Ben-Hadad's army would leave so little, in fact, that there would not be enough dust for each of his men to take a handful.

It is important to note that we have already seen several people make these oaths, or strong promises, in previous stories. When people in that time made an oath, they often said that if they did not keep their promise, the gods should punish them. This was a way to say that they were serious about doing what they promised to do.

Stop here and discuss with your group: What expressions do you use in your culture to describe a situation where people completely destroy everything, and nothing remains? Pause this audio here.

Ahab uses special language to respond to Ben-Hadad. Ahab says, "The one who boasts should not be the one putting on his armor, but the one taking it off." Ahab is implying that someone who is just going into battle should not claim victory, but only the one who has already won and is taking off his armor has the right to boast.

Stop here and discuss with your group: How do people in your culture say that someone should not act like they have achieved something before they actually have? Pause this audio here.

Ben-Hadad receives Ahab's response when he is drinking alcohol with the other kings in a tent or temporary shelter. Soldiers often stayed in tents when they were fighting battles during wartime. Ben-Hadad was likely already celebrating with his men the fact that he thought he would win the victory over King Ahab's city.

Ben-Hadad is upset that Ahab rejects his terms, so Ben-Hadad orders his men to prepare to attack Samaria.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has six scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Ben-Hadad, the king of Syria
- The Aramean army
- 32 kings
- Ahab, the king of Israel
- Messengers
- And the elders of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out the Aramean king Ben-Hadad attacking Samaria with all of his army, horses, chariots, and 32 other kings. Ben-Hadad sends messengers to Ahab. Ben-Hadad says he already owns all of Ahab's gold, silver, and best women and children.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am distressed. I must meet some of Ben-Hadad's demands, or he will not give up; or
- I feel worried. Hopefully, a few treasures will be enough to make Ben-Hadad go away; or
- I am afraid. Ben-Hadad's army is large. I hope this is all Ben-Hadad makes me pay.

Continue the drama.

Act out how Ahab sends messengers back to Ben-Hadad and agrees to his demands.

Act out how Ben-Hadad responds and says that not only will he take Ahab's silver, gold, women, and children, but at that time tomorrow, Ben-Hadad will send his servants to take whatever they want from Ahab's palace as well as from the houses of Ahab's officials.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am outraged. Now this is too much! I already accepted defeat; or
- I feel hatred. War is one thing, but to push for such a humiliating defeat is just insulting; or
- I am determined. I will call the elders, and we will find a way to fight. I cannot let the other nations think we are weak.

Continue the drama.

Act out how Ahab calls the elders of Israel to Samaria for a meeting and tells them what has happened. The elders agree that Ahab should not meet Ben-Hadad's humiliating demands. Ahab sends messengers to Ben-Hadad to say Ahab will not allow his palace and his officials' homes to be raided the next day.

Act out how Ben-Hadad receives Ahab's message and makes a promise to say the gods will punish Ben-Hadad if he does not completely destroy Samaria and turn it into handfuls of dust. Act out how Ahab sends messengers back to Ben-Hadad to say he should not speak as one who already has victory.

Act out how Ben-Hadad receives Ahab's message while he is drinking with the other kings in his tent. Ben-Hadad is so upset by the message that he orders his soldiers to attack Samaria once again.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ben-Hadad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel angry. How dare Ahab resist me? or
- I feel insulted. There is no way Ahab can defeat me or my army; or
- I will make Ahab pay for his words.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Ben-Hadad, the **king** of Aram, gathers his army and attacks Samaria. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a country. Ben-Hadad ruled over Aram, which is the modern-day country of Syria. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Aramean army "**besieges**," or surrounds, the city of Samaria to force them to fight their way out or surrender. The Aramean army includes soldiers and "**chariots**," or war carts that horses pull. Be sure to translate besiege and chariot in the same way you have in previous passages.

After he attacks Samaria, Ben-Hadad sends a message to Ahab. Ben-Hadad uses **messengers**, or men who deliver Ben-Hadad's message to Ahab on his behalf. Be sure to use the same word for messenger as you have used in previous passages.

Ahab was the king of **Israel**. Here, Israel refers to the land where the Israelites lived. Specifically, Samaria was in the northern territory of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ben-Hadad demands all of Ahab's silver and gold as well as his best women and children. Ahab agrees to Ben-Hadad's demands. Ahab calls Ben-Hadad "my **lord**, or master, the king" to show that he will obey Ben-Hadad's authority. Ahab is admitting that Ben-Hadad has defeated Ahab and is master over Ahab. Use the same word or phrase for lord as you used in previous passages. For more information on lord, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ben-Hadad further demands that his **servants**, or officials, come the next day and raid Ahab's **palace** and the houses of Ahab's servants, or officials, to take whatever they want. Use the same word for palace, or king's house, that you have used in previous passages. Ben-Hadad calls both his officials and Ahab's officials "servants," or men who work for a king to carry out what the king asks them to do. Use the same word or phrase for servants

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as you have in previous passages when it means government officials. If you use the word for servant, refer to the Master Glossary for more information.

Ahab is outraged and summons the **elders** of Israel for a meeting. The elders were tribal and family leaders throughout the land of Israel who helped make community decisions. Use the same word or phrase for elder as you used in previous passages. For more information on elder, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ahab refers to himself as a servant and tells Ben-Hadad that he cannot meet Ben-Hadad's second demand. By calling himself a servant, Ahab admits that he is under the power of Ben-Hadad as his master, but Ahab refuses to give in to Ben-Hadad's second demand.

Ben-Hadad makes an **oath**, or promise, saying that the **gods** will punish Ben-Hadad if he does not completely destroy Samaria and turn it into a few handfuls of dust. Although the storyteller does not use the word for oath, if you use it in your translation, use the same word or phrase for oath that you have used previously and refer to oath in the Master Glossary for more information. When Ben-Hadad refers to gods, he is not referring to the true Creator God but rather to other spirit beings as if they have power. Use the same word or phrase for gods as you used in previous passages. For more information on gods, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ahab quickly sends back a reply to Ben-Hadad and says, "One who puts on his armor should not boast like one who takes it off." Armor is what soldiers wear to protect themselves in battle.

Stop here and look at a picture of armor as a group. What words or phrases will you use for **armor**? Pause this audio here.

Ben-Hadad is in a **tent** with the other kings, probably drinking alcohol. Use the same word or phrase for tents as you have used previously.

Ben-Hadad prepares to attack the **city**. Cities were large settlements that had walls surrounding them. Use the same word or phrase for city as you have previously.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (702 KB)

- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 20:13–22

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 20:13–22 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:13–22 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:13–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Ben-Hadad, the king of Aram, attacked Samaria with his entire army, as well as 32 other kings. Ben-Hadad demanded that King Ahab give him all of Ahab's silver, gold, women, and children. King Ahab agreed and gave in, but when Ben-Hadad said his servants would also raid Ahab's palace and his officials' homes, King Ahab refused. Now, Ben-Hadad gets his soldiers ready to attack Samaria once again. You will remember that the modern-day name of Aram is Syria.

Stop here and look at a map of Aram and Samaria as a group. Pause this audio here.

While Ben-Hadad is preparing to attack Samaria, an unnamed prophet comes to Ahab, the King of Israel. As you remember, prophets are messengers of Yahweh who speak to people, especially kings, on Yahweh's behalf. The prophet asks Ahab if Ahab has seen the large numbers of the Aramean army. The prophet does not ask Ahab this because Ahab cannot see the army. The prophet wants to emphasize how large Ben-Hadad's army is and how hard it will be to defeat. The prophet tells King Ahab that Yahweh will give Ben-Hadad's army into Ahab's hand, or let Ahab's army win against Ben-Hadad's army. The prophet says Yahweh will do this so that Ahab will know that he is Yahweh, Israel's God, and that Yahweh is in control. You will remember that King Ahab and other Israelite kings during this time did not usually follow Yahweh as they should. Yahweh is yet again showing that he is the one true God of the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story of a time when a spiritual messenger came to a leader during a time of trouble. How do community leaders recognize and respond to messages from the spirit world? Pause this audio here.

King Ahab asks the prophet who Yahweh will use to bring about such a victory. The prophet says Yahweh will bring victory through the young officers of the provincial governors. Governors were leaders of smaller territories within the land who were under the authority of the king. The officers were young, unmarried men who were part of a special elite guard. These men were under the authority of different governors who paid them. Ahab asks who will start the battle, and the prophet says that Ahab himself will lead the soldiers into battle against Ben-Hadad.

So Ahab quickly musters, or calls together, the military in order to fight. Ahab gathers 232 young officers of the governors as well as 7,000 Israelite foot soldiers. The Israelite army begins to march at noon, or when the sun is at its highest, with the 232 young officers marching out first. Meanwhile, Ben-Hadad is getting drunk in his tent with the 32 kings who are helping him.

Ben-Hadad had sent out scouts, or men who explore and return with information. The scouts alert Ben-Hadad that Israelite troops are approaching from Samaria. Ben-Hadad tells them that whether the Israelites have come out for peace or to fight, Ben-Hadad wants his men to take the Israelites alive and not kill them.

Meanwhile, Ahab's young officers march out toward the Aramean camp, and they begin to kill their Aramean enemies who are coming to fight them. They strike down each Aramean they come to. The Arameans quickly find that the Israelites are defeating them, so they begin to run away from Ahab's army. King Ben-Hadad gets on a horse and is able to escape the Israelite soldiers with some of his horsemen. King Ahab wins a great victory over the Arameans. Ahab most likely kills the horses and destroys the carts.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of horses and chariots. How do groups celebrate victory over one another in your culture? Perhaps they celebrate victory even in competitions, sports, or wars. Pause this audio here.

When the battle is over, the same unnamed prophet comes to King Ahab. The prophet tells Ahab to prepare himself because Ben-Hadad, the King of Aram, will be back the next spring to attack once more. The prophet advises Ahab to rebuild his forces and strengthen his army so that he will be prepared for the next attack.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Though Ahab won a great victory, the prophet tells Ahab to prepare himself for another fight. Discuss how you will describe in your language a time when you knew a difficult task or fight was coming. How did you prepare for it?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:13–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: Ben-Hadad is in his tent with the other kings, preparing his troops to attack Samaria. Meanwhile, Yahweh sends a prophet to King Ahab. The prophet asks Ahab if he has seen the Aramean army. The prophet tells Ahab that Yahweh will give Ahab victory over the Arameans so that Ahab will know that Yahweh is God. The prophet says the victory will come through the young officers. The prophet tells Ahab he must lead the battle against Ben-Hadad.

In the second scene: Ahab gathers together 232 young officers and 7,000 Israelite soldiers. The Israelite army then marches out of Samaria with the young officers going first.

In the third scene: Ben-Hadad's scouts return to the tent where Ben-Hadad is drinking and tell him that the Israelite army is approaching. Ben-Hadad says that whether the Israelites have come for war or peace, Ben-Hadad wants his men to take the Israelites alive.

In the fourth scene: The young Israelite officers defeat their Aramean enemies. The Arameans begin to run away. King Ahab defeats the horses and chariots, while King Ben-Hadad manages to escape on a horse with some of his horsemen. King Ahab has a great victory.

In the fifth scene: The prophet tells King Ahab to prepare himself because Ben-Hadad will be back to attack again in the spring.

The characters in this passage are:

- King of Aram, Ben-Hadad
- 32 kings
- King Ahab

- Yahweh
- The unnamed prophet
- The 232 young officers
- The Israelite army
- The Aramean army with horses and chariots
- And Ben-Hadad's men who were sending Ben-Hadad messages

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that Ben-Hadad is in his tent, drinking with the 32 other kings and preparing to attack Samaria once again. The way the storyteller starts the story makes sure that the audience is paying attention to the events that are about to happen.

Yahweh sends a prophet, or messenger of God, to King Ahab. The storyteller does not tell us the name of this prophet. The prophet starts the message by saying, "This is what Yahweh says…." This was a common way to introduce an announcement of God.

Yahweh asks this question through the prophet: "Have you seen all this great multitude?" Yahweh asks the question not because Yahweh is looking for an answer, but to draw attention to the number of people in the enemy's army. In this case, the word multitude can also mean a lot of loud noise and disorder.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How would you describe a big, disordered group of people? Pause this audio here.

The prophet says that Yahweh says, "I will give it into your hand this day, and you shall know that I am Yahweh." Yahweh emphasizes that it is Yahweh himself who will make King Ahab victorious over Ben-Hadad's army and that he is Yahweh, Israel's special God.

It is important to note that Yahweh does not say he will literally put the enemies inside the hand of King Ahab, but that Yahweh is going to submit Ben-Hadad's army to the power of King Ahab.

Yahweh is not implying that King Ahab does not know who Yahweh is. Instead, Yahweh is making it clear that Yahweh is in control of the situation.

Ahab asks the prophet who Yahweh will use to bring victory over the Arameans.

The prophet says Yahweh will use the servants or young officers of the governors of the districts. Yahweh explains that it is the young men whom the governors have as special guards who will fight and win.

Ahab asks the prophet, "Who shall begin the battle?" The prophet says Ahab himself will lead them. So Ahab gathers together the servants of the governors of the districts, and there are 232 men. Ahab also gathers together 7,000 Israelite soldiers.

The Israelite army marches out of Samaria at noon, with the 232 young officers going out first. At the same time, Ben-Hadad is outside the city, becoming drunk in the tent with the 32 kings who help him. The storyteller is saying that Ben-Hadad and the other 32 governors are drinking so much that they do not know what is happening.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do drunk people act in your culture? What is the most common way for people to get drunk in your culture? Pause this audio here.

When Ben-Hadad's men see the Israelite army approaching, they report what is happening to Ben-Hadad. It is important to note that these men were already out exploring around the city when they saw the Israelite army march out.

The men tell Ben-Hadad, "Men are coming out from Samaria." Ben-Hadad says, "If they have come out for peace, take them alive. Or if they have come out for war, take them alive." This is another way to say that Ben-Hadad wants his men to take the Israelites alive, regardless of the Israelites' reasons for coming. In either case, Ben-Hadad wants his army to capture the Israelites.

So the young officers from Israel fight and each strikes down his man. This is another way to say that the officers defeat each enemy they come to. The Arameans run away, and the army of Israel chases after them. But Ben-Hadad, the king of Aram, escapes on a horse with horsemen.

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Ahab, the king of Israel, has a great victory over the horses and chariots. When the storyteller says the king of Israel struck a great blow, the storyteller is emphasizing the damage the Israelite army caused to the chariots and horses.

At the end of the battle, the prophet returns to Ahab and tells him to strengthen his position, because Ben-Hadad will return in the spring, or when the season changes. Spring is usually late March and late April. This was another way to say Ahab should strengthen and build his army since there is another battle yet to come.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:13–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King of Aram, Ben-Hadad
- 32 kings
- King Ahab
- Yahweh
- The unnamed prophet
- The 232 young officers
- The Israelite army
- The Aramean army with horses and chariots
- And Ben-Hadad's men who were sending Ben-Hadad messages

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out Ben-Hadad in his tent with the other kings preparing his troops to attack Samaria. Yahweh sends a prophet to King Ahab. The prophet asks Ahab if he has seen the Aramean army. The prophet tells Ahab that Yahweh will give Ahab victory over the Arameans so that Ahab will know that Yahweh is Yahweh. The prophet says the victory will come through the young officers. The prophet tells Ahab he must lead the battle against Ben-Hadad. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am surprised. Why does Yahweh care about our people now? I did not ask for Yahweh's help; or
- I do not have many choices. I will listen to this prophet if it will bring me victory; or
- I feel frustrated. Out of all the gods I have called on, I did not expect Yahweh to be the one to help me.

Continue the drama. Act out Ahab gathering 232 young officers and 7,000 Israelite soldiers. The Israelite army then marches out of Samaria with the young officers going first.

Act out Ben-Hadad's scouts returning to Ben-Hadad in the tent where he is drinking. The scouts tell Ben-Hadad that the Israelite army is approaching. Ben-Hadad says that, whether the Israelites have come for war or peace,

1 Kings 20:13–22

Ben-Hadad wants his men to take the Israelites alive. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Ben-Hadad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is all rather funny. What is Ahab doing now? or
- Those Israelites have no chance. The Israelites need to accept that I have them surrounded; or
- I am amused. Those soldiers look young! Maybe they are coming to give me what I demanded.

Continue the drama. Act out the young officers defeating their Aramean enemies. The Arameans begin to run away. King Ahab defeats the horses and chariots, while King Ben-Hadad manages to escape on a horse with some of his horsemen. King Ahab has a great victory.

Act out the prophet coming to King Ahab and telling Ahab to prepare himself because Ben-Hadad will be back to attack again in the spring. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am victorious. I never would have believed we were capable of defeating the Arameans; or
- I feel concerned. There is a lot to do if Ben-Hadad is going to come back with reinforcements; or
- I am surprised Yahweh gave me victory. I did not expect Yahweh to help me!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:13–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh sends a **prophet** to talk to King Ahab. A prophet is someone who gives messages from Yahweh to the people. Use the same word or phrase for prophet as you used in previous passages. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

The prophet speaks to Ahab, the **king** of **Israel**. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a country. Ahab ruled over the nation of Israel, or the land where the Israelites lived. Use the same words or phrases for king and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on king or Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

The prophet tells Ahab that **Yahweh** will give him victory so that Ahab will know that Yahweh is Yahweh. Yahweh is the personal name of God that shows the close relationship between God and Israel. Yahweh will give Ahab victory to show that Yahweh is the most powerful spiritual being who created everything. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

The prophet says the junior officers under the provincial governors will lead the Israelite army into battle. The storyteller calls these men "servants," but we know that the junior officers were young, unmarried men who were a part of a special elite guard and under the authority of the provincial governors. The provincial governors were leaders of different areas of land in Israel and under the authority of the king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss how you will define **junior officers** and **provincial governors** in your language. Pause this audio here.

Ben-Hadad sent out men from his army to know what was happening around the city of Samaria. The men reported to Ben-Hadad that the Israelite army was marching out of the city.

Stop here and discuss how you will talk about these men from Ben-Hadad's army that he sent out to see what was happening. Pause this audio here.

The prophet says Yahweh will give the Syrian army into Ahab's hand, which is another way to say Yahweh will give Ahab power over the enemy army. Be sure to use the same word or phrase for "**into your hand**" as you have used in previous passages.

When Ben-Hadad hears that the Israelite army is approaching, Ben-Hadad says to take the Israelites alive, whether they have come for war or **peace**. If the Israelites had come for war, then that meant they were going to fight. But if the Israelites had come for peace, then that meant they were going to surrender. When people live

in harmony with each other without fighting, they are living in peace. Use the same word or phrase for peace as you used in previous passages. For more information on peace, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelite army has a great victory over the Syrian soldiers and **chariots**. Chariots are war carts that horses pulled into battle. Be sure to use the same word for chariots as you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 20:13–22

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (711 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 20:23–34

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 20:23–34 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:23–34 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.

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5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, Yahweh sent a prophet to King Ahab to tell him how to defeat the Aramean army that Ben-Hadad led. King Ahab and the Israelite army defeated Ben-Hadad at Samaria, and Ben-Hadad fled. But a prophet warned Ahab that Ben-Hadad would return and attack again in the spring.

After Ben-Hadad escaped back to Aram, or Syria, his servants, the officials who served in his government, told Ben-Hadad that they only lost the battle to Israel because Israel's gods were gods of the hills. Though Yahweh is the one true God of Israel, the Arameans believed the Israelites worshipped many gods. As you remember, the Arameans had attacked Samaria, the capital city of Israel, which was built on a large hill. The Arameans also used chariots, which work best on flat ground, not on rocky hills. The Arameans thought this was why the Israelites completely defeated the Arameans. Now, Ben-Hadad's officials believe that if they fight the Israelites on the "plains," or flat land with no mountains, this time, then they will win.

Stop here and look at a picture of a plain as a group. Pause this audio here.

The Aramean officials also advise Ben-Hadad to remove the regional kings who had helped him before and to replace them with new commanders. As you remember, these were the same 32 kings who had helped Ben-Hadad attack Samaria and who drank with Ben-Hadad in his tent. Then the officials tell Ben-Hadad he must rebuild his army as strong as before, with the same number of horses and chariots. King Ben-Hadad agrees with the officials' advice and begins to make preparations.

When spring arrives, or the time of the year when kings often go to war, King Ben-Hadad has rebuilt his Aramean army. Ben-Hadad's army marches to the city of Aphek in Aram to fight against Israel. Aphek is located between Damascus and the Valley of Jezreel.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Aphek, Samaria, and Aram. Pause this audio here.

King Ahab also gathers his soldiers to fight at Aphek and gives them everything they need for battle. The two armies march out to meet each other and then camp across from each other on the plain. King Ahab divides the Israelites into two smaller groups. The storyteller tells us that the Israelite army looks small and unimpressive, like two small flocks of goats. In contrast, the Aramean army covers the whole countryside.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when a small army fought against a much larger army. Pause this audio here.

At this point, Yahweh sends the unnamed prophet, or man of God, to speak to King Ahab once again. The prophet gives Ahab the message from Yahweh, "The Arameans say that I am only a god of the hills, not the flat land. Because of this, I will cause you to conquer their large army, and in this way you and all your people will know that I am Yahweh." Yahweh tells Ahab he will deliver the Aramean army into Ahab's hands. This means that Yahweh will give Ahab power over the Arameans. Once again, Yahweh says Yahweh will do this so that Ahab and the Israelites will know that Yahweh is the one true God of Israel.

The two armies camp across from each other for seven days. Just like in the battle of Jericho, the Israelites enter into battle on the seventh day, and Yahweh gives them a huge victory. The Israelites kill 100,000 Aramean soldiers in one day, while the rest of the soldiers escape to the city of Aphek. But in the city, a wall collapses and kills 27,000 more Aramean soldiers. Meanwhile, King Ben-Hadad also runs away into the city and hides in an inner chamber or room.

While they hide with King Ben-hadad, Ben-Hadad's officials advise him to surrender to the king of Israel. The officials say that everyone knows that the kings of Israel are merciful, that they honor treaties and treat their enemies kindly. Ben-Hadad and his officials decide to wear "sackcloths," or rough pieces of cloth, and tie ropes around their heads before going to surrender to King Ahab. The officials hope that the king will spare their lives.

At that time, people wore sackcloth to show that they were sad and humble. People put ropes around their heads to show that they were prisoners of someone.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of someone wearing a sackcloth. Pause this audio here.

So Ben-Hadad wears a sackcloth and a rope around his head to meet King Ahab. Ben-Hadad waits behind while his officials go to talk to King Ahab. When the officials come before King Ahab, they say Ben-Hadad is the king's servant, and they beg Ahab to allow Ben-Hadad to live. King Ahab asks if Ben-Hadad is really still alive and seems surprised that he is not dead. Then King Ahab says the Aramean king is like a brother to Ahab. The officials listen carefully to King Ahab's words and try to decide if Ahab will treat Ben-Hadad kindly or not. When Ahab calls Ben-Hadad a brother, the officials are eager to believe him and agree that Ben-Hadad is like a brother to the king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story of a time when someone who was an enemy became like friends or family. Pause this audio here.

Ahab asks the officials to bring Ben-Hadad to him. Then Ben-Hadad comes out of hiding and climbs into Ahab's chariot. Ben-Hadad promises to give back the cities his father took from Ahab's father. Ben-Hadad also tells Ahab that Ahab can open markets, or places to buy and sell goods, in his city of Damascus, just like Ben-Hadad has done in Samaria. By opening up markets for Israelite sellers in Damascus, Ahab would gain a new source of income. Ahab agrees to Ben-Hadad's covenant, or treaty, and decides to let the Aramean king return home free, as long as he keeps his promise.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: King Ben-Hadad's officials advise him that the Israelites only won because their gods are gods of the hills. The officials tell Ben-Hadad to replace the kings with officers, rebuild his army, and fight the Israelites again on flat ground. Then the Arameans will be able to defeat the Israelites. Ben-Hadad listens to the officials' advice and begins preparing his army once again.

In the second scene: The next spring, Ben-Hadad leads his new Aramean army and marches to the city of Aphek to fight the Israelites. King Ahab leads the Israelite army and prepares them to meet the Arameans on the plain. The two armies face each other across the plain. The Israelite army camps in two small groups, while the Arameans cover the countryside.

In the third scene: The man of God gives Ahab a message from Yahweh. The man of God says, "Because the Arameans think I am a god of the hills and not a god of the valleys, I will deliver this vast army into your hands, and you will know that I am Yahweh."

In the fourth scene: After the Israelites and Arameans have camped across from each other for seven days, the Israelite army attacks the Arameans on the seventh day and kills 100,000 men in one day. The Arameans run to the city, where a wall collapses and kills 27,000 more soldiers. Ben-Hadad also runs and hides in an inner room in the city. Ben-Hadad's officials advise him to surrender to the king of Israel so that Israel's king will spare Ben-Hadad's life. Ben-hadad and his officials dress in sackcloths and go to meet Ahab.

In the fifth scene: The officials plead to Ahab to spare Ben-Hadad's life. Ahab is surprised that Ben-Hadad is still alive and calls him his brother. Ahab invites Ben-Hadad into his chariot, and the two kings make a treaty. Ben-Hadad agrees to return captured cities and let Ahab open markets in Damascus if Ahab spares his life. Ben-Hadad goes free.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Ben-Hadad's government officials
- King Ben-Hadad

- King Ahab
- Man of God
- Yahweh
- Israelite army
- And the Aramean army

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that a prophet has already warned King Ahab that King Ben-Hadad will rebuild his army and attack again in the spring.

The servants of Ben-Hadad advised Ben-Hadad. Here, servants refer to the officials who served in the government of King Ben-Hadad of Aram.

The officials tell Ben-Hadad that Israel only won the battle because their gods are gods of the hills. The Arameans think that the Israelites worship many gods, when the Israelites only follow one God, Yahweh.

The officials advise Ben-Hadad to fight the Israelites on the plains, or in the valley between the mountains, so that Ben-Hadad's army will win next time. It is important to remember that plains or valleys refer to flat or level ground where there are no mountains.

The hills the officials are talking about are larger than small hills. Samaria, the capital of Israel, sits on a high hill, while Damascus, the Aramean capital, is on a plain. For this reason, the Aramean officials think that their own gods will have more power than the God of Israel in a battle on the plain. The word "plain" means flat land, but sometimes it is easier to say "land with no mountains." The Aramean chariots would also move more easily on flat ground.

The officials tell Ben-Hadad to replace the kings with military commanders. These are the same 32 kings who previously helped Ben-Hadad and stood around drinking with Ben-Hadad in his tent.

The officials also advise Ben-Hadad to rebuild his army just as strong as before—horse for horse and chariot for chariot. In other words, the officials want Ben-Hadad to gather a new army that has the same number of horses and chariots as the previous one so that the army will be just as strong as it was before. Ben-Hadad agrees and begins to rebuild.

After time passes, the next spring, or at the time when kings usually go to war, Ben-Hadad is once again ready to go to war with Israel. Ben-Hadad marches with the Aramean army from Damascus to the city of Aphek, still in Aram. Aphek is located between Damascus and the Valley of Jezreel.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map that shows the route from Damascus to Aphek. Pause this audio here.

King Ahab listens to the prophet's advice and assembles and prepares his troops with provisions before going into battle. The Aramean army and the Israelite army arrive near Aphek and face each other across the plain.

The storyteller makes the Israelite army appear small and weak when he describes them as two flocks of goats, while the Aramean army appears large and powerful.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think the storyteller describes the Israelite army as two flocks of goats? How will you describe the way the two armies looked in your language? Pause this audio here.

The man of God, or the unnamed prophet from earlier, again gives King Ahab a message from Yahweh. Yahweh says, "The Arameans say that I am a god of the hills only and not the flat land. Because of this, I will cause you to conquer their large army, and in this way you and all your people will know that I am Yahweh."

It is important to note that Yahweh says Yahweh will bring victory to show Ahab and the Israelites who Yahweh is. He is Yahweh, and Yahweh is in control.

The two armies camp across from each other for seven days without attacking each other. The large plain where the armies are camped allows the soldiers in the two camps to see each other. But on the seventh day, the Israelites attack the Arameans and kill 100,000 soldiers. When the Arameans realize they are losing the battle,

the Arameans run back toward the city of Aphek. But when the Arameans reach the city, a wall collapses and kills 27,000 more Aramean soldiers. We do not know why exactly the wall collapses.

At some point in the battle, King Ben-Hadad escapes to the city of Aphek and hides in an inner room. It is possible that this inner room is part of the inside of the city fortress. Ben-Hadad's officials hide with him and advise him to surrender to the king of Israel. The officials want Ben-Hadad to do this because everyone knows the Israelite kings are merciful and sometimes spare their enemies' lives.

So the officials and Ben-Hadad put on sackcloths and place ropes on their heads before going out of the city to meet the king of Israel. People wore sackcloth to show that they were sad and humble, while people put ropes on their heads to show that they were a prisoner of someone.

The officials approach King Ahab first because they are not sure how Ahab will react. The officials plead with Ahab to spare Ben-Hadad's life. King Ahab is surprised and asks if Ben-Hadad is still alive.

King Ahab then says that Ben-Hadad is Ahab's brother. Ahab does not mean that Ben-Hadad is his biological brother. Instead, because they had gone through so much as enemies, Ahab honors Ben-Hadad and feels that he is like a brother to Ahab.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember your story from the previous script about someone who was an enemy who became like a friend or like family. How would you describe this kind of reconciliation in your language? Pause this audio here.

The officials take this as a good sign and are quick to pick up on Ahab's words. This means the officials are eager to believe that Ahab will treat Ben-Hadad kindly. The officials quickly agree with the king and repeat that Ben-Hadad is like a brother to Ahab.

King Ahab tells the officials to bring Ben-Hadad to Ahab. Ben-Hadad comes out of hiding and climbs into Ahab's chariot. The two kings make a covenant, or binding promise. Ben-Hadad agrees to return the captured cities to Ahab and to allow him to open markets in Damascus if Ahab lets him go free. It is important to note that Ben-Hadad had already established his own markets in the Israelite city of Samaria.

King Ahab allows Ben-Hadad to go home as part of their agreement.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Ben-Hadad's government officials
- King Ben-Hadad
- King Ahab
- Man of God
- Yahweh
- Israelite army
- And the Aramean army

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out how King Ben-Hadad’s officials give him advice in Aram. The officials tell Ben-Hadad that the Israelites only won because their gods are gods of the hills. The officials say Ben-Hadad should replace the kings with officers, rebuild his army, and fight the Israelites again on flat ground. Then the Arameans will be able to defeat the Israelites. Ben-Hadad listens to the officials’ advice and begins to prepare his army once again. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ben-Hadad, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- They are right! The Israelite gods will have no power against us if we fight the Israelites on flat ground. I will raise more chariots to destroy them! or
- I am determined. We will be more organized this time. There is no way I will let the Israelites win again; or
- I am hopeful our gods will help us on the plains.

Continue the drama. Act out how Ben-Hadad leads his new Aramean army to fight the Israelites at the city of Aphek the next spring. King Ahab marches with the Israelite army and prepares them to meet the Aramean army on the plain. The two armies face each other across the plain. The Israelite army camps in two small groups while the Arameans cover the countryside.

Act out how the man of God gives Ahab a message from Yahweh. The man of God says, “Because the Arameans think I am a god of the hills and not a god of the valleys, I will deliver this vast army into your hands, and you will know that I am Yahweh.” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahab, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- The prophet’s advice worked last time. I will keep doing what he says; or
- It is true what I heard. Yahweh is a jealous God who cares about his name among the nations; or
- I will choose to trust Yahweh again for this battle.

Continue the drama. Act out how the two armies camp across from each other for seven days. On the seventh day, the Israelite army attacks the Arameans and kills 100,000 men in one day. The Arameans run away to the city where a wall collapses and kills 27,000 more soldiers. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite soldiers, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel excited. Our enemies cannot stand against us. Yahweh is with us! or
- It is so clear Yahweh is fighting for us. I was nervous about our small numbers, but now our enemies are running away! or
- I am proud to fight in Yahweh’s army. I want to defend our people and keep the Arameans from coming back to Samaria.

Continue the drama. Act out how Ben-Hadad runs away to the city and hides in an inner room. Ben-Hadad’s officials advise him to surrender to the king of Israel because Israel’s king is merciful. Ben-Hadad and his officials dress in sackcloth and go to meet Ahab.

The officials plead with Ahab to spare Ben-Hadad’s life. Ahab is surprised that Ben-Hadad is still alive and calls Ben-Hadad his brother. Ahab invites Ben-Hadad into Ahab’s chariot, and the two kings make a treaty. Ben-Hadad will return captured cities and allow Ahab to open markets in Damascus if Ahab spares Ben-Hadad’s life. Ben-hadad goes free. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ben-Hadad’s officials, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel relieved. I knew the king of Israel would not punish Ben-Hadad. The Israelite kings have too much compassion; or
- I feel surprised. What fortune that the king saw Ben-Hadad as a brother! or
- That could have gone much worse. At least we are still alive!

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Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The Aramean servants, or **officials**, advise the **King** of Aram. Use the same word or phrase for government officials as you used in previous passages. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a country. Ben-Hadad rules over the country of Syria, otherwise known as Aram. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

The officials tell Ben-Hadad that the Israelites only won because their **gods** are gods of the hills. Although there is only one God, Yahweh, sometimes people worship other spirit beings or idols as if they have power. The Syrians worshipped several different gods, and they assumed the Israelites did as well. Use the same word or phrase for gods as you used in previous passages. For more information on gods, refer to the Master Glossary.

The officials say that if Ben-Hadad fights the Israelites again, but on plains this time, then the Syrian army will win. A plain is an area of flat ground where there are no mountains.

Stop here and look at the photo of a plain again. Discuss with your group what word or phrase you will use for **plains** in your language. Pause this audio here.

The officials want Ben-Hadad to rebuild his army to be as strong as it was before, with just as many horses and **chariots**. As you remember, a chariot is a war cart that horses pulled. Use the same word for chariots as you used in previous passages.

When **spring** arrives, or at the time when kings go to war, Ben-Hadad once again goes to battle with Israel. Spring refers to a time of year between early April and early March when the weather becomes warmer after a cold time of year. The dry weather makes this a good time of year for kings to fight battles. Use the same word or phrase for spring as you used in previous passages.

When the officials refer to the gods of **Israel**, they are referring to the gods of the nation of Israel. Israel was the territory where the Israelites lived. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelite army looks like two small flocks of goats on the hillside.

Stop here and decide how you will describe the Israelite army. If you choose to describe them like flocks of goats, use the same word or phrase for goats as you have previously. Pause this audio here.

While Ahab is preparing for battle, the **man of God** appears to him. This man is probably the same prophet who came to Ahab earlier. Old Testament storytellers sometimes call a prophet a “man of God.” In this case, the storyteller uses the title “man of God,” but he is talking about the prophet. Use the same term for “man of God” as you have used previously. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

The man tells Ahab he has a message from **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the personal name of God that shows the close relationship between God and Israel. Yahweh tells Ahab that Yahweh will bring a great victory to show who Yahweh is. He is Yahweh, and Yahweh is in control. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

The prophet tells Ahab that Yahweh will deliver his enemies **into his hands**, or into his power. In other words, Yahweh will give Ahab power and victory over the Syrians. Use the same word or phrase for “into your hands” as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites begin to defeat the Syrians, so many soldiers run away to the **city** of Aphek. A city is a large town where many people live. At this time, most cities had walls surrounding them to protect them from enemies. Use the same word or phrase for “city” as you used in previous passages.

When Ben-Hadad is hiding in the inner room, his officials tell Ben-Hadad to surrender, since everyone knew the kings of Israel were merciful. When someone is merciful, they show kindness, goodness, or compassion. The person keeps their promises and is loyal. In this case, King Ahab would be showing mercy, or loyal and steadfast

love, if he allowed King Ben-Hadad to live. Some translations say that the kings of Israel show mercy, and some translations say that they show steadfast love.

Stop here and decide as a group what word or phrase you will use for **mercy** or **steadfast love** here. For more information on mercy or steadfast love, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Ben-Hadad and his officials wear sackcloth and put ropes on their heads before going to meet Ahab. People wore sackcloth to show that they were sad and humble. Sackcloth is a very rough cloth, so it causes the person who uses it discomfort.

Stop here and, if needed, look again at the picture of someone who wears sackcloth. Discuss with your group what word or phrase you will use for **sackcloth** in your language. Pause this audio here.

The officials plead with Ahab to spare Ben-Hadad's life and call Ben-Hadad Ahab's **servant**. When the officials say that Ben-Hadad is Ahab's servant, they are saying Ben-Hadad is under the authority of Ahab and ready to serve him. Use the same word or phrase for servant as you used in previous passages. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

In the end, Ahab makes a **covenant**, or treaty, with Ben-Hadad. Ben-Hadad will return captured cities and allow Ahab to open markets in Damascus as long as Ahab lets him go free. When people make a covenant, they make a solemn promise to each other that they cannot break. By making a covenant, people say that they want to have a good relationship with each other. Use the same word or phrase for covenant as you used in previous passages. For more information on covenant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step. Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage. Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene. Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 20:23–34

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (721 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 20:35–43

1 Kings 20:35–43

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 20:35–43 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:35–43 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:35–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, Yahweh gave King Ahab and the Israelites a great victory over Ben-Hadad's Syrian army. But when Ben-Hadad surrendered to Ahab, Ahab decided to make a treaty with Ben-Hadad and let him live. Now, Yahweh will send a prophet to tell Ahab what the consequences will be.

During this time, there were groups, or "brotherhoods," of prophets who were messengers of God. These men received messages from Yahweh and delivered the messages to the people. When the storyteller says "one of the sons of the prophets," it means the man belonged to a group of prophets. The man was not a prophet's biological son.

The prophet receives a word from Yahweh, or a message directly from Yahweh. The prophet acts on Yahweh's instructions and asks another prophet, a companion, to strike him. But the other prophet does not recognize that this is from Yahweh because it is a strange request, so he refuses to strike the first prophet.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, if one person asked another person to strike them, how might the second person react to the first person's request? Why would they react in this way? Pause this audio here.

The prophet tells the companion that by refusing to strike the prophet, the companion has disobeyed Yahweh. Then the prophet says that a lion will attack and kill the companion when he leaves. Just like the prophet said, when the companion walks away, a lion finds him and kills him. In this way, Yahweh does what Yahweh says he will do.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a Middle Eastern lion. The lion in this story was a sign from God. In your culture, how do animals carry spiritual messages or act as warnings? Pause this audio here.

The prophet tries again and politely asks another man to hit him. This time, the man agrees and strikes the prophet, which leaves the prophet with a wound. The injury makes the prophet look like he has just come from battle. The prophet disguises himself by pulling a bandage, a strip of cloth, over his eyes. Then the prophet goes and waits by the road for King Ahab to pass by.

When Ahab comes along, the prophet acts like a common soldier and calls out to the king. As you remember, the Israelite soldiers have just won a huge victory over the Aramean army. The prophet tells Ahab that he is Ahab's servant as a way to show respect and submission to the king. Then the prophet begins to tell a story that is not true. The prophet invents the story to teach the king a lesson from Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do storytellers or elders use stories to teach hard lessons indirectly, like this prophet? How can stories help you confront someone without being disrespectful? Pause this audio here.

The prophet tells the king that in the middle of the battle, a fellow soldier gave him a prisoner of war to guard. Most likely, this captured enemy would have become the soldier's slave. The soldier told the prophet that if the prisoner escaped for any reason, the prophet would have to give his life in place of the man's life. In other words, if the prisoner escaped, the prophet would have to take the man's place as a slave, or pay the soldier a talent of silver instead. This was about 34 kilograms, or 75 pounds of silver, which was far too high a price for a soldier to pay. The prophet says that while he was busy, the prisoner escaped. That is why the prophet is now in trouble.

King Ahab responds and says the prophet has judged himself and must now suffer the consequence he has already described. Then the prophet quickly removes the bandage from his face and reveals who he really is. King Ahab immediately recognizes the prophet.

The prophet gives the king a message from Yahweh: Ahab let a man go free who Yahweh commanded Ahab to destroy. Because of this, Yahweh says that Ahab will pay with his life, and the Israelite people will suffer because of what Ahab has done.

As you remember, ever since the Israelites began to conquer the Promised Land, Yahweh went before the Israelites as their leader and commanded them to completely destroy their enemies as an offering to Yahweh. This meant the Israelites were not to leave anyone alive. However, after Yahweh gave Ahab a great victory over Ben-Hadad and the Arameans, Ahab chose to leave Ben-Hadad alive. Now, because of his disobedience, Ahab will lose his life.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story of a time when someone in your culture ignored advice from elders, spirits, or tradition, and something bad happened as a result. Pause this audio here.

Ahab returned to his palace in Samaria, and Ahab felt bitter and angry. King Ahab heard a story about someone he thought was an irresponsible soldier and ended up pronouncing judgment on himself.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:35–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: A prophet receives a message from Yahweh. The prophet asks his fellow prophet to strike him. The man refuses. The prophet warns that because the man disobeyed Yahweh, a lion will kill him when he leaves. The man leaves, and later a lion attacks and kills the man.

In the second scene: The prophet politely asks another man to strike him. The man agrees and wounds the prophet. The prophet then covers his eyes with a bandage to disguise himself and waits by the road for the king.

In the third scene: King Ahab passes by, and the prophet calls out to the king. The prophet tells Ahab a story. The prophet says he was responsible for guarding a prisoner who escaped. The soldier who left the prisoner with the prophet said that if the prisoner escaped, the prophet must pay with his life or a talent of silver. King Ahab says that the prophet has judged himself. The prophet removes his bandage and reveals who he truly is. The prophet tells Ahab Yahweh's message, and says, "You have set free a man I had determined should die. Therefore, your life will pay for his life, and your people for his people."

In the fourth scene: King Ahab returns to his palace in Samaria. Ahab feels bitter and angry.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- The prophet with a word from Yahweh
- The fellow prophet
- The lion
- The man who strikes the prophet
- And King Ahab

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that Israel has just won a great battle against the Arameans. According to the rules Yahweh gave the Israelites for war, the Israelites were supposed to completely destroy their enemies as an offering to Yahweh, but Ahab was not a king who followed Yahweh. King Ahab let Ben-Hadad, the king of Aram, or Syria, live in order to have a better trade partnership with Ben-Hadad.

The word of Yahweh comes to one of the sons of the prophets. When Yahweh's word comes to someone, it means Yahweh speaks to that person and tells them what to do or say. Here, "son" does not mean biological son but shows that this man belonged to a group of prophets.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you talk about the group of prophets in your language? Pause this audio here.

The prophet asks another prophet to strike him. We assume that the prophet means to strike him with a weapon, though it is unclear how the prophet's companion was supposed to strike him. We later learn that this is a part of Yahweh's plan. But the fellow prophet refuses to hit the man.

The prophet tells the other prophet that by refusing to strike him, he has disobeyed Yahweh. As a consequence, the prophet predicts that a lion will kill the man when he leaves the prophet's presence.

When the man leaves the prophet, a lion finds the man and kills him, just as Yahweh had said through the prophet. Lions were common predators in the region. Lions hunted both people and animals. Yahweh uses the lion to bring his divine judgment, or punishment, on the man.

The prophet then finds another man. We are unsure if this man was another prophet or just another man that the prophet found. The prophet politely asks the man to strike the prophet. This man agrees and wounds the prophet. The prophet looks like a soldier injured in battle. This appearance allows the prophet to convincingly tell his story to King Ahab.

The prophet disguises himself by pulling a bandage over his eyes. Then the prophet goes to stand by the road to Samaria and waits for King Ahab to pass by. The prophet looks like a common, wounded soldier in Israel's army. King Ahab most likely travels in a chariot.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you describe the prophet's appearance in your language? Remember, the prophet had a cloth bandage over his eyes that covered his head wound. Pause this audio here.

When the king passes by, the prophet calls out loudly to get the king's attention and make him stop. It is important to understand that the prophet is not telling a true story to Ahab. The prophet uses this story to deliver Yahweh's message of judgment to Ahab.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think the prophet told an untrue story instead of directly accusing the king? Tell a local story that teaches an important lesson. Pause this audio here.

When the prophet says, "Your servant went into battle...," the prophet is referring to himself as a servant of the king to show that he submits to the king's authority.

As part of his story, the prophet says that another soldier gave him a captive or prisoner to watch. The soldier told the prophet that if the prisoner escaped, the prophet would have to pay with his life or a talent of silver. When the prophet says, "your life for his life," he means that the soldier would make the prophet the soldier's slave if the prisoner got away.

The prophet explains that while he was busy, the prisoner escaped and left the prophet in serious trouble. King Ahab responds and says the man has judged himself and must suffer the consequence he already described. Remember that the king does not know that this man is one of the prophets of Israel. This means the prophet would have to give control of his own life over to the soldier.

The prophet quickly removes his bandage, and King Ahab immediately recognizes the prophet. It is possible that Ahab knew this prophet personally, or that prophets at that time had a certain appearance, such as being bald, that made them easy to recognise.

The prophet says, “This is what Yahweh says…” to show that his message comes directly from Yahweh to Ahab. Yahweh tells Ahab that Ahab let a man live whom Yahweh had said must die. As you remember, Ahab should have killed Ben-Hadad, the defeated enemy king.

Now Yahweh says, “It will be Ahab’s life for that man’s life, and Ahab’s people for that man’s people.” Because Ahab is the king of Israel, this means the Israelite people will suffer because of Ahab’s disobedience.

Ahab returns to his palace in Samaria, feeling bitter and angry.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:35–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- The prophet with a word from Yahweh
- The fellow prophet
- The lion
- The man who strikes the prophet
- And King Ahab

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out how the prophet receives a message from Yahweh. The prophet asks his fellow prophet to strike him with a weapon. The man refuses. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the prophet’s friend, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- This man is crazy. Why would Yahweh want me to hurt this man? or
- I feel doubtful. I do not think this man has truly heard from Yahweh; or
- I do not care if I am supposed to do this thing. I am not going to strike another person! I am a peaceful person.

Continue the drama. Act out how the prophet says that a lion will kill the man because he did not obey Yahweh. The man leaves the prophet, and a lion attacks and kills the man.

Act out how the prophet politely asks another man to strike him. The man strikes the prophet and leaves him wounded. The prophet uses a bandage to disguise himself, then waits by the road for the king. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the prophet, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- My head really hurts. I hope Ahab truly hears Yahweh’s message; or
- I am determined. I will give the king Yahweh’s message, no matter the cost; or
- I have a plan. I will let Ahab bring judgment on himself and then give him Yahweh’s message.

Continue the drama. Act out how King Ahab passes by as the prophet calls out loudly to get Ahab's attention. The prophet tells Ahab a story about being responsible for a prisoner who escaped. The prophet explains that the soldier who left the prophet in charge said he must pay with his life or a talent of silver if the prisoner got away. King Ahab says that the prophet has judged himself with his own words. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The fool. This man's case is obvious; or
- I feel entertained. I do not know what this man expects me to say. This man has obviously been careless and deserves the consequences; or
- I am annoyed. I do not know why this man stopped me for this.

Continue the drama. Act out how the prophet removes his bandage and reveals who he truly is. The prophet says he has a message from Yahweh for Ahab. Yahweh says, "You have set free a man I had determined should die. Therefore, it is your life for his life, your people for his people."

Act out how King Ahab returns to his palace in Samaria and feels bitter and angry. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am shocked. This God just helped me, and now he dares to bring judgment? or
- I am angry. Yahweh asks too much. Kings must make alliances. I am at war! or
- I feel guilty. I know I did not follow the rules of war Yahweh gave our people.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 20:35–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The **word of Yahweh** came to a man. The "word of Yahweh" means everything that Yahweh tells people. Yahweh either speaks to the people directly or through people called prophets. In this case, Yahweh explained to the prophet what to do to bring a message of judgment on King Ahab. Use the same word or phrase for "word of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages. For more information on "word" and "Yahweh," refer to the Master Glossary.

The word of Yahweh comes to a son of the **prophets**. Here, "son" means that the man belonged to a group of prophets, not that he was someone's biological son. A prophet is someone who gives messages from Yahweh to the people. Use the same word or phrase for prophet as you used in previous passages. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you talk about the group or sons of prophets in your language? Pause this audio here.

The prophet says a **lion** will kill the other prophet because he did not listen to Yahweh's voice. A lion is a large, powerful cat that hunts and eats other animals. Use the same word for lion as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lion as a group. Pause this audio here.

The wounded prophet stands by the road and waits for **King** Ahab. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a country. King Ahab ruled over the nation of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

The prophet calls out to Ahab and says he is Ahab's **servant**. When the prophet calls himself a servant, the prophet is showing submission to the king and admitting that he is under Ahab's power. Use the same word or phrase for servant as you used in previous passages. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

In the prophet's story, the soldier tells the prophet that if the prisoner escapes, then the prophet must become a slave in the prisoner's place or pay a **talent** of silver. A talent is about 34 kilograms of silver. Use the same word or phrase for talent as you used in previous passages. For more information about talent, see the Master Glossary.

Ahab was the king of **Israel**. Here, Israel refers to the territory, or land, where the Israelites lived. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ahab returns to his **palace** angry and sullen. A palace refers to the house of a king. Be sure to use the same word for palace as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 20:35–43

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (722 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 21:1–16

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 21:1–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:1–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 21:1–16

4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, Yahweh sent a prophet disguised as a soldier to deliver a message to King Ahab. Yahweh told Ahab that because Ahab let the Syrian king, Ben-Hadad, live, Yahweh would take Ahab's life instead, and the Israelites would suffer because of it. King Ahab returned to his palace and felt bitter and angry with Yahweh.

Some time passed after the prophet gave Yahweh's message to King Ahab. Now, the king finds himself in another difficult situation. As you remember, King Ahab had a palace in Samaria, the capital city of Israel. But Ahab also had a second palace in the city of Jezreel. Jezreel was located north of Samaria and southwest of Lake Galilee, in the territory of Issachar.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Samaria and Jezreel. Pause this audio here.

Naboth lived in Jezreel and owned a vineyard close to the palace of King Ahab. A vineyard is a type of garden where people grow grapes. Grapes are a soft, juicy fruit that grow on a tree called a grapevine.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a vineyard with grapes. Pause this audio here.

One day, King Ahab approaches Naboth and asks to buy Naboth's vineyard. Ahab says he wants to use the vineyard to plant different vegetables, or leafy plants. Ahab offers to give Naboth a better vineyard in exchange, or, if it seems good to Naboth, Ahab will pay Naboth the vineyard's value in silver. People used silver as money during that time.

Naboth strongly refuses the king's offer. Naboth says, "Yahweh forbid that I should give you the inheritance of my fathers." When Naboth says "Yahweh forbid," Naboth uses special language that puts a curse on himself from Yahweh if Naboth does something he is not supposed to do. This curse is a way to show Naboth's strong refusal and disgust towards the idea. For Naboth, the vineyard is Naboth's inheritance. According to the law of Moses, land was to stay with the descendants of the original owner. People could not sell land from one tribe to another. Each generation of Naboth's family had passed the vineyard down to the next. For Naboth, it is a matter of honor to keep what Naboth's ancestors have given him.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think Naboth felt so strongly about keeping the land? In your culture, what is something that has deep meaning or family history that you would never give away or exchange for any price? How would you feel if someone insisted on having that thing? Pause this audio here.

After Naboth rejects Ahab, Ahab returns to his palace sullen and angry. Ahab is so upset by Naboth's refusal that Ahab lies in bed, refuses to eat, and turns his face away so that he hides from everyone. Though Ahab is a king, Ahab begins to behave like a child who sulks. When Ahab's wife Jezebel finds out, Jezebel confronts Ahab and asks him why he is so upset that he will not eat.

Ahab tells Jezebel the story of Naboth and how Naboth refused to sell his vineyard. Jezebel asks Ahab, "Are you not the king of Israel?" not because she doubts Ahab's role, but to rebuke Ahab for not acting like a king. The queen commands Ahab to get up, eat, and let his heart be cheerful. In other words, Jezebel is telling Ahab that she will take care of his problem. When Jezebel says, "I will get you the vineyard," Jezebel emphasizes that she herself will make sure the vineyard becomes her husband's.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of roles do husbands and wives play when people make big decisions in your culture? How do husbands and wives influence each other's decisions? What do you see as a good or a harmful influence? Pause this audio here.

Jezebel then writes letters in her husband's name, which means she writes the letters and signs Ahab's name to give the letters the authority of the king. Jezebel also used Ahab's official seal. In those times, kings wore special rings that people had engraved with the king's name or their personal symbol in reverse. When someone pressed the ring into wax, it created a seal on the document and showed the king's official authorization. The

person who received the letter could not open and read the letter or document unless they broke the wax seal. This confirmed that the document was authentic or that the document was really from the king. Such a ring was a sign of power and authority. Jezebel uses Ahab's seal and ring to make the letters official.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a wax seal and a royal signet ring. Pause this audio here.

Jezebel sends these official letters to the elders and nobles of Naboth's town, Jezreel. Elders were important family leaders, while nobles were wealthy landowners with certain rights that not all people had. Together, these two groups represented the city's leadership. In Jezebel's letter, she commands the city leaders to proclaim a fast and to place Naboth in a position of honor. When people fast, they intentionally deny themselves food for the specific purpose of prayer. In the case of a public fast, the community would come together when someone committed a crime that brought guilt on the whole city. The community fasted together to humble themselves before Yahweh. In this case, Jezebel's plan is to use the day of fasting as a public event so that everyone can see Naboth when the leaders accuse Naboth of blasphemy. This way, the people will believe Naboth is guilty and has sinned against Yahweh.

Jezebel orders the leaders to place two dishonest men on either side of Naboth to accuse him of two things Naboth did not do: blaspheming Yahweh and cursing the king. Both blasphemy and cursing the king were crimes that people punished with death. Jezebel instructs that after the two men have falsely accused Naboth, the leaders should stone Naboth to death. It is important to remember that, although Jezebel gives these orders, the leaders receive these instructions as if they come directly from King Ahab.

The city leaders believe King Ahab is giving them official orders, so the city leaders of Jezreel follow Jezebel's instructions exactly. The leaders proclaim a day of fasting, gather the people together, place Naboth in a position of honor, and seat two dishonest men beside Naboth. During the gathering, the two men falsely accuse Naboth of cursing both Yahweh and King Ahab. The people then take Naboth outside the city and stone Naboth until he dies. Afterwards, the city leaders send a message to Jezebel to report that Naboth is dead.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are some actions that people usually consider to be good or holy? How have you seen people misuse these good things to cover up wrong intentions? Pause this audio here.

When Jezebel hears that Naboth is dead, she tells Ahab to go and take possession of Naboth's vineyard, since Naboth is no longer alive. So Ahab listens to Jezebel and goes and takes the vineyard for himself.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: King Ahab approaches Naboth and asks to buy Naboth's vineyard so Ahab can plant vegetables. Ahab offers Naboth a better vineyard in exchange, or if Naboth prefers, Ahab will pay Naboth the vineyard's value in silver. Naboth strongly refuses the king and says it would insult Yahweh if Naboth sold his inheritance. King Ahab returns to his palace angry.

In the second scene: In his palace, King Ahab lies in bed and refuses to eat. Ahab will not talk to anyone. When Jezebel hears this, she goes to Ahab's room and asks why he is so upset. Ahab tells Jezebel that Naboth has refused to sell his vineyard. Jezebel asks if this is how Ahab acts as the king of Israel. Jezebel tells Ahab to get up and eat because Jezebel will show Ahab how to get Naboth's vineyard.

In the third scene: Jezebel writes letters in Ahab's name to the city leaders of Jezreel. In the letters, she commands the leaders to proclaim a day of fasting and to put Naboth in a place of honor. Jezebel instructs the leaders to place two dishonest men beside Naboth to accuse him of cursing Yahweh and the king. Jezebel orders them to take Naboth outside the city and stone him to death.

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In the fourth scene: The city leaders of Jezreel receive the orders and follow all of the commands. The leaders proclaim a day of fasting, place Naboth in a seat of honor, and instruct two dishonest men to lie about Naboth. The two men accuse Naboth of cursing Yahweh and the king. The people take Naboth outside the city and stone him to death. The city leaders send word of Naboth's death to the king.

In the fifth scene: When Jezebel hears that Naboth is dead, she tells Ahab to go and take possession of the vineyard. Ahab immediately goes and seizes the vineyard.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Ahab
- Naboth
- Jezebel
- Elders and nobles of Jezreel
- People of Jezreel
- And the two dishonest men

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that the prophet has already told Ahab that Yahweh is displeased with Ahab for letting Ben-Hadad live, and that eventually, Ahab will die for what he has done.

King Ahab's palace in Jezreel was close to the vineyard of Naboth. It is important to note that Ahab had two palaces, one palace in Samaria and one palace in Jezreel.

The storyteller calls Ahab the King of Samaria. Here, Samaria refers to the entire northern region of Israel and not just the capital city.

Ahab offers to buy Naboth's vineyard because Ahab wants to use it to grow vegetables. This means Ahab would remove the grapevines and plant something else instead. Ahab offers to give Naboth a better vineyard in exchange, or to pay Naboth in silver, if that seems good to Naboth. To say "if it seems good to you" is another way to say "if you prefer."

Naboth replies, "Yahweh forbid that I should give you the inheritance of my fathers," as a way to strongly refuse the king's offer. Naboth finds the offer so offensive that he calls down a curse on himself from Yahweh if he were to do such a thing. For Naboth, the vineyard is his inheritance, or passed down from his family, and it is a matter of honor and pride to keep it in his family.

King Ahab returns to his palace angry, sulks in his room, and refuses to eat bread. In the original language, "bread" refers to all food, so Ahab is refusing to eat anything at all.

When Jezebel hears that her husband will not eat, Jezebel comes to check on Ahab. Jezebel asks why Ahab is so upset. Ahab tells Jezebel what happened with Naboth.

Jezebel asks, "Are you not the king of Israel?" This is a way that Jezebel rebukes Ahab for his weak behaviour.

Stop here and discuss how you will talk about the way Jezebel rebukes Ahab in your language. Pause this audio here.

Jezebel thinks Ahab's actions are not those of a true king. Jezebel commands Ahab to get up, eat, and let his heart be cheerful. In the original language, "heart" means the part of a person that thinks, feels, and makes decisions. Jezebel uses this special language to tell Ahab not to worry but to be cheerful.

When Jezebel says, "I will get you the vineyard," Jezebel is emphasising that she herself will get it. Jezebel wants to show Ahab, through her actions, how she expects Ahab to act as king.

Jezebel writes letters in Ahab's name, which means Jezebel signs Ahab's name on the letters as if the letters came from Ahab. Jezebel also uses Ahab's official ring and seal so that the letters appear to be official messages from the king.

The message inside the letters looks like it comes from Ahab. In the letters, Jezebel commands the elders and nobles of Jezreel to proclaim a day of fasting, to place Naboth in a seat of honor, and to put two scoundrels

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beside Naboth who will falsely accuse Naboth of cursing Yahweh and the king. “Scoundrel” is another word for someone who is bad, evil, or not trustworthy.

Stop here and discuss with your group: Tell a story of a person whom the community did not trust because that person had a reputation for causing trouble. Pay attention to what words you use to describe this type of person. Pause this audio here.

Jezebel orders the leaders to stone Naboth to death. Jezebel sends the letters from Samaria to the city leaders of Jezreel.

The city leaders receive the letters and obey the instructions inside. The leaders proclaim a day of fasting and place Naboth in a seat of honor. The leaders secretly tell two dishonest men what to accuse Naboth of before the leaders seat the men beside Naboth. The two men sit beside Naboth and then falsely accuse Naboth of blaspheming, or cursing, Yahweh and the king in front of all the people. A person cursed God when they insulted God, dishonored God, or made God seem less powerful or important.

Stop here and discuss with your group: Tell a story of someone who said something really bad or disrespectful about their leaders. What happened to that person? Pause this audio here.

The two men, the leaders, and the people forcibly take Naboth outside the city and stone him to death. It is important to remember that the people were following the law of Moses. The law of Moses said that people should stone someone to death if that person blasphemed against Yahweh or said bad things about Yahweh.

The city leaders send a letter to Jezebel and let her know Naboth is dead. When Jezebel receives the news, she tells Ahab to get up and take possession of Naboth’s vineyard because Naboth is dead. Jezebel does not want Ahab to physically stand up, but rather, Jezebel is telling Ahab to do something.

Ahab gets up and takes possession of Naboth’s vineyard.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Ahab
- Naboth
- Jezebel
- Elders and nobles of Jezreel
- People of Jezreel
- And the two dishonest men

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

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Act out how King Ahab approaches Naboth and asks to buy Naboth's vineyard so that Ahab can plant vegetables. Ahab says he will give Naboth a better vineyard, or if Naboth likes, Ahab will pay Naboth the value of the vineyard in silver. Naboth strongly refuses the king and says that to sell his inheritance would insult Yahweh. King Ahab returns to his palace angry and upset. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am outraged. How dare Naboth refuse me, the king? I offered Naboth a very fair price; or
- I feel confused. Why is Naboth so emotional about a vineyard? Money can buy Naboth a new vineyard; or
- I am angry. I will find a way to get back at Naboth. I just do not know how yet.

Continue the drama. Act out how King Ahab lies in bed in his palace and refuses to eat. Ahab will not talk to anyone. When Jezebel hears that Ahab refuses to eat, Jezebel goes to Ahab's room and asks why Ahab is so upset. Ahab tells Jezebel the story of Naboth and how Naboth refused to sell his vineyard. Jezebel asks if this is how Ahab behaves as the king of Israel. Jezebel tells Ahab to get up and eat because she will show Ahab how to get Naboth's vineyard. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jezebel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel disgusted. My husband is weak. I will show Ahab how a proper king should act; or
- I am proud. I know how to get what I want. I will show my husband how to do the same; or
- I feel frustrated. I do not understand why Ahab wants to act like a child instead of a king.

Continue the drama. Act out how Jezebel writes letters using Ahab's name and seal. In the letters, Jezebel commands the city leaders of Jezreel to proclaim a day of fasting and to put Naboth in a place of honor. Jezebel instructs the leaders to seat two dishonest men beside Naboth to accuse Naboth of cursing Yahweh and the king. Jezebel orders the leaders to take Naboth outside the city and stone him to death.

Act out how the city leaders of Jezreel receive the king's instructions. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the city leaders, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We feel confused. Why would Ahab want such a thing? Naboth is a good man; or
- We are afraid. What choice do we have? That is the king's royal seal. We will die if we do not obey; or
- We feel conflicted. We know it is wrong, but we do not want to bring punishment on ourselves or our families.

Continue the drama. Act out how the city leaders follow the letter's instructions. The leaders proclaim a day of fasting, place Naboth in a seat of honor, and tell two dishonest men what to say about Naboth. The two men accuse Naboth of cursing Yahweh and the king. Then, the people take Naboth outside the city and stone him to death. The city leaders send a message to the king to report Naboth's death.

Act out how Jezebel hears that Naboth is dead. Jezebel tells Ahab the news and tells him to go take possession of the vineyard. Ahab immediately goes and takes over the vineyard. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am satisfied. Jezebel may be bossy, but at least I got what I wanted; or
- I am happy to let my wife kill Naboth for me. Maybe Yahweh will hold Jezebel responsible for Naboth's death; or
- I feel clever. No one knows what we have done.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Naboth owned a vineyard near the palace of Ahab. A vineyard is a garden where people grow grapes. Grapes are a soft, juicy fruit that grows on a tree called a grapevine. A vineyard usually has a wall around it so that wild animals or thieves cannot come into the garden. People made this wall out of rocks or thorny bushes.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **vineyard**. Look up vineyard in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

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King Ahab approaches Naboth and tells Naboth he wants to buy Naboth's vineyard to grow vegetables. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a country. King Ahab ruled over the nation of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Ahab goes back to his palace sullen and angry. "Palace" refers to Ahab's large house. Use the same word for palace as you used in previous passages.

Naboth strongly refuses the king and says **Yahweh** forbade him to give away the inheritance of his fathers. "Yahweh forbid" is special language that means Naboth is pronouncing a curse on himself from Yahweh if Naboth does what he is not supposed to do. This curse is a way to show disgust for something the person wants nothing to do with. Yahweh is the personal name of God that shows the close relationship between God and Israel. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Naboth refuses to give away the vineyard because it was the **inheritance** of his fathers. Naboth's ancestors had passed the vineyard down from generation to generation until it was given to Naboth. The vineyard belonged to Naboth through family possession. Use the same word or phrase for inheritance as you have used in previous passages.

After Ahab sulks in his palace, Ahab's wife asks him why he is so upset. After Ahab explains, Jezebel asks if Ahab is not the king over **Israel**. Here, Israel refers to the territory, or land, where the Israelites lived in the northern kingdom. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Jezebel uses the king's seal to send letters to the city **elders** and nobles in Jezreel. An elder refers to a family leader who helped make important community decisions. Nobles were wealthy landowners with certain rights that not all people had. Use the same word or phrase for elders as you used in previous passages. For more information on elders, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **nobles**. Pause this audio here.

Jezebel orders the city leaders to declare a day of fasting. When people fast, they do not eat or drink anything for a certain time. People fast for many reasons—because they feel sad, want to repent, or want to show humility to God. Most likely, this day of fasting was to be a special event where the people asked God for help or guidance. Fasting was a way to show God how serious the problem was. In this story, the problem was the false sin they claimed Naboth had done.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **fasting**. Look up fasting in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The two men accuse Naboth of cursing **God** and **cursing** the king. When a person curses God, insults God, dishonors God, or makes God seem less powerful or important, this is called blasphemy. The punishment for blasphemy was death. When you curse someone, you are wishing that something bad will happen to that person. Use the same words or phrases for God and for curse as you used in previous passages. For more information on God and curse, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (719 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 21:17–29

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 21:17–29 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:17–29 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:17–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, King Ahab was very upset when Naboth refused to sell Ahab his vineyard. Jezebel heard that King Ahab was so sad that he would not eat. So, Jezebel decided to fix the problem for Ahab. Jezebel made a plan to kill Naboth. Jezebel pretended to be King Ahab and sent letters to the leaders in Naboth's city. Jezebel told the leaders to stone Naboth to death, and they obeyed. Then Jezebel told Ahab to go and take possession of the vineyard. Ahab went right away.

After this, the word of Yahweh came to Elijah the Tishbite. As you remember, Elijah was a prophet from the town of Tishbe, in the region of Gilead. When we say "the word of Yahweh came to Elijah," it means Yahweh gave Elijah a message. This message was for King Ahab, who was acting badly. Yahweh tells Elijah to go and meet Ahab.

King Ahab was the ruler of Israel. Ahab ruled from the capital city called Samaria. But at this time, Ahab was in Naboth's vineyard in Jezreel. As you know, Ahab had just gone there to take possession of the vineyard after Jezebel made the leaders kill Naboth.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel that includes Tishbe, Samaria, and Jezreel. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Elijah to say, "This is what Yahweh says..." to introduce Yahweh's message to Ahab when Elijah speaks to Ahab. Elijah is to ask Ahab, "Have you killed and also taken someone's possession?" Yahweh is not really asking Ahab a question to find out the truth. Instead, Elijah's words are a way to point out clearly that Ahab has killed a man and taken control of his property, the vineyard. As you remember, a vineyard is a special garden where people grow grapes on vines.

Stop here and look at a picture of a vineyard as a group. Pause this audio here.

Elijah will then give a prophecy, which means a message from God about what will happen in the future. Elijah says that dogs will lick up Ahab's blood in the same place where dogs licked Naboth's blood after Naboth died. You will remember that Naboth died outside the city of Jezreel when the city leaders stoned Naboth to death. Elijah's prophecy will happen in parts. First, Ahab will die outside the city of Samaria, and dogs will lick Ahab's blood there. Later, Ahab's son Joram will also die, and people will leave his body on Naboth's land. The storyteller emphasizes that it will be Ahab's own blood that the dogs will lick up, which shows that Ahab will have the same punishment as Naboth.

Stop here and look at a picture of a dog as a group. Pause this audio here.

After Elijah hears Yahweh's message for Ahab, Elijah goes to Naboth's vineyard and delivers the message to Ahab directly. Ahab responds and says, "So you have found me, my enemy." Ahab's response is defensive when he calls Elijah his enemy. As you may remember, this is not the first time Elijah and Ahab have spoken. The last time Elijah and Ahab met, Yahweh sent fire from heaven and defeated the prophets of Baal. At that time, Ahab called Elijah the "troublemaker of Israel." Now Ahab goes even further and calls Elijah his personal enemy, because Elijah keeps bringing Yahweh's judgment to the wicked king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what happens when someone speaks the truth, even if it is hard to hear? How do people treat prophets or truth-tellers? What words do people use for someone who brings bad news or correction? Pause this audio here.

Elijah says he only came because Ahab chose to sell himself to do evil in Yahweh's eyes. In other words, Ahab gave himself fully to doing the things that Yahweh hates.

Then Elijah continues to tell Ahab Yahweh's message. Because of Ahab's wickedness, Yahweh says he will kill every male in Ahab's family, whether slave or free, in Israel. Yahweh says he will make Ahab's house, or family, like the family of Jeroboam, son of Nebat, and the family of Baasha, son of Ahijah. These two men, Jeroboam and Baasha, were kings who led the people to worship idols instead of Yahweh. Because of this, Yahweh allowed Jeroboam and Baasha's enemies to defeat them and kill all their descendants so their family lines would end. Yahweh says the same thing will happen to Ahab because Ahab has made Yahweh angry by causing the people of Israel to sin. Ahab did not force Israel to sin, but Ahab led Israel in a way that encouraged them to turn away from Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when a leader does wrong, how does it affect the people? How do people hold leaders responsible in your culture, and what happens to the people they lead when something goes wrong? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells Ahab that Jezebel will die, and dogs will eat Jezebel's body near the walls of Jezreel. In fact, the dogs will eat every one of Ahab's relatives who die in the city, and birds will eat the bodies of his relatives who die in the countryside. These birds were most likely vultures, which are birds that eat animals that are already dead. For the Israelites, it was very shameful for dogs and birds to eat a person's dead body. Israelites saw dogs as unclean or impure animals, and they considered it shameful not to receive a proper burial. A decent burial was an important way to honor and respect the dead. You will remember that earlier, the unnamed prophet just said that Ahab would die, but now Elijah talks about what happens when Ahab dies.

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The storyteller then begins to describe how evil Ahab really was. The storyteller says that no one else was as evil as Ahab, because Ahab gave himself completely to doing what Yahweh says is wrong. Jezebel persuaded Ahab to do evil, and Ahab chose to do things that were "vile," or disgusting, in Yahweh's eyes. Ahab worshiped idols, or false gods, instead of Yahweh. Ahab acted like the Amorites, the people who lived in the land before the Israelites conquered it.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your community talk about people who choose to do wrong over and over again? What words do people use to describe these kinds of people? Pause this audio here.

After explaining how evil Ahab was, the storyteller continues to tell his story.

When Ahab heard Elijah's message from Yahweh, Ahab tore his clothes, put on a sackcloth, and began to fast, or intentionally chose not to eat. Sackcloth was a rough, uncomfortable kind of cloth. In this culture, to tear your clothes and wear a sackcloth was a way to show that you were very sorry or deeply upset. Ahab even slept in a sackcloth and became quiet and sad. This was very different from how Ahab usually acted, because Ahab normally thought only about himself.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a person who wears a sackcloth. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then speaks to Elijah and asks, "Have you noticed how Ahab has humbled himself before me?" The word "humbled" means that Ahab made himself low or chose to submit to someone else. In this case, Ahab submits to Yahweh and shows that Ahab is sorry for what he has done. Because of this, Yahweh decides to show mercy to Ahab. That means Yahweh chooses not to punish Ahab right away, even though Ahab deserves it. Instead, Yahweh says he will wait and bring the punishment or judgment on Ahab's family later on, after Ahab dies.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:17–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Elijah to go and find Ahab in Naboth's vineyard. Ahab is there because he took possession of the vineyard after Jezebel had Naboth killed. Yahweh tells Elijah to say, "This is what Yahweh says: Have you not murdered a man and taken his land? In the same place where dogs licked Naboth's blood, they will lick your blood too."

In the second scene: Elijah finds Ahab in Naboth's vineyard. Ahab says, "So you have found me, my enemy!" Elijah says he has come because Ahab keeps disobeying Yahweh. Then Elijah gives Ahab Yahweh's full message. Yahweh says Ahab, Jezebel, and all of Ahab's male descendants will die. This will happen because Ahab caused the people of Israel to sin.

In the third scene: The storyteller pauses his story to explain how Ahab was more evil than anyone else. Ahab gave himself fully to doing wrong. Jezebel helped Ahab do evil. Ahab followed idols like the Amorites, the people who lived in the land before the Israelites. Yahweh had chased those people out, but Ahab acted just like them. Then the storyteller returns to his story.

In the fourth scene: Ahab hears Yahweh's message and humbles himself. Ahab wears a rough cloth when he lies down to sleep, fasts, and begins to live in a quiet and humble way.

In the fifth scene: Yahweh speaks to Elijah again and asks him if he has seen how Ahab has humbled himself. Yahweh says he will delay punishing Ahab because Ahab has humbled himself.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah
- Yahweh
- The storyteller
- And Ahab

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As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

When the storyteller says that the word of Yahweh came to Elijah, the storyteller is using special language to mean that Yahweh gave Elijah the words to say to King Ahab.

Ahab was the king of Israel, and Ahab ruled from the city of Samaria. But at this time, Ahab was in the city of Jezreel, where Naboth's vineyard was. As you remember, Jezebel had people kill Naboth. Then Jezebel told Ahab to take the vineyard for himself. So Ahab went to take possession of it. Yahweh tells Elijah to go and meet Ahab there.

Yahweh tells Elijah to tell Ahab exactly what Yahweh says. As part of Yahweh's instructions, Yahweh tells Elijah to say, "This is what Yahweh says," as a way to introduce the message from Yahweh. Elijah has to say that these are Yahweh's own words. Then Yahweh continues to tell Elijah the rest of his message for Ahab.

Yahweh tells Elijah to ask Ahab on his behalf, "Have you killed and also taken possession?"' And also to say, "In the place where dogs licked up the blood of Naboth, dogs will lick up your blood."'

Yahweh is not asking the question because Yahweh wants an answer, but rather to emphasize what Ahab has done and to make Ahab aware of his own actions. The action of killing was against Naboth, and the action of taking possession refers to how Ahab took Naboth's vineyard. It is good to notice how Yahweh's message emphasizes that Ahab will die.

It is also important to note that the storyteller does not tell us that Elijah gave Yahweh's whole message to Ahab. But it is most likely that Elijah did say everything Yahweh told him to say. The storyteller also does not tell us that Elijah traveled to the vineyard. But we know Elijah had to go to the vineyard in Jezreel to be able to talk to Ahab. Perhaps the storyteller leaves out small steps in the story because they are already clear to the listener.

When Ahab sees Elijah in the vineyard, he asks Elijah, "Have you found me, my enemy?" Ahab is not really asking a question. Ahab already knows the answer. Ahab says these words because he did not expect Elijah to find him. Ahab knows he has done something wrong. Ahab calls Elijah "my enemy" because Elijah speaks for Yahweh, and Yahweh is against what Ahab has done.

Elijah answers, "I have found you, because you have sold yourself to do what is evil in the sight of the Lord." It is important to be aware that Elijah is stating two situations. Elijah agrees that he discovered the wrong Ahab did. Elijah is also stating that Ahab has done what is evil in the sight of Yahweh, or in other words, Ahab has disobeyed Yahweh.

Elijah answers, "I have found you because you have sold yourself to do evil in the sight of the Lord." Elijah is saying two things here. First, Elijah says that he has found Ahab doing wrong.

Second, Elijah says Ahab has chosen to do what is evil in God's sight. When Elijah says Ahab "sold yourself," he means that everything Ahab chooses to do is evil. Ahab seems to be committed to doing wrong things all the time.

When Elijah gives Yahweh's message, Elijah speaks as if Elijah is Yahweh. It is important to note that the storyteller is not suggesting that Elijah is Yahweh. The storyteller uses this way of speaking to bring attention to the words of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss with your group: In your culture, how does someone deliver a message to emphasize who the sender of the message is? How would you give that message so that the receiver of the message would know who the message came from? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Ahab through Elijah, "I will bring disaster upon you. I will utterly burn you up and will cut off from Ahab every male, whether they are a slave or a free man, in Israel." It is important to understand that Yahweh is talking about this same Ahab, even though the storyteller sometimes seems to be talking about someone else.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will make Ahab's house like the houses of Jeroboam and Baasha. Yahweh is not talking about the physical houses of Ahab, Jeroboam, and Baasha, but about their families or descendants.

It is important to remember that Jeroboam was an Israelite king who continued to do things that made Yahweh angry. Because of Jeroboam's sin, Yahweh allowed Baasha to kill Jeroboam and become king. Then Baasha killed

all of Jeroboam's family, just as Yahweh said would happen. But Baasha followed the same evil path, leading Israel into more sin and causing Yahweh to be angry again. So Yahweh said that he would also destroy Baasha's family and descendants. When Yahweh compares Ahab to the two kings, Yahweh is warning Ahab that all of Ahab's descendants will die because of Ahab's sin.

Yahweh tells Ahab that Ahab has made Yahweh angry and made Israel to sin, or caused Israel to sin. It is important to notice that Ahab did not force the people of Israel to sin. Instead, Ahab led Israel in a way that made the people choose to sin on their own.

Yahweh also says Jezebel will die near the walls of Jezreel. As you remember, this was the city where the leaders followed the orders of Jezebel and stoned Naboth to death.

When Yahweh says, "Anyone belonging to Ahab who dies in the city the dogs will eat," Yahweh is talking about Ahab's male descendants.

After Elijah finishes giving Yahweh's message to Ahab, the storyteller stops the story for a moment and speaks directly to the listeners. The storyteller says that no king was as committed to doing evil, or disobeying Yahweh, as Ahab. This was because Ahab's wife, Jezebel, caused Ahab to worship idols, just like the Amorites did. The Amorites were people who lived in the land before Yahweh let the Israelites take it over. After describing how evil Ahab is, the storyteller returns to the story about Elijah and Ahab.

Ahab reacts to Yahweh's message by tearing his clothes, wearing sackcloth, and fasting. In Ahab's culture, all these actions showed that a person felt sorrow, humility, and regret.

Later, Yahweh speaks to Elijah again and asks if Elijah has noticed how Ahab has humbled himself. Yahweh is not really asking for information. Instead, Yahweh wants to emphasize the change in Ahab's behavior. Yahweh chooses to delay his punishment and not bring disaster during Ahab's lifetime, but to bring disaster on Ahab's son.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:17–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elijah
- Yahweh
- The storyteller
- And Ahab

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out how Yahweh gives a message to Elijah for King Ahab. Yahweh wants Elijah to go and find Ahab in Naboth's vineyard. Yahweh wants Elijah to confront Ahab about killing Naboth for his vineyard. Elijah needs to tell Ahab

1 Kings 21:17–29

that Ahab will die and dogs will lick up his blood as punishment for what Ahab has done. Elijah obeys Yahweh and goes to find Ahab in Naboth's vineyard.

Act out how Elijah arrives at Naboth's vineyard and finds Ahab there taking possession of it. Ahab says, "So you have found me, my enemy!" Elijah tells Ahab he has come because Ahab continues to disobey Yahweh. Then Elijah speaks on Yahweh's behalf and gives Ahab Yahweh's whole message. Yahweh says Ahab, Jezebel, and all of Ahab's male descendants will die because Ahab caused Israel to sin. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am shocked. I never imagined my actions could affect not just myself but all of my descendants! What have I done? or
- I feel distressed. What am I going to do? How can I make this right again? or
- I feel regret. I can not believe I have been caught again. Why did I listen to Jezebel?

Continue the drama. Now, act out how the storyteller pauses his story to tell everyone how evil Ahab truly was. The storyteller says Jezebel caused Ahab to follow idols just as the Amorites used to before the Israelites drove them out of the land. Then the storyteller keeps telling his story about Elijah and Ahab. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the storyteller, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Ahab was truly the worst out of all the Israelite kings; or
- How could Ahab have let his wife rule in his place, lead Ahab to worship idols, and cause Ahab to allow murder and theft? or
- Yahweh gave Ahab so many chances to change his evil ways, but unfortunately, Ahab never really followed Yahweh.

Continue the drama. Act out how Ahab hears Yahweh's message and humbles himself. Ahab puts on a rough cloth and wears it even when he lies down to sleep. Ahab fasts and begins to live in a quiet and humble way.

Act out how Yahweh speaks to Elijah again and asks him if he has seen how Ahab humbled himself. Yahweh says he will delay his punishment because Ahab has humbled himself before Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I see that Ahab regrets what he has done. I will show mercy and delay Ahab's punishment; or
- I love Ahab as my creation, but I will not force him to follow me; or
- I am all-knowing. I know the plans I have for all of my people.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 21:17–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The **word of Yahweh** comes to Elijah. The word of God means everything that Yahweh tells people. Yahweh either speaks directly to the people or through people called prophets. In this case, Yahweh gave a message of judgment to Elijah the prophet for King Ahab. Use the same word or phrase for "word of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages. For more information on word, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells Elijah to go and meet the **king** of **Israel**. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a country. King Ahab ruled over the nation of Israel. Here, Israel refers to the territory, or land, where the Israelites lived in the northern kingdom. Use the same words or phrases for king and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on king and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

King Ahab ruled all of Israel from **Samaria**. In the Old Testament, Samaria was the capital city of the northern kingdom of Israel. One of Ahab's palaces was located in Samaria. Use the same word or phrase for Samaria as you used in previous passages. For more information on Samaria, refer to the Master Glossary.

Elijah found Ahab in Naboth's **vineyard**, where Ahab was claiming it as his own. A vineyard is a garden where people grow grapes. Grapes are a soft, juicy fruit that grows on a tree called a grapevine. Use the same word or phrase for vineyard as you used in previous passages. For more information on vineyard, refer to the Master Glossary.

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Elijah begins his message by saying, "**Yahweh** says…." Yahweh is the personal name of God that shows the close relationship between God and Israel. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ahab greets Elijah as his enemy, and Elijah says he only came because Ahab was doing **evil in the eyes of Yahweh**. When someone does evil, they willingly do bad things that hurt other people. When people stop obeying God, those people begin to do evil things. Use the same word or phrase for evil as you used in previous passages. For more information on evil, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrase for doing evil "in the eyes of Yahweh" as you have used before.

Yahweh says he will bring disaster, or evil, on Ahab's descendants and that they will all die, whether they are free men or **slaves**. If a servant does not get paid for his work and does not have the freedom to leave his master when he wants, then the servant is called a slave. A slave is the property of a master. The master can sell the slave to someone else, just as he can sell his other property. Use the same word or phrase for slave as you used in previous passages. For more information on slave, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says he will make Ahab's house like the houses of Jeroboam and Baasha. Both of these kings disobeyed God, and all of their descendants were killed. Here, "house" refers to the household. Yahweh is talking about the family of Ahab, all of the people who lived in Ahab's house. Use the same word or phrase for house as you used in previous passages. For more information on household, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ahab has **provoked**, or caused, Yahweh to be angry. Use the same word or phrase for provoke, or cause, as you have used in previous passages.

Yahweh blames Ahab for causing Israel to **sin**, or disobey Yahweh. Sin is any act of rebellion against God. Anytime that a person disobeys God's laws, they sin. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says the dogs will eat the bodies of Ahab's descendants in the streets, and the birds of **heaven** will eat the bodies of his descendants in the fields. Here, heaven refers to the sky. Use the same word or phrase for heaven, meaning sky, as you used in previous passages. For more information on heaven, refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller tells how evil Ahab was for following **idols** like the Amorites did. Idols are objects that people make in order to worship a god. The object reminds the people of some characteristics of this god. People make an object, an image of a god, and worship that object as if it were that god. People could make such an object out of stone, wood, or metal. Use the same word or phrase for idol as you used in previous passages. For more information on idol, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh gave the sons of Israel, or the **Israelites**, victory over the Amorites when the Israelites conquered the land. The sons of Israel is a way to say the "descendants of Israel," and it is the usual way to talk about the Israelite people. Use the same word or phrase for Israelites as you have used in previous passages. "Israelites" is in the Master Glossary.

When Ahab hears Yahweh's message, he puts on a sackcloth and **fasts** before Yahweh. When someone fasts, they intentionally do not eat or drink anything for a certain amount of time. People fasted for different reasons—because they were sad, wanted to repent, or show humility to God. Use the same words or phrases for sackcloth and fasting as you used in previous passages. For more information on fasting, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 21:17–29

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (726 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Kings 22:1–12

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 22:1–12 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:1–12 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous two stories, the storyteller told us about times when Yahweh's prophets told the king of Israel that the king was doing the wrong thing. In the first story, the storyteller does not name the prophet and the king of Israel. In the second story, the storyteller tells a story about Elijah the prophet and Ahab, the king of Israel. In this third story, it is possible that somebody took two stories from different times and mixed them together. It is possible that one storyteller took the story of Micaiah the prophet and put it with a story of Ahab, the king of Israel. You will notice that this story does not always name the king of Israel. Most people think that the king

of Israel in this story is Ahab, but it is possible that parts of the story relate to a different king of Israel. In any case, it is clear that the storyteller wants to tell a story about Ahab.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What stories do you know that have changed over time? Why might people change stories or mix stories together? Pause this audio here.

We can also find this story in 2 Chronicles 18:1–11, where a different storyteller tells the story. There are a few differences between this story in 1 Kings and the other telling of the story in 2 Chronicles. The storyteller of 2 Chronicles names the king of Israel as Ahab.

Stop here and listen to your translation of 2 Chronicles 18:1–11 if possible. Pause this audio here.

This story probably happens less than three years after Ben-Hadad, the king of Aram, and Ahab, the king of Israel, made an agreement to stop fighting. You will remember that Syria is the modern-day name for Aram, and the Aramean people are the same people as the Syrian people. At the time of the storyteller, people counted part of a year as a full year. The people of Aram and the people of Israel do not fight for two years and a part of a third year. In the third year, Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, goes from Jerusalem in Judah to the king of Israel in Samaria in Israel. Before Jehoshaphat visits the king of Israel, the king of Israel speaks to his officials. The king of Israel asks his officials a question that he does not expect them to answer about Ramoth, a city in Gilead. In the agreement between Ben-Hadad and Ahab, Ben-Hadad had agreed to give Ramoth back to Ahab. But Ben-Hadad did not give it back, and the king of Israel wants it. The king and the people of Israel are not doing anything to take the city back and make it part of Israel again.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of the kingdoms of Israel, Judah, and Aram and find the cities of Ramoth in Gilead and Samaria. Pause this audio here.

Jehoshaphat, king of Judah, visits the king of Israel in Samaria. We do not know why Jehoshaphat goes to Samaria. When Jehoshaphat is with the king of Israel, the king of Israel asks Jehoshaphat to fight with Israel against the people from Aram in Ramoth Gilead. The king of Israel wants the two armies to fight together against Ramoth Gilead. Jehoshaphat answers to say that everything that the king of Judah is and everything that belongs to Judah are the same or joined with everything that belongs to the king of Israel. The people of both kingdoms are like people of one kingdom, and the horses that Judah uses for fighting are like the horses in Israel. You may remember that a horse is a large animal. People ride on horses and use horses to pull war chariots.

Stop here and look at a picture of a horse as a group. Pause this audio here.

The two kingdoms have a close relationship; Jehoshaphat's son is married to Ahab's daughter.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When a son from one family marries a daughter from another family, how does the relationship between the two families change? Talk about times when one family helped another family because the families were related by marriage. Pause this audio here.

Jehoshaphat says that he will help the king of Israel, but Jehoshaphat wants to follow Yahweh and know what Yahweh thinks about the plan to take back Ramoth Gilead.

The king of Israel calls together a large group of people who work as prophets. The prophets were people who said they spoke messages from God. It is possible that the prophets all served the king of Israel. The king of Israel asks the prophets if the king of Israel should fight or not fight Ramoth Gilead. All the prophets tell the king of Israel to go and fight because God will give the city to the king of Israel. The king of Israel will have control and power over Ramoth Gilead. The prophets do not use the personal name for God, Yahweh. The prophets use the name of Adonai in the original language. Adonai means "God who is the master and creator." Jehoshaphat does not trust the answers from the prophets. This might be because the prophets use a different and less personal name for God. It is also possible that Jehoshaphat might not trust the prophets because they all give the same answer.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when someone said they spoke from God, but when you heard what the person said, you did not believe that person. Pause this audio here.

Jehoshaphat asks the king of Israel if there is a prophet of Yahweh to ask about the battle plans. Jehoshaphat does not know if any prophets of Yahweh still live in the kingdom of Israel. The king of Israel tells Jehoshaphat that there is one prophet whom the kings can use to talk to Yahweh. The king of Israel tells Jehoshaphat that the

king of Israel does not like the one prophet of Yahweh. The one prophet of Yahweh prophesies or speaks from God about bad things for the king of Israel. The prophet is called Micaiah, who is the son of Imlah. Jehoshaphat tells the king of Israel that the king of Israel should not say that he hates a prophet of Yahweh. The king of Israel asks one of his officials to bring Micaiah to the kings.

The story moves to a different place. The two kings wear special clothes or robes that show they are kings. Special servants made the robes from fine material and decorated the robes with special signs and patterns.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What special clothes or decorations does your king or most important leader wear to show that they are the king? Pause this audio here.

The kings are sitting on their thrones, their special seats. The kings are at the threshing floor near the gate of the city of Samaria. The threshing floor is an open area with a flat, level, stone surface. People went to the threshing floor to beat or break the outer coating off the grains of wheat or other grains.

Stop here and look at a picture of people using a threshing floor to separate wheat grains from other parts of the plant. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What open spaces do your leaders use for special times when they are with your people? Are these spaces inside or outside of buildings, or inside or outside of the cities or towns? Pause this audio here.

The threshing floor is probably outside the city gate so that the wind can blow away the grain's light outer coating. Big walls surrounded the city of Samaria to protect the city. People used big gates in the city walls to go in and out of the city.

Stop here and look at a picture of a city gate in the wall of a city. Pause this audio here.

There is a lot of space for people at the threshing floor. You will remember that in David's time, two important events with the ark of the covenant happened on a threshing floor. The kings probably think the threshing floor is an important place to hear from God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What special place or places do people go to in your city or the place where you live to hear from God? Pause this audio here.

The prophets are with the kings and are giving their messages and talking, or possibly dancing and shouting. One of the prophets is called Zedekiah and is the son of Kenaanah. Kenaanah is probably the father of Zedekiah. Zedekiah made horns from iron. Iron is a hard metal, and people use iron to make tools and weapons. Zedekiah probably shaped the iron to look like the horns on a bull, an adult male cow.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bull with horns and imagine the horns made from iron. Pause this audio here.

Sometimes bulls are dangerous. If a bull attacks a person, the bull hits a person with its horns and pushes its horns into the person's body. If a bull hurts a person with its horn, the person might die. Zedekiah probably put the iron horns on a helmet. Zedekiah tells the king of Israel that Yahweh said the king of Israel would use the horns to gore or make a big, bloody hole in the Arameans. The king would destroy or completely defeat the Arameans. Zedekiah probably gives the helmet to the king as a symbol of the words. You might remember that Zedekiah's words are very similar to the blessing Moses gave to the tribes descended from Joseph in Deuteronomy 33:17. But Zedekiah does not say that the king must be faithful to Yahweh like Moses said the tribes should be.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Listen to Deuteronomy 33:17 in your own language if you have translated it into your own language. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that all the other prophets at the threshing floor say the same thing as Zedekiah. All the prophets encourage the king of Israel to attack the Arameans at Ramoth Gilead and win the battle. The prophets say Yahweh will give Ramoth Gilead into the king of Israel's hand, or into the king's power.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 22:1–12

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us that there was peace between Aram and Israel. In the third year of peace, Jehoshaphat visits the king of Israel.

In the second scene: Before Jehoshaphat arrives, the king of Israel reminds his officials that the king of Aram controls Ramoth Gilead.

In the third scene: The king of Israel asks Jehoshaphat to help take control of Ramoth Gilead. Jehoshaphat agrees to help fight the Arameans but asks the king of Israel to ask Yahweh what to do first.

In the fourth scene: The king of Israel asks about 400 prophets if Israel should fight Ramoth Gilead. The prophets say God will give control of Ramoth Gilead to the king of Israel. Jehoshaphat wants to consult one of Yahweh's prophets. The king of Israel does not like the prophet of Yahweh because the prophet of Yahweh does not say good things about the king of Israel. The prophet of Yahweh is called Micaiah. Jehoshaphat tells the king of Israel not to say bad things about Micaiah. The king of Israel asks officials to bring Micaiah.

In the fifth scene: As the kings wait for Micaiah to arrive, the two kings sit outside the city of Samaria with many prophets in front of them. One of the prophets, Zedekiah, has iron horns like a bull. Zedekiah says Yahweh says the kings will defeat the Arameans with the iron horns. The prophets make a loud noise and tell the kings to attack Aram at Ramoth Gilead because the kings will win the battle.

The characters in this passage are:

- The king of Israel
- Jehoshaphat, king of Judah
- Officials of Israel
- 400 prophets
- And Zedekiah, son of Kenaanah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story does not follow on directly from the previous story. This story is the beginning of another story about a prophet who tells the king of Israel that the king of Israel is not doing what Yahweh wants the king to do. After the war between Aram and Israel, the two countries did not fight for nearly three years. The peace did not last for exactly three years. The war stopped in the first year, there was no fighting in the second year, and in the third year, Jehoshaphat went to see the king of Israel. Jehoshaphat went down from Jerusalem, which was on top of a hill, to Samaria, which was lower down. Samaria was north of Jerusalem.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about times you have travelled around your country, particularly from high to low areas. How will you translate Jehoshaphat going down from Jerusalem to Samaria? Pause this audio here.

Before Jehoshaphat arrives in Samaria, the king of Israel speaks to his officials. The officials are special servants who advise the king and help the king to make important decisions about Israel. The king asks the officials if the officials know Ramoth Gilead belongs to Israel. The king knows that the officials know the city belongs to Israel. The king does not expect the officials to answer him. The king asks the question to show his frustration that the king of Aram did not give Ramoth Gilead back to the king of Israel. The storyteller uses this scene to tell us that the king is thinking about attacking Ramoth Gilead to get control of the city back from the Arameans.

Stop here and look at a map that shows Israel and the cities of Samaria and Ramoth Gilead, if needed. Pause this audio here.

When Jehoshaphat arrives in Samaria, the king of Israel talks to Jehoshaphat. The king of Israel wants to know if Jehoshaphat will help the king of Israel fight the Arameans in Ramoth Gilead. Jehoshaphat tells the king of Israel that the king of Israel can use everything that belongs to Jehoshaphat. The king of Israel can use Jehoshaphat's people and horses in the same way as the king of Israel uses his own people and horses. In the same conversation with the king of Israel, Jehoshaphat says that the king of Israel should ask Yahweh for advice and wisdom before

going to fight. The king of Israel listens to Jehoshaphat and calls for prophets. Prophets are people who bring messages from gods. You will remember from earlier stories that not all prophets bring messages from Yahweh. About 400 prophets come to the kings. The prophets were probably men and women. The king of Israel asks the prophets if the king should go to war against the people in Ramoth Gilead or not go to war. The prophets reply to the king of Israel and tell the king of Israel to attack. The prophets say that God will give Ramoth Gilead into the king's hand. The prophets use the word "hand" to symbolise power. The prophets say the king of Israel will have power over Ramoth Gilead. The prophets do not call God by his personal name but use a different name that means lord, master, and God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the different names for God to show the different ways that Jehoshaphat and the prophets talk about Yahweh or God? Pause this audio here.

Jehoshaphat listens to the prophets. Jehoshaphat does not think that the prophets tell the kings a message from Yahweh. Jehoshaphat knows that there were prophets of Yahweh in Samaria, but does not know if there is a prophet of Yahweh in Samaria at this time. Jehoshaphat wants to ask for advice from a prophet of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you ask someone politely if a person is in a town or village if you do not know if they are still there or if they have gone away? Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel tells Jehoshaphat about the one prophet of Yahweh who is in Israel. The king of Israel says that he hates the prophet and sees the prophet as an enemy. The prophet's messages for the king of Israel are never good. The king of Israel names the prophet as Micaiah, son of Imlah. Jehoshaphat tells the king of Israel that the king of Israel should not speak in that way. The king of Israel should not say bad things about Micaiah because he is a prophet of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you tell somebody not to say bad things about another person? Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel asked one of his officials to come to him and asked the official to bring Micaiah to the kings.

The story changes to a different scene. Many people think that a different storyteller told this part of the story about a different time, probably from the time of King Ahab. Somebody put the two stories together to try to make one story. While the kings are waiting for Micaiah to arrive, the two kings are now sitting together outside the gates of Samaria at an open space where the people of Samaria can thresh or beat their grain. The kings are wearing special clothes and sitting on special seats, called thrones. We do not know how much time has passed between the first time the prophets gathered and this time at the threshing floor. All the prophets make a lot of noise and dance and chant as they prophesy. One prophet is called Zedekiah. Zedekiah has made two horns from iron. Zedekiah says that Yahweh has a message. When Zedekiah says "you," it is only to one person, the king of Israel. As a bull gores with its horns, so will the king of Israel push or gore the men of Aram until the king destroys them.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a bull with horns, if needed. Pause this audio here.

At the threshing floor, in front of the kings, all the prophets are saying similar things. All the prophets tell the king of Israel to attack Ramoth Gilead and win. Yahweh will give Ramoth Gilead into the hand or the power of the king of Israel. The prophets use polite language and do not address the king directly. The prophets do not tell Jehoshaphat to attack.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The king of Israel

1 Kings 22:1–12

- Jehoshaphat, king of Judah
- Officials of Israel
- 400 prophets
- And Zedekiah, son of Kenaanah

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The storyteller tells us that there was peace between Aram and Israel. In the third year of peace, Jehoshaphat visits the king of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the king of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want Jehoshaphat to visit me so I can talk about plans for Israel; or
- Peace is good, but Aram did not do everything they said they would do.

Ask the person playing Jehoshaphat, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to have a good relationship with the king of Israel; or
- I wonder what the king of Israel is thinking and if he has plans?

Continue the drama. Before Jehoshaphat arrives, the king of Israel reminds his officials that the king of Aram controls Ramoth Gilead. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the king of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am frustrated and cross with Aram; or
- I want Ramoth Gilead back. Ramoth Gilead should be part of Israel; or
- It is time to do something to make Ramoth Gilead part of Israel again.

Ask the person playing the officials of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are worried because our king is angry; or
- We know Aram did not give back Ramoth Gilead when we made peace with the king of Aram; or
- Will we go to war again?

Continue the drama. The king of Israel asks Jehoshaphat to help take control of Ramoth Gilead. Jehoshaphat agrees to help fight the Arameans but asks the king of Israel to consult Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the king of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want Jehoshaphat to help me get control of Ramoth Gilead and make it part of Israel again; or
- I am happy that Jehoshaphat wants to help me; or
- I have lots of prophets who will bring messages to me from God. I do not care which god they talk to.

Ask the person playing Jehoshaphat, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to help the king of Israel because our families are connected; or
- It is important to consult Yahweh. I do not want to fight if Yahweh does not tell us to fight; or
- I am worried that the king of Israel does not care about Yahweh.

Continue the drama. The king of Israel asks about 400 prophets if Israel should fight Ramoth Gilead. The prophets say God will give control of Ramoth Gilead to the king of Israel. Jehoshaphat wants to ask one of Yahweh's

prophets. The king of Israel does not like the prophet of Yahweh because the prophet of Yahweh does not say good things about the king of Israel. The prophet of Yahweh is called Micaiah. Jehoshaphat tells the king of Israel not to say bad things about Micaiah. The king of Israel asks officials to bring Micaiah. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the king of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am excited. All the prophets say that I should attack Ramoth Gilead. God is with me and will give me the victory; or
- Why does Jehoshaphat care about Yahweh? Yahweh's prophet never says anything good to me. I do not want to talk to him; or
- If I want Jehoshaphat to help me, I will need to get Micaiah to come and prophesy.

Ask the person playing the 400 prophets, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yes, go and fight Ramoth Gilead; or
- You, the king of Israel, are powerful. Of course, you will win; or
- The king is very powerful. We want to tell the king something that will make him happy; or
- Listen to all of us. We can tell you what God is saying.

Ask the person playing Jehoshaphat, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- There are so many prophets, but I do not think they speak messages from Yahweh; or
- I do not trust these prophets; or
- I must hear from Yahweh before I go with Israel and take my army to fight Aram; or
- The king of Israel does not respect Micaiah, Yahweh's prophet. I do not like what the king of Israel says about Micaiah.

Ask the person playing the officials of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Quick, we need to go and find Micaiah; or
- We wonder what Micaiah will say this time. We hope Micaiah does not make our king angry.

Continue the drama. As the kings wait for Micaiah to arrive, the two kings sit outside the city of Samaria with many prophets in front of them. One of the prophets, Zedekiah, has iron horns like a bull. Zedekiah says Yahweh says the kings will defeat the Arameans with the iron horns. The prophets make a loud noise and tell the kings to attack Aram at Ramoth Gilead because the kings will win the battle. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jehoshaphat, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- What a noise and strange sight. Are these men speaking from Yahweh or something else? or
- This man, Zedekiah, is sure that Israel will win the battle; or
- I need to hear from a prophet who speaks messages from Yahweh.

Ask the person playing the king of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- All these prophets are saying the same thing. They must be right! or
- I feel excited and very important. Zedekiah says that I will win if I fight at Ramoth Gilead; or
- Look at the iron horns that Zedekiah wears! I will push back and hurt the Arameans like a bull pushes and hurts people.

Ask the person playing Zedekiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Look at me! I know that Israel will be strong and dangerous like a bull; or
- Listen to me and my message. It is time for Israel to take back Ramoth Gilead; or
- The other prophets say the same as me. I feel powerful and excited.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22: 1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

1 Kings 22:1–12

For three years, there was no **war** between **Israel** and **Aram**. Use the same words or phrases for war, Israel, and Aram as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

The **king** of Israel talked to his **officials**. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary. The officials are important people who serve the king and help run the country. The officials are not domestic servants. Use the same word or phrase for officials as you used in previous passages.

Jehoshaphat, king of **Judah**, said that his **horses** were Israel's horses. Use the same words or phrases for Judah and horses as you used in previous passages. For more information on Judah, refer to the Master Glossary.

Jehoshaphat told the king of Israel to seek counsel, or a "**word**," from **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the personal name for God. In this passage, the storyteller calls the God of Israel Yahweh. Be sure to translate Yahweh in the same way as you have in previous passages, and remember that Yahweh is in the Master Glossary. When Yahweh gives a word, he gives a message. Jehoshaphat wanted Yahweh to give Yahweh's word, or message, to them. Use the same word or phrase for word, or counsel, from Yahweh as you have used in previous passages, and refer to word in the Master Glossary for more information.

The king of Israel gathered the **prophets**. Use the same word or phrase for prophets as you used in previous passages. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

The prophets say that the "**Lord**," their word for the most powerful being, will give Aram to the king of Israel. In the original language, the prophets use the word "Adonai" for God. Use the same word or phrase for Lord as you used in previous passages. For more information on Lord and Adonai, refer to the Master Glossary.

God will give Ramoth Gilead into the king's **hand** or into the king's power. Use the same word or phrase for "into the king's hand," when it means into the king's power, as you used in previous passages.

The king of Israel says that Micaiah never **prophesies** anything good about the king. Use the same word or phrase for prophesies as you used in previous passages. For more information on prophesy, refer to the Master Glossary.

The kings are dressed in **royal robes** or clothes. Something is royal if a king or their close family uses the item. Use the same words or phrases for royal and robes as you used in previous passages. For more information on robes, refer to the Master Glossary.

The kings sit on their **thrones** or special seats. Use the same word or phrase for thrones as you used in previous passages.

The kings are at the threshing floor, the open space for people to separate grains from the outer parts of the plant.

Stop here and look at a picture of people using a threshing floor to separate wheat grains from other parts of the plant. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **threshing floor**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The threshing floor is next to the entrance of the **gate** to the city. Use the same word or phrase for gate as you used in previous passages.

Zedekiah made **iron** horns. Zedekiah made from iron two horns like the horns on a bull. Use the same word or phrase for iron as you used in previous passages. The horns were not musical instruments.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bull with horns. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **horns**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Zedekiah tells the kings that Yahweh says the kings will gore or badly wound the **Arameans** with the horns. Use the same word or phrase for Arameans as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **gore**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 22:1–12

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1017 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 22:13–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 22:13–28 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:13–28 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:13–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This passage follows on from the previous passage. The storyteller is telling us a story about the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, who consult prophets to find out if the kings and their fighting men should fight the Arameans at Ramoth Gilead. The kings and the prophets are at the city of Samaria in the kingdom of Israel. Syria is another name for Aram. Aramean people are the same people as Syrian people.

Stop here and look at a map of the kingdom of Israel and western Aram and find the cities of Samaria and Ramoth Gilead. Pause this audio here.

This story is made of two stories. Two different storytellers told stories about Micaiah and the kings at different times. One person put the two stories together. You will remember from the previous passage that one storyteller told a story about king Ahab of Israel. Another storyteller told a story about a king of Israel who was probably a different person. Many years later, another storyteller took the story from this book of 1 Kings and retold the story in the book of 2 Chronicles. There are a few differences between this story in 1 Kings and the other telling of the story in 2 Chronicles.

Stop here and listen to your translation of 2 Chronicles 18:9–27 in your own language, if possible. Pause this audio here.

At the beginning of this passage, the story continues from the time the kings are sitting at the threshing floor outside Samaria. Many people think that the second storyteller wrote this part of the story. A messenger, a person who carries a message, went to order Micaiah to come to the kings. The messenger speaks to Micaiah and tells Micaiah to pay special attention and know that all the prophets are saying the same thing. The prophets are all saying what the king of Israel wants to hear. The messenger tells Micaiah to give a message like the other prophets and say what the king wants to hear. Micaiah replies to the messenger and uses the words of a strong oath or promise. Micaiah promises to the messenger that Micaiah will only say what Yahweh wants Micaiah to say.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when someone has told you to say something to keep another person happy. Maybe the person asked you to say something that was not true or to leave out some important information. Why did the person not want you to say the truth? Pause this audio here.

Micaiah comes to the king of Israel. The king of Israel asks Micaiah the same question that he asked to the 400 prophets. Micaiah answers with the same answer as the 400 prophets although Micaiah says Yahweh, not God, will give Ramoth Gilead to the king. Micaiah does not mean what he says. The king of Israel knew that Micaiah was not giving a true prophecy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when you heard someone talk, and you knew that the person did not mean what they said. The way they said it showed that they did not expect people to believe them. How did the person sound when they said the untrue thing? Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel is frustrated with Micaiah. The king rebukes Micaiah for not telling the truth. We do not know when or if Micaiah has told the king other things that are not true.

Micaiah answers the king of Israel's question with what Micaiah saw in a vision. We do not know when Micaiah saw this vision. Yahweh sends a vision to Micaiah to be a message for people. Micaiah saw the people of Israel spread out all over a hill. Micaiah uses special language to describe how the people look on the hill. Micaiah says the people look like a group of sheep who do not have a shepherd. Sheep live in open places with lots of grass and small plants. Normally, a shepherd works to keep sheep together to help protect the sheep and move them from one place to another. When no shepherd is with sheep, the sheep wander all over the place, do not stay together, and are not safe. Micaiah sees people, not sheep. The people who listen to Micaiah are used to seeing sheep on hills and know that it is wrong for a group of sheep to not have a shepherd.

Stop here and look at a picture of a group of sheep on a hillside and imagine the sheep all over the hillside instead of together in a group. Pause this audio here.

1 Kings 22:13–28

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If you see a group of people scattered over a large area, what might you compare those people to? How would you help someone understand what the group of people looked like? Pause this audio here.

Micaiah tells the king what Yahweh says to Micaiah. Yahweh says the people have no master, no person to tell them what to do and look after them. Yahweh says that each person is to go home in peace or safely and not fight.

The king of Israel then talks to Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah. The king of Israel uses a question that he does not expect Jehoshaphat to answer. The king of Israel asks, “Did I not tell you that Micaiah never prophesies anything good about me?” The king of Israel uses the question to say that Micaiah has done just what the king of Israel expected Micaiah to do.

Micaiah tells the king of Israel about another vision from Yahweh. Micaiah tells the king of Israel to hear a message from Yahweh. Micaiah talks about a vision. We do not know when Micaiah saw the vision. In the vision, Micaiah saw Yahweh sitting on a throne, a special seat for a king. Many heavenly beings stood around Yahweh on all sides of the throne. Yahweh asked the heavenly beings to say who will go to Ahab, the king of Israel, and try to persuade Ahab to attack Ramoth Gilead. Yahweh said that Ahab will die if Ahab attacks Ramoth Gilead. The heavenly beings gave different responses to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time someone asked a group of people to do something that they did not want to do or would find it difficult to do. How did the group of people respond? What did the people say to each other or the person who asked the question? Pause this audio here.

In the vision, a “spirit,” a heavenly being, stood in front of Yahweh and said it will entice the king of Israel. The spirit is a supernatural being who lives and serves Yahweh in heaven. The spirit is not the Holy Spirit or a demon. The spirit said it will be a deceiving spirit in the mouths of the king of Israel’s prophets. Someone who deceives a person makes a person believe something that is not true. The spirit made the prophets believe what the prophets said. Yahweh knew that the spirit would persuade Ahab to attack Ramoth Gilead. Micaiah tells the king of Israel that Yahweh sent the spirit who made the prophets tell Ahab to attack Ramoth Gilead. Yahweh has decided and declared that Ahab will have a terrible end.

Zedekiah, the son of Kenaanah, is angry. Zedekiah slaps Micaiah on the face to insult Micaiah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What ways do people use to insult other people in your community? Pause this audio here.

Zedekiah also uses a question that he does not expect Micaiah to answer. Zedekiah asks how or why the spirit of Yahweh has gone from Zedekiah to Micaiah. Zedekiah is not talking about the Holy Spirit or a demon. Zedekiah is talking about a spiritual being who carries the message from Yahweh. Zedekiah does not think that Micaiah has replaced Zedekiah as the main person to receive messages from Yahweh. Zedekiah thinks that he is better than Micaiah. Micaiah responds to Zedekiah and tells Zedekiah that Zedekiah will know the answer to his question on a day in the future. In the future, there would be a time when Zedekiah would hide in the most protected room inside a building or in the middle of the city. This may be when the Arameans defeat the Israelites or a time when Zedekiah hides from Israelites because Zedekiah gives false prophecies to the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If you want to hide from people who want to hurt you, where would you go to hide? Pause this audio here.

After Micaiah told the king a prophecy that the king did not like, the king of Israel gives an order to his official. The king of Israel tells the official to take Micaiah away and take him back to Amon and Joash. Amon was the governor or the most important official of the city of Samaria. We do not know if Joash was a son of the king. The king’s son might be a special title for someone who is a royal official and responsible for safety in the city.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Who in your community is responsible to look after the safety of your people? What title or special name, if any, do they have? Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel commands Amon and Joash to put Micaiah in prison. A prison is a strong building. If an official puts a person in a prison, the person cannot leave the building. People will guard the person in the prison and there are locks or barriers on the door to stop the person from opening the door and leaving.

1 Kings 22:13–28

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your community, what do you do with people who disobey the rules in your community or who might be a danger to other people in the community? Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel orders Amon and Joash to only feed Micaiah enough food, or bread, and water for Micaiah to stay alive. In Israel, bread that people make from wheat flour was not a special food.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you do with people who disobey your most important leader and say bad things about your most important leader? Pause this audio here.

The king wants the order to last until the time the king of Israel returns safely from attacking Ramoth Gilead.

Micaiah responds to the king of Israel's order to say that if the king comes back safely from the battle, Yahweh did not speak through Micaiah. Micaiah uses the outcome of the battle to show the people of Israel if Micaiah is a prophet of Yahweh or a false prophet. Micaiah then speaks to everyone who can hear him. Micaiah tells everybody to hear the warning from Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:13–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The messenger tells Micaiah to give the king the same prophecy as the other prophets. Micaiah says he will say what Yahweh tells him to say.

In the second scene: Micaiah says the false prophecy, but the king of Israel knows Micaiah is not giving a prophecy from Yahweh. Micaiah speaks about a vision from Yahweh where Micaiah sees Israelites who have lost their leader. The king of Israel is angry.

In the third scene: Micaiah speaks about another vision where Yahweh wants a spirit to persuade Ahab to attack Ramoth Gilead. Yahweh says Ahab will die if Ahab attacks Ramoth Gilead. A spirit agrees to deceive the king. Micaiah tells the king and everyone around the king that Yahweh put a spirit in the prophets to speak false prophecies. Zedekiah slaps and insults Micaiah. Micaiah says Zedekiah will understand one day in the future when Zedekiah hides away in an inner room.

In the fourth scene: The king of Israel orders people to take Micaiah back to Amon and Joash, and for Amon and Joash to put Micaiah in prison with basic food and water until the king of Israel returns from attacking Ramoth Gilead. Micaiah says if the king returns, Yahweh did not speak through Micaiah, and Micaiah warns everyone to listen to the prophecy.

The characters in this passage are:

- A messenger
- Micaiah
- King of Israel
- Yahweh
- Heavenly beings
- A spirit, one of the heavenly beings
- Jehoshaphat, king of Judah
- Zedekiah
- And the king of Israel's official who takes Micaiah to Amon and Joash

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This passage happens immediately after the events in the previous passage, when all the prophets began prophesying to the kings of Israel and Judah outside the gates of the city of Samaria. A messenger for the king of Israel went to get Micaiah and bring Micaiah to the kings. As the messenger and Micaiah are coming back to the kings, the messenger tries to give advice to Micaiah. The messenger uses special language to draw attention

to the importance of what the messenger tells Micaiah. The messenger wants Micaiah to know that the words of the prophets are in unity, which means all the prophets say the same thing. The messenger wants Micaiah to say the same prophecy that the 400 prophets have said. The storyteller uses language that shows that Micaiah's response will not be what the messenger wants to hear. Micaiah will not agree with the messenger. Micaiah uses a strong promise to say that Micaiah will only say what Yahweh tells Micaiah to say. Micaiah says that he is sure Yahweh lives. In the same way that Micaiah is sure Yahweh lives, Micaiah is also sure that he will only say what Yahweh tells him to say.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words or phrases do you use to make a strong promise or oath that you will do something? Pause this audio here.

Many people think that the first storyteller also wrote this part of the story. This is because this part follows on from the earlier part of the story when the king of Israel asked an official to bring Micaiah to the kings at the threshing floor. This part of the story tells us about when Micaiah came to the kings. The king of Israel asks Micaiah the same question he asked the 400 prophets. Micaiah tells the king to go up and attack and to be victorious, or win. Yahweh will give Ramoth Gilead into the king's hand or his power. Micaiah seems to say the opposite of what he means. Usually, a person talks like this to mock or insult someone. The king hears the mocking in Micaiah's voice and is frustrated with Micaiah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you use tone and body language to show that you are saying something that is not true or that you do not believe is correct? Try saying things to each other in this way. Pause this audio here.

The king uses the question, "How many times must I make you swear to only tell the truth?" to express how the king feels about Micaiah.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have one person pretend to be frustrated with another person in the group and use questions to express how the first person feels about something the second person has done. An example might be for the person to say, "How many times do I need to ask you to put away your clothes?" or "Why do you always forget to do what I ask?" Notice if you use questions to show this frustration or if you show frustration in another way. Pause this audio here.

Micaiah then speaks about a vision from Yahweh. Micaiah saw the people of Israel scattered on the hills. The people are not together in one group but spread out. Micaiah says the people were like sheep without a shepherd. Yahweh told Micaiah that the people have no master or leader. Yahweh said to let each person go home in peace. When a person goes somewhere in peace, they do not fight, and they are safe.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How can you help people understand that Micaiah is describing a vision that Yahweh gave to Micaiah, compared to something that is actually happening in the story? Pause this audio here.

After Micaiah tells the king of Israel about the vision, the king of Israel speaks to Jehoshaphat, king of Judah. The king of Israel speaks about Micaiah. The king of Israel does not expect Jehoshaphat to answer the question, "Did I not tell you that he never prophesies anything good about me?"

Micaiah gives another prophecy. The second storyteller tells this part of the story for this passage. This part of the story originally followed on from when Zedekiah was prophesying to the kings on the threshing floor. The storyteller of 1 Kings now tells us this part of the story after Micaiah's first prophecy to the king of Israel. We do not know if the story of Micaiah giving this prophecy follows on from the story before, or if it is a completely different time Micaiah gave a prophecy to the king of Israel. Micaiah tells the people who listen to hear the word or the message from Yahweh. In Micaiah's vision, Yahweh sits on his throne. There are heavenly beings around Yahweh on the left and right of Yahweh. Micaiah describes the group of heavenly beings as a group that contains many, many beings. The heavenly beings serve Yahweh and do what Yahweh wants to be done. Yahweh asks all the heavenly beings if one of the beings will go to persuade Ahab to attack the people in Ramoth Gilead. Yahweh wants the heavenly being to persuade Ahab to do something by saying something that is not true. But in fact, Yahweh says Ahab will die if Ahab attacks Ramoth Gilead.

Micaiah uses special language to say the heavenly beings speak and that each being says a different thing. Each being says a different response to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you describe it when lots of people talk at one time and give different responses to a question? Pause this audio here.

Then one of the beings, a spirit, moves to be in front of Yahweh. The spirit is a heavenly being, not the Holy Spirit or a demon. The spirit says that it will persuade Ahab to attack Ramoth Gilead. Yahweh asks the spirit how the spirit will entice Ahab. The spirit tells Yahweh that it will go from heaven to Ahab's prophets in Israel. In Israel, the spirit will make all Ahab's prophets say lies. Yahweh tells the spirit that the spirit will be successful and commands the spirit to go persuade Ahab.

Micaiah tells the king of Israel and the other people who listen to Micaiah that the spirit came to the prophets. The spirit made the prophets say untrue prophecies. Yahweh has decided that other nations will destroy and kill the king of Israel. Zedekiah, the son of Kenaanah, is one of the people listening to Micaiah. Zedekiah moves close to Micaiah and slaps or hits Micaiah in the face. A person slaps another person with an open hand, and it makes a loud noise when the hand hits the face.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What different words do you use when one person hits another person in the face? Pause this audio here.

Zedekiah uses a question to insult Micaiah. Zedekiah asks how the spirit from Yahweh went from Zedekiah to Micaiah. Zedekiah questions why Yahweh would speak to Micaiah and not Zedekiah. Micaiah replies to Zedekiah to say that Zedekiah will know the answer to Zedekiah's question one day in the future. Zedekiah will know when he goes to hide from people in a room away from the outside walls of the city or building. We do not know when Zedekiah knows the answer to his question or what happens to Zedekiah at that time.

Many people think that this last part of the story is part of the same story that the first storyteller tells. After Micaiah tells the king of Israel about the visions, the king of Israel is angry. The king of Israel tells his officials to take hold of Micaiah and take Micaiah back to Amon and Joash. The king of Israel tells the people who hold Micaiah to give a message to Amon and Joash. The king of Israel gives instructions to an official to give to Amon and Joash. The king of Israel uses special words to show that what follows is a royal command for Amon and Joash. The king wants Amon and Joash to put Micaiah in prison and only give him small amounts of bread and water to eat and drink. The king wants Micaiah to only have enough bread and water to keep Micaiah alive.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How would you describe the amount of food that Amon and Joash will give to Micaiah in prison? Pause this audio here.

The king wants Micaiah to be in prison until the king comes back safely after the king fights the Arameans. Micaiah speaks to the king of Israel to say that if the king comes back, Yahweh did not speak through Micaiah. Micaiah then speaks to everybody to tell everybody to hear or remember what Micaiah said.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How would you tell a large group of people to listen carefully and remember something that you say? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:13–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- A messenger
- Micaiah
- King of Israel
- Yahweh
- Heavenly beings
- A spirit, one of the heavenly beings

- Jehoshaphat, king of Judah
- Zedekiah
- And the king of Israel's official who takes Micaiah to Amon and Joash

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The messenger tells Micaiah to give the king the same prophecy as the other prophets. Micaiah says he will say what Yahweh tells Micaiah to say. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the messenger, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am worried that Micaiah will make the king angry; or
- I hope Micaiah will give a good prophecy like the other prophets; or
- I do not think Micaiah will please my king today.

Ask the person playing Micaiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know that I will make the king angry again; or
- I want to be faithful to Yahweh; or
- Yahweh, please give me your words to speak today.

Continue the drama. Micaiah says the false prophecy, but the king of Israel knows Micaiah is not giving a prophecy from Yahweh. Micaiah speaks about a vision from Yahweh where Micaiah sees Israelites who have lost their leader. The king of Israel is angry. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Micaiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know that these words are not true. All of your prophets are telling you lies; or
- I am worried and sad because I can see that my king will die; or
- Thank you, Yahweh, for showing me your vision and giving me the words to tell the king.

Ask the person playing the king of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not like Micaiah; or
- I want to hear what Yahweh thinks; or
- This is what I expected. Now I feel angry and frustrated; or
- Micaiah is embarrassing me in front of Jehoshaphat.

Ask the person playing Jehoshaphat, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This will be interesting. Is Micaiah a prophet from Yahweh or just like all the other prophets? or
- Micaiah is making his king angry. I want to hear from Yahweh; or
- I feel relieved. This man is a prophet of Yahweh.

Continue the drama. Micaiah speaks about another vision where Yahweh wants a spirit to persuade Ahab to attack Ramoth Gilead. Yahweh says Ahab will die if Ahab attacks Ramoth Gilead. A spirit agrees to deceive the king. Micaiah tells the king and everyone around the king that Yahweh put a spirit in the prophets to speak false prophecies. Zedekiah slaps and insults Micaiah. Micaiah says Zedekiah will understand one day in the future when Zedekiah hides away in an inner room. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Micaiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- I am scared, but I must tell the king about my vision from Yahweh; or
- I know this truth offends everyone; or
- Zedekiah hates me; or
- One day, Zedekiah will know everything that he has done wrong; or
- I feel sorry for Zedekiah. He will be afraid, and I hope he asks Yahweh for help.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Here is a final test for Ahab. I know Ahab will fail, and Ahab will die; or
- Here are my words for Ahab and his people; or
- I am pleased with Micaiah, who speaks the truth and brings my warning to Ahab.

Ask the person playing the heavenly beings, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are here to serve Yahweh; or
- How can we persuade Ahab? What is the best way to tempt Ahab to attack Ramoth Gilead?

Ask the person playing the spirit, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have a good idea and know how I can entice Ahab; or
- I am sad to know that I will be successful; or
- It is always good to do what Yahweh wants.

Ask the person playing Zedekiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel horrified. How can Micaiah say this about all of us? or
- I am so angry with Micaiah; or
- What does Micaiah mean? What day will come when I hide somewhere?

Continue the drama. The king of Israel orders people to take Micaiah back to Amon and Joash, and for Amon and Joash to put Micaiah in prison with basic food and water until the king of Israel returns from attacking Ramoth Gilead. Micaiah says if the king returns, Yahweh did not speak through Micaiah and warns everyone to listen to the prophecy. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the king of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Micaiah has gone too far. How can Micaiah say that all my prophets lied to me? or
- I do not believe Micaiah; or
- I have heard enough. Micaiah makes me angry; or
- I hope Micaiah suffers while I go to fight Ramoth Gilead.

Ask the person playing the king of Israel's official, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Micaiah has offended my king; or
- I must tell Amon and Joash the king's punishment of Micaiah; or
- I am pleased to take Micaiah to be punished.

Ask the person playing Micaiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I knew the king would be angry; or
- I feel relieved that I spoke the truth, but I am frightened; or
- Everyone will know that I spoke the truth when the king dies at Ramoth Gilead.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:13–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The **messenger** spoke to Micaiah about the messages the **prophets** gave to the **king**. Use the same words or phrases for messenger, prophets, and king as you used in previous passages. For more information on "prophet" and "king," refer to the Master Glossary.

Micaiah uses the words, "**As surely as Yahweh lives**," as a promise or oath.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for this phrase. Look up oath in the Master Glossary. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Micaiah says he will say what **Yahweh** says to Micaiah. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages, and remember that Yahweh is in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh will give Ramoth Gilead into the king's **hand** or into the king's power. Use the same word or phrase for "into the king's hand" as you used in previous passages.

Micaiah says he saw the people of Israel scattered on the hills. The people were spread out over the hill.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **scattered**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The people looked like **sheep** without a shepherd. Use the same word or phrase for sheep as you used in previous passages. A shepherd is a person who protects and cares for sheep.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **shepherd**. Look up shepherd in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Each person can go home in **peace**. The people can go home without fighting and be safe. Use the same word or phrase for peace as you used in previous passages. For more information on peace, refer to the Master Glossary.

Micaiah never **prophesies** anything good. Use the same word or phrase for "prophesies" as you used in previous passages. For more information on "prophesy," refer to the Master Glossary.

Micaiah tells the people to hear the **word** of Yahweh. Micaiah wants the people to hear Yahweh's message. Use the same word or phrase for "word" as you used in previous passages. For more information on "word," refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh sits on his **throne**, and the "host of heaven" is around Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for throne as you used in previous passages. The host of heaven is the heavenly beings who do Yahweh's work.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**host of heaven**." Look up heaven in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh asks for someone to persuade Ahab to attack Ramoth Gilead. When someone persuades someone else, they convince a person to do something. In this case, Yahweh wants someone to persuade Ahab to do something that will be bad for Ahab.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **persuade**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A spirit came to Yahweh. The spirit is a supernatural being created by Yahweh who lives in heaven with Yahweh. It is not the Holy Spirit, and it is not evil.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **spirit**. Look up spirit in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Zedekiah is the **son** of Kenaanah. Use the same word or phrase for son as you used in previous passages. For more information on son, refer to the Master Glossary.

Zedekiah slapped Micaiah in the face.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **slapped**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Zedekiah will one day hide in an **inner room**. An inner room is a safe place inside a building. Use the same word or phrase for "inner room" as you used in previous passages.

Amon is the **governor** of the city. A governor is a senior official in charge of a city. Use the same word or phrase for governor as you used in previous passages.

The king of Israel wants Amon to put Micaiah in prison. A prison is a solid building that stops a person who is inside the building from going outside the building.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **prison**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel wants Micaiah to have a small amount of simple food to eat, like **bread**, and water. Use the same word or phrase for "bread" or food as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 22:13–28

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1022 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 22:29–40

1 Kings 22:29–40

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 22:29–40 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:29–40 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:29–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This story finishes the story about the king of Israel and the prophet Micaiah. You will remember that the king of Israel is probably Ahab. The storyteller only connects Ahab to this story at the end of the story. You will remember that the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, want to hear from Yahweh before they go to attack the Arameans at Ramoth Gilead. Micaiah the prophet told the king of Israel that if the king attacked the Arameans, the king would die. After the king hears Micaiah's message from Yahweh, the king decides to ignore the prophecy and attack the Arameans at Ramoth Gilead. Syria is another name for Aram. Aramean people are the same people as Syrian people. Many years later, another storyteller took the story from this book of 1 Kings and retold the story in the book of 2 Chronicles. There are a few differences between this story in 1 Kings and the other telling of the story in 2 Chronicles.

Stop here and listen to your translation of 2 Chronicles 18:28–34 in your own language, if possible. Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel and Jehoshaphat go from Samaria in Israel to Ramoth Gilead. Ramoth Gilead is about 45 kilometers northeast of Samaria. The kings go to attack the Arameans in Ramoth Gilead.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and find the cities of Samaria and Ramoth Gilead. Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel talks to Jehoshaphat. We do not know when the conversation between the two kings happens. The conversation might happen in Samaria or on the way to Ramoth Gilead. The king of Israel tells Jehoshaphat that he, the king of Israel, will go into the battle in disguise. The king will wear clothes and other items which do not make him look like a king. The king of Israel does not want the Arameans to recognise the king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when people or a person wore a disguise. Why did the person or people wear a disguise? Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel wants Jehoshaphat to wear royal robes in the battle. The king of Israel wants Jehoshaphat to look like a king. The king of Israel puts on a disguise and starts to fight the battle at Ramoth Gilead. The king does not fight the Arameans alone. The king fights the battle with Jehoshaphat and soldiers from Israel and Judah.

Before the battle starts, the king of Aram gives orders or commands to his 32 leaders. The 32 men are commanders or captains who ride chariots. The commanders lead the Aramean fighters in the battle and tell the fighters what to do.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Who leads the people in your army or group of fighters? What special title do these people have to show that they have authority over the other fighters? Pause this audio here.

The commanders fight from chariots. A chariot is an open, two-wheeled vehicle. Horses pull the chariot along, and a person or people ride in the chariot and fight from the chariot. A person in the chariot uses strips of leather that go from the horses' heads to the person's hands to guide the horses. The strips of leather are reins. A soldier in a chariot moves quickly in battle.

Stop here and look at a picture of a soldier in a chariot with horses. Pause this audio here.

The king of Aram tells the commanders not to fight with anybody who is not the king of Israel. The king of Aram does not want the commanders to fight with everyone: not the small, ordinary soldiers or the great, important army commanders from Israel.

In the battle, the commanders see Jehoshaphat. Jehoshaphat looks like a king. The commanders think Jehoshaphat is the king of Israel. The commanders tell the people who drive the chariots to turn the chariots. The commanders go towards Jehoshaphat to attack Jehoshaphat. Jehoshaphat cries out or gives a shout. We do not know why Jehoshaphat shouts. It is possible that Jehoshaphat shouts a battle cry, a special phrase to encourage the fighters of Judah. The shout tells the Arameans that they are about to fight the wrong person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the battle cries that your people use now or in the past to encourage each other in battles. How do the battle cries help to identify the people fighting in the battle? Pause this audio here.

When the commanders hear Jehoshaphat, the commanders know that Jehoshaphat is not the king of Israel. Now, the commanders do not follow or try to fight Jehoshaphat. The battle continues.

An Aramean soldier draws his bow. The soldier pulls back on the bow string and fires an arrow from the bow into the battle.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man drawing a bow to fire an arrow. Pause this audio here.

The soldier does not know that he hits the king of Israel with the arrow. The Aramean soldier hits the king of Israel by chance.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when something happened without a person meaning to make it happen or possibly by accident. Pause this audio here.

The arrow hits the king of Israel between the pieces of the king's armor. People wear armor to protect themselves in a battle. People make armor from hard leather or flat or shaped pieces of metal. People connect the armor together with straps. There are small gaps between the pieces of armor. A breastplate is a special piece of armor that covers the chest of a person.

Stop here and look at a picture of a soldier with armor. Notice the pieces of armor, the breastplate, and the gaps between the different pieces or sections of armor. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do your soldiers wear to protect their bodies during a battle? How do your soldiers connect the different pieces of armor together? Which areas of the body does armor not protect? Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel is in a chariot. Another person drives the chariot for the king of Israel. The king of Israel tells the driver to use his hands to pull on the reins to the horses and turn the chariot around.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have one person pretend to be a horse and one person be the driver of the horse. Take two long pieces of string, rope, or fabric and give one pair of ends to the "horse" and another pair of ends to the "driver." Have the "driver" pull on one string to turn the "horse" to one side. Then use the other string to turn the "horse" to the other side. Pause this audio here.

The king tells his driver that the king is wounded and hurt. The battle continues with people fighting each other. The king of Israel stays in his chariot. Someone helps the king of Israel to stay upright. The king uses the chariot to support himself. The king of Israel looks towards the Arameans in the battle.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Find a cup or something similar to use as a chariot. Now get something about the length and width of your thumb and place it in the cup. Find a way to make your item stay upright in the cup. What do you need to make it stay upright and face one way? Pause this audio here.

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The king of Israel bleeds from the wound on his body. The blood runs out of his body and onto the bottom of the chariot. The king of Israel dies late in the afternoon before the sun goes down. At sunset, soldiers start to shout to each other to go back to their hometowns and home countries. People start shouting the order in one part of the army, and then other people shout the same order to pass the order to more people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when you were in a crowd of people, and some people shouted something on one side of the crowd, and more people passed the message on through the crowd to reach everyone. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller ends the story of how the king of Israel died and tells us that people took the king's body to Samaria. It was the custom for the Israelite people to bury dead people in the hometown of the dead person. We do not know who took the king's body to Samaria and buried him in Samaria. The king of Israel's people put the king's body in a grave or tomb, a place where people bury a dead body. The king's servants took the king's chariot to a public pool of water in Samaria to wash the chariot. There was a pool of water in the north-west corner of the city of Samaria. The public pool was a place most people visited and used for washing their bodies and their clothes.

Stop here and look at a picture of a public pool like the one people used to wash the chariot in the story. Pause this audio here.

Prostitutes used the same pool to wash themselves. A prostitute is a woman who has sexual intercourse with people for payment. We do not know if the prostitutes wash themselves in the pool at the same time as the servants clean the chariot, or if the prostitutes wash themselves with the king's blood in the water. At the time of the story, some people believed the king's blood had special power that might help or heal people if they washed with it. The Israelites thought prostitutes were wicked people. The dogs lick the king's blood. It is likely that the dogs in the story did not belong to people and lived on the streets of the city. At the time of the story, the Israelites thought a dog was an unclean animal. Dogs use their tongues to lick and take water into their mouths. The storyteller tells us that this fulfills Yahweh's message in Elijah's prophecy to Ahab in an earlier story in 1 Kings 21 verse 19.

Stop here and look at a picture of a dog licking up water to drink. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller uses a formal set of words to end the stories of Ahab, king of Israel. The storyteller reminds us of some of Ahab's significant achievements. Ahab built a palace and decorated it with ivory. Ahab did not build the palace himself, and the builders did not make the palace out of ivory. The builders probably used a lot of ivory inside the palace to make the palace very beautiful. Ivory is hard and creamy-white in colour. Ivory comes from the tusks, special teeth, of some animals, including elephants, hippopotamus, and warthog. People carve patterns into ivory and use ivory to decorate furniture and wooden structures.

Stop here and look at a picture of an elephant with long tusks of ivory. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of wood that people have decorated with carved ivory. Pause this audio here.

Storytellers made a written record of the events in Ahab's reign in the scroll, or book of the history of the kings of Israel. This book no longer exists and is not the books of Chronicles in the bible. The storyteller of this book ends the story by telling us that Ahab rested with his ancestors. You will remember that this is a formal way to tell us that Ahab died. Ahaziah was the next king of Israel after Ahab. Ahab was the father of Ahaziah.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:29–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has nine scenes.

In the first scene: The king of Israel and Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, go to attack Ramoth Gilead. The king of Israel tells Jehoshaphat to wear royal robes in the battle, but the king of Israel will wear a disguise.

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In the second scene: The king of Israel puts on a disguise and attacks Ramoth Gilead.

In the third scene: Before the battle, the king of Aram tells his chariot commanders to only fight the king of Israel.

In the fourth scene: In the battle, the chariot commanders see Jehoshaphat and attack him. Jehoshaphat shouts, and the Arameans realise it is not the king of Israel and stop chasing Jehoshaphat.

In the fifth scene: An Aramean soldier fires an arrow from his bow into the battle. The arrow hits and hurts the king of Israel. The king's chariot driver takes the king away from the battle. Someone or something holds the king upright in his chariot, and the king watches the battle.

In the sixth scene: The king's blood runs onto the chariot, and the king dies just before sunset.

In the seventh scene: At sunset, the soldiers from Israel and Judah shout to tell each other to leave the battle and go home.

In the eighth scene: Israelites take the king's body to Samaria and bury the body. The king's servants wash the king's chariot in a public pool in Samaria.

In the ninth scene: The storyteller reminds us that people wrote of the events of Ahab's reign in the records of the kings of Israel. Ahab is dead, and Ahaziah is the new king.

The characters in this passage are:

- King of Israel
- Jehoshaphat, king of Judah
- King of Aram
- Thirty-two chariot commanders
- Aramean soldier who hits the king of Israel with an arrow
- The king of Israel's chariot driver
- The soldiers in the armies of Judah, Israel, and Aram
- Israelite servants
- Prostitutes
- The storyteller
- And Ahaziah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, the storyteller continues the story of the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat. After they hear Micaiah's prophecies, the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat go up to Ramoth Gilead to attack the Arameans at the city. Before the battle, the king of Israel talks to Jehoshaphat about the plan for the battle. The king of Israel will wear a disguise when he goes into the battle. The king of Israel wants Jehoshaphat to wear royal robes. The storyteller then tells us that the king of Israel puts on a disguise and goes to fight the Arameans at Ramoth Gilead.

In the next scene, the storyteller tells us about the king of Aram's plan. Before the battle, the king of Aram gives an order to his chariot commanders. The king does not want the commanders to fight with anyone except the king of Israel. The king of Aram uses the special phrase "small or great" to mean everyone.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words or phrases do you use to mean everyone who is in a place or at an event? Pause this audio here.

At the battle at Ramoth Gilead, the chariot commanders obey the order from the king of Aram and look for the king of Israel. The commanders see Jehoshaphat and think that Jehoshaphat is the king of Israel. The commanders turn or move to attack Jehoshaphat. Jehoshaphat shouts or cries out. The chariot commanders hear Jehoshaphat and know that Jehoshaphat is not the king of Israel. The chariot commanders stop following Jehoshaphat.

In another part of the battle, an Aramean soldier pulls the string of his bow back to fire an arrow.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man drawing a bow to fire an arrow, if needed. Pause this audio here.

The soldier releases the arrow into the battle. The soldier's arrow strikes the king of Israel by chance. The soldier does not plan to hit the king of Israel with the arrow.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you describe something that happens by chance? Pause this audio here.

The soldier's arrow hits the king of Israel between the pieces of the king's armor and the king's breastplate.

Stop here and look at a picture of a soldier with armor, if needed. Pause this audio here.

After the arrow hits and hurts the king of Israel, the king of Israel tells his chariot driver to turn the chariot around. The king wants the driver to turn the chariot away from the battle and drive the chariot somewhere away from the fighting.

The battle lasts all day, and people fight hard all day.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about how fighting in a battle can change from being less intense to more intense. Notice how you describe soldiers fighting more and harder with each other. Pause this audio here.

The king of Israel stays in his chariot, and someone helps the king of Israel to be upright in the chariot and face towards the battle. The king of Israel uses the chariot for support.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time someone needed to use an object to help them keep standing upright. Notice what words you use to describe how the person used the object to help them stand. Pause this audio here.

As the king stands in his chariot, the blood from the wound on the king's body flows out and onto the flat bottom or base of the chariot. The king dies in late afternoon when the sun is getting low in the sky. As the sun sets, soldiers shout to pass the message to go home to other soldiers from Israel and Judah. The message passes from one side of the battle to the other.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words do you use to describe or name the different times as the afternoon ends and sunset happens? Pause this audio here.

After the battle, soldiers take the king of Israel's body to Samaria and bury the body. Israelite people take the king's chariot to a big pool in Samaria to wash the chariot clean. At the pool, prostitutes use the water to bathe and wash themselves. Dogs lick up the blood of the king of Israel from the chariot. The storyteller reminds us that this happens as Yahweh told Ahab it would happen.

The storyteller ends the story and uses the same formal phrase to finish telling a story of a king's life. The phrase contains a question to which the storyteller does not expect an answer. The storyteller uses the question to tell a person who hears the story to find out more information about Ahab in the scroll, or book of the history of the kings of Israel. The storyteller uses the words, "Ahab rested with his ancestors," as a polite way to say Ahab is dead.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What different ways do you have to say someone is dead? Which ways, if any, are more polite than the others? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that Ahaziah is the next king of Israel.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:29–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has nine scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King of Israel
- Jehoshaphat, king of Judah
- King of Aram
- Thirty-two chariot commanders

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- Aramean soldier who hits the king of Israel with an arrow
- The king of Israel's chariot driver
- The soldiers in the armies of Judah, Israel, and Aram
- Israelite servants
- Prostitutes
- The storyteller
- And Ahaziah

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The king of Israel and Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, go to attack Ramoth Gilead. The king of Israel tells Jehoshaphat to wear royal robes in the battle, but the king of Israel will wear a disguise. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the king of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want Ramoth Gilead back. I do not care about Micaiah's prophecies; or
- I am feeling clever. I will hide, and the Arameans will not find me; or
- Jehoshaphat will look like a king. The Arameans will try to kill Jehoshaphat and not me.

Ask the person playing Jehoshaphat, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to help the king of Israel get Ramoth Gilead back from the king of Aram; or
- It is very strange that the king of Israel does not want to look like a king in the battle; or
- I want my soldiers to see me and know I am with them in the battle.

Continue the drama. The king of Israel puts on a disguise and attacks Ramoth Gilead. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the king of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Arameans cannot see where I am; or
- I will be safer in ordinary clothes; or
- It is time to get my city back.

Continue the drama. Before the battle, the king of Aram tells his chariot commanders to only fight the king of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the king of Aram, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want the king of Israel to be dead; or
- My best fighters must look out for the king of Israel.

Ask the person playing the 32 chariot commanders, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are proud to serve our king; or
- We will find the king of Israel; or
- We will kill the king of Israel and keep Ramoth Gilead for Aram.

Continue the drama. In the battle, the chariot commanders see Jehoshaphat and attack him. Jehoshaphat shouts, and the Arameans realise it is not the king of Israel and stop chasing Jehoshaphat. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the 32 chariot commanders, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- We can see the king! Let us go and kill him; or
- We think we are wrong. The person does not sound like the king of Israel; or
- Turn away! We will not chase this person. We need to find the king of Israel.

Ask the person playing Jehoshaphat, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want to help Israel get back Ramoth Gilead; or
- Attack the Arameans! or
- Come and help me! or
- Why did those soldiers turn away from me?

Continue the drama. An Aramean soldier fires an arrow from his bow into the battle. The arrow hits and hurts the king of Israel. The king’s chariot driver takes the king away from the battle. Someone or something holds the king upright in his chariot, and the king watches the battle. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Aramean soldier, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I will defend Ramoth Gilead; or
- There are so many Israelites that I do not need to aim; or
- I wonder if my arrows are stopping Israelites?

Ask the person playing the king of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Someone hit me with an arrow! I need to leave the battle and go somewhere safe; or
- I feel worried. I am bleeding a lot; or
- I want to watch the battle, but I feel weak and cannot stand up.

Ask the person playing the king of Israel’s chariot driver, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I will take my king out of the battle; or
- I am worried about my king. The arrow has hurt the king.

Continue the drama. The king’s blood runs onto the chariot, and the king dies just before sunset. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the king of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel weak; or
- I can see my blood around my feet; or
- Yahweh was right, I am going to die today; or
- I should have listened to Micaiah.

Ask the person playing the armies of Judah, Israel and Aram, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We will fight to win back Ramoth Gilead for Israel; or
- Keep fighting, our king is watching us; or
- Keep fighting, the sun is going down, and we will win today.

Continue the drama. At sunset, the soldiers from Israel and Judah shout to tell each other to leave the battle and go home. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the soldiers of Israel and Judah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- The king of Israel is dead, and we have lost the battle! or
- We are frightened; or
- We need to go home to our own towns in our own country.

Continue the drama. Israelites take the king’s body to Samaria and bury the body. The king’s servants wash the king’s chariot in a public pool in Samaria. Prostitutes wash their bodies in the pool, and dogs lick the blood. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the soldiers of Israel and Judah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We must take the king’s body back to Samaria so that people can bury the body in the right place.

Ask the person playing the Israelite servants, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We want to wash all the blood off the chariot; or
- We are sad that our king died and our soldiers lost the battle for Ramoth Gilead.

Ask the person playing the prostitutes, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- What is happening today? or
- The king of Israel’s blood is in the water of the pool that we wash in; or
- Dogs are licking the blood from the chariot; or
- How amazing that the blood of the king is here in this dirty and public place.

Continue the drama. The storyteller reminds us that people wrote of the events of Ahab’s reign in the book of the history of the kings of Israel. Ahab is dead, and Ahaziah is the new king. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the storyteller, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- There is more to learn about Ahab in the records of the kings; or
- This is the end of King Ahab. I hope the people who hear the story learn from the story.

Ask the person playing Ahaziah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that my father did not win the battle at Ramoth Gilead; or
- Now I am king.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:29–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The **king** of **Israel** and the king of **Judah** went to attack Ramoth Gilead. Use the same words or phrases for king, Israel, and Judah as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, Israel, and Judah, refer to the Master Glossary.

The king of Israel will wear a disguise.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **disguise**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Jehoshaphat will wear **royal robes**. Use the same word or phrase for royal robes as you used in previous passages. For more information about robes, refer to the Master Glossary.

The king of Aram gives orders to his **chariot commanders**. Use the same words or phrases for chariot and commanders as you used in previous passages.

Someone drew his bow. The man pulled back on the string of the bow and shot an arrow.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man drawing a bow to fire an arrow, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **drew his bow**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The arrow hit the king of Israel between the sections or pieces of his **armor**. Use the same word or phrase for armor as you used in previous passages.

The king spoke to his chariot driver. The chariot driver is the person who guides the horses that pull the chariot.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for chariot **driver**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

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The dogs licked the king's blood as the **word** of **Yahweh** had said they would. Yahweh is the personal name for God. Use the same words or phrases for word and Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on word and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ahab decorated a **palace** with **ivory**. Use the same words or phrases for palace, or king's house, and ivory as you used in previous passages.

Ahab **fortified cities**. Ahab made the cities stronger. Use the same word or phrase for cities as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate that Ahab made the cities stronger. If you have translated a phrase like this before, use the same phrase here. Pause this audio here.

The events of Ahab's reign are in the scroll, or **book of the history of the kings of Israel**. Use the same phrase for scroll, or book of the history of the kings of Israel, as you used in previous passages. For more information about scroll, refer to the Master Glossary.

Ahab rested with his **ancestors**. Use the same word or phrase for ancestors as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Kings 22:29–40

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (7.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Kings 22:41–53

1 Kings 22:41–53

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Kings 22:41–53 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:41–53 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:41–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, King Ahab of Israel and King Jehoshaphat of Judah went to fight the Arameans at Ramoth Gilead. Ahab disguised himself in battle, but an enemy soldier shot Ahab with an arrow. Ahab bled in his chariot and died at sunset. The people took Ahab's body to Samaria, and dogs licked up Ahab's blood, just as Yahweh promised. Ahab's son Ahaziah became king of Israel.

In this story, the storyteller summarizes the reign of King Jehoshaphat of Judah and introduces the reign of King Ahaziah of Israel. A different storyteller also tells the story of Jehoshaphat's rule in 2 Chronicles 20:31–37.

When Ahab has been king of Israel for four years, Jehoshaphat, son of Asa, becomes king over Judah. Jehoshaphat is 35 years old when he becomes king of Judah, and Jehoshaphat rules in Jerusalem for 25 years, from around the year 872 to 848 before Jesus. Jerusalem was the capital of Judah, from where the kings of Judah ruled. Jehoshaphat's mother's name is Azubah. Shilhi is Azubah's father.

Stop here and, as a group, locate Jerusalem in Judah on the map. Pause this audio here.

Jehoshaphat follows his father Asa's good example in everything. Jehoshaphat does not leave his father's ways. Jehoshaphat does what Yahweh considers right. However, Jehoshaphat does not remove all the shrines on the hilltops where people worship other gods. In 2 Chronicles 17:6, the storyteller says that earlier in Jehoshaphat's reign, Jehoshaphat removed the shrines on hilltops from Judah and tried to lead the people of Judah back to Yahweh. But the people of Judah later rebuild the high places, or shrines on hilltops, and Jehoshaphat does not fully destroy the high places for the rest of his reign. The people of Judah continue to sacrifice animals and burn sweet-smelling spices on altars at those places. The people of Judah often worship Yahweh at shrines on hilltops, but that worship is wrong. Yahweh wants the people of Judah to worship only Yahweh and to worship Yahweh only at the temple in Jerusalem. The people of Judah disobey God when they worship at high places.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What gods do people in your people group worship apart from Yahweh? Where and how do people worship the other gods? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a king or leader from your group or another group who took away all the places where people worshiped other gods so everyone would worship only Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

Jehoshaphat has a peaceful relationship with the king of Israel. The storyteller does not say which king of Israel the storyteller means. The storyteller may mean King Ahab. However, the phrase "king of Israel" more likely describes all the kings of Israel who ruled at the same time as Jehoshaphat, including Ahab, Ahaziah, and Joram. Before the rule of King Jehoshaphat of Judah, the kingdom of Judah and the kingdom of Israel usually acted like enemies and behaved in hostile ways toward each other. Jehoshaphat shows a friendly attitude toward Israel, and this friendly attitude is good. However, Jehoshaphat goes too far. We know from another story that

Jehoshaphat makes a marriage alliance with the family of King Ahab. Jehoshaphat allows his son Jehoram to marry a daughter of Ahab and Jezebel. This marriage joins God's people to idol worship, and God forbids idol worship.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when a leader of your people group made an alliance with another people group, and this alliance caused bad things to happen to your people. Why was it a bad idea to work together with those people? Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller summarizes and evaluates the reign of King Jehoshaphat. The storyteller says that people record the other events during Jehoshaphat's reign in the book or scroll called "History of the Kings of Judah." The people also write about the great things Jehoshaphat did and his military victories in this book. This book records the actions of the kings of Judah during the reigns of the kings of Judah.

Now the storyteller begins again to talk about events in Jehoshaphat's life. Jehoshaphat removes all the male shrine prostitutes who are still in Judah from the time of his father, King Asa. Shrine prostitutes are either men or women who work in temples and have sex as part of pagan religious ceremonies. The original language can mean that Jehoshaphat either puts these people to death or sends them out of Judah.

Now the storyteller gives background for the next event in Jehoshaphat's reign. The storyteller says that Edom has no king of its own. Judah controls Edom at this time, so a deputy king, whom Jehoshaphat appoints, rules Edom. Edom lies south of Judah and stretches down toward the Red Sea. Jehoshaphat makes ships of Tarshish to carry gold from the land of Ophir. "Ships of Tarshish" means large, strong trading ships that people made for long sea trips. We do not know where Ophir was, but it was probably in the southern part of the Arabian Peninsula. Ophir was a large land, not a city, and it was famous for its gold. However, the ships do not sail. The ships break into pieces at Ezion Geber, an important port city on the north side of the Gulf of Aqaba in Edom. We do not know what destroyed the ships, but natural events like a strong storm, powerful winds, or rough seas may have caused it.

Stop here and locate on the map Edom, the possible place where the land of Ophir was, and the port city of Ezion Geber. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a ship of Tarshish. Pause this audio here.

At that time, Ahaziah, king of Israel and son of Ahab, makes an offer to Jehoshaphat after the shipwreck. Ahaziah wants to persuade Jehoshaphat to build the ships again. Ahaziah suggests to Jehoshaphat that the servants of Ahaziah, or the sailors of Ahaziah, go with the servants of Jehoshaphat in the ships.

We know from 2 Chronicles 20:36–37 that the first time Jehoshaphat built the ships of Tarshish, Jehoshaphat did it in alliance with Ahaziah. This alliance did not please Yahweh, and so Yahweh caused the ships to break apart. Now Ahaziah suggests that Ahaziah and Jehoshaphat build the ships together again. But Jehoshaphat does not agree.

Stop here and, as a group, tell a story about a leader from your people group who said no to a business deal with a leader from another people group. Explain that your leader said no because they had learned a lesson from something that happened with that other leader before. Pause this audio here.

Then Jehoshaphat dies and goes to be with his ancestors. People bury Jehoshaphat in the city of his ancestor David, where people had buried Jehoshaphat's other ancestors. The City of David was part of Jerusalem and had become the burial place for the kings of Judah. And Jehoshaphat's son Jehoram becomes king of Judah in his place.

Stop here and, as a group, locate the City of David on a map of Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller introduces the reign of Ahaziah, king of Israel. Ahaziah, son of Ahab, becomes king over Israel in Samaria. Samaria is the capital city of Israel. King Ahab rules Israel from there. This happens in the 17th year of the reign of Jehoshaphat as king of Judah. Ahaziah rules Israel for two years from around the year 853 to 852 before Jesus.

Stop here and, as a group, locate Samaria in Israel on the map. Pause this audio here.

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Ahaziah does evil things in Yahweh's sight. Ahaziah acts in the same bad way as his father, King Ahab, and his mother, Jezebel. King Ahab and Queen Jezebel worshipped Baal and encouraged the people of Israel to do the same, instead of worshiping Yahweh. Ahaziah also behaves like Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who led the people of Israel into sin. You will remember that Jeroboam was the first king of the northern kingdom of Israel. Jeroboam set up golden calves and told the people of Israel to worship them instead of worshiping Yahweh.

Stop here and, as a group, talk about the rulers of your people group who passed bad behaviour from father to son and kept doing evil things from one ruler to the next. Pause this audio here.

Ahaziah serves Baal and worships him. Ahaziah makes Yahweh, the God of Israel, angry by doing all the same things that Ahaziah's father, King Ahab, did.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:41–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has 10 scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller introduces the reign of King Jehoshaphat of Judah. When Ahab has been king of Israel for four years, Jehoshaphat, son of Asa, becomes king over Judah. Jehoshaphat is 35 years old when Jehoshaphat becomes king of Judah. Jehoshaphat rules in Jerusalem for 25 years. Jehoshaphat's mother's name is Azubah. Azubah is the daughter of Shilhi.

In the second scene: Jehoshaphat follows his father Asa's good example in everything. Jehoshaphat does not turn away from his father's ways. Jehoshaphat does what Yahweh says is right. However, Jehoshaphat does not remove all the high places. People still go to the high places to worship and continue to offer animals and burn sweet-smelling spices on altars at those places.

In the third scene: Jehoshaphat has a peaceful relationship with the king or kings of Israel.

In the fourth scene: Now the storyteller summarizes and evaluates the reign of King Jehoshaphat. People record the other events during Jehoshaphat's reign in the book called "History of the Kings of Judah." People also write about Jehoshaphat's accomplishments and his military victories in that book.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller begins again to talk about events in Jehoshaphat's life. Jehoshaphat removes all the male shrine prostitutes who are still in Judah from the time of his father, King Asa.

In the sixth scene: The storyteller gives background for the next event in Jehoshaphat's reign and says that Edom has no king of its own. A deputy king rules Edom. Jehoshaphat makes ships of Tarshish to carry gold from the land of Ophir. However, the ships do not sail. The ships break into pieces at the port of Ezion Geber.

In the seventh scene: Ahaziah, king of Israel and son of Ahab, makes an offer to Jehoshaphat after the shipwreck. Ahaziah wants to persuade Jehoshaphat to build the ships again, after the destruction of the ships that Jehoshaphat first built. Ahaziah suggests to Jehoshaphat that the sailors of Ahaziah go with the sailors of Jehoshaphat in the ships. But Jehoshaphat does not agree.

In the eighth scene: Jehoshaphat dies and goes to be with his ancestors. People bury Jehoshaphat in the city of David, Jehoshaphat's ancestor, where people buried Jehoshaphat's other ancestors.

In the ninth scene: The storyteller introduces the reign of Ahaziah, king of Israel. Ahaziah, the son of Ahab, becomes king over Israel in Samaria. This happens in the 17th year of the reign of Jehoshaphat as king of Judah.

In the tenth scene: Ahaziah does evil things in Yahweh's sight. Ahaziah acts in the same bad way as his father, King Ahab, and his mother, Jezebel. Ahaziah also behaves like Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who led the people of Israel into sin. Ahaziah serves Baal and worships Baal. Ahaziah makes Yahweh, the God of Israel, angry because Ahaziah does all the same things that Ahaziah's father, King Ahab, did.

The characters in this passage are:

- King Ahab of Israel
- King Jehoshaphat of Judah
- All the kings of Israel who rule at the same time as Jehoshaphat: Ahab, Ahaziah, and Joram. The storyteller calls them “the king of Israel”
- Deputy king of Edom
- King Ahaziah of Israel
- And King Jehoram of Judah, Jehoshaphat’s son

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage’s setting:

In this story, the storyteller sums up the reign of King Jehoshaphat of Judah and introduces the reign of King Ahaziah of Israel. A different storyteller also tells the story of Jehoshaphat’s rule in 2 Chronicles 20:31–37. The storyteller follows the normal way of talking about a king’s rule. The storyteller says how long Jehoshaphat rules and gives the name of Jehoshaphat’s mother.

When Ahab has been king of Israel for four years, Jehoshaphat, son of Asa, becomes king over Judah. Jehoshaphat is 35 years old when Jehoshaphat becomes king of Judah. Jehoshaphat rules in Jerusalem for 25 years, from about the year 872 to the year 848 before Jesus. For the first three years, Jehoshaphat co-reigns with Jehoshaphat’s father, Asa. For the last five years, Jehoshaphat probably co-reigns with his son Jehoram. Jehoshaphat’s mother’s name is Azubah. Azubah is the daughter of Shilhi, who is Azubah’s father. People know Shilhi is Azubah’s father and not her mother because, in the Bible, when a woman is called the daughter of someone, the name almost always refers to her father. That was the normal way to show family lines. Also, the words in the original language make it clear that Shilhi is a male.

Stop here and, as a group, locate Jerusalem in Judah on the map. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you introduce the reign or rule of a new king or leader when you tell a history story? What important information do you give to your audience? Pause this audio here.

Jehoshaphat follows his father Asa’s good example in everything. Jehoshaphat does not turn away from his father’s ways. Jehoshaphat does what is right in the eyes of Yahweh, which is what Yahweh says is right. The storyteller now uses contrast language to point out an exception to Jehoshaphat’s good behaviour as a ruler. Jehoshaphat does not remove all the high places. People still go to those places to worship Yahweh and other gods. The people of Judah continue to offer animals and burn sweet-smelling spices on altars at those places.

Stop here and do this exercise as a group. Think of three leaders from your people group who were mostly good, but made one mistake. For each leader, say all the good things they did, and then tell the one bad thing they did. How do you show that the one bad thing the leader did was different than the rest of the things he did? Pause this audio here.

And Jehoshaphat makes peace with the king of Israel. The language that the storyteller uses may show that he sees Jehoshaphat’s peaceful relationship with Israel as another mistake. This mistake connects to Jehoshaphat’s failure to remove the hilltop shrines to idols. The phrase “to make peace” can also mean “to submit to someone” in some cases. Perhaps the storyteller criticizes Jehoshaphat and says that Jehoshaphat submits to the king of Israel. The storyteller does not say which king of Israel the storyteller means. The storyteller may mean King Ahab. However, the phrase “king of Israel” more likely refers to all the kings of Israel who rule at the same time as Jehoshaphat rules Judah. These kings include Ahab, Ahaziah, and Joram.

Now the storyteller uses the common formula to summarize and evaluate the reign of King Jehoshaphat. The storyteller uses a question that does not require an answer. The storyteller says, “Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, and his strength that he showed, and how he fought battles, have people not written about them in the book called History of the Kings of Judah?”

The storyteller begins again to talk about events in Jehoshaphat’s life. Jehoshaphat removes all the male shrine prostitutes who are still in Judah from the time of his father, King Asa. The original language can mean that Jehoshaphat either puts the male cult prostitutes to death or sends them out of Judah. We know from 1 Kings 15:12 that Jehoshaphat’s father, King Asa, forced the male shrine prostitutes out of the land of Judah, but perhaps some still remained. Jehoshaphat now removes these people completely.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How can you say that when Jehoshaphat removes the male shrine prostitutes, Jehoshaphat either puts these people to death or sends them completely out of Judah? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller gives background for the next event in Jehoshaphat's reign. The storyteller says that Edom has no king of its own. A deputy king, whom Jehoshaphat appoints, rules Edom. Edom lies south of Judah and stretches down toward the Red Sea. Jehoshaphat makes ships of Tarshish to carry gold from the land of Ophir. Jehoshaphat does not make the ships himself, but oversees his workers who make them. Ships of Tarshish were big, strong trading ships that could travel very far, even to a distant place called Tarshish. People made these ships from strong wood, often cedar. The ships usually had one large square sail, though some may have had two sails for longer journeys. We do not know where Ophir is, but it is probably in the southern part of the Arabian Peninsula. However, the ships do not sail. The ships break into pieces at the port of Ezion Geber, which is on the north side of the Gulf of Aqaba in Edom. We do not know what destroys the ships, but natural events like a strong storm, powerful winds, or rough seas may cause it.

Stop here and locate on the map Edom, the possible place where the land of Ophir was, and the port city of Ezion Geber. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a ship of Tarshish. Pause this audio here.

At that time, Ahaziah, king of Israel and son of Ahab, makes an offer to Jehoshaphat after the shipwreck. Ahaziah wants to persuade Jehoshaphat to build the ships again. Ahaziah suggests to Jehoshaphat that the servants of Ahaziah go with the servants of Jehoshaphat in the ships. Here, the word "servants" refers to sailors, or men who work on and steer the ships. Ahaziah suggests that Ahaziah and Jehoshaphat build the ships together. But Jehoshaphat does not agree.

Then Jehoshaphat dies and sleeps with his fathers, which means he goes to be with his ancestors. People bury Jehoshaphat in the City of David, Jehoshaphat's father, where people had buried Jehoshaphat's other fathers. In all these cases, the word "father" means ancestor. Then Jehoshaphat's son Jehoram becomes king of Judah in his place.

Now the storyteller introduces the reign of Ahaziah, king of Israel. The storyteller uses the usual formula that links the rule of Ahaziah with the rule of the king in Judah. Ahaziah, the son of Ahab, becomes king over Israel in Samaria. This happens in the 17th year of the reign of Jehoshaphat as king of Judah. Ahaziah rules Israel for about two years, from around 853 to 852 before Jesus.

Stop here and, as a group, find Samaria in Israel on the map. Pause this audio here.

Ahaziah does evil things in Yahweh's sight. Ahaziah acts in the same bad way as his father, King Ahab, and his mother, Jezebel. Ahaziah also behaves like Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who led the people of Israel into sin.

Ahaziah serves Baal and worships Baal. The word "serves" means almost the same as "worships," but "serves" also means that Ahaziah places himself under Baal and gives Baal his loyalty. Ahaziah makes Yahweh, the God of Israel, angry because Ahaziah does all the same things that Ahaziah's father, King Ahab, did.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Think of words to explain how Ahaziah "serves" Baal and "worships" Baal. Make sure your words show the difference: "worships" means Ahaziah honors Baal, and "serves" means Ahaziah follows Baal and gives Baal his loyalty. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:41–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has 10 scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

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- King Ahab of Israel
- King Jehoshaphat of Judah
- All the kings of Israel who rule at the same time as Jehoshaphat: Ahab, Ahaziah, and Joram. The storyteller calls them “the king of Israel”
- Deputy king of Edom
- King Ahaziah of Israel
- And King Jehoram of Judah, Jehoshaphat’s son

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

When Ahab has been king of Israel for four years, Jehoshaphat, son of Asa, becomes king over Judah. Jehoshaphat is 35 years old when Jehoshaphat becomes king of Judah. Jehoshaphat rules in Jerusalem for 25 years. Jehoshaphat’s mother’s name is Azubah. Azubah is the daughter of Shilhi.

Jehoshaphat follows his father Asa’s good example in everything. Jehoshaphat does not turn away from his father’s ways. Jehoshaphat does what Yahweh says is right. However, Jehoshaphat does not remove all the high places. People still go to these shrines to worship, and people continue to offer animals and burn sweet-smelling spices on altars at these places.

And Jehoshaphat makes peace with the king or kings of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am pleased with King Jehoshaphat because he continues to do the good things that his father, King Asa, did. Jehoshaphat trusts me; or
- I am very sad because Jehoshaphat does not completely remove the shrines on the hilltops. This means that people of Judah can still worship idols there; or
- I am very angry, because the people of Judah worship me at the shrines on hilltops. The people know they can only sacrifice to me and pray to me at the temple in Jerusalem.

Continue the drama. People record the other events during Jehoshaphat’s reign in the book called “History of the Kings of Judah.” People also write about Jehoshaphat’s accomplishments and his military victories in that book.

Jehoshaphat removes all the male shrine prostitutes who are still in Judah from the time of his father, King Asa.

Edom has no king of its own. A deputy king rules Edom. Jehoshaphat makes ships of Tarshish to carry gold from the land of Ophir. However, the ships do not sail. The ships break into pieces at the port of Ezion Geber.

Ahaziah, king of Israel and son of Ahab, makes an offer to Jehoshaphat after the shipwreck. Ahaziah wants to persuade Jehoshaphat to build the ships again. Ahaziah suggests to Jehoshaphat that the sailors of Ahaziah go with the sailors of Jehoshaphat in the ships. But Jehoshaphat does not agree. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King Jehoshaphat of Judah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am upset that my ships of Tarshish did not sail after we built them. We wasted so much money to build the ships, and now we cannot even go to the land of Ophir to get gold; or
- I am sad because it looks like Yahweh did not want me to build these ships. Yahweh stopped the ships from sailing; or
- I will be careful not to upset Yahweh again. King Ahaziah of Israel wants me and him to build more ships together. I will not do it.

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Ask the person playing King Ahaziah of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel hopeful. Perhaps King Jehoshaphat will want to build more ships of Tarshish with me; or
- I am excited that Israel can hopefully make this business alliance with Judah. Judah is a strong country, and Yahweh blesses Judah. We can sail together to get gold; or
- I am disappointed that Jehoshaphat refused my proposal to build ships together. Does Jehoshaphat not trust me?

Continue the drama. Then Jehoshaphat dies and goes to be with his ancestors. People bury Jehoshaphat in the City of David, Jehoshaphat’s ancestor, where people buried Jehoshaphat’s other ancestors.

Ahaziah, the son of Ahab, becomes king over Israel in Samaria. This happens in the 17th year of the reign of Jehoshaphat as king of Judah.

Ahaziah does evil things in Yahweh’s sight. Ahaziah acts in the same bad way as his father, King Ahab, and his mother, Jezebel. Ahaziah also behaves like Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who led the people of Israel into sin. Ahaziah serves Baal and worships Baal. Ahaziah makes Yahweh, the God of Israel, angry because Ahaziah does all the same things that Ahaziah’s father, King Ahab, did. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so angry with the kings of Israel! Beginning with Jeroboam, the first king of the northern kingdom, they have worshipped other gods. And each king has followed in the evil steps of his father; or
- I am overwhelmed with sadness. I love the nation of Israel so much and want to have a relationship with them. But the Israelites rejected me. The Israelites do not know me; or
- I feel so sad that the wicked kings have led the people to serve and worship Baal. Do they not know that I am a just God and I will have to punish them for this?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Kings 22:41–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

When Ahab has been **king** of **Israel** for four years, Jehoshaphat, son of Asa, becomes king over **Judah**. Jehoshaphat rules in **Jerusalem** for 25 years. Use the same words or phrases for king, Israel, Judah, and Jerusalem as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, Israel, Judah, and Jerusalem, refer to the Master Glossary.

The word **son** here means a biological son. Use the same word for biological son as you used in previous passages, and refer to son in the Master Glossary if needed.

Jehoshaphat follows his father Asa’s good example in everything; Jehoshaphat does what is right in the eyes of Yahweh. Jehoshaphat does not turn away from his father’s ways. Jehoshaphat does what Yahweh says is right. However, Jehoshaphat does not remove all the “high places,” or places where people worship, often on the hilltops. People still go to these places to worship, and they continue to offer animals and burn sweet-smelling spices on altars at these places.

The word **father** here means biological father. Use the same word for father as you used in previous passages.

Use the same phrase for doing something good or evil “**in the eyes of Yahweh**” as you have used in previous passages.

Yahweh is the personal name of God. Use the same name for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same word or phrase for **high places** as you used in previous passages.

Use the same word or phrase for **worship** and **altar** as you used in previous passages. For more information on worship and altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

Jehoshaphat removes all the **male shrine prostitutes** who are still in Judah after the time of his father, King Asa. Use the same word or phrase for “male shrine prostitutes” as you used in previous passages.

Someone wrote everything that Jehoshaphat did in the book or **scroll** of the history of the kings of Judah. Use the same phrase for “book or scroll of the history of the Kings of Judah” as you have used in previous passages. Refer to scroll in the Master Glossary if needed.

Jehoshaphat makes **ships of Tarshish**, or trading ships, to carry gold from the land of Ophir. Your translation may just say trading ships. Use the same word or phrase for “trading ships,” or “ships of Tarshish” as you used in 1 Kings 10:22.

Stop here and, if needed, look at a photo of a ship of Tarshish again as a group. Pause this audio here.

Ahaziah, king of Israel and son of Ahab, makes an offer to Jehoshaphat after the shipwreck. Ahaziah wants to persuade Jehoshaphat to build the ships again, after the destruction of the ships that Jehoshaphat first built. Ahaziah suggests to Jehoshaphat that the servants of Ahaziah go with the sailors of Jehoshaphat in the ships.

The word **son** here means a biological son. Use the same word for a biological son as you used in previous passages.

Use the same word or phrase for **servant** as you used in previous passages. Remember that Ahaziah calls his sailors “servants” here. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Then Jehoshaphat dies and sleeps with his **fathers**. People bury Jehoshaphat in the **City of David**, Jehoshaphat’s father, where people had buried Jehoshaphat’s other fathers. Then Jehoshaphat’s **son** Jehoram becomes king of Judah in his place. The word father means ancestor in all three cases here. Use the same word or phrase for “City of David” as you used in previous passages. The word son here means a biological son. Use the same word for a biological son as you used in previous passages.

Ahaziah does **evil** things in Yahweh’s sight. Ahaziah acts in the same bad way as his **father**, King Ahab, and his mother, Jezebel. Ahaziah also behaves like Jeroboam, the **son** of Nebat, who led the people of Israel into **sin**. Ahaziah serves **Baal** and worships Baal. Ahaziah makes Yahweh, the God of Israel, angry because Ahaziah does all the same things that Ahaziah’s father, King Ahab, did. The word father means biological father in all three cases here. The word son here means a biological son. Use the same word for a biological son as you used in previous passages. Use the same words or phrases for evil, sin, and Baal as you used in previous passages. For more information on evil, sin, and Baal, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

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Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (974 KB)
- Setting the Stage (8.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (11.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)